

THE COMPLETE WORKS
OF
JOHN GOWER

*EDITED FROM THE MANUSCRIPTS
WITH INTRODUCTIONS, NOTES, AND GLOSSARIES*

BY
G. C. MACAULAY, M.A.
FORMERLY FELLOW OF TRINITY COLLEGE, CAMBRIDGE

* * *

THE ENGLISH WORKS
(*CONFESSIO AMANTIS*, LIB. V. 1971—LIB. VIII; *and IN PRAISE OF PEACE*)

O gentile Engleterre, a toi j'escrits.

Oxford
AT THE CLARENDON PRESS
1901

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Transcriber's Notes

Obvious typographical errors in punctuation have been silently corrected.

Corrections noted in "[CORRIGENDA ET ADDENDA](#)" before page 1 have been corrected in place.

[Page 548](#) - corrected "inital" to "initial"

Footnote [847](#) (original page 208) - Corrected 2513 to 1513

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JOHN GOWER**

G. C. MACAULAY

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HENRY FROWDE, M.A.
PUBLISHER TO THE UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD



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- [p. 1, l. 1981](#), *for one read on*
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CONFESSIO AMANTIS

(LIBER QUINTUS).

iii. *Agros iungit agris cupidus*
domibusque domosque,
Possideat totam sic quasi solus humum.
Solus et innumeros mulierum spirat amores,
*Vt sacra millenis sit sibi culta Venus.*¹

[COVEITISE.]

Dame Avarice is noght soleine,
 Which is of gold the Capiteine;
 Bot of hir Court in sondri wise²
 After the Scol of hire aprise
 Sche hath of Servantz manyon,
 Wherof that Covoitise is on;
 Which goth the large world aboute,
 To seche thavantages oute,⁴
 Wher that he mai the profit winne⁵
 1980 To Avarice, and bringth it inne.
 That on hald and that other draweth,⁶
 Ther is no day which hem bedaweth,
 No mor the Sonne than the Mone,
 Whan ther is eny thing to done,
 And namely with Covoitise;
 For he stant out of al assisse
 Of resonable mannes fare.
 Wher he pourposeth him to fare⁷
 Upon his lucre and his beyete,
 1990 The smale path, the large Strete,
 The furlong and the longe Mile,
 Al is bot on for thilke while:⁸
 And for that he is such on holde,
 Dame Avarice him hath withholde,
 As he which is the principal
 Outward, for he is overal
 A pourveour and an asprie.
 For riht as of an hungri Pie
 The storve bestes ben awaited,
 2000 Riht so is Covoitise afaited

Hic tractat
 confessor super illa
 specie Auaricie,
 que Cupiditas³
 dicitur, quam in
 amoris causa
 pertractans Amanti
 super hoc opponit.

P. ii.
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To loke where he mai pourchace,
For be his wille he wolde embrace⁹
Al that this wyde world beclippeth;
Bot evere he somewhat overhippeth,
That he ne mai noght al fulfille
The lustes of his gredi wille.
Bot where it falleth in a lond,
That Covoitise in myhti hond
Is set, it is ful hard to fiede;

2010 For thanne he takth non other hiede,
Bot that he mai pourchace and gete,
His conscience hath al foryete,
And not what thing it mai amonte
That he schal afterward acompte.
Bote as the Luce in his degre
Of tho that lasse ben than he
The fisshes griedeli devoureth,
So that no water hem socoureth,
Riht so no lawe mai rescowe

2020 Fro him that wol no riht allowe;¹⁰
For wher that such on is of myht,
His will schal stonde in stede of riht.
Thus be the men destruid fulofte,
Til that the grete god alofte
Ayein so gret a covoitise
Redresce it in his oghne wise:
And in ensample of alle tho
I finde a tale write so,
The which, for it is good to liere,

2030 Hierafterward thou schalt it hiere.¹¹

Whan Rome stod in noble plit,
Virgile, which was tho parfit,
A Mirour made of his clergie
And sette it in the tounes ye
Of marbre on a piler withoute;
That thei be thritty Mile aboute
Be daie and ek also be nyhte

P. ii.
195

[TALE OF VIRGIL'S
MIRROR.]

Hic ponit
exemplum contra
magnates cupidos.
Et narrat de Crasso
Romanorum
Imperatore, qui

In that Mirour beholde myhte
Here enemys, if eny were,
2040 With al here ordinance there,
Which thei ayein the Cite caste:
So that, whil thilke Mirour laste,
Ther was no lond which mihte achieve
With werre Rome forto grieve;
Wherof was gret envie tho.
And fell that ilke time so,
That Rome hadde werres stronge
Ayein Cartage, and stoden longe
The tuo Cites upon debat.

2050 Cartage sih the stronge astat¹²
Of Rome in thilke Mirour stonde,
And thoghte al prively to fonde
To overthrowe it be som wyle.
And Hanybal was thilke while
The Prince and ledere of Cartage,
Which hadde set al his corage
Upon knihthod in such a wise,¹³
That he be worthi and be wise
And be non othre was conseiled,¹⁴

2060 Wherof the world is yit merveiled
Of the maistries that he wroghte
Upon the marches whiche he soghte.
And fell in thilke time also,
The king of Puile, which was tho,
Thoghte ayein Rome to rebelle,
And thus was take the querele,
Hou to destruie this Mirour.

Of Rome tho was Emperour¹⁵
Crassus, which was so coveitous,
2070 That he was evere desirous
Of gold to gete the pilage;
Wherof that Puile and ek Cartage
With Philosophres wise and grete

turrim, in qua
speculum Virgilii
Rome fixum
extiterat, dolosa
circumuentus
cupiditate evertit;
vnde non solum sui
ipsius perdicionem,
set tocius Ciuitatis
intollerabile
dampnum
contingere
causauit.

P. ii.
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Begunne of this matiere trete,¹⁶
 And ate laste in this degre
 Ther weren Philosophres thre,
 To do this thing whiche undertoke,
 And therupon thei with hem toke
 A gret tresor of gold in cophres,¹⁷
 2080 To Rome and thus these philisophres
 Togedre in compainie wente,
 Bot noman wiste what thei mente.
 Whan thei to Rome come were,
 So prively thei duelte there,
 As thei that thoghten to deceive:
 Was non that mihte of hem perceive,
 Til thei in sondri stedes have
 Here gold under the ground begrave
 In tuo tresors, that to beholde
 2090 Thei scholden seme as thei were olde.
 And so forth thanne upon a day
 Al openly in good arai
 To themperour thei hem presente,
 And tolden it was here entente
 To duellen under his servise.
 And he hem axeth in what wise;
 And thei him tolde in such a plit,
 That ech of hem hadde a spirit,¹⁸
 The which slepende a nyht appiereth
 2100 And hem be sondri dremes lereth
 After the world that hath betid.
 Under the ground if oght be hid
 Of old tresor at eny throwe,
 They schull it in here swevenes knowe;
 And upon this condicioun,
 Thei sein, what gold under the toun
 Of Rome is hid, thei wole it finde,
 Ther scholde noght be left behinde,¹⁹
 Be so that he the halvendel
 2110 Hem grante, and he assenteth wel;

P. ii.
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P. ii.
 198

And thus cam sleighte forto duelle
 With Covoitise, as I thee telle.
 This Emperour bad redily
 That thei be logged faste by²⁰
 Where he his oghne body lay;
 And whan it was amorwe day,
 That on of hem seith that he mette
 Wher he a goldhord scholde fette:
 Wherof this Emperour was glad,
 2120 And therupon anon he bad
 His Mynours forto go and myne,
 And he himself of that covine
 Goth forth withal, and at his hond
 The tresor redi there he fond,
 Where as thei seide it scholde be;
 And who was thanne glad bot he?
 Upon that other dai secounde
 Thei have an other goldhord founde,
 Which the seconde maister tok
 2130 Upon his swevene and undertok.
 And thus the sothe experience
 To themperour yaf such credence,
 That al his trist and al his feith
 So sikerliche on hem he leith,
 Of that he fond him so relieved,
 That thei ben parfitli believed,
 As thogh thei were goddes thre.
 Nou herkne the soutilete.
 The thridde maister scholde mete,
 2140 Which, as thei seiden, was unmete
 Above hem alle, and couthe most;
 And he withoute noise or bost
 Al priveli, so as he wolde,
 Upon the morwe his swevene tolde
 To themperour riht in his Ere,
 And seide him that he wiste where
 A tresor was so plentivous

Of gold and ek so precious
 Of jeueals and of riche stones,
 2150 That unto alle hise hors at ones²¹
 It were a charge sufficant.
 This lord upon this covenant
 Was glad, and axeth where it was.
 The maister seide, under the glas,
 And tolde him eke, as for the Myn
 He wolde ordeigne such engin,
 That thei the werk schull undersette²²
 With Tymber, that withoute lette
 Men mai the tresor saufli delve,
 2160 So that the Mirour be himselve
 Withoute empeirement schal stonde:
 And this the maister upon honde²³
 Hath undertake in alle weie.
 This lord, which hadde his wit aweie
 And was with Covoitise blent,
 Anon therto yaf his assent;
 And thus they myne forth withal,
 The timber set up overal,
 Wherof the Piler stod upriht;
 2170 Til it befell upon a nyht
 These clerkes, whan thei were war
 Hou that the timber only bar
 The Piler, wher the Mirour stod,—
 Here sleihte noman understod,—
 Thei go be nyhte unto the Myne
 With pich, with souldphre and with rosine,
 And whan the Cite was a slepe,²⁴
 A wylde fyr into the depe
 They caste among the timberwerk,
 2180 And so forth, whil the nyht was derk,
 Desguised in a povere arai
 Thei passeden the toun er dai.
 And whan thei come upon an hell,
 Thei sihen how the Mirour fell,

Wherof thei maden joie ynowh,
 And ech of hem with other lowh,
 And seiden, 'Lo, what coveitise
 Mai do with hem that be noght wise!'
 And that was proved afterward,
 2190 For every lond, to Romeward
 Which hadde be soubgit tofore,
 Whan this Mirour was so forlore
 And thei the wonder herde seie,
 Anon begunne desobeie
 With werres upon every side;
 And thus hath Rome lost his pride
 And was defouled overal.
 For this I finde of Hanybal,
 That he of Romeins in a dai,
 2200 Whan he hem fond out of arai,
 So gret a multitude slowh,
 That of goldringes, whiche he drowh²⁵
 Of gentil handes that ben dede,
 Buisshelles fulle thre, I rede,
 He felde, and made a bregge also,
 That he mihte over Tibre go
 Upon the corps that dede were
 Of the Romeins, whiche he slowh there.²⁶

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Bot now to speke of the juisse,
 2210 The which after the covoitise
 Was take upon this Emperour,
 For he destruide the Mirour;
 It is a wonder forto hier.
 The Romeins maden a chaire
 And sette here Emperour therinne,
 And seiden, for he wolde winne
 Of gold the superfluite,
 Of gold he scholde such plente
 Receive, til he seide Ho:
 2220 And with gold, which thei hadden tho
 Buillende hot withinne a panne,

Into his Mouth thei poure thanne.
And thus the thirst of gold was queynt,
With gold which hadde ben atteignt.

[COVEITISE.]

Confessor.

Wherof, mi Sone, thou miht hiere,
Whan Covoitise hath lost the stiere²⁷
Of resonable governance,
Ther falleth ofte gret vengeance.

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For ther mai be no worse thing
2230 Than Covoitise aboute a king:
If it in his persone be,
It doth the more adversite;
And if it in his conseil stonde,
It bringth alday meschief to honde
Of commun harm; and if it growe
Withinne his court, it wol be knowe,
For thanne schal the king be piled.
The man which hath hise londes tiled,
Awaiteth noght more redily

2240 The Hervest, than thei gredily
Ne maken thanne warde and wacche,
Wher thei the profit mihten cacche:
And yit fulofte it falleth so,
As men mai sen among hem tho,
That he which most coveiteth faste
Hath lest advantage ate laste.
For whan fortune is therayein,
Thogh he coveite, it is in vein;
The happes be noght alle liche,

2250 On is mad povere, an other riche,
The court to some doth profit,
And some ben evere in o plit;
And yit thei bothe aliche sore
Coveite, bot fortune is more
Unto that o part favorable.
And thogh it be noght resonable,
This thing a man mai sen alday,
Wherof that I thee telle may

P. ii.
203

A fair ensample in remembrance,
 2260 Hou every man mot take his chance
 Or of richesse or of poverté.
 Hou so it stonde of the decerte,
 Hier is noght every thing aquit,
 For ofte a man mai se this yit,
 That who best doth, lest thonk schal have;
 It helpeth noght the world to crave,
 Which out of reule and of mesure
 Hath evere stonde in aventure
 Als wel in Court as elles where:
 2270 And hou in olde daies there
 It stod, so as the thinges felle,
 I thenke a tale forto telle.

In a Cronique this I rede.
 Aboute a king, as moste nede,
 Ther was of knyhtes and squiers
 Gret route, and ek of Officers:
 Some of long time him hadden served,
 And thoghten that thei have deserved
 Avancement, and gon withoute;
 2280 And some also ben of the route
 That comen bat a while agon,
 And thei avanced were anon.
 These olde men upon this thing,
 So as thei dorste, ayein the king
 Among hemself compleignen ofte:
 Bot ther is nothing seid so softe,
 That it ne comth out ate laste;
 The king it wiste, and als so faste,²⁹
 As he which was of hih Prudence,
 2290 He schop therfore an evidence
 Of hem that pleignen in that cas,³⁰
 To knowe in whos defalte it was.
 And al withinne his oghne entente,
 That noman wiste what it mente,

[TALE OF THE TWO
COFFERS.]

Hic ponit
 Confessor
 exemplum contra
 illos, qui in
 domibus Regum
 seruientes, pro eo
 quod ipsi
 secundum eorum
 cupiditatem
 promoti non
 existunt, de regio
 servicio quamuis in
 eorum²⁸ defectu
 indiscrete
 murmurant.

P. ii.
 204

Anon he let tuo cofres make
 Of o semblance and of o make,
 So lich that no lif thilke throwe³¹
 That on mai fro that other knowe:
 Thei were into his chambre broght,
 2300 Bot noman wot why thei be wroght,
 And natheles the king hath bede
 That thei be set in prive stede.
 As he that was of wisdom slih,
 Whan he therto his time sih,
 Al prively, that non it wiste,
 Hise oghne hondes that o kiste
 Of fin gold and of fin perrie,
 The which out of his tresorie
 Was take, anon he felde full;
 2310 That other cofre of straw and mull
 With Stones meind he felde also.
 Thus be thei fulle bothe tuo,
 So that erliche upon a day
 He bad withinne, ther he lay,
 Ther scholde be tofore his bed
 A bord upset and faire spred;
 And thanne he let the cofres fette,
 Upon the bord and dede hem sette.
 He knew the names wel of tho,
 2320 The whiche ayein him grucche so,
 Bothe of his chambre and of his halle,
 Anon and sende for hem alle,
 And seide to hem in this wise:
 ‘Ther schal noman his happ despise;
 I wot wel ye have longe served,
 And god wot what ye have deserved:
 Bot if it is along on me
 Of that ye unavanced be,³²
 Or elles it be long on you,
 2330 The sothe schal be proved nou,
 To stoppe with youre evele word.

Lo hier tuo cofres on the bord:
 Ches which you list of bothe tuo;
 And witeth wel that on of tho
 Is with tresor so full begon,
 That if ye happe therupon,
 Ye schull be riche men for evere.
 Now ches and tak which you is levere:
 Bot be wel war, er that ye take;
 2340 For of that on I undertake
 Ther is no maner good therinne,
 Wherof ye mihten profit winne.
 Now goth togedre of on assent
 And taketh youre avisement,
 For bot I you this dai avance,
 It stant upon youre oghne chance
 Al only in defalte of grace:
 So schal be schewed in this place
 Upon you alle wel afyn,
 2350 That no defalte schal be myn.³³
 Thei knelen alle and with o vois
 The king thei thonken of this chois:³⁴
 And after that thei up arise,
 And gon aside and hem avise,
 And ate laste thei acorde;
 Wherof her tale to recorde,
 To what issue thei be falle,³⁵
 A kniht schal speke for hem alle.
 He kneleth down unto the king,
 2360 And seith that thei upon this thing,
 Or forto winne or forto lese,
 Ben alle avised forto chese.
 Tho tok this kniht a yerde on honde,
 And goth there as the cofres stonde,
 And with assent of everichon
 He leith his yerde upon that on,
 And seith the king hou thilke same
 Thei chese in reguerdoun be name,

And preith him that thei mote it have.
 2370 The king, which wolde his honour save,
 Whan he hath herd the commun vois,
 Hath granted hem here oghne choise
 And tok hem therupon the keie.
 Bot for he wolde it were seie
 What good thei have, as thei suppose,
 He bad anon the cofre uncloze,
 Which was fulfild with straw and stones:
 Thus be thei served al at ones.
 This king thanne in the same stede
 2380 Anon that other cofre undede,
 Where as thei sihen gret richesse,
 Wei more than thei couthen gesse.
 ‘Lo,’ seith the king, ‘nou mai ye se
 That ther is no defalte in me;
 Forthi miself I wole aquyte,
 And bereth ye youre oghne wyte
 Of that fortune hath you refused.’
 Thus was this wise king excused,
 And thei lefte of here evele speche
 2390 And mercy of here king beseche.

P. ii.
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Somdiel to this matiere lik
 I finde a tale, hou Frederik,
 Of Rome that time Emperour,
 Herde, as he wente, a gret clamour
 Of tuo beggers upon the weie.
 That on of hem began to seie,
 ‘Ha lord, wel mai the man be riche
 Whom that a king list forto riche.’
 That other saide nothing so,
 Bot, ‘He is riche and wel bego, 2400
 To whom that god wole sende wele.’
 And thus thei maden wordes fele,
 Wherof this lord hath hiede nome,
 And dede hem bothe forto come

[TALE OF THE
 BEGGARS AND THE
 PASTIES.]

Nota hic de
 diuiciarum
 Accidencia: vbi
 narrat qualiter
 Fredericus
 Romanorum
 Imperator duos
 pauperes audiuit
 litigantes, quorum
 vnus dixit, ‘Bene
 potest ditari, quem
 Rex vult ditare.’ Et
 alius dixit, ‘Quem
 deus vult ditare,
 diues erit.’ Que res
 cum ad

To the Paleis, wher he schal ete,
 And bad ordeine for here mete
 Tuo Pastes, whiche he let do make.
 A capoun in that on was bake,
 And in that other forto winne
 Of florins al that mai withinne
 He let do pute a gret richesse;³⁷
 2410 And evene aliche, as man mai gesse,³⁸
 Outward thei were bothe tuo.
 This begger was comanded tho,
 He that which hield him to the king,
 That he ferst chese upon this thing:
 He sih hem, bot he felte hem noght,³⁹
 So that upon his oghne thoght
 He ches the Capoun and forsok
 2420 That other, which his fela tok.
 Bot whanne he wiste hou that it ferde,
 He seide alowd, that men it herde,
 'Nou have I certainly conceived
 That he mai lihtly be deceived,
 That tristeth unto mannes helpe;
 Bot wel is him whom god wol helpe,
 For he stant on the siker side,
 Which elles scholde go beside:
 I se my fela wel recovere,
 2430 And I mot duelle stille povere.'
 Thus spak this begger his entente,
 And povere he cam and povere he wente;
 Of that he hath richesse soght,⁴⁰
 His infortune it wolde noght.
 So mai it schewe in sondri wise,
 Betwen fortune and covoitise
 The chance is cast upon a Dee;
 Bot yit fulofte a man mai se
 Ynowe of suche natheles,
 2440 Whiche evere pute hemself in press
 To gete hem good, and yit thei faile.

experimentum
 postea probata
 fuisset, ille qui
 deum inuocabat
 pastellum auro
 plenum sortitus est,
 alius vero caponis
 pastellum sorte³⁶
 preelegit.

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P. ii.
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And forto speke of this entaile
Touchende of love in thi matiere,
Mi goode Sone, as thou miht hiere,
That riht as it with tho men stod
Of infortune of worldes good,
As thou hast herd me telle above,
Riht so fulofte it stant be love:
Thogh thou coveite it everemore,
2450 Thou schalt noght have o diel the more,
Bot only that which thee is schape,
The remenant is bot a jape.
And natheles ynowe of tho⁴¹
Ther ben, that nou coveiten so,
That where as thei a womman se,
Ye ten or tuelve thogh ther be,
The love is nou so unavised,
That wher the Beaute stant assised,
The mannes herte anon is there,
2460 And rouneth tales in hire Ere,
And seith hou that he loveth streite,
And thus he set him to coveite,
An hundred thogh he sihe aday.
So wolde he more thanne he may;
Bot for the grete covoitise⁴²
Of sotie and of fol emprise
In ech of hem he fint somewhat
That pleseth him, or this or that;
Som on, for sche is whit of skin,
2470 Som on, for sche is noble of kin,
Som on, for sche hath rodi chieke,
Som on, for that sche semeth mieke,
Som on, for sche hath yhen greie,
Som on, for sche can lawhe and pleie,
Som on, for sche is long and smal,
Som on, for sche is lyte and tall,
Som on, for sche is pale and bleche,⁴³
Som on, for sche is softe of speche,

Som on, for that sche is camused,
2480 Som on, for sche hath noght ben used,
Som on, for sche can daunce and singe;
So that som thing to his likinge⁴⁴
He fint, and thogh nomore he fiele,
Bot that sche hath a litel hiele,
It is ynow that he therfore
Hire love, and thus an hundred score,
Whil thei be newe, he wolde he hadde;
Whom he forsakth, sche schal be badde.⁴⁵

Cecus non iudicat
de coloribus.

The blinde man no colour demeth,
2490 But al is on, riht as him semeth;
So hath his lust no juggement,
Whom covoitise of love blent.
Him thenkth that to his covoitise
Hou al the world ne mai suffise,
For be his wille he wolde have alle,
If that it mihte so befalle:
Thus is he commun as the Strete,
I sette noght of his beyete.

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Mi Sone, hast thou such covoitise?
2500 Nai, fader, such love I despise,⁴⁶
And whil I live schal don evere,
For in good feith yit hadde I levere,
Than to coveite in such a weie,
To ben for evere til I deie
As povere as Job, and loveles,
Outaken on, for haveles
His thonkes is noman alyve.
For that a man scholde al unthryve⁴⁷

Confessor.
Amans.

2510 The lawe was noght set so streite:
Forthi miself withal to save,
Such on ther is I wolde have,
And non of al these othre mo.⁴⁸

Mi Sone, of that thou woldest so,

Confessor.

I am noght wroth, bot over this
I wol thee tellen hou it is.
For ther be men, whiche otherwise,
Riht only for the covoitise
Of that thei sen a womman riche,
2520 Ther wol thei al here love affiche;
Noght for the Beaute of hire face,
Ne yit for vertu ne for grace,
Which sche hath elles riht ynowh,
Bot for the Park and for the plowh,
And other thing which therto longeth:
For in non other wise hem longeth⁴⁹
To love, bot thei profit finde;
And if the profit be behinde,
Here love is evere lesse and lesse,
2530 For after that sche hath richesse,
Her love is of proporcion.
If thou hast such condicion,
Mi Sone, tell riht as it is.

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Confessio Amantis.

Min holi fader, nay ywiss,
Condicion such have I non.
For trewli, fader, I love oon
So wel with al myn hertes thoght,
That certes, thogh sche hadde noght,
And were as povere as Medea,
2540 Which was exiled for Creusa,⁵⁰
I wolde hir noght the lasse love;
Ne thogh sche were at hire above,
As was the riche qwen Candace,
Which to deserve love and grace
To Alisandre, that was king,
Yaf many a worthi riche thing,⁵¹
Or elles as Pantasilee,
Which was the quen of Feminee,
And gret richesse with hir nam,
2550 Whan sche for love of Hector cam⁵²

To Troie in rescousse of the toun,—⁵³
 I am of such condicion,
 That thogh mi ladi of hirselve
 Were also riche as suche tuelve,⁵⁴
 I couthe noght, thogh it wer so,
 No betre love hir than I do.
 For I love in so plein a wise,
 That forto speke of coveitise,
 As for poverté or for richesse
 2560 Mi love is nouthér mor né lesse.
 For in good feith I trowe this,
 So coveitous noman ther is,
 Forwhy and he mi ladi sihe,⁵⁵
 That he thurgh lokinge of his yhe⁵⁶
 Né scholde have such a strok withinne,
 That for no gold he mihte winne
 He scholde noght hire love asterte,
 Bot if he lefté there his herte;
 Be so it were such a man,
 2570 That couthe Skile of a womman.
 For ther be men so ruide some,⁵⁷
 Whan thei among the wommen come,
 Thei gon under proteccioun,⁵⁸
 That love and his affeccioun⁵⁹
 Né schal noght take hem be the slieve;
 For thei ben out of that believe,
 Hem lusteth of no ladi chiere,
 Bot evere thenken there and hiere
 Wher that here gold is in the cofre,⁶⁰
 2580 And wol non other love profre:
 Bot who so wot what love amounteth
 And be resoun trewliche acompteth,
 Than mai he knowe and taken hiede
 That al the lust of wommanhiede,
 Which mai ben in a ladi face,
 Mi ladi hath, and ek of grace

If men schull yiven hire a pris,⁶¹
Thei mai wel seie hou sche is wys
And sobre and simple of contenance,
2590 And al that to good governance
Belongeth of a worthi wiht⁶²
Sche hath pleinli: for thilke nyht
That sche was bore, as for the nones
Nature sette in hire at ones
Beaute with bounte so besein,
That I mai wel afferme and sein,
I sawh yit nevere creature
Of comlihed and of feture
In eny kinges regioun
2600 Be lich hire in comparisoun:
And therto, as I have you told,
Yit hath sche more a thousandfold
Of bounte, and schortli to telle,
Sche is the pure hed and welle
And Mirour and ensample of goode.
Who so hir vertus understode,
Me thinkth it oughte ynow suffise
Withouten other covoitise
To love such on and to serve,
2610 Which with hire chiere can deserve
To be beloved betre ywiss
Than sche per cas that richest is
And hath of gold a Milion.
Such hath be myn opinion
And evere schal: bot natheles
I seie noght sche is haveles,
That sche nys riche and wel at ese,
And hath ynow wherwith to plese
Of worldes good whom that hire liste;
2620 Bot o thing wolde I wel ye wiste,
That nevere for no worldes good
Min herte untoward hire stod,
Bot only riht for pure love;

That wot the hihe god above.
Nou, fader, what seie ye therto?

Mi Sone, I seie it is wel do.

Confessor.

For tak of this riht good believe,⁶³
What man that wole himself relieve
To love in eny other wise,

2630He schal wel finde his coveitise

Schal sore grieve him ate laste,
For such a love mai noght laste.
Bot nou, men sein, in oure daies
Men maken bot a fewe assaies,
Bot if the cause be richesse;
Forthi the love is wel the lesse.

And who that wolde ensamples telle,⁶⁴
Be olde daies as thei felle,

Than mihte a man wel understonde

2640Such love mai noght longe stonde.

Now herkne, Sone, and thou schalt hier
A gret ensample of this matiere.

To trete upon the cas of love,
So as we tolden hier above,
I finde write a wonder thing.
Of Puile whilom was a king,
A man of hih complexioun
And yong, bot his affeccioun
After the nature of his age
Was yit noght falle in his corage
The lust of wommen forto knowe.
So it betidde upon a throwe
This lord fell into gret seknesse:
Phisque hath don the besinesse
Of sondri cures manyon
To make him hol; and therupon
A worthi maister which ther was

2650Yaf him conseil upon this cas,⁶⁵

That if he wolde have parfit hele,

[TALE OF THE KING
AND HIS STEWARD'S
WIFE.]

Hic ponit
exemplum contra
istos qui non
propter amorem
sed propter diuicias
sponsalia sumunt.
Et narrat de
quodam Regis
Apulie
Seneschallo, qui
non solum propter
pecuniam vxorem
duxit, set eciam
pecunie
commercio vxorem
sibi desponsatam
vendidit.

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2660 He scholde with a womman dele,
A freissh, a yong, a lusti wiht,
To don him compaignie a nyht;
For thanne he seide him redily,
That he schal be al hol therby,
And otherwise he kneu no cure.

This king, which stod in aventure⁶⁶
Of lif and deth, for medicine
Assented was, and of covine
His Steward, whom he tristeth wel,
2670 He tok, and tolde him everydel,
Hou that this maister hadde seid:⁶⁷
And therupon he hath him preid
And charged upon his ligance,
That he do make porveance
Of such on as be covenable
For his plesance and delitable;
And bad him, hou that evere it stod,
That he schal spare for no good,
For his will is riht wel to paie.

2680 The Steward seide he wolde assaie:
Bot nou hierafter thou schalt wite,
As I finde in the bokes write,⁶⁸
What coveitise in love doth.
This Steward, forto telle soth,
Amonges al the men alyve⁶⁹
A lusti ladi hath to wyve,
Which natheles for gold he tok
And noght for love, as seith the bok.
A riche Marchant of the lond

2690 Hir fader was, and hire fond⁷⁰
So worthily, and such richesse
Of worldes good and such largesse
With hire he yaf in mariage,
That only for thilke advantage⁷¹
Of good this Steward hath hire take,

For lucre and noght for loves sake,⁷²
And that was afterward wel seene;
Nou herkne what it wolde meene.

This Steward in his oghne herte
2700 Sih that his lord mai noght asterte
His maladie, bot he have
A lusti womman him to save,
And thoghte he wolde yive ynowh
Of his tresor; wherof he drowh
Gret coveitise into his mynde,
And sette his honour fer behynde.
Thus he, whom gold hath overset,
Was trapped in his oghne net;
The gold hath mad hise wittes lame,
2710 So that sechende his oghne schame
He rouneth in the kinges Ere,
And seide him that he wiste where
A gentile and a lusti on
Tho was, and thider wolde he gon:⁷³
Bot he mot yive yiftes grete;
For bot it be thurgh gret beyete
Of gold, he seith, he schal noght spede.
The king him bad upon the nede
That take an hundred pound he scholde,
2720 And yive it where that he wolde,
Be so it were in worthi place:
And thus to stonde in loves grace
This king his gold hath abandouned.
And whan this tale was full rouned,
The Steward tok the gold and wente,
Withinne his herte and many a wente
Of coveitise thanne he caste,
Wherof a pourpos ate laste
Ayein love and ayein his riht
2730 He tok, and seide hou thilke nyht
His wif schal ligge be the king;
And goth thenkende upon this thing

Toward his In, til he cam hom
 Into the chambre, and thanne he nom
 His wif, and tolde hire al the cas.⁷⁴
 And sche, which red for schame was,
 With bothe hire handes hath him preid⁷⁵
 Knelende and in this wise seid,⁷⁶
 That sche to reson and to skile
 2740 In what thing that he bidde wile⁷⁷
 Is redy forto don his heste,
 Bot this thing were noght honeste,
 That he for gold hire scholde selle.
 And he tho with hise wordes felle
 Forth with his gastly contenance
 Seith that sche schal don obeissance
 And folwe his will in every place;
 And thus thurgh strengthe of his manace
 Hir innocence is overlad,
 2750 Wherof sche was so sore adrad
 That sche his will mot nede obeie.
 And therupon was schape a weie,⁷⁸
 That he his oghne wif be nyhte
 Hath out of alle mennes sihte
 So prively that non it wiste
 Broght to the king, which as him liste
 Mai do with hire what he wolde.
 For whan sche was ther as sche scholde,
 With him abedde under the cloth,
 2760 The Steward tok his leve and goth
 Into a chambre faste by;⁷⁹
 Bot hou he slep, that wot noght I,
 For he sih cause of jelousie.
 Bot he, which hath the compainie
 Of such a lusti on as sche,
 Him thoghte that of his degre
 Ther was noman so wel at ese:
 Sche doth al that sche mai to plese,

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So that his herte al hol sche hadde;
 2770 And thus this king his joie ladde,
 Til it was nyh upon the day.⁸⁰
 The Steward thanne wher sche lay
 Cam to the bedd, and in his wise⁸¹
 Hath bede that sche scholde arise.
 The king seith, 'Nay, sche schal noght go.'
 His Steward seide ayein, 'Noght so;⁸²
 For sche mot gon er it be knowe,
 And so I swor at thilke throwe,
 Whan I hire fette to you hierе.'⁸³
 2780 The king his tale wol noght hierе,⁸⁴
 And seith hou that he hath hire boght,
 Forthi sche schal departe noght,
 Til he the brighte dai beholde.
 And cawhte hire in hise armes folde,
 As he which liste forto pleie,
 And bad his Steward gon his weie,
 And so he dede ayein his wille.
 And thus his wif abedde stille
 Lay with the king the longe nyht,
 2790 Til that it was hih Sonne lyht;
 Bot who sche was he knew nothing.
 Tho cam the Steward to the king
 And preide him that withoute schame⁸⁵
 In savinge of hire goode name
 He myhte leden hom ayein
 This lady, and hath told him plein
 Hou that it was his oghne wif.
 The king his Ere unto this strif
 Hath leid, and whan that he it herde,
 2800 Welnyh out of his wit he ferde,
 And seide, 'Ha, caitif most of alle,
 Wher was it evere er this befalle,
 That eny cokard in this wise
 Betok his wif for coveitise?

Thou hast bothe hire and me beguiled
And ek thin oghne astat reviled,
Wherof that buxom unto thee
Hierafter schal sche nevere be.
For this avou to god I make,
2810After this day if I thee take,
Thou schalt ben honged and todrawe.
Nou loke anon thou be withdrawe,
So that I se thee neveremore.’
This Steward thanne dradde him sore,
With al the haste that he mai
And fledde awei that same dai,⁸⁶
And was exiled out of londe.

Lo, there a nyce housebonde,
Which thus hath lost his wif for evere!
2820Bot natheles sche hadde a levere;
The king hire weddeth and honoureth,
Wherof hire name sche socoureth,
Which erst was lost thurgh coveitise
Of him, that ladde hire other wise,
And hath himself also forlore.

Mi Sone, be thou war therfore,
Wher thou schalt love in eny place,
That thou no covoitise embrace,
The which is noght of loves kinde.

Confessor.

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2830Bot for al that a man mai finde
Nou in this time of thilke rage
Ful gret desese in mariage,
Whan venym melleth with the Sucre
And mariage is mad for lucre,
Or for the lust or for the hele:
What man that schal with outhere dele,⁸⁷
He mai noght faile to repente.

Mi fader, such is myn entente:
Bot natheles good is to have,
2840For good mai ofte time save
The love which scholde elles spille.

Amans.

Bot god, which wot myn hertes wille,
 I dar wel take to witnesse,
 Yit was I nevere for richesse
 Beset with mariage non;
 For al myn herte is upon on
 So frely, that in the persone
 Stant al my worldes joie al one:
 I axe nouthur Park ne Plowh,
 2850 If I hire hadde, it were ynowh,
 Hir love scholde me suffise
 Withouten other coveitise.
 Lo now, mi fader, as of this,
 Touchende of me riht as it is,
 Mi schrifte I am beknowe plein;
 And if ye wole oght elles sein,⁸⁸
 Of covoitise if ther be more
 In love, agropeth out the sore.

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iv. *Fallere cum nequeat propria vir
 fraude, subornat*

[FALSE WITNESS
 AND PERJURY.]

*Testes, sit quod eis vera retorta fides.*⁸⁹
Sicut agros cupidus dum querit amans mulieres,
*Vult testes falsos falsus habere suos.*⁹⁰
Non sine vindicta periurus abibit in eius
Visu, qui cordis intima cuncta videt.
*Fallere periuro non est laudanda puellam*⁹¹
Gloria, set false condicionis opus.

Mi Sone, thou schalt understonde
 2860 Hou Coveitise hath yit on honde
 In special tuo conseilours,
 That ben also hise procurours.
 The ferst of hem is Falswitnesse,⁹³
 Which evere is redi to witnesse
 What thing his maister wol him hote:
 Perjurie is the secounde hote,⁹⁴
 Which spareth noght to swere an oth,

Hic tractat super
 illis⁹² Auaricie
 speciebus, que
 falsum
 Testimonium et
 Periurium

Thogh it be fals and god be wroth.⁹⁶
 That on schal falswitnessse bere,
 2870 That other schal the thing forswere,
 Whan he is charged on the bok.
 So what with hepe and what with crok⁹⁷
 Thei make here maister ofte winne
 And wol noght knowe what is sinne
 For coveitise, and thus, men sain,
 Thei maken many a fals bargain.
 Ther mai no trewe querele arise
 In thilke queste and thilke assise,⁹⁸
 Where as thei tuo the poeple enforme;
 2880 For thei kepe evere o maner forme,
 That upon gold here conscience
 Thei founde, and take here evidence;
 And thus with falswitnessse and othes
 Thei winne hem mete and drinke and clothes.
 Riht so ther be, who that hem knewe,
 Of thes lovers ful many untrewē:
 Nou mai a womman finde ynowe,
 That ech of hem, whan he schal wowe,
 Anon he wole his hand down lein
 2890 Upon a bok, and swere and sein
 That he wole feith and trouthe bere;
 And thus he profreth him to swere
 To serven evere til he die,
 And al is verai tricherie.
 For whan the sothe himselven trieth,
 The more he swerth, the more he lieth;
 Whan he his feith makth althermest,
 Than mai a womman truste him lest;
 For til he mai his will achieve,
 2900 He is no lengere forto lieve.⁹⁹
 Thus is the trouthe of love exiled,
 And many a good womman beguiled.
 And ek to speke of Falswitnessse,

nuncupantur;
 quorum
 fraudulenta
 circumuencio tam
 in cupiditatis⁹⁵
 quam in amoris
 causa sui desiderii
 propositum
 quamsepe fallaciter
 attingit.

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[FALSE WITNESS.]
 Confessor.

There be nou many suche, I gesse, [100](#)
 That lich unto the provisours
 Thei make here prive procurours, [101](#)
 To telle hou ther is such a man,
 Which is worthi to love and can
 Al that a good man scholde kunne;
 2910 So that with lesinge is begunne
 The cause in which thei wole procede,
 And also siker as the crede
 Thei make of that thei knowen fals.
 And thus fulofte aboute the hals
 Love is of false men embraced;
 Bot love which is so pourchaced
 Comth afterward to litel pris.
 Forthi, mi Sone, if thou be wis,
 Nou thou hast herd this evidence,
 2920 Thou miht thin oghne conscience
 Oppose, if thou hast ben such on.
 Nai, god wot, fader, I am non,
 Ne nevere was; for as men seith,
 Whan that a man schal make his feith,
 His herte and tunge moste acorde;
 For if so be that thei discorde,
 Thanne is he fals and elles noght:
 And I dar seie, as of my thoght,
 In love it is noght descordable
 2930 Unto mi word, bot acordable.
 And in this wise, fader, I
 Mai riht wel swere and salvely, [102](#)
 That I mi ladi love wel,
 For that acordeth everydel.
 It nedeth noght to mi sothsawe
 That I witnesse scholde drawe,
 Into this dai for nevere yit [103](#)
 Ne mihte it sinke into mi wit,
 That I my conseil scholde seie

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Amans.

2940 To eny wiht, or me bewreie¹⁰⁴
 To sechen help in such manere,
 Bot only of mi ladi diere.¹⁰⁵
 And thogh a thousand men it wiste,
 That I hire love, and thanne hem liste
 With me to swere and to witesse,
 Yit were that no falswitesse;
 For I dar on this trouthe duelle,
 I love hire mor than I can telle.
 Thus am I, fader, gulteles,
 2950 As ye have herd, and natheles
 In youre dom I put it al.¹⁰⁶
 Mi Sone, wite in special,
 It schal noght comunliche faile,
 Al thogh it for a time availe
 That Falswitesse his cause spede,
 Upon the point of his falshiede
 It schal wel afterward be kid;
 Wherof, so as it is betid,
 Ensamle of suche thinges blinde
 2960 In a Cronique write I finde.

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Confessor.

The Goddesse of the See Thetis,
 Sche hadde a Sone, and his name is
 Achilles, whom to kepe and warde,
 Whil he was yong, as into warde¹⁰⁷
 Sche thoghte him salfly to betake,
 As sche which dradde for his sake¹⁰⁸
 Of that was seid in prophecie,¹⁰⁹
 That he at Troie scholde die,
 Whan that the Cite was belein.
 2970 Forthi, so as the bokes sein,
 Sche caste hire wit in sondri wise,
 Hou sche him mihte so disguise
 That noman scholde his bodi knowe:
 And so befell that ilke throwe,

[TALE OF ACHILLES
 AND DEIDAMIA.]

Hic ponit
 exemplum de illis,
 qui falsum
 testificantes amoris
 innocenciam
 circumueniunt. Et
 narrat qualiter
 Thetis Achillem
 filium suum
 adolescentem,
 muliebri vestitum
 apparatu, asserens
 esse puellam inter
 Regis Lichomedis
 filias ad
 educandum

Whil that sche thoghte upon this dede, [110](#)
Ther was a king, which Lichomede
Was hote, and he was wel begon
With faire dowhtres manyon,
And duelte fer out in an yle.

produxit. Et sic
Achilles decepto
Rege filie sue
Deidamie socia et
cubicularia effectus
super ipsam Pirrum
genuit; qui postea
mire probitatis
miliciam assecutus
mortem patris sui
apud Troiam in
Polixenen tirannice
vindicauit.

Nou schalt thou hiere a wonder wyle:
This queene, which the moder was
Of Achilles, upon this cas
Hire Sone, as he a Maiden were,
Let clothen in the same gere
2980 Which longeth unto wommanhiede:
And he was yong and tok non hiede,
Bot soffreth al that sche him dede.
Wherof sche hath hire wommen bede
And charged be here othes alle,

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2990 Hou so it afterward befalle,
That thei discovere noght this thing,
Bot feigne and make a knowleching,
Upon the conseil which was nome,
In every place wher thei come
To telle and to witnesse this,
Hou he here ladi dowhter is. [111](#)
And riht in such a maner wise
Sche bad thei scholde hire don servise,
So that Achilles underfongeth

3000 As to a yong ladi belongeth
Honour, servise and reverence.
For Thetis with gret diligence
Him hath so tawht and so afaited,
That, hou so that it were awaited, [112](#)
With sobre and goodli contenance
He scholde his wommanhiede avance,
That non the sothe knowe myhte,
Bot that in every mannes syhte
He scholde seme a pure Maide.

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3010 And in such wise as sche him saide,
Achilles, which that ilke while

Was yong, upon himself to smyle
Began, whan he was so besein.

And thus, after the bokes sein,
With frette of Perle upon his hed,
Al freissh betwen the whyt and red,
As he which tho was tendre of Age,
Stod the colour in his visage,
That forto loke upon his cheke
3020 And sen his childly manere eke,
He was a womman to beholde.
And thanne his moder to him tolde,
That sche him hadde so begon
Be cause that sche thoghte gon
To Lichomede at thilke tyde,
Wher that sche seide he scholde abyde¹¹³
Among hise dowhtres forto duelle.

Achilles herde his moder telle,
And wiste noght the cause why;
3030 And natheles ful buxomly
He was redy to that sche bad,
Wherof his moder was riht glad,¹¹⁴
To Lichomede and forth thei wente.
And whan the king knew hire entente,
And sih this yonge dowhter there,
And that it cam unto his Ere
Of such record, of such witesse,
He hadde riht a gret gladnesse
Of that he bothe syh and herde,
3040 As he that wot noght hou it ferde
Upon the conseil of the nede.
Bot for al that king Lichomede
Hath toward him this dowhter take,
And for Thetis his moder sake
He put hire into compainie¹¹⁵
To duelle with Deïdamie,¹¹⁶
His oghne dowhter, the eldeste,
The faireste and the comelieste

Of alle hise doghtres whiche he hadde.
 3050 Lo, thus Thetis the cause ladde,
 And lefte there Achilles feigned,
 As he which hath himself restreigned
 In al that evere he mai and can
 Out of the manere of a man,^{[117](#)}
 And tok his wommannyssh chiere,
 Wherof unto his beddefere
 Deïdamie he hath be nyhte.
 Wher kinde wole himselve rihte,^{[118](#)}
 After the Philosophres sein,
 3060 Ther mai no wiht be therayein:
 And that was thilke time seene.
 The longe nyhtes hem betuene
 Nature, which mai noght forbere,
 Hath mad hem bothe forto stere
 Thei kessen ferst, and overmore
 The hihe weie of loves lore
 Thei gon, and al was don in dede,
 Wherof lost is the maydenhede;
 And that was afterward wel knowe.
 3070 For it befell that ilke throwe
 At Troie, wher the Siege lay
 Upon the cause of Menelay
 And of his queene dame Heleine,
 The Gregois hadden mochel peine
 Alday to fihte and to assaile.
 Bot for thei mihten noght availe
 So noble a Cite forto winne,
 A prive conseil thei beginne,
 In sondri wise wher thei trete;
 3080 And ate laste among the grete
 Thei fellen unto this acord,
 That Protheüs, of his record
 Which was an Astronomen
 And ek a gret Magicien,
 Scholde of his calculacion

Seche after constellacion,
 Hou thei the Cite mihten gete:
 And he, which hadde noght foryete
 Of that belongeth to a clerk,
 3090 His studie sette upon this werk. [119](#)
 So longe his wit aboute he caste,
 Til that he fond out ate laste,
 Bot if they hadden Achilles
 Here werre schal ben endeles.
 And over that he tolde hem plein
 In what manere he was besein,
 And in what place he schal be founde;
 So that withinne a litel stounde
 Ulixes forth with Diomede
 3100 Upon this point to Lichomede
 Agamenon togedre sente.
 Bot Ulixes, er he forth wente,
 Which was on of the moste wise,
 Ordeigned hath in such a wise,
 That he the moste riche aray,
 Wherof a womman mai be gay,
 With him hath take manyfold,
 And overmore, as it is told,
 An harneis for a lusti kniht,
 3110 Which burned was as Selver bryht, [120](#)
 Of swerd, of plate and ek of maile,
 As thogh he scholde to bataille,
 He tok also with him be Schipe.
 And thus togedre in felaschipe
 Forth gon this Diomede and he
 In hope til thei mihten se
 The place where Achilles is.
 The wynd stod thanne noght amis,
 Bot evene topseilcole it blew, [121](#)
 3120 Til Ulixes the Marche knew,
 Wher Lichomede his Regne hadde.
 The Stieresman so wel hem ladde,

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That thei ben comen sauf to londe,
 Wher thei gon out upon the stronde
 Into the Burgh, wher that thei founde
 The king, and he which hath facounde,
 Ulixes, dede the message.
 Bot the conseil of his corage,
 Why that he cam, he tolde noght,
 3130 Bot undernethe he was bethoght
 In what manere he mihte asprie
 Achilles fro Deïdamie
 And fro these othre that ther were,
 Full many a lusti ladi there.
 Thei pleide hem there a day or tuo,
 And as it was fortunèd so,
 It fell that time in such a wise,
 To Bachus that a sacrificise
 Thes yonge ladys scholden make;
 3140 And for the strange mennes sake,
 That comen fro the Siege of Troie,
 Thei maden wel the more joie.
 Ther was Revel, ther was daunsinge,
 And every lif which coude singe
 Of lusti wommen in the route¹²²
 A freissh carole hath sunge aboute;
 Bot for al this yit natheles
 The Greks unknowe of Achilles
 So weren, that in no degre
 3150 Thei couden wite which was he,
 Ne be his vois, ne be his pas.
 Ulixes thanne upon this cas¹²³
 A thing of hih Prudence hath wrought:
 For thilke aray, which he hath broght
 To yive among the wommen there,
 He let do fetten al the gere
 Forth with a knihtes harneis eke,—
 In al a contre forto seke¹²⁴
 Men scholden noght a fairer se,—

3160 And every thing in his degre
 Endlong upon a bord he leide.
 To Lichomede and thanne he preide
 That every ladi chese scholde
 What thing of alle that sche wolde,
 And take it as be weie of yifte;
 For thei hemself it scholde schifte,
 He seide, after here oghne wille.
 Achilles thanne stod noght stille:
 Whan he the bryhte helm behield, ¹²⁵
 3170 The swerd, the hauberk and the Schield,
 His herte fell therto anon;
 Of all that othre wolde he non,
 The knihtes gere he underfongeth,
 And thilke aray which that belongeth
 Unto the wommen he forsok.
 And in this wise, as seith the bok,
 Thei knowen thanne which he was:
 For he goth forth the grete pas
 Into the chambre where he lay;
 3180 Anon, and made no delay,
 He armeth him in knyhtli wise,
 That bettre can noman devise,
 And as fortune scholde falle,
 He cam so forth tofore hem alle,
 As he which tho was glad ynowh.
 But Lichomede nothing lowh,
 Whan that he syh hou that it ferde,
 For thanne he wiste wel and herde,
 His dowhter hadde be forlein;
 3190 Bot that he was so oversein,
 The wonder overgoth his wit.
 For in Cronique is write yit ¹²⁶
 Thing which schal nevere be foryete,
 Hou that Achilles hath begete
 Pirrus upon Deïdamie,
 Wherof cam out the tricherie

Of Falswitness, whan thei saide¹²⁷
Hou that Achilles was a Maide.
Bot that was nothing sene tho,
3200 For he is to the Siege go
Forth with Ulix and Diomede.

Lo, thus was proved in the dede Confessor.
And fulli spoke at thilke while:
If o womman an other guile,
Wher is ther eny sikernesse?
Whan Thetis, which was the goddesse,
Deïdamie hath so bejaped,
I not hou it schal ben ascaped
With tho wommen whos innocence¹²⁸

3210 Is nou alday thurgh such credence¹²⁹
Deceived ofte, as it is seene,
With men that such untrouthe meene.
For thei ben slyhe in such a wise,
That thei be sleihte and be queintise
Of Falswitness bringen inne
That doth hem ofte forto winne,
Wher thei ben noght worthi therto.¹³⁰
Forthi, my Sone, do noght so.

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Mi fader, as of Falswitness
3220 The trouthe and the matiere expresse,
Touchende of love hou it hath ferd,
As ye have told, I have wel herd.
Bot for ye seiden otherwise,
Hou thilke vice of Covoitise
Hath yit Perjurie of his acord,¹³¹
If that you list of som record
To telle an other tale also
In loves cause of time ago,
What thing it is to be forswore,
3230 I wolde preie you therfore,
Wherof I mihte ensample take.

[PERJURY.]

Amans

Mi goode Sone, and for thi sake Confessor.

Touchende of this I schal fulfillle
 Thin axinge at thin oghne wille,
 And the matiere I schal declare,
 Hou the wommen deceived are,
 Whan thei so tendre herte bere, [132](#)
 Of that thei hieren men so swere;
 Bot whan it comth unto thassay,
 3240Thei finde it fals an other day:
 As Jason dede to Medee, [133](#)
 Which stant yet of Auctorite
 In tokne and in memorial;
 Wherof the tale in special
 Is in the bok of Troie write,
 Which I schal do thee forto wite. [134](#)

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In Grece whilom was a king,
 Of whom the fame and knowleching
 Beleveth yit, and Peleüs
 3250He hihte; bot it fell him thus,
 That his fortune hir whiel so ladde
 That he no child his oghne hadde
 To regnen after his decess.
 He hadde a brother natheles,
 Whos rihte name was Eson,
 And he the worthi kniht Jason
 Begat, the which in every lond
 Alle othre passede of his hond
 In Armes, so that he the beste
 3260Was named and the worthieste,
 He soghte worschipe overal.
 Nou herkne, and I thee telle schal
 An aventure that he soghte,
 Which afterward ful dere he boghte.
 Ther was an yle, which Colchos
 Was cleped, and therof aros
 Gret speche in every lond aboute,
 That such merveile was non oute

[TALE OF JASON
 AND MEDEA.]

Hic in amoris
 causa ponit
 exemplum contra
 periuros. Et narrat
 qualiter Iason,
 priusquam ad
 insulam Colchos
 pro aureo vellere
 ibidem
 conquestando
 transmearet, in
 amorem et
 coniugium Medee
 Regis Othonis filie
 iuramento firmitus
 se astrinxit; set suo
 postea completo
 negocio, cum
 ipsam secum
 nauigio in Greciam
 perduxisset, vbi
 illa senectam [135](#)
 patris sui Esonis in
 floridam

In al the wyde world nawhere,
 3270As tho was in that yle there.
 Ther was a Schiep, as it was told,
 The which his flees bar al of gold,
 And so the goddes hadde it set,
 That it ne mihte awei be fet
 Be pouer of no worldes wiht:
 And yit ful many a worthi kniht
 It hadde assaied, as thei dorste,
 And evere it fell hem to the worste.
 Bot he, that wolde it noght forsake,
 3280Bot of his knyghthod undertake
 To do what thing therto belongeth,¹³⁶
 This worthi Jason, sore alongeth
 To se the strange regiouns
 And knowe the condiciouns
 Of othre Marches, where he wente;
 And for that cause his hole entente
 He sette Colchos forto seche,
 And therupon he made a speche
 To Peleüs his Em the king.
 3290And he wel paid was of that thing;¹³⁷
 And schop anon for his passage,
 And suche as were of his lignage,
 With othre knihtes whiche he ches,
 With him he tok, and Hercules,
 Which full was of chivalerie,¹³⁸
 With Jason wente in compaignie;
 And that was in the Monthe of Maii,
 Whan colde stormes were away.
 The wynd was good, the Schip was yare,
 3300Thei tok here leve, and forth thei fare¹³⁹
 Toward Colchos: bot on the weie
 What hem befell is long to seie;
 Hou Lamedon the king of Troie,
 Which oghte wel have mad hem joie,¹⁴⁰

iuuentutem
 mirabili sciencia
 reformauit, ipse
 Iason fidei sue
 ligamento aliisque
 beneficiis
 postpositis, dictam
 Medeam pro
 quadam Creusa
 Regis Creontis filia
 periurus dereliquit.

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Whan thei to reste a while him preide,
 Out of his lond he hem congeide;¹⁴¹
 And so fell the dissencion,
 Which after was destruccion
 Of that Cite, as men mai hiere:
 3310 Bot that is noght to mi matiere.
 Bot thus this¹⁴² worthi folk Gregeis¹⁴³
 Fro that king, which was noght curteis,
 And fro his lond with Sail updrawe
 Thei wente hem forth, and many a sawe
 Thei made and many a gret manace,
 Til ate laste into that place
 Which as thei soghte thei aryve,
 And striken Sail, and forth as blyve
 Thei sente unto the king and tolden
 3320 Who weren ther and what thei wolden.
 Oëtes, which was thanne king,¹⁴⁴
 Whan that he herde this tyding
 Of Jason, which was comen there,
 And of these othre, what thei were,
 He thoghte don hem gret worschipe:
 For thei anon come out of Schipe,
 And strawht unto the king thei wente,
 And be the hond Jason he hente,
 And that was ate paleis gate,
 3330 So fer the king cam on his gate
 Toward Jason to don him chiere;
 And he, whom lacketh no manere,
 Whan he the king sih in presence,
 Yaf him ayein such reverence
 As to a kinges stat belongeth.
 And thus the king him underfongeth,
 And Jason in his arm he cawhte,
 And forth into the halle he strawhte,
 And ther they siete and spieke of thinges,
 3340 And Jason tolde him tho tidinges,¹⁴⁵
 Why he was come, and faire him preide

To haste his time, and the kyng seide,
 'Jason, thou art a worthi kniht,
 Bot it lith in no mannes myht
 To don that thou art come fore:
 Ther hath be many a kniht forlore
 Of that thei wolden it assaie.'
 Bot Jason wolde him noght esmaie,
 And seide, 'Of every worldes cure
 3350 Fortune stant in aventure,
 Per aunter wel, per aunter wo:
 Bot hou as evere that it go,
 It schal be with myn hond assaied.'
 The king tho hield him noght wel paied,
 For he the Grekes sore dredde,
 In aunter, if Jason ne spedde,
 He mihte therof bere a blame;
 For tho was al the worldes fame
 In Grece, as forto speke of Armes.
 3360 Forthi he dredde him of his harmes,
 And gan to preche him and to preie;
 Bot Jason wolde noght obeie,
 Bot seide he wolde his porpos holde
 For ought that eny man him tolde.
 The king, whan he thes wordes herde, [146](#)
 And sih hou that this kniht ansuerde,
 Yit for he wolde make him glad,
 After Medea gon he bad,
 Which was his dowhter, and sche cam.
 3370 And Jason, which good hiede nam,
 Whan he hire sih, ayein hire goth;
 And sche, which was him nothing loth,
 Welcomede him into that lond,
 And softe tok him be the hond,
 And down thei seten bothe same.
 Sche hadde herd spoke of his name [147](#)
 And of his grete worthinesse;
 Forthi sche gan hir yhe impresse

Upon his face and his stature,
 3380 And thoghte hou nevere creature
 Was so wel farende as was he.
 And Jason riht in such degre
 Ne mihte noght withholde his lok,
 Bot so good hiede on hire he tok,
 That him ne thoghte under the hevene
 Of Beaute sawh he nevere hir evene,
 With al that fell to wommanhiede.
 Thus ech of other token hiede,
 Thogh ther no word was of record;
 3390 Here hertes bothe of on acord
 Ben set to love, bot as tho
 Ther mihten be no wordes mo.
 The king made him gret joie and feste, [148](#)
 To alle his men he yaf an heste,
 So as thei wolde his thonk deserve,
 That thei scholde alle Jason serve,
 Whil that he wolde there duelle.
 And thus the dai, schortly to telle,
 With manye merthes thei despente,
 3400 Til nyht was come, and tho thei wente,
 Echon of other tok his leve,
 Whan thei no lengere myhten leve.
 I not hou Jason that nyht slep,
 Bot wel I wot that of the Schep,
 For which he cam into that yle,
 He thoghte bot a litel whyle;
 Al was Medea that he thoghte,
 So that in many a wise he soghte
 His witt wakende er it was day,
 3410 Som time yee, som time nay,
 Som time thus, som time so,
 As he was stered to and fro
 Of love, and ek of his conqueste
 As he was holde of his behest.
 And thus he ros up be the morwe

And tok himself seint John to borwe,
And seide he wolde ferst beginne
At love, and after forto winne
The flees of gold, for which he com,
3420 And thus to him good herte he nom.

Medea riht the same wise,
Til dai cam that sche moste arise,¹⁴⁹
Lay and bethoughte hire al the nyht,
Hou sche that noble worthi kniht
Be eny weie mihte wedde:
And wel sche wiste, if he ne spedde
Of thing which he hadde undertake,
Sche mihte herself no porpos take;
For if he deide of his bataile,
3430 Sche moste thanne algate faile
To geten him, whan he were ded.
Thus sche began to sette red
And torne aboute hir wittes alle,
To loke hou that it mihte falle
That sche with him hadde a leisir
To speke and telle of hir desir.
And so it fell that same day¹⁵⁰
That Jason with that suete may
Togedre sete and hadden space
3440 To speke, and he besoughte hir grace.¹⁵¹
And sche his tale goodli herde,
And afterward sche him ansuerde
And seide, 'Jason, as thou wilt,
Thou miht be sauf, thou miht be spilt;
For wite wel that nevere man,
Bot if he couthe that I can,
Ne mihte that fortune achieve
For which thou comst: bot as I lieve,
If thou wolt holde covenant
3450 To love, of al the remenant
I schal thi lif and honour save,
That thou the flees of gold schalt have.'

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He seide, 'Al at youre oghne wille,
 Ma dame, I schal treuly fulfille
 Youre heste, whil mi lif mai laste.'
 Thus longe he preide, and ate laste
 Sche granteth, and behihte him this,
 That whan nyht comth and it time is,
 Sche wolde him sende certainly
 3460 Such on that scholde him prively
 Al one into hire chambre bringe.
 He thonketh hire of that tidinge,
 For of that grace him is begonne
 Him thenkth alle othre thinges wonne.
 The dai made ende and lost his lyht, [152](#)
 And comen was the derke nyht,
 Which al the daies yhe blente.
 Jason tok leve and forth he wente,
 And whan he cam out of the pres,
 3470 He tok to conseil Hercules,
 And tolde him hou it was betid,
 And preide it scholde wel ben hid, [153](#)
 And that he wolde loke aboute,
 Therwhiles that he schal ben oute.
 Thus as he stod and hiede nam,
 A Mayden fro Medea cam
 And to hir chambre Jason ledde,
 Wher that he fond redi to bedde
 The faireste and the wiseste eke;
 3480 And sche with simple chiere and meke,
 Whan sche him sih, wax al aschamed. [154](#)
 Tho was here tale newe entamed; [155](#)
 For sikernesse of Mariage
 Sche fette forth a riche ymage, [156](#)
 Which was figure of Jupiter,
 And Jason swor and seide ther,
 That also wiss god scholde him helpe,
 That if Medea dede him helpe,

That he his pourpos myhte wtnne,
3490Thei scholde nevere parte atwinne,¹⁵⁷
Bot evere whil him lasteth lif,
He wolde hire holde for his wif.
And with that word thei kisten bothe;
And for thei scholden hem unclothe,
Ther cam a Maide, and in hir wise
Sche dede hem bothe full servise,
Til that thei were in bedde naked:
I wot that nyht was wel bewaked,
Thei hadden bothe what thei wolde.

3500And thanne of leisir sche him tolde,
And gan fro point to point enforme
Of his bataile and al the forme,
Which as he scholde finde there,
Whan he to thyle come were.

Sche seide, at entre of the pas
Hou Mars, which god of Armes was,
Hath set tuo Oxen sterne and stoute,
That caste fyr and flamme aboute
Bothe at the mouth and ate nase,

3510So that thei setten al on blase
What thing that passeth hem betwene:
And forthermore upon the grene
Ther goth the flees of gold to kepe
A Serpent, which mai nevere slepe.
Thus who that evere scholde it winne,
The fyr to stoppe he mot beginne,
Which that the fierce bestes caste,¹⁵⁸
And daunte he mot hem ate laste,
So that he mai hem yoke and dryve;

3520And therupon he mot as blyve
The Serpent with such strengthe assaile,
That he mai slen him be bataile;
Of which he mot the teth outdrawe,
As it belongeth to that lawe,
And thanne he mot tho Oxen yoke,

Til thei have with a plowh to broke
 A furch of lond, in which arowe
 The teth of thaddre he moste sowe,
 And therof schule arise knihtes
 3530 Wel armed up at alle rihtes.
 Of hem is noght to taken hiede,
 For ech of hem in hastihiede
 Schal other slen with dethes wounde:¹⁵⁹
 And thus whan thei ben leid to grounde,¹⁶⁰
 Than mot he to the goddes preie,
 And go so forth and take his preie.
 Bot if he faile in eny wise
 Of that ye hiere me devise,
 Ther mai be set non other weie,
 3540 That he ne moste algates deie.
 ‘Nou have I told the peril al:
 I woll you tellen forth withal,’
 Quod Medea to Jason tho,
 ‘That ye schul knowen er ye go,
 Ayein the venym and the fyr¹⁶¹
 What schal ben the recoverir.
 Bot, Sire, for it is nyh day,
 Ariseth up, so that I may
 Deliver you what thing I have,
 3550 That mai youre lif and honour save.’
 Thei weren bothe loth to rise,
 Bot for thei weren bothe wise,
 Up thei arisen ate laste:
 Jason his clothes on him caste
 And made him redi riht anon,
 And sche hir scherte dede upon
 And caste on hire a mantel clos,
 Without more and thanne aros.
 Tho tok sche forth a riche Tye
 3560 Mad al of gold and of Perrie,
 Out of the which sche nam a Ring,
 The Ston was worth al other thing.

Sche seide, whil he wolde it were,
Ther myhte no peril him dere,
In water mai it noght be dreynt,
Wher as it comth the fyr is queynt,
It daunteth ek the cruel beste,
Ther may no qued that man areste,
Wher so he be on See or lond,
3570Which hath that ring upon his hond:
And over that sche gan to sein,
That if a man wol ben unsein,
Withinne his hond hold clos the Ston,
And he mai invisible gon.
The Ring to Jason sche betauhte,
And so forth after sche him tauhte
What sacrifise he scholde make;
And gan out of hire cofre take
Him thoughte an hevenely figure,
3580Which al be charme and be conjure
Was wroght, and ek it was thurgh write
With names, which be scholde wite, [162](#)
As sche him tauhte tho to rede;
And bad him, as he wolde spede,
Withoute reste of eny while,
Whan he were loded in that yle,
He scholde make his sacrifise
And rede his carecte in the wise
As sche him tauhte, on kneis down bent,
3590Thre sithes toward orient;
For so scholde he the goddes plese
And winne himselven mochel ese.
And whanne he hadde it thries rad,
To opne a buiste sche him bad,
Which sche ther tok him in present,
And was full of such oignement,
That ther was fyr ne venym non
That scholde fastnen him upon,
Whan that he were enoynt withal. [163](#)

3600Forthi sche tauhte him hou he schal
Enoignte his armes al aboute,
And for he scholde nothing doute,
Sche tok him thanne a maner glu,
The which was of so gret vertu,
That where a man it wolde caste,
It scholde binde anon so faste
That noman mihte it don aweie.
And that sche bad be alle weie
He scholde into the mouthes throwen

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3610Of tho tweie Oxen that fyr blowen,
Therof to stoppen the malice;
The glu schal serve of that office.
And over that hir oignement,
Hir Ring and hir enchantement
Ayein the Serpent scholde him were,
Til he him sle with swerd or spere:
And thanne he may saufliche ynowh
His Oxen yoke into the plowh
And the teth sowe in such a wise, [164](#)

3620Til he the knyhtes se arise,
And ech of other doun be leid
In such manere as I have seid.
Lo, thus Medea for Jason
Ordeigneth, and preith therupon
That he nothing foryete scholde,
And ek sche preith him that he wolde,
Whan he hath alle his Armes don,
To grounde knele and thonke anon
The goddes, and so forth be ese

3630The flees of gold he scholde sese.
And whanne he hadde it sesed so,
That thanne he were sone ago
Withouten eny tariynge.

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Whan this was seid, into wepinge
Sche fell, as sche that was thurgh nome
With love, and so fer overcome,

That al hir world on him sche sette.
 Bot whan sche sih ther was no lette,
 That he mot nedes parte hire fro,
 3640 Sche tok him in hire armes tuo,
 An hundred time and gan him kisse,
 And seide, 'O, al mi worldes blisse,
 Mi trust, mi lust, mi lif, min hele,
 To be thin helpe in this querele
 I preie unto the goddes alle.'
 And with that word sche gan doun falle
 On swoune, and he hire uppe nam, [165](#)
 And forth with that the Maiden cam,
 And thei to bedde anon hir broghte,
 3650 And thanne Jason hire besoghte,
 And to hire seide in this manere:
 'Mi worthi lusti ladi dere,
 Conforteth you, for be my trouthe
 It schal noght fallen in mi slouthe
 That I ne wol thurghout fulfille
 Youre hestes at youre oghne wille.
 And yit I hope to you bringe
 Withinne a while such tidinge,
 The which schal make ous bothe game.'
 3660 Bot for he wolde kepe hir name,
 Whan that he wiste it was nyh dai,
 He seide, 'A dieu, mi swete mai.'
 And forth with him he nam his gere,
 Which as sche hadde take him there,
 And strauht unto his chambre he wente, [166](#)
 And goth to bedde and slep him hente,
 And lay, that noman him awok,
 For Hercules hiede of him tok, [167](#)
 Til it was undren hih and more. [168](#)
 3670 And thanne he gan to sighe sore
 And sodeinliche abreide of slep; [169](#)
 And thei that token of him kep,

His chamberleins, be sone there,
 And maden redi al his gere,
 And he aros and to the king
 He wente, and seide hou to that thing
 For which he cam he wolde go.
 The king therof was wonder wo,¹⁷⁰
 And for he wolde him fain withdrawe,
 3680 He tolde him many a dredful sawe,
 Bot Jason wolde it noght recorde,
 And ate laste thei acorde.
 Whan that he wolde noght abide,
 A Bot was redy ate tyde,
 In which this worthi kniht of Grece
 Ful armed up at every piece,
 To his bataile which belongeth,
 Tok ore on honde and sore him longeth,¹⁷¹
 Til he the water passed were.
 3690 Whan he cam to that yle there,
 He set him on his kneis doun strauht,¹⁷²
 And his carecte, as he was tawht,
 He radde, and made his sacrifise,
 And siththe enoignte him in that wise,
 As Medea him hadde bede;
 And thanne aros up fro that stede,
 And with the glu the fyr he queynte,
 And anon after he atteinte
 The grete Serpent and him slowh.
 3700 Bot erst he hadde sorwe ynowh,
 For that Serpent made him travaile
 So harde and sore of his bataile,
 That nou he stod and nou he fell:
 For longe time it so befell,
 That with his swerd ne with his spere¹⁷³
 He mihte noght that Serpent dere.¹⁷⁴
 He was so scherded al aboute,
 It hield all eggetol withoute,

He was so ruide and hard of skin,
 3710 Ther mihte nothing go therin;
 Venym and fyr togedre he caste,
 That he Jason so sore ablaste,
 That if ne were his oignement,
 His Ring and his enchantement,
 Which Medea tok him tofore,
 He hadde with that worm be lore;
 Bot of vertu which therof cam
 Jason the Dragon overcam.
 And he anon the teth outdrouh,
 3720 And sette his Oxen in a plouh, [175](#)
 With which he brak a piece of lond
 And sieu hem with his oghne hond.
 Tho mihte he gret merveile se:
 Of every toth in his degre
 Sprong up a kniht with spere and schield,
 Of whiche anon riht in the field
 Echon slow other; and with that
 Jason Medea noght foryat,
 On bothe his knes he gan doun falle,
 3730 And yaf thonk to the goddes alle.
 The Flees he tok and goth to Bote,
 The Sonne schyneth bryhte and hote,
 The Flees of gold schon forth withal,
 The water glistreth overal.
 Medea wepte and sigheth ofte,
 And stod upon a Tour alofte:
 Al prively withinne hirselve,
 Ther herde it nouthen ten ne tuelve,
 Sche preide, and seide, 'O, god him spede,
 3740 The kniht which hath mi maidenhiede!'
 And ay sche loketh toward thyle.
 Bot whan sche sih withinne a while [176](#)
 The Flees glistrende ayein the Sonne,
 Sche saide, 'Ha lord, now al is wonne, [177](#)
 Mi kniht the field hath overcome:

Nou wolde god he were come;
 Ha lord, that he ne were alonde!' ¹⁷⁸
 Bot I dar take this on honde,
 If that sche hadde wynges tuo,
 3750Sche wolde have flowe unto him tho
 Strawht ther he was into the Bot. ¹⁷⁹
 The dai was clier, the Sonne hot,
 The Gregeis weren in gret doute,
 The whyle that here lord was oute:
 Thei wisten noght what scholde tyde,
 Bot waiten evere upon the tyde,
 To se what ende scholde falle.
 Ther stoden ek the nobles alle
 Forth with the comun of the toun;
 3760And as thei loken up and down,
 Thei weren war withinne a throwe,
 Wher cam the bot, which thei wel knowe,
 And sihe hou Jason broghte his preie.
 And tho thei gonnen alle seie,
 And criden alle with o stevene, ¹⁸⁰
 'Ha, wher was evere under the hevene
 So noble a knyht as Jason is?'
 And welnyh alle seiden this,
 That Jason was a faie kniht,
 3770For it was nevere of marines miht
 The Flees of gold so forto winne;
 And thus to talen thei beginne. ¹⁸¹
 With that the king com forth anon,
 And sih the Flees, hou that it schon;
 And whan Jason cam to the lond,
 The king himselve tok his hond
 And kist him, and gret joie him made.
 The Gregeis weren wonder glade,
 And of that thing riht merie hem thoghte,
 3780And forth with hem the Flees thei broghte,
 And ech on other gan to leyhe;
 Bot wel was him that mihte neyhe,

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To se therof the proprete.
 And thus thei passen the cite
 And gon unto the Paleis straght.
 Medea, which foryat him naght,
 Was redy there, and seide anon,
 ‘Welcome, O worthi kniht Jason.’
 Sche wolde have kist him wonder fayn,
 3790 Bot schame tornede hire agayn;
 It was noght the manere as tho, [182](#)
 Forthi sche dorste noght do so.
 Sche tok hire leve, and Jason wente
 Into his chambre, and sche him sente
 Hire Maide to sen hou he ferde;
 The which whan that sche sih and herde, [183](#)
 Hou that he hadde faren oute
 And that it stod wel al aboute, [184](#)
 Sche tolde hire ladi what sche wiste,
 3800 And sche for joie hire Maide kiste.
 The bathes weren thanne araied,
 With herbes tempred and assaied,
 And Jason was unarmed sone
 And dede as it befell to done:
 Into his bath he wente anon
 And wyssh him clene as eny bon;
 He tok a sopp, and oute he cam,
 And on his beste aray he nam,
 And kempde his hed, whan he was clad,
 3810 And goth him forth al merie and glad
 Riht strawht into the kinges halle.
 The king cam with his knihtes alle
 And maden him glad welcominge;
 And he hem tolde the tidinge [185](#)
 Of this and that, hou it befell,
 Whan that he wan the schepes fell.
 Medea, whan sche was asent,
 Com sone to that parlement,
 And whan sche mihte Jason se,

3820 Was non so glad of alle as sche.
 Ther was no joie forto seche,
 Of him mad every man a speche, ¹⁸⁶
 Som man seide on, som man seide other; ¹⁸⁷
 Bot thogh he were goddes brother
 And mihte make fyr and thonder,
 Ther mihte be nomore wonder
 Than was of him in that cite.
 Echon tauhte other, 'This is he,
 Which hath in his pouer withinne
 3830 That al the world ne mihte winne:
 Lo, hier the beste of alle goode.'
 Thus saiden thei that there stode,
 And ek that walkede up and down,
 Bothe of the Court and of the toun.
 The time of Souper cam anon,
 Thei wisshen and therto thei gon,
 Medea was with Jason set:
 Tho was ther many a deynte fet
 And set tofore hem on the bord,
 3840 Bot non so likinge as the word
 Which was ther spoke among hem tuo,
 So as thei dorste speke tho.
 Bot thogh thei hadden litel space,
 Yit thei acorden in that place
 Hou Jason scholde come at nyht,
 Whan every torche and every liht
 Were oute, and thanne of other thinges ¹⁸⁸
 Thei spieke aloud for supposinges
 Of hem that stoden there aboute:
 3850 For love is everemore in doute,
 If that it be wisly governed ¹⁸⁹
 Of hem that ben of love lerned.
 Whan al was don, that dissh and cuppe
 And cloth and bord and al was uppe,
 Thei waken whil hem lest to wake,
 And after that thei leve take

And gon to bedde forto reste.
 And whan him thoghte for the beste,
 That every man was faste aslepe,
 3860 Jason, that wolde his time kepe,
 Goth forth stalkende al prively
 Unto the chambre, and redely
 Ther was a Maide, which him kepte.
 Medea wok and nothing slepte,
 Bot natheles sche was abedde,
 And he with alle haste him spedde
 And made him naked and al warm.
 Anon he tok hire in his arm:
 What nede is forto speke of ese?
 3870 Hem list ech other forto plesse,
 So that thei hadden joie ynow:
 And tho thei setten whanne and how
 That sche with him away schal stele.
 With wordes suche and othre fele
 Whan al was treted to an ende,
 Jason tok leve and gan forth wende
 Unto his oughne chambre in pes;
 Ther wiste it non bot Hercules.
 He slepte and ros whan it was time, [190](#)
 3880 And whanne it fell towards prime,
 He tok to him suche as he triste
 In secre, that non other wiste,
 And told hem of his conseil there, [191](#)
 And seide that his wille were
 That thei to Schipe hadde alle thinge
 So priveliche in thevenynge,
 That noman mihte here dede asprie
 Bot tho that were of compaignie: [192](#)
 For he woll go withoute leve,
 3890 And lengere woll he noght beleve;
 Bot he ne wolde at thilke throwe
 The king or queene scholde it knowe.
 Thei saide, 'Al this schal wel be do:'

And Jason truste wel therto.
 Medea in the mene while,
 Which thoghte hir fader to beguile,
 The Tresor which hir fader hadde
 With hire al prively sche ladde,
 And with Jason at time set
 3900 Awey sche stal and fond no let,
 And straght sche goth hire unto schipe
 Of Grece with that felaschipe,
 And thei anon drowe up the Seil.
 And al that nyht this was conseil,
 Bot erly, whan the Sonne schon,
 Men syhe hou that thei were agon,
 And come unto the king and tolde:
 And he the sothe knowe wolde,
 And axeth where his dowhter was.
 3910 Ther was no word bot Out, Allas!
 Sche was ago. The moder wepte,
 The fader as a wod man lepte,
 And gan the time forto warie,
 And swor his oth he wol noght tarie, [193](#)
 That with Caliphe and with galeie
 The same cours, the same weie,
 Which Jason tok, he wolde take,
 If that he mihte him overtake.
 To this thei seiden alle yee:
 3920 Anon thei weren ate See,
 And alle, as who seith, at a word
 Thei gon withinne schipes bord,
 The Sail goth up, and forth thei strauhte.
 Bot non espleit therof thei cauhte,
 And so thei tornen hom ayein,
 For al that labour was in vein.
 Jason to Grece with his preie
 Goth thurgh the See the rihte weie:
 Whan he ther com and men it tolde,
 3930 Thei maden joie yonge and olde.

Eson, whan that he wiste of this,
Hou that his Sone comen is,
And hath achieved that he soughte
And hom with him Medea broughte,
In al the wyde world was non
So glad a man as he was on.
Togedre ben these lovers tho,
Til that thei hadden sones tuo,
Wherof thei weren bothe glade,
3940 And olde Eson gret joie made
To sen thencress of his lignage;
For he was of so gret an Age,
That men awaiten every day,
Whan that he scholde gon away.
Jason, which sih his fader old,
Upon Medea made him bold,
Of art magique, which sche couthe,
And preith hire that his fader youthe
Sche wolde make ayeinward newe:
3950 And sche, that was toward him trewe,
Behihte him that sche wolde it do,
Whan that sche time sawh therto.
Bot what sche dede in that matiere
It is a wonder thing to hiere,
Bot yit for the novellerie
I thenke tellen a partie. [194](#)

Thus it befell upon a nyht,
Whan ther was noght bot sterreliht,
Sche was vanyssht riht as hir liste,
3960 That no wyht bot hirself it wiste, [195](#)
And that was ate mydnyht tyde.
The world was stille on every side; [196](#)
With open hed and fot al bare,
Hir her tosprad sche gan to fare, [197](#)
Upon hir clothes gert sche was,
Al specheles and on the gras [198](#)

Nota quibus
medicamentis
Esonem senectute
decrepitum ad sue
iuuentutis
adolescenciam
prudens Medea
reduxit.

Sche glod forth as an Addre doth:
 Non otherwise sche ne goth,
 Til sche cam to the freisshe flod,
 3970 And there a while sche withstod.
 Thries sche torned hire aboute,
 And thries ek sche gan doun loute
 And in the flod sche wette hir her,
 And thries on the water ther
 Sche gaspeth with a drecchinge onde, [199](#)
 And tho sche tok hir speche on honde.
 Ferst sche began to clepe and calle
 Upward unto the sterres alle,
 To Wynd, to Air, to See, to lond
 3980 Sche preide, and ek hield up hir hond
 To Echates, and gan to crie,
 Which is goddesse of Sorcerie.
 Sche seide, 'Helpeth at this nede,
 And as ye maden me to spede,
 Whan Jason cam the Flees to seche,
 So help me nou, I you beseche.'
 With that sche loketh and was war,
 Doun fro the Sky ther cam a char,
 The which Dragouns aboute drowe:
 3990 And tho sche gan hir hed doun bowe, [200](#)
 And up sche styh, and faire and wel
 Sche drof forth bothe char and whel [201](#)
 Above in thair among the Skyes.
 The lond of Crete and tho parties
 Sche soughte, and faste gan hire hye,
 And there upon the hulles hyhe
 Of Othrin and Olimpe also,
 And ek of othre hulles mo,
 Sche fond and gadreth herbes suote,
 4000 Sche pulleth up som be the rote,
 And manye with a knyf sche scherth,
 And alle into hir char sche berth.
 Thus whan sche hath the hulles sought,

The flodes ther foryat sche nought,
 Eridian and Amphrisos,
 Peneie and ek Spercheïdos,²⁰²
 To hem sche wente and ther sche nom
 Bothe of the water and the fom,²⁰³
 The sond and ek the smale stones,
 4010Whiche as sche ches out for the nones,
 And of the rede See a part,
 That was behovelich to hire art,
 Sche tok, and after that aboute
 Sche soughte sondri sedes oute
 In feldes and in many greves,
 And ek a part sche tok of leves:
 Bot thing which mihte hire most availe
 Sche fond in Crete and in Thessaile.
 In daies and in nyhtes Nyne,
 4020With gret travaile and with gret pyne,²⁰⁴
 Sche was pourveid of every piece,
 And torneth homward into Grece.
 Before the gates of Eson
 Hir char sche let awai to gon,²⁰⁵
 And tok out ferst that was therinne;
 For tho sche thoghte to beginne
 Such thing as semeth impossible,
 And made hirselves invisible,
 As sche that was with Air enclosed²⁰⁶
 4030And mihte of noman be desclosed.
 Sche tok up turves of the lond
 Withoute helpe of mannes hond,
 Al heled with the grene gras,
 Of which an Alter mad ther was
 Unto Echates the goddesse
 Of art magique and the maistresse,
 And eft an other to Juvente,
 As sche which dede hir hole entente.
 Tho tok sche fieldwode and verveyne,

4040 Of herbes ben noght betre tueine,
 Of which anon withoute let
 These alters ben aboute set:
 Tuo sondri puttes faste by²⁰⁷
 Sche made, and with that hastely
 A wether which was blak sche slouh,
 And out therof the blod sche drouh
 And dede into the pettes tuo;
 Warm melk sche putte also therto
 With hony meynd: and in such wise²⁰⁸
 4050 Sche gan to make hir sacrifice,
 And cride and preide forth withal
 To Pluto the god infernal,
 And to the queene Proserpine.
 And so sche soghte out al the line
 Of hem that longen to that craft,
 Behinde was no name laft,
 And preide hem alle, as sche wel couthe,
 To grante Eson his ferste youthe.
 This olde Eson broght forth was tho,
 4060 Awei sche bad alle othre go
 Upon peril that mihte falle;
 And with that word thei wenten alle,
 And leften there hem tuo al one.
 And tho sche gan to gaspe and gone,
 And made signes manyon,
 And seide hir wordes therupon;
 So that with spellinge of hir charmes²⁰⁹
 Sche tok Eson in bothe hire armes,
 And made him forto slepe faste,
 4070 And him upon hire herbes caste.
 The blake wether tho sche tok,
 And hiewh the fleissh, as doth a cok;²¹⁰
 On either alter part sche leide,²¹¹
 And with the charmes that sche seide
 A fyr down fro the Sky alyhte

And made it forto brenne lyhte.
Bot whan Medea sawh it brenne,
Anon sche gan to sterte and renne
The fyri aulters al aboute:

4080 Ther was no beste which goth oute
More wylde than sche semeth ther:
Aboute hir schuldres hyng hir her,
As thogh sche were oute of hir mynde
And torned in an other kynde.
Tho lay ther certein wode cleft,
Of which the pieces nou and eft
Sche made hem in the pettes wete,
And put hem in the fyri hete, [212](#)

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And tok the brond with al the blase,
4090 And thries sche began to rase
Aboute Eson, ther as he slepte;
And eft with water, which sche kepte,
Sche made a cercle aboute him thries,
And eft with fyr of sulphre twyes:
Ful many an other thing sche dede,
Which is noght writen in this stede.
Bot tho sche ran so up and down,
Sche made many a wonder soun,
Somtime lich unto the cock,

4100 Somtime unto the Laverock,
Somtime kacleth as a Hen,
Somtime spekth as don the men:
And riht so as hir jargoun strangeth,
In sondri wise hir forme changeth,
Sche semeth faie and no womman;
For with the craftes that sche can [213](#)
Sche was, as who seith, a goddesse,
And what hir liste, more or lesse,
Sche dede, in bokes as we finde,

4110 That passeth over manneskinde. [214](#)
Bot who that wole of wondres hiere,
What thing sche wroghte in this matiere,

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To make an ende of that sche gan,²¹⁵
Such merveile herde nevere man.

Apointed in the newe Mone,
Whan it was time forto done,
Sche sette a caldron on the fyr,
In which was al the hole atir,
Wheron the medicine stod,
4120 Of jus, of water and of blod,
And let it buile in such a plit,
Til that sche sawh the spume whyt;
And tho sche caste in rynde and rote,
And sed and flour that was for bote,
With many an herbe and many a ston,
Wherof sche hath ther many on:
And ek Cimpheius the Serpent
To hire hath alle his scales lent,
Chelidre hire yaf his addres skin,²¹⁶
4130 And sche to builen caste hem in;
A part ek of the horned Oule,
The which men hie on nyhtes houles;
And of a Raven, which was told
Of nyne hundred wynter old,
Sche tok the hed with al the bile;
And as the medicine it wile,
Sche tok therafter the bouele²¹⁷
Of the Seewolf, and for the hele²¹⁸
Of Eson, with a thousand mo
4140 Of thinges that sche hadde tho,²¹⁹
In that Caldron togedre as blyve
Sche putte, and tok thanne of Olyve
A drie branche hem with to sterve,
The which anon gan floure and bere
And waxe al freissh and grene ayein.
Whan sche this vertu hadde sein,
Sche let the leste drope of alle
Upon the bare flor down falle;

Anon ther sprong up flour and gras,
 4150 Where as the drope falle was,
 And wox anon al medwe grene, [220](#)
 So that it mihte wel be sene. [221](#)
 Medea thanne knew and wiste
 Hir medicine is forto triste,
 And goth to Eson ther he lay,
 And tok a swerd was of assay,
 With which a wounde upon his side
 Sche made, that therout mai slyde
 The blod withinne, which was old
 4160 And sek and trouble and fieble and cold. [222](#)
 And tho sche tok unto his us [223](#)
 Of herbes al the beste jus,
 And poured it into his wounde;
 That made his veynes fulle and sounde:
 And tho sche made his wounde clos,
 And tok his hand, and up he ros;
 And tho sche yaf him drinke a drauhte,
 Of which his youthe ayein he cauhte,
 His hed, his herte and his visage
 4170 Lich unto twenty wynter Age;
 Hise hore heres were away,
 And lich unto the freisshe Maii,
 Whan passed ben the colde schoures,
 Riht so recovereth he his floures.
 Lo, what mihte eny man devise,
 A womman schewe in eny wise
 Mor hertly love in every stede, [224](#)
 Than Medea to Jason dede?
 Ferst sche made him the flees to winne,
 4180 And after that fro kiththe and kinne
 With gret tresor with him sche stal,
 And to his fader forth withal
 His Elde hath torned into youthe,
 Which thing non other womman couthe:

Bot hou it was to hire aquit,
The remembrance duelleth yit. [225](#)

King Peleüs his Em was ded,
Jason bar corone on his hed,
Medea hath fulfild his wille:

4190 Bot whanne he scholde of riht fulfille
The trouthe, which to hire afore
He hadde in thyle of Colchos swore,
Tho was Medea most deceived.
For he an other hath received,
Which dowhter was to king Creon,
Creusa sche hihte, and thus Jason,
As he that was to love untrewed,
Medea lefte and tok a newe.

Bot that was after sone aboght:

4200 Medea with hire art hath wrought
Of cloth of gold a mantel riche,
Which semeth worth a kingesriche,
And that was unto Creusa sent
In name of yifte and of present,
For Sosterhode hem was betuene;
And whan that yonge freisshe queene
That mantel lappeth hire aboute,
Anon therof the fyr sprong oute
And brente hir bothe fleissh and bon.

4210 Tho cam Medea to Jason
With bothe his Sones on hire hond,
And seide, 'O thou of every lond
The moste untrewed creature,
Lo, this schal be thi forfeiture.'
With that sche bothe his Sones slough
Before his yhe, and he outdrouh
His swerd and wold have slayn hir tho, [226](#)
Bot farewell, sche was ago
Unto Pallas the Court above,

4220 Wher as sche pleigneth upon love,
As sche that was with that goddesse,

And he was left in gret destresse.

Thus miht them se what sorwe it doth Confessor.
To swere an oth which is noght soth,
In loves cause namely.
Mi Sone, be wel war forthi,
And kep that thou be noght forswore:
For this, which I have told tofore,
Ovide telleth everydel.

4230 Mi fader, I may lieve it wel, Amans.
For I have herde it ofte seie^{[227](#)}
Hou Jason tok the flees aweie
Fro Colchos, bot yit herde I noght
Be whom it was ferst thider broght.
And for it were good to hiere,
If that you liste at mi preiere
To telle, I wolde you beseche.

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 Mi Sone, who that wole it seche, Confessor.
In bokes he mai finde it write;
4240 And natheles, if thou wolt wite,
In the manere as thou hast preid
I schal the telle hou it is seid.

The fame of thilke schepes fell,²²⁸
 Which in Colchos, as it befell,
 Was al of gold, schal nevere deie;
 Wherof I thenke for to seie
 Hou it cam ferst into that yle.
 Ther was a king in thilke whyle
 Towardes Grece, and Athemas
 4250 The Cronique of his name was;
 And hadde a wif, which Philen hihte,
 Be whom, so as fortune it dihte,
 He hadde of children yonge tuo.
 Frixus the ferste was of tho,
 A knave child, riht fair withalle;
 A dowhter ek, the which men calle
 Hellen, he hadde be this wif.
 Bot for ther mai no mannes lif
 Endure upon this Erthe hiere,
 4260 This worthi queene, as thou miht hiere,
 Er that the children were of age,
 Tok of hire ende the passage,
 With gret worschipe and was begrave.
 What thing it liketh god to have
 It is gret reson to ben his;
 Forthi this king, so as it is,
 With gret suffrance it underfongeth:
 And afterward, as him belongeth,
 Whan it was time forto wedde,
 A newe wif he tok to bedde,
 Which Yno hihte and was a Mayde,
 And ek the dowhter, as men saide,
 Of Cadme, which a king also
 Was holde in thilke daies tho.
 Whan Yno was the kinges make,
 4270 Sche caste hou that sche mihte make²³²
 These children to here fader lothe,
 And schope a wyle ayein hem bothe,²³³

[TALE OF PHRIXUS
AND HELLE.]

Nota qualiter
 aureum vellus in
 partes insule
 Colchos primo
 deuenit. Athemas
 Rex Philen habuit
 coniugem, ex qua
 Frixum et Hellen
 genuit: mortua
 autem²²⁹ Philen
 Athemas Ynonem
 Regis Cadmi filiam
 postea in vxorem
 duxit, que more
 Nouerce dictos
 infantes in tantum
 recollegit odium,
 quod ambos in
 mare proici penes
 Regem procurauit.
 Vnde Iuno
 compaciens
 quendam Arietem
 grandem aureo
 vestitum vellere ad
 litus natantem
 destinauit; super
 cuius dorsum
 pueros apponi
 iussit. Quo facto
 Aries super vndas
 regressus cum solo
 Frixo sibi
 adherente in
 Colchos applicuit,
 vbi Iuno dictum
 Arietem cum suo
 vellere,²³⁰ prout in
 aliis canitur²³¹
 cronicis, sub arta
 custodia collocauit.

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Which to the king was al unknowe.
4280A yeer or tuo sche let do sowe
The lond with sode whete aboute,
Wherof no corn mai springen oute;
And thus be sleyhte and be covine
Aros the derthe and the famine
Thurghout the lond in such a wise,
So that the king a sacrificise
Upon the point of this destresse
To Ceres, which is the goddesse
Of corn, hath schape him forto yive,
4290To loke if it mai be foryive,
The meschief which was in his lond.
Bot sche, which knew tofor the hond
The circumstance of al this thing,
Ayein the cominge of the king
Into the temple, hath schape so,
Of hire acord that alle tho
Whiche of the temple prestes were
Have seid and full declared there
Unto the king, bot if so be
4300That he delivere the contre
Of Frixus and of Hellen bothe,
With whom the goddes ben so wrothe,
That whil tho children ben therinne,
Such tilthe schal noman beginne,
Wherof to gete him eny corn.
Thus was it seid, thus was it sworn
Of all the Prestes that ther are;²³⁴
And sche which causeth al this fare
Seid ek therto what that sche wolde,²³⁵
4310And every man thanne after tolde
So as the queene hem hadde preid.²³⁶
The king, which hath his Ere leid,
And lieveth al that evere he herde,
Unto here tale thus ansuerde,
And seith that levere him is to chese

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Hise children bothe forto lese,
 Than him and al the remenant
 Of hem whiche are aportenant
 Unto the lond which he schal kepe:
 4320 And bad his wif to take kepe
 In what manere is best to done,²³⁷
 That thei delivered weren sone
 Out of this world. And sche anon
 Tuo men ordeigneth forto gon;
 Bot ferst sche made hem forto swere
 That thei the children scholden bere
 Unto the See, that non it knowe,
 And hem therinne bothe throwe.
 The children to the See ben lad,
 4330 Wher in the wise as Yno bad²³⁸
 These men be redy forto do.
 Bot the goddesse which Juno
 Is hote, appiereth in the stede,
 And hath unto the men forbede²³⁹
 That thei the children noght ne sle;
 Bot bad hem loke into the See
 And taken hiede of that thei sihen.
 Ther swam a Schep tofore here yhen,
 Whos flees of burned gold was al;
 4340 And this goddesse forth withal
 Comandeth that withoute lette
 Thei scholde anon these children sette
 Above upon this Schepes bak;²⁴⁰
 And al was do, riht as sche spak,
 Wherof the men gon hom ayein.
 And fell so, as the bokes sein,
 Hellen the yonge Mayden tho,
 Which of the See was wo bego,
 For pure drede hire herte hath lore,²⁴¹
 4350 That fro the Schep, which hath hire bore,
 As sche that was swounende feint,²⁴²

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Sche fell, and hath hirselve dreint;²⁴³
 With Frixus and this Schep forth swam,
 Til he to thyle of Colchos cam,
 Where Juno the goddesse he fond,
 Which tok the Schep unto the lond,
 And sette it there in such a wise
 As thou tofore hast herd devise,
 Wherof cam after al the wo,
 4360 Why Jason was forswore so
 Unto Medee, as it is spoke.²⁴⁴
 Mi fader, who that hath tobroke
 His trouthe, as ye have told above,
 He is noght worthi forto love
 Ne be beloved, as me semeth:
 Bot every newe love quemeth
 To him which newefongel is.²⁴⁵
 And natheles nou after this,
 If that you list to taken hiede²⁴⁶

Amans.

4370 Upon mi Schrifte to procede,
 In loves cause ayein the vice
 Of covoitise and Avarice
 What ther is more I wolde wite.
 Mi Sone, this I finde write,
 Ther is yit on of thilke brood,
 Which only for the worldes good,
 To make a Tresor of Moneie,
 Put alle conscience aweie:
 Wherof in thi confession

Confessor.

4380 The name and the condicion
 I schal hierafterward declare,
 Which makth on riche, an other bare.

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*v. Plus capit vsura sibi quam debetur, et
 illud*

[USURY.]

*Fraude colorata sepe latenter agit.
 Sic amor excessus quamsepe suos vt auarus
 Spirat, et vnus tres capit ipse loco.*

Upon the bench sittende on hih
 With Avarice Usure I sih,
 Full clothed of his oghne suite,
 Which after gold makth chace and suite
 With his brocours, that renne aboute
 Lich unto racches in a route.
 Such lucre is non above grounde,
 4390 Which is noght of tho racches founde;
 For wher thei se beyete sterte, [247](#)
 That schal hem in no wise asterte,
 Bot thei it dryve into the net
 Of lucre, which Usure hath set.
 Usure with the riche duelleth,
 To al that evere he beith and selleth [248](#)
 He hath ordeined of his sleyhte
 Mesure double and double weyhte:
 Outward he selleth be the lasse,
 4400 And with the more he makth his tasse,
 Wherof his hous is full withinne.
 He reccheth noght, be so he winne, [249](#)
 Though that ther lese ten or tuelve:
 His love is al toward himselve
 And to non other, bot he se
 That he mai winne suche thre;
 For wher he schal oght yive or lene,
 He wol ayeinward take a bene,
 Ther he hath lent the smale pese.
 4410 And riht so ther ben manye of these
 Lovers, that thogh thei love a lyte, [250](#)
 That scarsly wolde it weie a myte,
 Yit wolde thei have a pound again, [251](#)
 As doth Usure in his bargain.
 Bot certes such usure unliche
 It falleth more unto the riche,
 Als wel of love as of beyete,
 Than unto hem that be noght grete,

Hic tractat de illa
 specie Auaricie,
 que Vsura dicitur,
 cuius creditor in
 pecunia tantum
 numerata
 plusquam sibi de
 iure debetur
 incrementum lucri
 adauget.

And, as who seith, ben simple and povere;
4420 For sielden is whan thei recovere,
Bot if it be thurgh gret decerte.
And natheles men se poverte
With porsuite and continuance²⁵²
Fulofte make a gret chevance
And take of love his advantage,²⁵³
Forth with the help of his brocage,
That maken seme wher is noght.²⁵⁴
And thus fulofte is love boght
For litel what, and mochel take,
4430 With false weyhtes that thei make.

Nou, Sone, of that I seide above
Thou wost what Usure is of love:
Tell me forthi what so thou wilt,
If thou therof hast eny gilt.

Confessor.

Mi fader, nay, for ought I hierie.
For of tho pointz ye tolden hierie
I wol you be mi trouthe assure,
Mi weyhte of love and mi mesure
Hath be mor large and mor certein

Amans.

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4440 Than evere I tok of love ayein:
For so yit couthe I nevere of sleyhte,
To take ayein be double weyhte
Of love mor than I have yive.
For als so wiss mot I be schrive
And have remission of Sinne,
As so yit couthe I nevere winne,
Ne yit so mochel, soth to sein,
That evere I mihte have half ayein
Of so full love as I have lent:

4450 And if myn happ were so wel went,
That for the hole I mihte have half,
Me thenkth I were a goddeshalf.²⁵⁵
For where Usure wole have double,
Mi conscience is noght so trouble,
I biede nevere as to my del

Bot of the hole an halvendel;
 That is non excess, as me thenketh.
 Bot natheles it me forthenketh;
 For wel I wot that wol noght be,
 4460 For every day the betre I se
 That hou so evere I yive or lene
 Mi love in place ther I mene, [256](#)
 For oght that evere I axe or crave,
 I can nothing ayeinward have.
 Bot yit for that I wol noght lete,
 What so befalle of mi beyete,
 That I ne schal hire yive and lene
 Mi love and al mi thoght so clene, [257](#)
 That toward me schal noght beleve.
 4470 And if sche of hire goode leve
 Rewarde wol me noght again,
 I wot the laste of my bargain
 Schal stonde upon so gret a lost,
 That I mai neveremor the cost
 Recovere in this world til I die.
 So that touchende of this partie
 I mai me wel excuse and schal;
 And forto speke forth withal,
 If eny brocour for me wente,
 4480 That point cam nevere in myn entente:
 So that the more me merveilleth,
 What thing it is mi ladi eilleth,
 That al myn herte and al my time
 Sche hath, and doth no betre bime.
 I have herd seid that thoght is fre, [258](#)
 And natheles in privete
 To you, mi fader, that ben hiere
 Min hole schrifte forto hiere,
 I dar min herte wel desclose.
 4490 Touchende usure, as I suppose,
 Which as ye telle in love is used,
 Mi ladi mai noght ben excused;

That for o lokinge of hire yë
 Min hole herte til I dye
 With al that evere I may and can
 Sche hath me wonne to hire man:
 Wherof, me thenkth, good reson wolde
 That sche somdel rewarde scholde,
 And yive a part, ther sche hath al.
 4500I not what falle hierafter schal,
 Bot into nou yit dar I sein,
 Hire liste nevere yive ayein
 A goodli word in such a wise,
 Wherof min hope mihte arise, [259](#)
 Mi grete love to compensate.
 I not hou sche hire conscience
 Excuse wole of this usure; [260](#)
 Be large weyhte and gret mesure
 Sche hath mi love, and I have noght
 4510Of that which I have diere boght,
 And with myn herte I have it paid;
 Bot al that is asyde laid, [261](#)
 And I go loveles aboute.
 Hire oghte stonde in ful gret doute,
 Til sche redresce such a sinne,
 That sche wole al mi love winne
 And yifh me noght to live by:
 Noght als so moche as 'grant mercy' [262](#)
 Hir list to seie, of which I mihte
 4520Som of mi grete peine allyhte.
 Bot of this point, lo, thus I fare
 As he that paith for his chaffare,
 And beith it diere, and yit hath non, [263](#)
 So mot he nedes povere gon:
 Thus beie I diere and have no love, [264](#)
 That I ne mai noght come above [265](#)
 To winne of love non encress.
 Bot I me wole natheles

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Touchende usure of love aquite;
4530 And if mi ladi be to wyte,
I preie to god such grace hir sende
That sche be time it mot amende.
Mi Sone, of that thou hast ansuerd
Touchende Usure I have al herd,
Hou thou of love hast wonne smale:
Bot that thou tellest in thi tale
And thi ladi therof accusest,
Me thenkth tho wordes thou misusest.
For be thin oghne knowlechinge
4540 Thou seist hou sche for o lokinge
Thin hole herte fro the tok:
Sche mai be such, that hire o lok
Is worth thin herte manyfold;
So hast thou wel thin herte sold,
Whan thou hast that is more worth.
And ek of that thou tellest forth,
Hou that hire weyhte of love unevene
Is unto thin, under the hevene
Stod nevere in evene that balance
4550 Which stant in loves governance.
Such is the statut of his lawe,
That thogh thi love more drawe
And peise in the balance more,
Thou miht noght axe ayein therfore
Of duete, bot al of grace.
For love is lord in every place,
Ther mai no lawe him justefie
Be reddour ne be compaignie,
That he ne wole after his wille
4560 Whom that him liketh spede or spille.
To love a man mai wel beginne,
Bot whether he schal lese or winne,
That wot noman til ate laste:
Forthi coveite noght to faste,
Mi Sone, bot abyd thin ende, [266](#)

Confessor.

Per cas al mai to goode wende.
Bot that thou hast me told and said,
Of o thing I am riht wel paid,²⁶⁷
That thou be sleyhte ne be guile
4570Of no brocour hast otherwhile
Engined love, for such dede²⁶⁸
Is sore venged, as I rede.

Brocours of love that deceiven,
No wonder is thogh thei receiven²⁶⁹
After the wrong that thei decerven;
For whom as evere that thei serven²⁷⁰
And do plesance for a whyle,
Yit ate laste here oghne guile
Upon here oghne hed descendeth,²⁷¹
4580Which god of his vengance sendeth,
As be ensample of time go
A man mai finde it hath be so.
It fell somtime, as it was sene,
The hihe goddesse and the queene
Juno tho hadde in compainie
A Maiden full of tricherie;
For sche was evere in on acord²⁷³
With Jupiter, that was hire lord,
To gete him othre loves newe,
Thurgh such brocage and was untrew
Al otherwise than him nedeth.
Bot sche, which of no schame dredeth,
With queinte wordes and with slyhe
Blente in such wise hir lady yhe,
4590As sche to whom that Juno triste,²⁷⁴
So that therof sche nothing wiste.
Bot so prive mai be nothing,
That it ne comth to knowleching;
Thing don upon the derke nyht
4600Is after knowe on daies liht:

[LOVE-BROKERAGE.
TALE OF ECHO.]

Hic ponit
exemplum contra
istos maritos qui
vltra id quod
proprias habent
vxores ad noue
voluptatis
incrementum alias
mulieres superflue
lucrari non
verentur. Et narrat
qualiter Iuno
vindictam suam in
Eccho decreuit, pro
eo quod ipsa
Eccho²⁷² in
huiusmodi
mulierum lucris
adquirendis de
consilio mariti sui
Iouis mediatrix
extiterat.

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So it befell, that ate laste
 Al that this slyhe maiden caste
 Was overcast and overthrowe.
 For as the sothe mot be knowe,
 To Juno was don understonde
 In what manere hir housebonde
 With fals brocage hath take usure
 Of love mor than his mesure,
 Whan he tok othre than his wif,
 4610Wherof this mayden was gultif,
 Which hadde ben of his assent.
 And thus was al the game schent;²⁷⁵
 Sche soffreth him, as sche mot nede,
 Bot the brocour of his misdede,
 Sche which hir conseil yaf therto,
 On hire is the vengeance do:
 For Juno with hire wordes hote,
 This Maiden, which Eccho was hote,
 Reproveth and seith in this wise:
 4620'O traiteresse, of which servise
 Hast thou thin oghne ladi served!
 Thou hast gret peine wel deserved,
 That thou canst maken it so queinte,
 Thi slyhe wordes forto peinte
 Towardes me, that am thi queene,
 Wherof thou madest me to wene
 That myn housbonde trewe were,
 Whan that he loveth elleswhere,
 Al be it so him nedeth noght.
 4630Bot upon thee it schal be boght,
 Which art prive to tho doinges,
 And me fulofte of thi lesinges
 Deceived hast: nou is the day
 That I thi while aquite may;²⁷⁶
 And for thou hast to me conceled
 That my lord hath with othre deled,
 I schal thee sette in such a kende,

That evere unto the worldes ende
Al that thou hierest thou schalt telle,
4640 And clappe it out as doth a belle.'

And with that word sche was forschape,
Ther may no vois hire mouth ascape,²⁷⁷
What man that in the wodes crieth,²⁷⁸
Withoute faile Eccho replieth,
And what word that him list to sein,
The same word sche seith ayein.

Thus sche, which whilom hadde leve
To duelle in chambre, mot beleve
In wodes and on helles bothe,

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4650 For such brocage as wyves lothe,
Which doth here lordes hertes change²⁷⁹
And love in other place strange.²⁸⁰

Forthi, if evere it so befalle,
That thou, mi Sone, amonges alle
Be wedded man, hold that thou hast,
For thanne al other love is wast.
O wif schal wel to thee suffise,
And thanne, if thou for covoitise
Of love woldest axe more,

Confessor.

4660 Thou scholdest don ayein the lore
Of alle hem that trewe be.

Mi fader, as in this degre
My conscience is noght accused;
For I no such brocage have used,
Wherof that lust of love is wonne.
Forthi spek forth, as ye begonne,
Of Avarice upon mi schrifte.

Amans.

Mi Sone, I schal the branches schifte
Be ordre so as thei ben set,

Confessor.

4670 On whom no good is wel beset.

vi. *Pro verbis verba, munus pro munere
reddi*

[PARSIMONY.]

Convenit, vt pondus equa statera gerat.

*Propterea cupido non dat sua dona Cupido,
Nam qui nulla serit, gramina nulla metet.*

Blinde Avarice of his lignage²⁸¹
For conseil and for cousinage,
To be withholde ayein largesse,
Hath on, whos name is seid Skarsnesse,
The which is kepere of his hous,
And is so thurghout averous,
That he no good let out of honde;
Thogh god himself it wolde fonde,
Of yifte scholde he nothing have;
4680 And if a man it wolde crave,²⁸²
He moste thanne faile nede,
Wher god himselve mai noght spede.²⁸³
And thus Skarsnesse in every place
Be reson mai no thonk porchace,
And natheles in his degree
Above alle othre most prive
With Avarice stant he this.
For he governeth that ther is
In ech astat of his office
4690 After the reule of thilke vice;
He takth, he kepth, he halt, he bint,
That lihtere is to fle the flint
Than gete of him in hard or neisshe
Only the value of a reysshe
Of good in helpinge of an other,
Noght thogh it were his oghne brother.
For in the cas of yifte and lone
Stant every man for him al one,
Him thenkth of his unkindeschipe
4700 That him nedeth no felaschipe:
Be so the bagge and he acorden,²⁸⁴
Him reccheth noght what men recorden
Of him, or it be evel or good.
For al his trust is on his good,

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Hic tractat super
illa specie Auaricie
que Parcimonia
dicitur, cuius
natura tenax
aliqualem sue
substantie
porcionem aut deo
aut hominibus
participare
nullatenus
consentit.

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So that al one he falleth ofte,
 Whan he best weneth stonde alofte,
 Als wel in love as other wise;
 For love is evere of som reprise
 To him that wole his love holde.
 4710 Forthi, mi Sone, as thou art holde,
 Touchende of this tell me thi schrifte:
 Hast thou be scars or large of yifte
 Unto thi love, whom thou servest?
 For after that thou wel deservest
 Of yifte, thou miht be the bet;
 For that good holde I wel beset,
 For why thou miht the betre fare;²⁸⁵
 Thanne is no wisdom forto spare.
 For thus men sein, in every nede
 4720 He was wys that ferst made mede;
 For where as mede mai noght spede,
 I not what helpeth other dede:
 Fulofte he faileth of his game
 That wol with ydel hand reclame
 His hauk, as many a nyce doth.
 Forthi, mi Sone, tell me soth
 And sei the trouthe, if thou hast be
 Unto thy love or skars or fre.
 Mi fader, it hath stonde thus,
 4730 That if the tresor of Cresus
 And al the gold Octovien,
 Forth with the richesse Yndien²⁸⁶
 Of Perles and of riche stones,
 Were al togedre myn at ones,
 I sette it at nomore acompte
 Than wolde a bare straw amonte,
 To yive it hire al in a day,
 Be so that to that suete may²⁸⁷
 I myhte like or more or lesse.²⁸⁸
 4740 And thus be cause of my scarsnesse
 Ye mai wel understonde and lieve

Confessio Amantis.

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That I schal noght the worse achieve²⁸⁹
 The pourpos which is in my thoght.
 Bot yit I yaf hir nevere noght,
 Ne therto dorste a profre make;
 For wel I wot sche wol noght take,
 And yive wol sche noght also,
 She is eschu of bothe tuo.
 And this I trowe be the skile
 4750 Towardes me, for sche ne wile
 That I have eny cause of hope,
 Noght also mochel as a drope.
 Bot toward othre, as I mai se,
 Sche takth and yifth in such degre,
 That as be weie of frendlihiede
 Sche can so kepe hir wommanhiede,
 That every man spekth of hir wel.
 Bot sche wole take of me no del,
 And yit sche wot wel that I wolde
 4760 Yive and do bothe what I scholde
 To plesen hire in al my myht:
 Be reson this wot every wyht,
 For that mai be no weie asterte,
 Ther sche is maister of the herte,
 Sche mot be maister of the good.
 For god wot wel that al my mod
 And al min herte and al mi thoght
 And al mi good, whil I have oght,
 Als freliche as god hath it yive,
 4770 It schal ben hires, while I live,²⁹⁰
 Riht as hir list hirself commande.
 So that it nedeth no demande,
 To axe of me if I be scars
 To love, for as to tho pars
 I wole ansuere and seie no.
 Mi Sone, that is riht wel do.
 For often times of scarsnesse
 It hath be sen, that for the lesse

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Confessor.

Is lost the more, as thou schalt hiere
4780A tale lich to this matiere.

Skarsnesse and love acorden nevere,
For every thing is wel the levere,
Whan that a man hath boght it diere:
And forto speke in this matiere,
For sparinge of a litel cost
Fulofte time a man hath lost
The large cote for the hod.
What man that scars is of his good²⁹¹
And wol noght yive, he schal noght take:
4790With yifte a man mai undertake
The hihe god to plesse and queme,
With yifte a man the world mai deme;²⁹³
For every creature bore,
If thou him yive, is glad therfore,
And every gladschipe, as I finde,
Is confort unto loves kinde
And causeth ofte a man to spede.
So was he wys that ferst yaf mede,
For mede kepeth love in house;
4800Bot wher the men ben coveitouse
And sparen forto yive a part,
Thei knowe noght Cupides art:
For his fortune and his aprise
Desdeigneth alle coveitise
And hateth alle nygardie.
And forto loke of this partie,
A soth ensample, hou it is so,
I finde write of Babio;²⁹⁴
Which hadde a love at his menage,
4810Ther was non fairere of hire age,
And hihte Viola be name;
Which full of youthe and ful of game
Was of himself, and large and fre,
Bot such an other chinche as he²⁹⁵

[TALE OF BABIO
AND CROCEUS.]

Hic loquitur contra
istos, qui Avaricia
stricti largitatis
beneficium in
amoris causa
confundunt. Et
ponit exemplum,
qualiter Croceus
largus et hillaris
Babionem²⁹²
avarum et tenacem
de amore Viole,
que pulcherrima
fuit, donis
largissimis
circumuenit.

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Men wisten noght in al the lond,
And hadde affaited to his hond
His servant, the which Spodius²⁹⁶
Was hote. And in this wise thus²⁹⁷
The worldes good of sufficance
4820 Was had, bot likinge and plesance,
Of that belongeth to richesse
Of love, stod in gret destresse;
So that this yonge lusty wyht
Of thing which fell to loves riht
Was evele served overal,
That sche was wo bego withal,
Til that Cupide and Venus eke
A medicine for the seke
Ordeigne wolden in this cas.
4830 So as fortune thanne was,
Of love upon the destine
It fell, riht as it scholde be,
A freissh, a fre, a frendly man
That noght of Avarice can,
Which Croceus be name hihte,
Toward this swete caste his sihte,
And ther sche was cam in presence.
Sche sih him large of his despence,
And amorous and glad of chiere,
4840 So that hir liketh wel to hie
The goodly wordes whiche he seide;
And therupon of love he preide,
Of love was al that he mente,
To love and for sche scholde assente,
He yaf hire yiftes evere among.
Bot for men sein that mede is strong,
It was wel seene at thilke tyde;
For as it scholde of ryht betyde,
This Viola largesce hath take
4850 And the nygard sche hath forsake:
Of Babio sche wol no more,²⁹⁸

For he was grucchende everemore,
 Ther was with him non other fare
 Bot forto prinche and forto spare,
 Of worldes muk to gete encress.
 So goth the wrecche loveles, [299](#)
 Bejaped for his Skarcete,
 And he that large was and fre
 And sette his herte to despende,
 4860 This Croceus, the bowe bende,
 Which Venus tok him forto holde,
 And schotte als ofte as evere he wolde. [300](#)
 Lo, thus departeth love his lawe,
 That what man wol noght be felawe
 To yive and spende, as I thee telle,
 He is noght worthi forto duelle
 In loves court to be relieved.
 Forthi, my Sone, if I be lieved, [301](#)
 Thou schalt be large of thi despence.
 4870 Mi fader, in mi conscience Amans.
 If ther be eny thing amis,
 I wol amende it after this, [302](#)
 Toward mi love namely.
 Mi Sone, wel and redely Confessor.
 Thou seist, so that wel paid withal
 I am, and forthere if I schal
 Unto thi schrifte specefie [303](#)
 Of Avarices progenie
 What vice suieth after this,
 4880 Thou schalt have wonder hou it is,
 Among the folk in eny regne
 That such a vice myhte regne,
 Which is comun at alle assaies,
 As men mai finde nou adaies.

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vii. *Cuncta creatura, deus et qui cuncta* [INGRATITUDE.]
creauit,
Damnant ingrati dicta que facta viri. [304](#)

*Non dolor alonge stat, quo sibi talis amicum³⁰⁵
Traxit, et in fine deserit esse suam.*

The vice lik unto the fend,
Which nevere yit was mannes frend,
And cleped is Unkindeschipe,
Of covine and of felaschipe
With Avarice he is withholde.
4890 Him thenkth he scholde noght ben holde
Unto the moder which him bar;
Of him mai nevere man be war,
He wol noght knowe the merite,
For that he wolde it noght aquite;
Which in this world is mochel used,
And fewe ben therof excused.
To telle of him is endeles,
Bot this I seie natheles,
Wher as this vice comth to londe,
4900 Ther takth noman his thonk on honde;
Thogh he with alle his myhtes serve,
He schal of him no thonk deserve.
He takth what eny man wol yive,
Bot whil he hath o day to live,
He wol nothing rewarde ayein;
He gruccheth forto yive o grein,
Wher he hath take a berne full.
That makth a kinde herte dull,
To sette his trust in such frendschipe,
4910 Ther as he fint no kindeschipe;
And forto speke wordes pleine,
Thus hiere I many a man compleigne,
That nou on daies thou schalt finde
At nede fewe frendes kinde;
What thou hast don for hem tofore,
It is foryete, as it were lore.
The bokes speken of this vice,
And telle hou god of his justice,

Hic loquitur super
illa aborta specie
Avaricie, que
Ingratitudo, dicta
est, cuius
condicionem non
solum creator, set
eciam cuncte
creature
abhominabilem
detestantur.

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Be weie of kinde and ek nature
 4920 And every lifissh creature, [306](#)
 The lawe also, who that it kan, [307](#)
 Thei dampnen an unkinde man.
 It is al on to seie unkinde
 As thing which don is ayein kinde,
 For it with kinde nevere stod
 A man to yelden evel for good.
 For who that wolde taken hede,
 A beste is glad of a good dede,
 And loveth thilke creature
 4930 After the lawe of his nature
 Which doth him ese. And forto se
 Of this matiere Auctorite,
 Fulofte time it hath befalle;
 Wherof a tale amonges alle,
 Which is of olde ensamplerie, [308](#)
 I thenke forto specefie.

To speke of an unkinde man,
 I finde hou whilom Adrian,
 Of Rome which a gret lord was,
 Upon a day as he per cas
 4940 To wode in his huntinge wente,
 It hapneth at a soudein wente, [309](#)
 After his chace as he poursuieth,
 Thurgh happ, the which noman
 eschuieth, [310](#)
 He fell unwar into a pet,
 Wher that it mihte noght be let.
 The pet was dep and he fell lowe,
 That of his men non myhte knowe
 Wher he becam, for non was nyh,
 4950 Which of his fall the meschief syh.
 And thus al one ther he lay
 Clepende and criende al the day
 For socour and deliverance,

[TALE OF ADRIAN
AND BARDUS.]

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Hic dicit qualiter
 bestie in suis
 beneficiis
 hominem ingratum
 naturaliter
 precellunt. Et ponit
 exemplum de
 Adriano Rome
 Cenatore, qui in
 quadam Foresta
 venacionibus
 insistens, dum
 predam
 persequeretur, in
 Cisternam
 profundam nescia
 familia corruit: vbi
 superueniens
 quidam pauper

Til ayein Eve it fell per chance,
 A while er it began to nyhte,
 A povere man, which Bardus hihte,
 Cam forth walkende with his asse,
 And hadde gadred him a tasse
 Of grene stickes and of dreie
 4960 To selle, who that wolde hem beie,
 As he which hadde no liflode,
 Bot whanne he myhte such a lode
 To toune with his Asse carie.
 And as it fell him forto tarie
 That ilke time nyh the pet,
 And hath the trusse faste knet,
 He herde a vois, which cride dimme,
 And he his Ere to the brimme
 Hath leid, and herde it was a man,
 4970 Which seide, 'Ha, help hier Adrian,
 And I wol yiven half mi good.'

The povere man this understod,
 As he that wolde gladly winne,
 And to this lord which was withinne
 He spak and seide, 'If I thee save,
 What sikernesse schal I have
 Of covenant, that afterward
 Thou wolt me yive such reward
 As thou behihtest nou tofore?'

4980 That other hath his othes swore
 Be hevene and be the goddes alle, [312](#)
 If that it myhte so befalle
 That he out of the pet him broghte,
 Of all the goodes whiche he oghte [313](#)
 He schal have evene halvendel.

This Bardus seide he wolde wel;
 And with this word his Asse anon
 He let untrusse, and therupon
 Doun goth the corde into the pet, [314](#)
 4990 To which he hath at ende knet

nomine Bardus,
 immissa cordula,
 putans hominem
 extraxisse, primo
 Simeam extraxit,
 secundo
 Serpentem, tercio
 Adrianum, qui
 pauperem
 despiciens aliquid
 ei pro benefacto
 reddere recusabat.
 Set tam Serpens
 quam Simea
 gratuita
 beneuolencia
 ipsum [311](#) singulis
 donis sufficienter
 remunerarent.

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A staf, wherby, he seide, he wolde
 That Adrian him scholde holde.
 Bot it was tho per chance falle,
 Into that pet was also falle³¹⁵
 An Ape, which at thilke throwe,
 Whan that the corde cam doun lowe,
 Al sodeinli therto he skipte
 And it in bothe hise armes clipte.
 And Bardus with his Asse anon
 5000Him hath updrawe, and he is gon.
 But whan he sih it was an Ape,
 He wende al hadde ben a jape
 Of faierie, and sore him dradde:³¹⁶
 And Adrian eftsone gradde
 For help, and cride and preide faste,
 And he eftsone his corde caste;
 Bot whan it cam unto the grounde,
 A gret Serpent it hath bewounde,
 The which Bardus anon up drouh.
 5010And thanne him thoghte wel ynouh,
 It was fantosme, bot yit he herde³¹⁷
 The vois, and he therto ansuerde,
 ‘What wiht art thou in goddes name?’
 ‘I am,’ quod Adrian, ‘the same,
 Whos good thou schalt have evene half.’
 Quod Bardus, ‘Thanne a goddes half
 The thridde time assaie I schal’:
 And caste his corde forth withal
 Into the pet, and whan it cam
 5020To him, this lord of Rome it nam,
 And therupon him hath adresced,³¹⁸
 And with his hand fulofte blessed,
 And thanne he bad to Bardus hale.
 And he, which understod his tale,
 Betwen him and his Asse al softe³¹⁹
 Hath drawe and set him up alofte

Withouten harm al esely.
 He seith noght ones 'grant merci,'
 Bot strauhte him forth to the cite,
 5030 And let this povere Bardus be.
 And natheles this simple man
 His covenant, so as he can,
 Hath axed; and that other seide,
 If so be that he him umbreide³²⁰
 Of oght that hath be speke or do,³²¹
 It schal ben venged on him so,
 That him were betre to be ded.
 And he can tho non other red,
 But on his asse ayein he caste
 5040 His trusse, and hieth homward faste:
 And whan that he cam hom to bedde,
 He tolde his wif hou that he spedde.
 Bot finaly to speke oght more
 Unto this lord he dradde him sore,
 So that a word ne dorste he sein:³²²
 And thus upon the morwe ayein,
 In the manere as I recorde,
 Forth with his Asse and with his corde
 To gadre wode, as he dede er,
 5050 He goth; and whan that he cam ner
 Unto the place where he wolde,³²³
 He hath his Ape anon beholde,
 Which hadde gadred al aboute
 Of stickes hiere and there a route,³²⁴
 And leide hem redy to his hond,
 Wherof he made his trosse and bond;
 Fro dai to dai and in this wise
 This Ape profreth his servise,
 So that he hadde of wode ynouh.
 5060 Upon a time and as he drouh
 Toward the wode, he sih besyde
 The grete gastli Serpent glyde,

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Til that sche cam in his presence,
 And in hir kinde a reverence³²⁵
 Sche hath him do, and forth withal
 A Ston mor briht than a cristall
 Out of hir mouth tofore his weie
 Sche let down falle, and wente aweie,
 For that he schal noght ben adrad.
 5070 Tho was this povere Bardus glad,
 Thonkende god, and to the Ston³²⁶
 He goth and takth it up anon,
 And hath gret wonder in his wit
 Hou that the beste him hath aquit,
 Wher that the mannes Sone hath failed,
 For whom he hadde most travailed.
 Bot al he putte in goddes hond,
 And torneth hom, and what he fond
 Unto his wif he hath it schewed;
 5080 And thei, that weren bothe lewed,
 Acorden that he scholde it selle.
 And he no lengere wolde duelle,
 Bot forth anon upon the tale
 The Ston he profreth to the sale;
 And riht as he himself it sette,
 The jueler anon forth fette
 The gold and made his paiement,
 Therof was no delaie ment.
 Thus whan this Ston was boght and sold,
 5090 Homward with joie manyfold
 This Bardus goth; and whan he cam
 Hom to his hous and that he nam
 His gold out of his Purs, withinne
 He fond his Ston also therinne,
 Wherof for joie his herte pleide,
 Unto his wif and thus he seide,
 ‘Lo, hier my gold, lo, hier mi Ston!’
 His wif hath wonder therupon,
 And axeth him hou that mai be.

5100 'Nou be mi trouthe I not,' quod he,
 'Bot I dar swere upon a bok,
 That to my Marchant I it tok,³²⁷
 And he it hadde whan I wente:
 So knowe I noght to what entente
 It is nou hier, bot it be grace.³²⁸
 Forthi tomorwe in other place
 I wole it fonde forto selle,
 And if it wol noght with him duelle,
 Bot crepe into mi purs ayein,

5110 Than dar I saufly swere and sein,
 It is the vertu of the Ston.'³²⁹

 The morwe cam, and he is gon
 To seche aboute in other stede
 His Ston to selle, and he so dede,³³⁰
 And lefte it with his chapman there.
 Bot whan that he cam elleswhere,
 In presence of his wif at hom,
 Out of his Purs and that he nom
 His gold, he fond his Ston withal:

5120 And thus it fell him overal,
 Where he it solde in sondri place,
 Such was the fortune and the grace.
 Bot so wel may nothing ben hidd,
 That it nys ate laste kidd:
 This fame goth aboute Rome³³¹
 So ferforth, that the wordes come
 To themperour Justinian;
 And he let sende for the man,³³²
 And axede him hou that it was.

5130 And Bardus tolde him al the cas,³³³
 Hou that the worm and ek the beste,³³⁴
 Although thei maden no beheste,
 His travail hadden wel aquit;
 Bot he which hadde a mannes wit,³³⁵
 And made his covenant be mouthe

And swor therto al that he couthe
To parte and yiven half his good,
Hath nou foryete hou that it stod,
As he which wol no trouthe holde.

5140 This Emperour al that he tolde
Hath herd, and thilke unkindenesse
He seide he wolde himself redresse.
And thus in court of juggement
This Adrian was thanne assent,
And the querele in audience³³⁶
Declared was in the presence
Of themperour and many mo;
Wherof was mochel speche tho
And gret wondringe among the press.

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5150 Bot ate laste natheles
For the partie which hath pleigned
The lawe hath diemed and ordeigned
Be hem that were avised wel,
That he schal have the halvendel
Thurghout of Adrianes good.
And thus of thilke unkinde blod
Stant the memoire into this day,³³⁷
Wherof that every wysman may³³⁸
Ensamplen him, and take in mynde³³⁹

5160 What schame it is to ben unkinde;
Ayein the which reson debateth,
And every creature it hateth.

[INGRATITUDE.]

Forthi, mi Sone, in thin office
I rede fle that ilke vice.

Confessor.

For riht as the Cronique seith
Of Adrian, hou he his feith
Foryat for worldes covoitise,
Fulofte in such a maner wise
Of lovers nou a man mai se

5170 Full manye that unkinde be:
For wel behote and evele laste
That is here lif; for ate laste,

Whan that thei have here wille do,
Here love is after sone ago.
What seist thou, Sone, to this cas?

 Mi fader, I wol seie Helas,
That evere such a man was bore,
Which whan he hath his trouthe suore
And hath of love what he wolde,

Amans.

5180 That he at eny time scholde ³⁴⁰

 Evere after in his herte finde
 To falsen and to ben unkinde.
 Bot, fader, as touchende of me,
 I mai noght stonde in that degre;
 For I tok nevere of love why,
 That I ne mai wel go therby
 And do my profit elles where,
 For eny sped I finde there.

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 I dar wel thenken al aboute,
5190 Bot I ne dar noght speke it oute;
 And if I dorste, I wolde pleigne,
 That sche for whom I soffre peine
 And love hir evere aliche hote,
 That nouthur yive ne behote
 In rewardinge of mi servise
 It list hire in no maner wise.
 I wol noght say that sche is kinde,
 And forto sai sche is unkinde,
 That dar I noght; bot god above, ³⁴¹

5200 Which demeth every herte of love,
 He wot that on myn oghne side
 Schal non unkindeschipe abide:
 If it schal with mi ladi duelle,
 Therof dar I nomore telle. ³⁴²

 Nou, goode fader, as it is,
Tell me what thenketh you of this.

Confessor.

 Mi Sone, of that unkindeschipe,
The which toward thi ladischipe
Thou pleignest, for sche wol thee noght,

5210Thou art to blamen of that thoght.³⁴³

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For it mai be that thi desir,
Thogh it brenne evere as doth the fyr,
Per cas to hire honour missit,
Or elles time com noght yit,
Which standt upon thi destine:³⁴⁴
Forthi, mi Sone, I rede thee,
Thenk wel, what evere the befalle;
For noman hath his lustes alle.
Bot as thou toldest me before

5220That thou to love art noght forswore,
And hast don non unkindenesse,
Thou miht therof thi grace blesse:
And lef noght that continuance;
For ther mai be no such grevance
To love, as is unkindeschipe.³⁴⁵
Wherof to kepe thi worschipe,
So as these olde bokes tale,
I schal thee telle a redi tale:
Nou herkne and be wel war therby,
5230For I wol telle it openly.

Mynos, as telleth the Poete,
The which whilom was king of Crete,
A Sone hadde and Androchee
He hihte: and so befell that he
Unto Athenes forto lere
Was send, and so he bar him there,³⁴⁶
For that he was of hih lignage,
Such pride he tok in his corage,
That he foryeten hath the Scoles,
And in riote among the foles
He dede manye thinges wronge;
And useth thilke lif so longe,³⁴⁹
Til ate laste of that he wroghte
He fond the meschief which he soghte,
Wherof it fell that he was slain.

[TALE OF THESEUS
AND ARIADNE.]

Hic ponit
exemplum contra
viros amori
ingratos. Et narrat
qualiter Theseus
Cadmi filius,
consilio
suffultus³⁴⁷
Adriagne Regis
Mynos filie, in
domo que
laborinthus dicitur
Minotaurum
vicit:³⁴⁸ vnde
Theseus Adriagne
sponsalia

His fader, which it herde sain,
 Was wroth, and al that evere he mihte,
 Of men of Armes he him dighte³⁵⁰
 A strong pouer, and forth he wente
 Unto Athenys, where he brente
 The pleine contre al aboute:
 The Cites stode of him in doute,
 As thei that no defence hadde³⁵¹
 Ayein the pouer which he ladde.
 Egeüs, which was there king,
 His conseil tok upon this thing,
 For he was thanne in the Cite:
 5240 So that of pes into tretee
 5250 Betwen Mynos and Egeüs
 5260 Thei felle, and ben acorded thus;
 That king Mynos fro yer to yeere
 Receive schal, as thou schalt here,
 Out of Athenys for truage
 Of men that were of myhti Age
 Persones nyne, of whiche he schal
 His wille don in special
 For vengance of his Sones deth.
 Non other grace ther ne geth,
 Bot forto take the juisse;
 5270 And that was don in such a wise,
 Which stod upon a wonder cas.
 For thilke time so it was,
 Wherof that men yit rede and singe,
 King Mynos hadde in his kepinge
 A cruel Monstre, as seith the geste:
 For he was half man and half beste,
 And Minotaurus he was hote,³⁵²
 Which was begete in a riote
 Upon Pasiphe, his oghne wif,
 5280 Whil he was oute upon the strif
 Of thilke grete Siege at Troie.³⁵³

certissime
 promittens ipsam
 vna cum Fedra
 sorore sua a Creta
 secum nauigio
 duxit. Set statim
 postea oblito
 gratitudinis
 beneficio
 Adriagnam ipsum
 saluantem in insula
 Chio spretam post
 tergum reliquit; et
 Fedram Athenis
 sibi sponsatam
 ingratus coronauit.

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Bot sche, which lost hath alle joie, ³⁵⁴
 Whan that sche syh this Monstre bore,
 Bad men ordeigne anon therfore:
 And fell that ilke time thus,
 Ther was a Clerk, on Dedalus,
 Which hadde ben of hire assent
 Of that hir world was so miswent; ³⁵⁵
 And he made of his oghne wit,
 5290 Wherof the remembrance is yit,
 For Minotaure such an hous,
 Which was so strange and merveilous,
 That what man that withinne wente,
 Ther was so many a sondri wente,
 That he ne scholde noght come oute,
 But gon amased al aboute.
 And in this hous to loke and warde
 Was Minotaurus put in warde,
 That what lif that therinne cam, ³⁵⁶
 5300 Or man or beste, he overcam
 And slow, and fedde him therupon;
 And in this wise many on ³⁵⁷
 Out of Athenys for truage
 Devoured weren in that rage.
 For every yeer thei schope hem so,
 Thei of Athenys, er thei go
 Toward that ilke wofull chance,
 As it was set in ordinance, ³⁵⁸
 Upon fortune here lot thei caste;
 5310 Til that Theseüs ate laste,
 Which was the kinges Sone there,
 Amonges othre that ther were
 In thilke yeer, as it befell,
 The lot upon his chance fell.
 He was a worthi kniht withalle;
 And whan he sih this chance falle, ³⁵⁹
 He ferde as thogh he tok non hiede,

Bot al that evere he mihte spiede,
 With him and with his felaschipe
 5320Forth into Crete he goth be Schipe;
 Wher that the king Mynos he soghte, [360](#)
 And profreth all that he him oghte
 Upon the point of here acord.
 This sterne king, this cruel lord
 Tok every day on of the Nyne,
 And put him to the discipline [361](#)
 Of Minotaure, to be devoured;
 Bot Theseüs was so favoured,
 That he was kept til ate laste.
 5330And in the meene while he caste
 What thing him were best to do:
 And fell that Adriagne tho,
 Which was the dowhter of Mynos,
 And hadde herd the worthi los
 Of Theseüs and of his myht,
 And syh he was a lusti kniht,
 Hire hole herte on him sche leide,
 And he also of love hir preide,
 So ferforth that thei were al on.
 5340And sche ordeigneth thanne anon
 In what manere he scholde him save, [362](#)
 And schop so that sche dede him have
 A clue of thred, of which withinne
 Ferst ate dore he schal beginne
 With him to take that on ende,
 That whan he wolde ayeinward wende, [363](#)
 He mihte go the same weie.
 And over this, so as I seie,
 Of pich sche tok him a pelote, [364](#)
 5350The which he scholde into the throte
 Of Minotaure caste rihte:
 Such wepne also for him sche dighte,
 That he be reson mai noght faile

To make an ende of his bataile;
 For sche him tawhte in sondri wise,
 Til he was knowe of thilke emprise,
 Hou he this beste schulde quelle.³⁶⁵
 And thus, schort tale forto telle,
 So as this Maide him hadde tawht,³⁶⁶
 5360 Theseüs with this Monstre fawht,
 Smot of his hed, the which he nam,
 And be the thred, so as he cam,
 He goth ayein, til he were oute.
 Tho was gret wonder al aboute:³⁶⁷
 Mynos the tribut hath relessed,
 And so was al the werre cessed
 Betwen Athene and hem of Crete.
 Bot now to speke of thilke suete,
 Whos beaute was withoute wane,
 5370 This faire Maiden Adriane,
 Whan that sche sih Theseüs sound,
 Was nevere yit upon the ground³⁶⁸
 A gladder wyht than sche was tho.
 Theseüs duelte a dai or tuo
 Wher that Mynos gret chiere him dede:
 Theseüs in a prive stede
 Hath with this Maiden spoke and rouned,
 That sche to him was abandouned
 In al that evere that sche couthe,
 5380 So that of thilke lusty youthe
 Al prively betwen hem tweie
 The ferste flour he tok aweie.
 For he so faire tho behihte
 That evere, whil he live mihte,
 He scholde hire take for his wif,
 And as his oghne hertes lif
 He scholde hire love and trouthe bere;³⁶⁹
 And sche, which mihte noght forbere,
 So sore loveth him ayein,

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5390 That what as evere he wolde sein
With al hire herte sche believeth.
And thus his pourpos he achieveth,
So that assured of his trouthe
With him sche wente, and that was routhe.

Fedra hire yonger Soster eke,
A lusti Maide, a sobre, a meke,
Fulfilde of alle curtesie,
For Sosterhode and compainie
Of love, which was hem betuene,
5400 To sen hire Soster mad a queene,
Hire fader lefte and forth sche wente
With him, which al his ferste entente
Foryat withinne a litel throwe,
So that it was al overthrowe,
Whan sche best wende it scholde stonde.
The Schip was blowe fro the londe,
Wherin that thei seilende were;
This Adriagne hath mochel fere
Of that the wynd so loude bleu,

5410 As sche which of the See ne kneu,
And preide forto reste a whyle.³⁷⁰
And so fell that upon an yle,
Which Chyo hihte, thei ben drive,
Where he to hire his leve hath yive
That sche schal londe and take hire reste.
Bot that was nothing for the beste:
For whan sche was to londe broght,
Sche, which that time thoghte noght
Bot alle trouthe, and tok no kepe,

5420 Hath leid hire softe forto slepe,
As sche which longe hath ben forwacched;
Bot certes sche was evele macched
And fer from alle loves kinde;
For more than the beste unkinde
Theseüs, which no trouthe kepte,
Whil that this yonge ladi slepte,

Fulfild of his unkindeschipe³⁷¹
 Hath al foryete the goodschipe
 Which Adriane him hadde do,
 5430 And bad unto the Schipmen tho³⁷²
 Hale up the seil and noght abyde,
 And forth he goth the same tyde
 Toward Athene, and hire alonde
 He lefte, which lay nyh the stronde
 Slepande, til that sche awok.
 Bot whan that sche cast up hire lok
 Toward the stronde and sih no wyht,
 Hire herte was so sore aflyht,³⁷³
 That sche ne wiste what to thinke;
 5440 Bot drouh hire to the water brinke,
 Wher sche behield the See at large.
 Sche sih no Schip, sche sih no barge
 Als ferforth as sche mihte kenne:
 ‘Ha lord,’ sche seide, ‘which a Senne,
 As al the world schal after hiere,
 Upon this woful womman hiere
 This worthi kniht hath don and wrought!
 I wende I hadde his love boght,
 And so deserved ate nede,³⁷⁴
 5450 Whan that he stod upon his drede,
 And ek the love he me behihte.
 It is gret wonder hou he mihte
 Towardes me nou ben unkinde,
 And so to lete out of his mynde
 Thing which he seide his oghne mouth.
 Bot after this whan it is couth³⁷⁵
 And drawe into the worldes fame,³⁷⁶
 It schal ben hindringe of his name:
 For wel he wot and so wot I,
 5460 He yaf his trouthe bodily,
 That he myn honour scholde kepe.’
 And with that word sche gan to wepe,

And sorweth more than ynouh:
 Hire faire tresces sche todrouh,³⁷⁷
 And with hirsself tok such a strif,³⁷⁸
 That sche betwen the deth and lif³⁷⁹
 Swounende lay fulofte among.³⁸⁰
 And al was this on him along,
 Which was to love unkinde so,
 5470Wherof the wrong schal everemo
 Stonde in Cronique of remembrance.
 And ek it asketh a vengeance
 To ben unkinde in loves cas,
 So as Theseüs thanne was,
 Al thogh he were a noble kniht;
 For he the lawe of loves riht
 Forfeted hath in alle weie,
 That Adriagne he putte aweie,
 Which was a gret unkinde dede:
 5480And after this, so as I rede,³⁸¹
 Fedra, the which hir Soster is,
 He tok in stede of hire, and this
 Fel afterward to mochel teene.
 For thilke vice of which I meene,
 Unkindeschipe, where it falleth,
 The trouthe of mannes herte it palleth,
 That he can no good dede aquite:
 So mai he stonde of no merite
 Towardes god, and ek also
 5490Men clepen him the worldes fo;
 For he nomore than the fend
 Unto non other man is frend,
 Bot al toward himself al one.
 Forthi, mi Sone, in thi persone
 This vice above alle othre fle.
 Mi fader, as ye techen me,
 I thenke don in this matiere.
 Bot over this nou wolde I hiere,

Wherof I schal me schryve more.
5500 Mi goode Sone, and for thi lore, [382](#)
After the reule of coveitise
I schal the proprete devise
Of every vice by and by.
Nou herkne and be wel war therby.

viii. *Viribus ex clara res tollit luce* [RAVINE.]
Rapina,
Floris et inuita virgine mella capit.

In the lignage of Avarice,
Mi Sone, yit ther is a vice,
His rihte name it is Ravine, [383](#)
Which hath a route of his covine.
Ravine among the maistres duelleth,
And with his servantz, as men telleth, [384](#)
Extorcion is nou withholde:
Ravine of othre mennes folde
5510 Makth his larder and paieth noght;
For wher as evere it mai be soght,
In his hous ther schal nothing lacke,
And that fulofte abyth the packe
Of povere men that duelle aboute.
Thus stant the comun poeple in doute,
Which can do non amendement;
5520 For whanne him faileth paiement, [385](#)
Ravine makth non other skile,
Bot takth be strengthe what he wile. [386](#)
So ben ther in the same wise
Lovers, as I thee schal devise, [387](#)
That whan noght elles mai availe,
Anon with strengthe thei assaile
And gete of love the sesine, [388](#)
Whan thei se time, be Ravine.

Forthi, mi Sone, schrif thee hier,
5530 If thou hast ben a Raviner

Hic tractat super
illa specie cupida
que Rapina
nuncupatur, cuius
mater extorcio
ipsam ad
deseruiendum
magnatum curiis
specialius
commendavit.

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Confessor.

Of love.

Certes, fader, no:

Amans.

For I mi ladi love so, [389](#)

That thogh I were as was Pompeie, [390](#)

That al the world me wolde obeie,

Or elles such as Alisandre,

I wolde noght do such a sklaundre;

It is no good man, which so doth.

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In good feith, Sone, thou seist soth:

For he that wole of pourveance [391](#)

Confessor.

5540 Be such a weie his lust avance,

He schal it after sore abie,

Bot if these olde ensamples lie.

Nou, goode fader, tell me on,

Amans.

So as ye cunne manyon,

Touchende of love in this matiere.

Nou list, mi Sone, and thou schalt

Confessor.

hiere, [392](#)

So as it hath befalle er this,

In loves cause hou that it is

A man to take be Ravine

5550 The preie which is femeline.

Ther was a real noble king,

[TALE OF TEREUS.]

And riche of alle worldes thing,

Which of his propre enheritance

Athenes hadde in governance,

And who so thenke therupon,

His name was king Pandion.

Tuo douhtres hadde he be his wif,

The whiche he lovede as his lif;

The ferste douhter Progne hihte,

5560 And the secounde, as sche wel mihte, [397](#)

Was cleped faire Philomene,

To whom fell after mochel tene.

The fader of his pourveance

His doughter Progne wolde avance,

Hic ponit
exemplum contra
istos in amoris
causa raptores. Et
narrat qualiter
Pandion Rex
Athenarum duas
filias, [393](#) videlicet
Progne et
Philomenam,
habuit. Progne
autem Tereo [394](#)
Regi Tracie
desponsata,

And yaf hire unto mariage
 A worthi king of hih lignage,
 A noble kniht eke of his hond,
 So was he kid in every lond,
 Of Trace he hihte Tereüs;
 The clerk Ovide telleth thus.
 This Tereüs his wif hom ladde,
 A lusti lif with hire he hadde;
 Til it befell upon a tyde,
 This Progne, as sche lay him besyde,
 Bethoughte hir hou it mihte be
 That sche hir Soster myhte se,
 And to hir lord hir will sche seide,
 With goodly wordes and him preide
 That sche to hire mihte go:
 And if it liked him noght so,
 That thanne he wolde himselve wende,
 Or elles be som other sende,
 Which mihte hire diere Soster griete,
 And schape hou that thei mihten miete.

5570 Hir lord anon to that he herde

5580 Yaf his acord, and thus ansuerde:

'I wole,' he seide, 'for thi sake
 The weie after thi Soster take
 Miself, and bringe hire, if I may.'

5590 And sche with that, there as he lay, ³⁹⁸

Began him in hire armes clippe,
 And kist him with hir softe lippe, ³⁹⁹
 And seide, 'Sire, grant mercy.'

And he sone after was redy,
 And tok his leve forto go;
 In sori time dede he so.

This Tereüs goth forth to Schipe ⁴⁰⁰
 With him and with his felaschipe;
 Be See the rihte cours he nam,

5600 Into the contre til he cam, ⁴⁰¹

Wher Philomene was duellinge,

contigit quod
 cum ³⁹⁵ Tereus ad
 instanciam
 vxoris ³⁹⁶ sue
 Philomenam de
 Athenis in Traciam
 sororie visitacionis
 causa secum
 quadam vice
 perduceret, in
 concupiscenciam
 Philomene tanta
 seueritate in itinere
 dilapsus est, quod
 ipse non solum sue
 violencia rapine
 virginitatem eius
 oppressit, set et
 ipsius linguam, ne
 factum detegeret,
 forpice mutulauit.
 Vnde in perpetue
 memorie Cronicam
 tanti raptoris
 austeritatem miro
 ordine dii postea
 vindicarunt.

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And of hir Soster the tidinge
 He tolde, and tho thei weren glade,
 And mochel joie of him thei made.
 The fader and the moder bothe
 To leve here douhter weren lothe,
 Bot if thei weren in presence;
 And natheles at reverence
 Of him, that wolde himself travaile,
 5610 Thei wolden noght he scholde faile⁴⁰²
 Of that he preide, and yive hire leve:⁴⁰³
 And sche, that wolde noght beleve,
 In alle haste made hire yare
 Toward hir Soster forto fare,
 With Tereüs and forth sche wente.
 And he with al his hole entente,
 Whan sche was fro hir frendes go,
 Assoteth of hire love so,
 His yhe myhte he noght withholde,
 5620 That he ne moste on hir beholde;
 And with the sihte he gan desire,⁴⁰⁴
 And sette his oghne herte on fyre;⁴⁰⁵
 And fyr, whan it to tow aprocheth,
 To him anon the strengthe acrocheth,
 Til with his hete it be devoured,
 The tow ne mai noght be socoured.
 And so that tirant raviner,⁴⁰⁶
 Whan that sche was in his pouer,
 And he therto sawh time and place,
 5630 As he that lost hath alle grace,
 Foryat he was a wedded man,
 And in a rage on hire he ran,
 Riht as a wolf which takth his preie.⁴⁰⁷
 And sche began to crie and preie,
 ‘O fader, o mi moder diere,
 Nou help!’ Bot thei ne mihte it hiere,
 And sche was of to litel myht

Defense ayein so ruide a knyht
 To make, whanne he was so wod
 5640 That he no reson understod,
 Bot hield hire under in such wise,
 That sche ne myhte noght arise,
 Bot lay oppressed and desesed,
 As if a goshauk hadde sesed
 A brid, which dorste noght for fere
 Remue: and thus this tirant there⁴⁰⁸
 Beraft hire such thing as men sein
 Mai neveremor be yolde ayein,
 And that was the virginite:
 5650 Of such Ravine it was pite.
 Bot whan sche to hirselves com,
 And of hir meschief hiede nom,
 And knew hou that sche was no maide,
 With wofull herte thus sche saide:
 'O thou of alle men the worste,
 Wher was ther evere man that dorste
 Do such a dede as thou hast do?
 That dai schal falle, I hope so,
 That I schal telle out al mi fille,
 5660 And with mi speche I schal fulfille
 The wyde world in brede and lengthe.
 That thou hast do to me be strengthe,
 If I among the poeple duelle,
 Unto the poeple I schal it telle;
 And if I be withinne wall
 Of Stones closed, thanne I schal
 Unto the Stones clepe and crie,⁴⁰⁹
 And tellen hem thi felonie;
 And if I to the wodes wende,
 5670 Ther schal I tellen tale and ende,⁴¹⁰
 And crie it to the briddes oute,⁴¹¹
 That thei schul hiere it al aboute.
 For I so loude it schal reherce,
 That my vois schal the hevene perce,

That it schal soune in goddes Ere.
 Ha, false man, where is thi fere?
 O mor cruel than eny beste,
 Hou hast thou holden thi beheste⁴¹²
 Which thou unto my Soster madest?
 5680 O thou, which alle love ungladest,
 And art ensample of alle untrewes,
 Nou wolde god mi Soster knewe,
 Of thin untrouthe, hou that it stod!
 And he than as a Lyon wod⁴¹³
 With hise unhappi handes stronge
 Hire cauhte be the tresses longe,
 With whiche he bond ther bothe hire armes,
 That was a fieble dede of armes,
 And to the grounde anon hire caste,
 5690 And out he clippeth also faste
 Hire tunge with a peire scheres.
 So what with blod and what with teres
 Out of hire yhe and of hir mouth,
 He made hire faire face uncouth:
 Sche lay swounende unto the deth,
 Ther was unethes eny breth;
 Bot yit whan he hire tunge refte,
 A litel part therof belefte,
 Bot sche with al no word mai soune,
 5700 Bot chitre and as a brid jargoune.
 And natheles that wode hound
 Hir bodi hent up fro the ground,
 And sente hir there as be his wille
 Sche scholde abyde in prison stille
 For everemo: bot nou tak hiede
 What after fell of this misdede.
 Whanne al this meschief was befallle,
 This Tereüs, that foule him falle,
 Unto his contre hom he tyh;
 5710 And whan he com his paleis nyh,
 His wif al redi there him kepte.

Whan he hir sih, anon he wepte,
 And that he dede for deceite,
 For sche began to axe him streite,
 'Wher is mi Soster?' And he seide
 That sche was ded; and Progne abreide,
 As sche that was a wofull wif,
 And stod betuen hire deth and lif,
 Of that sche herde such tidinge:⁴¹⁴
 5720 Bot for sche sih hire lord wepinge,
 She wende noght bot alle trouthe,
 And hadde wel the more routhe.
 The Perles weren tho forsake
 To hire, and blake clothes take;
 As sche that was gentil and kinde,
 In worschipe of hir Sostres mynde
 Sche made a riche enterement,
 For sche fond non amendement
 To syghen or to sobbe more:
 5730 So was ther guile under the gore.
 Nou leve we this king and queene,
 And torne ayein to Philomene,
 As I began to tellen erst.
 Whan sche cam into prison ferst,
 It thoghte a kinges douhter strange
 To maken so soudein a change
 Fro welthe unto so grete a wo;⁴¹⁵
 And sche began to thenke tho,
 Thogh sche be mouthe nothing preide,
 5740 Withinne hir herte thus sche seide:⁴¹⁶
 'O thou, almyhty Jupiter,
 That hihe sist and lokest fer,
 Thou soffrest many a wrong doinge,⁴¹⁷
 And yit it is noght thi willinge.
 To thee ther mai nothing ben hid,
 Thou wost hou it is me betid:
 I wolde I hadde noght be bore,

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For thanne I hadde noght forlore⁴¹⁸
 Mi speche and mi virginite.
 5750 Bot, goode lord, al is in thee,
 Whan thou therof wolt do vengance
 And schape mi deliverance.'
 And evere among this ladi wepte,
 And thoghte that sche nevere kepte
 To ben a worldes womman more,
 And that sche wissheth everemore.
 Bot ofte unto hir Soster diere
 Hire herte spekth in this manere,
 And seide, 'Ha, Soster, if ye knewe
 5760 Of myn astat, ye wolde rewe,
 I trowe, and my deliverance
 Ye wolde schape, and do vengance
 On him that is so fals a man:
 And natheles, so as I can,
 I wol you sende som tokninge,⁴¹⁹
 Wherof ye schul have knowlechinge
 Of thing I wot, that schal you lothe,
 The which you toucheth and me bothe.'
 And tho withinne a whyle als tyt⁴²⁰
 5770 Sche waf a cloth of Selk al whyt
 With lettres and ymagerie,
 In which was al the felonie,
 Which Tereüs to hire hath do;⁴²¹
 And lappede it togedre tho⁴²²
 And sette hir signet therupon
 And sende it unto Progne anon.
 The messenger which forth it bar,
 What it amonteth is noght war;
 And natheles to Progne he goth
 5780 And prively takth hire the cloth,
 And wente ayein riht as he cam,
 The court of him non hiede nam.
 Whan Progne of Philomene herde,

Sche wolde knowe hou that it ferde,
 And opneth that the man hath broght,
 And wot therby what hath be wroght
 And what meschief ther is befalle.
 In swoune tho sche gan doun falle,
 And efte aros and gan to stonde,
 5790 And eft sche takth the cloth on honde,
 Behield the lettres and thymages;
 Bot ate laste, 'Of suche outrages,'
 Sche seith, 'wepinge is noght the bote:'
 And swerth, if that sche live mote,
 It schal be venged otherwise.
 And with that sche gan hire advise
 Hou ferst sche mihte unto hire winne
 Hir Soster, that noman withinne,
 Bot only thei that were suore,
 5800 It scholde knowe, and schop therfore
 That Tereüs nothing it wiste;
 And yit riht as hirselves liste,⁴²³
 Hir Soster was delivered sone
 Out of prison, and be the mone
 To Progne sche was broght be nyhte.
 Whan ech of other hadde a sihte,
 In chambre, ther thei were al one,⁴²⁴
 Thei maden many a pitous mone;
 Bot Progne most of sorwe made,
 5810 Which sihe hir Soster pale and fade⁴²⁵
 And specheles and deshonoured,
 Of that sche hadde be defloured;
 And ek upon hir lord sche thoghte,
 Of that he so untreuly wroghte
 And hadde his espousaile broke.
 Sche makth a vou it schal be wroke,⁴²⁶
 And with that word sche kneleth doun
 Wepinge in gret devocioun:
 Unto Cupide and to Venus
 5820 Sche preide, and seide thanne thus:

'O ye, to whom nothing avertere
 Of love mai, for every herte
 Ye knowe, as ye that ben above
 The god and the goddesse of love;
 Ye witen wel that evere yit
 With al mi will and al my wit,
 Sith first ye schopen me to wedde,
 That I lay with mi lord abedde,
 I have be trewe in mi degre,
 5830 And evere thoghte forto be,
 And nevere love in other place,
 Bot al only the king of Trace,
 Which is mi lord and I his wif.
 Bot nou allas this wofull strif!
 That I him thus ayeinward finde
 The most untrew and most unkinde
 That evere in ladi armes lay.⁴²⁷
 And wel I wot that he ne may
 Amende his wrong, it is so gret;
 5840 For he to lytel of me let,
 Whan he myn oughne Soster tok,
 And me that am his wif forsok.'
 Lo, thus to Venus and Cupide
 Sche preide, and furthermor sche cride
 Unto Appollo the hiheste,
 And seide, 'O myghti god of reste,
 Thou do vengeance of this debat.
 Mi Soster and al hire astat
 Thou wost, and hou sche hath forlore
 5850 Hir maidenhod, and I therfore
 In al the world schal bere a blame
 Of that mi Soster hath a schame,
 That Tereüs to hire I sente:
 And wel thou wost that myn entente
 Was al for worschipe and for goode.
 O lord, that yifst the lives fode
 To every wyht, I prei thee hier

Thes wofull Sostres that ben hiere,
And let ous noght to the ben lothe;⁴²⁸
5860We ben thin oghne wommen bothe.'

Thus pleigneth Progne and axeth wreche,
And thogh hire Soster lacke speche,
To him that alle thinges wot
Hire sorwe is noght the lasse hot:
Bot he that thanne had herd hem tuo,
Him oughte have sorwed everemo
For sorwe which was hem betuene.
With signes pleigneth Philomene,
And Progne seith, 'It schal be wreke,
5870That al the world therof schal speke.'

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And Progne tho seknesse feigneth,
Wherof unto hir lord sche pleigneth,
And preith sche moste hire chambres kepe,⁴²⁹
And as hir liketh wake and slepe.
And he hire granteth to be so;
And thus togedre ben thei tuo,
That wolde him bot a litel good.
Nou herk hierafter hou it stod⁴³⁰
Of wofull auntres that befelle:

5880Thes Sostres, that ben bothe felle,—⁴³¹
And that was noght on hem along,
Bot onliche on the grete wrong
Which Tereüs hem hadde do,—
Thei schopen forto venge hem tho.

This Tereüs be Progne his wif
A Sone hath, which as his lif
He loveth, and Ithis he hihte:
His moder wiste wel sche mihte
Do Tereüs no more grief⁴³²
5890Than sle this child, which was so lief.⁴³³
Thus sche, that was, as who seith, mad
Of wo, which hath hir overlad,
Withoute insihte of moderhede

Foryat pite and loste drede,
 And in hir chambre prively
 This child withouten noise or cry
 Sche slou, and hieu him al to pieces:
 And after with diverse spieces
 The fleissh, whan it was so toheewe,
 5900Sche takth, and makth therof a sewe,
 With which the fader at his mete
 Was served, til he hadde him ete;
 That he ne wiste hou that it stod,
 Bot thus his oughne fleissh and blod
 Himself devoureth ayein kinde,
 As he that was tofore unkinde.
 And thanne, er that he were arise,
 For that he scholde ben agrise,
 To schewen him the child was ded,
 5910This Philomene tok the hed
 Betwen tuo disshes, and al wrothe
 Tho comen forth the Sostres bothe,
 And setten it upon the bord.
 And Progne tho began the word,
 And seide, 'O werste of alle wicke,
 Of conscience whom no pricke
 Mai stere, lo, what thou hast do!
 Lo, hier ben nou we Sostres tuo;[434](#)
 O Raviner, lo hier thi preie,
 5920With whom so falsliche on the weie
 Thou hast thi tirannye wrought.
 Lo, nou it is somdel aboght,
 And bet it schal, for of thi dede
 The world schal evere singe and rede
 In remembrance of thi defame:[435](#)
 For thou to love hast do such schame,
 That it schal nevere be foryete.'
 With that he sterte up fro the mete,
 And schof the bord unto the flor,[436](#)
 5930And cauhte a swerd anon and suor

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That thei scholde of his handes dye.
 And thei unto the goddes crie
 Begunne with so loude a stevene,
 That thei were herd unto the hevene;
 And in a twinclinge of an yhe
 The goddes, that the meschief syhe,⁴³⁷
 Here formes changen alle thre.
 Echon of hem in his degre
 Was torned into briddes kinde;
 5940 Diverseliche, as men mai finde,
 After thastat that thei were inne,
 Here formes were set atwinne.
 And as it telleth in the tale,
 The ferst into a nyhtingale⁴³⁸
 Was schape, and that was Philomene,
 Which in the wynter is noght sene,
 For thanne ben the leves falle
 And naked ben the buisshes alle.
 For after that sche was a brid,
 5950 Hir will was evere to ben hid,
 And forto duelle in prive place,
 That noman scholde sen hir face
 For schame, which mai noght be lassed,
 Of thing that was tofore passed,
 Whan that sche loste hir maidenhiede:
 For evere upon hir wommanhiede,
 Thogh that the goddes wolde hire change,
 Sche thenkth, and is the more strange,⁴³⁹
 And halt hir clos the wyntres day.
 5960 Bot whan the wynter goth away,
 And that Nature the goddesse
 Wole of hir oughne fre largesse⁴⁴⁰
 With herbes and with floures bothe
 The feldes and the medwes clothe,
 And ek the wodes and the greves
 Ben heled al with grene leves,⁴⁴¹

So that a brid hire hyde mai,
 Betwen Averil and March and Maii,
 Sche that the wynter hield hir clos,
 5970 For pure schame and noght aros,
 Whan that sche seth the bowes thikke, [442](#)
 And that ther is no bare sticke,
 Bot al is hid with leves grene,
 To wode comth this Philomene [443](#)
 And makth hir ferste yeres flyht;
 Wher as sche singeth day and nyht,
 And in hir song al openly [444](#)
 Sche makth hir pleignte and seith, 'O why,
 O why ne were I yit a maide?' [445](#)
 5980 For so these olde wise saide,
 Which understoden what sche mente, [446](#)
 Hire notes ben of such entente.
 And ek thei seide hou in hir song
 Sche makth gret joie and merthe among,
 And seith, 'Ha, nou I am a brid,
 Ha, nou mi face mai ben hid:
 Thogh I have lost mi Maidenhede,
 Schal noman se my chekes rede.'
 Thus medleth sche with joie wo
 5990 And with hir sorwe merthe also,
 So that of loves maladie
 Sche makth diverse melodie,
 And seith love is a wofull blisse,
 A wisdom which can noman wisse,
 A lusti fievere, a wounde softe:
 This note sche reherceth ofte
 To hem whiche understonde hir tale.
 Nou have I of this nyhtingale,
 Which erst was cleped Philomene,
 6000 Told al that evere I wolde mene,
 Bothe of hir forme and of hir note,
 Wherof men mai the storie note.

And of hir Soster Progne I finde,
 Hou sche was torned out of kinde
 Into a Swalwe swift of winge,
 Which ek in wynter lith swounynge,
 Ther as sche mai nothing be sene:
 Bot whan the world is woxe grene⁴⁴⁷
 And comen is the Somertide,
 6010 Than fleth sche forth and ginth to chide,
 And chitreth out in hir langage⁴⁴⁸
 What falshod is in mariage,⁴⁴⁹
 And telleth in a maner speche
 Of Tereüs the Spousebreche.
 Sche wol noght in the wodes duelle,
 For sche wolde openliche telle;⁴⁵⁰
 And ek for that sche was a spouse,
 Among the folk sche comth to house,
 To do thes wyves understonde⁴⁵¹
 6020 The falshod of hire housebonde,⁴⁵²
 That thei of hem be war also,
 For ther ben manye untrewes of tho.
 Thus ben the Sostres briddes bothe,
 And ben toward the men so lothe,
 That thei ne wole of pure schame
 Unto no mannes hand be tame;⁴⁵³
 For evere it duelleth in here mynde
 Of that thei founde a man unkinde,
 And that was false Tereüs.
 6030 If such on be amonges ous
 I not, bot his condicion
 Men sein in every region
 Withinne toune and ek withoute
 Nou regneth comunliche aboute.
 And natheles in remembrance
 I wol declare what vengeance
 The goddes hadden him ordeined,
 Of that the Sostres hadden pleigned:

For anon after he was changed
6040 And from his oghne kinde stranged,
A lappewincke mad he was,
And thus he hoppeth on the gras,⁴⁵⁴
And on his hed ther stant upriht
A creste in tokne he was a kniht;⁴⁵⁵
And yit unto this dai men seith,
A lappewincke hath lore his feith⁴⁵⁶
And is the brid falseste of alle.

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Bewar, mi Sone, er thee so falle;⁴⁵⁷
For if thou be of such covine,
6050 To gete of love be Ravine
Thi lust, it mai thee falle thus,
As it befell of Tereüs.⁴⁵⁸

Confessor.

Mi fader, goddes forebode!⁴⁵⁹
Me were levere be fortrode⁴⁶⁰
With wilde hors and be todrawe,
Er I ayein love and his lawe
Dede eny thing or loude or stille,
Which were noght mi ladi wille.
Men sein that every love hath drede;⁴⁶¹
6060 So folweth it that I hire drede,
For I hire love, and who so dredeth,
To plesse his love and serve him nedeth.
Thus mai ye knowen be this skile
That no Ravine don I wile
Ayein hir will be such a weie;
Bot while I live, I wol obeie
Abidinge on hire courtesie,
If eny merci wolde hir plie.
Forthi, mi fader, as of this
6070 I wot noght I have don amis:
Bot furthermore I you beseche,
Som other point that ye me teche,
And axeth forth, if ther be auht,
That I mai be the betre tauht.

Amans.

ix. *Viuat vt ex spoliis grandi quamsepe
tumultu,*

[ROBBERY.]

*Quo graditur populus, latro perurget iter.
Sic amor, ex casu poterit quo carpere
predam,*

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Si locus est aptus, cetera nulla timet.

Whan Covoitise in povere astat
Stant with himself upon debat⁴⁶²
Thurgh lacke of his misgovernance,
That he unto his sustenance
Ne can non other weie finde
6080 To gete him good, thanne as the blinde,
Which seth noght what schal after falle,
That ilke vice which men calle
Of Robberie, he takth on honde;
Wherof be water and be londe⁴⁶³
Of thing which othre men beswinke
He get him cloth and mete and drinke.
Him reccheth noght what he beginne,
Thurgh thefte so that he mai winne:
Forthi to maken his pourchas
6090 He lith awaitende on the pas,
And what thing that he seth ther passe,
He takth his part, or more or lasse,
If it be worthi to be take.
He can the packes wel ransake,
So prively berth non aboute
His gold, that he ne fint it oute,
Or other juel, what it be;
He takth it as his proprete.
In wodes and in feldes eke
6100 Thus Robberie goth to seke,
Wher as he mai his pourpos finde.⁴⁶⁴
And riht so in the same kinde,
My goode Sone, as thou miht hiere,⁴⁶⁵

Hic loquitur super
illa Cupiditatis
specie quam
furtum vocant,
cuius Ministri
alicuius legis
offensam non
metuentes, tam in
amoris causa quam
aliter, suam
quamsepe
conscienciam
offendunt.

To speke of love in the matiere
And make a verrai resemblance,
Riht as a thief makth his chevance
And robbeth mennes good aboute
In wode and field, wher he goth oute,
So be ther of these lovers some,
6110 In wylde stedes wher thei come⁴⁶⁶
And finden there a womman able,
And therto place covenable,
Withoute leve, er that thei fare,
Thei take a part of that chaffare:⁴⁶⁷
Yee, though sche were a Scheperdesse,
Yit wol the lord of wantounesse
Assaie, althogh sche be unmete,
For other mennes good is swete.
Bot therof wot nothing the wif
6120 At hom, which loveth as hir lif
Hir lord, and sitt alday wisshinge
After hir lordes hom comynge:
Bet whan that he comth hom at eve,
Anon he makth his wif beleve,
For sche noght elles scholde knowe:
He telth hire hou his hunte hath blowe,
And hou his houndes have wel runne,
And hou ther schon a merye Sunne,
And hou his haukes flowen wel;
6130 Bot he wol telle her nevere a diel
Hou he to love untrewe was,
Of that he robbede in the pas,
And tok his lust under the schawe
Ayein love and ayein his lawe.

Which thing, mi Sone, I thee forbede, Confessor.
For it is an ungoodly dede.
For who that takth be Robberie
His love, he mai noght justefie
His cause, and so fulofte sithe
6140 For ones that he hath be blithe

He schal ben after sory thries.
Ensample of suche Robberies
I finde write, as thou schalt hiere,
Acordende unto this matiere.

I rede hou whilom was a Maide,
The faireste, as Ovide saide,
Which was in hire time tho;
And sche was of the chambre also
Of Pallas, which is the goddesse
6150 And wif to Marte, of whom prouesse
Is yove to these worthi knihtes.⁴⁶⁹
For he is of so grete mihtes,
That he governeth the bataille;
Withouten him may noght availe
The stronge hond, bot he it helpe;
Ther mai no knyht of armes yelpe,
Bot he feihte under his banere.
Bot nou to speke of mi matiere,
This faire, freisshe, lusti mai,
6160 Al one as sche wente on a dai
Upon the stronde forto pleie,
Ther cam Neptunus in the weie,⁴⁷⁰
Which hath the See in governance;
And in his herte such plesance
He tok, whan he this Maide sih,
That al his herte aros on hih,
For he so sodeinliche unwar⁴⁷¹
Behield the beaute that sche bar.
And caste anon withinne his herte
6170 That sche him schal no weie asterte,
Bot if he take in advantage
Fro thilke maide som pilage,
Noght of the broches ne the Ringes,
Bot of some othre smale thinges
He thoghte parte, er that sche wente;
And hire in bothe hise armes hente,

[NEPTUNE AND
CORNIX.]

Hic loquitur contra
istos in amoris
causa predones,
qui cum in suam
furtive
concupiscenciam
aspirant, fortuna in
contrarium
operatur. Et narrat
quod cum⁴⁶⁸
Neptunus
quamdam virginem
nomine Cornicem
solam iuxta mare
deambulantem
opprimere suo
furto voluisset,
superueniens
Pallas ipsam e
manibus eius
virginitate servata
gracius liberavit.

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And putte his hond toward the cofre,
 Wher forto robbe he made a profre,⁴⁷²
 That lusti tresor forto stele,
 6180 Which passeth othre goodes fele
 And cleped is the maidenhede,
 Which is the flour of wommanhede.
 This Maiden, which Cornix be name
 Was hote, dredende alle schame,
 Sih that sche mihte noght debate,
 And wel sche wiste he wolde algate
 Fulfille his lust of Robberie,
 Anon began to wepe and crie,
 And seide, 'O Pallas, noble queene,
 6190 Scheu nou thi myht and let be sene,⁴⁷³
 To kepe and save myn honour:
 Help, that I lese noght mi flour,
 Which nou under thi keie is loke.'
 That word was noght so sone spoke,
 Whan Pallas schop recoverir
 After the will and the desir
 Of hire, which a Maiden was,
 And sodeinliche upon this cas
 Out of hire wommanisshe kinde
 6200 Into a briddes like I finde
 Sche was transformed forth withal,
 So that Neptunus nothing stal
 Of such thing as he wolde have stole.
 With fetheres blake as eny cole
 Out of hise armes in a throwe
 Sche flih before his yhe a Crowe;
 Which was to hire a more delit,
 To kepe hire maidenhede whit
 Under the wede of fethers blake,
 6210 In Perles whyte than forsake
 That no lif mai restore ayein.
 Bot thus Neptune his herte in vein
 Hath upon Robberie sett;

The bridd is flowe and he was let,
The faire Maide him hath ascaped,⁴⁷⁴
Wherof for evere he was bejaped
And scorned of that he hath lore.

Mi Sone, be thou war therfore
That thou no maidenhode stele,
6220Wherof men sen deseses fele
Aldai befall in sondri wise;
So as I schal thee yit devise
An other tale therupon,
Which fell be olde daies gon.

King Lichaon upon his wif
A dowhter hadde, a goodly lif,
A clene Maide of worthi fame,
Calistona whos rihte name
Was cleped, and of many a lord
6230Sche was besoght, bot hire acord
To love myhte noman winne,
As sche which hath no lust therinne;
Bot swor withinne hir herte and saide
That sche wolde evere ben a Maide.⁴⁷⁵
Wherof to kepe hireself in pes,
With suche as Amadriades
Were cleped, wodemaydes, tho,
And with the Nymphes ek also
Upon the spring of freisshe welles
6240Sche schop to duelle and nagher elles.
And thus cam this Calistona
Into the wode of Tegea,
Wher sche virginite behihte
Unto Diane, and therto plihte
Her trouthe upon the bowes grene,
To kepe hir maidenhode clene.
Which afterward upon a day
Was priveliche stole away;
For Jupiter thurgh his queintise

Confessor.

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[TALE OF
CALISTONA.]

Hic ponit
exemplum contra
istos in causa
virginitatis lese
predones. Et narrat
quod cum
Calistona
Lichaontis mire
pulcritudinis filia
suam virginitatem
Diane
conseruandam
castissima
vouisset, et in
Siluam que Tegea
dicitur inter alias
ibidem Nymphas
moraturam se
transtulisset,
Iupiter virginis
castitatem subtili
furto surripiens,
quendam⁴⁷⁶ filium,
qui postea Archas
nominatus est, ex
ea genuit: vnde
Iuno in Calistonam
seuiens eius
pulcritudinem in
vrse turpissime

6250 From hire it tok in such a wise,
 That sodeinliche forth withal
 Hire wombe aros and sche toswal,
 So that it mihte noght ben hidd.
 And therupon it is betidd,
 Diane, which it herde telle,
 In prive place unto a welle⁴⁷⁷
 With Nymphes al a compainie⁴⁷⁸
 Was come, and in a ragerie
 Sche seide that sche bathe wolde,
 6260 And bad that every maide scholde
 With hire al naked bathe also.
 And tho began the prive wo,
 Calistona wax red for schame;
 Bot thei that knewe noght the game,
 To whom no such thing was befalle,
 Anon thei made hem naked alle,
 As thei that nothing wolden hyde:⁴⁷⁹
 Bot sche withdrouh hire evere asyde,
 And natheles into the flod,
 6270 Wher that Diane hirselve stod,
 Sche thoghte come unaperceived.
 Bot therof sche was al deceived;
 For whan sche cam a litel nyh,
 And that Diane hire wombe syh,
 Sche seide, 'Awey, thou foule beste,
 For thin astat is noght honeste
 This chaste water forto touche;
 For thou hast take such a touche,
 Which nevere mai ben hol ayein.'
 6280 And thus goth sche which was forlein
 With schame, and fro the Nymphes fledde,
 Til whanne that nature hire spedde,
 That of a Sone, which Archas
 Was named, sche delivered was.
 And tho Juno, which was the wif
 Of Jupiter, wroth and hastif,

deformitatem
 subito
 transfiguravit.

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In pourpos forto do vengeance
 Cam forth upon this ilke chance,
 And to Calistona sche spak,⁴⁸⁰
 6290 And sette upon hir many a lak,
 And seide, 'Ha, nou thou art atake,
 That thou thi werk myht noght forsake.
 Ha, thou ungoodlich ypocrite,⁴⁸¹
 Hou thou art gretly forto wyte!
 Bot nou thou schalt ful sore abie
 That ilke stelthe and micherie,⁴⁸²
 Which thou hast bothe take and do;
 Wherof thi fader Lichao
 Schal noght be glad, whan he it wot,
 6300 Of that his dowhter was so hot,
 That sche hath broke hire chaste avou.
 Bot I thee schal chastise nou,⁴⁸³
 Thi grete Beaute schal be torned,
 Thurgh which that thou hast be mistorned,⁴⁸⁴
 Thi large frount, thin yhen greie,
 I schal hem change in other weie,
 And al the feture of thi face
 In such a wise I schal deface,
 That every man thee schal forbere.'
 6310 With that the liknesse of a bere
 Sche tok and was forschape anon.
 Withinne a time and therupon
 Befell that with a bowe on honde,⁴⁸⁵
 To hunte and gamen forto fonde,
 Into that wode goth to pleie
 Hir Sone Archas, and in his weie
 It hapneth that this bere cam.⁴⁸⁶
 And whan that sche good hiede nam,⁴⁸⁷
 Wher that he stod under the bowh,⁴⁸⁸
 6320 Sche kneu him wel and to him drouh;
 For thogh sche hadde hire forme lore,
 The love was noght lost therfore

Which kinde hath set under his lawe.
Whan sche under the wodesschawe⁴⁸⁹
Hire child behield, sche was so glad,
That sche with bothe hire armes sprad,
As thogh sche were in wommanhiede,
Toward him cam, and tok non hiede
Of that he bar a bowe bent.

6330 And he with that an Arwe hath hent
And gan to teise it in his bowe,
As he that can non other knowe,
Bot that it was a beste wylde.
Bot Jupiter, which wolde schylde
The Moder and the Sone also,
Ordeineth for hem bothe so,⁴⁹⁰
That thei for evere were save.

Bot thus, mi Sone, thou myht have
Ensample, hou that it is to fle

Confessor.

6340 To robbe the virginite
Of a yong innocent aweie:⁴⁹¹
And overthis be other weie,
In olde bokes as I rede,
Such Robberie is forto drede,
And nameliche of thilke good
Which every womman that is good
Desireth forto kepe and holde,
As whilom was be daies olde.
For if thou se mi tale wel

6350 Of that was tho, thou miht somdiel
Of old ensample taken hiede,⁴⁹²
Hou that the flour of maidenhiede
Was thilke time holde in pris.
And so it was, and so it is,
And so it schal for evere stonde:
And for thou schalt it understonde,
Nou herkne a tale next suiende,
Hou maidenhod is to commende.

x. *Vt Rosa de spinis spineto preualet*
*orta,*⁴⁹³

[VIRGINITY.]

Et lilii flores cespite plura valent,
Sic sibi virginitas carnis sponsalia vincit,
Eternos fetus que sine labe parit.

Of Rome among the gestes olde
6360I finde hou that Valerie tolde

That what man tho was Emperour⁴⁹⁴
Of Rome, he scholde don honour
To the virgine, and in the weie,⁴⁹⁵
Wher he hire mette, he scholde obeie
In worschipe of virginite,
Which tho was of gret dignite.⁴⁹⁷
Noght onliche of the wommen tho,⁴⁹⁸
Bot of the chaste men also
It was commended overal:

Hic loquitur de
virginitatis
commendacione,
vbi dicit quod
nuper Imperatores
ob tanti status
dignitatem
virginibus
cedebant⁴⁹⁶ in via.

6370And forto speke in special
Touchende of men, ensample I finde,
Phyryns, which was of mannes
kinde⁴⁹⁹

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Above alle othre the faireste
Of Rome and ek the comelieste,
That wel was hire which him mihte
Beholde and have of him a sihte.
Thus was he tempted ofte sore;
Bot for he wolde be nomore⁵⁰⁰
Among the wommen so coveited,

Hic loquitur,
qualiter Phyrinus,
iuuenum Rome
pulcherrimus, ut
illesam suam
conseruaret
virginitatem,
ambos oculos
eruens vultus sui
decorem
abhominabilem
constituit.

6380The Beaute of his face streited
He hath, and threste out bothe hise yhen,⁵⁰¹
That alle wommen whiche him syhen⁵⁰²
Thanne afterward, of him ne roghte:
And thus his maidehiede he boghte.
So mai I prove wel forthi,
Above alle othre under the Sky,
Who that the vertus wolde peise,⁵⁰³

Virginite is forto preise,
Which, as thapocalips recordeth,
6390 To Crist in hevene best acordeth. [504](#)

So mai it schewe wel therfore,
As I have told it hier tofore,
In hevene and ek in Erthe also
It is accept to bothe tuo*.

And if I schal more over this
Declare what this vertu is,
I finde write upon this thing
Of Valentinian the king
And Emperour be thilke daies,
6400 A worthi knyht at alle assaies,
Hou he withoute Mariage
Was of an hundred wynter Age,
And hadde ben a worthi kniht
Bothe of his lawe and of his myht.

[CHASTITY OF
VALENTINIAN.]

Hic loquitur
qualiter
Valentinianus
Imperator, cum
ipse octogenarius
plures prouincias
Romano Imperio
belliger
subiugasset, dixit
se super omnia
magis gaudere de
eo, quod contra sue
carnis
concupiscenciam
victoriam
optinuisset; nam et
ipse virgo omnibus
diebus vite sue
castissimus
permansit.

*Out of his flessh a man to live⁵⁰⁵

Gregoire hath this ensample yive,
And seith it schal rather be told
Lich to an Angel manyfold,⁵⁰⁷
Than to the lif of mannes kinde.

In carne preter
carnem viuere
pocius vita
angelica quam
humana est.⁵⁰⁶

6400 Ther is no reson forto finde,
Bot only thurgh the grace above,
In flessh withoute flesshly love
A man to live chaste hiere:
And natheles a man mai hiere
Of suche that have ben er this,
And yit ther ben; bot for it is
A vertu which is sielde wonne,
Now I this matiere have begonne,
I thenke tellen overmore,
6410 Which is, mi Sone, for thi lore,
If that the list to taken hiede.

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x.⁵⁰⁸ *Vt Rosa de spinis spineto preualet orta,
Et lilii flores cespite plura valent,
Sic sibi virginitas carnis sponsalia vincit,
Eternos fetus que sine labe parit.*

To trete upon the maidenhiede,
The bok seith that a mannes lif
Upon knyghthode in werre and strif⁵¹⁰
Is sett among hise enemys:
The frele fleissh, whos nature is
Ai redy forto sporne and falle,
The ferste foman is of alle;
For thilke werre is redi ai,
6420 It werreth nyht, it werreth dai,

Milicia est vita
hominis super
terram.⁵⁰⁹

So that a man hath nevere reste.
Forthi is thilke knyht the beste,
Thurgh myht and grace of goddes sonde
Which that bataille mai withstonde:
Wherof yit duelleth the memoire
Of hem that whilom the victoire
Of thilke dedly werre hadden;⁵¹¹
The hih prouesse which thei ladden,
Wherof the Soule stod amended,⁵¹²
6430* Upon this erthe is yit commended.⁵¹³

An Emperour be olde daies
Ther was, and he at alle assaies
A worthi knyht was of his hond,
Ther was non such in al the lond;
Bot yit for al his vasselage
He stod unwedded al his age,⁵¹⁶
And in Cronique as it is told,
He was an hundred wynter old.
Bot whan men wolde etc. (as 6405 ff.)

Hic loquitur
qualiter
Valentinianus
Imperator, cum
ipse octogenarius
plures prouincias
Romano Imperio
belliger
subiugasset, dixit
se super omnia
magis gaudere de
eo quod contra⁵¹⁴
sue carnis
concupiscenciam
victoriam
optinuisset; nam et
ipse virgo omnibus
diebus vite sue
castissimus⁵¹⁵
permansit.

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Bot whan men wolde his dedes peise
And his knyghthode of Armes preise,
Of that he dede with his hondes,
Whan he the kinges and the londes⁵¹⁷
To his subjeccion put under,⁵¹⁸
6410 Of al that pris hath he no wonder,
For he it sette of non acompte,
And seide al that may noght amonte
Ayeins o point which he hath nome,

That he his fleissh hath overcome:
He was a virgine, as he seide;
(6450*) that bataille his pris he leide.

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Lo nou, my Sone, avise thee.

[VIRGINITY.]

Yee, fader, al this wel mai be, [519](#)

Amans.

Bot if alle othre dede so,

6420The world of men were sone go:
And in the lawe a man mai finde,
Hou god to man be weie of kinde
Hath set the world to multeplie;
And who that wol him justefie,
It is ynouh to do the lawe.
And natheles youre goode sawe
Is good to kepe, who so may,
I wol noght therayein seie nay.

Mi Sone, take it as I seie; [520](#)

Confessor.

6430If maidenhod be take aweie
Withoute lawes ordinance,
It mai noght failen of vengeance.
And if thou wolt the sothe wite,
Behold a tale which is write,
Hou that the King Agamenon,
Whan he the Cite of Lesbon
Hath wonne, a Maiden ther he fond,
Which was the faireste of the Lond
In thilke time that men wiste.

6440He tok of hire what him liste
Of thing which was most precious,
Wherof that sche was dangerous.
This faire Maiden cleped is
Criseide, douhter of Crisis, [521](#)
Which was that time in special
Of thilke temple principal,
Wher Phebus hadde his sacrifice,
So was it wel the more vice.

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Agamenon was thanne in weie
6450To Troieward, and tok aweie

This Maiden, which he with him ladde,
 So grete a lust in hire he hadde. [522](#)
 Bot Phebus, which hath gret desdeign
 Of that his Maiden was forlein,
 Anon as he to Troie cam,
 Vengance upon this dede he nam
 And sende a comun pestilence.
 Thei soghten thanne here evidence
 And maden calculation,
 6460 To knowe in what condicion
 This deth cam in so sodeinly; [523](#)
 And ate laste redyly
 The cause and ek the man thei founde: [524](#)
 And forth withal the same stounde
 Agamenon opposed was, [525](#)
 (6500) Which hath beknewen al the cas
 Of the folie which he wroghte.
 And therupon mercy thei soghte
 Toward the god in sondri wise
 6470 With preiere and with sacrificise,
 The Maide and hom ayein thei sende, [526](#)
 And yive hire good ynouh to spende [527](#)
 For evere whil sche scholde live:
 And thus the Senne was foryive
 And al the pestilence cessed.
 Lo, what it is to ben encressed
 Of love which is evele wonne.
 It were betre noght begonne
 Than take a thing withoute leve,
 6480 Which thou most after nedes leve,
 And yit have malgre forth withal.
 Forthi to robben overal
 In loves cause if thou beginne,
 I not what ese thou schalt winne.
 Mi Sone, be wel war of this,
 For thus of Robberie it is. [528](#)

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Confessor.

Mi fader, youre ensamplerie
In loves cause of Robberie
I have it riht wel understonde.
6490 Bot overthis, hou so it stonde,
Yit wolde I wite of youre aprise
What thing is more of Covoitise.

Amans.

xi. *Insidiando latens tempus rimatur et*
*horam*⁵²⁹

[STEALTH AND
MICHERY.]

*Fur, quibus occulto tempore furta parat.*⁵³⁰
*Sic amor insidiis vacat, vt sub tegmine ludos*⁵³¹
Prendere furtiuos nocte fauente queat.

With Covoitise yit I finde
A Servant of the same kinde,
Which Stelthe is hote, and Mecherie
With him is evere in compainie.
Of whom if I schal telle soth,
He stalketh as a Pocok doth,
And takth his preie so covert,
6500 That noman wot it in apert.
For whan he wot the lord from home,⁵³³
Than wol he stalke aboute and rome;
And what thing he fint in his weie,
Whan that he seth the men aweie,
He stelth it and goth forth withal,
That therof noman knowe schal.
And ek fulofte he goth a nyht
Withoute Mone or sterreliht,
And with his craft the dore unpiketh,
6510 And takth therinne what him liketh:
And if the dore be so schet,
That he be of his entre let,
He wole in ate wyndou crepe,
And whil the lord is faste aslepe,
He stelth what thing as him best list,
(6550) And goth his weie er it be wist.

Hic tractat super
illa Cupiditatis
specie, que
secretum
latrocinium dicitur,
cuius natura
custode⁵³² rerum
nesciente ea que
cupit tam per diem
quam per noctem
absque strepitu
clanculo furatur.

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Fulofte also be lyhte of day
Yit wole he stele and make assay;⁵³⁴
Under the cote his hond he put,
6520 Til he the mannes Purs have cut,
And rifleth that he fint therinne.
And thus he auntreth him to winne,
And berth an horn and noght ne bloweth,
For noman of his conseil knoweth;
What he mai gete of his Michinge,
It is al bile under the winge.
And as an hound that goth to folde
And hath ther taken what he wolde,
His mouth upon the gras he wypeth,
6530 And so with feigned chiere him slypeth,
That what as evere of schep he strangle,
Ther is noman therof schal jangle,
As forto knowen who it dede;⁵³⁵
Riht so doth Stelthe in every stede,
Where as him list his preie take.
He can so wel his cause make
And so wel feigne and so wel glose,
That ther ne schal noman suppose,
Bot that he were an innocent,
6540 And thus a mannes yhe he blent:
So that this craft I mai remene
Withouten help of eny mene.
Ther be lovers of that degre,
Which al here lust in privete,
As who seith, geten al be Stelthe,
And ofte atteignen to gret welthe
As for the time that it lasteth.⁵³⁶
For love awaiteth evere and casteth
Hou he mai stele and cacche his preie,
6550 Whan he therto mai finde a weie:
For be it nyht or be it day,
He takth his part, whan that he may,
And if he mai nomore do,

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[STEALTH OF
LOVERS.]

Yit wol he stele a cuss or tuo.

Mi Sone, what seist thou therto?

Confessor.

Tell if thou dedest evere so.

Mi fader, hou?

Mi Sone, thus,—

If thou hast stolen eny cuss

Or other thing which therto longeth,

6560 For noman suche thieves hongeth:

Tell on forthi and sei the trouthe.

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Mi fader, nay, and that is routhe,

For be mi will I am a thief;

Confessio Amantis.

Bot sche that is to me most lief,

Yit dorste I nevere in private

(6600) Noight ones take hire be the kne,

To stele of hire or this or that,

And if I dorste, I wot wel what:

And natheles, bot if I lie,

6570 Be Stelthe ne be Robberie

Of love, which fell in mi thoght,

To hire dede I nevere noght.

Bot as men sein, wher herte is failed,

Ther schal no castell ben assailed;

Bot thogh I hadde hertes ten,

And were als strong as alle men,

If I be noght myn oghne man

And dar noght usen that I can,

I mai miselve noght recovere.

6580 Thogh I be nevere man so povere,

I bere an herte and hire it is,

So that me faileth wit in this,

Hou that I scholde of myn acord

The servant lede ayein the lord:

For if mi fot wolde awher go, [537](#)

Or that min hand wolde elles do,

Whan that myn herte is therayein,

The remenant is al in vein.

And thus me lacketh alle wele,

6590 And yit ne dar I nothing stele
Of thing which longeth unto love:
And ek it is so hyh above,
I mai noght wel therto areche,
Bot if so be at time of speche,
Ful selde if thanne I stele may
A word or tuo and go my way.
Betwen hire hih astat and me⁵³⁸
Comparison ther mai non be,
So that I fiele and wel I wot,

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6600 Al is to hevy and to hot
To sette on hond withoute leve:
And thus I mot algate leve
To stele that I mai noght take,
And in this wise I mot forsake
To ben a thief ayein mi wille
Of thing which I mai noght fulfille.
For that Serpent which nevere slepte
The flees of gold so wel ne kepte
In Colchos, as the tale is told,

6610 That mi ladi a thousandfold
Nys betre yemed and bewaked,
Wher sche be clothed or be naked.
To kepe hir bodi nyht and day,
Sche hath a wardein redi ay,
Which is so wonderful a wyht,

(6650) That him ne mai no mannes myht
With swerd ne with no wepne daunte,⁵³⁹
Ne with no sleihte of charme enchaunte,
Wherof he mihte be mad tame,

6620 And Danger is his rihte name;
Which under lock and under keie,
That noman mai it stele aweie,
Hath al the Tresor underfonge
That unto love mai belonge.
The leste lokinge of hire yhe
Mai noght be stole, if he it syhe;

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And who so gruccheth for so lyte,
 He wolde sone sette a wyte
 On him that wolde stele more.
 6630 And that me grieveth wonder sore,
 For this proverbe is evere newe,
 That stronge lokes maken trewe
 Of hem that wolden stele and pyke:⁵⁴⁰
 For so wel can ther noman slyke⁵⁴¹
 Be him ne be non other mene,
 To whom Danger wol yive or lene
 Of that tresor he hath to kepe.
 So thogh I wolde stalke and crepe,
 And wayte on eve and ek on morwe,
 6640 Of Danger schal I nothing borwe,
 And stele I wot wel may I noght:⁵⁴²
 And thus I am riht wel bethoght,
 Whil Danger stant in his office,
 Of Stelthe, which ye clepe a vice,
 I schal be gultif neveremo.
 Therfore I wolde he were ago
 So fer that I nevere of him herde,
 Hou so that afterward it ferde:
 For thanne I mihte yit per cas
 6650 Of love make som pourchas
 Be Stelthe or be som other weie,
 That nou fro me stant fer aweie.
 Bot, fader, as ye tolde above,⁵⁴³
 Hou Stelthe goth a nyht for love,
 I mai noght wel that point forsake,
 That ofte times I ne wake
 On nyhtes, whan that othre slepe;
 Bot hou, I prei you taketh kepe.
 Whan I am loged in such wise⁵⁴⁴
 6660 That I be nyhte mai arise,
 At som wyndowe and loken oute
 And se the housinge al aboute,

So that I mai the chambre knowe
 In which mi ladi, as I trowe,
 Lyth in hir bed and slepeth softe,
 (6670)Thanne is myn herte a thief fulofte:
 For there I stonde to beholde⁵⁴⁵
 The longe nyhtes that ben colde,
 And thenke on hire that lyth there.
 6670And thanne I wisshe that I were
 Als wys as was Nectanabus
 Or elles as was Protheüs,
 That couthen bothe of nigromaunce
 In what liknesse, in what semblaunce,
 Riht as hem liste, hemself transforme:
 For if I were of such a forme,
 I seie thanne I wolde fle
 Into the chambre forto se⁵⁴⁶
 If eny grace wolde falle,
 6680So that I mihte under the palle
 Som thing of love pyke and stele.
 And thus I thenke thoghtes fele,
 And thogh therof nothing be soth,
 Yit ese as for a time it doth:
 Bot ate laste whanne I finde
 That I am falle into my mynde,
 And se that I have stonde longe
 And have no profit underfonge,
 Than stalke I to mi bedd withinne.
 6690And this is al that evere I winne
 Of love, whanne I walke on nyht:
 Mi will is good, bot of mi myht
 Me lacketh bothe and of mi grace;
 For what so that mi thoght embrace,⁵⁴⁷
 Yit have I noght the betre ferd.
 Mi fader, lo, nou have ye herd
 What I be Stelthe of love have do,⁵⁴⁸
 And hou mi will hath be therto:
 If I be worthi to penance

6700I put it on your ordinance.⁵⁴⁹

Mi Sone, of Stelthe I the behiete,
Thogh it be for a time swete,
At ende it doth bot litel good,
As be ensample hou that it stod
Whilom, I mai thee telle nou.

Confessor.

I preie you, fader, sei me hou.⁵⁵⁰

Amans.

Mi Sone, of him which goth be daie
Be weie of Stelthe to assaie,
In loves cause and takth his preie,

Confessor.

6710Ovide seide as I schal seie,

And in his Methamor he tolde
A tale, which is good to holde.

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The Poete upon this matiere
Of Stelthe wrot in this manere.

[TALE OF
LEUCOTHOE.]

Venus, which hath this lawe in honde⁵⁵¹

(6750) thing which mai noght be withstonde,

As sche which the tresor to warde
Of love hath withinne hir warde,

Phebum to love hath so constreigned,⁵⁵⁶

6720That he withoute reste is peined

With al his herte to coveite
A Maiden, which was warded streyte
Withinne chambre and kept so clos,
That selden was whan sche desclos
Goth with hir moder forto pleie.

Hic in amoris
causa super isto
Latrocinio quod de
die⁵⁵² contigit
ponit exemplum.
Et narrat quod,
cum Leuchotoe
Orchami filia in
cameris sub arta
matris custodia
virgo
preservabatur,
Phebus eius
pulcritudinem
concupiscens, in
conclave domus
clara luce
subintrans, virginis
pudiciam matre
nescia⁵⁵³
defloravit: vnde
ipsa inpregnata
iratus pater filiam
suam ad
sepeliendum viam
effodit; ex cuius
tumulo florem,

Leuchotoe, so as men seie,

This Maiden hihte, and Orchamus
Hir fader was; and befell thus.

This doughter, that was kept so deere,

6730And hadde be fro yer to yeere

Under hir moder discipline
A clene Maide and a Virgine,
Upon the whos nativite
Of comelihiede and of beaute
Nature hath set al that sche may,

That lich unto the fresshe Maii,
 Which othre monthes of the yeer
 Surmonteth, so withoute pier
 Was of this Maiden the feture.
 6740Wherof Phebus out of mesure
 Hire loveth, and on every syde
 Awaiteth, if so mai betyde, [557](#)
 That he thurgh eny sleihte myhte
 Hire lusti maidenhod unrihte,
 The which were al his worldes welthe.
 And thus lurkende upon his stelthe [558](#)
 In his await so longe he lai,
 Til it befell upon a dai,
 That he thurghout hir chambre wall
 6750Cam in al sodeinliche, and stall
 That thing which was to him so lief. [559](#)
 Bot wo the while, he was a thief!
 For Venus, which was enemie
 Of thilke loves micherie,
 Discovereth al the pleine cas
 To Clymene, which thanne was [560](#)
 Toward Phebus his concubine.
 And sche to lette the covine
 Of thilke love, dedli wroth
 6760To pleigne upon this Maide goth,
 And tolde hire fader hou it stod;
 Wherof for sorwe welnyh wod
 Unto hire moder thus he saide:
 ‘Lo, what it is to kepe a Maide!
 To Phebus dar I nothing speke,
 (6800*) Bot upon hire I schal be wreke, [561](#)
 So that these Maidens after this
 Mow take ensample, what it is [562](#)
 To soffre her maidenhed be stole, [563](#)
 6770Wherof that sche the deth schal thole.’
 And bad with that do make a pet, [564](#)

quem [554](#)
 Solsequium
 vocant, dicunt
 tunc [555](#)
 consequenter
 primitus
 accreuisse.

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Wherinne he hath his douhter set,
As he that wol no pite have,
So that sche was al quik begrave
And deide anon in his presence.
Bot Phebus, for the reverence
Of that sche hadde be his love,
Hath wrought thurgh his pouer above,
That sche sprong up out of the molde

6780 Into a flour was named golde,
Which stant governed of the Sonne.
And thus whan love is evele wonne,
Fulofte it comth to repentaile.

Mi fader, that is no mervaille,
Whan that the conseil is bewreid.
Bot ofte time love hath pleid
And stole many a prive game,
Which nevere yit cam into blame,
Whan that the thinges weren hidde.

Amans.

6790 Bot in youre tale, as it betidde,
Venus discoverede al the cas,
And ek also brod dai it was,
Whan Phebus such a Stelthe wroghte,
Wherof the Maide in blame he broghte,
That afterward sche was so lore. [565](#)

Bot for ye seiden nou tofore
Hou stelthe of love goth be nyhte,
And doth hise thinges out of syhte,
Therof me liste also to hiere

6800 A tale lich to the matiere,
Wherof I miyhte ensample take.

Mi goode Sone, and for thi sake, [566](#)
So as it fell be daies olde, [567](#)
And so as the Poete it tolde,
Upon the nyhtes micherie
Nou herkne a tale of Poesie.

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Confessor.

The myhtieste of alle men

Whan Hercules with Eolen,
 Which was the love of his corage,
 6810 Togedre upon a Pelrinage
 Towardes Rome scholden go,⁵⁷⁰
 It fell hem be the weie so,
 That thei upon a dai a Cave
 Withinne a roche founden have,
 Which was real and glorious
 (6850) And of Entaile curious,
 Be name and Thophis it was hote.
 The Sonne schon tho wonder hote,
 As it was in the Somer tyde;
 6820 This Hercules, which be his syde
 Hath Eolen his love there,⁵⁷¹
 Whan thei at thilke cave were,
 He seide it thoghte him for the beste
 That sche hire for the hete reste
 Al thilke day and thilke nyht;
 And sche, that was a lusti wyht,
 It liketh hire al that he seide:
 And thus thei duelle there and pleide
 The longe dai. And so befell,
 6830 This Cave was under the hell
 Of Tymolus, which was begrowe
 With vines, and at thilke throwe
 Faunus with Saba the goddesse,
 Be whom the large wilderness
 In thilke time stod governed,
 Weere in a place, as I am lerned,⁵⁷²
 Nyh by, which Bachus wode hihte.
 This Faunus tok a gret insihte
 Of Eolen, that was so nyh;⁵⁷³
 For whan that he hire beaute syh,
 Out of his wit he was assoted,
 And in his herte it hath so noted,
 That he forsok the Nimphes alle,
 And seide he wolde, hou so it falle,

[TALE OF HERCULES
AND FAUNUS.]

Hic ponit
 exemplum super
 eodem quod de
 nocte contigit. Et
 narrat qualiter
 Hercules cum Eole
 in quadam
 spelunca nobili,
 Thophis dicta, sub
 monte Thymolo,
 vbi silua Bachi est,
 hospicio
 pernoctarunt. Et
 cum ipsi variis
 lectis seperatim⁵⁶⁸
 iacentes
 dormierunt,
 contigit lectum
 Herculis
 vestimentis Eole
 lectumque Eole
 pelle leonis, qua
 Hercules
 induebatur, operiri.
 Super quo Faunus
 a silua descendens
 speluncam
 subintravit,
 temptans si forte
 cum Eole sue
 concupiscencie
 voluptatem⁵⁶⁹
 nesciente Hercule
 furari posset. Et
 cum ad lectum
 Herculis muliebri
 palpata veste ex
 casu peruenisset,
 putans Eolen
 fuisse, cubiculum
 nudo corpore
 ingreditur; quem
 senciens Hercules
 manibus
 apprehensum
 ipsum ad terram ita
 fortiter allisit, ut
 impotens sui

Assaie an other forto winne;
 So that his hertes thoght withinne⁵⁷⁴
 He sette and caste hou that he myhte
 Of love pyke away be nyhte⁵⁷⁵
 That he be daie in other wise
 To stele mihte noght suffise:
 6840 And therupon his time he waiteth.
 6850 Nou tak good hiede hou love afaiteth
 Him which withal is overcome.
 Faire Eolen, whan sche was come
 With Hercules into the Cave,
 Sche seide him that sche wolde have⁵⁷⁶
 Hise clothes of and hires bothe,⁵⁷⁷
 That ech of hem scholde other clothe.⁵⁷⁸
 And al was do riht as sche bad,
 6860 He hath hire in hise clothes clad
 And caste on hire his gulion,
 Which of the Skyn of a Leoun
 Was mad, as he upon the weie
 It slouh, and overthis to pleie
 Sche tok his grete Mace also
 (6900*) And knet it at hir gerdil tho.
 So was sche lich the man arraied,⁵⁷⁹
 And Hercules thanne hath assaied
 To clothen him in hire array:
 6870 And thus thei jape forth the dai,
 Til that her Souper redy were.
 And whan thei hadden souped there,
 Thei schopen hem to gon to reste;
 And as it thoghte hem for the beste,
 Thei bede, as for that ilke nyht,
 Tuo sondri beddes to be dyht,
 For thei togedre ligge nolde,
 Be cause that thei offre wolde
 Upon the morwe here sacrifice.
 6880 The servantz deden here office

corporis effectus
 usque mane ibidem
 requieuit, vbi Saba
 cum Nimphis
 siluestribus
 superueniens
 ipsum sic illusum
 deridebat.

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And sondri beddes made anon,
Wherin that thei to reste gon
Ech be himself in sondri place.⁵⁸⁰
Faire Eole hath set the Mace
Beside hire beddes hed above,
And with the clothes of hire love
Sche helede al hire bed aboute;
And he, which hadde of nothing doute,
Hire wympel wond aboute his cheke,
6890 Hire kertell and hire mantel eke
Abrod upon his bed he spredde.
And thus thei slepen bothe abedde;
And what of travail, what of wyn,
The servantz lich to drunke Swyn
Begunne forto route faste.⁵⁸¹

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This Faunus, which his Stelthe caste,
Was thanne come to the Cave,
And fond thei weren alle save
Withoute noise, and in he wente.
6900 The derke nyht his sihte blente,
And yit it happeth him to go
Where Eolen abedde tho
Was leid al one for to slepe;
Bot for he wolde take kepe
Whos bed it was, he made assai,
And of the Leoun, where it lay,
The Cote he fond, and ek he fieleth
The Mace, and thanne his herte kieleth,
That there dorste he noght abyde,
6910 Bot stalketh upon every side
And soghte aboute with his hond,
That other bedd til that he fond,
Wher lai bewympled a visage.
Tho was he glad in his corage,
For he hir kertell fond also
(6950) And ek hir mantell bothe tuo
Bespred upon the bed alofte.

He made him naked thanne, and softe
Into the bedd unwar he crepte,
6920Wher Hercules that time slepte,
And wende wel it were sche;
And thus in stede of Eole
Anon he profreth him to love.
But he, which felte a man above,
This Hercules, him threw to ground⁵⁸²
So sore, that thei have him founde
Liggende there upon the morwe;
And tho was noght a litel sorwe,
That Faunus of himselve made,
6930Bot elles thei were alle glade
And lowhen him to scorne aboute:
Saba with Nimphis al a route⁵⁸³
Cam doun to loke hou that he ferde,⁵⁸⁴
And whan that thei the sothe herde,
He was bejaped overal.

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 Mi Sone, be thou war withal
 To seche suche mecheries,
 Bot if thou have the betre aspies,
 In aunter if the so betyde
6940As Faunus dede thilke tyde,
 Wherof thou miht be schamed so.

Confessor.

 Min holi fader, certes no.
 Bot if I hadde riht good leve,
 Such mecherie I thenke leve:
 Mi feinte herte wol noght serve;
 For malgre wolde I noght deserve
 In thilke place wher I love.
 Bot for ye tolden hier above
 Of Covoitise and his pilage,
6950If ther be more of that lignage,
 Which toucheth to mi schrifte, I preie
 That ye therof me wolde seie,
 So that I mai the vice eschuie.

Amans.

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 Mi Sone, if I be order suie⁵⁸⁵

Confessor.

The vices, as thei stonde arowe,⁵⁸⁶
 Of Covoitise thou schalt knowe
 Ther is yit on, which is the laste;
 In whom ther mai no vertu laste,
 For he with god himself debateth,
 6960Wherof that al the hevene him hateth.

xii. *Sacrilegus tantum furto loca sacra* [SACRILEGE.]
prophanat;
Vt sibi sunt agri, sic domus alma dei.
Nec locus est, in quo non temptat amans quod amatur,
Et que posse nequit carpere, velle capit.

The hihe god, which alle goode
 Pourveied hath for mannes fode
 Of clothes and of mete and drinke,
 Bad Adam that he scholde swinke
 To geten him his sustenance;
 (7000)And ek he sette an ordinance
 Upon the lawe of Moïses,⁵⁸⁷
 That though a man be haveles,
 Yit schal he noght be thefte stele.
 6970Bot nou adaies ther ben fele,
 That wol no labour undertake,
 Bot what thei mai be Stelthe take
 Thei holde it sikerliche wonne.
 And thus the lawe is overronne,
 Which god hath set, and namely
 With hem that so untrewely
 The goodes robbe of holi cherche.
 The thefte which thei thanne werche
 Be name is cleped Sacrilege,
 6980Ayein the whom I thenke alegge.*
 Of his condicion to telle,
 Which rifleth bothe bok and belle,

Hic tractat super
 vltima Cupiditatis
 specie, que
 Sacrilegium dicta
 est, cuius furtum ea
 que altissimo
 sanctificantur bona
 depredans ecclesie
 tantum spoliis
 insidiatur.

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[588](#)*Upon the pointz as we ben taught[589](#)

Stant sacrilege, and elles nought.

The firste point is for to seye,
Whan that a thief schal stele aweye
The holy thing from holy place.

7020* The secounde is, if he pourchace
By wey of thefte unholy thing,
Which he upon his knowleching
Fro holy place aweie took.

The thridde point, as seith the book,
Is such as, wher as evere it be, [590](#)
In woode, in feld or in Cite,
Schal no man stele by no wise
That halwed is to the servise
Of god which alle thinges wot.

7030But ther is nouthur cold ne hot,
Which he for god or man wol spare,
So that the body may wel fare;
And that he may the world aschape,
The hevene him thenkth is but a jape: [591](#)
And thus, the sothe for to telle,
He rifleth bothe book and belle, [592](#)
So forth with al, etc. (*as* 6983 ff.)

So forth with al the remenant
To goddes hous appourtenant,
Wher that he scholde bidde his bede,
He doth his thefte in holi stede,
And takth what thing he fint therinne:
For whan he seth that he mai winne,
He wondeth for no cursednesse,
6990That he ne brekth the holinesse
And doth to god no reverence;
For he hath lost his conscience,

That though the Prest therfore curse,
He seith he fareth noght the wurse.⁵⁹³

And forto speke it otherwise,
(7050) ~~W~~hat man that lassethe the franchise
And takth of holi cherche his preie,
I not what bedes he schal preie.

Whan he fro god, which hath yive al,
7000 The Pourpartie in special,

Which unto Crist himself is due,⁵⁹⁴
Benymth, he mai noght wel eschue
The peine comende afterward;
For he hath mad his foreward
With Sacrilege forto duelle,
Which hath his heritage in helle.
And if we rede of tholde lawe,⁵⁹⁵
I finde write, in thilke dawes⁵⁹⁶
Of Princes hou ther weren thre⁵⁹⁷

7010 Coupable sore in this degre.⁵⁹⁸

That on of hem was cleped thus,
The proude king Antiochus;
That other Nabuzardan hihte,
Which of his cruelte behyhte
The temple to destruie and waste,
And so he dede in alle haste;
The thridde, which was after schamed,
Was Nabugodonosor named,
And he Jerusalem putte under,

7020 Of Sacrilege and many a wonder
There in the holi temple he wroghte,
Which Baltazar his heir aboghte,⁵⁹⁹
Whan Mane, Techel, Phares write
Was on the wal, as thou miht wite,
So as the bible it hath declared.⁶⁰⁰
Bot for al that it is noght spared
Yit nou aday, that men ne pile,
And maken argument and skile

To Sacrilege as it belongeth,
7030 For what man that ther after longeth,
He takth non hiede what he doth.*
And riht so, forto telle soth,

[601](#)* And if a man schal telle soth,
Of guile and of soubtilite
Is non so slyh in his degre
To feigne a thing for his beyete,
7090 As is this vice of which I trete.
He can so priveliche pyke,
He can so wel hise wordes slyke
To putte away suspeciou,un,
That in his excusacioun,
Ther schal noman defalte finde.
And thus fulofte men be blinde,
That stonden of his word deceived,
Er his queintise be perceived.
Bot natheles yit otherwhile,
7100 For al his sleyhte and al his guile, [602](#)
Of that he wolde his werk forsake,
He is atteint and overtake;
Wherof thou schalt a tale rede,
In Rome as it befell in dede. [603](#)

Er Rome cam to the creance
Of Cristes feith, it fell per chance,
Cesar, which tho was Emperour,
Him liste forto don honour
Unto the temple Apollinis,
7110 And made an ymage upon this,
The which was cleped Apollo.
Was non so riche in Rome tho;
Of plate of gold a berd he hadde,
The which his brest al overspradde;

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[TALE OF LUCIUS
AND THE STATUE.]

Hic loquitur de illis
qui laruata
consciencia
Sacrilegium sibi
licere fingunt. Et
narrat quod, cum
quidam Lucius
clericus famosus et
Imperatori notus
deum suum
Apollinem in

Of gold also withoute faile
 His mantell was of large entaile,
 Beset with perrie al aboute,
 Forthriht he strawhte his finger oute,
 Upon the which he hadde a ryng,
 7120 **T**o sen it was a riche thing,
 A fin Carbuncle for the nones, [604](#)
 Most precious of alle Stones.
 And fell that time in Rome thus:
 Ther was a clerk, on Lucius,
 A Courteour, a famous man,
 Of every witt somewhat he can,
 Outake that him lacketh reule
 His oghne astat to guide and reule;
 How so it stod of his spekinge,
 He was noght wys in his doinge.
 Bot every riot ate laste
 Mot nedes falle and mai noght laste:
 After the meede of his decerte,
 So fell this clerk into poverte
 And wiste noght how forto ryse;
 Wherof in many a sondri wyse
 He caste his wittes hier and ther,
 He loketh nyh, he loketh fer,
 Til on a time that he com
 Into the temple, and hiede he nom [609](#)
 Wher that the god Apollo stod.
 He sih the richesse and the good,
 And thoghte he wolde be som weie
 The tresor pyke and stele aweie;
 And therupon so slyhly wroghte,
 That his pourpos aboute he broghte,
 7130 **A**nd wente away unaparceived.
 7140 **T**hus hath the man his god deceived, [610](#)
 His ryng, his mantell and his beard,
 7150 **A**s he which nothing was a feerd, [611](#)
 Al prively with him he bar:

templo Rome de
 anulo suo, pallio et
 barba aurea
 spoliasset, ipse
 tandem
 apprehensus et
 coram Imperatore
 accusatus taliter se
 excusando ait:
 'Anulum a deo
 recepi, quia ipse
 digito protenso ex
 sua largitate
 anulum hunc
 gracie michi
 optulit; pallium ex
 lamine aureo
 constructum tuli,
 quia aurum
 maxime
 ponderosum et
 frigidum
 naturaliter
 consistit, unde nec
 in estate propter
 pondus nec in
 yeme propter
 frigus ad dei vestes
 vtile fuit; barbam
 ab eo [605](#) deposui,
 quia ipsum patri
 suo assimilare
 volui, [606](#) nam et
 Apollo, qui ante
 ipsum in templo [607](#)
 stetit, absque barba
 iuvenis apparuit. Et
 sic ea que gessi
 non ex furto set
 honestate [608](#)
 processisse
 manifeste
 declaravi.'

And whan the wardeins weren war
 Of that here god despuiled was,
 Hem thoghte it was a wonder cas,
 How that a man for eny wele
 Durste in so holy place stele,⁶¹²
 And namely so gret a thing.⁶¹³
 This tale cam unto the king,
 And was thurgh spoken overal:
 7160 Bot forto knowe in special
 What maner man hath do the dede,
 Thei soghten help upon the nede
 And maden calculacioun,
 Wherof be demonstracioun
 The man was founde with the good.
 In juggement and whan he stood,
 The king hath axed of him thus:
 ‘Sey, thou unsely Lucius,
 Whi hast thou do this sacrilege?’
 7170* ‘Mi lord, if I the cause allegge,’
 Quod he ayein, ‘me thenketh this,
 That I have do nothing amis.
 Thre pointz ther ben whiche I have do,
 Wherof the ferste point stant so,
 That I the ryng have take aweie.
 As unto that this wole I seie:⁶¹⁴
 Whan I the god behield aboute,
 I sih how he his hond strawhte oute
 And profred me the ryng to yive;
 7180 And I, which wolde gladly live
 Out of poverté of his largesse,⁶¹⁵
 It underfing, so that I gesse,
 As therof I am noght to wyte.⁶¹⁶
 And overmore I wol me quite,
 Of gold that I the mantell tok:
 Gold in his kinde, as seith the bok,
 Is hevy bothe and cold also;

And for that it was hevy so,
Me thoghte it was no garnement
7190~~U~~nto the god convenient,
To clothen him the somer tide;
I thoghte upon that other side
How gold is cold, and such a cloth
Be resoun oghte to be loth
In wynter time for the chele.
And thus thenkende thoghtes fele,
As I myn yhe aboute caste,
His large beard thanne ate laste
I syh, and thoghte anon therfore
7200~~H~~ow that his fader him before,
Which stod upon the same place,
Was beerdles with a yongly face:
And in such wise as ye have herd
I tok away the Sones berd, [617](#)
For that his fader hadde non,
To make hem liche, and hier upon
I axe forto ben excused.'

Lo thus, wher Sacrilege is used,
A man can feigne his conscience;
7210~~A~~nd riht upon such evidence
In loves cause, &c. (*as 7033 ff.*)

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In loves cause if I schal trete,
Ther ben of suche smale and grete:
If thei no leisir fynden elles,
Thei wol noght wonden for the belles,
Ne thogh thei sen the Prest at masse;
That wol thei leten overpasse.
If that thei finde here love there,
7040Thei stonde and tellen in hire Ere,

[SACRILEGE OF
LOVERS.]

And axe of god non other grace,
Whyl thei ben in that holi place;
Bot er thei gon som advantage
Ther wol thei have, and som pilage
Of goodli word or of beheste,
Or elles thei take ate leste
Out of hir hand or ring or glove,
So nyh the weder thei wol love,⁶¹⁸
As who seith sche schal noght foryete,
7050 Nou I this tokne of hire have gete:
Thus halwe thei the hihe feste.
Such thefte mai no cherche areste,
For al is leveful that hem liketh,⁶¹⁹
To whom that elles it misliketh.
And ek riht in the selve kinde
In grete Cites men mai finde
This lusti folk, that make it gay,
And waite upon the haliday:
In cherches and in Menstres eke
7060 Thei gon the wommen forto seke,
And wher that such on goth aboute,
Tofore the faireste of the route,
Wher as thei sitten alle arewe,
Ther wol he most his bodi schewe,
His croket kembd and theron set
A Nouche with a chapelet,
Or elles on of grene leves,
Which late com out of the greves,
Al for he scholde seme freissh.
7070 And thus he loketh on the fleissh,⁶²⁰
Riht as an hauk which hath a sihte
(7250) Upon the foul, ther he schal lihte;
And as he were of faierie,
He scheweth him tofore here yhe
In holi place wher thei sitte,
Al forto make here hertes flitte.
His yhe nawher wole abyde,

Bot loke and prie on every syde⁶²¹
 On hire and hire, as him best lyketh:
 7080 And otherwhile among he syketh;
 Thenkth on of hem, 'That was for me,'
 And so ther thenken tuo or thre,
 And yit he loveth non of alle,
 Bot wher as evere his chance falle.
 And natheles to seie a soth,
 The cause why that he so doth
 Is forto stele an herte or tuo,
 Out of the cherche er that he go:
 And as I seide it hier above,
 7090 Al is that Sacrilege of love;
 For wel mai be he stelth away
 That he nevere after yelde may.
 Tell me forthi, my Sone, anon,
 Hast thou do Sacrilege, or non,⁶²²
 As I have said in this manere?
 Mi fader, as of this matiere
 I wole you tellen redely
 What I have do; bot trewely
 I mai excuse min entente,
 7100 That nevere I yit to cherche wente
 In such manere as ye me schryve,
 For no womman that is on lyve.
 The cause why I have it laft
 Mai be for I unto that craft
 Am nothing able so to stele,
 Thogh ther be wommen noght so fele.⁶²³
 Bot yit wol I noght seie this,
 Whan I am ther mi ladi is,
 In whom lith holly mi querele,
 7110 And sche to cherche or to chapele
 Wol go to matins or to messe,—
 That time I waite wel and gesse,
 To cherche I come and there I stonde,
 And thogh I take a bok on honde,

Confessio Amantis.

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Mi contenance is on the bok,
 Bot toward hire is al my lok;
 And if so falle that I preie
 Unto mi god, and somewhat seie
 Of Paternoster or of Crede, [624](#)
 7120 Al is for that I wolde spede,
 So that mi bede in holi cherche
 (7300*) her mihte som miracle werche
 Mi ladi herte forto chaunge,
 Which evere hath be to me so strange. [625](#)
 So that al mi devocion
 And al mi contemplacion
 With al min herte and mi corage
 Is only set on hire ymage;
 And evere I waite upon the tyde.
 7130 If sche loke eny thing asyde,
 That I me mai of hire avise, [626](#)
 Anon I am with covoitise
 So smite, that me were lief
 To ben in holi cherche a thief;
 Bot noght to stele a vestement,
 For that is nothing mi talent,
 Bot I wold stele, if that I mihte, [627](#)
 A glad word or a goodly syhte;
 And evere mi service I profre,
 7140 And namly whan sche wol gon offre,
 For thanne I lede hire, if I may,
 For somewhat wolde I stele away.
 Whan I beclippe hire on the wast,
 Yit ate leste I stele a tast,
 And otherwhile 'grant mercy'
 Sche seith, and so winne I therby
 A lusti touch, a good word eke,
 Bot al the remenant to seke
 Is fro mi pourpos wonder ferr.
 7150 So mai I seie, as I seide er,
 In holy cherche if that I wowe,

My conscience it wolde allowe,⁶²⁸
 Be so that up amendement
 I mihte gete assignement
 Wher forto spede in other place:
 Such Sacrilege I holde a grace.
 And thus, mi fader, soth to seie,
 In cherche riht as in the weie,
 If I mihte oght of love take,
 7160 Such hansell have I noght forsake.⁶²⁹
 Bot finali I me confesse,
 Ther is in me non holinesse,
 whil I hire se in eny stede;⁶³⁰
 And yit, for oght that evere I dede,
 No Sacrilege of hire I tok,
 Bot if it were of word or lok,⁶³¹
 Or elles if that I hir fredde,
 Whan I toward offringe hir ledde,
 Take therof what I take may,
 7170 For elles bere I noght away:
 For thogh I wolde oght elles have,
 (7350*) Alle othre thinges ben so save⁶³²
 And kept with such a privilege,
 That I mai do no Sacrilege.
 God wot mi wille natheles,
 Thogh I mot nedes kepe pes
 And malgre myn so let it passe,⁶³³
 Mi will therto is noght the lasse,
 If I mihte other wise aweie.
 7180 Forthi, mi fader, I you preie,
 Tell what you thenketh therupon,⁶³⁴
 If I therof have gult or non.
 Thi will, mi Sone, is forto blame,
 The remenant is bot a game,
 That I have herd the telle as yit.
 Bot tak this lore into thi wit,
 That alle thing hath time and stede,

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Confessor.

The cherche serveth for the bede,
The chambre is of an other speche.
7190 Bot if thou wistest of the wreche,
Hou Sacrilege it hath aboght,
Thou woldest betre ben bethoght;
And for thou schalt the more amende,
A tale I wole on the despende. [635](#)

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To alle men, as who seith, knowe
It is, and in the world thurgh blowe,
Hou that of Troie Lamedon
To Hercules and to Jasoun,
Whan toward Colchos out of Grece
7200 Be See sailende upon a piece
Of lond of Troie reste preide,—
Bot he hem wrathfulli congeide:
And for thei founde him so vilein,
Whan thei come into Grece ayein,
With pouer that thei gete myhte
Towardes Troie thei hem dyhte,
And ther thei token such vengeance,
Wherof stant yit the remembrance; [639](#)
For thei destruide king and al,
7210 And leften bot the brente wal.
The Grecs of Troiens many slowe
And prisoners thei toke ynowe,
Among the whiche ther was on,
The kinges doughter Lamedon,
Esiona, that faire thing, [640](#)
Which unto Thelamon the king
Be Hercules and be thassent
Of al the hole parlement
Was at his wille yove and granted.
7220 And thus hath Grece Troie danted,
And hom thei torne in such manere:
(7400) Bot after this nou schalt thou hier
The cause why this tale I telle, [641](#)

[TALE OF PARIS
AND HELEN.]

Hic in amoris
causa super istius
vicii articulo ponit
exemplum. Et
narrat, pro eo quod
Paris Priami Regis
filius Helenam
Menelai vxorem in
quadam Grece
insula a templo
Veneris Sacrilegus
abduxit, illa Troie
famosissima [636](#)
obsidio per
vniuersi [637](#) orbis
climata divulgata
precipue
causabatur. [638](#) Ita
quod huiusmodi
Sacrilegium non
solum ad ipsius
regis Priami
omniumque
suorum interitum,
set eciam ad
perpetuam vrbis
desolacionem
vindictę fomitem
ministrabat.

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Upon the chances that befelle.
 King Lamedon, which deide thus,
 He hadde a Sone, on Priamus,
 Which was noght thilke time at hom:
 Bot whan he herde of this, he com,
 And fond hou the Cite was falle,
 7230 Which he began anon to walle
 And made ther a cite newe,
 That thei whiche othre londes knewe
 Tho seiden, that of lym and Ston
 In al the world so fair was non.
 And on that o side of the toun
 The king let maken Ylioun,⁶⁴²
 That hihe Tour, that stronge place,
 Which was adrad of no manace
 Of quarel nor of non engin;
 7240 And thogh men wolde make a Myn,
 No mannes craft it mihte aproche,
 For it was sett upon a roche.
 The walles of the toun aboute,
 Hem stod of al the world no doute,
 And after the proporcion
 Sex gates weren of the toun
 Of such a forme, of such entaile,
 That hem to se was gret mervaile:
 The diches weren brode and depe,
 7250 A fewe men it mihte kepe
 From al the world, as semeth tho,
 Bot if the goddes weren fo.
 Gret presse unto that cite drouh,
 So that ther was of poeple ynouh,
 Of Burgeis that therinne duellen;
 Ther mai no mannes tunge tellen
 Hou that cite was riche of good.⁶⁴³
 Whan al was mad and al wel stod,
 King Priamus tho him bethoghte
 7260 What thei of Grece whilom wroghte,

And what was of her swerd devoured,
 And hou his Soster deshonoured
 With Thelamon away was lad:
 And so thenkende he wax unglad,⁶⁴⁴
 And sette anon a parlement,
 To which the lordes were assent.
 In many a wise ther was spoke,
 Hou that thei mihten ben awroke,
 Bot ate laste natheles
 7270Thei seiden alle, 'Acord and pes.'
 To setten either part in reste⁶⁴⁵
 (7450*)hoghte hem thanne for the beste
 With resonable amendement;
 And thus was Anthenor forth sent⁶⁴⁶
 To axe Esionam ayein⁶⁴⁷
 And witen what thei wolden sein.
 So passeth he the See be barge⁶⁴⁸
 To Grece forto seie his charge,
 The which he seide redely
 7280Unto the lordes by and by:
 Bot where he spak in Grece aboute,
 He herde noght bot wordes stoute,
 And nameliche of Thelamon;
 The maiden wolde he noght forgon,
 He seide, for no maner thing,
 And bad him gon hom to his king,
 For there gat he non amende
 For oght he couthe do or sende.
 This Anthenor ayein goth hom
 7290Unto his king, and whan he com,
 He tolde in Grece of that he herde,
 And hou that Thelamon ansuerde,
 And hou thei were at here above,
 That thei wol nouthen pes ne love,
 Bot every man schal don his beste.
 Bot for men sein that nyht hath reste,

The king bethoghte him al that nyht, [649](#)
 And erli, whan the dai was lyht,
 He tok conseil of this matiere;
 7300 And thei acorde in this manere,
 That he withouten eny lette
 A certein time scholde sette
 Of Parlement to ben avised: [650](#)
 And in the wise it was devised,
 Of parlement he sette a day,
 And that was in the Monthe of Maii.
 This Priamus hadde in his yhte
 A wif, and Hecuba sche hyhte,
 Be whom that time ek hadde he
 7310 Of Sones fyve, and douhtres thre
 Besiden hem, and thritty mo, [651](#)
 And weren knyhtes alle tho,
 Bot noght upon his wif begete,
 Bot elles where he myhte hem gete
 Of wommen whiche he hadde knowe;
 Such was the world at thilke throwe:
 So that he was of children riche,
 As therof was noman his liche. [652](#)
 Of Parlement the dai was come,
 7320 Ther ben the lordes alle and some;
 Tho was pronounced and pourposed,
 (7500) And al the cause hem was desclosed,
 Hou Anthenor in Grece ferde.
 Thei seten alle stille and herde,
 And tho spak every man aboute:
 Ther was alegged many a doute,
 And many a proud word spoke also; [653](#)
 Bot for the moste part as tho [654](#)
 Thei wisten noght what was the beste,
 7330 Or forto werre or forto reste.
 Bot he that was withoute fere,
 Hector, among the lordes there

His tale tolde in such a wise,
 And seide, 'Lordes, ye ben wise,
 Ye knowen this als wel as I,
 Above all othre most worthi⁶⁵⁵
 Stant nou in Grece the manhode
 Of worthinesse and of knihthode;
 For who so wole it wel agrope,
 7340 To hem belongeth al Europe,
 Which is the thridde parti evene
 Of al the world under the hevene;
 And we be bot of folk a fewe.
 So were it reson forto schewe⁶⁵⁶
 The peril, er we falle thrinne:
 Betre is to leve, than beginne
 Thing which as mai noght ben achieved;
 He is noght wys that fint him grieved,
 And doth so that his grief be more;
 7350 For who that loketh al tofore
 And wol noght se what is behinde,
 He mai fulofte hise harmes finde:
 Wicke is to stryve and have the worse.
 We have encheson forto corse,
 This wot I wel, and forto hate
 The Greks; bot er that we debate
 With hem that ben of such a myht,
 It is ful good that every wiht
 Be of himself riht wel bethoght.
 7360 Bot as for me this seie I noght;
 For while that mi lif wol stonde,
 If that ye taken werre on honde,
 Falle it to beste or to the werste,⁶⁵⁷
 I schal miselven be the ferste
 To grieven hem, what evere I may.
 I wol noght ones seie nay
 To thing which that youre conseil demeth,
 For unto me wel more it quemeth
 The werre certes than the pes;

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7370 Bot this I seie natheles,
As me belongeth forto seie.
(7550*) You schape ye the beste weie.’
Whan Hector hath seid his avis,
Next after him tho spak Paris,
Which was his brother, and alleide
What him best thoghte, and thus he seide:
‘Strong thing it is to soffre wrong,
And suffre schame is more strong,
Bot we have suffred bothe tuo;

7380 And for al that yit have we do
What so we mihte to reforme
The pes, whan we in such a forme⁶⁵⁸
Sente Anthenor, as ye wel knowe.
And thei here grete wordes blowe
Upon her wrongful dedes eke;
And who that wole himself noght meke
To pes, and list no reson take,
Men sein reson him wol forsake:⁶⁵⁹
For in the multitude of men

7390 Is noght the strengthe, for with ten
It hath be sen in trew querele⁶⁶⁰
Ayein an hundred false dele,
And had the betre of goddes grace.
This hath befalle in many place;
And if it like unto you alle,
I wole assaie, hou so it falle,
Oure enemis if I mai grieve;
For I have cawht a gret believe
Upon a point I wol declare.

7400 This ender day, as I gan fare⁶⁶¹
To hunte unto the grete hert,
Which was tofore myn houndes stert,
And every man went on his syde⁶⁶²
Him to poursuie, and I to ryde
Began the chace, and soth to seie,⁶⁶³

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Withinne a while out of mi weie
 I rod, and nyste where I was.
 And slep me cauhte, and on the gras
 Beside a welle I lay me down
 7410 To slepe, and in a visioun [664](#)
 To me the god Mercurie cam;
 Goddesses thre with him he nam,
 Minerve, Venus and Juno,
 And in his hond an Appel tho
 He hield of gold with lettres write:
 And this he dede me to wite,
 Hou that thei putt hem upon me, [665](#)
 That to the faireste of hem thre
 Of gold that Appel scholde I yive. [666](#)
 7420 With ech of hem tho was I schrive,
 And echon faire me behihte;
 (7600) Bot Venus seide, if that sche mihte
 That Appel of mi yifte gete,
 Sche wolde it neveremor foryete,
 And seide hou that in Grece lond
 Sche wolde bringe unto myn hond
 Of al this Erthe the faireste;
 So that me thoghte it for the beste,
 To hire and yaf that Appel tho.
 7430 Thus hope I wel, if that I go,
 That sche for me wol so ordeine,
 That thei matiere forto pleigne
 Schul have, er that I come ayein.
 Nou have ye herd that I wol sein:
 Sey ye what stant in youre avis.'
 And every man tho seide his,
 And sundri causes thei recorde,
 Bot ate laste thei acorde
 That Paris schal to Grece wende,
 7440 And thus the parlement tok ende.
 Cassandra, whan sche herde of this, [667](#)
 The which to Paris Soster is,

Anon sche gan to wepe and weile,
 And seide, 'Allas, what mai ous eile?
 Fortune with hire blinde whiel
 Ne wol noght lete ous stonde wel:
 For this I dar wel undertake,
 That if Paris his weie take,
 As it is seid that he schal do,
 7450 We ben for evere thanne undo.'
 This, which Cassandre thanne hihte,
 In al the world as it berth sihte,
 In bokes as men finde write,
 Is that Sibille of whom ye wite,
 That alle men yit clepen sage.
 Whan that sche wiste of this viage,
 Hou Paris schal to Grece fare,
 No womman mihte worse fare
 Ne sorwe more than sche dede;
 7460 And riht so in the same stede
 Ferde Helenus, which was hir brother,
 Of prophecie and such an other:
 And al was holde bot a jape,
 So that the pourpos which was schape,
 Or were hem lief or were hem loth,⁶⁶⁸
 Was holde, and into Grece goth
 This Paris with his retenance.
 And as it fell upon his chance,
 Of Grece he londeth in an yle,
 7470 And him was told the same whyle⁶⁶⁹
 Of folk which he began to freyne,
 (7650) Who was in thyle queene Heleyne,
 And ek of contres there aboute
 Of ladis many a lusti route,
 With mochel worthi poeple also.
 And why thei comen theder tho,
 The cause stod in such a wise,—
 For worschipe and for sacrifise
 That thei to Venus wolden make,

7480As thei tofore hadde undertake,
Some of good will, some of beheste,
For thanne was hire hihe feste
Withinne a temple which was there.

Whan Paris wiste what thei were,
Anon he schop his ordinance
To gon and don his obeissance
To Venus on hire holi day,
And dede upon his beste aray.
With gret richeshe he him behongeth,

7490As it to such a lord belongeth,
He was noght armed natheles,
Bot as it were in lond of pes,
And thus he goth forth out of Schipe
And takth with him his felaschipe:
In such manere as I you seie
Unto the temple he hield his weie.

Tydinge, which goth overal
To grete and smale, forth withal
Com to the queenes Ere and tolde

7500Hou Paris com, and that he wolde
Do sacrifice to Venus:
And whan sche herde telle thus,
She thoghte, hou that it evere be,
That sche wole him abyde and se.

Forth comth Paris with glad visage
Into the temple on pelrinage,
Wher unto Venus the goddesse
He yifh and offreth gret richeshe,
And preith hir that he preie wolde.

7510And thanne aside he gan beholde,
And sih wher that this ladi stod;
And he forth in his freisshe mod
Goth ther sche was and made hir chiere,
As he wel couthe in his manere,
That of his wordes such plesance
Sche tok, that al hire aqueintance,

Als ferforth as the herte lay,
 He stal er that he wente away.
 So goth he forth and tok his leve,
 7520 And thoghte, anon as it was eve,
 He wolde don his Sacrilege,
 (7700th) That many a man it scholde abegge.
 Whan he to Schipe ayein was come,
 To him he hath his conseil nome,
 And al devised the matiere
 In such a wise as thou schalt hiere.
 Withinne nyht al prively
 His men he warneth by and by,
 That thei be redy armed sone
 7530 For certain thing which was to done:
 And thei anon ben redi alle,
 And ech on other gan to calle,
 And went hem out upon the stronde ⁶⁷²
 And tok a pourpos ther alonde
 Of what thing that thei wolden do, ⁶⁷³
 Toward the temple and forth thei go.
 So fell it, of devocion
 Heleine in contemplacion
 With many an other worthi wiht
 7540 Was in the temple and wok al nyht,
 To bidde and preie unto thymage ⁶⁷⁴
 Of Venus, as was thanne usage;
 So that Paris riht as him liste
 Into the temple, er thei it wiste, ⁶⁷⁵
 Com with his men al sodeinly,
 And alle at ones sette ascry
 In hem whiche in the temple were,
 For tho was mochel poeple there;
 Bot of defense was no bote,
 7550 So soffren thei that soffre mote.
 Paris unto the queene wente,
 And hire in bothe hise armes hente
 With him and with his felaschipe,

P. ii.
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P. ii.
 387

And forth thei bere hire unto Schipe.⁶⁷⁶
 Up goth the Seil and forth thei wente,
 And such a wynd fortune hem sente,
 Til thei the havene of Troie cauhte;
 Where out of Schipe anon thei strauhte
 And gon hem forth toward the toun,
 7560 The which cam with processioun
 Ayein Paris to sen his preie.
 And every man began to seie
 To Paris and his felaschipe
 Al that thei couthen of worschipe;
 Was non so litel man in Troie,
 That he ne made merthe and joie
 Of that Paris hath wonne Heleine.
 Bot al that merthe is sorwe and peine
 To Helenus and to Cassaundre;
 7570 For thei it token schame and sklaundre⁶⁷⁷
 And lost of al the comun grace,
 (7750) That Paris out of holi place
 Be Stelthe hath take a mannes wif,
 Wherof that he schal lese his lif
 And many a worthi man therto,
 And al the Cite be fordo,
 Which nevere schal be mad ayein.
 And so it fell, riht as thei sein,
 The Sacrilege which he wroghte
 7580 Was cause why the Gregois soughte
 Unto the toun and it beleie,
 And wolden nevere parte aweie,
 Til what be sleihte and what be strengthe
 Thei hadde it wonne in brede and lengthe,
 And brent and slayn that was withinne.
 Now se, mi Sone, which a sinne
 Is Sacrilege in holy stede:
 Be war therfore and bidd thi bede,
 And do nothing in holy cherche,
 7590 Bot that thou miht be reson werche.

And ek tak hiede of Achilles,
Whan he unto his love ches
Polixena, that was also
In holi temple of Appollo,
Which was the cause why he dyde
And al his lust was leyd asyde.

And Troilus upon Criseide
Also his ferste love leide
In holi place, and hou it ferde,
7600As who seith, al the world it herde;⁶⁷⁸
Forsake he was for Diomedede,
Such was of love his laste mede.

Forthi, mi Sone, I wolde rede,
Be this ensample as thou myht rede,⁶⁷⁹
Sech elles, wher thou wolt, thi grace,
And war the wel in holi place
What thou to love do or speke,
In aunter if it so be wreke
As thou hast herd me told before.

7610And tak good hiede also therfore
Upon what forme, of Avarice⁶⁸⁰
Mor than of eny other vice,
I have divided in parties
The branches, whiche of compainies
Thurghout the world in general
Ben nou the leders overal,
Of Covoitise and of Perjure,
Of fals brocage and of Usure,
Of Skarsnesse and Unkindeschipe,⁶⁸¹

7620Which nevere drouh to felaschipe,
Of Robberie and privi Stelthe,⁶⁸²
(7800~~W~~)hich don is for the worldes welthe,
Of Ravine and of Sacrilege,
Which makth the conscience agregge;
Although it mai richesse atteigne,
It floureth, bot it schal noght greine

Confessor.

[DIVISIONS OF
AVARICE.]

P. ii.
389

Unto the fruit of rihtwisnesse.
 Bot who that wolde do largesse
 Upon the reule as it is yive,
 7630 So myhte a man in trouthe live⁶⁸³
 Toward his god, and ek also
 Toward the world, for bothe tuo
 Largesse awaiteth as belongeth,
 To neither part that he ne wrongeth;⁶⁸⁴
 He kepeth himself, he kepeth his frendes,
 So stant he sauf to bothe hise endes,
 That he excedeth no mesure,
 So wel he can himself mesure:
 Wherof, mi Sone, thou schalt wite,
 7640 So as the Philosophre hath write.

xiii. *Prodeus et parcus duo sunt extrema,* [PRODICALITY AND
*que largus*⁶⁸⁵ LARGESS.]
Est horum medius, plebis in ore bonus. **P. ii.**
 390

Betwen the tuo extremities
 Of vice stant the propretes
 Of vertu, and to prove it so
 Tak Avarice and tak also
 The vice of Prodegalite;
 Betwen hem Liberalite,
 Which is the vertu of Largesse,
 Stant and governeth his noblesse.
 For tho tuo vices in discord
 7650 Stonde evere, as I finde of record;
 So that betwen here tuo debat
 Largesse reuleth his estat.
 For in such wise as Avarice,
 As I tofore have told the vice,
 Thurgh streit holdinge and thurgh skarsnesse
 Stant in contraire to Largesse,
 Riht so stant Prodegalite
 Revers, bot noght in such degre.

Nota hic de virtute
 Largitatis, que ad
 oppositum
 Avaricie inter duo
 extrema, videlicet
 Parcimoniam et
 Prodegalitatem,
 specialiter
 consistit.

For so as Avarice spareth,
 7660 And forto kepe his tresor careth,
 That othre al his oghne and more
 Ayein the wise mannes lore
 Yifthe and despendeth hiere and there,
 So that him reccheth nevere where.
 While he mai borwe, he wol despende,
 Til ate laste he seith, 'I wende';
 Bot that is spoken al to late,
 For thanne is poverte ate gate
 And takth him evene be the slieve,
 7670 For erst wol he no wisdom lieve.
 And riht as Avarice is Sinne,
 (7850) That wolde his tresor kepe and winne,
 Riht so is Prodegalite:
 Bot of Largesse in his degre,
 Which evene stant between the tuo,
 The hihe god and man also
 The vertu ech of hem commendeth.
 For he himselven ferst amendeth,
 That overal his name spredeth,
 7680 And to alle othre, where it nedeth,
 He yifthe his good in such a wise,
 That he makth many a man arise,
 Which elles scholde falle lowe.
 Largesse mai noght ben unknowe;
 For what lond that he regneth inne,
 It mai noght faile forto winne
 Thurgh his decerte love and grace,
 Wher it schal faile in other place.

P. ii.
 391

And thus between tomoche and lyte⁶⁸⁶
 7690 Largesse, which is noght to wyte,
 Halt evere forth the middel weie:
 Bot who that torne wole aweie
 Fro that to Prodegalite,
 Anon he lest the proprete⁶⁸⁷
 Of vertu and goth to the vice;

For in such wise as Avarice
Lest for scarsnesse his goode name,
Riht so that other is to blame,
Which thurgh his wast mesure exceedeth,
7700 For noman wot what harm that bredeth. [688](#)

P. ii.
392

Bot mochel joie ther betydeth, [689](#)
Wher that largesse an herte guydeth:
For his mesure is so governed,
That he to bothe partz is lerned,
To god and to the world also,
He doth reson to bothe tuo.
The povere folk of his almesse
Relieved ben in the destresse
Of thurst, of hunger and of cold;
7710 The yifte of him was nevere sold,
Bot frely yive, and natheles
The myhti god of his encress
Rewardeth him of double grace;
The hevene he doth him to purchace
And yifh him ek the worldes good:
And thus the Cote for the hod
Largesse takth, and yit no Sinne
He doth, hou so that evere he winne.

What man hath hors men yive him
hors,

Lucas. Omni
habenti dabitur.

7720 And who non hath of him no fors,
For he mai thanne on fote go;
The world hath evere stonde so.
Bot forto loken of the tweie,
A man to go the siker weie,
Betre is to yive than to take:
With yifte a man mai frendes make,
Bot who that takth or gret or smal,
He takth a charge forth withal,
And stant noght fre til it be quit.

Beacius est dare
quam accipere. [690](#)

P. ii.
393

7730 So forto deme in mannes wit,
It helpeth more a man to have

His oghne good, than forto crave
Of othre men and make him bounde,
Wher elles he mai stonde unbounde.

Senec conseileth in this wise,
And seith, 'Bot if thi good suffise
Unto the liking of thi wille,
Withdrawh thi lust and hold the stille,
And be to thi good sufficient.'

Seneca. Si res tue
tibi non sufficient,
fac vt rebus tuis
sufficias.

7740 For that thing is appourtenant
To trouthe and causeth to be fre
After the reule of charite,
Which first beginneth of himselfe.
For if thou richest othre twelve,
Wherof thou schalt thiself be povere,
I not what thonk thou miht recovere.

Apostolus.⁶⁹¹
Ordinata caritas
incipit a seipsa.

Whil that a man hath good to yive,
With grete routes he mai live
And hath his frendes overal,

7750 And everich of him telle schal.

Therwhile he hath his fulle packe,⁶⁹²
Thei seie, 'A good felawe is Jacke';
Bot whanne it faileth ate laste,
Anon his pris thei overcaste,
For thanne is ther non other lawe
Bot, 'Jacke was a good felawe.'
Whan thei him povere and nedy se,
Thei lete him passe and farwel he;
Al that he wende of compainie

P. ii.
394

7760 Is thanne torned to folie.

Bot nou to speke in other kinde
Of love, a man mai suche finde,
That wher thei come in every route
Thei caste and waste her love aboute,
Til al here time is overgon,
And thanne have thei love non.⁶⁹³

[PRODIGALITY OF
LOVERS.]

For who that loveth overal,
(7900*) is no reson that he schal

Of love have eny proprete.
7770Forthi, mi Sone, avise thee
If thou of love hast be to large,
For such a man is noght to charge:
And if it so be that thou hast
Despended al thi time in wast
And set thi love in sondri place,
Though thou the substance of thi grace
Lese ate laste, it is no wonder;
For he that put himselven under,
As who seith, comun overal,

7780He lest the love special
Of eny on, if sche be wys;
For love schal noght bere his pris
Be reson, whanne it passeth on.
So have I sen ful many on,⁶⁹⁴
That were of love wel at ese,
Whiche after felle in gret desese
Thurgh wast of love, that thei spent
In sondri places wher thei wente.

P. ii.
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Riht so, mi Sone, I axe of thee

Confessor.

7790If thou with Prodegalite
Hast hier and ther thi love wasted.
Mi fader, nay; bot I have tasted
In many a place as I have go,
And yit love I nevere on of tho,
Bot forto drive forth the dai.
For lieveth wel, myn herte is ay
Withoute mo for everemore
Al upon on, for I nomore
Desire bot hire love al one:

Amans.

7800So make I many a prive mone,
For wel I fiele I have despended
Mi longe love and noght amended
Mi sped, for oght I finde yit.
If this be wast to youre wit⁶⁹⁵
Of love, and Prodegalite,

Nou, goode fader, demeth ye:
Bot of o thing I wol me schryve,
That I schal for no love thryve,
Bot if himself me wol relieve.⁶⁹⁶

7810 Mi Sone, that I mai wel lieve:

Confessor.

And natheles me semeth so,
For oght that thou hast yit misdo
Of time which thou hast despended,
It mai with grace ben amended.
For thing which mai be worth the cost
Per chaunce is nouthur wast ne lost;
For what thing stant on aventure,⁶⁹⁷

P. ii.
396

(7950) That can no worldes creature

Telle in certein hou it schal wende,⁶⁹⁸

7820 Til he therof mai sen an ende.

So that I not as yit therfore
If thou, mi Sone, hast wonne or lore:
For ofte time, as it is sene,⁶⁹⁹

Whan Somer hath lost al his grene
And is with Wynter wast and bare,
That him is left nothing to spare,
Al is recovered in a throwe;

The colde wyndes overblowe,
And stille be the scharpe schoures,⁷⁰⁰

7830 And soudeinliche ayein his floures

The Somer hapneth and is riche:
And so per cas thi graces liche,
Mi Sone, thogh thou be nou povere
Of love, yit thou miht recovere.

Mi fader, certes grant merci:

Amans.

Ye have me tawht so redeli,
That evere whil I live schal
The betre I mai be war withal
Of thing which ye have seid er this.

7840 Bot overmore hou that it is,⁷⁰¹

Toward mi schrifte as it belongeth,

To wite of othre pointz me longeth;
Wherof that ye me wolden teche
With al myn herte I you beseche.

Explicit Liber Quintus.

FOOTNOTES:

- [1](#) *Latin verses* iii. 4 tibi AM ... B₂, AdBT
- [2](#) 1973 his AM ... B₂
- [3](#) 1976 *margin* cupiditatis RCLB₂
- [4](#) 1978 þauantage (þe auantage) E ... B₂, W þe vantages MH₁XG
- [5](#) 1979 that *om.* RCLB₂
- [6](#) 1981 That on *om.* B And that oon H₁ hald S, F halt A, B haltd J
- [7](#) 1988 tofare S, F
- [8](#) 1992 while] Mile AM
- [9](#) 2002 he his wille wolde AMH₁E ... B₂
- [10](#) 2020 ffor him E ... B₂
- [11](#) 2030 thou schalt it] as þou schalt BT
- [12](#) 2050 seeþ H₁XG seiþ AM
- [13](#) 2057 knyththod S knithod F knyththode AJ in] on E ... B₂ vp on Δ
- [14](#) 2059 non opre AJ, S, F non oper C, B
- [15](#) 2068 tho] þat E ... B₂
- [16](#) 2074 matier(e) to trete H₁L, AdBT, W
- [17](#) 2079 cophres AC, F cofres (coffres) J, SB
- [18](#) 2098 ech AJ, B eche F
- [19](#) 2108 beleft F
- [20](#) 2114 faste by A, F fasteby J, B
- [21](#) 2150 unto] it to BT to Δ
- [22](#) 2157 scholde (schuld &c.) M ... B₂, TΔ, W
- [23](#) 2162 And þus A ... B₂, W Al þis S ... Δ
- [24](#) 2177 a slepe B, F aslepe AJ
- [25](#) 2202 goldringes JE, S, F gold ringes A, B
- [26](#) 2208 Of þe comuns E ... B₂ (þo EC) Of þe bomeins (?) M Of Romayns W
- [27](#) 2226 the] his XCB₂, Ad
- [28](#) 2278 *margin* eorum *om.* AMH₁
- [29](#) 2288 and als so] anon als B and als (as) X, WH₃
- [30](#) 2291 þe cas S ... Δ
- [31](#) 2297 lich J, S, F liche A, B
- [32](#) 2328 vnauanced (vn auanced) 3e be E ... B₂
- [33](#) 2350 faute E ... B₂
- [34](#) 2352 his chois AM ... B₂, BT
- [35](#) 2357 be falle] byfalle A
- [36](#) 2405 *margin* sorte *om.* A ... B₂
- [37](#) 2411 He] And BT
- [38](#) 2412 man] a man AMH₁ men WH₃
- [39](#) 2417 seeþ B
- [40](#) 2433 he richesse (*om.* hath) E ... B₂ richesse he haþ Ad
- [41](#) 2453 ynowe] I trowe BT
- [42](#) 2465 Bot] So BT
- [43](#) 2477 Somon F
- [44](#) 2482 to] of BT
- [45](#) 2488 forsakeþ sche is b. BT forsaketh he shal be b. H₃
- [46](#) 2500 My fader G ... B₂

[47](#) 2508 that] þan (panne) XG, B þough E ... B₂
[48](#) 2513 al A, S, F alle J, B
[49](#) 2526 hem *om.* RCB₂ he L
[50](#) 2540 for J, FH₃ fro AM ... B₂, S ... Δ, WMagd.
[51](#) 2546 Yaf] Of E ... B₂
[52](#) 2550 to Hector BT
[53](#) 2551 recousse F
[54](#) 2554 also] as AM ... B₂, Ad, W
[55](#) 2563 he] I (y) BT
[56](#) 2564 his] hir X ... B₂, T
[57](#) 2571 some] of some A ... B₂, B
[58](#) 2573 protection(?) F
[59](#) 2574 and] of B
[60](#) 2579 þe gold is in her cofre AdBT her(e) gold is in her(e) E ... B₂ ther ... her
H₁
[61](#) 2587 schulde E ... B₂, W hire a pris BTΔ, F hir(e) apris (appris)
AJMXERLB₂, W here a pris C her(e) apris H₁, Ad, H₃
[62](#) 2591 of] to AJMXG vnto H₁E ... B₂ as Δ
[63](#) 2627 To take E ... B₂
[64](#) 2637 ensample AM ... B₂, W
[65](#) 2658 conseil upon] to conseil in AM ... B₂
[66](#) 2666 The B
[67](#) 2671 his maister E ... B₂
[68](#) 2682 the *om.* E ... B₂
[69](#) 2685 al the] alle (all) XE ... B₂
[70](#) 2690 hire] he hir(e) A ... B₂, S ... Δ
[71](#) 2694 f.

Whan þat sche was but of 3ong age
ffor good

E ... B₂ (was of L)

[72](#) 2696 And lucre E ... B₂
[73](#) 2714 Ther was RCLB₂, W Wher was E
[74](#) 2735 tolde J, S told A, B, F
[75](#) 2737 hath him preid] to him preide B with him p. T
[76](#) 2738 seyde BT
[77](#) 2740 bidde] didde AM
[78](#) 2752 a weie MC, T aweie AJ, B, F
[79](#) 2761 faste by AJ, B fasteby F
[80](#) 2771 nyh *om.* E ... B₂
[81](#) 2773 þis wise JR, BT, W
[82](#) 2776 The stiward BT Theward J seide no þing so B
[83](#) 2779 hire fette to] hire fette vnto C 3ou fette vnto B
[84](#) 2780 wold(e) H₁E ... B₂, W
[85](#) 2793 that *om.* AdB
[86](#) 2816 þe same E ... B₂, S ... Δ, WH₃
[87](#) 2836 outhur] oper (opir) M ... B₂, AdBT, W eiþer Δ
[88](#) 2856 wold(e) RCLB₂, W
[89](#) *Latin Verses* iv. 2 vere A ... CB₂ vero L verba W

[90](#) 4-7 *om.* B
[91](#) 7 *laudando* E ... B₂
[92](#) 2863 *margin* super illis] semper de illis E ... B₂
[93](#) 2863 *ferst* J, S, F *ferste* A
[94](#) 2866 *Periurie* J, F *Periure* AC, B
[95](#) 2867 *margin* tam cupiditatis EC *causa* cup. RLB₂ tam in cupiditate H₁
[96](#) 2868 be wroth] wroth AMH₁
[97](#) 2872 *hepe* J, SB, F *hipe* T *hupe* C *hup* A
[98](#) 2878 and] of BT in XE, W
[99](#) 2900 *line om.* B
[100](#) 2904 *suche* J, SB *such* A, F
[101](#) 2906 *hire* AR, F *procurous* B, F
[102](#) 2932 *saluely* S, F *sauely* AJ, B
[103](#) 2937 *euere* BT
[104](#) 2940 *bewreie* C, SB *be wreie* J, F *by wreie* A
[105](#) 2942 of] for BT on W
[106](#) 2951 *put* AJ, S, F (?) *putte* C, BT
[107](#) 2964 *as*] and BT, H₃
[108](#) 2966 *And* AM ... B₂, W
[109](#) 2967 *in*] of BT
[110](#) 2975 *this*] *his* AMH₁X
[111](#) 2996 *hir(e)* lady H₁ ... B₂, B, W (here l. G)
[112](#) 3004 *it*] *he* S ... Δ
[113](#) 3026 *he*] *sche* E, BT
[114](#) 3032 *hir* B *riht*] *ful* E ... B₂
[115](#) 3045 *put* AJ, S, F *putte* C, B
[116](#) 3046 *wip* þat *Dedamie* RCLB₂
[117](#) 3054 the *om.* AMGRLB₂ *alle* (maner of man) H₁
[118](#) 3058 *wolde* EL, BT
[119](#) 3090 *his* *werk* E ... B₂, Δ the *werke* W
[120](#) 3110 *burned* as þe *siluer* E ... B₂ b. was with s. W b. was of s. H₃
[121](#) 3119 *topseilcole* ACL, SAd, FH₃ *topseil cole* (coole) MH₁XGERB₂, BT *topseil cole* Δ to *pseilcole* J to *Pheilcole* W to *pleiseil cole* Δ
[122](#) 3145 *Al* (Alle) *lusti wommen* AMH₁ A *lusty womman* ECLB₂ Of *women* *lusti* Ad þat *route* E ... B₂
[123](#) 3152 *this*] þe BT
[124](#) 3158 a *contre*] þe *contre* BTΔ
[125](#) 3169 the *om.* B
[126](#) 3192 in a *Cronique* AMH₁RCLB₂, AdΔ, H₃
[127](#) 3197 *thei*] *he* X, BT
[128](#) 3209 *whos*] *which* AMH₁XG
[129](#) 3210 *now* a day X, B, WH₃
[130](#) 3217 *Wher*] þer BT
[131](#) 3225 *Periurie* J, B, F *Periure* AC
[132](#) 3237 *hertes* XL, S ... Δ
[133](#) 3241 *vnto* B of T
[134](#) 3246 *Who* þat *wol* *rede* it þer *may* *wite* E ... B₂
[135](#) 3261 *margin* *illam senectam* E ... B₂, BT *illa senecta* MH₁
[136](#) 3281 þerto *what* þing A ... B₂
[137](#) 3290 *that*] þis B

[138](#) 3295 was ful AMH₁XG
[139](#) 3300 tok (took) AJ, SB, F toke C, Ad, H₃ (token leue H₁)
[140](#) 3304 have mad] to make BT
[141](#) 3306 But (Bot) of his lond E ... B₂
[142](#) 3311 this] þe B þese X
[143](#) 3311 f. gregeis (Gregeis): curteis J, S, F Gregois (gregois): curtois
(courtoys) AC, B
[144](#) 3321 which þanne (þan) was þe k. E ... B₂ which was the k. H₁, W which
was þer k. X
[145](#) 3340 tho] þe AM ... B₂
[146](#) 3365 thes] þis MXGEC
[147](#) 3376 speke(n) AM ... B₂, B, W
[148](#) 3393 made AJ, B mad S, F
[149](#) 3422 rise RCLB₂, T, W
[150](#) 3437 þe same day XE ... B₂, BTΔ
[151](#) 3440 he *om.* E ... B₂
[152](#) 3465 lost is l. AYEC, S
[153](#) 3472 And nought þer of haþ fro him hid E ... B₂ ben wel MH₁X
[154](#) 3481 aschamed A, SB a schamed J, F
[155](#) 3482 hire tale AJMXE
[156](#) 3484 sette BT
[157](#) 3490 departe AMXG
[158](#) 3517 the] þo ERC, SBT
[159](#) 3533 dethes] hasty E ... B₂
[160](#) 3534 leid] brought B
[161](#) 3545 and] of BT
[162](#) 3582 name RCLB₂, T which AJ, S, F whiche B
[163](#) 3599 enoynt J, S, F anoynt AC, B So 3601
[164](#) 3619 such(e) wise XGE, B
[165](#) 3647 Of swoune RCLB₂, BT Inne swone W uppe nam] vp þo nam E ... B₂
vpon name H₁
[166](#) 3665 he *om.* E ... B₂, BT, W
[167](#) 3668 of hem CL on him W
[168](#) 3669 vnder ERL, BT, H₃ vndorne X vndur CB₂, W
[169](#) 3671 abreide] he breide E ... B₂, BT, H₃
[170](#) 3678 was wonder wo] þan was ful wo YE ... B₂, BTΔ
[171](#) 3688 ore on] oore in RLB₂, Δ sore in EC, BT (And forþ *with* all his wey he
fongeþ X)
[172](#) 3691 set AJ, S, F sette C, B
[173](#) 3705 ne] and BT, W
[174](#) 3706 þe serpent XB₂, BT, W
[175](#) 3720 his plough YE ... B₂, BT the plogh W
[176](#) 3742 whan (when) AJC, B whanne F
[177](#) 3744 a (ha) lord al is y wonne (al is wonne) YE ... B₂, BTΔ ha lord al now is
w. MH₁XG
[178](#) 3747 on londe E ... B₂, BTΔ, W
[179](#) 3751 he *om.* AM
[180](#) 3765 cried (criede) RCLB₂, Δ
[181](#) 3772 to talen] talen B of talen M of tales H₁ to talkan W
[182](#) 3791 as tho] also AM ... B₂, BT

[183](#) 3796 sche] he H₁, BT
[184](#) 3798 al *om.* AMH₁, H₃W
[185](#) 3814 the] þo EC, B
[186](#) 3822 mad AJ, S, F made C, B
[187](#) 3823 seide ... seide AC, B seid ... seide S, F seid ... seid J
[188](#) 3847 of *om.* E ... B₂, BT
[189](#) 3851 ffor if it be E ... B₂, BT, But if hit be W
[190](#) 3879 slepte] slep (sleep) YE, B
[191](#) 3883 him AH₁XR
[192](#) 3888 in compaignie AM ... B₂, BT
[193](#) 3914 wolde (wold) M ... B₂, BTΔ, WH₃
[194](#) 3956 telle a gret partie B, W tellen it a parti Δ
[195](#) 3960 it wiste] wiste CLB₂, BTΔ ne wist(e) MH₁X
[196](#) 3962 in euery side E ... B₂, BT
[197](#) 3964 Hir heed BT
[198](#) 3966 and on] vpon BT
[199](#) 3975 dreechinge honde J drenching(e) onde YXGEC, BTΔ drenching(e)
hond(e) AH₁RLB₂ dremchinge honde M
[200](#) 3990 An F
[201](#) 3992 bothe] by þe E, BTΔ but H₃
[202](#) 4006 Spertheidos XECB₂, BT
[203](#) 4008 and of þe AM ... B₂, BTΔΔ, W
[204](#) 4020 To make wiþ þis medicine B *line om.* TΔ
[205](#) 4024 His AMRC, T
[206](#) 4029 þat wiþ þe air YE ... B₂, BT þat was *with* þe air Δ þat was of air XG
[207](#) 4043 puttes AJ, B, F pettes S
[208](#) 4049 and in such wise] in such a wise C in such(e) wise BT and such(e)
wise RLB₂
[209](#) 4067 And þan B And þat T
[210](#) 4072 þe cook H₁G, BT
[211](#) 4073 either] euery AM ... B₂
[212](#) 4088 put J, S, F putte AC, B
[213](#) 4106 fforþ A ... GC
[214](#) 4110 over] euery ERLB₂, W ony C oure X
[215](#) 4113 make] take ERCB₂
[216](#) 4129 his] hir C, B
[217](#) 4137 thereafter] after E ... B₂ her (hir) after BT
[218](#) 4138 seefoul E, BTΔ sedewolf L
[219](#) 4140 that] which E ... B₂, W
[220](#) 4151 mede E ... B₂
[221](#) 4152 be sene (seene) AJ, B besene S, F
[222](#) 4160 and fieble] fieble E, B, W
[223](#) 4161 into (in to) AM ... B₂
[224](#) 4177 eny stede XGL, BΔ
[225](#) 4186 telleþ BT
[226](#) 4217 wold C, SB, F wolde AJ
[227](#) 4231 herde AJ, F herd C, B
[228](#) 4243 schepe felle B
[229](#) 4250 *margin* mortua autem Philen SΔΔ mortua autem Hellen A ... B₂, BT,
FWH₃

[230](#) 4266 *margin* cum solo vellere A ... B₂, B
[231](#) 4267 *margin* canitur YGE, BTΔΔ canetur AMH₁XRCLB₂, S, FH₃ habetur W
[232](#) 4276 Anon sche bigan for to make E ... B₂ She kest anone howe she myght make W
[233](#) 4278 schope AJ, S, F schop (schoop) C, B
[234](#) 4307 all S, F alle AJ, B
[235](#) 4309 seid AJ, B, F seide C
[236](#) 4311 hem haþ preid B hath hem preide W
[237](#) 4321 it is AMH₁
[238](#) 4330 Wherin J, F
[239](#) 4334 þo men H₁XGEC, B
[240](#) 4343 þe AMH₁XGB₂, Δ, W
[241](#) 4349 was lore H₁ ... B₂
[242](#) 4351 As] And AM ... B₂
[243](#) 4352 himself adreynt B
[244](#) 4361 was spoke H₁XECLB₂
[245](#) 4367 To him þat BT, W
[246](#) 4369 you] þou H₁YB₂, BT, WH₃
[247](#) 4391 where þe biȝete sterte EC wher euere þei be ȝit stert(e) H₁XRLB₂
[248](#) 4396 To] And H₁ ... B₂
[249](#) 4402 by so AMH₁XRCLB₂, B so W
[250](#) 4411 thei] sche B
[251](#) 4413 wolde he H₁XRCLB₂
[252](#) 4423 of continuance BT and contenance LB₂, WH₃
[253](#) 4425 his *om.* AM ... B₂
[254](#) 4427 wher it is A ... B₂, FWKH₃
[255](#) 4452 it were AM
[256](#) 4462 ther] þat BT
[257](#) 4468 My þought and al my loue BT Mi loue and al mi trewþe Δ
[258](#) 4485 sein (seie) MXCLB₂, W
[259](#) 4504 mihte S miht (might) AJ, B, F
[260](#) 4507 usure] mesure BT
[261](#) 4512 al þis BT
[262](#) 4518 als so] als (as) X, Ad, WH₃
[263](#) 4523 it *om.* B
[264](#) 4525 Thus beie I diere] I beye deere H₁ ... B₂
[265](#) 4526 noght *om.* H₁RCLB₂, W
[266](#) 4565 þe ende H₁ ... B₂
[267](#) 4568 riht wel paid] wel a payd (appaied) H₁ ... B₂
[268](#) 4571 of suche dede BT
[269](#) 4574 thogh] of ERCB₂ if H₁
[270](#) 4576 ffro whom AM
[271](#) 4579 hire AJM
[272](#) 4586 *margin* decreuit, pro eo quod ipsa Eccho *om.* BT, H₃
[273](#) 4587 on *om.* BT
[274](#) 4595 that *om.* MH₁XRCLB₂, Δ, W
[275](#) 4612 was *om.* AM
[276](#) 4634 quite BT, W
[277](#) 4642 vice BT

[278](#) 4643 in the wodes] euere in wodes AM ... B₂
[279](#) 4651 herte XEC, BT, W
[280](#) 4652 places XGLB₂, B
[281](#) 4671 Blinde AJ, S, F Blind C, B
[282](#) 4680 wole A
[283](#) 4682 Whan EC
[284](#) 4701 By (Bi) so AM ... B₂, B (Be so G)
[285](#) 4717 why F which A ... B₂, S ... Δ, KH₃Magd thi W
[286](#) 4732 ffor wiþ SΔ
[287](#) 4738 By so AMX ... B₂, B
[288](#) 4739 I myhte] It m. AM ... B₂, S ... Δ
[289](#) 4742 That it schal H₁ ... B₂
[290](#) 4770 I schal BT
[291](#) 4788 That man H₁ ... B₂
[292](#) 4789 *margin* Babilonem A ... B₂
[293](#) 4792 yifte *om.* H₁RCLB₂
[294](#) 4808 Rabio A ... B₂
[295](#) 4814 such *om.* AMRCL
[296](#) 4817 Spondeus H₁ ... B₂ Spondius T
[297](#) 4818 in *om.* RCB₂
[298](#) 4851 Rabio A ... B₂
[299](#) 4856 the] he AM
[300](#) 4862 schette (schet) JXERCB₂
[301](#) 4868 I] it BT þou H₁ ... B₂
[302](#) 4872 wold B
[303](#) 4877 thi] þis H₁E ... B₂
[304](#) *Latin Verses* vii. 2 dicta que SBT dictaque AJM, FW dictique (dicti que)
H₁E ... B₂
[305](#) 3 alonge AJ, F a longe SB
[306](#) 4920 Dampnen þe vnkinde creature H₁ ... B₂ (Dampneth H₁B₂) lifiss S, F
liuiss BT liuyng AJM, Δ liflich (livelich) WH₃
[307](#) 4921 who that it kan] þat it can AM by þat I can H₁ ... B₂
[308](#) 4935 olde AJ, S, F old C, B
[309](#) 4942 at] þat XECLB₂ þat at H₁R
[310](#) 4944 the *om.* H₁ ... B₂, BΔ
[311](#) 4959 *margin* ipsum] insuper ipsum AM
[312](#) 4981 the] þo B *om.* T
[313](#) 4984 all S, F alle AJ, B
[314](#) 4989 f. put: knvt AMC pit: knit H₁XRLB₂, Ad, W
[315](#) 4994 þe pit (put &c.) H₁ ... B₂, Ad, W
[316](#) 5003 sore] for AM he W
[317](#) 5011 fantosme, bot yit] fantasme (fantome) þat BTA fantasme and 3it L
fantasie but he 3it W
[318](#) 5021 him hath adresced] þo him haþ dresced H₁XRCLB₂
[319](#) 5025 al softe] alofte B softe W
[320](#) 5034 If it so be þat he vpbreyde (ymbreide) BT
[321](#) 5035 speke F *rest* spoke
[322](#) 5045 o word H₁C, BT one word Δ, W
[323](#) 5051 the *om.* AM
[324](#) 5054 aroute F

[325](#) 5064 a *om.* H₁RCLB₂
[326](#) 5071 Thonkende] Touchynge AH₁R (Thonkinge *in ras.* C)
[327](#) 5102 That to] Vnto B
[328](#) 5105 bot it be grace] but it be bi grace AM but be goddis grace Δ
[329](#) 5111 the *om.* AM
[330](#) 5114 so he dede AdBTΔ, W
[331](#) 5125 al aboute H₁XRCL
[332](#) 5128 þat man H₁ ... B₂
[333](#) 5130 him *om.* BT
[334](#) 5131 ek (eek) AJC, BT eke F
[335](#) 5134 a mannes] mannes XE, B
[336](#) 5145 And in þe AM And tho the H₁
[337](#) 5157 the] in AM ... B₂
[338](#) 5158 eny AM
[339](#) 5159 hem AMGRLB₂
[340](#) 5180 eny *om.* AM
[341](#) 5199 bot] by (be) BT for W
[342](#) 5204 Wherof AM ... B₂
[343](#) 5210 þy þought BT
[344](#) 5215 standt S, F stant AC, B standeþ J thi] þe H₁ ... B₂
[345](#) 5225 ffor loue H₁ ... B₂
[346](#) 5236 bar AJC, BT bare S, F
[347](#) 5237 *margin* suffultus] fultus BT
[348](#) 5239 *margin* vincit H₁ ... B₂
[349](#) 5242 vsed AM ... B₂, W
[350](#) 5248 dighte F dihte AJ *and so also in l. 5352*
[351](#) 5252 cite H₁ ... B₂, T
[352](#) 5277 And] Of B
[353](#) 5281 of Troie XC, S ... Δ, W
[354](#) 5282 lost hath] lost(e) H₁ ... B₂ hath lost W
[355](#) 5288 world] lord BT
[356](#) 5299 therinne] euer inne H₁ ... B₂
[357](#) 5302 many AC, B manye (manie) S, F monie J
[358](#) 5308 As] And X ... B₂
[359](#) 5316 this] his L, BT
[360](#) 5321 the king] to king E ... B₂, kynge (*om.* the) X
[361](#) 5326 put AJ, S, F putte C, BT
[362](#) 5341 sche schold B, W sche wolde T
[363](#) 5346 ayeinward] azein H₁ ... B₂
[364](#) 5349 tok (took) AJC, SB toke F
[365](#) 5357 Hou he] How þat he AH₁RCLB₂ How þat M
[366](#) 5359 þe maide AM ... B₂
[367](#) 5364 So was B gret *om.* AM wonder AC, BT wondre J, S, F
[368](#) 5372 þis ground S ... Δ
[369](#) 5387 wold(e) BT
[370](#) 5411 f.

And so fell þat vpon an ile
 Thei were wind driue wipinne a while

H₁ ... B₂ (driuen in a while L)
[371](#) 5427 his] alle B
[372](#) 5430 schipman H₁ ... B₂, W
[373](#) 5438 afriht (a fright &c.) A ... B₂ (*except* E), W
[374](#) 5449 it at nede H₁XRCLB₂
[375](#) 5456 is] was H₁E ... B₂
[376](#) 5457 into] to S ... Δ
[377](#) 5464 tresces AC tresses BT trescess J, S, F
[378](#) 5465 wiþ hir selue (self) took a strif H₁ ... B₂ wiþ hirself sche took such a s.
 B
[379](#) 5466 betwen(e) dep H₁ ... B₂
[380](#) 5467 lay] weepe (wep) BT
[381](#) 5480 after þat S ... Δ
[382](#) 5500 as for BT
[383](#) 5507 it *om.* AM ... B₂ (*except* E)
[384](#) 5510 seruant H₁ ... B₂
[385](#) 5520 þei failen H₁ ... B₂ he faileth W
[386](#) 5522 what] al þat B
[387](#) 5524 thee schal] schal M ... B₂ schal þe Δ, W
[388](#) 5527 seline BT
[389](#) 5532 ladi love] loue desire H₁ ... B₂
[390](#) 5533 That] ffor BT was *om.* H₁ ... B₂
[391](#) 5539 wolde H₁ ... B₂
[392](#) 5546 lust AMCL listne Δ
[393](#) 5557 *margin* duas filias *om.* B
[394](#) 5559 *margin* Terco A ... B₂
[395](#) 5561 *margin* cum *om.* A ... B₂
[396](#) 5563 *margin* sororis A ... B₂, B, W
[397](#) 5560 wel *om.* H₁E ... B
[398](#) 5590 sche lay XGB₂, S ... Δ, W
[399](#) 5592 kist SB, F kyste (kiste) AJ
[400](#) 5597 to] by (be) A ... B₂
[401](#) 5600 Vnto B
[402](#) 5610 noght *om.* AM
[403](#) 5611 Of þat þey preyde T And þat þei preyde B
[404](#) 5621 he *om.* BT
[405](#) 5622 a fyre XC, B
[406](#) 5627 that] þe BT
[407](#) 5633 which] that H₁, BT *om.* M, W
[408](#) 5646 þi A this] þe M
[409](#) 5667 þo stones EC
[410](#) 5670 tale] al BT
[411](#) 5671 f.

And crie it to briddes al aboute
 How þou hast do to me þurghoute H₁ ... B₂

(to þe briddes R)

[412](#) 5678 How schalt AM ... B₂ Euel has W
[413](#) 5684 a *om.* A

[414](#) 5719 Of] And BT
[415](#) 5737 wele vnto E, B welþe into MH₁C grete A, S, F gret JC, B
[416](#) 5740 and þus C
[417](#) 5743 wrongful þing X ... B₂ wonderfull thyng H₁
[418](#) 5748 hadde I S ... Δ
[419](#) 5765 wold(e) H₁ECB₂, W
[420](#) 5769 tyt (tit) AC, SB tyd J, F
[421](#) 5773 hadde (had) do H₁ ... B₂
[422](#) 5774 lappeþ B
[423](#) 5802 riht *om.* H₁ ... B₂
[424](#) 5807 ther] wher H₁ ... B₂
[425](#) 5810 sihe AJ, S, F sih C, B
[426](#) 5816 a vov (a vou) J, S, F avow AC, B
[427](#) 5837 ladis (ladyes) H₁ ... B₂
[428](#) 5859 noght] neuer H₁ ... B₂
[429](#) 5873 chambre H₁XELB₂, AdBTΔ, W
[430](#) 5878 herkne (herken) LB₂, BTΔ, W
[431](#) 5880 The AJMH₁XRLB₂ Tho EC
[432](#) 5889 To ... grieue H₁ ... B₂
[433](#) 5890 þat was so lieue H₁ ... B₂
[434](#) 5918 hier ben nou we] here be we now J nowe we her be W here ben we M
 hier (here) ben now (*om.* we) H₁ ... B₂
[435](#) 5925 remembrance F
[436](#) 5929 in to H₁ECLB₂, BTΔ, H₃
[437](#) 5936 Al sodeinly þat men it syhe H₁ ... B₂
[438](#) 5944 þe nightingale XECLB₂
[439](#) 5958 Sche thenkth] Sche was H₁ ... B₂
[440](#) 5962 larchesse F
[441](#) 5966 al] and AM ... L *om.* B₂
[442](#) 5971 sih (sigh &c.) E, AdBT, WH₃ saw Δ (sep S)
[443](#) 5974] þe Philomene H₁ ... B₂
[444](#) 5977 openly] priuely H₁ ... B₂
[445](#) 5979 O why] Why BT
[446](#) 5981 Which AJ, S, F Whiche B
[447](#) 6008 world] woode B word T
[448](#) 6011 chatreþ (chatereth) AMH₁ chater (chateren) YXG ... B₂
[449](#) 6012 falshod A, S, F falshode JC, B
[450](#) 6016 wol C, B
[451](#) 6019 to vnderstonde H₁E ... B₂
[452](#) 6020 falshod A, F falshode J, SB falshode C hire] here (her) H₁ERL, SAdΔ,
 FH₃
[453](#) 6026 no *om.* AM, Ad þe X, W
[454](#) 6042 in H₁E ... B₂
[455](#) 6044 he was] of a BT
[456](#) 6046 The l. A ... B₂, SAdΔ, WH₃
[457](#) 6048 Bewar F Be war AJC, SB
[458](#) 6052 to Tereus BT
[459](#) 6053 goddes forebode] nay god it forbode X ... B₂ nay god for bede H₁
 (goddes forbode AJM, AdT, WH₃)
[460](#) 6054 be fortrede (for trede) H₁XECLB₂ to be trede R

[461](#) 6059 lou(er)e AM ... B₂
[462](#) 6076 himseluen (himself) in d. H₁ ... B₂
[463](#) 6084 water AC, B watre J, S, F
[464](#) 6101 purchas S ... Δ
[465](#) 6103 as] or AMRCL heere H₁ *om.* E
[466](#) 6110 wyldee F wher] þer AM
[467](#) 6114 hir(e) chaffare H₁ ... B₂ þi ch. M
[468](#) *margin* cum *om.* B
[469](#) 6151 þis AM þe H₁XGRB₂ þo EC
[470](#) 6162 Neptimus AH₁R, BT, H₃
[471](#) 6167 so sod.] al sod. H₁ ... B₂
[472](#) 6178 Wherfor(e) to AB₂, Δ Wherof to H₁ Where to BT, W
[473](#) 6190 and] ad F lete it be AM
[474](#) 6215 Maide] may H₁ ... B₂ him hath] is him S ... Δ hath him W
[475](#) 6234 wol B
[476](#) 6239 *margin* quendam] quem B
[477](#) 6256 in to A ... B₂, W
[478](#) 6257 al a] alle AM al þe (alle the) H₁E ... B₂
[479](#) 6267 byde AM
[480](#) 6289 he AdBT
[481](#) 6293 vngoodlich JC, SB, F vngoodliche A
[482](#) 6296 of micherye B
[483](#) 6302 chastie EC
[484](#) 6304 that *om.* AM, Ad
[485](#) 6313 in honde X, SAdBTΔ
[486](#) 6317 happeþ E, AdBTΔ happed W
[487](#) 6318 he YEC, AdBT
[488](#) 6319 a bough H₁ ... B₂, Δ
[489](#) 6324 wodesschawe AJ, F woode schawe C, BT
[490](#) 6336 so] tuo E, B too W
[491](#) 6341 a weie F
[492](#) 6351 olde ensamples AdBT, W
[493](#) *Latin Verses* x. *om.* *here and ins.* *later* S ... Δ (*ins.* *here* Δ)
[494](#) 6361 That whilom was an emp. H₁E That whilom þer was emp. XRCLB₂
 þat what man was þo emp. Δ
[495](#) 6363 and in] and AMR in LB₂
[496](#) 6364 *margin* sedebant H₁RCLB₂
[497](#) 6366 of] a AdBT
[498](#) 6367 womman H₁ ... B₂, W
[499](#) 6372 Phirus AM
[500](#) 6378 be *om.* AM
[501](#) 6381 threste] put B
[502](#) 6382 him] it B
[503](#) 6387 f.

That maidenhode is forto preise
 Who þat þe vertus wolde peise

S ... ΔΔ

[504](#) 6390 *margin* Hii secuntur agnum quocunque ierit SΔ

[505](#) 6395*-6438* *Only in SAdBTΔΔ The text here follows S*
[506](#) 6396* ff. *margin* In carne—est om. B
[507](#) 6398* Lich BT Liche S
[508](#) *Latin Verses x. inserted after 6412* SAdBT after 6413* Δ*
[509](#) *margin* Milicia—terram BΔ om. SΔ
[510](#) 6413* book BT boke S
[511](#) 6427* dedly BT dedely S
[512](#) 6429* stood BT stode S
[513](#) 6430* is 3it SΔ it is AdBTΔ
[514](#) *margin* contra sue om. B
[515](#) 6439* *margin* castissime B
[516](#) 6436* stood BT stode S
[517](#) 6408 and] of AdBT
[518](#) 6409 put AJ, S, F putte B
[519](#) 6418 My fader H₁ ... B₂, Ad mai wel AMEC, S ... ΔΔ
[520](#) 6429 take AJ, F tak SB
[521](#) 6444 Criseid(e) þe doughter AdBTΔ (Criseide dowhter S)
[522](#) 6452 grete AJ, S, F gret C, BT
[523](#) 6461 in] hem AXG ... B₂ hym MH₁
[524](#) 6463 he founde RCLB₂ be f. E
[525](#) 6465 apposed AM ... B₂ (*except* E)
[526](#) 6471 maide and] mayden (maide) H₁ ... B₂, AdBT, W
[527](#) 6472 3af AM ... B₂, T, W (gave)
[528](#) 6486 f.

[Sidenote: Amans.]

My fader so I wole I wis
 But now [wiþ] 3our ensamplerie H₁ ... B₂

(wiþ om. *all except* E)

[529](#) *Latin Verses* xi. 1 ad horam E, B
[530](#) 2 tempora AdBT
[531](#) 3 insidii H₁ ... B₂
[532](#) 6499 *margin* custodire A ... B₂
[533](#) 6501 at home H₁ ... B₂
[534](#) 6518 wold(e) H₁ ... B₂
[535](#) 6533 As] And AdBT, H₃
[536](#) 6547 And for AdBT, W
[537](#) 6585 wolde AJ, SB wold C, F
[538](#) 6597 hih A, F hihe B hye J
[539](#) 6617 no om. H₁E ... B₂, H₃
[540](#) 6633 pile C
[541](#) 6634 skile C
[542](#) 6641 I wot wel may I] wel ne may I B wel may I AdT I wot wel I mai Δ
[543](#) 6653 tolde] me tolde AM
[544](#) 6659 such a wise MH₁E ... B₂, W
[545](#) 6667 to] and S ... Δ
[546](#) 6678 the] hire (hir) X ... B₂, B here H₁
[547](#) 6694 who so AdBT þoght (þought) C, SB þoghte (þouhte) AJ, F
[548](#) 6697 ha doo AM kan do Δ

[549](#) 6700 put AJ, S, F putte B it on] it in H₁ECL me in B₂
[550](#) 6706 tel E, B
[551](#) 6715 his lawe AMX ... B₂ hire lawe H₁ þe lawe S ... Δ
[552](#) 6717 *margin* de die] die H₁ ... B₂ de nocte B
[553](#) 6728 *margin* matre nescia] matre H₁RCLB₂ matre nesciente X, B nesciente
 matre E
[554](#) 6731 *margin* quem *om.* AMH₁E ... B₂
[555](#) 6732 *margin* nunc H₁ ... B₂
[556](#) 6719 Phebus H₁ ... B₂
[557](#) 6742 if *om.* AM
[558](#) 6746 thus *om.* AM
[559](#) 6751 which] þat A ... B₂ *om.* W
[560](#) 6756 How it befell and how it was H₁ ... B₂
[561](#) 6766 it schal S ... Δ
[562](#) 6768 Mow AC, S, F Mowe J, B
[563](#) 6769 hir(e) AJM, WH₃
[564](#) 6771 do make J, SΔ, FH₃ to make AM, AdBT, W go make H₁ ... B₂
[565](#) 6795 he AdBT
[566](#) 6802 and *om.* B
[567](#) 6803 bifell AM, Ad, H₃
[568](#) 6816 *margin* sectis ARCLB₂
[569](#) 6824 *margin* voluntatem AM
[570](#) 6811 Toward XRCLB₂ Towarde H₁
[571](#) 6821 *S has lost a leaf* (ll. 6821-7000)
[572](#) 6836 Weere F Were AC, B Wher(e) JG
[573](#) 6839 so *om.* H₁XRCLB₂ him E
[574](#) 6846 herte H₁RCLB₂
[575](#) *For* 6848-6851 X *has*—

That he by daye in oþer stede
 ffor ouȝte þat he haþ prayde and bede
 To stele myȝte nouȝt suffise
 Bepouȝte him in a noþer wise
 And þer vpon his time awaiteþ

[576](#) 6856 him *om.* A ... B₂
[577](#) 6857 hire AM, B
[578](#) 6858 That] And AM ... B₂
[579](#) 6867 the man] to man H₁ ... B₂
[580](#) 6883 Ech AJC, B Eche F hemself B
[581](#) 6895 Beginne H₁ ... B₂ (*except* C), AdBT
[582](#) 6925 þrew C, B þrewe AJ, F
[583](#) 6932 a route J, B, F arowte A
[584](#) 6933 it ferde AdBT
[585](#) 6954 Mi *om.* AdBT
[586](#) 6955 on rowe H₁RCLB₂
[587](#) 6967 a lawe B
[588](#) 7015*-7036* *Only in AdBTΔ (not Δ) S is here defective, but did not contain
 the passage. Text follows B*
[589](#) 7015* f. taght: naght T
[590](#) 7025* euere T euer B

[591](#) 7034* þenkeþ B thinkth T
[592](#) 7036* rifleth T ruyfleþ B
[593](#) 6994 wurse A, F worse JC, B
[594](#) 7001 S *resumes*
[595](#) 7007 (7061*) *margin* SBΔΔ *have here* Hic tractat precipue de tribus
sacrilegis, quorum vnus fuit Antiochus, alter Nabuzardan, tercius
Nabugodonosor. (precipue *om.* Δ)
[596](#) 7008 lawe AdBT
[597](#) 7009 hou *om.* H₁ ... B₂
[598](#) 7010 sore] alle H₁ ... B₂
[599](#) 7022 (7076*) *margin* Nota de scriptura in pariete tempore Regis Baltazar,
que fuit mane, techel, phares SBA (scripta B)
[600](#) 7025 it *om.* H₁ ... B₂
[601](#) 7086*-7210* *Only in* SAdBTΔΔ *Text here follows* S
[602](#) 7100* sleyhte SΔ stelþe AdBT
[603](#) 7104* *line om.* BT
[604](#) 7121* charboncle AdT charbocle B
[605](#) 7126* *margin* barbam ab eo] barbam a deo BA (*margin om.* AdT)
[606](#) 7128* *margin* volui] nolui BA
[607](#) 7129* *margin* qui ante—templo *om.* B
[608](#) 7132* *margin* set honestate] sed ex honestate BA
[609](#) 7140* he *om.* AdBTΔ
[610](#) 7148* the] he S
[611](#) 7150* a feerd (a ferd) SB aferd T
[612](#) 7156* Durste BT Durst S
[613](#) 7157* gret BT grete S
[614](#) 7176* As vnto þat SΔ Vnto þat AdTΔ Vnto þat point B
[615](#) 7181* of SΔ þurgh BT þoro Ad
[616](#) 7183* And ... am I AdBTΔ
[617](#) 7204* took BT toke S
[618](#) 7048 love] houe G, AdBTΔ
[619](#) 7053 leueful AJ, S, F leuful C lieful B
[620](#) 7070 the fleissh] his fl. AdBTΔ
[621](#) 7078 preie (prey) AMH₁
[622](#) 7094 do] be CL
[623](#) 7106 noght] neuer (neer) A ... B₂
[624](#) 7119 or of] of a AM
[625](#) 7124 to me haþ be strange H₁ ... B₂, W
[626](#) 7131 on hire A ... B₂ on here H₁
[627](#) 7137 wold C, S, F wolde AJ, B
[628](#) 7152 I wolde AdBTΔ
[629](#) 7160 I *om.* AMR
[630](#) 7163 eny] holi S ... ΔΔ
[631](#) 7166 as it were H₁ ... B₂ 3if I were J
[632](#) 7172 so] to AM
[633](#) 7177 so] sone H₁ ... B₂
[634](#) 7181 3e þenken AM 3ou þenken H₁XRCL ye thingeth W
[635](#) 7194 on þe I wol H₁ ... CB₂ on þe wol I L
[636](#) 7203 *margin* famosissima F
[637](#) 7205 *margin* vniuersa BT vniuersum A ... B₂

[638](#) 7206 *margin* causabat A ... B₂
[639](#) 7208 the] in AM ... B₂
[640](#) 7215 that] þe H₁ ... B₂
[641](#) 7223 þe tale H₁ ... B₂
[642](#) 7236 maken] make an B
[643](#) 7257 of good] and good JH₁, AdBTΛ
[644](#) 7264] þo þenkende he B þus þenking he GC he þenking he H₁XRLB₂ he
 þenking þus E
[645](#) 7271 euery AdBT
[646](#) 7274 Antenor F
[647](#) 7275 Esiona H₁ ... B₂, T
[648](#) 7277 be large Ad by grace AM
[649](#) 7297 that] þe S ... Δ
[650](#) 7303 f. *two lines om.* AdBT
[651](#) 7311 hem] tuo (too) H₁ ... B₂
[652](#) 7318 his] him H₁ ... B₂, B, W
[653](#) 7327 And a proud word AMH₁XRCL And proude wordes B₂
[654](#) 7328 as tho] also AdBT
[655](#) 7336 all S, F alle AJ, B
[656](#) 7344 forto schewe] forto eschewe (for teschewe &c.) H₁ ... B₂
[657](#) 7363 or to werste JXERCL, H₂ falle it to werste H₁B₂
[658](#) 7382 This wrong and schame in bettre forme H₁ ... B₂ (The wrong X)
[659](#) 7388 wol (wil) him H₁ ... B₂, W
[660](#) 7391 trew F trewe AJC, SB
[661](#) 7400 ende er dai A
[662](#) 7403 went AC, S, F wente J, BT
[663](#) 7405 the] to AdBT
[664](#) 7410 a visioun MXGCLB₂, Δ, FWH₃ auisioun (avision etc.) AJH₁ER,
 SAdBT
[665](#) 7417 putt A, S, F putte JC, B
[666](#) 7419 that] þe AM
[667](#) 7441 Cassandre H₁ ... B₂
[668](#) 7464 the *om.* AM ... B₂
[669](#) 7470 þat same XRCLB₂, T
[670](#) 7504 wolde AdB
[671](#) 7510 on side H₁ ... B₂ (*except* E)
[672](#) 7533 went A, SB, F wente JC
[673](#) 7535 that *om.* AM ... B₂
[674](#) 7541 unto] to H₁ ... B₂
[675](#) 7544 it *om.* H₁ ... B₂
[676](#) 7554 in to AM ... B₂, WH₃ to Δ
[677](#) 7570 token] tolden S ... Δ
[678](#) 7602 of lust (luste) H₁ ... B₂
[679](#) 7604 *line om.* B
[680](#) 7611 what] þe AdBT that W
[681](#) 7619 Skarnesse F
[682](#) 7621 and of M ... B₂, T
[683](#) 7630 to troupe AMH₁XRCLB₂ by troupe E
[684](#) 7634 partie (party) þat he wrongeþ AM ... B₂
[685](#) *Latin Verses* xiii. 1 extrema *que* C, B extrema*que* J, F

[686](#) 7689 tomoche E, S, F to moche AJ, BT tuo (two) moche H₁ ... B₂ (*except* E)
 the moche W
[687](#) 7694 lost AM ... B₂ (*except* E) loseth W leueth Δ
[688](#) 7700 it bredeþ A ... B₂
[689](#) 7701-7746 *Forty-six lines om. S ... Δ (ins. Λ)*
[690](#) 7725 *margin* Beacius—accipere *om.* A ... B₂ accipere] ac-pere F
[691](#) 7742 *margin* Aplus A Amplus H₁ERC Amplius B₂ Ambrosius X
[692](#) 7751 The whil J, W þat whil C (Al þe while he hath his pak Δ)
[693](#) 7766 non] gon AM
[694](#) 7784 sene (sen) many on H₁ ... B₂
[695](#) 7804 to] vnto E, B
[696](#) 7809 wol me AdBT, W me wolde M
[697](#) 7817 in auenture AM ... B₂, W
[698](#) 7819 Telle JC, SB Tell A, F
[699](#) 7823 tymes AdBTΔ
[700](#) 7829 stilled S ... Δ
[701](#) 7840 euermore H₁XRB₂, BΔ, W

Incipit Liber Sextus

i. *Est gula que nostrum maculauit prima
parentem*

P. iii. 1

[GLUTTONY.]

*Ex vetito pomo, quo dolet omnis homo.
Hec agit vt corpus anime contraria spirat,
Quo caro fit crassa, spiritus atque macer.
Intus et exterius si que virtutis habentur,
Potibus ebrietas conuiciata ruit.
Mersa sopore, labris, que Bachus inebriat hospes,
Indignata Venus oscula raro premit.*

The grete Senne original,
Which every man in general
Upon his berthe hath envenymed,
In Paradis it was mystymed:
Whan Adam of thilke Appel bot,
His swete morscel was to hot,
Which dedly made the mankinde.
And in the bokes as I finde,
This vice, which so out of rule
10 Hath sette ous alle, is cleped Gule;[702](#)
Of which the branches ben so grete,
That of hem alle I wol noght trete,
Bot only as touchende of tuo[703](#)
I thenke speke and of no mo;
Wherof the ferste is Dronkeschipe,
Which berth the cuppe felaschipe.
Ful many a wonder doth this vice,
He can make of a wisman nyce,
And of a fool, that him schal seme
20 That he can al the lawe deme,
And yiven every juggement

Hic in sexto libro
tractare intendit de
illo capitali vicio
quod Gula dicitur,
nec non et de
eiusdem duabus
solummodo
speciebus, videlicet
Ebrietate et
Delicacia, ex
quibus humane
concupiscencie
oblectamentum
habundancius
augmentatur.

P. iii. 2

[i. DRUNKENNESS.]

Which longeth to the firmament
 Bothe of the sterre and of the mone;
 And thus he makth a gret clerk sone
 Of him that is a lewed man.
 Ther is nothing which he ne can,
 Whil he hath Dronkeschipe on honde,
 He knowth the See, he knowth the stronde,
 He is a noble man of armes,
 30 And yit no strengthe is in his armes:
 Ther he was strong ynouh tofore,
 With Dronkeschipe it is forlore,
 And al is changed his astat,
 And wext anon so fieble and mat,⁷⁰⁴
 That he mai nouthur go ne come,
 Bot al togedre him is benome
 The pouer bothe of hond and fot,
 So that algate abide he mot.
 And alle hise wittes he foryet,
 40 The which is to him such a let,
 That he wot nevere what he doth,
 Ne which is fals, ne which is soth,
 Ne which is dai, ne which is nyht,
 And for the time he knowth no wyht,⁷⁰⁵
 That he ne wot so moche as this,
 What maner thing himselven is,
 Or he be man, or he be beste.
 That holde I riht a sori feste,
 Whan he that reson understod
 50 So soudeinliche is woxe wod,
 Or elles lich the dede man,
 Which nouthur go ne speke can.
 Thus ofte he is to bedde broght,
 Bot where he lith yit wot he noght,
 Til he arise upon the morwe;
 And thanne he seith, 'O, which a sorwe
 It is a man be drinkeles!'⁷⁰⁶
 So that halfdrunke in such a res

P. iii. 3

With dreie mouth he sterte him uppe,⁷⁰⁷
 60 And seith, 'Nou *baillez ça* the cuppe.'
 That made him lese his wit at eve
 Is thanne a morwe al his beleve;
 The cuppe is al that evere him pleseth,
 And also that him most deseseth;
 It is the cuppe whom he serveth,
 Which alle cares fro him kerveth⁷⁰⁸
 And alle bales to him bringeth:
 In joie he wepeth, in sorwe he singeth,
 For Dronkeschipe is so divers,⁷⁰⁹
 70 It may no whyle stonde in vers.
 He drinkth the wyn, bot ate laste
 The wyn drynkth him and bint him faste,
 And leith him drunke be the wal,
 As him which is his bonde thral
 And al in his subjeccion.
 And lich to such condicion,
 As forto speke it other wise,
 It falleth that the moste wise
 Ben otherwhile of love adoted,⁷¹⁰
 80 And so bewhaped and assoted,
 Of drunke men that nevere yit
 Was non, which half so loste his wit
 Of drinke, as thei of such thing do
 Which cleped is the jolif wo;
 And waxen of here oghne thoght
 So drunke, that thei knowe noght⁷¹¹
 What reson is, or more or lesse.
 Such is the kinde of that sieknesse,
 And that is noght for lacke of brain,
 90 Bot love is of so gret a main,
 That where he takth an herte on honde,
 Ther mai nothing his miht withstonde:
 The wise Salomon was nome,
 And stronge Sampson overcome,

P. iii. 4

[LOVE-
DRUNKENNESS.]

The knihtli David him ne mihte
Rescoue, that he with the sihte
Of Bersabee ne was bestad,
Virgile also was overlad,
And Aristotle was put under.

- 100 Forthi, mi Sone, it is no wonder
If thou be drunke of love among,⁷¹²
Which is above alle othre strong:
And if so is that thou so be,
Tell me thi Schrifte in privite;
It is no schame of such a thew
A yong man to be dronkelew.
Of such Phisique I can a part,
And as me semeth be that art,
Thou scholdest be Phisonomie
110 Be schapen to that maladie
Of lovedrunke, and that is routhe.

P. iii. 5

Confessio Amantis.

- Ha, holi fader, al is trouthe
That ye me telle: I am beknowe
That I with love am so bethrowe,
And al myn herte is so thurgh sunke,
That I am verrailiche drunke,
And yit I mai bothe speke and go.
Bot I am overcome so,
And torned fro miself so clene,
120 That ofte I wot noght what I mene;
So that excusen I ne mai
Min herte, fro the ferste day
That I cam to mi ladi kiththe,
I was yit sobre nevere siththe.
Wher I hire se or se hire noght,
With musinge of min oghne thoght,
Of love, which min herte assaileth,
So drunke I am, that mi wit faileth
And al mi brain is overtorned,
130 And mi manere so mistorned,
That I foryete al that I can

P. iii. 6

And stonde lich a mased man;
 That ofte, whanne I scholde pleie,
 It makth me drawe out of the weie
 In soulein place be miselve,
 As doth a labourer to delve,
 Which can no gentil mannes chere;
 Or elles as a lewed Frere,
 Whan he is put to his penance,
 140 Riht so lese I mi contenance.
 And if it nedes so betyde,
 That I in compainie abyde,
 Wher as I moste daunce and singe
 The hovedance and carolinge,
 Or forto go the newefot,⁷¹³
 I mai noght wel heve up mi fot,
 If that sche be noght in the weie;
 For thanne is al mi merthe aweie,
 And waxe anon of thoght so full,
 150 Wherof mi limes ben so dull,
 I mai unethes gon the pas.⁷¹⁴
 For thus it is and evere was,⁷¹⁵
 Whanne I on suche thoghtes muse,
 The lust and merthe that men use,
 Whan I se noght mi ladi byme,
 Al is foryete for the time
 So ferforth that mi wittes changen
 And alle lustes fro me strangen,
 That thei seie alle trewely,
 160 And swere, that it am noght I.⁷¹⁶
 For as the man which ofte drinketh,
 With win that in his stomac sinketh⁷¹⁷
 Wext drunke and witles for a throwe,
 Riht so mi lust is overthrowe,
 And of myn oghne thoght so mat
 I wexe, that to myn astat
 Ther is no lime wol me serve,

Bot as a drunke man I swerve,
And suffre such a Passion,
170 That men have gret compassion,
And everich be himself mervelleth
What thing it is that me so eilleth. [718](#)
Such is the manere of mi wo
Which time that I am hire fro,
Til eft ayein that I hire se.
Bot thanne it were a nycete
To telle you hou that I fare:
For whanne I mai upon hire stare,
Hire wommanhede, hire gentillesse,
180 Myn herte is full of such gladnesse,
That overpasseth so mi wit,
That I wot nevere where it sit,
Bot am so drunken of that sihte,
Me thenkth that for the time I mihte
Riht sterte thurgh the hole wall;
And thanne I mai wel, if I schal,
Bothe singe and daunce and lepe aboute,
And holde forth the lusti route.
Bot natheles it falleth so
190 Fulofte, that I fro hire go
Ne mai, bot as it were a stake,
I stonde avisement to take
And loke upon hire faire face;
That for the while out of the place
For al the world ne myhte I wende.
Such lust comth thanne into mi mende,
So that withoute mete or drinke, [719](#)
Of lusti thoughtes whiche I thinke
Me thenkth I mihte stonden evere;
200 And so it were to me levere
Than such a sihte forto leve,
If that sche wolde yif me leve [720](#)
To have so mochel of mi wille.
And thus thenkende I stonde stille

Without blenchinge of myn yhe,
 Riht as me thoghte that I syhe
 Of Paradis the moste joie:
 And so therwhile I me rejoie,
 Into myn herte a gret desir,⁷²¹
 210 The which is hotere than the fyr,
 Al soudeinliche upon me renneth,
 That al mi thocht withinne brenneth,
 And am so ferforth overcome,
 That I not where I am become;
 So that among the hetes stronge⁷²²
 In stede of drinke I underfonge
 A thocht so swete in mi corage,
 That nevere Pymment ne vernage
 Was half so swete forto drinke.
 220 For as I wolde, thanne I thinke
 As thogh I were at myn above,
 For so thurgh drunke I am of love,
 That al that mi sotye demeth
 Is soth, as thanne it to me semeth.
 And whyle I mai tho thoghtes kepe,
 Me thenkth as thogh I were aslepe
 And that I were in goddes barm;
 Bot whanne I se myn oghne harm,
 And that I soudeinliche awake
 230 Out of my thought, and hiede take
 Hou that the sothe stant in dede,
 Thanne is mi sekernes in drede
 And joie torned into wo,
 So that the hete is al ago
 Of such sotie as I was inne.⁷²³
 And thanne ayeinward I beginne
 To take of love a newe thorst,
 The which me grieveth altherworst,
 For thanne comth the blanche fievere,
 240 With chele and makth me so to chievere,
 And so it coldeth at myn herte,⁷²⁴

That wonder is hou I asterte,⁷²⁵
 In such a point that I ne deie:
 For certes ther was nevere keie
 Ne frosen ys upon the wal
 More inly cold than I am al.
 And thus soffre I the hote chele,
 Which passeth othre peines fele;
 In cold I brenne and frese in hete:
 250 And thanne I drinke a biter swete
 With dreie lippe and yhen wete.
 Lo, thus I tempre mi diete,
 And take a drauhte of such reles,
 That al mi wit is herteles,
 And al myn herte, ther it sit,
 Is, as who seith, withoute wit;
 So that to prove it be reson
 In makinge of comparison
 Ther mai no difference be
 260 Betwen a drunke man and me.
 Bot al the worste of everychon
 Is evere that I thurste in on;⁷²⁶
 The more that myn herte drinketh,
 The more I may; so that me thinketh,
 My thirst schal nevere ben aqueint.
 God schilde that I be noght dreint
 Of such a superfluite:
 For wel I fiele in mi degre
 That al mi wit is overcast,
 270 Wherof I am the more agast,
 That in defaulte of ladischipe
 Per chance in such a drunkeschipe
 I mai be ded er I be war.
 For certes, fader, this I dar
 Beknowe and in mi schrifte telle:
 Bot I a drauhte have of that welle,
 In which mi deth is and mi lif,
 Mi joie is torned into strif,

That sobre schal I nevere worthe,
 280 Bot as a drunke man forworthe;
 So that in londe where I fare⁷²⁷
 The lust is lore of mi welfare,
 As he that mai no bote finde.
 Bot this me thenkth a wonder kinde,
 As I am drunke of that I drinke,⁷²⁸
 So am I ek for falte of drinke;
 Of which I finde no reles:
 Bot if I myhte natheles
 Of such a drinke as I coveite,
 290 So as me liste, have o receite,
 I scholde assobre and fare wel.
 Bot so fortune upon hire whiel
 On hih me deigneth noght to sette,
 For everemore I finde a lette:
 The boteler is noght mi frend,
 Which hath the keie be the bend;
 I mai wel wisshe and that is wast,⁷²⁹
 For wel I wot, so freissh a tast,
 Bot if mi grace be the more,
 300 I schal assaie neveremore.
 Thus am I drunke of that I se,
 For tastinge is defended me,
 And I can noght miselven stanche:
 So that, mi fader, of this branche
 I am gultif, to telle trouthe.

Mi Sone, that me thenketh routhe;

Confessor.

For lovedrunke is the meschief
 Above alle othre the most chief,
 If he no lusti thoght assaie,
 310 Which mai his sori thurst allaie:
 As for the time yit it lisseth
 To him which other joie misseth.
 Forthi, mi Sone, aboven alle
 Thenk wel, hou so it the befalle,
 And kep thi wittes that thou hast,

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 12

And let hem noght be drunke in wast:
 Bot natheles ther is no wyht
 That mai withstonde loves miht.
 Bot why the cause is, as I finde,
 320 Of that ther is diverse kinde
 Of lovedrunke, why men pleigneth
 After the court which al ordeigneth,
 I wol the tellen the manere;
 Nou lest, mi Sone, and thou schalt hiere.

For the fortune of every chance
 After the goddes pourveance
 To man it groweth from above,
 So that the sped of every love
 Is schape there, er it befaller.⁷³⁰

330 For Jupiter aboven alle,
 Which is of goddes sovereign,
 Hath in his celier, as men sein,
 Tuo tonnes fulle of love drinke,
 That maken many an herte sinke
 And many an herte also to flete,
 Or of the soure or of the swete.
 That on is full of such piment,
 Which passeth all entendement
 Of mannes witt, if he it taste,⁷³¹

340 And makth a jolif herte in haste:
 That other biter as the galle,
 Which makth a mannes herte palle,
 Whos drunkeschipe is a sieknesse
 Thurgh fieling of the biternesse.
 Cupide is boteler of bothe,
 Which to the lieve and to the lothe
 Yifeth of the swete and of the soure,
 That some lawhe, and some loure.
 But for so moche as he blind is,

350 Fulofte time he goth amis
 And takth the badde for the goode,
 Which hindreth many a mannes fode

[JUPITER'S TWO
 TUNS.]

Hic narrat
 secundum Poetam,
 qualiter in suo
 celario Iupiter duo
 dolea habet,
 quorum primum
 liquoris dulcissimi,
 secundum
 amarissimi plenum
 consistit, ita quod
 ille cui fatata est
 prosperitas de dulci
 potabit, alter vero,
 cui aduersabitur,
 poculum gustabit
 amaram.

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 13

Withoute cause, and forthreth eke.
 So be ther some of love seke,⁷³²
 Whiche oghte of reson to ben hole,
 And some comen to the dole
 In happ and as hemselfe leste⁷³³
 Drinke undeserved of the beste.⁷³⁴
 And thus this blinde Boteler
 360 Yifh of the trouble in stede of cler
 And ek the cler in stede of trouble:
 Lo, hou he can the hertes trouble,
 And makth men drunke al upon chaunce⁷³⁵
 Withoute lawe of governance.
 If he drawe of the swete tonne,
 Thanne is the sorwe al overronne
 Of lovedrunke, and schalt noght greven⁷³⁶
 So to be drunken every even,
 For al is thanne bot a game.
 370 Bot whanne it is noght of the same,
 And he the biter tonne draweth,
 Such drunkeschipe an herte gnaweth
 And fiebleth al a mannes thoght,
 That betre him were have drunke noght
 And al his bred have eten dreie;
 For thanne he lest his lusti weie⁷³⁷
 With drunkeschipe, and wot noght whider
 To go, the weies ben so slider,
 In which he mai per cas so falle,⁷³⁸
 380 That he schal breke his wittes alle.
 And in this wise men be drunke
 After the drink that thei have drunke.⁷³⁹
 Bot alle drinken noght alike,
 For som schal singe and som schal syke,
 So that it me nothing merueilleth,
 Mi Sone, of love that thee eilleth;
 For wel I knowe be thi tale,⁷⁴⁰
 That thou hast drunken of the duale,

Which biter is, til god the sende
390 Such grace that thou miht amende.

Bot, Sone, thou schalt bidde and preie

[PRAYER. BACCHUS
IN THE DESERT.]

In such a wise as I schal seie,
That thou the lusti welle atteigne
Thi wofull thurstes to restreigne
Of love, and taste the swetnesse;
As Bachus dede in his distresse,
Whan bodiliche thirst him hente
In strange londes where he wente.

This Bachus Sone of Jupiter

400 Was hote, and as he wente fer
Be his fadres assignement
To make a werre in Orient,
And gret pouer with him he ladde,
So that the heiere hond he hadde
And victoire of his enemys,
And torneth homward with his pris,
In such a contre which was dreie
A meschief fell upon the weie.⁷⁴¹

As he rod with his compainie
Nyh to the strondes of Lubie,
Ther myhte thei no drinke finde
Of water nor of other kinde,
So that himself and al his host

410 Were of defalte of drinke almost⁷⁴³
Destruid, and thanne Bachus preide
To Jupiter, and thus he seide:

‘O hihe fader, that sest al,
To whom is reson that I schal
Beseche and preie in every nede,

420 Behold, mi fader, and tak hiede
This wofull thirst that we ben inne⁷⁴⁴
To staunche, and grante ous forto winne,
And sauf unto the contre fare,
Wher that oure lusti loves are
Waitende upon oure hom cominge.’

Nota hic qualiter
potus aliquando
sicienti precibus
adquiritur. Et
narrat in exemplum
quod, cum Bachus
de quodam bello
ab oriente
repatrians in
quibusdam Lubie
partibus alicuius
generis potum non
inuenit, fuis ad
Iouem precibus,
apparuit ei Aries,
qui terram pede
percussit,⁷⁴²
statimque fons
emanauit; et sic
potum petenti
peticio preualuit.

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And with the vois of his preiyng,
 Which herd was to the goddes hihe,
 He syh anon tofore his yhe
 A wether, which the ground hath sporned;
 430 And wher he hath it overtorned,
 Ther sprang a welle freissh and cler,
 Wherof his oghne boteler
 After the lustes of his wille
 Was every man to drinke his fille. [745](#)
 And for this ilke grete grace
 Bachus upon the same place
 A riche temple let arere,
 Which evere scholde stonde there
 To thursti men in remembrance.
 440 Forthi, mi Sone, after this chance Confessor.
 It sit thee wel to taken hiede
 So forto preie upon thi nede, [746](#)
 As Bachus preide for the welle;
 And thenk, as thou hast herd me telle,
 Hou grace he gradde and grace he hadde.
 He was no fol that ferst so radde,
 For selden get a domb man lond:
 Tak that proverbe, and understond
 That wordes ben of vertu grete.
 450 Forthi to speke thou ne lete,
 And axe and prei erli and late
 Thi thurst to quenche, and thenk algate,
 The boteler which berth the keie
 Is blind, as thou hast herd me seie;
 And if it mihte so betyde,
 That he upon the blinde side
 Per cas the swete tonne arauhte,
 Than schalt thou have a lusti drauhte
 And waxe of lovedrunke sobre.
 460 And thus I rede thou assobre
 Thin herte in hope of such a grace;
 For drunkschipe in every place,

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 17

To whether side that it torne,⁷⁴⁷
Doth harm and makth a man to sporne
And ofte falle in such a wise,
Wher he per cas mai noght arise.

And forto loke in evidence
Upon the sothe experience,
So as it hath befalle er this,⁷⁴⁸
470 In every mannes mouth it is
Hou Tristram was of love drunke
With Bele Ysolde, whan thei drunke
The drink which Brangwein hem betok,
Er that king Marc his Eem hire tok
To wyve, as it was after knowe.
And ek, mi Sone, if thou wolt knowe,
As it hath fallen overmore
In loves cause, and what is more
Of drunkeschipe forto drede,
480 As it whilom befell in dede,
Wherof thou miht the betre eschue
Of drunke men that thou ne suie
The compaignie in no manere,
A gret ensample thou schalt hier.

This finde I write in Poesie
Of thilke faire Ipotacie,
Of whos beaute ther as sche was
Spak every man,—and fell per cas,
That Pirotöus so him spedde,
490 That he to wyve hire scholde wedde,
Wherof that he gret joie made.
And for he wolde his love glade,
Ayein the day of mariage
Be mouthe bothe and be message
Hise frendes to the feste he preide,⁷⁵¹
With gret worschipe and, as men seide,
He hath this yonge ladi spoused.
And whan that thei were alle housed,

[LOVE-
DRUNKENNESS.
TRISTRAM.]

Hic de amoris
ebrietate ponit
exemplum, qualiter
Tristrans ob
potum,⁷⁴⁹ quem
Brangweyne in
naui ei porrexit, de
amore Bele Isolde
inebriatus extitit.

[MARRIAGE OF
PIRITHOUS.]

Hic de periculis
ebrietatis causa in
amore
contingentibus⁷⁵⁰
narrat quod, cum
Pirothous illam
pulcherimam
Ypotaciam in
vxorem duceret,
quosdam qui
Centauri
vocabantur inter
alios vicinos ad
nupcias inuitauit;
qui vino imbuti,
noue nupte

And set and served ate mete,
 Ther was no wyn which mai be gete,⁷⁵³
 That ther ne was plente ynouh:
 Bot Bachus thilke tonne drouh,
 Wherof be weie of drunkschipe
 The greteste of the felaschipe
 Were oute of reson overtake;
 And Venus, which hath also take
 500 The cause most in special,
 Hath yove hem drinke forth withal⁷⁵⁴
 Of thilke cuppe which exciteth
 510 The lust wherinne a man deliteth:
 And thus be double weie drunke,
 Of lust that ilke fyri funke
 Hath mad hem, as who seith, halfwode,⁷⁵⁵
 That thei no reson understode,
 Ne to non other thing thei syhen,
 Bot hire, which tofore here yhen
 Was wedded thilke same day,
 That freisshe wif, that lusti May,
 On hire it was al that thei thoghten.⁷⁵⁶
 520 And so ferforth here lustes soghten,
 That thei the whiche named were
 Centauri, ate feste there
 Of on assent, of on acord
 This yonge wif malgre hire lord
 In such a rage awei forth ladden,
 As thei whiche non insihte hadden
 Bot only to her drunke fare,
 Which many a man hath mad misfare
 In love als wel as other weie.
 530 Wherof, if I schal more seie
 Upon the nature of the vice,⁷⁵⁷
 Of custume and of excercise
 The mannes grace hou it fordoth,
 A tale, which was whilom soth,

formositatem
 aspicientes, duplici
 ebrietate
 insanierunt, ita
 quod ipsi subito
 salientes a mensa
 Ipotaciam a
 Pirothoo marito
 suo in⁷⁵² impetu
 rapuerunt.

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 19

Of fooles that so drunken were,
I schal reherce unto thine Ere.

I rede in a Cronique thus
Of Galba and of Vitellus,
The whiche of Spaigne bothe were
540 The greteste of alle othre there,
And bothe of o condicion
After the disposicion
Of glotonie and drunkschipe. [759](#)
That was a sori felaschipe:
For this thou miht wel understonde,
That man mai wel noght longe stonde
Which is wyndrunke of comun us;
For he hath lore the vertus,
Wherof reson him scholde clothe;
550 And that was seene upon hem bothe.
Men sein ther is non evidence,
Wherof to knowe a difference
Betwen the drunken and the wode,
For thei be nevere nouthur goode; [761](#)
For wher that wyn doth wit aweie,
Wisdom hath lost the rihte weie,
That he no maner vice dredeth;
Nomore than a blind man thredeth
His nedle be the Sonnes lyht, [762](#)
Nomore is reson thanne of myht,
Whan he with drunkschipe is blent.
And in this point thei weren schent,
560 This Galba bothe and ek Vitelle,
Upon the cause as I schal telle,
Wherof good is to taken hiede.
For thei tuo thurgh her drunkenhiede
Of witles excitacioun
Oppressede al the nacion
Of Spaigne; for of fool usance, [763](#)
570 Which don was of continuance

[GALBA AND
VITELLIUS.]

Hic loquitur
specialiter contra
viciū illorum, qui
nimia potacione
quasi ex
consuetudine
ebriosi efficiuntur.
Et narrat
exemplum de
Galba et Vitello,
qui potentes in
Hispania principes
fuerunt, set ipsi
cotidiane ebrietatis
potibus assueti,
tanta vicinis
intulerunt enormia,
quod tandem [760](#)
toto conclamante
populo pena
sentencie capitalis
in eos iudicialiter
diffinita est: qui
priusquam
morerentur, vt
penam mortis
alleuiarent,
spontanea vini
ebrietate sopiti,
quasi porci
semimortui gladio
interierunt. [758](#)

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20

Of hem, whiche alday drunken were,
 Ther was no wif ne maiden there,
 What so thei were, or faire or foule,
 Whom thei ne token to defoule,
 Wherof the lond was often wo:
 And ek in othre thinges mo
 Thei wroghten many a sondri wrong.
 Bot hou so that the dai be long,
 The derke nyht comth ate laste:
 580 God wolde noght thei scholden laste,
 And schop the lawe in such a wise,
 That thei thurgh dom to the juise
 Be dampned forto be forlore.
 Bot thei, that hadden ben tofore
 Enclin to alle drunkenesse,—
 Here ende thanne bar witnesse;
 For thei in hope to assuage
 The peine of deth, upon the rage
 That thei the lasse scholden fiele,
 590 Of wyn let fille full a Miele, [764](#)
 And dronken til so was befall
 That thei her strengthes losten alle
 Withouten wit of eny brain;
 And thus thei ben halfdede slain,
 That hem ne grieveth bot a lyte.
 Mi Sone, if thou be forto wyte
 In eny point which I have seid,
 Wherof thi wittes ben unteid,
 I rede clepe hem hom ayein. [765](#)
 600 I schal do, fader, as ye sein,
 Als ferforth as I mai suffise:
 Bot wel I wot that in no wise
 The drunkeschipe of love aweie
 I mai remue be no weie,
 It stant noght upon my fortune.
 Bot if you liste to comune
 Of the seconde Glotonie,

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 21

Confessor.

Amans.

Which cleped is Delicacie,
Wherof ye spieken hier tofore,
610 Beseche I wolde you therfore.

Mi Sone, as of that ilke vice,
Which of alle othre is the Norrice,
And stant upon the retenue
Of Venus, so as it is due,
The proprete hou that it fareth
The bok hierafter nou declareth.

Confessor.

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ii. *Delicie cum diuiciis sunt iura
potentum,*

[DELICACY.]

*In quibus orta Venus excitat ora gule.
Non sunt delicie tales, que corpora pascunt,
Ex quibus impletus gaudia venter agit,
Quin completus amor maiori munere gaudet,
Cum data deliciis mens in amante satur.*⁷⁶⁶

Of this chapitre in which we trete
There is yit on of such diete,
To which no povere mai atteigne;
620 For al is Past of paindemeine⁷⁶⁹
And sondri wyn and sondri drinke,
Wherof that he wole ete and drinke:
Hise cokes ben for him affaited,
So that his body is awaited,
That him schal lacke no delit,
Als ferforth as his appetit
Sufficeth to the metes hote.
Wherof this lusti vice is hote
Of Gule the Delicacie,
630 Which al the hole progenie
Of lusti folk hath undertake
To feede, whil that he mai take
Richesses wherof to be founde:⁷⁷⁰
Of Abstinence he wot no bounde,
To what profit it scholde serve.

Hic tractat super
illa specie Gule
que Delicacia
nuncupatur, cuius
mollicies⁷⁶⁷
voluptuose carni in
personis precipue
potentibus
queque⁷⁶⁸
complacencia
corporaliter
ministrat.

And yit phisique of his conserve
 Makth many a restauracioun
 Unto his recreacioun,
 Which wolde be to Venus lief.
 640 Thus for the point of his relief
 The coc which schal his mete arraie,
 Bot he the betre his mouth assaie,
 His lordes thonk schal ofte lese,
 Er he be served to the chese:
 For ther mai lacke noght so lyte,
 That he ne fint anon a wyte;
 For bot his lust be fully served,⁷⁷¹
 Ther hath no wiht his thonk deserved.
 And yit for mannes sustenance,
 650 To kepe and holde in governance,
 To him that wole his hele gete
 Is non so good as comun mete:
 For who that loketh on the bokes,⁷⁷²
 It seith, confeccion of cokes,
 A man him scholde wel avise
 Hou he it toke and in what wise.
 For who that useth that he knoweth,
 Ful selden seknesse on him groweth,
 And who that useth metes strange,
 660 Though his nature empeire and change
 It is no wonder, lieve Sone,
 Whan that he doth ayein his wone;
 For in Phisique this I finde,
 Usage is the seconde kinde.⁷⁷³
 And riht so changeth his astat⁷⁷⁴
 He that of love is delicat:
 For though he hadde to his hond
 The beste wif of al the lond,
 Or the faireste love of alle,
 670 Yit wolde his herte on othre falle
 And thenke hem mor delicious
 Than he hath in his oghne hous:

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 23

Philosophus.
 Consuetudo est
 altera natura.

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 24

[LOVE-DELICACY.]

Men sein it is nou ofte so;⁷⁷⁵
Avisé hem wel, thei that so do.
And forto speke in other weie,
Fulofte time I have herd seie,
That he which hath no love achieved,
Him thenkth that he is noght relieved,
Thogh that his ladi make him chiere,
680 So as sche mai in good manere
Hir honour and hir name save,⁷⁷⁶
Bot he the surplus mihte have.
Nothing withstondende hire astat,
Of love more delicat
He set hire chiere at no delit,
Bot he have al his appetit.⁷⁷⁷
Mi Sone, if it be with thee so,
Tell me.

Myn holi fader, no:
For delicat in such a wise
690 Of love, as ye to me devise,
Ne was I nevere yit gultif;
For if I hadde such a wif
As ye speke of, what scholde I more?
For thanne I wolde neveremore
For lust of eny wommanhiede
Myn herte upon non other fiede:
And if I dede, it were a wast.
Bot al withoute such repast
Of lust, as ye me tolde above,
700 Of wif, or yit of other love,
I faste, and mai no fode gete;
So that for lacke of deinte mete,
Of which an herte mai be fedd,
I go fastende to my bedd.
Bot myhte I geten, as ye tolde,
So mochel that mi ladi wolde
Me fede with hir glad semblant,
Though me lacke al the remenant,

Confessio Amantis.

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Yit scholde I somdel ben abeched
 710 And for the time wel refreched.
 Bot certes, fader, sche ne doth;
 For in good feith, to telle soth,
 I trowe, thogh I scholde sterve,
 Sche wolde noght hire yhe swerve,
 Min herte with o goodly lok⁷⁷⁸
 To fede, and thus for such a cok
 I mai go fastinge everemo:
 Bot if so is that eny wo
 Mai fede a mannes herte wel,
 720 Therof I have at every meel
 Of plente more than ynowh;
 Bot that is of himself so towh,
 Mi stomac mai it noght defie.
 Lo, such is the delicacie
 Of love, which myn herte fedeth;
 Thus have I lacke of that me nedeth.

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Bot for al this yit natheles
 I seie noght I am gylteles,
 That I somdel am delicat:
 730 For elles were I fulli mat,
 Bot if that I som lusti stounde
 Of confort and of ese founde,
 To take of love som repast;
 For thogh I with the fulle tast⁷⁷⁹
 The lust of love mai noght fiele,
 Min hunger otherwise I kiele
 Of smale lustes whiche I pike,
 And for a time yit thei like;
 If that ye wisten what I mene.
 740 Nou, goode Sone, schrif thee clene
 Of suche deyntes as ben goode,
 Wherof thou takst thin hertes fode.

Confessor.

Mi fader, I you schal reherce,
 Hou that mi fodes ben diverse,
 So as thei fallen in degre.

Confessio Amantis.

O fiedinge is of that I se,⁷⁸⁰
 An other is of that I here,
 The thridde, as I schal tellen here,
 It groweth of min oghne thocht:
 750 And elles scholde I live noght;
 For whom that failleth fode of herte,⁷⁸¹
 He mai noght wel the deth asterte.
 Of sihte is al mi ferste fode,
 Thurgh which myn yhe of alle goode
 Hath that to him is acordant,
 A lusti fode sufficient.
 Whan that I go toward the place
 Wher I schal se my ladi face,
 Min yhe, which is loth to faste,
 760 Beginth to hungre anon so faste,
 That him thenkth of on houre thre,
 Til I ther come and he hire se:⁷⁸²
 And thanne after his appetit
 He takth a fode of such delit,
 That him non other deynte nedeth.
 Of sondri sihtes he him fedeth:
 He seth hire face of such colour,
 That freisshere is than eny flour,
 He seth hire front is large and plein
 770 Withoute frounce of eny grein,
 He seth hire yhen lich an hevene,
 He seth hire nase strauht and evene,
 He seth hire rode upon the cheke,
 He seth hire rede lippes eke,
 Hire chyn acordeth to the face,
 Al that he seth is full of grace,
 He seth hire necke round and clene,
 Therinne mai no bon be sene,
 He seth hire handes faire and whyte;
 780 For al this thing without wyte
 He mai se naked ate leste,
 So is it wel the more feste

Nota qualiter visus
 in amore se
 continet delicatus.

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 27

And wel the mor Delicacie
 Unto the fiedinge of myn yhe.⁷⁸³
 He seth hire schapthe forth withal,⁷⁸⁴
 Hire bodi round, hire middel smal,
 So wel begon with good array,
 Which passeth al the lust of Maii,
 Whan he is most with soft schoures
 790 Ful clothed in his lusti floures.
 With suche sihtes by and by
 Min yhe is fed; bot finaly,
 Whan he the port and the manere
 Seth of hire wommanysshe chere,
 Than hath he such delice on honde,
 Him thenkth he mihte stille stonde,
 And that he hath ful sufficance
 Of liflode and of sustenance
 As to his part for everemo.
 800 And if it thoghte alle othre so,
 Fro thenne wolde he nevere wende,
 Bot there unto the worldes ende
 He wolde abyde, if that he mihte,
 And fieden him upon the syhte.
 For thogh I mihte stonden ay
 Into the time of domesday
 And loke upon hire evere in on,
 Yit whanne I scholde fro hire gon,
 Min yhe wolde, as thogh he faste,
 810 Ben hungerstorven al so faste,
 Til efte ayein that he hire syhe.
 Such is the nature of myn yhe:
 Ther is no lust so deintefull,
 Of which a man schal noght be full,
 Of that the stomac underfongeth,
 Bot evere in on myn yhe longeth:
 For loke hou that a goshawk tireth,
 Riht so doth he, whan that he pireth
 And toteth on hire wommanhiede;

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820 For he mai nevere fulli fiede
His lust, bot evere aliche sore
Him hungreth, so that he the more
Desireth to be fed algate:
And thus myn yhe is mad the gate,
Thurgh which the deyntes of my thoght
Of lust ben to myn herte broght.

Riht as myn yhe with his lok⁷⁸⁵
Is to myn herte a lusti coc
Of loves fode delicat,

830 Riht so myn Ere in his astat,
Wher as myn yhe mai noght serve,
Can wel myn hertes thonk deserve
And fieden him fro day to day
With suche deyntes as he may.
For thus it is, that overal,
Wher as I come in special,
I mai hiere of mi ladi pris;

Qualiter auris in
amore delectatur.

I hiere on seith that sche is wys,⁷⁸⁶
An other seith that sche is good,
840 And som men sein, of worthi blod
That sche is come, and is also⁷⁸⁷
So fair, that nawher is non so;
And som men preise hire goodli chiere:
Thus every thing that I mai hiere,
Which souneth to mi ladi goode,
Is to myn Ere a lusti foode.

P. iii.
30

And ek min Ere hath over this
A deynte feste, whan so is
That I mai hiere hirselve speke;
850 For thanne anon mi faste I breke
On suche wordes as sche seith,
That full of trouthe and full of feith
Thei ben, and of so good desport,
That to myn Ere gret confort
Thei don, as thei that ben delices.
For al the metes and the spices,⁷⁸⁸

That eyn Lombard couthe make,
Ne be so lusti forto take
Ne so ferforth restauratif,
860 I seie as for myn oghne lif,
As ben the wordes of hire mouth:
For as the wyndes of the South
Ben most of alle debonaire,
So whan hir list to speke faire,
The vertu of hire goodly speche
Is verrailly myn hertes leche.
And if it so befalle among,
That sche carole upon a song,
Whan I it hiere I am so fedd,
870 That I am fro miself so ledd,
As thogh I were in paradis;
For certes, as to myn avis,
Whan I here of hir vois the stevene,
Me thenkth it is a blisse of hevene.

And ek in other wise also
Fulofte time it falleth so,
Min Ere with a good pitance
Is fedd of redinge of romance
Of Ydoine and of Amadas,
880 That whilom weren in mi cas,
And eke of othre many a score,
That loveden longe er I was bore.
For whan I of here loves rede,
Min Ere with the tale I fede;
And with the lust of here histoire
Somtime I drawe into memoire
Hou sorwe mai noght evere laste;
And so comth hope in ate laste,
Whan I non other fode knowe.
890 And that endureth bot a throwe,
Riht as it were a cherie feste;
Bot forto compten ate leste, [789](#)
As for the while yit it eseth

And somdel of myn herte appeseth:
For what thing to myn Ere spreadeth,
Which is plesant, somdel it feedeth
With wordes suche as he mai gete
Mi lust, in stede of other mete.

Lo thus, mi fader, as I seie, ⁷⁹⁰

Amans.

900 Of lust the which myn yhe hath seie,
And ek of that myn Ere hath herd,
Fulofte I have the betre ferd.

And tho tuo bringen in the thridde,
The which hath in myn herte amidde
His place take, to arraie

The lusti fode, which assaie ⁷⁹¹

I mot; and nameliche on nyhtes,
Whan that me lacketh alle sihtes,
And that myn heringe is aweie,

910 Thanne is he redy in the weie
Mi reresouper forto make,
Of which myn hertes fode I take.

This lusti cokes name is hote
Thoght, which hath evere hise pottes hote
Of love buillende on the fyr
With fantasie and with desir,
Of whiche er this fulofte he fedde
Min herte, whanne I was abedde;
And thanne he set upon my bord

Qualiter cogitatus
impressiones
leticie
ymaginatuias
cordibus inserit
amantum.

920 Bothe every syhte and every word
Of lust, which I have herd or sein.
Bot yit is noght mi feste al plein,
Bot al of woldes and of wisshes,
Therof have I my fulle disshes,
Bot as of fieling and of tast,
Yit mihte I nevere have o repast.

And thus, as I have seid afor, ⁷⁹²

I licke hony on the thorn, ⁷⁹³

And as who seith, upon the bridel

930 I chiewe, so that al is ydel

As in effect the fode I have.
Bot as a man that wolde him save,
Whan he is sek, be medicine,
Riht so of love the famine
I fonde in al that evere I mai
To fiede and dryve forth the day,
Til I mai have the grete feste,
Which al myn hunger myhte areste.

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33

Lo suche ben mi lustes thre;
940 Of that I thenke and hiere and se
I take of love my fiedinge
Withoute tastinge or fieling:
And as the Plover doth of Eir
I live, and am in good espeir
That for no such delicacie
I trowe I do no glotonie.⁷⁹⁴
And natheles to youre avis,
Min holi fader, that be wis,
I recomande myn astat
950 Of that I have be delicat.

Confessor.

Mi Sone, I understonde wel
That thou hast told hier everydel,
And as me thenketh be thi tale,
It ben delices wonder smale,
Wherof thou takst thi loves fode.
Bot, Sone, if that thou understode
What is to ben delicious,
Thou woldest noght be curious
Upon the lust of thin astat
960 To ben to sore delicat,
Wherof that thou reson excede:
For in the bokes thou myht rede,
If mannes wisdom schal be suied,
It oghte wel to ben eschuiet⁷⁹⁵
In love als wel as other weie;
For, as these holi bokes seie,
The bodely delices alle

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34

[DELICACY.]

In every point, hou so thei falle,
Unto the Soule don grievance.
970 And forto take in remembrance,
A tale acordant unto this,
Which of gret understandinge is
To mannes soule resonable,⁷⁹⁶
I thenke telle, and is no fable.

Delicie corporis
militant aduersus
animam.

Of Cristes word, who wole it rede,
Hou that this vice is forto drede
In thevangile it telleth plein,
Which mot algate be certein,
For Crist himself it berth witnesse.
980 And thogh the clerk and the clergesse
In latin tunge it rede and singe,
Yit for the more knowlechinge
Of trouthe, which is good to wite,
I schal declare as it is write
In Engleissh, for thus it began.

[DIVES AND
LAZARUS.]

Hic ponit
exemplum contra
istos delicatos. Et
narrat de diuite et
Lazaro, quorum
gestus⁷⁹⁷ in
euangelio Lucas
euidencius
describit.

Crist seith: 'Ther was a riche man,
A mihti lord of gret astat,
And he was ek so delicat⁷⁹⁸
Of his clothing, that everyday
990 Of pourpre and bisse he made him gay,
And eet and drank therto his fille
After the lustes of his wille,
As he which al stod in delice⁷⁹⁹
And tok non hiede of thilke vice.
And as it scholde so betyde,
A povere lazre upon a tyde
Cam to the gate and axed mete:
Bot there mihte he nothing gete⁸⁰⁰
His dedly hunger forto stanche;
1000 For he, which hadde his fulle panche
Of alle lustes ate bord,
Ne deigneth noght to speke a word,
Onliche a Crumme forto yive,

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35

Wherof the povere myhte live⁸⁰¹
 Upon the yifte of his almesse.
 Thus lai this povere in gret destresse⁸⁰²
 Acold and hungred ate gate,
 Fro which he mihte go no gate,⁸⁰³
 So was he wofulli besein.
 1010 And as these holi bokes sein,⁸⁰⁴
 The houndes comen fro the halle,
 Wher that this sike man was falle,
 And as he lay ther forto die,
 The woundes of his maladie
 Thei licken forto don him ese.
 Bot he was full of such desese,
 That he mai noght the deth eschape;
 Bot as it was that time schape,
 The Soule fro the bodi passeth,
 1020 And he whom nothing overpasseth,
 The hihe god, up to the hevene
 Him tok, wher he hath set him evene
 In Habrahammes barm on hyh,⁸⁰⁵
 Wher he the hevene joie syh
 And hadde al that he have wolde.
 And fell, as it befalle scholde,
 This riche man the same throwe⁸⁰⁶
 With soudein deth was overthrowe,
 And forth withouten eny wente
 1030 Into the helle straght he wente;⁸⁰⁷
 The fend into the fyr him drouh,
 Wher that he hadde peine ynouh
 Of flamme which that evere brenneth.
 And as his yhe aboute renneth,
 Toward the hevene he cast his lok,
 Wher that he syh and hiede tok
 Hou Lazar set was in his Se
 Als ferr as evere he mihte se
 With Habraham; and thanne he preide

1040Unto the Patriarch and seide:
 “Send Lazar doun fro thilke Sete,
 And do that he his finger wete
 In water, so that he mai droppe
 Upon my tunge, forto stoppe
 The grete hete in which I brenne.”
 Bot Habraham answerde thenne
 And seide to him in this wise:
 “Mi Sone, thou thee miht avise⁸⁰⁸
 And take into thi remembrance,
 1050Hou Lazar hadde gret penance,
 Whyl he was in that other lif,
 Bot thou in al thi lust jolif
 The bodily delices soghtest:
 Forthi, so as thou thanne wroghtest,
 Nou schalt thou take thi reward
 Of dedly peine hierafterward
 In helle, which schal evere laste;
 And this Lazar nou ate laste
 The worldes peine is overronne,
 1060In hevene and hath his lif begonne
 Of joie, which is endeles.
 Bot that thou preidest natheles,
 That I schal Lazar to the sende
 With water on his finger ende,
 Thin hote tunge forto kiele,
 Thou schalt no suche graces fiele;
 For to that foule place of Sinne,
 For evere in which thou schalt ben inne,
 Comth non out of this place thider,
 1070Ne non of you mai comen hider;
 Thus be yee parted nou atuo.”
 The riche ayeinward cride tho:
 “O Habraham, sithe it so is,
 That Lazar mai noght do me this
 Which I have axed in this place,
 I wolde preie an other grace.

For I have yit of brethren fyve,
That with mi fader ben alyve
Togedre duellende in on hous;
1080 To whom, as thou art gracious,
I preie that thou woldest sende
Lazar, so that he mihte wende
To warne hem hou the world is went,
That afterward thei be noght schent
Of suche peines as I drye.⁸⁰⁹
Lo, this I preie and this I crie,
Now I may noght miself amende.”

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38

The Patriarch anon suiende
To his preiere ansuerde nay;⁸¹⁰
1090 And seide him hou that everyday
His brethren mihten knowe and hierre
Of Moïses on Erthe hierre
And of prophetes othere mo,
What hem was best. And he seith no;
Bot if ther mihte a man aryse
Fro deth to lyve in such a wise,
To tellen hem hou that it were,
He seide hou thanne of pure fere⁸¹¹
Thei scholden wel be war therby.
1100 Quod Habraham: “Nay sikerly;⁸¹²
For if thei nou wol noght obeie
To suche as techen hem the weie,
And alday preche and alday telle
Hou that it stant of hevene and helle,
Thei wol noght thanne taken hiede,⁸¹³
Thogh it befelle so in dede
That eny ded man were arered,⁸¹⁴
To ben of him no betre lered
Than of an other man alyve.”⁸¹⁵
1110 If thou, mi Sone, canst descryve
This tale, as Crist himself it tolde,
Thou schalt have cause to beholde,⁸¹⁶

Confessor.

To se so gret an evidence,
 Wherof the sothe experience
 Hath schewed openliche at ye,
 That bodili delicacie
 Of him which yeveth non almesse
 Schal after falle in gret destresse.
 And that was sene upon the riche:
 1120 For he ne wolde unto his liche
 A Crumme yiven of his bred,
 Thanne afterward, whan he was ded,
 A drope of water him was werned.
 Thus mai a mannes wit be lerned
 Of hem that so delices taken;
 Whan thei with deth ben overtaken,
 That erst was swete is thanne sour.
 Bot he that is a governour
 Of worldes good, if he be wys,
 1130 Withinne his herte he set no pris
 Of al the world, and yit he useth
 The good, that he nothing refuseth,
 As he which lord is of the thinges.
 The Nouches and the riche ringes,
 The cloth of gold and the Perrie
 He takth, and yit delicacie
 He leveth, thogh he were al this.
 The beste mete that ther is
 He ett, and drinkth the beste drinke;
 1140 Bot hou that evere he ete or drinke,
 Delicacie he put aweie,
 As he which goth the rihte weie
 Noght only forto fiede and clothe
 His bodi, bot his soule bothe.
 Bot thei that taken otherwise
 Here lustes, ben none of the wise;
 And that whilom was schewed eke,
 If thou these olde bokes seke,
 Als wel be reson as be kinde,

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P. iii.
 40

1150 Of olde ensample as men mai finde.

What man that wolde him wel advise,⁸¹⁸

[DELICACY OF
NERO.]

Delicacie is to despise,

Whan kinde acordeth noght withal;

Wherof ensample in special

Of Nero whilom mai be told,

Which ayein kinde manyfold

Hise lustes tok, til ate laste

That god him wolde al overcaste;

Of whom the Cronique is so plein,

Hic loquitur de
delicacia Neronis,
qui corporalibus
deliciis magis
adherens spiritalia
gaudia minus⁸¹⁹
obtinuit.

1160 Me list nomore of him to sein.

And natheles for glotonie

Of bodili Delicacie,

To knowe his stomak hou it ferde,

Of that noman tofore herde,

Which he withinne himself bethoghte,

A wonder soubtil thing he wroghte.

Thre men upon eleccioun

Of age and of complexioun

Lich to himself be alle weie

1170 He tok towards him to pleie,

And ete and drinke als wel as he.

Therof was no diversite;

For every day whan that thei eete,

Tofore his oghne bord thei seete,

And of such mete as he was served,

Although thei hadde it noght deserved,

Thei token service of the same.

Bot afterward al thilke game

Was into wofull earnest torned;

1180 For whan thei weren thus sojourned,

Withinne a time at after mete

Nero, which hadde noght foryete

The lustes of his frele astat,

As he which al was delicat,

To knowe thilke experience,

P. iii.
41

The men let come in his presence:⁸²⁰
 And to that on the same tyde,
 A courser that he scholde ryde
 Into the feld, anon he bad;
 1190Wherof this man was wonder glad,
 And goth to prike and prance aboute.
 That other, whil that he was oute,
 He leide upon his bedd to slepe:
 The thridde, which he wolde kepe
 Withinne his chambre, faire and softe
 He goth now down nou up fulofte,
 Walkende a pass, that he ne slepte,
 Til he which on the courser lepte
 Was come fro the field ayein.
 1200Nero thanne, as the bokes sein,
 These men doth taken alle thre
 And slouh hem, for he wolde se
 The whos stomak was best defied:
 And whanne he hath the sothe tryed,
 He fond that he which goth the pass
 Defyed best of alle was,
 Which afterward he usede ay.
 And thus what thing unto his pay
 Was most plesant, he lefte non:⁸²¹
 1210With every lust he was begon,
 Wherof the bodi myhte glade,
 For he non abstinence made;
 Bot most above alle erthli thinges
 Of wommen unto the likinges
 Nero sette al his hole herte,
 For that lust scholde him noght asterte.
 Whan that the thirst of love him cawhte,
 Wher that him list he tok a drauhte,
 He spareth nouter wif ne maide,
 1220That such an other, as men saide,
 In al this world was nevere yit.
 He was so drunke in al his wit

Thurgh sondri lustes whiche he tok,
That evere, whil ther is a bok,
Of Nero men schul rede and singe
Unto the worldes knowlechinge,
Mi goode Sone, as thou hast herd.
For evere yit it hath so ferd,
Delicacie in loves cas

[LOVE-DELICACY.]

1230 Without reson is and was;⁸²²
For wher that love his herte set,
Him thenkth it myhte be no bet;
And thogh it be noght fulli mete,⁸²³
The lust of love is evere swete.

Lo, thus togedre of felaschipe
Delicacie and drunkschipe,
Wherof reson stant out of herre,
Have mad full many a wisman erre
In loves cause most of alle:

Confessor.

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43

1240 For thanne hou so that evere it falle,
Wit can no reson understonde,
Bot let the governance stonde
To Will, which thanne wext so wylde,
That he can noght himselve schylde
Fro no peril, bot out of feere⁸²⁴
The weie he secheth hiere and there,
Him recheth noght upon what syde:
For oftetime he goth beside,
And doth such thing withoute drede,

1250 Wherof him oghte wel to drede.
Bot whan that love assoteth sore,
It passeth alle mennes lore;
What lust it is that he ordeigneth,
Ther is no mannes miht restreigneth,⁸²⁵
And of the godd takth he non hiede:
Bot laweles withoute drede,
His pourpos for he wolde achieve⁸²⁶
Ayeins the pointz of the believe,

He tempteth hevene and erthe and helle,
1260Hierafterward as I schal telle.

iii. *Dum stimulat amor, quicquid iubet
orta voluptas,*

[SORCERY AND
WITCHCRAFT.]

*Audet et aggreditur, nulla timenda timens.
Omne quod astra queunt herbarum siue potestas,
Seu vigor inferni, singula temptat amans.
Quod nequit ipse deo mediante parare sinistrum,
Demonis hoc magica credulus arte parat.
Sic sibi non curat ad opus que recia tendit,
Dummodo nudatam prendere possit auem.*

Who dar do thing which love ne dar?

P. iii.

44

To love is every lawe unwar,
Bot to the lawes of his heste
The fisch, the foul, the man, the beste
Of al the worldes kinde louteth.
For love is he which nothing douteth;
In mannes herte where he sit, [827](#)
He compteth noght toward his wit
The wo nomore than the wele,

Hic tractat qualiter
Ebrietas et
Delicacia omnis
pudicie
contrarium
instigantes inter
alia ad carnalis
concupiscencie
promocionem
Sortilegio [827m](#)
magicam requirunt.

1270No mor the hete than the chele,
No mor the wete than the dreie,
No mor to live than to deie,
So that tofore ne behinde
He seth nothing, bot as the blinde
Withoute insyhte of his corage
He doth merveilles in his rage.
To what thing that he wole him drawe,
Ther is no god, ther is no lawe,
Of whom that he takth eny hiede;
1280Bot as Baiard the blinde stede,
Til he falle in the dich amide,
He goth ther noman wole him bidde;
He stant so ferforth out of reule,
Ther is no wit that mai him reule.

And thus to telle of him in soth,
 Ful many a wonder thing he doth,
 That were betre to be laft,
 Among the whiche is wicchecraft,
 That som men clepen Sorcerie,⁸²⁸
 1290 Which forto winne his druerie
 With many a circumstance he useth,
 Ther is no point which he refuseth.
 The craft which that Saturnus fond,
 To make prickes in the Sond,⁸³⁰
 That Geomance cleped is,
 Fulofte he useth it amis;
 And of the flod his Ydromance,
 And of the fyr the Piromance,
 With questions echon of tho
 1300 He tempteth ofte, and ek also
 Aëremance in juggement
 To love he bringth of his assent:
 For these craftes, as I finde,
 A man mai do be weie of kinde,
 Be so it be to good entente.
 Bot he goth al an other wente;
 For ratherer he scholde faile,
 With Nigromance he wole assaile
 To make his incantacioun
 1310 With hot subfumigacioun.
 Thilke art which Spatula is hote,
 And used is of comun rote⁸³¹
 Among Paiens, with that craft ek
 Of which is Auctor Thosz the Grek,
 He worcheth on and on be rowe:
 Razel is noght to him unknowe,
 Ne Salomones Candarie,⁸³²
 His Ydeac, his Eutonye;
 The figure and the bok withal⁸³³
 1320 Of Balamuz, and of Ghenbal⁸³⁴

P. iii.
 45

Nota de Auctorum
 necnon et de⁸²⁹
 librorum tam
 naturalis quam
 execrabilis magice
 nominibus.

The Seal, and therupon thymage
Of Thebith, for his advantage
He takth, and somewhat of Gibiere,
Which helplich is to this matiere.
Babilla with hire Sones sevene,
Which hath renonced to the hevene,
With Cernes bothe square and rounde,
He traceth ofte upon the grounde,
Makende his invocacioun;
1330 And for full enformacioun
The Scole which Honorius
Wrot, he poursuieth: and lo, thus
Magique he useth forto winne
His love, and spareth for no Sinne.
And over that of his Sotie,
Riht as he secheth Sorcerie
Of hem that ben Magiciens,
Riht so of the Naturiens
Upon the Sterres from above
1340 His weie he secheth unto love,
Als fer as he hem understondeth.
In many a sondry wise he fondeth:
He makth ymage, he makth sculpture,
He makth writinge, he makth figure,
He makth his calculacions,
He makth his demonstracions;
His houres of Astronomie
He kepeth as for that partie
Which longeth to thinspeccion
1350 Of love and his affeccion;
He wolde into the helle seche
The devel himselve to beseche,
If that he wiste forto spede,
To gete of love his lusti mede:
Wher that he hath his herte set,
He bede nevere fare bet
Ne wite of other hevene more.

Mi Sone, if thou of such a lore
 Hast ben er this, I red thee leve. [835](#)
 1360 Min holi fader, be youre leve
 Of al that ye have spoken hiere
 Which toucheth unto this matiere,
 To telle soth riht as I wene,
 I wot noght o word what ye mene.
 I wol noght seie, if that I couthe,
 That I nolde in mi lusti youthe
 Benethe in helle and ek above
 To winne with mi ladi love
 Don al that evere that I mihte;
 1370 For therof have I non insihte
 Wher afterward that I become,
 To that I wonne and overcome
 Hire love, which I most coveite.
 Mi Sone, that goth wonder streite:
 For this I mai wel telle soth,
 Ther is noman the which so doth,
 For al the craft that he can caste,
 That he nabeith it ate laste.
 For often he that wol beguile
 1380 Is guiled with the same guile,
 And thus the guilour is beguiled;
 As I finde in a bok compiled
 To this matiere an old histoire,
 The which comth nou to mi memoire,
 And is of gret essamplerie
 Ayein the vice of Sorcerie,
 Wherof non ende mai be good.
 Bot hou whilom therof it stod, [836](#)
 A tale which is good to knowe
 1390 To thee, mi Sone, I schal beknowe.

Confessor.

Amans.

Confessor.

P. iii.
48

Among hem whiche at Troie were, [837](#)
 Uluxes ate Siege there
 Was on be name in special;

[TALE OF ULYSSES
AND TELEGONUS.]

Of whom yit the memorial
 Abit, for whyl ther is a mouth,
 For evere his name schal be couth.
 He was a worthi knyht and king
 And clerk knowende of every thing;
 He was a gret rethorien,
 1400 He was a gret magicien;
 Of Tullius the rethorique,
 Of king Zorastes the magique,
 Of Tholome thastronomie,
 Of Plato the Philosophie,
 Of Daniel the slepi dremes,
 Of Neptune ek the water stremes,
 Of Salomon and the proverbes,
 Of Macer al the strengthe of herbes,
 And the Phisique of Ypocras,
 1410 And lich unto Pictagoras
 Of Surgerie he knew the cures.
 Bot somewhat of his adventures,
 Which schal to mi matiere acorde,
 Ter thee, mi Sone, I wol recorde.
 This king, of which thou hast herd sein,
 Fro Troie as he goth hom ayein
 Be Schipe, he fond the See divers,
 With many a wyndi storm revers.
 Bot he thurgh wisdom that he schapeth ⁸³⁸
 Ful many a gret peril ascapeth,
 1420 Of whiche I thenke tellen on,
 Hou that malgre the nedle and ston
 Wynddrive he was al soudeinly
 Upon the strondes of Cilly,
 Wher that he moste abyde a whyle.
 Tuo queenes weren in that yle
 Calipsa named and Circes;
 And whan they herde hou Uluxes
 Is loded ther upon the ryve,
 1430 For him thei senden als so blive.

Nota contra istos
 ob amoris causam
 sortilegos; vbi
 narrat in exemplum
 quod, cum Vluxe
 a subuersione Troie
 repatriare nauigio
 voluisset, ipsum in
 Insula Cilly, vbi
 illa expertissima
 maga nomine
 Circes regnauit,
 contigit
 applicuisse: quem
 vt in sui amoris
 concupiscenciam
 exardesceret,
 Circes omnibus
 suis
 incantacionibus
 vincere conabatur.
 Vluxe tamen
 magica potencior
 ipsam in amore
 subegit, ex qua
 filium nomine
 Thelogonum
 genuit, qui postea
 patrem suum
 interfecit: et sic
 contra fidei
 naturam genitus
 contra generacionis
 naturam
 patricidium
 operatus est.

P. iii.
 49

With him suche as he wolde he nam
And to the court to hem he cam.⁸³⁹
Thes queenes were as tuo goddesses
Of Art magique Sorceresses,
That what lord comth to that rivage,
Thei make him love in such a rage
And upon hem assote so,⁸⁴⁰
That thei wol have, er that he go,
Al that he hath of worldes good.

1440Uluxes wel this understod,
Thei couthe moche, he couthe more;
Thei schape and caste ayein him sore⁸⁴¹
And wroghte many a soutil wyle,
Bot yit thei mihte him noght beguile.⁸⁴²
Bot of the men of his navie
Thei tuo forschope a gret partie,
Mai non of hem withstonde here hestes;
Som part thei schopen into bestes,
Som part thei schopen into foules,
1450To beres, tigres, Apes, oules,
Or elles be som other weie;
Ther myhte hem nothing desobeie,
Such craft thei hadde above kinde.
Bot that Art couthe thei noght finde,
Of which Uluxes was deceived,
That he ne hath hem alle weyved,
And broght hem into such a rote,
That upon him thei bothe assote;
And thurgh the science of his art
1460He tok of hem so wel his part,
That he begat Circes with childe.
He kepte him sobre and made hem wilde,
He sette himselve so above,
That with here good and with here love,
Who that therof be lief or loth,
Al quit into his Schip he goth.
Circes toswolle bothe sides

He lefte, and waiteth on the tydes,
And straght thurghout the salte fom
1470He takth his cours and comth him hom,
Where as he fond Penolope;
A betre wif ther mai non be,
And yit ther ben ynowhe of goode.
Bot who hir goodschipe understode
Fro ferst that sche wifhode tok,
Hou many loves sche forsok
And hou sche bar hire al aboute,
Ther whiles that hire lord was oute,
He mihte make a gret avant⁸⁴³

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51

1480Amonges al the remenant
That sche was on of al the beste.⁸⁴⁴
Wel myhte he sette his herte in reste,
This king, whan he hir fond in hele;
For as he couthe in wisdom dele,
So couthe sche in wommanhiede:
And whan sche syh withoute drede
Hire lord upon his oghne ground,
That he was come sauf and sound,
In al this world ne mihte be⁸⁴⁵

1490A gladdere womman than was sche.
The fame, which mai noght ben hidd,
Thurghout the lond is sone kidd,
Here king is come hom ayein:
Ther mai noman the fulle sein,
Hou that thei weren alle glade,
So mochel joie of him thei made.
The presens every day be newed,
He was with yiftes al besnewed;
The poeple was of him so glad,

1500That thogh non other man hem bad,
Taillage upon hemself thei sette,
And as it were of pure dette
Thei yeve here goodes to the king:
This was a glad hom welcomyng.

P. iii.
52

Thus hath Uluxes what he wolde,
His wif was such as sche be scholde,
His poeple was to him sougit,
Him lacketh nothing of delit.

Bot fortune is of such a sleyhte,
1510 That whan a man is most on heyhte, [846](#)

Sche makth him rathest forto falle:
Ther wot noman what schal befall,
The happes over mannes hed
Ben honged with a tendre thred.
That proved was on Uluxes;

Oracius. Omnia [847](#)
sunt hominum
tenui pendencia
filo.

For whan he was most in his pes, [848](#)
Fortune gan to make him werre
And sette his welthe al out of herre. [849](#)
Upon a dai as he was merie,

1520 As thogh ther mihte him nothing derie, [850](#)

Whan nyht was come, he goth to bedde,
With slep and bothe his yhen fedde.
And while he slepte, he mette a swevene:

Him thoghte he syh a stature evene, [851](#)
Which brihtere than the sonne schon;

A man it semeth was it non,
Bot yit it was as in figure
Most lich to mannyssh creature,
Bot as of beaute hevenelich

1530 It was most to an Angel lich:

And thus betwen angel and man
Beholden it this king began,

And such a lust tok of the sihte,
That fain he wolde, if that he mihte,
The forme of that figure embrace;
And goth him forth toward the place, [852](#)

Wher he sih that ymage tho,
And takth it in his Armes tuo,
And it embraceth him ayein

1540 And to the king thus gan it sein:

‘Uluxes, understand wel this,
The tokne of oure aqueintance is
Hierafterward to mochel tene:
The love that is ous betuene,
Of that we nou such joie make,
That on of ous the deth schal take,
Whan time comth of destine;
It may non other wise be.’

Uluxes tho began to preie

1550 That this figure wolde him seie
What wyht he is that seith him so.
This wyht upon a spere tho
A pensel which was wel begon,
Embrouded, scheweth him anon:
Thre fisshes alle of o colour
In manere as it were a tour
Upon the pensel were wroght.
Uluxes kneu this tokne noght,
And preith to wite in som partie

1560 What thing it myhte signefie,
‘A signe it is,’ the wyht ansuerde,
‘Of an Empire:’ and forth he ferde
Al sodeinly, whan he that seide.

Uluxes out of slep abreide,
And that was riht ayein the day,
That lengere slepen he ne may.

Men sein, a man hath knowleching⁸⁵⁴
Save of himself of alle thing;
His oghne chance noman knoweth,

1570 Bot as fortune it on him throweth:
Was nevere yit so wys a clerk,
Which mihte knowe al goddes werk,
Ne the secret which god hath set
Ayein a man mai noght be let.
Uluxes, thogh that he be wys,
With al his wit in his avis,
The mor that he his swevene acompteth,

P. iii.
54

Bernardus. Plures
plura sciunt⁸⁵³ et
seipsos nesciunt.

The lasse he wot what it amonteth:
 For al his calculacion,
 1580 He seth no demonstracion
 Al pleinely forto knowe an ende;⁸⁵⁵
 Bot natheles hou so it wende,
 He dradde him of his oghne Sone.
 That makth him wel the more astone,
 And schop therfore anon withal,
 So that withinne castel wall
 Thelamachum his Sone he schette,
 And upon him strong warde he sette.
 The sothe further he ne knew,
 1590 Til that fortune him overthreu;
 Bot natheles for sikernesse,
 Wher that he mihte wite and gesse
 A place strengest in his lond,
 Ther let he make of lym and sond
 A strengthe where he wolde duelle;
 Was nevere man yit herde telle
 Of such an other as it was.
 And forto strengthe him in that cas,⁸⁵⁶
 Of al his lond the sekereste
 1600 Of servantz and the worthieste,
 To kepen him withinne warde,
 He sette his bodi forto warde;⁸⁵⁷
 And made such an ordinance,
 For love ne for aqueintance,
 That were it erly, were it late,
 Thei scholde lete in ate gate
 No maner man, what so betydde,
 Bot if so were himself it bidde.
 Bot al that myhte him noght availe,
 1610 For whom fortune wole assaile,
 Ther mai be non such resistance,
 Which mihte make a man defence;
 Al that schal be mot falle algate.
 This Circes, which I spak of late,

On whom Uluxes hath begete
A child, thogh he it have foryete,
Whan time com, as it was wone,
Sche was delivered of a Sone,
Which cleped is Thelogonus.

1620 This child, whan he was bore thus,
Aboute his moder to ful age,
That he can reson and langage,
In good astat was drawe forth:
And whan he was so mochel worth
To stonden in a mannes stede,
Circes his moder hath him bede
That he schal to his fader go,
And tolde him al togedre tho
What man he was that him begat.

1630 And whan Thelogonus of that
Was war and hath ful knowleching⁸⁵⁸
Hou that his fader was a king,
He preith his moder faire this,
To go wher that his fader is;
And sche him granteth that he schal,
And made him redi forth withal.
It was that time such usance,
That every man the conoiscance
Of his contre bar in his hond,

1640 Whan he wente into strange lond;
And thus was every man therfore
Wel knowe, wher that he was bore:
For espiaile and mistrowinges
They dede thanne suche thinges,
That every man mai other knowe.⁸⁵⁹
So it befell that ilke throwe
Thelogonus as in this cas;
Of his contre the signe was
Thre fisshes, whiche he scholde bere

1650 Upon the penon of a spere:
And whan that he was thus arraied

And hath his harneis al assaied,
That he was redy everydel,
His moder bad him farewel,
And seide him that he scholde swithe
His fader griete a thousand sithe.

Thelogonus his moder kiste
And tok his leve, and wher he wiste
His fader was, the weie nam,
1660 Til he unto Nachaie cam,
Which of that lond the chief Cite
Was cleped, and ther axeth he
Wher was the king and hou he ferde.
And whan that he the sothe herde,
Wher that the king Uluxes was,
Al one upon his hors gret pas
He rod him forth, and in his hond
He bar the signal of his lond
With fisshes thre, as I have told;⁸⁶⁰

1670 And thus he wente unto that hold,
Wher that his oghne fader duelleth.
The cause why he comth he telleth
Unto the kepers of the gate,
And wolde have comen in therate,
Bot schortli thei him seide nay:
And he als faire as evere he may
Besoghte and tolde hem ofte this,
Hou that the king his fader is;
Bot they with proude wordes grete

1680 Begunne to manace and threte,⁸⁶¹
Bot he go fro the gate faste,
Thei wolde him take and sette faste.
Fro wordes unto strokes thus
Thei felle, and so Thelogonus
Was sore hurt and welnyh ded;
Bot with his scharpe speres hed
He makth defence, hou so it falle,
And wan the gate upon hem alle,

And hath slain of the beste fyve;
 1690 And thei ascriden als so blyve
 Thurghout the castell al aboute. [862](#)
 On every syde men come oute,
 Wherof the kinges herte afflihte,
 And he with al the haste he mihte
 A spere cauhte and out he goth, [863](#)
 As he that was nyh wod for wroth. [864](#)
 He sih the gates ful of blod,
 Thelogonus and wher he stod
 He sih also, bot he ne knew
 1700 What man it was, and to him threw [865](#)
 His Spere, and he sterte out asyde.
 Bot destine, which schal betide,
 Befell that ilke time so,
 Thelogonus knew nothing tho
 What man it was that to him caste,
 And while his oghne spere laste,
 With al the signe therupon
 He caste unto the king anon,
 And smot him with a dedly wounde.
 1710 Uluxes fell anon to grounde;
 Tho every man, 'The king! the king!'
 Began to crie, and of this thing
 Thelogonus, which sih the cas,
 On knes he fell and seide, 'Helas!
 I have min oghne fader slain:
 Nou wolde I deie wonder fain, [866](#)
 Nou sle me who that evere wile,
 For certes it is riht good skile.' [867](#)
 He crith, he wepth, he seith therefore,
 1720 'Helas; that evere was I bore,
 That this unhappi destine
 So wofulli comth in be me!'
 This king, which yit hath lif ynouh,
 His herte ayein to him he drouh,

And to that vois an Ere he leide
 And understod al that he seide,
 And gan to speke, and seide on hih;
 'Bring me this man.' And whan he sih
 Thelogonus, his thoght he sette
 1730 Upon the swevene which he mette,
 And axeth that he myhte se
 His spere, on which the fisshes thre
 He sih upon a pensel wrought.⁸⁶⁸
 Tho wiste he wel it faileth noght,
 And badd him that he telle scholde⁸⁶⁹
 Fro whenne he cam and what he wolde.
 Thelogonus in sorghe and wo
 So as he mihte tolde tho
 Unto Uluxes al the cas,
 1740 Hou that Circes his moder was,
 And so forth seide him everydel,
 Hou that his moder gret him wel,
 And in what wise sche him sente.
 Tho wiste Uluxes what it mente,
 And tok him in hise Armes softe,
 And al bledende he kest him ofte,⁸⁷⁰
 And seide, 'Sone, whil I live,
 This infortune I thee foryive.'
 After his other Sone in haste
 1750 He sende, and he began him haste
 And cam unto his fader tyt.
 Bot whan he sih him in such plit,
 He wolde have ronne upon that other
 Anon, and slain his oghne brother,
 Ne hadde be that Uluxes
 Betwen hem made acord and pes,
 And to his heir Thelamachus
 He bad that he Thelogonus
 With al his pouer scholde kepe,
 1760 Til he were of his woundes depe
 Al hol, and thanne he scholde him yive

Lond wher upon he mihte live.
Thelamachus, whan he this herde,
Unto his fader he ansuerde
And seide he wolde don his wille.
So duelle thei togedre stille,
These brethren, and the fader sterveth.

Lo, wherof Sorcerie serveth.

Thurgh Sorcerie his lust he wan,
1770Thurgh Sorcerie his wo began,
Thurgh Sorcerie his love he ches,
Thurgh Sorcerie his lif he les;
The child was gete in Sorcerie,
The which dede al this felonie:
Thing which was ayein kynde wroght
Unkindeliche it was aboght;
The child his oghne fader slowh,
That was unkindeschipe ynowh.
Forthi tak hiede hou that it is,
1780So forto winne love amis,
Which endeth al his joie in wo:
For of this Art I finde also,
That hath be do for loves sake,
Wherof thou miht ensample take,
A gret Cronique imperial,
Which evere into memorial⁸⁷¹
Among the men, hou so it wende,⁸⁷²
Schal duelle to the worldes ende.

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The hihe creatour of thinges,
1790Which is the king of alle kinges,
Ful many a wonder worldes chance
Let slyden under his suffrance;
Ther wot noman the cause why,
Bot he the which is almyhty.
And that was proved whilom thus,
Whan that the king Nectanabus,
Which hadde Egipte forto lede,—

[TALE OF
NECTANABUS.]

Hic narrat
exemplum super
eodem, qualiter
Nectanabus ab
Egipto⁸⁷³ in
Macedoniam
fugitiuus,⁸⁷⁴
Olimpiadem
Philippi Regis

Bot for he sih tofor the dede
 Thurgh magique of his Sorcerie,
 1800Wherof he couthe a gret partie,
 Hise enemys to him comende,
 Fro whom he mihte him noght defende,
 Out of his oghne lond he fledde;
 And in the wise as he him dredde
 It fell, for al his wicchecraft,
 So that Egipte him was beraft,
 And he disguised fledde aweie
 Be schipe, and hield the rihte weie
 To Macedoine, wher that he
 Aryveth ate chief Cite.
 Thre yomen of his chambre there
 Al only forto serve him were,
 The whiche he trusteth wonder wel,
 For thei were trewe as eny stiel;
 And hapneth that thei with him ladde⁸⁷⁶

1810Part of the beste good he hadde.
 Thei take logginge in the toun⁸⁷⁷
 After the disposicion
 Wher as him thoghte best to duelle:

1820He axeth thanne and herde telle
 Hou that the king was oute go
 Upon a werre he hadde tho;
 But in that Cite thanne was
 The queene, which Olimpias
 Was hote, and with sollempnete
 The feste of hir nativite,
 As it befell, was thanne holde;
 And for hire list to be beholde⁸⁷⁸
 And preised of the poeple aboute,

1830Sche schop hir forto riden oute
 At after mete al openly.
 Anon were alle men redy,
 And that was in the monthe of Maii,
 This lusti queene in good arrai

ibidem tunc
 absentis vxorem
 arte magica
 decipiens, cum
 ipsa concubuit,
 magnumque ex ea
 Alexandrum
 sortilegus genuit:
 qui natus, postea
 cum ad
 erudiendum sub
 custodia Nectanabi
 commendatus
 fuisset, ipsum
 Nectanabum
 patrem suum ab
 altitudine
 cuiusdam turris in
 fossam profundam
 proiciens interfecit.
 Et sic sortilegus
 ex⁸⁷⁵ suo sortilegio
 infortunii sortem
 sortitus est.

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Was set upon a Mule whyt:
 To sen it was a gret delit
 The joie that the cite made;
 With freisshe thinges and with glade
 The noble toun was al behonged,
 1840 And every wiht was sore alonged
 To se this lusti ladi ryde.
 Ther was gret merthe on alle syde;
 Wher as sche passeth be the strete,
 Ther was ful many a tymber bete
 And many a maide carolende:
 And thus thurghout the toun pleiende
 This queene unto a pleine rod, [879](#)
 Wher that sche hoved and abod
 To se diverse game pleie,
 1850 The lusti folk jouste and tourneie;
 And so forth every other man,
 Which pleie couthe, his pley began,
 To plese with this noble queene.
 Nectanabus cam to the grene
 Amonges othre and drouh him nyh.
 Bot whan that he this ladi sih
 And of hir beaute hiede tok,
 He couthe noght withdrawe his lok
 To se noght elles in the field,
 1860 Bot stod and only hire behield.
 Of his clothinge and of his gere
 He was unlich alle othre there,
 So that it hapneth ate laste,
 The queene on him hire yhe caste,
 And knew that he was strange anon:
 Bot he behield hire evere in on
 Withoute blenchinge of his chere.
 Sche tok good hiede of his manere,
 And wondreth why he dede so,
 1870 And bad men scholde for him go.
 He cam and dede hire reverence,

And sche him axeth in cilence
 Fro whenne he cam and what he wolde.
 And he with sobre wordes tolde,
 And seith, 'Ma dame, a clerk I am,⁸⁸⁰
 To you and in message I cam,
 The which I mai noght tellen hiere;
 Bot if it liketh you to hiere,
 It mot be seid al prively,⁸⁸¹
 1880Wher non schal be bot ye and I.'
 Thus for the time he tok his leve.
 The dai goth forth til it was eve,
 That every man mot lete his werk,⁸⁸²
 And sche thoghte evere upon this clerk,
 What thing it is he wolde mene:
 And in this wise abod the queene,
 And passeth over thilke nyht,
 Til it was on the morwe liht.
 Sche sende for him, and he com,
 1890With him his Astellabre he nom,
 Which was of fin gold precious
 With pointz and cercles merveilous;
 And ek the hevenely figures
 Wroght in a bok ful of peintures
 He tok this ladi forto schewe,
 And tolde of ech of hem be rewe
 The cours and the condicion.
 And sche with gret affeccion
 Sat stille and herde what he wolde:
 1900And thus whan he sih time, he tolde,
 And feigneth with hise wordes wise
 A tale, and seith in such a wise:
 'Ma dame, bot a while ago,
 Wher I was in Egipte tho,
 And radde in scole of this science,
 It fell into mi conscience
 That I unto the temple wente,
 And ther with al myn hole entente

As I mi sacrifice dede,
 1910 On of the goddes hath me bede
 That I you warne prively,
 So that ye make you redy,
 And that ye be nothing agast;
 For he such love hath to you cast,
 That ye schul ben his oghne diere,
 And he schal be your beddefiere,
 Til ye conceive and be with childe.'
 And with that word sche wax al mylde,
 And somdel red becam for schame,
 1920 And axeth him that goddes name,
 Which so wol don hire compainie.
 And he seide, 'Amos of Lubie.'
 And sche seith, 'That mai I noght lieve,
 Bot if I sihe a betre prieve.'
 'Ma dame,' quod Nectanabus,
 'In tokne that it schal be thus,
 This nyht for enformacion
 Ye schul have an avision:
 That Amos schal to you appiere,
 1930 To schewe and teche in what manere
 The thing schal afterward befaller.⁸⁸³
 Ye oghten wel aboven alle
 To make joie of such a lord;
 For whan ye ben of on acord,
 He schal a Sone of you begete,
 Which with his swerd schal winne and gete
 The wyde world in lengthe and brede;
 Alle erthli kinges schull him drede,
 And in such wise, I you behote,⁸⁸⁴
 1940 The god of erthe he schal be hote.'
 'If this be soth,' tho quod the queene,
 'This nyht, thou seist, it schal be sene.
 And if it falle into mi grace,
 Of god Amos that I pourchace
 To take of him so gret worschipe,

I wol do thee such ladischipe,
 Wherof thou schalt for everemo
 Be riche.' And he hir thonketh tho,
 And tok his leve and forth he wente.
 1950Sche wiste litel what he mente,
 For it was guile and Sorcerie,
 Al that sche tok for Prophecie.
 Nectanabus thurghout the day,
 Whan he cam hom wher as he lay, [885](#)
 His chambre be himselve tok,
 And overtorneth many a bok,
 And thurgh the craft of Artemage
 Of wex he forgeth an ymage.
 He loketh his equacions
 1960And ek the constellacions,
 He loketh the conjunccions,
 He loketh the recepcions,
 His signe, his houre, his ascendent,
 And drawth fortune of his assent:
 The name of queene Olimpias
 In thilke ymage write was
 Amiddes in the front above.
 And thus to winne his lust of love
 Nectanabus this werk hath diht;
 1970And whan it cam withinne nyht,
 That every wyht is falle aslepe,
 He thoghte he wolde his time kepe,
 As he which hath his houre apointed.
 And thanne ferst he hath enoignted
 With sondri herbes that figure,
 And therupon he gan conjure,
 So that thurgh his enchantement
 This ladi, which was innocent
 And wiste nothing of this guile,
 1980Mette, as sche slepte thilke while,
 Hou fro the hevene cam a lyht,
 Which al hir chambre made lyht;

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And as sche loketh to and fro,
Sche sih, hir thoghte, a dragoun tho,
Whos scherdes schynen as the Sonne,
And hath his softe pas begonne
With al the chiere that he may
Toward the bedd ther as sche lay,
Til he cam to the beddes side.

1990 And sche lai stille and nothing cride,
For he dede alle his thinges faire
And was courteis and debonaire:
And as he stod hire fasteby, [886](#)
His forme he changeth sodeinly,
And the figure of man he nom,
To hire and into bedde he com, [887](#)
And such thing there of love he wroghte,
Wherof, so as hire thanne thoghte,
Thurgh likinge of this god Amos

2000 With childe anon hire wombe aros,
And sche was wonder glad withal.
Nectanabus, which causeth al
Of this metrede the substance,
Whan he sih time, his nigromance
He stinte and nothing more seide
Of his carecte, and sche abreide
Out of hir slep, and lieveth wel
That it is soth thanne everydel
Of that this clerk hire hadde told,

2010 And was the gladdere manyfold
In hope of such a glad metrede,
Which after schal befall in dede.

Sche longeth sore after the dai,
That sche hir swevene telle mai
To this guilour in privete,
Which kneu it als so wel as sche: [888](#)
And natheles on morwe sone
Sche lefte alle other thing to done,
And for him sende, and al the cas

2020Sche tolde him plainly as it was,
 And seide hou thanne wel sche wiste
 That sche his wordes mihte triste,
 For sche fond hire Avisioun
 Riht after the condicion
 Which he hire hadde told tofore;
 And preide him hertely therfore
 That he hire holde covenant
 So forth of al the remenant,
 That sche may thurgh his ordinance
 2030Toward the god do such plesance,⁸⁸⁹
 That sche wakende myhte him kepe
 In such wise as sche mette aslepe.
 And he, that couthe of guile ynouh,
 Whan he this herde, of joie he louh,
 And seith, 'Ma dame, it schal be do.
 Bot this I warne you therto:
 This nyht, whan that he comth to pleie,
 That ther be no lif in the weie
 Bot I, that schal at his likinge
 2040Ordeine so for his cominge,
 That ye ne schull noght of him faile.⁸⁹⁰
 For this, ma dame, I you consaile,
 That ye it kepe so prive,
 That no wiht elles bot we thre
 Have knowlechinge hou that it is;
 For elles mihte it fare amis,⁸⁹¹
 If ye dede oght that scholde him grieve.'
 And thus he makth hire to believe,
 And feigneth under guile feith:
 2050Bot natheles al that he seith
 Sche troweth; and ayein the nyht
 Sche hath withinne hire chambre dyht,
 Wher as this guilour faste by
 Upon this god schal prively
 Awaite, as he makth hire to wene:⁸⁹²
 And thus this noble gentil queene,

Whan sche most trusteth, was deceived.
 The nyht com, and the chambre is weyved,
 Nectanabus hath take his place,
 2060 And whan he sih the time and space,
 Thurgh the deceipte of his magique⁸⁹³
 He putte him out of mannes like,⁸⁹⁴
 And of a dragoun tok the forme,
 As he which wolde him al conforme
 To that sche sih in swevene er this;
 And thus to chambre come he is.
 The queene lay abedde and sih,
 And hopeth evere, as he com nyh,
 That he god of Luby were,
 2070 So hath sche wel the lasse fere.
 Bot for he wolde hire more assure,⁸⁹⁵
 Yit eft he changeth his figure,
 And of a wether the liknesse
 He tok, in signe of his noblesse
 With large hornes for the nones:
 Of fin gold and of riche stones
 A corone on his hed he bar,
 And soudeinly, er sche was war,
 As he which alle guile can,
 2080 His forme he torneth into man,
 And cam to bedde, and sche lai stille,
 Wher as sche soffreth al his wille,
 As sche which wende noght misdo.⁸⁹⁶
 Bot natheles it hapneth so,
 Althogh sche were in part deceived,
 Yit for al that sche hath conceived
 The worthieste of alle kiththe,
 Which evere was tofore or siththe
 Of conqueste and chivalerie;⁸⁹⁷
 2090 So that thurgh guile and Sorcerie
 Ther was that noble knyht begunne,⁸⁹⁸
 Which al the world hath after wunne.

Thus fell the thing which falle scholde,
 Nectanabus hath that he wolde;
 With guile he hath his love sped,
 With guile he cam into the bed,
 With guile he goth him out ayein:
 He was a schrewed chamberlein,
 So to beguile a worthi queene,
 2100 And that on him was after seene.
 Bot natheles the thing is do;
 This false god was sone go,
 With his decepte and hield him clos,
 Til morwe cam, that he aros.
 And tho, whan time and leisir was,
 The queene tolde him al the cas,
 As sche that guile non supposeth;
 And of tuo pointz sche him opposeth.
 On was, if that this god nomore
 2110 Wol come ayein, and overmore,
 Hou sche schal stonden in acord
 With king Philippe hire oghne lord,
 Whan he comth hom and seth hire grone.
 'Ma dame,' he seith, 'let me alone:
 As for the god I undertake
 That whan it liketh you to take
 His compaignie at eny throwe,
 If I a day tofore it knowe,
 He schal be with you on the nyht;
 2120 And he is wel of such a myht
 To kepe you from alle blame.
 Forthi conforte you, ma dame,
 Ther schal non other cause be.'
 Thus tok he leve and forth goth he,
 And tho began he forto muse
 Hou he the queene mihte excuse
 Toward the king of that is falle;
 And fond a craft amonges alle,
 Thurgh which he hath a See foul daunted,

2130 With his magique and so enchanted,
That he flyh forth, whan it was nyht,
Unto the kinges tente riht,
Wher that he lay amide his host:
And whanne he was aslepe most,
With that the See foul to him broghte
And othre charmes, whiche he wroghte⁸⁹⁹
At hom withinne his chambre stille,
The king he torneth at his wille,
And makth him forto dreame and se

2140 The dragoun and the privete
Which was betuen him and the queene.⁹⁰⁰
And over that he made him wene
In swevene, hou that the god Amos,
Whan he up fro the queene aros,
Tok forth a ring, wherinne a ston⁹⁰¹
Was set, and grave therupon
A Sonne, in which, whan he cam nyh,
A leoun with a swerd he sih;
And with that priente, as he tho mette,⁹⁰²

2150 Upon the queenes wombe he sette
A Seal, and goth him forth his weie.
With that the swevene wente aweie,
And tho began the king awake
And sigheth for his wyves sake,
Wher as he lay withinne his tente,⁹⁰³
And hath gret wonder what it mente.⁹⁰⁴

With that he hasteth him to ryse
Anon, and sende after the wise,
Among the whiche ther was on,

2160 A clerc, his name is Amphion:
Whan he the kinges swevene herde,
What it betokneth he ansuerde,
And seith, 'So siker as the lif,
A god hath leie be thi wif,
And gete a Sone, which schal winne

The world and al that is withinne.
As leon is the king of bestes,
So schal the world obeie his hestes,
Which with his swerd schal al be wonne,
2170Als ferr as schyneth eny Sonne.'

The king was doubtif of this dom;
Bot natheles, whan that he com
Ayein into his oghne lond,
His wif with childe gret he fond.
He mihte noght himselve stiere,
That he ne made hire hevy chiere;
Bot he which couthe of alle sorwe,
Nectanabus, upon the morwe
Thurgh the deceipte and nigromance
2180Tok of a dragoun the semblance,
And wher the king sat in his halle,
Com in rampende among hem alle
With such a noise and such a rore,
That thei agast were also sore
As thogh thei scholde deie anon.
And natheles he grieveth non,
Bot goth toward the deyss on hih;
And whan he cam the queene nyh,
He stinte his noise, and in his wise

2190To hire he profreth his servise,
And leith his hed upon hire barm;
And sche with goodly chiere hire arm
Aboute his necke ayeinward leide,
And thus the queene with him pleide
In sihte of alle men aboute.
And ate laste he gan to loute
And obeissance unto hire make,
As he that wolde his leve take;
And sodeinly his lothly forme
2200Into an Egle he gan transforme,
And flyh and sette him on a raile;
Wherof the king hath gret mervaile,

For there he pruneth him and piketh,
 As doth an hauk whan him wel liketh,
 And after that himself he schok,
 Wherof that al the halle quok,
 As it a terremote were;
 Thei seiden alle, god was there:
 In such a res and forth he flyh.
 2210 The king, which al this wonder syh,
 Whan he cam to his chambre alone,
 Unto the queene he made his mone⁹⁰⁵
 And of foryivenesse hir preide;
 For thanne he knew wel, as he seide,
 Sche was with childe with a godd.
 Thus was the king withoute rodd
 Chastised, and the queene excused
 Of that sche hadde ben accused.
 And for the gretere evidence,
 2220 Yit after that in the presence
 Of king Philipp and othre mo,
 Whan thei ride in the fieldes tho,
 A Phesant cam before here yhe,
 The which anon as thei hire syhe,
 Fleende let an ey down falle,
 And it tobrak tofore hem alle:⁹⁰⁶
 And as thei token therof kepe,
 Thei syhe out of the schelle crepe
 A litel Serpent on the ground,
 2230 Which rampeth al aboute round,
 And in ayein it wolde have wonne,⁹⁰⁷
 Bot for the brennyng of the Sonne
 It mihte noght, and so it deide.
 And therupon the clerkes seide,
 ‘As the Serpent, whan it was oute,
 Went envirooun the schelle aboute
 And mihte noght torne in ayein,
 So schal it fallen in certein:
 This child the world schal environe,

2240 And above alle the corone
 Him schal befalle, and in yong Age
 He schal desire in his corage,
 Whan al the world is in his hond,
 To torn ayein into the lond⁹⁰⁸
 Wher he was bore, and in his weie
 Homward he schal with puison deie.'
 The king, which al this sih and herde,⁹⁰⁹
 Fro that dai forth, hou so it ferde,
 His jalousie hath al foryete.
 2250 Bot he which hath the child begete,
 Nectanabus, in privete
 The time of his nativite
 Upon the constellacioun
 Awaiteth, and relacion
 Makth to the queene hou sche schal do,⁹¹⁰
 And every houre apointeth so,
 That no mynut therof was lore.⁹¹¹
 So that in due time is bore
 This child, and forth with therupon
 2260 Ther felle wondres many on
 Of terremote universiel:
 The Sonne tok colour of stiel
 And loste his lyht, the wyndes blewe,
 And manye strengthes overthrewe;
 The See his propre kinde changeth,
 And al the world his forme strangeth;
 The thonder with his fyri levene
 So cruel was upon the hevene,
 That every erthli creature
 2270 Tho thoghte his lif in aventure.
 The tempeste ate laste cesseth,
 The child is kept, his age encresseth,
 And Alisandre his name is hote,
 To whom Calistre and Aristote
 To techen him Philosophie
 Entenden, and Astronomie,

With othre thinges whiche he couthe
Also, to teche him in his youthe
Nectanabus tok upon honde.

2280 Bot every man mai understonde,
Of Sorcerie hou that it wende,
It wole himselve prove at ende,
And namely forto beguile
A lady, which withoute guile
Supposeth trouthe al that sche hiereth:
Bot often he that evele stiereth
His Schip is dreynt therinne amidde;
And in this cas riht so betidde.

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Nectanabus upon a nyht,
2290Whan it was fair and sterre lyht,
This yonge lord ladde up on hih
Above a tour, wher as he sih
The sterres suche as he acompteth,
And seith what ech of hem amonteth,
As thogh he knewe of alle thing;
Bot yit hath he no knowleching
What schal unto himself befalle.
Whan he hath told his wordes alle,
This yonge lord thanne him opposeth,[912](#)

2300And axeth if that he supposeth
What deth he schal himselve deie.[913](#)
He seith, 'Or fortune is aweie
And every sterre hath lost his wone,[914](#)
Or elles of myn oghne Sone
I schal be slain, I mai noght fle.'
Thoghte Alisandre in privete,
'Hierof this olde dotard lieth':
And er that other oght aspieth,
Al sodeinliche his olde bones

2310He schof over the wal at ones,
And seith him, 'Ly doun there apart:
Wherof nou serveth al thin art?
Thou knewe alle othre mennes chance

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And of thiself hast ignorance:⁹¹⁵

That thou hast seid amonges alle
Of thi persone, is noght befaller.'

Nectanabus, which hath his deth,
Yit while him lasteth lif and breth,
To Alisandre he spak and seide

2320 That he with wrong blame on him leide;

Fro point to point and al the cas

He tolde, hou he his Sone was.

Tho he, which sory was ynowh,

Out of the dich his fader drouh,

And tolde his moder hou it ferde

In conseil; and whan sche it herde

And kneu the toknes whiche he tolde,

Sche nyste what sche seie scholde,

Bot stod abayssht as for the while

2330 Of his magique and al the guile.

Sche thoghte hou that sche was deceived,⁹¹⁶

That sche hath of a man conceived,

And wende a god it hadde be.

Bot natheles in such degre,

So as sche mihte hire honour save,

Sche schop the body was begrave.

And thus Nectanabus aboghte

The Sorcerie which he wroghte:

Thogh he upon the creatures

2340 Thurgh his carectes and figures

The maistrie and the pouer hadde,

His creatour to noght him ladde,

Ayein whos lawe his craft he useth,

Whan he for lust his god refuseth,

And tok him to the dieules craft,⁹¹⁷

Lo, what profit him is belaft:

That thing thurgh which he wende have stonde,

Ferst him exilede out of londe

Which was his oghne, and from a king

2350 Made him to ben an underling;

And siththen to deceive a queene,
 That torneth him to mochel teene;
 Thurgh lust of love he gat him hate,
 That ende couthe he noght abate.
 His olde sleyhtes whiche he caste, [918](#)
 Yonge Alisaundre hem overcaste,
 His fader, which him misbegat, [919](#)
 He slouh, a gret mishap was that;
 Bot for o mis an other mys
 2360 Was yolde, and so fulofte it is;
 Nectanabus his craft miswente,
 So it misfell him er he wente.
 I not what helpeth that clergie
 Which makth a man to do folie,
 And nameliche of nigromance,
 Which stant upon the mescreance.
 And forto se more evidence,
 Zorastes, which thexperience
 Of Art magique ferst forth drouh,
 2370 Anon as he was bore, he louh,
 Which tokne was of wo suinge:
 For of his oghne controvinge
 He fond magique and tauhte it forth;
 Bot al that was him litel worth,
 For of Surrie a worthi king
 Him slou, and that was his endyng. [920](#)
 Bot yit thurgh him this craft is used,
 And he thurgh al the world accused,
 For it schal nevere wel achieve
 That stant noght riht with the believe:
 Bot lich to wolle is evele sponne,
 2380 Who lest himself hath litel wonne,
 An ende proveth every thing. [921](#)
 Saül, which was of Juys king,
 Up peine of deth forbad this art,
 And yit he tok therof his part.
 The Phitonesse in Samarie

[ZOROASTER.]

Nota qualiter Rex
 Zorastes, statim
 cum ab vtero
 matris sue
 nasceretur, gaudio
 magno risit; in quo
 prenosticum
 doloris
 subsequentis
 signum
 figurabatur: nam et
 ipse detestabilis
 magice primus fuit
 inuentor, quem
 postea Rex Surrie
 dira morte
 trucidauit, et sic
 opus operarium
 consumpsit.

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81

[SAUL AND THE
WITCH.]

Nota de Saule et
 Phitonissa. [922](#)

Yaf him conseil be Sorcerie,
Which after fell to mochel sorwe,
2390 For he was slain upon the morwe.

To conne moche thing it helpeth,
Bot of to mochel noman yelpeth:
So forto loke on every side,
Magique mai noght wel betyde.
Forthi, my Sone, I wolde rede
That thou of these ensamples drede,
That for no lust of erthli love
Thou seche so to come above,
Wherof as in the worldes wonder
2400 Thou schalt for evere be put under.

Mi goode fader, grant mercy,
For evere I schal be war therby:
Of love what me so befalle, [923](#)
Such Sorcerie aboven alle
Fro this dai forth I schal eschuie,
That so ne wol I noght poursuie
Mi lust of love forto seche.
Bot this I wolde you beseche,
Beside that me stant of love,
2410 As I you herde speke above
Hou Alisandre was betawht
To Aristotle, and so wel tawht
Of al that to a king belongeth,
Wherof min herte sore longeth
To wite what it wolde mene.
For be reson I wolde wene
That if I herde of thinges strange, [924](#)
Yit for a time it scholde change
Mi peine, and lisse me somdiel.

2420 Mi goode Sone, thou seist wel.
For wisdom, hou that evere it stonde,
To him that can it understonde
Doth gret profit in sondri wise;
Bot touchende of so hih aprise,

Confessor.

[MAGIC TO BE
ESCHEWED.]

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Amans.

Confessor.

Which is noght unto Venus knowe,
I mai it noght miselue knowe,
Which of hir court am al forthdrawe
And can nothing bot of hir lawe.
Bot natheles to knowe more
2430 Als wel as thou me longeth sore;
And for it helpeth to comune,
Al ben thei noght to me comune,
The scoles of Philosophie, [925](#)
Yit thenke I forto specefie,
In boke as it is comprehended, [926](#)
Wherof thou mihtest ben amended.
For thogh I be noght al cunnyng
Upon the forme of this wrytyng,
Som part therof yit have I herd,
2440 In this matiere hou it hath ferd.

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Explicit Liber Sextus.

FOOTNOTES:

- [702](#) 10 sette AJC, S, F set BT
[703](#) 13 tuo] mo B
[704](#) 34 wext BT, F wexit J wexþ A wexeþ C
[705](#) 44 As for AdBTΔ
[706](#) 57 a man be] for to be AdBT a man to be JB₂, Δ
[707](#) 59 sterte AJ, S, F stert C, BT
[708](#) 66 care H₁ ... B₂
[709](#) 69 ffro F
[710](#) 79 doted AdBT
[711](#) 86 þei ne knowe AM ... B₂ (*except* GE) þei knewe J
[712](#) 101 If] Of ERCB₂ Thou3e X
[713](#) 145 newefot S, F *the rest* newe foot (fot)
[714](#) 151 a pas H₁ ... B₂
[715](#) 152 cuer(e) it was AdBT
[716](#) 160 I am H₁XERC
[717](#) 162 With] The AM ... B₂
[718](#) 172 so *om.* H₁ ... B₂
[719](#) 197 or] and AMX ... B₂, Δ
[720](#) 202 3if A, F 3iue J, B ffor wel is me þat I haue leue H₁ ... B₂ (I *om.* C)
[721](#) 209 Vnto AdBT
[722](#) 215 þo hetes ST þo hertes B
[723](#) 235 I *om.* AM
[724](#) 241 at] al (alle) H₁E, SAdTΔ
[725](#) 242 hou] þat AM
[726](#) 262 þruste M, Δ trust(e) AdBT, W
[727](#) 281 wher þat AMG, H₃
[728](#) 285 *line om.* B
[729](#) 297 wel *om.* AM ... B₂
[730](#) 329 be falle JH₁ERB₂, BT
[731](#) 339 caste AdBT, H₃
[732](#) 354 of þe seke AM ... B₂
[733](#) 357 In iape AM
[734](#) 358 vnserued AM, W
[735](#) 363 drinke al H₁X, AdBT drunken (*om.* al) E all (*om.* drunke) B₂ dronke and W
[736](#) 367 Of louedrunke and schalt FK Of louedrunke and schal J, SAdBT, W Of louedrinke and schal AM ... B₂, Δ Of loue drunken and shal H₃
[737](#) 376 lest J, B, F lesþ A leeseþ C
[738](#) 379 which A, B, F whiche J
[739](#) 382 that *om.* AdBT
[740](#) 387 I wel AJM I wol(e) H₁ ... B₂
[741](#) 408 the] þei F
[742](#) 409 *margin* concussit A ... B₂
[743](#) 414 for defaute H₁ ... C, Δ, H₃ in defaute B₂, W
[744](#) 421 wofull] foule AdBT
[745](#) 434 Was] 3af H₁ ... B₂

[746](#) 442 þe nede AM ... B₂
[747](#) 463 i (I) torne AM
[748](#) 469 So þat AdBT, W
[749](#) 470 *margin* ad potum H₁ ... B₂
[750](#) 488 *margin* contingentibus F
[751](#) 495 feste AJ, B fest C, F
[752](#) 497 *margin* in *om.* H₁ ... B₂, SBA, W
[753](#) 500 be gete] begete (bigete) AX, SAdTΔ
[754](#) 508 3oue B, F 3eue A 3iue J, C
[755](#) 513 halfwode S, F half wode (woode) AJ, B
[756](#) 519 On] Of B
[757](#) 531 þis vice A ... B₂, S ... Δ
[758](#) 556 *margin* perierunt A ... B₂
[759](#) 543 and of H₁ ... B₂, W
[760](#) 550 *margin* que tandem AM coclamante F
[761](#) 554 neuere AJ, T neuer C, SB, F
[762](#) 559 Sonne H₁E, B, W (sonne bright)
[763](#) 569 of fool] a fool AM ... C a foul B₂ of foul Ad of foli Δ
[764](#) 590 fille ful] fulfille (ful fille) H₁XRCB₂ fulle M fille W
[765](#) 599 I rede þe H₁ERCB₂, Ad I rede þou X (I rede þe M *corr.*)
[766](#) *Latin Verses* ii. 6 fatur H₁ ... B₂, B
[767](#) 621 *margin* molliciis A ... B₂
[768](#) 623 *margin* quoque AMH₁XB₂, W
[769](#) 620 is Past of] his past of AJ is past(e) as BT his past is Ad
[770](#) 633 Richesse AMH₁, H₃ Riches W
[771](#) 647 For bot] But if AdBT
[772](#) 653 who that] who so AM ... B₂
[773](#) 664 Vsance A ... B₂
[774](#) 665-964 *ins. after 1146 SAdBTΔΔ These copies proceed here with l. 965*

Vsage is þe seconde kinde
 In loue als wel as oþer weie, &c.

[775](#) 673 nou *om.* AM
[776](#) 681 His honour AM
[777](#) 686 But if BT
[778](#) 715 a goodly JH₁RCB₂, AdBT, H₃ a gladly W one goodly Δ
[779](#) 734 ful paast AM
[780](#) 746 Of fieding(e) AM, AdΔ, H₃ If feding(e) H₁ ... B₂ (*not* G) Tho fedyng W
[781](#) 751 of herte] and herte AJM
[782](#) 762 he hire] to hir(e) AdBT
[783](#) 784 myn] his AM ... B₂
[784](#) 785 schapþe S, F *the rest* schape (schappe &c.)
[785](#) 827 *Paragraph at l. 830 in MSS.*
[786](#) 838 seith] seie MC, AdΔ, W (say)
[787](#) 841 is also] seiþ also AdBT
[788](#) 856 and all(e) þe spices M ... B₂, W
[789](#) 892 for tacompten B
[790](#) 899 as I þe seye B
[791](#) 906 fode] þoughtes B *om.* AdT flode B₂
[792](#) 927 toforn AdBT

[793](#) 928 on] of EB₂, AdBT
[794](#) 946 I do] to do AM
[795](#) After 964 Als wel be reson as be kinde etc. (1149 ff.) SAdBTΔΔ
[796](#) 973 To] In AM ... B₂
[797](#) 979 *margin* gesta B
[798](#) 988 eek he was C, Δ
[799](#) 993 As] And AdBT stood al H₁ ... B₂, Ad, W
[800](#) 998 he] be AMXRB₂
[801](#) 1004 þis p. S ... Δ
[802](#) 1006 þe p. S ... Δ
[803](#) 1008 ffor AdBT
[804](#) 1010 these] þe AM ... B₂, H₃
[805](#) 1023 Habrahammes J, F *rest* Abrahames (Abrahams &c.): so 1039, 1046,
 1073
[806](#) 1027 the] þis H₁ ... B₂
[807](#) 1030 Vnto þe helle BT In to helle JRB₂, Δ, W
[808](#) 1048 *margin* Salomon. Qui obturat aures suas ad clamorem pauperum, ipse
 clamabit et non exaudietur SBTΔ
[809](#) 1085 I drye] þey drye B
[810](#) 1089 his] þis (this) H₁, AdBTΔ (his S)
[811](#) 1098 hou *om.* S ... Δ
[812](#) 1100 Habraham JX, F *rest* Abraham
[813](#) 1105 wold(e) M, B, W
[814](#) 1107 Than eny AH₁ Themeny M (*p. m.*)
[815](#) 1109 of lyue X ... B₂, Ad, H₃ on liue Δ
[816](#) 1112 be holde JH₁RB₂
[817](#) After 1146 SAdBTΔΔ have the following six lines (omitting the two 1147 f.),
 and then insert the passage 665-964. The text here is that of S:—

Bot now a dai a man mai se
 The world so full of vanite,
 That noman takþ of reson hiede
 Or forto cloþe or forto fiede,
 Bot al is sett vnto þe vice
 To newe and changen his delice.
 And riht so etc. (*as* 665 ff.)

[818](#) 1151 That man X ... B₂ (*not* G), W
[819](#) 1155 *margin* minus *om.* B
[820](#) 1186 let C, BT lete AJ, S, F
[821](#) 1209 non] anon EC, AdBT
[822](#) 1230 it is AM ... B₂
[823](#) 1233 Alpough B As þough AdT Thogh W
[824](#) 1245 no] þe B₂, AdBT þat M
[825](#) 1254 is] as A ... B₂
[826](#) 1257 wol(e) AH₁ ... B₂
[827](#) 1267 he] it G, B
[827m](#) 1267 *margin* Sortilegio SBTΔΔ Sacrilegio AX ... B₂, FH₃ sacrilegis H₁
 sacri legis M (*Latin om.* J, Ad, W)
[828](#) 1289 som men] somme (some &c.) A ... B₂
[829](#) 1293 *margin* et de] et BT

[830](#) 1294 pikkes AdBTΔ
[831](#) 1312 of] to AM
[832](#) 1317 Ne] The B
[833](#) 1319 and] of B
[834](#) 1320 Chenbal B₂, SΔ Geubal AM Glenball H₃ Thenballe W
[835](#) 1359 red S, F rede AJC, B
[836](#) 1388 whilom how þerof AMX ... B₂ hou somtyme þ. J whilome therof how
H₁
[837](#) 1391 whiche SB which AJC, F
[838](#) 1419 which B
[839](#) 1432 of hem AdBT
[840](#) 1437 And] That AM ... B₂ (*not* G)
[841](#) 1442 schope S ... Δ
[842](#) 1444 And 3it AM ... B₂
[843](#) 1479 a *om.* AJMXGERCL
[844](#) 1481 was *om.* AdBT
[845](#) 1489 þe world AM ... B₂
[846](#) 1510 on] of AMG, H₃ *in* Δ
[847](#) 1513 *margin* Omina T, F
[848](#) 1516 in pes AdBTΔ (in his pes S)
[849](#) 1518 al *om.* AdBT
[850](#) 1520 ther] he AM
[851](#) 1524 statue A ... B₂, B
[852](#) 1536 þat place BT
[853](#) 1567 *margin* Multi multa sciunt AH₁XGECLB₂ *Latin om.* JMR, AdB, W
[854](#) 1567 seiþ SBT
[855](#) 1581 As S ... Δ
[856](#) 1598 þe cas JM, Δ þa cas A
[857](#) 1602 He] His F He charged hem þei scholde harde H₁ ... B₂ (*but* warde E)
[858](#) 1631 hath] had (hadde) AM ... B₂, W
[859](#) 1645 mihte (might) S ... Δ
[860](#) 1669 Which A
[861](#) 1680 and to þrete JH₁CB₂, Δ, WK
[862](#) 1691 al *om.* AM
[863](#) 1695 out] forþ H₁, AdBT
[864](#) 1696 nyh] right AdBT for wroth] and wroþ AM ... B₂ (*except* C), W wroþ T
for worþ J
[865](#) 1700 and] but AdBT
[866](#) 1716 I wolde AMX ... B₂
[867](#) 1718 good skile] and skile S ... ΔΔ
[868](#) 1733 þe pensel G, B
[869](#) 1735 badd S bad A, B bed J badde F
[870](#) 1746 kest J, SB, F keste T kiste AC
[871](#) 1786 into] in A ... B₂ vnto W
[872](#) 1787 it so AM
[873](#) 1793 *margin* de Egipto BT
[874](#) 1794 *margin* fugiturus BT
[875](#) 1806 *margin* ex] pro BT
[876](#) 1815 thei] he B
[877](#) 1817 toke (took &c.) A ... B₂

[878](#) 1828 to beholde (be holde) H₁, AdTB
[879](#) 1847 þe pleine AdBT
[880](#) 1875 And] He AdBT
[881](#) 1879 al] so S ... Δ
[882](#) 1883 leue R, AdBT
[883](#) 1931 thing] king B
[884](#) 1939 such AJC, B suche S, F
[885](#) 1954 wher þat A ... B₂ (*except* E) ther as W
[886](#) 1993 fasteby J, F faste by AC, SB
[887](#) 1996 he *om.* AdBT
[888](#) 2016 als (as) wel XCLB₂, Δ(?), WK
[889](#) 2030 Towardes (Toward) god AdBT
[890](#) 2041 3e schol (schul) not of him AdΔ ye ne shalle of him H₁ I ne schal of
him AM
[891](#) 2046 mihte AJ, S miht F might C, B
[892](#) 2055 and he makþ BT and makeþ Ad
[893](#) 2061 the *om.* AM ... B₂, Δ
[894](#) 2062 putte AC, B put J, F
[895](#) 2071 wolde AJ, SB wold F
[896](#) 2083 noght misdo *om.* B
[897](#) 2089 and of cheualerie (chialrie &c.) AM ... B₂, AdΔ, W
[898](#) 2091 that] þe AM
[899](#) 2136 Anoþer charme H₁ ... B₂
[900](#) 2141 hem B, K
[901](#) 2145 þer inne AdBT
[902](#) 2149 tho] so AdBT
[903](#) 2155 Wher þat AM ... B₂
[904](#) 2156 what] þat AM
[905](#) 2212 he *om.* B
[906](#) 2226 bifore (biforn &c.) M ... B₂ afore (afor) Δ, W
[907](#) 2231 he wolde AdBT
[908](#) 2244 vnto AdBT
[909](#) 2247 sih (sigh, seyh) A, SB sihe F sye J
[910](#) 2255 schal] had H₁, AdBT
[911](#) 2257 no *om.* B
[912](#) 2299 apposeþ AMGB₂, W
[913](#) 2301 schold(e) SAdBT
[914](#) 2303 hast F
[915](#) 2314 of H₁GEC, S ... Δ, W if AJMXRLB₂, FK
[916](#) 2331 that *om.* AM ... B₂, WK
[917](#) 2345 dieules S, F dieueles A deueles J, B
[918](#) 2355 caste] caughte B
[919](#) 2357 *S has lost a leaf* 2357-vii. 88.
[920](#) 2376 that *om.* AM
[921](#) 2383 An ende BT, F And ende AJMERL, Ad, K And þende CL And the ende
H₁ And sende X The ende B₂, W At ende Δ
[922](#) 2385 *margin* Nota de Saule et Ph. *om.* AM, Δ
[923](#) 2403 so me A ... B₂, AdΔ euer me W
[924](#) 2417 But B
[925](#) 2433 Philophie F

Incipit Liber Septimus.

i. *Omnibus in causis sapiens doctrina salutem*

P. iii.

*Consequitur, nec habet quis nisi doctus
opem.*

84

[THE EDUCATION OF
ALEXANDER.]

*Naturam superat doctrina, viro quod et
ortus*

Ingenii docilis non dedit, ipsa dabit.

Non ita discretus hominum per climata regnat,

Quin, magis vt sapiat, indiget ipse scole.

I Genius the prest of love,

Mi Sone, as thou hast preid above

That I the Scole schal declare

Of Aristotle and ek the fare

Of Alisandre, hou he was tauht,

I am somdel therof destrauht;

For it is noght to the matiere

Of love, why we sitten hiere

To schryve, so as Venus bad.

10 Bot natheles, for it is glad,

So as thou seist, for thin aprise

To hiere of suche thinges wise,

Wherof thou myht the time lisse, [927](#)

So as I can, I schal the wisse:

For wisdom is at every throwe [928](#)

Above alle other thing to knowe

In loves cause and elleswhere.

Forthi, my Sone, unto thin Ere,

Though it be noght in the registre

Quia omnis
doctrina bona
humano regimini
salutem confert, in
hoc septimo libro
ad instanciam
Amantis languidi
intendit Genius
illam ex qua
Philosophi et
Astrologi
philosophie
doctrinam Regem
Alexandrum
imbuerunt,
secundum aliquid
declarare. Diuidit
enim philosophiam
in tres partes,
quarum prima
Theorica, secunda
Rethorica, tertia
Practica nuncupata
est, de quarum
condicionibus
subsequenter per
singula tractabit.

P. iii.

85

20 Of Venus, yit of that Calistre
 And Aristotle whylom write
 To Alisandre, thou schalt wite.
 Bot for the lores ben diverse,
 I thenke ferst to the reherce
 The nature of Philosophie;[929](#)
 Which Aristotle of his clergie,
 Wys and expert in the sciences,
 Declareth thilke intelligences,[930](#)
 As of thre pointz in principal.[931](#)
 30 Wherof the ferste in special
 Is Theorique, which is grounded
 On him which al the world hath founded,
 Which comprehendeth al the lore.
 And forto loken overmore,
 Next of sciences the seconde
 Is Rethorique, whos faconde
 Above alle othre is eloquent:
 To telle a tale in juggement
 So wel can noman speke as he.
 40 The laste science of the thre
 It is Practique, whos office
 The vertu tryeth fro the vice,
 And techeth upon goode thewes
 To fle the compaignie of schrewes,
 Which stant in disposicion
 Of mannes free eleccion.
 Practique enformeth ek the reule,
 Hou that a worthi king schal reule
 His Realme bothe in werre and pes.
 50 Lo, thus danz Aristotiles
 These thre sciences hath divided
 And the nature also decided,
 Wherof that ech of hem schal serve.
 The ferste, which is the conserve
 And kepere of the remnant,

[THREE PARTS OF
PHILOSOPHY.]

P. iii.
86

As that which is most sufficient⁹³²
And chief of the Philosophie,
If I therof schal specefie
So as the Philosophre tolde,
60 Nou herkne, and kep that thou it holde.

[i. THEORIC.]

ii. *Prima creatorem dat scire sciencia
summum:*

*Qui caput agnoscit, sufficit illud ei.*⁹³³
*Plura viros quandoque iuuat nescire, set illud
Quod videt expediens, sobrius ille sapit.*

Of Theorique principal
The Philosophre in special
The propretees hath determined,
As thilke which is enlumined
Of wisdom and of hih prudence
Above alle othre in his science:
And stant departed upon thre,
The ferste of which in his degre
Is cleped in Philosophie
70 The science of Theologie,
That other named is Phisique,
The thridde is seid Mathematique.

Hic tractat de
prima parte
Philosophie, que
Theorica dicitur,
cuius natura triplici
dotata est sciencia,
scilicet Theologia,
Phisica et
Mathematica: set
primo illam partem
Theologie
declarabit.

P. iii.
87

[THEOLOGY.]

Theologie is that science
Which unto man yifth evidence
Of thing which is noght bodely,
Wherof men knowe redely
The hihe almyhti Trinite,
Which is o god in unite
Withouten ende and beginnyng
80 And creatour of alle thinge,
Of hevene, of erthe and ek of helle.
Wherof, as olde bokes telle,
The Philosophre in his resoun
Wrot upon this conclusioun,
And of his wrytinge in a clause

He clepeth god the ferste cause,
 Which of himself is thilke good,⁹³⁴
 Withoute whom nothing is good,
 Of which that every creature⁹³⁵
 90 Hath his beinge and his nature.
 After the beinge of the thinges
 Ther ben thre formes of beinges:⁹³⁶
 Thing which began and ende schal,
 That thing is cleped temporal;
 Ther is also be other weie
 Thing which began and schal noght deie,
 As Soules, that ben spiritiel,
 Here beinge is perpetuel:
 Bot ther is on above the Sonne,
 100 Whos time nevere was begonne,
 And endeles schal evere be;
 That is the god, whos mageste
 Alle othre thinges schal governe,
 And his beinge is sempiterne.
 The god, to whom that al honour
 Belongeth, he is creatour,
 And othre ben hise creatures:
 The god commandeth the natures⁹³⁷
 That thei to him obeien alle,⁹³⁸
 110 Withouten him, what so befalle,
 Her myht is non, and he mai al:
 The god was evere and evere schal,
 And thei begonne of his assent;
 The times alle be present
 To god, to hem and alle unknowe,
 Bot what him liketh that thei knowe:
 Thus bothe an angel and a man,
 The whiche of al that god began
 Be chief, obeien goddes myht,⁹³⁹
 120 And he stant endeles upriht.
 To this science ben prive

Nota quod triplex
 dicitur essencia:
 Prima temporanea,
 que incipit et
 desinit, Secunda
 perpetua, que
 incipit et non
 desinit, Tercia
 sempiterna, que
 nec incipit nec
 desinit.

P. iii.
 88

The clerkes of divinite,
 The whiche unto the poeple prechen
 The feith of holi cherche and techen,
 Which in som cas upon believe
 Stant more than thei conne prieve
 Be weie of Argument sensible:
 Bot natheles it is credible,
 And doth a man gret meede have,
 130 To him that thenkth himself to save.
 Theologie in such a wise
 Of hih science and hih aprise
 Above alle othre stant unlike,
 And is the ferste of Theorique.
 Phisique is after the secounde,
 Thurgh which the Philosophre hath
 founde
 To techen sondri knowlechinges
 Upon the bodiliche thinges.
 Of man, of beste, of herbe, of ston,
 140 Of fisch, of foughl, of everychon
 That ben of bodely substance,
 The nature and the circumstance
 Thurgh this science it is ful soght,
 Which vaileth and which vaileth noght.
 The thridde point of Theorique,
 Which cleped is Mathematique,
 Devided is in sondri wise
 And stant upon diverse aprise.
 The ferste of whiche is Arsmetique,
 150 And the secounde is seid Musique,
 The thridde is ek Geometrie,
 Also the ferthe Astronomie.
 Of Arsmetique the matiere
 Is that of which a man mai liere
 What Algorisme in nombre amonteth,
 Whan that the wise man acompteth
 After the formel proprete

P. iii.
89

[PHYSICS.]

Nota de secunda
 parte Theorice, que
 Phisica dicitur.

[MATHEMATICS.]

Nota de tercia
 parte Theorice, que
 Mathematica
 dicitur, cuius
 condicio quatuor in
 se continet
 intelligencias,
 scilicet
 Arsmeticam,
 Musicam,
 Geometriam et
 Astronomiam: set
 primo de
 Artismetice natura
 dicere intendit.

Of Algorismes Abece:
Be which multiplicacioun
160 Is mad and diminucioun
Of sommes be the experience
Of this Art and of this science.

P. iii.
90

The seconde of Mathematique, [940](#)
Which is the science of Musique,
That techeth upon Armonie
A man to make melodie
Be vois and soun of instrument
Thurgh notes of acordement,
The whiche men pronounce alofte,
170 Nou scharpe notes and nou softe,
Nou hihe notes and nou lowe,
As be the gamme a man mai knowe,
Which techeth the prolacion
Of note and the condicion.

Nota de Musica,
que secunda pars
Artis Mathematice
dicitur.

Mathematique of his science
Hath yit the thridde intelligence
Full of wisdom and of clergie
And cleped is Geometrie,
Thurgh which a man hath thilke sleyhte
180 Of lengthe, of brede, of depthe, of heyhte
To knowe the proporcion
Be verrai calculacion
Of this science: and in this wise
These olde Philosophres wise,
Of al this worldes erthe round,
Hou large, hou thikke was the ground,
Controeveden the experience;
The cercle and the circumference
Of every thing unto the hevene

Nota de terciã
specie Artis
Mathematice,
quam Geometriam
vocant. [941](#)

190 Thei setten point and mesure evene. [942](#)

Mathematique above therthe
Of hyh science hath yit the ferthe,
Which spekth upon Astronomie
And techeth of the sterres hihe,

P. iii.
91

Beginnyng upward fro the mone.
 Bot ferst, as it was forto done,
 This Aristotle in other thing
 Unto this worthi yonge king
 The kinde of every element
 200 Which stant under the firmament,
 Hou it is mad and in what wise,
 Fro point to point he gan devise.

iii. *Quatuor omnipotens elementa creauit
 origo,*

[CREATION OF THE
 FOUR ELEMENTS.]

*Quatuor et venti partibus ora dabat.
 Nostraque quadruplici complexio sorte creatur,
 Corpore sicque suo stat variatus homo.*

Tofore the creacion
 Of eny worldes stacion,
 Of hevene, of erthe, or eke of helle,
 So as these olde bokes telle,
 As soun tofore the song is set
 And yit thei ben togedre knet,
 Riht so the hihe pourveance
 210 Tho hadde under his ordinance
 A gret substance, a gret matiere,
 Of which he wolde in his manere
 These othre thinges make and forme.
 For yit withouten eny forme
 Was that matiere universal,
 Which hihte Ylem in special.
 Of Ylem, as I am enformed,
 These elementz ben mad and formed,
 Of Ylem elementz they hote
 220 After the Scol of Aristote,
 Of whiche if more I schal reherce,
 Foure elementz ther ben diverse.

Hic interim⁹⁴³
 tractat de creacione
 quatuor
 Elementorum,
 scilicet terre, aque,
 aeris et ignis,
 necnon et de
 eorum naturis, nam
 et singulis
 proprietates
 singule
 attribuuntur.

P. iii.
 92

The ferste of hem men erthe calle,
 Which is the lowest of hem alle,

Nota de Terra,
 quod est primum

And in his forme is schape round,
Substantial, strong, sadd and sound,
As that which mad is sufficant
To bere up al the remenant.

For as the point in a compas

230 Stant evene amiddes, riht so was
This erthe set and schal abyde,
That it may swerve to no side,
And hath his centre after the lawe
Of kinde, and to that centre drawe
Desireth every worldes thing,
If ther ne were no lettyng.^{[944](#)}

Above therthe kepth his bounde
The water, which is the secounde
Of elementz, and al withoute

240 It environeth therthe aboute.
 Bot as it scheweth, noght forthi
 This soubtil water myhtely,
 Thogh it be of himselve softe,
 The strengthe of therthe perceth ofte;
 For riht as veines ben of blod
 In man, riht so the water flod
 Therthe of his cours makth ful of veines,
 Als wel the helles as the pleines.

And that a man may sen at ye,
250 For wher the hulles ben most hyhe,
Ther mai men welle stremes finde:
So proveth it be weie of kinde
The water heyher than the lond.

And over this nou understond,
Air is the thridde of elementz,
Of whos kinde his aspiementz
Takth every lifiss creature,⁹⁴⁵
The which schal upon erthe endure:
For as the fissh, if it be dreie,

260 Mot in defaute of water deie,
Riht so withouten Air on lyve

No man ne beste myhte thryve,⁹⁴⁶
The which is mad of fleissh and bon;
There is outake of alle non.

This Air in Periferies thre
Divided is of such degre,
Benethe is on and on amidde,
To whiche above is set the thridde:
And upon the divisions⁹⁴⁷

Nota qualiter Aer
in tribus Periferiis
diuiditur.

270 There ben diverse impressions
Of moist and ek of drye also,
Whiche of the Sonne bothe tuo
Ben drawe and haled upon hy,
And maken cloudes in the Sky,
As schewed is at mannes sihte;⁹⁴⁸
Wherof be day and ek be nyhte
After the times of the yer
Among ous upon Erthe her
In sondri wise thinges falle.

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94

280 The ferste Periferie of alle
Engendreth Myst and overmore
The dewes and the Frostes hore,
After thilke intersticion
In which thei take impression,
Fro the seconde, as bokes sein,
The moiste dropes of the reyn
Descenden into Middilerthe,
And tempreth it to sed and Erthe,
And doth to springe grass and flour.

De prima Aeris
Periferia.

De secunda Aeris
Periferia.

290 And ofte also the grete schour
Out of such place it mai be take,
That it the forme schal forsake
Of reyn, and into snow be torned;
And ek it mai be so sojorned
In sondri places up alofte,
That into hail it torneth ofte.

The thridde of thair after the lawe
Thurgh such matiere as up is drawe⁹⁴⁹

De tertia Aeris
Periferia.

Of dreie thing, as it is ofte,
300 Among the cloudes upon lofte,⁹⁵⁰
And is so clos, it may noght oute,—
Thanne is it chased sore aboute,
Til it to fyr and leyt be falle,⁹⁵¹
And thanne it brekth the cloudes alle,
The whiche of so gret noyse craken,
That thei the feerful thonder maken.
The thonderstrok smit er it leyte,
And yit men sen the fyr and leyte,
The thonderstrok er that men hiere:

310 So mai it wel be proeved hiere
In thing which schewed is fro feer,
A mannes yhe is there nerr
Thanne is the soun to mannes Ere.
And natheles it is gret feere
Bothe of the strok and of the fyr,
Of which is no recoverir
In place wher that thei descende,
Bot if god wolde his grace sende.

And forto speken over this,

320 In this partie of thair it is
That men fulofte sen be nyhte
The fyr in sondri forme alyhte.
Somtime the fyrdrake it semeth,⁹⁵²
And so the lewed poeple it demeth;
Somtime it semeth as it were
A Sterre, which that glydeth there:
Bot it is nouthur of the tuo,
The Philosophre telleth so,
And seith that of impressions

330 Thurgh diverse exalacions⁹⁵³
Upon the cause and the matiere
Men sen diverse forme appiere
Of fyr, the which hath sondri name.

Assub, he seith, is thilke same,
The which in sondry place is founde,

P. iii.
95

Nota hic⁹⁵²
qualiter Ignis,
quos noctanter in
Aere discurrere
videmus,
secundum varias
apparencie formas
varia gestant
nomina: quorum
primus Assub,
secundus Capra
saliens, tercius
Eges et quartus
Daali in libris
Philosophorum
nuncupatus est.

Whanne it is falle doun to grounde,⁹⁵⁵
So as the fyr it hath aneled,
Lich unto slym which is congeled.

P. iii.
96

Of exalacion I finde⁹⁵⁶

340 Fyr kinled of the fame kinde,
Bot it is of an other forme;
Wherof, if that I schal conforme
The figure unto that it is,
These olde clerkes tellen this,
That it is lik a Got skippende,
And for that it is such semende,
It hatte Capra saliens.

And ek these Astronomiens
An other fyr also, be nyhte

350 Which scheweth him to mannes syhte,
Thei clepen Eges, the which brenneth
Lik to the corrant fyr that renneth
Upon a corde, as thou hast sein,
Whan it with poudre is so besein
Of Sulphre and othre thinges mo.

Ther is an other fyr also,
Which semeth to a mannes yhe
Be nyhtes time as thogh ther flyhe
A dragon brennende in the Sky,

360 And that is cleped proprely
Daaly, wherof men sein fulofte,⁹⁵⁷
'Lo, wher the fyri drake alofte
Fleth up in thair!' and so thei demen.
Bot why the fyres suche semen
Of sondri formes to beholde,⁹⁵⁸
The wise Philosophre tolde,
So as tofore it hath ben herd.

P. iii.
97

Lo thus, my Sone, hou it hath ferd:⁹⁵⁹
Of Air the due proprete

Confessor.

370 In sondri wise thou myht se,
And hou under the firmament

It is ek the thridde element,
Which environeth bothe tuo,
The water and the lond also. ⁹⁶⁰

And forto tellen overthis
Of elementz which the ferthe is,
That is the fyr in his degre,
Which environeth thother thre
And is withoute moist al drye.
380 Bot lest nou what seith the clergie;
For upon hem that I have seid
The creatour hath set and leid
The kinde and the complexion
Of alle mennes nacion.
Foure elementz sondri ther be,
Lich unto whiche of that degre
Among the men ther ben also
Complexions foure and nomo,
Wherof the Philosophre treteth,
390 That he nothing behinde leteth,
And seith hou that thei ben diverse,
So as I schal to thee reherse.

He which natureth every kinde, ⁹⁶¹
The myhti god, so as I finde,
Of man, which is his creature,
Hath so devided the nature,
That non til other wel acordeth:
And be the cause it so discordeth,
The lif which fieleth the seknesse
Mai stonde upon no sekernesse.

Of therthe, which is cold and drye,
The kinde of man Malencolie
Is cleped, and that is the ferste,
The most ungoodlich and the werste;
For unto loves werk on nyht
Him lacketh bothe will and myht:
400 No wonder is, in lusty place

Nota de Igne, quod
est quartum
elementum.

[THE FOUR
COMPLEXIONS OF
MAN.]

Nota hic qualiter
secundum naturam
quatuor
elementorum
quatuor in humano
corpore
complexiones,
scilicet Malencolia,
Fleuma, Sanguis et
Colera, naturaliter
constituuntur: vnde
primo de
Malencolia
dicendum est.

P. iii.
98

Of love though he lese grace.
What man hath that complexion,
410 Full of ymaginacion
Of dredes and of wrathful thoghtes,
He fret himselven al to noghtes.

The water, which is moyste and cold,
Makth fleume, which is manyfold
Foryetel, slou and wery sone
Of every thing which is to done:
He is of kinde sufficient
To holde love his covenant,
Bot that him lacketh appetit,

De complexionē
Fleumatis.

420 Which longeth unto such delit.

What man that takth his kinde of thair,
He schal be lyht, he schal be fair,
For his complexion is blood.
Of alle ther is non so good,
For he hath bothe will and myht
To plesse and paie love his riht:
Wher as he hath love undertake,
Wrong is if that he be forsake.

De complexionē
Sanguinis.

P. iii.
99

The fyr of his condicion⁹⁶²
430 Appreth the complexion
Which in a man is Colre hote,
Whos propretes ben dreie and hote:
It makth a man ben enginous
And swift of fote and ek irous;
Of contek and folhastifnesse
He hath a riht gret besinesse,
To thenke of love and litel may:
Though he behote wel a day,⁹⁶³
On nyht whan that he wole assaie,
440 He may ful evele his dette paie.

De complexionē
Colere.

After the kinde of thelement,
Thus stant a mannes kinde went,
As touchende his complexion,
Upon sondri division

Nota qualiter
quatuor
complexiones
quatuor in homine

Of dreie, of moiste, of chele, of hete,⁹⁶⁴ And ech of hem his oghne sete Appropred hath withinne a man. And ferst to telle as I began,	habitaciones diuisim possident.
The Splen is to Malencolie 450 Assigned for herbergerie:	Splen domus est⁹⁶⁵ Malencolie.
The moiste fleume with his cold⁹⁶⁶ Hath in the lunges for his hold Ordeined him a propre stede, To duelle ther as he is bede:	Pulmo domus^{966m} Fleumatis.
To the Sanguin complexion Nature of hire inspeccion⁹⁶⁷ A propre hous hath in the livere For his duellinge mad delivere:	Epar domus Sanguinis. P. iii. 100
The dreie Colre with his hete 460 Be weie of kinde his propre sete Hath in the galle, wher he duelleth, So as the Philosophre telleth.	Fel domus Colere.
Nou over this is forto wite, As it is in Phisique write Of livere, of lunge, of galle, of splen, Thei alle unto the herte ben Servantz, and ech in his office Entendeth to don him service, As he which is chief lord above.⁹⁶⁹	Nota de Stomacho, qui vna cum aliis cordi⁹⁶⁸ specialius deseruit.
470 The livere makth him forto love, The lunge yifth him weie of speche, The galle serveth to do wreche, The Splen doth him to lawhe and pleie, Whan al unclennesse is aweie: Lo, thus hath ech of hem his dede. And to sustienen hem and fede In time of recreacion, Nature hath in creacion⁹⁷⁰ The Stomach for a comun Coc	
480 Ordeined, so as seith the boc.⁹⁷¹	

The Stomach coc is for the halle,
And builleth mete for hem alle,
To make hem myghty forto serve⁹⁷²
The herte, that he schal noght sterve:
For as a king in his Empire
Above alle othre is lord and Sire,
So is the herte principal,
To whom reson in special
Is yove as for the governance.

P. iii.
101

- 490 And thus nature his pourveance
Hath mad for man to liven hiere;
Bot god, which hath the Soule diere,⁹⁷³
Hath formed it in other wise.
That can noman pleinli devise;
Bot as the clerkes ous enforme,
That lich to god it hath a forme,
Thurgh which figure and which liknesse
The Soule hath many an hyh noblesse
Appropred to his oghne kinde.
- 500 Bot ofte hir wittes be mad blinde
Al onliche of this ilke point,
That hir abydinge is conjoint
Forth with the bodi forto duelle:
That on desireth toward helle,
That other upward to the hevene;
So schul thei nevere stonde in evene,
Bot if the fleissh be overcome
And that the Soule have holi nome⁹⁷⁴
The governance, and that is selde,
- 510 Whil that the fleissh him mai bewelde.⁹⁷⁵
Al erthli thing which god began
Was only mad to serve man;
Bot he the Soule al only made
Himselven forto serve and glade.
Alle othre bestes that men finde
Thei serve unto here oghne kinde,
Bot to reson the Soule serveth;

[THE SOUL OF
MAN.]

Wherof the man his thonk deserveth
And get him with hise werkes goode
520 The perdurable lyves foode.

P. iii.
102

Of what matiere it schal be told,⁹⁷⁶
A tale lyketh manyfold
The betre, if it be spoke plein:
Thus thinke I forto torne ayein
And telle plenerly therfore⁹⁷⁷
Of therthe, wherof nou tofore
I spak, and of the water eke,
So as these olde clerkes spieke,⁹⁷⁸
And sette proprely the bounde
530 After the forme of Mappemounde,
Thurgh which the ground be pourparties
Departed is in thre parties,
That is Asie, Aufrique, Europe,
The whiche under the hevene cope,
Als ferr as streccheth eny ground,
Begripeth al this Erthe round.
Bot after that the hihe wrieche
The water weies let out seche
And overgo the helles hye,
540 Which every kinde made dye
That upon Middelerthe stod,⁹⁷⁹
Outake Noë and his blod,
His Sones and his doughtres thre,
Thei were sauf and so was he;—
Here names who that rede rihte,
Sem, Cam, Japhet the brethren hihte;—⁹⁸⁰
And whanne thilke almyhty hond
Withdrouh the water fro the lond,
And al the rage was aweie,
550 And Erthe was the mannes weie,
The Sones thre, of whiche I tolde,
Riht after that hemselfe wolde,⁹⁸¹
This world departe thei begonne.

[THE DIVISION OF
THE EARTH.]

Hic loquitur
vlterius de
diuisione Terre que
post diluuium
tribus filiis Noe in
tres partes, scilicet
Asiam, Affricam et
Europam
diuidebatur.

P. iii.
103

Asie, which lay to the Sonne
 Upon the Marche of orient,
 Was graunted be comun assent
 To Sem, which was the Sone eldeste;
 For that partie was the beste
 And double as moche as othre tuo.
 560 And was that time bounded so;
 Wher as the flod which men Nil calleth
 Departeth fro his cours and falleth
 Into the See Alexandrine,
 Ther takth Asie ferst seisine
 Toward the West, and over this
 Of Canahim wher the flod is
 Into the grete See rennende,
 Fro that into the worldes ende
 Estward, Asie it is algates,
 570 Til that men come unto the gates
 Of Paradis, and there ho.
 And schortly for to speke it so,
 Of Orient in general
 Withinne his bounde Asie hath al.

De Asia.

And thanne upon that other syde
 Westward, as it fell thilke tyde,
 The brother which was hote Cham
 Upon his part Aufrique nam.⁹⁸³
 Japhet Europe tho tok he,
 580 Thus parten thei the world on thre.
 Bot yit ther ben of londes fele
 In occident as for the chele,
 In orient as for the hete,
 Which of the poeple be forlete⁹⁸⁴
 As lond desert that is unable,
 For it mai noght ben habitable.

De Aufrica⁹⁸² et
Europa.

P. iii.
104

The water eke hath sondri bounde,
 After the lond wher it is founde,
 And takth his name of thilke londes
 590 Wher that it renneth on the strondes:

Nota de mari quod
magnum
Occeanum dicitur.

Bot thilke See which hath no wane
 Is cleped the gret Occeane,
 Out of the which arise and come
 The hyhe flodes alle and some;
 Is non so litel welle spring,
 Which ther ne takth his beginnyng,
 And lich a man that haleth breth⁹⁸⁵
 Be weie of kinde, so it geth
 Out of the See and in ayein,
 600 The water, as the bokes sein.
 Of Elementz the propretes
 Hou that they stonden be degrees,
 As I have told, nou myht thou hie,
 Mi goode Sone, al the matiere
 Of Erthe, of water, Air and fyr.
 And for thou saist that thi desir
 Is forto witen overmore
 The forme of Aristotles lore,
 He seith in his entendement,
 610 That yit ther is an Element
 Above the foure, and is the fifte,
 Set of the hihe goddes yifte,
 The which that Orbis cleped is.
 And therupon he telleth this,
 That as the schelle hol and sound
 Encloseth al aboute round
 What thing withinne an Ey belongeth,
 Riht so this Orbis underfongeth
 These elementz alle everychon,
 620 Which I have spoke of on and on.⁹⁸⁶
 Bot overthis nou tak good hiede,⁹⁸⁷
 Mi Sone, for I wol procede
 To speke upon Mathematique,
 Which grounded is on Theorique.
 The science of Astronomie
 I thinke forto specefie,
 Withoute which, to telle plein,

Nota hic secundum
 philosophum de
 quinto Elemento,
 quod omnia sub
 celo creata infra
 suum ambitum
 continet, cui
 nomen Orbis
 specialiter
 appropriatum est.

P. iii.
105

Alle othre science is in vein⁹⁸⁸
Toward the scole of erthli thinges:
630 For as an Egle with his winges
Fleth above alle that men finde,
So doth this science in his kinde.

iv. *Lege planetarum magis inferiora
reguntur,*

[ASTRONOMY.]

*Ista set interdum regula fallit opus.
Vir mediante deo sapiens dominabitur astris,
Fata nec immerito quid nouitatis agunt.*⁹⁸⁹

Benethe upon this Erthe hiere
Of alle thinges the matiere,
As tellen ous thei that ben lerned,
Of thing above it stant governed,
That is to sein of the Planetes.
The cheles bothe and ek the hetes,
The chances of the world also,
640 That we fortune clepen so,
Among the mennes nacion
Al is thurgh constellacion,
Wherof that som man hath the wele,
And som man hath deseses fele
In love als wel as othre thinges;
The stat of realmes and of kinges
In time of pes, in time of werre
It is conceived of the Sterre:
And thus seith the naturien
650 Which is an Astronomien.
Bot the divin seith otherwise,
That if men weren goode and wise
And plesant unto the godhede,
Thei scholden noght the sterres drede;
For o man, if him wel befalle,
Is more worth than ben thei alle
Towardes him that weldeth al.
Bot yit the lawe original,

P. iii.
106

Hic loquitur de
Artis Mathematice
quarta specie, que
Astronomia
nuncupata est, cui
eciam Astrologia
socio
connumeratur: set
primo de septem
planetis, que inter
astra potenciores
existunt,
incipiendo a luna
seorsum tractare
intendit.

Which he hath set in the natures,
660 Mot worchen in the creatures,
That therof mai be non obstacle,
Bot if it stonde upon miracle
Thurgh preiere of som holy man.
And forthi, so as I began
To speke upon Astronomie,
As it is write in the clergie,
To telle hou the planetes fare,
Som part I thenke to declare,
Mi Sone, unto thin Audience.

P. iii.
107

670 Astronomie is the science
Of wisdom and of hih connyng,
Which makth a man have knowleching⁹⁹⁰
Of Sterres in the firmament,
Figure, cercle and moevement
Of ech of hem in sondri place,
And what between hem is of space,
Hou so thei moeve or stonde faste,
Al this it telleth to the laste.

Assembled with Astronomie
680 Is ek that ilke Astrologie,
The which in juggementz acompteth
Theffect, what every sterre amonteth,
And hou thei causen many a wonder
To tho climatz that stonde hem under.⁹⁹¹

And forto telle it more plein,⁹⁹²
These olde philosophres sein
That Orbis, which I spak of err,
Is that which we fro therthe a ferr
Beholde, and firmament it calle,
690 In which the sterres stonden alle,
Among the whiche in special
Planetes sefne principal
Ther ben, that mannes sihte demeth,
Bot thorizonte, as to ous semeth.⁹⁹³
And also ther ben signes tuelve,

[PLANETS AND
SIGNS.]

P. iii.
108

Whiche have her cercles be hemselfe
 Compassed in the zodiaque,
 In which thei have here places take.
 And as thei stonden in degre,
 700 Here cercles more or lasse be,
 Mad after the proporcion
 Of therthe, whos condicion
 Is set to be the foundement
 To sustiene up the firmament.
 And be this skile a man mai knowe,
 The more that thei stonden lowe,
 The more ben the cercles lasse;
 That causeth why that some passe
 Here due cours tofore an other.
 710 Bot nou, mi lieve dere brother,
 As thou desirest forto wite
 What I finde in the bokes write,
 To telle of the planetes sevene,
 Hou that thei stonde upon the hevene
 And in what point that thei ben inne,
 Tak hiede, for I wol beginne,
 So as the Philosophre tauhte⁹⁹⁴
 To Alisandre and it betauhte,
 Wherof that he was fulli tawht
 720 Of wisdom, which was him betawht.
 Benethe alle othre stant the Mone,
 The which hath with the See to done:
 Of flodes hihe and ebbes lowe
 Upon his change it schal be knowe;⁹⁹⁵
 And every fissh which hath a schelle
 Mot in his governance duelle,
 To wexe and wane in his degre,
 As be the Mone a man mai se;
 And al that stant upon the grounde
 730 Of his moisture it mot be founde.
 Alle othre sterres, as men finde,
 Be schynende of here oghne kinde

[THE PLANETS.]

Nota hic de prima
 planeta, que aliis
 inferior Luna
 dicitur.

P. iii.
 109

Outake only the monelyht,
Which is noght of himselve bright,
Bot as he takth it of the Sonne.
And yit he hath noght al fulwonne⁹⁹⁶
His lyht, that he nys somdiel derk;
Bot what the lette is of that werk
In Almageste it telleth this:

740 The Mones cercle so lowe is,
Wherof the Sonne out of his stage
Ne seth him noght with full visage,
For he is with the ground beschaded,
So that the Mone is somdiel faded
And may noght fully schyne cler.
Bot what man under his pouer
Is bore, he schal his places change
And seche manye londes strange:
And as of this condicion

750 The Mones disposicion
Upon the lond of Alemaigne
Is set, and ek upon Bretaigne,
Which nou is cleped Engeland;
For thei travaile in every lond.

Of the Planetes the secounde
Above the Mone hath take his bounde,
Mercurie, and his nature is this,
That under him who that bore is,
In boke he schal be studious

760 And in wrytinge curious,
And slouh and lustles to travaile
In thing which elles myhte availe:
He loveth ese, he loveth reste,
So is he noght the worthieste;
Bot yit with somdiel besinesse
His herte is set upon richesse.
And as in this condicion,
Theffect and disposicion
Of this Planete and of his chance⁹⁹⁷

P. iii.
110

De secunda
planeta, que
Mercurius dicitur.

770 Is most in Burgoigne and in France.

Next to Mercurie, as wol befalle,
Stant that Planete which men calle
Venus, whos constellacion
Governeth al the nacion
Of lovers, wher thei spiede or non,
Of whiche I trowe thou be on:
Bot whiderward thin happes wende,
Schal this planete schewe at ende,
As it hath do to many mo,

De tertia planeta,
que Venus dicitur.

780 To some wel, to some wo.

And natheles of this Planete
The moste part is softe and swete;
For who that therof takth his berthe,
He schal desire joie and merthe,
Gentil, courteis and debonaire,
To speke his wordes softe and faire,
Such schal he be be weie of kinde,
And overal wher he may finde
Plesance of love, his herte boweth

P. iii.
111

790 With al his myht and there he woweth.

He is so ferforth Amourous,
He not what thing is vicious
Touchende love, for that lawe
Ther mai no maner man withdrawe,
The which venerien is bore
Be weie of kinde, and therefore
Venus of love the goddesse
Is cleped: bot of wantounesse⁹⁹⁸
The climat of hir lecherie

800 Is most commun in Lombardie.

Next unto this Planete of love
The brighte Sonne stant above,
Which is the hindrere of the nyht
And forthrere of the daies lyht,
As he which is the worldes ye,
Thurgh whom the lusti compaignie

Nota de Sole, qui
medio planetarum
residens Astrorum
principatum
obtinet.

Of foules be the morwe singe,
The freisshe floures sprede and springe,
The hihe tre the ground beschadeth,
810 And every mannes herte gladeth.
And for it is the hed Planete,
Hou that he sitteth in his sete,
Of what riches, of what nobleie,
These bokes telle, and thus thei seie.

P. iii.
112

Nota de curru Solis
necnon et de vario
eiusdem apparatu.

Of gold glistrende Spoke and whiel
The Sonne his carte hath faire and wiel,
In which he sitt, and is coroned
With brighte stones environed;
Of whiche if that I speke schal,
820 Ther be tofore in special
Set in the front of his corone
Thre Stones, whiche no persone
Hath upon Erthe, and the ferste is
Be name cleped Licuchis;
That othre tuo be cleped thus,
Astrices and Ceramius.
In his corone also behinde,
Be olde bokes as I finde,
Ther ben of worthi Stones thre
830 Set ech of hem in his degre:
Wherof a Cristall is that on,
Which that corone is set upon;
The seconde is an Adamant;
The thridde is noble and avenant,
Which cleped is Ydriades.
And over this yit natheles
Upon the sydes of the werk,
After the wrytinge of the clerk,
Ther sitten fyve Stones mo:
840 The smaragdine is on of tho,
Jaspis and Elitropius
And Dendides and Jacinctus,
Lo, thus the corone is beset,

Wherof it schyneth wel the bet;
And in such wise his liht to sprede
Sit with his Diademe on hede
The Sonne schynende in his carte.
And forto lede him swithe and smarte
After the bryhte daies lawe,
850 Ther ben ordeined forto drawe
Foure hors his Char and him withal,
Wherof the names telle I schal:
Eritheüs the ferste is hote,
The which is red and schyneth hote,
The seconde Acteos the bryhte,
Lampes the thridde coursier hihte,
And Philogeüs is the ferthe,
That bringen lyht unto this erthe,
And gon so swift upon the hevene,
860 In foure and twenty houres evene
The carte with the bryhte Sonne
Thei drawe, so that overronne
Thei have under the cercles hihe
Al Middelerthe in such an hye.
And thus the Sonne is overal
The chief Planete imperial,
Above him and benethe him thre:
And thus between hem regneth he,
As he that hath the middel place
870 Among the Sevene, and of his face
Be glade alle erthly creatures,
And taken after the natures
Here ese and recreacion.
And in his constellacion
Who that is bore in special,
Of good will and of liberal
He schal be founde in alle place,
And also stonde in mochel grace
Toward the lordes forto serve
880 And gret profit and thonk deserve.

And over that it causeth yit
A man to be soubtil of wit
To worche in gold, and to be wys
In every thing which is of pris.
Bot forto speken in what cost
Of al this erthe he regneth most
As for wisdom, it is in Grece,
Wher is apropred thilke spiece.

Mars the Planete bataillous
890 Next to the Sonne glorious
Above stant, and doth mervailles
Upon the fortune of batailes.
The conquerours be daies olde
Were unto this planete holde:
Bot who that his nativite
Hath take upon the proprete
Of Martes disposicioun
Be weie of constellacioun,
He schal be fiers and folhastif
900 And desirous of werre and strif.
Bot forto telle redely
In what climat most comunly
That this planete hath his effect,
Seid is that he hath his aspect
Upon the holi lond so cast,
That there is no pes stedefast.

Above Mars upon the hevene,
The sexte Planete of the sevene,
Stant Jupiter the delicat,
910 Which causeth pes and no debar.
For he is cleped that Planete⁹⁹⁹
Which of his kinde softe and swete
Attempreth al that to him longeth;
And whom this planete underfongeth
To stonde upon his regiment,
He schal be meke and pacient
And fortunat to Marchandie

Nota de quinta
planeta, que Mars
dicitur.

P. iii.
115

Nota de sexta
planeta, que Iupiter
dicitur.

And lusti to delicacie
 In every thing which he schal do.
 920 This Jupiter is cause also
 Of the science of lyhte werkes,
 And in this wise tellen clerkes
 He is the Planete of delices.
 Bot in Egipte of his offices
 He regneth most in special:
 For ther be lustes overal
 Of al that to this lif befalleth;
 For ther no stormy weder falleth,
 Which myhte grieve man or beste,
 930 And ek the lond is so honeste
 That it is plentevous and plein,
 Ther is non ydel ground in vein;
 And upon such felicitye¹⁰⁰⁰
 Stant Jupiter in his degre.

P. iii.
 116

The heyeste and aboven alle
 Stant that planete which men calle¹⁰⁰²
 Saturnus, whos complexion
 Is cold, and his condicion
 Causeth malice and cruelte
 940 To him the whos nativite
 Is set under his governance.
 For alle hise werkes ben grevance
 And enemy to mannes hele,
 In what degre that he schal dele.
 His climat is in Orient,
 Wher that he is most violent.
 Of the Planetes by and by,
 Hou that thei stonde upon the Sky,
 Fro point to point as thou myht hiere,
 950 Was Alisandre mad to liere.
 Bot overthis touchende his lore,
 Of thing that thei him tawhte more
 Upon the scoles of clergie
 Now herkne the Philosophie.

De septima
 planeta, que
 reliquis celsior
 Saturnus dictus
 est.¹⁰⁰¹

He which departeth dai fro nyht,
 That on derk and that other lyht,¹⁰⁰³
 Of sevene daies made a weke,
 A Monthe of foure wekes eke
 He hath ordeigned in his lawe,
 960 Of Monthes tuelve and ek forthdrawe
 He hath also the longe yeer.
 And as he sette of his pouer
 Acordant to the daies sevene
 Planetes Sevene upon the hevene,
 As thou tofore hast herd devise,
 To speke riht in such a wise,
 To every Monthe be himselve
 Upon the hevene of Signes tuelve
 He hath after his Ordinal
 970 Assigned on in special,
 Wherof, so as I schal rehearsen,
 The tydes of the yer diversen.
 Bot plainly forto make it knowe
 Hou that the Signes sitte arowe,
 Ech after other be degre
 In substance and in proprete
 The zodiaque comprehendeth
 Withinne his cercle, as it appendeth.¹⁰⁰⁵
 The ferste of whiche natheles¹⁰⁰⁷
 980 Be name is cleped Aries,
 Which lich a wether of stature
 Resembled is in his figure.
 And as it seith in Almageste,
 Of Sterres tuelve upon this beste¹⁰⁰⁸
 Ben set, wherof in his degre
 The wombe hath tuo, the heved hath thre,
 The Tail hath sevene, and in this wise,
 As thou myht hiere me devise,
 Stant Aries, which hot and drye
 990 Is of himself, and in partie
 He is the receipte and the hous

[THE SIGNS.]

Postquam dictum
 est de vii. Planetis,
 quibus singuli
 septimane dies
 singulariter
 attitulantur,
 dicendum est iam
 de xii. Signis, per
 que xii. Menses
 Anni variis
 temporibus
 effectus varios
 assequuntur.¹⁰⁰⁴

P. iii.
 117

Nota hic de primo
 Signo, quod Aries
 dicitur, cui Mensis
 Marcii specialiter
 appropriatus est.
 Quo deus in primo
 produxit ad
 esse¹⁰⁰⁶ creata.

Of myhty Mars the bataillous.
And overmore ek, as I finde,
The creatour of alle kinde
Upon this Signe first began
The world, whan that he made man.
And of this constellacioun
The verray operacioun
Availeth, if a man therinne
1000The pourpos of his werk beginne;
For thanne he hath of proprete
Good sped and gret felicite.
The twelve Monthes of the yeer
Attitled under the pouer
Of these twelve Signes stonde;
Wherof that thou schalt understonde
This Aries on of the twelve¹⁰⁰⁹
Hath March attitled for himselve,
Whan every bridd schal chese his make,
1010And every neddre and every Snake
And every Reptil which mai moeve,
His myht assaieth forto proeve,
To crepen out ayein the Sonne,
Whan Ver his Seson hath begonne.

Taurus the seconde after this
Of Signes, which figured is
Unto a Bole, is dreie and cold;¹⁰¹⁰
And as it is in bokes told,
He is the hous appourtienant¹⁰¹¹
1020To Venus, somdiel discordant.
This Bole is ek with sterres set,
Thurgh whiche he hath hise hornes knet
Unto the tail of Aries,
So is he noght ther sterreles.
Upon his brest ek eyhtetiene
He hath, and ek, as it is sene,
Upon his tail stonde othre tuo.¹⁰¹²

Secundum Signum
dicitur Taurus,
cuius Mensis est
Aprilis.
Quo prius occultas
inuenit herba vias.

His Monthe assigned ek also
Is Averil, which of his schoures
1030Ministreth weie unto the floures.

The thridde signe is Gemini,
Which is figured redely
Lich to tuo twinnes of mankinde,¹⁰¹³
That naked stonde; and as I finde,
Thei be with Sterres wel bego:
The heved hath part of thilke tuo
That schyne upon the boles tail,
So be thei bothe of o parail;
But on the wombe of Gemini
1040Ben fyve sterres noght forthi,
And ek upon the feet be tweie,
So as these olde bokes seie,
That wise Tholomeüs wrot.
His propre Monthe wel I wot¹⁰¹⁴
Assigned is the lusti Maii,
Whanne every brid upon his lay
Among the griene leves singeth,
And love of his pointure stingeth
After the lawes of nature
1050The youthe of every creature.

Tercium Signum
dicitur Gemini,
cuius Mensis
Maius est.
Quo volucrum
cantus gaudet de
floribus ortis.

P. iii.
120

Cancer after the reule and space
Of Signes halt the ferthe place.
Like to the crabbe he hath semblance,
And hath unto his retienance
Sextiene sterres, wherof ten,
So as these olde wise men
Describe, he berth on him tofore,
And in the middel tuo be bore,¹⁰¹⁵
And foure he hath upon his ende.
1060Thus goth he sterred in his kende,
And of himself is moiste and cold,
And is the propre hous and hold

Quartum Signum
Cancer dicitur,
cuius Mensis
Iunius est.
Quo falcet pratis
pabula tonsor
equis.

Which appartieneth to the Mone,
And doth what longeth him to done.
The Monthe of Juin unto this Signe
Thou schalt after the reule assigne.

The fifte Signe is Leo hote,
Whos kinde is schape dreie and hote,
In whom the Sonne hath herbergage.
1070 And the semblance of his ymage
Is a leoun, which in baillie
Of sterres hath his pourpartie:
The foure, which as Cancer hath
Upon his ende, Leo tath
Upon his heved, and thanne nest
He hath ek foure upon his brest,
And on upon his tail behinde,
In olde bokes as we finde.
His propre Monthe is Juyl be name, [1016](#)
1080 In which men pleien many a game.

Quintum signum
Leo dicitur, cuius
Mensis Iulius est.
Quo magis ad
terras expandit
Lucifer ignes.

P. iii.
121

After Leo Virgo the nexte
Of Signes cleped is the sexte,
Wherof the figure is a Maide;
And as the Philosophre saide,
Sche is the welthe and the risinge,
The lust, the joie and the likinge
Unto Mercurie: and soth to seie
Sche is with sterres wel beseie,
Wherof Leo hath lent hire on,
1090 Which sit on hih hir heved upon,
Hire wombe hath fyve, hir feet also
Have other fyve: and overmo
Touchende as of complexion,
Be kindly disposicion
Of dreie and cold this Maiden is. [1017](#)
And forto tellen over this
Hir Monthe, thou schalt understonde,

Sextum Signum
Virgo dicitur, cuius
Mensis Augustus
est.
Quo vacuata prius
pubes replet horrea
messis.

Whan every feld hath corn in honde
And many a man his bak hath plied,
1100Unto this Signe is Augst applied. [1018](#)

After Virgo to reknen evene
Libra sit in the nombre of sevene,
Which hath figure and resemblance
Unto a man which a balance
Berth in his hond as forto weie:
In boke and as it mai be seie,
Diverse sterres to him longeth,
Wherof on hevede he underfongeth
Ferst thre, and ek his wombe hath tuo,
1110And doun benethe eighte othre mo.
This Signe is hot and moiste bothe,
The whiche thinges be noght lothe
Unto Venus, so that alofte
Sche resteth in his hous fulofte,
And ek Saturnus often hyed
Is in this Signe and magnified. [1019](#)
His propre Monthe is seid Septembre,
Which yifth men cause to remembre,
If eny Sor be left behinde
1120Of thing which grieve mai to kinde.

Among the Signes upon heighte
The Signe which is nombred eighte
Is Scorpio, which as feloun
Figured is a Scorpioun.
Bot for al that yit natheles
Is Scorpio noght sterreles;
For Libra granteth him his ende
Of eighte sterres, wher he wende,
The whiche upon his heved assised
1130He berth, and ek ther ben divided
Upon his wombe sterres thre,
And eighte upon his tail hath he.

Septimum Signum
Libra dicitur, cuius
Mensis Septembris
est.
Vinea quo Bachum
pressa liquore
colit.

P. iii.
122

Octauum Signum
Scorpio dicitur,
cuius Mensis
October est.
Floribus exclusis
yemis qui ianitor
extat.

P. iii.
123

Which of his kinde is moiste and cold
And unbehovely manyfold;
He harmeth Venus and empeireth,
Bot Mars unto his hous repeireth,
Bot war whan thei togedre duellen.
His propre Monthe is, as men tellen,
Octobre, which bringth the kalende
1140Of wynter, that comth next suiende.

The nynthe Signe in nombre also,
Which folweth after Scorpio,
Is cleped Sagittarius,
The whos figure is marked thus,
A Monstre with a bowe on honde:
On whom that sondri sterres stonde,
Thilke eighte of whiche I spak tofore,
The whiche upon the tail ben bore¹⁰²⁰
Of Scorpio, the heved al faire
1150Bespreden of the Sagittaire;
And eighte of othre stonden evene
Upon his wombe, and othre sevene
Ther stonde upon his tail behinde.
And he is hot and dreie of kinde:
To Jupiter his hous is fre,
Bot to Mercurie in his degre,
For thei ben noght of on assent,
He worcheth gret empeirement.
This Signe hath of his proprete
1160A Monthe, which of duete
After the sesoun that befalleth
The Plowed Oxe in wynter stalleth;
And fyr into the halle he bringeth,¹⁰²¹
And thilke drinke of which men singeth,
He torneth must into the wyn;
Thanne is the larder of the swyn;
That is Novembre which I meene,
Whan that the lef hath lost his greene.

Nonum signum
Sagittarius dicitur,
cuius Mensis
Nouember est.
Quo mustum
bibulo linquit sua
nomina vino.

The tenthe Signe dreie and cold,
1170 The which is Capricornus told,
Unto a Got hath resemblance:
For whos love and whos aqueintance
Withinne hise houses to sojorne
It liketh wel unto Satorne,
Bot to the Mone it liketh noght,
For no profit is there wrought.
This Signe as of his proprete
Upon his heved hath sterres thre,
And ek upon his wombe tuo,
1180 And tweie upon his tail also.
Decembre after the yeeres forme, [1022](#)
So as the bokes ous enforme,
With daies schorte and nyhtes longe
This ilke Signe hath underfonge.

Decimum Signum
Capricornus
dicitur, cuius
Mensis December
est.
Ipse diem Nano
noctemque Gigante
figurat.

Of tho that sitte upon the hevene
Of Signes in the nombre ellevene
Aquarius hath take his place,
And stant wel in Satornes grace,
Which duelleth in his herbergage,
Bot to the Sonne he doth outrage.
1190 This Signe is verrailly resembled
Lich to a man which halt assembled
In eyther hand a water spoute,
Wherof the stremes rennen oute.
He is of kinde moiste and hot,
And he that of the sterres wot
Seith that he hath of sterres tuo
Upon his heved, and ben of tho
That Capricorn hath on his ende;
1200 And as the bokes maken mende,
That Tholomeüs made himselfe,
He hath ek on his wombe twelve,
And tweie upon his ende stonde.
Thou schalt also this understonde,

Vndecimum
Signum Aquarius
dicitur, cuius
Mensis Ianuarius
est.
Quo Ianus vultum
duplum conuertit
in annum.

P. iii.
125

The frosti colde Janever,
Whan comen is the newe yeer,
That Janus with his double face
In his chaire hath take his place
And loketh upon bothe sides,
1210 Somdiel toward the wynter tydes,
Somdiel toward the yeer suiende,
That is the Monthe belongende
Unto this Signe, and of his dole
He yifth the ferste Primerole.

The tuelfthe, which is last of alle
Of Signes, Piscis men it calle,
The which, as telleth the scripture,
Berth of tuo fisshes the figure.
So is he cold and moiste of kinde,
And ek with sterres, as I finde,
1220 Beset in sondri wise, as thus:
Tuo of his ende Aquarius
Hath lent unto his heved, and tuo¹⁰²³
This Signe hath of his oghne also
Upon his wombe, and over this
Upon his ende also ther is
A nombre of twenty sterres bryghte,
Which is to sen a wonder sighte.
Toward this Signe into his hous¹⁰²⁴
1230 Comth Jupiter the glorious,
And Venus ek with him acordeth
To duellen, as the bok recordeth.
The Monthe unto this Signe ordeined
Is Februer, which is bereined,
And with londflodes in his rage
At Fordes letteth the passage.

Nou hast thou herd the proprete
Of Signes, bot in his degre
Albumazar yit over this

Duodecimum
Signum Piscis
dicitur, cuius
Mensis Februarius
est.
Quo pluuię torrens
riparum concitat
ampnes.

P. iii.
126

1240Seith, so as therthe parted is
In foure, riht so ben divided
The Signes tuelve and stonde assised,
That ech of hem for his partie
Hath his climat to justefie.
Wherof the ferste regiment
Toward the part of Orient
From Antioche and that contre
Governed is of Signes thre,
That is Cancer, Virgo, Leo:

P. iii.
127

1250And toward Occident also
From Armenie, as I am lerned,
Of Capricorn it stant governed,
Of Pisces and Aquarius:
And after hem I finde thus,
Southward from Alisandre forth
Tho Signes whiche most ben worth
In governance of that doaire,
Libra thei ben and Sagittaire
With Scorpio, which is conjoint

1260With hem to stonde upon that point:[1025](#)
Constantinople the Cite,[1026](#)
So as the bokes tellen me,
The laste of this division
Stant untoward Septemtrion,
Wher as be weie of pourveance
Hath Aries the governance[1027](#)
Forth with Taurus and Gemini.
Thus ben the Signes propreli
Divided, as it is reherced,

1270Wherof the londes ben diversed.

Lo thus, mi Sone, as thou myht hiere, Confessor.
Was Alisandre mad to liere
Of hem that weren for his lore.
But nou to loken overmore,
Of othre sterres hou thei fare
I thenke hierafter to declare,

P. iii.
128

So as king Alisandre in youthe
Of him that suche thinges couthe
Enformed was tofore his yhe
1280Be nyhte upon the sterres hihe. [1028](#)

Upon sondri creacion
Stant sondri operacion,
Som worcheth this, som worcheth that;
The fyr is hot in his astat
And brenneth what he mai atteigne,
The water mai the fyr restreigne,
The which is cold and moist also. [1029](#)
Of other thing it farth riht so
Upon this erthe among ous here;
1290And forto speke in this manere,
Upon the hevene, as men mai finde,
The sterres ben of sondri kinde
And worchen manye sondri thinges
To ous, that ben here underlinges.
Among the whiche forth withal
Nectanabus in special,
Which was an Astronomen
And ek a gret Magicien,
And undertake hath thilke emprise
1300To Alisandre in his aprise
As of Magique naturel
To knowe, enformeth him somdel
Of certein sterres what thei mene;
Of whiche, he seith, ther ben fiftene,
And sondrily to everich on
A gras belongeth and a Ston,
Wherof men worchen many a wonder
To sette thing bothe up and under.
To telle riht as he began,
1310The ferste sterre Aldeboran,
The clirreste and the moste of alle,
Be rihte name men it calle;

[THE FIFTEEN
STARS.]

Hic tractat super
doctrina Nectanabi,
dum ipse iuuenem
Alexandrum
instruxit, de illis
precipue xv. stellis
vna cum earum
lapidibus et herbis,
que ad artis magice
naturalis
operacionem
specialius
conueniunt.

P. iii.
129

Prima Stella
vocatur Aldeboran,
cuius lapis
Carbunculus et
herba Anabulla est.

Which lich is of condicion
To Mars, and of complexion
To Venus, and hath therupon
Carbunculum his propre Ston:
His herbe is Anabulla named,
Which is of gret vertu proclamed.

The seconde is noght vertules;
1320 Clota or elles Pliades
It hatte, and of the mones kinde¹⁰³⁰
He is, and also this I finde,
He takth of Mars complexion:
And lich to such condicion
His Ston appropred is Cristall,
And ek his herbe in special
The vertuous Fenele it is.

The thridde, which comth after this,
Is hote Algol the clere rede,
1330 Which of Satorne, as I may rede,
His kinde takth, and ek of Jove
Complexion to his behove.
His propre Ston is Dyamant,
Which is to him most acordant;
His herbe, which is him betake,
Is hote Eleborum the blake.

So as it falleth upon lot,
The ferthe sterre is Alhaiot,
Which in the wise as I seide er
1340 Of Satorne and of Jupiter
Hath take his kinde; and therupon
The Saphir is his propre Ston,
Marrubium his herbe also,
The whiche acorden bothe tuo.

And Canis maior in his like
The fifte sterre is of Magique,
The whos kinde is venerien,
As seith this Astronomen.
His propre Ston is seid Berille,

Secunda stella
vocatur Clota seu
Pliades, cuius lapis
Cristallum et herba
Feniculus est.

Tercia Stella
vocatur Algol,
cuius lapis
Dyamans et herba
Eleborum nigrum
est.

P. iii.
130

Quarta Stella
vocatur Alhaiot,
cuius lapis
Saphirus et herba
Marrubium est.

Quinta Stella
vocatur Canis
maior, cuius lapis
Berillus¹⁰³¹ et
herba Savina est.

1350 Bot forto worche and to fulfille
Thing which to this science falleth,
Ther is an herbe which men calleth
Saveine, and that behoveth nede
To him that wole his pourpos spede.

The sexte suiende after this
Be name Canis minor is;
The which sterre is Mercurial
Be weie of kinde, and forth withal,
As it is writen in the carte,

Sexta Stella
vocatur Canis
minor, cuius lapis
Achates et herba
Primula est.

1360 Complexion he takth of Marte.

His Ston and herbe, as seith the Scole, [1032](#)
Ben Achates and Primerole.

The sefnthe sterre in special
Of this science is Arial,
Which sondri nature underfongeth.
The Ston which propre unto him longeth,
Gorgonza proprely it hihte:
His herbe also, which he schal rihte
Upon the worching as I mene,

Septima Stella
vocatur Arial,
cuius lapis
Gorgonza et herba
Celidonia est.

P. iii.
131

1370 Is Celidoine freissh and grene.

Sterre Ala Corvi upon heihte
Hath take his place in nombre of eighte,
Which of his kinde mot parforne
The will of Marte and of Satorne:
To whom Lapacia the grete
Is herbe, hot of no beyete;
His Ston is Honochinus hote,
Thurgh which men worchen gret riote.

Octava stella
vocatur Ala Corui,
cuius lapis
Honochinus [1033](#) et
herba Lapacia est.

The nynthe sterre faire and wel

1380 Be name is hote Alaezel,
Which takth his propre kinde thus
Bothe of Mercurie and of Venus.
His Ston is the grene Amyraude, [1034](#)
To whom is yoven many a laude:
Salge is his herbe appourtenant
Aboven al the remenant.

Nona stella vocatur
Alaezel, cuius lapis
Smaragdus et
herba Salgea est.

The tenthe sterre is Almareth,
Which upon lif and upon deth
Thurgh kinde of Jupiter and Mart
1390He doth what longeth to his part.
His Ston is Jaspe, and of Planteine
He hath his herbe sovereine.

The sterre ellefthe is Venenas, [1035](#)
The whos nature is as it was
Take of Venus and of the Mone,
In thing which he hath forto done.
Of Adamant is that perrie
In which he worcheth his maistrie;
Thilke herbe also which him befalleth,
1400Cicorea the bok it calleth. [1036](#)

Alpheta in the nombre sit,
And is the twelfthe sterre yit;
Of Scorpio which is governed,
And takth his kinde, as I am lerned;
And hath his vertu in the Ston
Which cleped is Topazion: [1038](#)
His herbe propre is Rosmarine,
Which schapen is for his covine.

Of these sterres, whiche I mene,
1410Cor Scorpionis is thritiene;
The whos nature Mart and Jove
Have yoven unto his behove.
His herbe is Aristologie, [1040](#)
Which folweth his Astronomie:
The Ston which that this sterre alloweth,
Is Sardis, which unto him boweth.

The sterre which stant next the laste,
Nature on him this name caste
And clepeth him Botercadent;
1420Which of his kinde obedient
Is to Mercurie and to Venus.
His Ston is seid Crisolitus,
His herbe is cleped Satureie,

Decima stella
vocatur Almareth,
cuius lapis Iaspis et
herba Plantago est.

Vndecima Stella
vocatur Venenas,
cuius lapis
Adamans et herba
Cicorea est.

P. iii.
132

Duodecima stella
vocatur Alpheta,
cuius lapis
Topazion [1037](#) et
herba Rosa marina
est.

Terciadecima stella
vocatur Cor
Scorpionis, cuius
lapis Sardis et
herba
Aristologia [1039](#) est.

Quartadecima
stella vocatur
Botercadent, cuius
lapis Crisolitus et
herba Satureia est.

So as these olde bokes seie.

Bot nou the laste sterre of alle
The tail of Scorpio men calle,
Which to Mercurie and to Satorne
Be weie of kinde mot retorne
After the preparacion

1430Of due constellacion.

The Calcedoine unto him longeth,
Which for his Ston he underfongeth;
Of Majorane his herbe is grounded.
Thus have I seid hou thei be founded,
Of every sterre in special,
Which hath his herbe and Ston withal,
As Hermes in his bokes olde
Witnesse berth of that I tolde.

The science of Astronomie,
1440Which principal is of clergie
To dieme betwen wo and wel
In thinges that be naturel,
Thei hadde a gret travail on honde¹⁰⁴¹
That made it ferst ben understonde;
And thei also which overmore
Here studie sette upon this lore,
Thei weren gracious and wys
And worthi forto bere a pris.
And whom it liketh forto wite

1450Of hem that this science write,
On of the ferste which it wrot
After Noë, it was Nembrot,
To his disciple Ychonithon
And made a bok forth therupon
The which Megaster cleped was.
An other Auctor in this cas
Is Arachel, the which men note;
His bok is Abbategnyh hote.

Danz Tholome is noght the leste,
1460Which makth the bok of Almageste;

P. iii.
133

Quintadecima
stella vocatur
Cauda Scorpionis,
cuius lapis
Calcedonia et
herba Maiorana
est.

[AUTHORS OF THE
SCIENCE OF
ASTRONOMY.]

Nota hic de
Auctoribus illis,
qui ad Astronomie
scienciam pre
ceteris studiosius
intendentes libros
super hoc distinctis
nominibus
composuerunt.

P. iii.
134

And Alfraganus doth the same,
 Whos bok is Chatemuz be name.
 Gebuz and Alpetragus eke
 Of Planisperie, which men seke, [1042](#)
 The bokes made: and over this
 Ful many a worthi clerc ther is,
 That writen upon this clergie
 The bokes of Altemetrie,
 Planemetrie and ek also,
 1470Whiche as belongen bothe tuo,
 So as thei ben naturiens,
 Unto these Astronomiens.
 Men sein that Habraham was on; [1043](#)
 Bot whether that he wrot or non,
 That finde I noght; and Moïses
 Ek was an other: bot Hermes
 Above alle othre in this science [1044](#)
 He hadde a gret experience;
 Thurgh him was many a sterre assised,
 1480Whos bokes yit ben auctorized.
 I mai noght knowen alle tho
 That writen in the time tho
 Of this science; bot I finde,
 Of jugement be weie of kinde
 That in o point thei alle acorden:
 Of sterres whiche thei recorden
 That men mai sen upon the hevene,
 Ther ben a thousand sterres evene
 And tuo and twenty, to the syhte
 1490Whiche aren of hemself so bryhte, [1045](#)
 That men mai dieme what thei be,
 The nature and the proprete.
 Nou hast thou herd, in which a wise [1046](#)
 These noble Philosophres wise
 Enformeden this yonge king,
 And made him have a knowleching

Of thing which ferst to the partie
 Belongeth of Philosophie,
 Which Theorique cleped is,
 1500As thou tofore hast herd er this.
 Bot nou to speke of the secounde,
 Which Aristotle hath also founde,
 And techeth hou to speke faire,
 Which is a thing full necessaire
 To contrepise the balance,
 Wher lacketh other sufficance.

v. *Compositi pulcra sermonis verba*
*placere*¹⁰⁴⁷

[ii. RHETORIC.]

Principio poterunt, veraque fine placent.
Herba, lapis, sermo, tria sunt virtute repleta,
*Vis tamen ex verbi pondere plura facit.*¹⁰⁴⁸

Above alle erthli creatures
 The hihe makere of natures
 The word to man hath yove alone,
 1510So that the speche of his persone,
 Or forto lese or forto winne,
 The hertes thoght which is withinne
 Mai schewe, what it wolde mene;
 And that is noghwhere elles sene
 Of kinde with non other beste.
 So scholde he be the more honeste,
 To whom god yaf so gret a yifte,
 And loke wel that he ne schifte
 Hise wordes to no wicked us;
 1520For word the techer of vertus
 Is cleped in Philosophie.
 Wherof touchende this partie,
 Is Rethorique the science
 Appropred to the reverence
 Of wordes that ben resonable:
 And for this art schal be vailable

Hic tractat de
 secunda parte
 Philosophie, cuius
 nomen Rethorica
 facundos efficit.
 Loquitur eciam de
 eiusdem duabus
 speciebus, scilicet
 Grammatica et
 Logica, quarum
 doctrina Rethor sua
 verba perornat.

P. iii.
136

With goodli wordes forto like,
 It hath Gramaire, it hath Logique,
 That serven bothe unto the speche.
 1530 Gramaire ferste hath forto teche [1049](#)
 To speke upon congruite:
 Logique hath eke in his degre
 Betwen the trouthe and the falshode
 The pleine wordes forto schode,
 So that nothing schal go beside,
 That he the riht ne schal decide,
 Wherof full many a gret debat
 Reformed is to good astat,
 And pes sustiened up alofte
 1540 With esy wordes and with softe,
 Wher strengthe scholde lete it falle.
 The Philosophre amonges alle
 Forthi commendeth this science,
 Which hath the reule of eloquence.
 In Ston and gras vertu ther is, [1050](#)
 Bot yit the bokes tellen this,
 That word above alle erthli thinges
 Is vertuous in his doinges,
 Wher so it be to evele or goode.
 1550 For if the wordes semen goode
 And ben wel spoke at mannes Ere,
 Whan that ther is no trouthe there,
 Thei don fulofte gret deceipte;
 For whan the word to the conceipte
 Descordeth in so double a wise,
 Such Rethorique is to despise
 In every place, and forto drede.
 For of Uluxes thus I rede,
 As in the bok of Troie is founde,
 1560 His eloquence and his facounde
 Of goodly wordes whiche he tolde,
 Hath mad that Anthenor him solde
 The toun, which he with tresoun wan.

Word hath beguiled many a man;
 With word the wilde beste is daunted,
 With word the Serpent is enchaunted,
 Of word among the men of Armes
 Ben woundes heeled with the charmes,
 Wher lacketh other medicine;
 1570 Word hath under his discipline
 Of Sorcerie the karectes.
 The wordes ben of sondri sectes,
 Of evele and eke of goode also;
 The wordes maken frend of fo, [1051](#)
 And fo of frend, and pes of werre,
 And werre of pes, and out of herre
 The word this worldes cause entriketh, [1052](#)
 And reconsileth whan him liketh.
 The word under the coupe of hevene
 1580 Set every thing or odde or evene;
 With word the hihe god is plesed,
 With word the wordes ben appesed,
 The softe word the loude stilleth;
 Wher lacketh good, the word fulfillleth,
 To make amendes for the wrong;
 Whan wordes medlen with the song,
 It doth plesance wel the more.
 Bot forto loke upon the lore [1053](#)
 Hou Tullius his Rethorique [1054](#)
 1590 Componeth, ther a man mai pike
 Hou that he schal hise wordes sette,
 Hou he schal lose, hou he schal knette,
 And in what wise he schal pronounce
 His tale plein withoute frounce.
 Wherof ensample if thou wolt seche,
 Tak hiede and red whilom the speche [1055](#)
 Of Julius and Cithero, [1056](#)
 Which consul was of Rome tho,
 Of Catoun eke and of Cillene,

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Nota de
 Eloquencia Iulii in
 causa Cateline
 contra Cillenum et
 alios tunc vrbis
 Rome Conciues.

1600 Behold the wordes hem betwene,
Whan the tresoun of Cateline
Descoevered was, and the covine
Of hem that were of his assent
Was knowe and spoke in parlement,
And axed hou and in what wise
Men scholde don hem to juisse.
Cillenus ferst his tale tolde,
To trouthe and as he was beholde, [1057](#)
The comun profit forto save,

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1610 He seide hou tresoun scholde have
A cruel deth; and thus thei spieke,
The Consul bothe and Catoun eke,
And seiden that for such a wrong
Ther mai no peine be to strong.
Bot Julius with wordes wise
His tale tolde al otherwise,
As he which wolde her deth respite,
And fondeth hou he mihte excite
The jugges thurgh his eloquence [1058](#)

1620 Fro deth to torne the sentence
And sette here hertes to pite.
Nou tolden thei, nou tolde he;
Thei spieken plein after the lawe,
Bot he the wordes of his sawe
Coloureth in an other weie
Spekende, and thus betwen the tweie,
To trete upon this juggement,
Made ech of hem his Argument.
Wherof the tales forto hiere,

1630 Ther mai a man the Scolle liere
Of Rethoriques eloquences,
Which is the secounde of sciences
Touchende to Philosophie;
Wherof a man schal justifie
Hise wordes in disputeisoun,
And knette upon conclusioun

P. iii.
140

His Argument in such a forme,
Which mai the pleine trouthe enforme
And the soubtil cautele abate,
1640 Which every trewman schal debate. [1059](#)

vi. *Practica quemque statum pars tercia*
Philosophie

[iii. PRACTIC.]

Ad regimen recte ducit in orbe vie:
Set quanto maior Rex est, tanto magis ipsum
Hec scola concernit, qua sua regna regat. [1060](#)

The ferste, which is Theorique,
And the secounde Rethorique,
Sciences of Philosophie,
I have hem told as in partie,
So as the Philosophe it tolde
To Alisandre: and nou I wolde
Telle of the thridde what it is,
The which Practique cleped is.

Hic tractat de
tercia parte
Philosophie, que
Practica vocatur,
cuius species sunt
tres, scilicet Etica,
Ichonomia et
Policia, quarum
doctrina regia
magestas in suo
regimine ad
honoris
magnificenciam
per singula
dirigitur.

Practique stant upon thre thinges
1650 Toward the governance of kinges;
Wherof the first Etique is named, [1061](#)
The whos science stant proclamed
To teche of vertu thilke reule,
Hou that a king himself schal reule
Of his moral condicion
With worthi disposicion
Of good livinge in his persone,
Which is the chief of his corone.

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It makth a king also to lerne
1660 Hou he his bodi schal governe,
Hou he schal wake, hou he schal slepe,
Hou that he schal his hele kepe
In mete, in drinke, in clothinge eke:
Ther is no wisdom forto seke
As for the reule of his persone,
The which that this science al one [1062](#)
Ne techeth as be weie of kinde,
That ther is nothing left behinde.

That other point which to Practique
1670 Belongeth is Iconomique, [1063](#)

Which techeth thilke honestete¹⁰⁶⁴
Thurgh which a king in his degre
His wif and child schal reule and guie,
So forth with al the companie
Which in his houshold schal abyde,
And his astat on every syde
In such manere forto lede,
That he his houshold ne mislede.

Practique hath yit the thridde aprise,
1680 Which techeth hou and in what wise

Thurgh hih pourveied ordinance¹⁰⁶⁵
A king schal sette in governance
His Realme, and that is Policie,
Which longeth unto Regalie
In time of werre, in time of pes,
To worschipe and to good encress
Of clerk, of kniht and of Marchant,
And so forth of the remenant¹⁰⁶⁶
Of al the comun poeple aboute,

1690 Withinne Burgh and ek withoute,¹⁰⁶⁷
Of hem that ben Artificiers,
Whiche usen craftes and mestiers,
Whos Art is cleped Mechanique.
And though thei ben noght alle like,
Yit natheles, hou so it falle,¹⁰⁶⁸
O lawe mot governe hem alle,
Or that thei lese or that thei winne,
After thastat that thei ben inne.¹⁰⁶⁹

Lo, thus this worthi yonge king
1700 Was fulli tauht of every thing,
Which mihte yive entendement
Of good reule and good regiment
To such a worthi Prince as he.
Bot of verray necessite
The Philosophre him hath betake
Fyf pointz, whiche he hath undertake

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[FIVE POINTS OF
POLICY.]

To kepe and holde in observance,
As for the worthi governance
Which longeth to his Regalie,
1710After the reule of Policie.

vii. *Moribus ornatus regit hic qui regna
moderna,
Cercius expectat ceptra futura poli.
Et quia veridica virtus supereminet omnes,
Regis ab ore boni fabula nulla sonat.*

[THE FIRST POINT
OF POLICY. TRUTH.]

To every man behoveth lore,¹⁰⁷⁰
Bot to noman belongeth more
Than to a king, which hath to lede
The poeple; for of his kinghede
He mai hem bothe save and spille.
And for it stant upon his wille,
It sit him wel to ben avised,
And the vertus whiche are assised¹⁰⁷²
Unto a kinges Regiment,
1720To take in his entendement:
Wherof to tellen, as thei stonde,
Hierafterward nou woll I fonde.
Among the vertus on is chief,
And that is trouthe, which is lief
To god and ek to man also.
And for it hath ben evere so,
Tawhte Aristotle, as he wel couthe,
To Alisandre, hou in his youthe
He scholde of trouthe thilke grace
1730With al his hole herte embrace,
So that his word be trewe and plein,
Toward the world and so certein
That in him be no double speche:
For if men scholde trouthe seche
And founde it noght withinne a king,
It were an unsittende thing.

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Hic secundum
Policiam tractare
intendit precipue
super quinque
regularum
Articulis, que ad
Principis Regimen
obseruande
specialius
existunt,¹⁰⁷¹
quarum prima
veritas nuncupatur.
Per quam veridicus
fit sermo Regis ad
omnes.

The word is tokne of that withinne,
Ther schal a worthi king beginne
To kepe his tunge and to be trewe,
1740 So schal his pris ben evere newe.

Avise him every man tofore,
And be wel war, er he be swore,
For afterward it is to late,
If that he wole his word debate. [1073](#)

For as a king in special
Above all othre is principal
Of his pouer, so scholde he be
Most vertuous in his degre;
And that mai wel be signefied [1074](#)

1750 Be his corone and specified.

The gold betokneth excellence,
That men schull don him reverence
As to here liege sovereign.
The Stones, as the bokes sein,
Commended ben in treble wise:
Ferst thei ben harde, and thilke assisse
Betokneth in a king Constance,
So that ther schal no variance
Be founde in his condicion;

1760 And also be descripcion

The vertu which is in the stones
A verrai Signe is for the nones
Of that a king schal ben honeste
And holde trewly his beheste
Of thing which longeth to kinghede:
The bryhte colour, as I rede,
Which in the stones is schynende,
Is in figure betoknende

The Cronique of this worldes fame, [1076](#)

1770 Which stant upon his goode name. [1077](#)

The cercle which is round aboute
Is tokne of al the lond withoute,
Which stant under his Gerarchie,

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144

Nota super hiis que
in corona Regis
designantur. [1075](#)

That he it schal wel kepe and gye.
And for that trouthe, hou so it falle,
Is the vertu sovereign of alle,
That longeth unto regiment,
A tale, which is evident
Of trouthe in comendacioun,
1780 Toward thin enformacion,
Mi Sone, hierafter thou schalt hiere
Of a Cronique in this matiere.

As the Cronique it doth reherce,
A Soldan whilom was of Perce,
Which Daires hihte, and Ytaspis
His fader was; and soth it is
That thurgh wisdom and hih prudence
Mor than for eny reverence
Of his lignage as be descente¹⁰⁷⁸
1790 The regne of thilke empire he hente:
And as he was himselve wys,¹⁰⁷⁹
The wisemen he hield in pris¹⁰⁸⁰
And soghte hem oute on every side,¹⁰⁸¹
That toward him thei scholde abide.
Among the whiche thre ther were
That most service unto him bere
As thei which in his chambre lyhen¹⁰⁸³
And al his conseil herde and syhen.
Here names ben of strange note,
1800 Arpaghes was the ferste hote,¹⁰⁸⁴
And Manachaz was the secounde,
Zorobabel, as it is founde
In the Cronique, was the thridde.
This Soldan, what so him betidde,
To hem he triste most of alle,¹⁰⁸⁵
Wherof the cas is so befall: e
This lord, which hath conceiptes depe,
Upon a nyht whan he hath slepe,

[KING, WINE,
WOMAN AND
TRUTH.]

Hic narrat, qualiter
Darius filius
Ytaspis Soldanus
Percie a tribus suis
Cubiculariis,
quorum nomina
Arpaghes,
Manachaz et
Zorobabel dicta
sunt, nomine
questionis
singillatim
interrogavit, vtrum
Rex aut mulier aut
vinum maioris
fortitudinis vim
obtineret: ipsis
vero varia opinione
respondentibus,
Zorobabel vltimus
asseruit¹⁰⁸² quod
mulier sui amoris
complacencia tam
Regis quam vini
potenciam excellit.
Addidit insuper pro
finali conclusione
dicens, quod
veritas super omnia
vincit. Cuius
responsio ceteris
laudabilior
acceptabatur.

As he which hath his wit desposed,
1810 Touchende a point hem hath opposed.

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The kinges question was this;
Of thinges thre which strengest is,
The wyn, the womman or the king:
And that thei scholde upon this thing
Of here ansuere avised be, [1086](#)
He yaf hem fulli daies thre,
And hath behote hem be his feith
That who the beste reson seith,
He schal resceive a worthi mede.
1820 Upon this thing thei token hiede
And stoden in desputeison,
That be diverse opinion
Of Argumentz that thei have holde
Arpaghes first his tale tolde,
And seide hou that the strengthe of kinges
Is myhtiest of alle thinges.
For king hath pouer over man,
And man is he which reson can,
As he which is of his nature

1830 The moste noble creature
Of alle tho that god hath wrought:
And be that skile it semeth noght,
He seith, that eny erthly thing
Mai be so myhty as a king.
A king mai spille, a king mai save,
A king mai make of lord a knave [1087](#)
And of a knave a lord also:
The pouer of a king stant so,
That he the lawes overpasseth;

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1840 What he wol make lasse, he lasseth,
What he wol make more, he moreth;
And as the gentil faucon soreth, [1088](#)
He fleth, that noman him reclameth;
Bot he al one alle othre tameth,
And stant himself of lawe fre.

Lo, thus a kinges myht, seith he,
So as his reson can argue,
Is strengest and of most value.

Bot Manachaz seide otherwise,
1850 That wyn is of the more emprise;
And that he scheweth be this weie.
The wyn fulofte takth aweie
The reson fro the mannes herte;
The wyn can make a krepel sterte,
And a delivere man unwelde;
It makth a blind man to behelde,
And a bryht yhed seme derk;
It makth a lewed man a clerk,
And fro the clerkes the clergie

1860 It takth aweie, and couardie
It torneth into hardiesse;
Of Avarice it makth largesse.
The wyn makth ek the goode blod,
In which the Soule which is good
Hath chosen hire a resting place,
Whil that the lif hir wole embrace.
And be this skile Manachas
Ansuered hath upon this cas,
And seith that wyn be weie of kinde
1870 Is thing which mai the hertes binde
Wel more than the regalie.

Zorobabel for his partie
Seide, as him thoghte for the beste,
That wommen ben the myhtieste.
The king and the vinour also
Of wommen comen bothe tuo;
And ek he seide hou that manhede
Thurgh strengthe unto the wommanhede
Of love, wher he wole or non,
1880 Obeie schal; and therupon,
To schewe of wommen the maistrie,
A tale which he syh with yhe¹⁰⁸⁹

As for ensample he tolde this,—[1090](#)

Hou Apemen, of Besazis[1091](#)

Which dowhter was, in the paleis

Sittende upon his hihe deis,

Whan he was hottest in his ire

Toward the grete of his empire,

Cirus the king tirant sche tok,

1890 And only with hire goodly lok

Sche made him debonaire and meke,

And be the chyn and be the cheke

Sche luggeth him riht as hir liste,

That nou sche japeth, nou sche kiste,

And doth with him what evere hir liketh;

Whan that sche loureth, thanne he siketh,

And whan sche gladeth, he is glad:

And thus this king was overlad

With hire which his lemman was.

1900 Among the men is no solas,

If that ther be no womman there;

For bot if that the wommen were,[1092](#)

This worldes joie were aweie:

Thurgh hem men finden out the weie

To knihthode and to worldes fame;

Thei make a man to drede schame,

And honour forto be desired:

Thurgh the Beaute of hem is fyred

The Dart of which Cupide throweth,

1910 Wherof the jolif peine groweth,

Which al the world hath under fote.

A womman is the mannes bote,

His lif, his deth, his wo, his wel;

And this thing mai be schewed wel,

Hou that wommen ben goode and kihde,

For in ensample this I finde.

Whan that the duk Ametus lay

Sek in his bedd, that every day

Men waiten whan he scholde deie,

Nota hic de vigore
amoris, qui inter
Cirum Regem
Persarum et
Apemen Besazis
filiam ipsius Regis
Concubinam
spectante tota
Curia experiebatur.

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[TALE OF
ALCESTIS.]

1920 Alceste his wif goth forto preie,
As sche which wolde thonk deserve,
With Sacrifice unto Minerve,
To wite ansuere of the goddesse
Hou that hir lord of his seknesse,
Wherof he was so wo besein,
Recovere myhte his hele ayein.
Lo, thus sche cride and thus sche preide,
Til ate laste a vois hir seide,
That if sche wolde for his sake

1930 The maladie soffre and take,
And deie hirself, he scholde live.
Of this ansuere Alceste hath yive [1093](#)
Unto Minerve gret thonkinge,
So that hir deth and his livinge
Sche ches with al hire hole entente,
And thus acorded hom sche wente.
Into the chambre and whan sche cam,
Hire housebonde anon sche nam
In bothe hire Armes and him kiste,

1940 And spak unto him what hire liste;
And therupon withinne a throwe
This goode wif was overthrowe [1094](#)
And deide, and he was hool in haste.
So mai a man be reson taste,
Hou next after the god above
The trouthe of wommen and the love,
In whom that alle grace is founde,
Is myhtiest upon this grounde
And most behovely manyfold.

1950 Lo, thus Zorobabel hath told
The tale of his opinion:
Bot for final conclusion
What strengest is of erthli thinges,
The wyn, the wommen or the kinges,
He seith that trouthe above hem alle
Is myhtiest, hou evere it falle.

Nota de fidelitate
Coniugis, qualiter
Alcesta vxor
Ameti, vt maritum
suum viuificaret,
seipsam morti
spontanee subegit.

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The trouthe, hou so it evere come,
 Mai for nothing ben overcome;
 It mai wel soffre for a throwe,
 1960 Bot ate laste it schal be knowe.
 The proverbe is, who that is trewe,
 Him schal his while nevere rewe:
 For hou so that the cause wende,
 The trouthe is schameles ate ende,
 Bot what thing that is troutheles,
 It mai noght wel be schameles,
 And schame hindreth every wyht:
 So proveth it, ther is no myht
 Withoute trouthe in no degre.
 1970 And thus for trouthe of his decre
 Zorobabel was most commended,
 Wherof the question was ended,
 And he resceived hath his mede
 For trouthe, which to mannes nede
 Is most behoveliche overal.
 Forthi was trouthe in special
 The ferste point in observance
 Betake unto the governance¹⁰⁹⁵
 Of Alisandre, as it is seid:
 1980 For therupon the ground is leid¹⁰⁹⁶
 Of every kinges regiment,
 As thing which most convenient
 Is forto sette a king in evene
 Bothe in this world and ek in hevene.

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viii. *Absit Auaricia, ne tangat regia corda,* [THE SECOND POINT
*Eius enim spoliis exoriatur humus.*¹⁰⁹⁷ OF POLICY.
Fama colit largum volitans per secula LIBERALITY.]
Regem,
Dona tamen licitis sunt moderanda modis.

Next after trouthe the secounde,
 In Policie as it is founde,

Which serveth to the worldes fame
 In worschipe of a kinges name,
 Largesse it is, whos privilegge
 1990 Ther mai non Avarice abregge.
 The worldes good was ferst comune,
 Bot afterward upon fortune
 Was thilke comun profit cessed:
 For whan the poeple stod encresced
 And the lignages woxen grete,
 Anon for singulier beyete
 Drouh every man to his partie;
 Wherof cam in the ferste envie
 With gret debat and werres stronge,
 2000 And laste among the men so longe,
 Til noman wiste who was who,
 Ne which was frend ne which was fo.
 Til ate laste in every lond
 Withinne hemself the poeple fond
 That it was good to make a king,
 Which mihte appesen al this thing
 And yive riht to the lignages
 In partinge of here heritages
 And ek of al here other good;
 2010 And thus above hem alle stod
 The king upon his Regalie,
 As he which hath to justifie
 The worldes good fro covoitise.
 So sit it wel in alle wise
 A king betwen the more and lesse¹⁰⁹⁹
 To sette his herte upon largesse
 Toward himself and ek also
 Toward his poeple; and if noght so,
 That is to sein, if that he be
 2020 Toward himselven large and fre
 And of his poeple take and pile,¹¹⁰⁰
 Largesse be no weie of skile
 It mai be seid, bot Avarice,

Hic tractat de regie
 maiestatis secunda
 Policia, quam
 Aristotiles
 largitatem vocat:
 cuius virtute non
 solum propulsata
 Avaricia Regis
 nomen magnificum
 extollitur, set et sui
 subditi omni¹⁰⁹⁸
 diuiciarum
 habundancia
 iocundiores
 efficiuntur.

Which in a king is a gret vice.
 A king behoveth ek to fle
 The vice of Prodegalite,
 That he mesure in his expence
 So kepe, that of indigence
 He mai be sauf: for who that nedeth,
 2030 In al his werk the worse he spedeth.
 As Aristotle upon Chaldee
 Ensample of gret Auctorite
 Unto king Alisandre tauhte
 Of thilke folk that were unsauhte
 Toward here king for his pilage:
 Wherof he bad, in his corage
 That he unto thre pointz entende,
 Wher that he wolde his good despende.
 Ferst scholde he loke, hou that it stod,
 2040 That al were of his oghne good
 The yiftes whiche he wolde yive;
 So myhte he wel the betre live:
 And ek he moste taken hiede¹¹⁰¹
 If ther be cause of eny nede,
 Which oghte forto be defended,
 Er that his goodes be despended:
 He mot ek, as it is befalle,
 Amonges othre thinges alle
 Se the decertes of his men;
 2050 And after that thei ben of ken
 And of astat and of merite,
 He schal hem largeliche aquite,
 Or for the werre, or for the pes,
 That non honour falle in descres,
 Which mihte torne into defame,
 Bot that he kepe his goode name,
 So that he be noght holde unkinde.
 For in Cronique a tale I finde,
 Which spekth somdiel of this matiere,
 2060 Hierafterward as thou schalt hiere.

Nota super hoc
 quod Aristotiles
 Alexandrum
 exemplificauit de
 exaccionibus Regis
 Chaldeorum.

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In Rome, to poursuie his riht,
 Ther was a worthi povere kniht,
 Which cam al one forto sein
 His cause, when the court was plein,
 Wher Julius was in presence.
 And for him lacketh of despence,
 Ther was with him non advocat
 To make ple for his astat.
 Bot thogh him lacke forto plede,
 Him lacketh nothing of manhede;
 He wiste wel his pours was povere,
 Bot yit he thoghte his riht recovere,
 2070 And openly poverte alleide,
 To themperour and thus he seide:
 ‘O Julius, lord of the lawe,
 Behold, mi conseil is withdrawe
 For lacke of gold: do thin office¹¹⁰³
 After the lawes of justice:¹¹⁰⁴
 Help that I hadde conseil hiere
 2080 Upon the trouthe of mi matiere.’
 And Julius with that anon
 Assigned him a worthi on,
 Bot he himself no word ne spak.
 This kniht was wroth and fond a lak
 In themperour, and seide thus:
 ‘O thou unkinde Julius,
 Whan thou in thi bataille were
 Up in Aufrique, and I was there,
 Mi myht for thi rescousse I dede
 2090 And putte noman in my stede,
 Thou wost what woundes ther I hadde:
 Bot hier I finde thee so badde,
 That thee ne liste speke o word¹¹⁰⁵
 Thin oghne mouth, nor of thin hord
 To yive a florin me to helpe.
 Hou scholde I thanne me beyelp
 Fro this dai forth of thi largesse,

[TALE OF JULIUS
 AND THE POOR
 KNIGHT.]

Hic secundum
 gesta Iulii
 exemplum ponit,
 qualiter Rex
 suorum militum,
 quos probos
 agnouerit,
 indigenciam
 largitatis sue
 beneficiis
 releuare¹¹⁰²
 tenetur.

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Whan such a gret unkindenesse
 Is founde in such a lord as thou?’
 2100 This Julius knew wel ynou
 That al was soth which he him tolde;
 And for he wolde noght ben holde
 Unkinde, he tok his cause on honde,
 And as it were of goddes sonde,
 He yaf him good ynouh to spende
 For evere into his lives ende. [1106](#)
 And thus scholde every worthi king
 Take of his knihtes knowleching,
 Whan that he syh thei hadden nede,
 2110 For every service axeth mede:
 Bot othre, whiche have noght deserved
 Thurgh vertu, bot of japes served,
 A king schal noght deserve grace,
 Thogh he be large in such a place.

P. iii.
 156

It sit wel every king to have
 Discrecion, whan men him crave,
 So that he mai his yifte wite:
 Wherof I finde a tale write,
 Hou Cinichus a povere kniht
 A Somme which was over myht 2120
 Preide of his king Antigonus.
 The king ansuerde to him thus, [1107](#)
 And seide hou such a yifte passeth
 His povere astat: and thanne he lasseth,
 And axeth bot a litel peny,
 If that the king wol yive him eny.
 The king ansuerde, it was to smal
 For him, which was a lord real; [1108](#)
 To yive a man so litel thing
 2130 It were unworschipe in a king.

[ANTIGONUS AND
 CINICHUS.]

Hic ponit
 exemplum de Rege
 Antigono, qualiter
 dona regia
 secundum maius et
 minus equa
 discrecione
 moderanda sunt.

P. iii.
 157

Be this ensample a king mai lere
 That forto yive is in manere:
 For if a king his tresor lasseth

[DISCRETION IN
 GIVING.]

Without honour and thonkles passeth,
 Whan he himself wol so beguile,
 I not who schal compleigne his while,
 Ne who be rihte him schal relieve.
 Bot natheles this I believe,
 To helpe with his oghne lond
 2140 Behoveth every man his hond [1109](#)
 To sette upon necessite;
 And ek his kinges realte
 Mot every liege man conforte,
 With good and bodi to supporte,
 Whan thei se cause resonable:
 For who that is noght entendable
 To holde upriht his kinges name,
 Him oghte forto be to blame.
 Of Policie and overmore
 2150 To speke in this matiere more,
 So as the Philosophre tolde,
 A king after the reule is holde
 To modifie and to adresce
 Hise yiftes upon such largesce
 That he mesure noght excede:
 For if a king falle into nede,
 It causeth ofte sondri thinges
 Whiche are ungoodly to the kinges. [1112](#)
 What man wol noght himself mesure,
 2160 Men sen fulofte that mesure
 Him hath forsake: and so doth he
 That useth Prodegalite,
 Which is the moder of poverte,
 Wherof the londes ben deserte;
 And namely whan thilke vice
 About a king stant in office
 And hath withholde of his partie
 The covoitouse flaterie,
 Which many a worthi king deceiveth,
 2170 Er he the fallas aperceiveth

Nota hic quod
 Regius status a suis
 fidelibus omni
 fauore
 supportandus est.

[PRODIGALITY OF
KINGS.]

Nota hic secundum
 Aristotilem, [1110](#)
 qualiter Principum
 Prodegalitas
 paupertatem
 inducit
 communem.
 Seneca. [1111](#) Sic
 aliis benefacito, vt
 tibi non noceas.

P. iii.
158

Of hem that serven to the glose.
For thei that cunnen plese and glose,
Ben, as men tellen, the norrices
Unto the fostringe of the vices,
Wherof fulofte natheles
A king is blamed gulteles.

A Philosophre, as thou schalt hiere,
Spak to a king of this matiere,
And seide him wel hou that flatours
2180 Coupable were of thre errors.
On was toward the goddes hihe,
That weren wrothe of that thei sihe
The meschief which befalle scholde
Of that the false flatour tolde.
Toward the king an other was,
Whan thei be sleihte and be fallas
Of feigned wordes make him wene
That blak is whyt and blew is grene
Touchende of his condicion:

2190 For whanne he doth extorcion
With manye an other vice mo,
Men schal noght finden on of tho
To groucche or speke therayein,
Bot holden up his oil and sein
That al is wel, what evere he doth;
And thus of fals thei maken soth,
So that here kinges yhe is blent
And wot not hou the world is went. [1113](#)

The thridde errour is harm comune,
2200 With which the poeple mot commune
Of wronges that thei bringen inne:
And thus thei worchen treble sinne,
That ben flatours aboute a king.
Ther myhte be no worse thing
Aboute a kinges regalie,
Thanne is the vice of flaterie.

And natheles it hath ben used,

[FLATTERERS.]

Nota qualiter in
principum curiis
adulatores triplici
grauitate
offendunt.

Primo contra
deum.

Secundo contra
Principem.

P. iii.
159

Tercio contra
populum. [1114](#)

That it was nevere yit refused
 As forto speke in court real;
 2210 For there it is most special,
 And mai noght longe be forbore.
 Bot whan this vice of hem is bore,
 That scholden the vertus forthbringe,
 And trouthe is torned to lesinge,
 It is, as who seith, ayein kinde,
 Wherof an old ensample I finde.

Among these othre tales wise
 Of Philosophres, in this wise
 I rede, how whilom tuo ther were,
 And to the Scole forto lere
 2220 Unto Athenes fro Cartage
 Here frendes, whan thei were of Age,
 Hem sende; and ther thei stoden longe,
 Til thei such lore have underfonge,
 That in here time thei surmonte
 Alle othre men, that to acompte
 Of hem was tho the grete fame.
 The ferste of hem his rihte name
 Was Diogenes thanne hote,
 2230 In whom was founde no riote:
 His felaw Arisippus hyhte,
 Which mochel couthe and mochel myhte.
 Bot ate laste, soth to sein,
 Thei bothe tornen hom ayein
 Unto Cartage and scole lete.
 This Diogenes no beyete
 Of worldes good or lasse or more
 Ne soghte for his longe lore,
 Bot tok him only forto duelle
 2240 At hom; and as the bokes telle,
 His hous was nyh to the rivere
 Besyde a bregge, as thou schalt hiere.
 Ther duelleth he to take his reste, [1116](#)

[TALE OF DIOGENES
 AND ARISTIPPUS]

P. iii.
160

[1115](#) Hic contra
 vanitates
 adulantum
 loquitur, et narrat
 quod cum
 Arisippus de
 Cartagine
 Philosophus scole
 studium relinquens
 sui Principis
 obsequio in magnis
 adulacionibus pre
 ceteris carior
 assistebat, accidit
 vt ipse quodam die
 Diogenem
 Philosophum nuper
 socium suum,
 virum tam moribus
 quam sciencia
 probatissimum,
 herbas ad olera sua
 collectas lauante
 ex casu ad ripam
 inuenit: cui ait, 'O
 Diogenes, vere si
 tu sicut et ego
 Principi tuo placere
 scires, huiusmodi
 herbas aut colligere
 aut lauare tibi
 minime indigeret.'

So as it thoghte him for the beste,
To studie in his Philosophie,
As he which wolde so defie
The worldes pompe on every syde.

Bot Arisippe his bok aside
Hath leid, and to the court he wente,
Wher many a wyle and many a wente
2250 With flaterie and wordes soft¹¹¹⁷
He caste, and hath compassed ofte
Hou he his Prince myhte plese;
And in this wise he gat him ese
Of vein honour and worldes good.
The londes reule upon him stod,
The king of him was wonder glad,
And all was do, what thing he bad,
Bothe in the court and ek withoute.

2260 With flaterie he broghte aboute
His pourpos of the worldes werk,
Which was ayein the stat of clerk,¹¹¹⁸
So that Philosophie he lefte
And to richesse himself uplefte:
Lo, thus hadde Arisippe his wille.

Bot Diogenes duelte stille
At home and loked on his bok:
He soghte noght the worldes crok
For vein honour ne for richesse,
2270 Bot all his hertes besinesse
He sette to be vertuous;
And thus withinne his oghne hous
He liveth to the sufficance
Of his havinge. And fell per chance,
This Diogene upon a day,
And that was in the Monthe of May,
Whan that these herbes ben holsome,
He walketh forto gadre some

In his gardin, of whiche his joutes
2280 He thoghte have, and thus aboutes

Cui alter respondit,
'O Arisippe, certe
et si tu sicut et ego
olera tua colligere
et lauare scires,
principem tuum ob
inanis glorie
cupiditatem
blandiri nullatenus
deberes.'

P. iii.
161

P. iii.
162

Whanne he hath gadred what him liketh,
 He satte him thanne doun and pyketh,^{[1119](#)}
 And wyssh his herbes in the flod
 Upon the which his gardin stod,
 Nyh to the bregge, as I tolde er.
 And hapneth, whil he sitteth ther,
 Cam Arisippes be the strete
 With manye hors and routes grete,
 And straght unto the bregge he rod,
 2290Wher that he hoved and abod;
 For as he caste his yhe nyh,
 His felaw Diogene he syh,
 And what he dede he syh also,
 Wherof he seide to him so:^{[1120](#)}
 ‘O Diogene, god thee spede.
 It were certes litel nede
 To sitte there and wortes pyke,
 If thou thi Prince couthest lyke,
 So as I can in my degre.’
 2300 ‘O Arisippe,’ ayein quod he,
 ‘If that thou couthist, so as I,
 Thi wortes pyke, trewely
 It were als litel nede or lasse,
 That thou so worldly wolt compasse
 With flaterie forto serve,
 Wherof thou thenkest to deserve
 Thi princes thonk, and to pourchace
 Hou thou myht stonden in his grace,
 For getinge of a litel good.
 2310If thou wolt take into thi mod
 Reson, thou myht be reson deeme
 That so thi prince forto queeme
 Is noght to reson acordant,
 Bot it is gretly discordant
 Unto the Scoles of Athene.’
 Lo, thus ansuerde Diogene
 Ayein the clerkes flaterie.

Bot yit men sen thessamplerie¹¹²¹
Of Arisippe is wel received,
2320 And thilke of Diogene is weyved.
Office in court and gold in cofre
Is nou, men sein, the philosophre
Which hath the worschipe in the halle;
Bot flaterie passeth alle
In chambre, whom the court avanceth;
For upon thilke lot it chanceth
To be beloved nou aday.
*I not if it be ye or nay,
Bot as the comun vois it telleth;¹¹²²
2330 Bot wher that flaterie duelleth¹¹²³

[FLATTERY.]

*I not if it be ye or nay.
How Dante the poete answerde¹¹²⁴
To a flatour, the tale I herde.
2330 Upon a strif bitwen hem tuo
He seide him, 'Ther ben many mo¹¹²⁵
Of thy servantes than of myne.
For the poete of his covyne
Hath non that wol him clothe and fede,
But a flatour may reule and lede
A king with al his loun aboute.'
So stant the wise man in doute
Of hem that to folie drawe:
2340 For such is now the newe lawe,
And as the comune vois it telleth,
Wher now that flaterie duelleth
In every lond etc. (*as* 2331 ff.)

[EXAMPLE OF
DANTE.]

Nota exemplum
cuiusdam poete de
Ytalia, qui Dante
vocabatur.

P. iii.
164

In eny lond under the Sonne,¹¹²⁶
Ther is ful many a thing begonne
Which were betre to be left;
That hath be schewed nou and eft.

Bot if a Prince wolde him reule¹¹²⁷
Of the Romeins after the reule,
In thilke time as it was used,¹¹²⁸
This vice scholde be refused,
Wherof the Princes ben assoted.

2340 Bot wher the pleine trouthe is noted,
Ther may a Prince wel conceive,
That he schal noght himself deceive,
Of that he hiereth wordes pleine;
For him thar noght be reson pleigne,
That warned is er him be wo.
And that was fully proeved tho,
Whan Rome was the worldes chief,
The Sothseiere tho was lief,
Which wolde noght the trouthe spare,
2350 Bot with hise wordes pleine and bare
To Themperour hise sothes tolde,
As in Cronique is yit withholde,¹¹²⁹
Hierafterward as thou schalt hiere
Acordende unto this matiere.

To se this olde ensamplerie,
That whilom was no flaterie
Toward the Princes wel I finde;
Wherof so as it comth to mynde,
Mi Sone, a tale unto thin Ere,
2360 Whil that the worthi princes were
At Rome, I thenke forto tellen.
For whan the chances so befellen
That eny Emperour as tho¹¹³¹
Victoire hadde upon his fo,
And so forth cam to Rome ayein,
Of treble honour he was certain,

[THE ROMAN
TRIUMPH.]

P. iii.
165

¹¹³⁰Hic narrat
super eodem,
qualiter nuper
Romanorum
Imperator, cum
ipse triumphator in
hostes a bello
Rome rediret, tres
sibi laudes in
signum sui
triumphi precipue
debebantur: primo

Wherof that he was magnified.
 The ferste, as it is specefied,
 Was, whan he cam at thilke tyde,
 2370 The Charr in which he scholde ryde
 Foure whyte Stiedes scholden drawe;
 Of Jupiter be thilke lawe
 The Cote he scholde were also;
 Hise prisoners ek scholden go
 Endlong the Charr on eyther hond,
 And alle the nobles of the lond¹¹³²
 Tofore and after with him come
 Ridende and broghten him to Rome,
 In thonk of his chivalerie
 2380 And for non other flaterie.
 And that was schewed forth withal;
 Wher he sat in his Charr real,
 Beside him was a Ribald set,
 Which hadde hise wordes so beset,¹¹³⁶
 To themperour in al his gloire
 He seide, 'Tak into memoire,
 For al this pompe and al this pride
 Let no justice gon aside,
 Bot know thiself, what so befall.
 (2400) For men sen ofte time falle
 2390 Thing which men wende siker stonde:
 Thogh thou victoire have nou on honde,
 Fortune mai noght stonde alway;
 The whiel per chance an other day
 Mai torne, and thou myht overthrowe;
 Ther lasteth nothing bot a throwe.'
 With these wordes and with mo
 This Ribald, which sat with him tho,
 To Themperour his tale tolde:
 2400 And overmor what ever he wolde,
 Or were it evel or were it good,
 So plainly as the trouthe stod,
 He spareth noght, bot spekth it oute;

quatuor equi
 albissimi currum in
 quo sedebat
 veherent, secundo
 tunica Iovis pro
 tunc indueretur,
 tercio sui captiui
 prope currum ad
 vtrumque latus
 catenati
 deambulant. Set
 ne tanti honoris
 adulacio eius
 animum in
 superbiam
 extolleret, quidam
 scurra linguosus
 iuxta ipsum in
 curru sedebat, qui
 quasi continuatis
 vocibus
 improperando ei
 dixit, 'Notheos,'
 hoc est nosce
 teipsum, 'quia si
 hodie fortuna¹¹³³
 tibi prospera
 fuerit,¹¹³⁴ cras
 forte¹¹³⁵ versa rota
 mutabilis
 aduersabitur.'

P. iii.
 166

And so myhte every man aboute
The day of that solempnete
His tale telle als wel as he
To Themperour al openly.
And al was this the cause why;
That whil he stod in that noblesse, [1137](#)
2410 He scholde his vanite repressen
With suche wordes as he herde.

Lo nou, hou thilke time it ferde [1138](#)
Toward so hih a worthi lord:
For this I finde ek of record,
Which the Cronique hath auctorized.
What Emperour was entronized,
The ferste day of his corone,
Wher he was in his real Throne
And hield his feste in the paleis
Sittende upon his hihe deis
With al the lust that mai be gete,
Whan he was gladdest at his mete,
And every menstral hadde pleid,
And every Disour hadde seid [1140](#)
What most was plesant to his Ere,
Than ate laste comen there

2420 Hise Macons, for thei scholden crave
Wher that he wolde be begrave, [1141](#)
And of what Ston his sepulture

2430 Thei scholden make, and what sculpture
He wolde ordeine therupon.

Tho was ther flaterie non
The worthi princes to bejape;
The thing was other wise schape [1142](#)
With good conseil; and otherwise
Thei were hemselven thanne wise,
And understoden wel and knewen.
Whan suche softe wyndes blewen
Of flaterie into here Ere,

[THE EMPEROR AND
HIS MASONS.]

Hic eciam contra
adulacionem
scribit quod primo
die quo nuper
Imperator
intronizatus extitit,
latomi sui ab ipso
constanter peterent,
de quali lapide sue
sepulture tumulum
fabricarent; vt sic
futuram mortem
commemorans
vanitates huius
seculi transitorias
facilius
reprimeret. [1139](#)

P. iii.
167

2440Thei setten noght here hertes there;
Bot whan thei herden wordes feigned,
The pleine trouthe it hath desdeigned
Of hem that weren so discrete.
So tok the flatour no beyete¹¹⁴³
Of him that was his prince tho:
And forto proven it is so,
A tale which befell in dede
In a Cronique of Rome I rede.

P. iii.
168

Cesar upon his real throne
Wher that he sat in his persone
2450And was hiest in al his pris,
A man, which wolde make him wys,
Fell doun knelende in his presence,
And dede him such a reverence,
As thogh the hihe god it were:
Men hadden gret mervaille there
Of the worschipe which he dede.
This man aros fro thilke stede,
And forth with al the same tyde
2460He goth him up and be his side¹¹⁴⁴
He set him doun as pier and pier,¹¹⁴⁵
And seide, 'If thou that sittest hier
Art god, which alle thinges myht,
Thanne have I do worschipe ariht¹¹⁴⁶
As to the god; and other wise,
If thou be noght of thilke assisse,
Bot art a man such as am I,
Than mai I sitte faste by,
For we be bothen of o kinde.'¹¹⁴⁷
2470 Cesar ansuerde and seide, 'O blinde,
Thou art a fol, it is wel sene
Upon thiself: for if thou wene
I be a god, thou dost amys
To sitte wher thou sest god is;
And if I be a man, also

[CAESAR'S
ANSWER.]

Hic inter alia gesta
Cesaris narrat
vnum exemplum
precipue contra
illos qui, cum in
aspectu principis
aliis sapienciores
apparere vellent,
quandoque tamen
simulate sapiencie
taliam committunt,
per que ceteris
stulciores in fine
comprobantur.

Thou hast a gret folie do,
Whan thou to such on as schal deie
The worschipe of thi god aweie
Hast yoven so unworthely.
2480 Thus mai I prove redely,
Thou art noght wys.' And thei that herde
Hou wysly that the king ansuerde,
It was to hem a newe lore;
Wherof thei dradden him the more,
And broghten nothing to his Ere,
Bot if it trouthe and reson were. [1148](#)
So be ther manye, in such a wise
(2500) That feignen wordes to be wise,
And al is verray flaterie
2490 To him which can it wel aspie.
The kinde flatour can noght love
Bot forto bringe himself above;
For hou that evere his maister fare,
So that himself stonde out of care,
Him reccheth noght: and thus fulofte
Deceived ben with wordes softe
The kinges that ben innocent.
Wherof as for chastiment
The wise Philosophre seide,
2500 What king that so his tresor leide
Upon such folk, he hath the lesse,
And yit ne doth he no largesse,
Bot harmeth with his oghne hond
Himself and ek his oghne lond,
And that be many a sondri weie.
Wherof if that a man schal seie,
As forto speke in general,
Wher such thing falleth overal
That eny king himself misreule,
2510 The Philosophre upon his reule
In special a cause sette,
Which is and evere hath be the lette

[FLATTERERS OF A
KING.]

Nota, qualiter isti
circa Principem
adulatores potius a
Curia expelli,
quam ad regie
maiestatis munera
acceptari, Policia
suadente deberent.

In governance aboute a king
 Upon the meschief of the thing,
 And that, he seith, is Flaterie.
 Wherof tofore as in partie
 What vice it is I have declared;
 For who that hath his wit bewared
 Upon a flatour to believe,
 2520Whan that he weneth best achieve
 His goode world, it is most fro.
 And forto proeven it is so
 Ensamples ther ben manyon,
 Of whiche if thou wolt knowen on,
 It is behovely forto hiere
 What whilom fell in this matiere.

Among the kinges in the bible
 I finde a tale, and is credible,
 Of him that whilom Achab hihte,
 2530Which hadde al Irahel to rihte; [1149](#)
 Bot who that couthe glose softe
 And flatre, suche he sette alofte
 In gret astat and made hem riche;
 Bot thei that speiken wordes liche
 To trouthe and wolde it noght forbere,
 For hem was non astat to bere,
 The court of suche tok non hiede.
 Til ate laste upon a nede,
 That Benedab king of Surie
 Of Irahel a gret partie, [1151](#)
 Which Ramoth Galaath was hote,
 Hath sesed; and of that riote
 He tok conseil in sondri wise,
 2540Bot noght of hem that weren wise.
 And natheles upon this cas
 To strengthen him, for Josaphas, [1152](#)
 Which thanne was king of Judee,
 He sende forto come, as he

[AHAB AND
 MICAIAH.]

Hic loquitur
 vltorius de consilio
 adulantum, quorum
 fabulis principis
 aures organizate
 veritatis auditum
 capere nequiunt. Et
 narrat exemplum
 de Rege Achab, qui
 pro eo quod ipse
 prophetias fidelis
 Michee recusavit
 blandiciisque
 adulantis [1150](#)
 Zedechie adhesit,
 Rex Sirie Benedab
 in campo bellator
 ipsum diuino
 iudicio deuictum
 interfecit.

P. iii.
 171

Which thurgh frendschipe and alliance
 2550 Was next to him of aqueintance;
 For Joram Sone of Josaphath
 Achabbes dowhter wedded hath,
 Which hihte faire Godelie.
 And thus cam into Samarie
 King Josaphat, and he fond there
 The king Achab: and whan thei were
 Togedre spekende of this thing,
 This Josaphat seith to the king,
 Hou that he wolde gladly hier
 2560 Som trew prophete in this matiere, [1153](#)
 That he his conseil myhte yive
 To what point that it schal be drive. [1154](#)
 And in that time so befell,
 Ther was such on in Irahel,
 Which sette him al to flaterie,
 And he was cleped Sedechie;
 And after him Achab hath sent:
 And he at his comandement
 Tofore him cam, and be a sleyhte
 2570 He hath upon his heved on heyhte
 Tuo large hornes set of bras,
 As he which al a flatour was,
 And goth rampende as a leoun
 And caste hise hornes up and down,
 And bad men ben of good espeir,
 For as the homes percen their,
 He seith, withoute resistance,
 So wiste he wel of his science
 That Benedab is desconfit.
 2580 Whan Sedechie upon this plit
 Hath told this tale to his lord,
 Anon ther were of his acord
 Prophetes false manye mo
 To bere up oil, and alle tho
 Affermen that which he hath told,

Wherof the king Achab was bold
 And yaf hem yiftes al aboute.
 (2600) But Josaphat was in gret doute,
 And hield fantosme al that he herde,
 2590 Preiende Achab, hou so it ferde,
 If ther were eny other man,
 The which of prophecie can,
 To hiere him speke er that thei gon.
 Quod Achab thanne, 'Ther is on, [1155](#)
 A brothell, which Micheas hihte;
 Bot he ne comth noght in my sihte,
 For he hath longe in prison lein.
 Him liketh nevere yit to sein [1156](#)
 A goodly word to mi plesance;
 2600 And natheles at thin instance
 He schal come oute, and thanne he may
 Seie as he seide many day;
 For yit he seide nevere wel.'
 Tho Josaphat began somdel
 To gladen him in hope of trouthe,
 And bad withouten eny slouthe
 That men him scholden fette anon.
 And thei that weren for him gon,
 Whan that thei comen wher he was, [1157](#)
 2610 Thei tolden unto Micheas
 The manere hou that Sedechie
 Declared hath his prophecie;
 And therupon thei preie him faire
 That he wol seie no contraire,
 Wherof the king mai be desplesed,
 For so schal every man ben esed,
 And he mai helpe himselfe also.
 Micheas upon trouthe tho
 His herte sette, and to hem seith, [1158](#)
 2620 Al that belongeth to his feith
 And of non other feigned thing,

That wol he telle unto his king, [1159](#)
 Als fer as god hath yove him grace.
 Thus cam this prophete into place
 Wher he the kinges wille herde;
 And he therto anon ansuerde,
 And seide unto him in this wise:
 ‘Mi liege lord, for mi servise,
 Which trewe hath stonden evere yit,
 2630 Thou hast me with prisoneQUIT: [1160](#)
 Bot for al that I schal noght glose
 Of trouthe als fer as I suppose;
 And as touchende of this bataille, [1160](#)
 Thou schalt noght of the sothe faile.
 For if it like thee to hiere,
 As I am tauht in that matiere,
 Thou miht it understonde sone, [1161](#)
 Bot what is afterward to done
 Advise thee, for this I sih.
 2640 I was tofor the throne on hih,
 Wher al the world me thoghte stod, [1162](#)
 And there I herde and understod
 The vois of god with wordes cliere
 Axende, and seide in this manere:
 “In what thing mai I best beguile
 The king Achab?” And for a while
 Upon this point thei spieken faste.
 Tho seide a spirit ate laste,
 “I undertake this emprise.”
 2650 And god him axeth in what wise.
 “I schal,” quod he, “deceive and lye
 With flaterende prophecie
 In suche mouthes as he lieveth.”
 And he which alle thing achieveth
 Bad him go forth and don riht so.
 And over this I sih also
 The noble peple of Irahel [1163](#)

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Dispers as Schep upon an hell,
 Withoute a kepere unarraied:
 2660 And as thei wente aboute astraied,
 I herde a vois unto hem sein,
 "Goth hom into your hous ayein,
 Til I for you have betre ordeigned."'
 Quod Sedechie, 'Thou hast feigned
 This tale in angringe of the king.'
 And in a wraththe upon this thing
 He smot Michee upon the cheke;
 The king him hath rebuked eke,
 And every man upon him cride:
 2670 Thus was he schent on every side,
 Ayein and into prison lad,
 For so the king himselve bad.
 The trouthe myhte noght ben herd;
 Bot afterward as it hath ferd,
 The dede proveth his entente:
 Achab to the bataille wente,
 Wher Benedab for al his Scheld
 Him slouh, so that upon the feld
 His poeple goth aboute astray.
 2680 Bot god, which alle thinges may,
 So doth that thei no meschief have;
 Here king was ded and thei ben save,
 And hom ayein in goddes pes
 Thei wente, and al was founde les
 That Sedechie hath seid tofore.
 So sit it wel a king therfore
 To loven hem that trouthe mene;
 (2700 For) ate laste it wol be sene
 That flaterie is nothing worth. [1164](#)
 2690 Bot nou to mi matiere forth,
 As forto speken overmore [1165](#)
 After the Philosophres lore,
 The thridde point of Policie
 I thenke forto specifie

ix. *Propter transgressos leges statuuntur in orbe,* [THE THIRD POINT
OF POLICY.
JUSTICE.]

*Ut uiuant iusti Regis honore viri.
Lex sine iusticia populum sub principis vmbra
Deuiat, vt rectum nemo videbit iter.*

What is a lond wher men ben none?
What ben the men whiche are al one
Withoute a kinges governance?
What is a king in his ligance,
Wher that ther is no lawe in londe?
2700 What is to take lawe on honde,
Bot if the jugges weren trewe?
These olde worldes with the newe
Who that wol take in evidence,
Ther mai he se the experience,
What thing it is to kepe lawe,
Thurgh which the wronges ben withdrawe
And rihtwisnesse stant commended,
Wherof the regnes ben amended.
For wher the lawe mai comune

Hic tractat de
tercia Principum
regiminis¹¹⁶⁶
Policia, que
Iusticia nominata
est, cuius condicio
legibus incorrupta
vnicuique quod
suum est equo
pondere distribuit.

2710 The lordes forth with the commune,¹¹⁶⁷
Ech hath his propre duete;
And ek the kinges realte
Of bothe his worschipe underfongeth,
To his astat as it belongeth,
Which of his hihe worthinesse
Hath to governe rihtwisnesse,
As he which schal the lawe guide.
And natheles upon som side
His pouer stant above the lawe,
2720 To yive bothe and to withdrawe
The forfet of a mannes lif;
But thinges whiche are excessif
Ayein the lawe, he schal noght do
For love ne for hate also.

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The myhtes of a king ben grete,

Bot yit a worthi king schal lete
 Of wrong to don, al that he myhte;
 For he which schal the poeple ryhte,
 It sit wel to his regalie
 2730 That he himself ferst justefie
 Towardes god in his degre:
 For his astat is elles fre
 Toward alle othre in his persone,
 Save only to the god al one,
 Which wol himself a king chastise,
 Wher that non other mai suffise.
 So were it good to taken hiede
 That ferst a king his oghne dede
 Betwen the vertu and the vice
 2740 Redresce, and thanne of his justice
 So sette in evene the balance
 Towardes othre in governance,
 That to the povere and to the riche
 Hise lawes myhten stonde liche,
 He schal excepte no persone.
 Bot for he mai noght al him one
 In sondri places do justice, [1168](#)
 He schal of his real office
 With wys consideracion
 2750 Ordeigne his deputation [1169](#)
 Of suche jugges as ben lerned,
 So that his poeple be governed
 Be hem that trewe ben and wise.
 For if the lawe of covoitise
 Be set upon a jugges hond,
 Wo is the poeple of thilke lond,
 For wrong mai noght himselven hyde:
 Bot elles on that other side,
 If lawe stonde with the riht,
 2760 The poeple is glad and stant upriht.
 Wher as the lawe is resonable,
 The comun poeple stant menable, [1170](#)

Imperatoriam
 maiestatem non
 solum armis, set
 eciam legibus
 oportet esse
 armatam.

P. iii.
 178

And if the lawe torne amis,
The poeple also mistorned is.

And in ensample of this matiere
Of Maximin a man mai hiere,
Of Rome which was Emperour,
That whanne he made a governour
Be weie of substitucion
2770 Of Province or of region,
He wolde ferst enquire his name,
And let it openly proclame
What man he were, or evel or good.
And upon that his name stod
Enclin to vertu or to vice, [1171](#)
So wolde he sette him in office,
Or elles putte him al aweie.
Thus hield the lawe his rihte weie,
Which fond no let of covoitise:
2780 The world stod than upon the wise,
As be ensample thou myht rede;
And hold it in thi mynde, I rede.

In a Cronique I finde thus,
Hou that Gayus Fabricius,
Which whilom was Consul of Rome,
Be whom the lawes yede and come,
Whan the Sampnites to him broghte
(2800*) somme of gold, and him besoghte
To don hem favour in the lawe,
2790 Toward the gold he gan him drawe,
Wherof in alle mennes lok
A part up in his hond he tok, [1172](#)
Which to his mouth in alle haste
He putte, it forto smelle and taste, [1173](#)
And to his yhe and to his Ere,
Bot he ne fond no confort there:
And thanne he gan it to despise,
And tolde unto hem in this wise:

[JUSTICE OF
MAXIMIN.]

Nota hic de iusticia
Maximini
Imperatoris, qui
cum alicuius
prouincie
custodem sibi
substituere volebat,
primo de sui
nominis fama
proclamacione
facta ipsius
condicionem
diligencius
inuestigabat.

P. iii.
179

[GAIUS FABRICIUS.]

Hic ponit
exemplum de
iudicibus
incorruptis. Et
narrat qualiter
Gayus Fabricius
nuper Rome
Consul aurum a
Sampnitibus sibi
oblatum renuit,
dicens quod
nobilius est aurum
possidentes
dominio subiugare,
quam ex auri
cupiditate dominii
libertatem amittere.

'I not what is with gold to thryve,
 2800Whan non of all my wittes fyve
 Fynt savour ne delit therinne.
 So is it bot a nyce Sinne
 Of gold to ben to covoitous;
 Bot he is riche and glorious,
 Which hath in his subjeccion
 Tho men whiche in possession¹¹⁷⁴
 Ben riche of gold, and be this skile;
 For he mai aldai whan he wile,
 Or be hem lieve or be hem lothe,
 2810Justice don upon hem bothe.'
 Lo, thus he seide, and with that word
 He threw tofore hem on the bord
 The gold out of his hond anon,
 And seide hem that he wolde non:¹¹⁷⁵
 So that he kepte his liberte
 To do justice and equite,
 Withoute lucre of such richesse.
 Ther be nou fewe of suche, I gesse;
 For it was thilke times used,
 2820That every jugge was refused
 Which was noght frend to comun riht;
 Bot thei that wolden stonde upriht
 For trouthe only to do justice
 Preferred were in thilke office
 To deme and jugge commun lawe:
 Which nou, men sein, is al withdrawe.
 To sette a lawe and kepe it noght
 Ther is no comun profit soght;
 Bot above alle natheles
 2830The lawe, which is mad for pes,
 Is good to kepe for the beste,
 For that set alle men in reste.

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P. iii.
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The rihtful Emperour Conrade
 To kepe pes such lawe made,

[THE EMPEROR
 CONRAD.]

That non withinne the cite
In destorbance of unite
Dorste ones moeven a matiere.
For in his time, as thou myht hiere,
What point that was for lawe set
2840 It scholde for no gold be let, [1176](#)
To what persone that it were.
And this broghte in the comun fere,
Why every man the lawe dradde,
For ther was non which favour hadde.

So as these olde bokes sein,
I finde write hou a Romein,
Which Consul was of the Pretoire,
Whos name was Carmidotoire,
He sette a lawe for the pes,
2850 That non, bot he be wepneles, [1177](#)
Schal come into the conseil hous,
And elles as malicious
He schal ben of the lawe ded.
To that statut and to that red
Acorden alle it schal be so,
For certein cause which was tho:
Nou lest what fell therafter sone. [1178](#)
This Consul hadde forto done, [1179](#)
And was into the feldes ride;
2860 And thei him hadden longe abide,
That lordes of the conseil were,
And for him sende, and he cam there
With swerd begert, and hath foryete, [1180](#)
Til he was in the conseil sete.
Was non of hem that made speche,
Til he himself it wolde seche,
And fond out the defalte himselve;
And thanne he seide unto the tuelve,
Whiche of the Senat weren wise,
2870 'I have deserved the juisse,

Hic narrat de
iusticia nuper
Conradi
Imperatoris, cuius
tempore alicuius
reuerencia persone,
aliqua seu precum
interuencione
quacunque vel auri
redempcione,
legum Statuta
commutari seu
redimi nullatenus
potuerunt.

[THE CONSUL
CARMIDOTIRUS.]

Nota exemplum de
constancia iudicis;
vbi narrat de
Carmidotiro Rome
nuper Consule, qui
cum sui statuti
legem nescius
offendisset,
Romanique super
hoc penam sibi
remittere
voluissent, ipse
propria manu, vbi
nullus alius in
ipsum vindex fuit,
sui criminis
vindictam executus
est.

P. iii.
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In haste that it were do.'
 And thei him seiden alle no;
 For wel thei wiste it was no vice,
 Whan he ne thoghte no malice,
 Bot onliche of a litel slouthe:
 And thus thei leften as for routhe
 To do justice upon his gilt,
 For that he scholde noght be spilt.
 And whanne he sih the maner hou
 2880Thei wolde him save, he made avou
 With manfull herte, and thus he seide,
 That Rome scholde nevere abreide
 His heires, whan he were of dawe,
 That here Ancestre brak the lawe.
 Forthi, er that thei weren war,
 Forth with the same swerd he bar
 The statut of his lawe he kepte, [1181](#)
 (2900) that al Rome his deth bewepete.

In other place also I rede,
 2890Wher that a jugge his oghne dede
 Ne wol noght venge of lawe broke,
 The king it hath himselven wroke.
 The grete king which Cambises
 Was hote, a jugge laweles
 He fond, and into remembrance
 He dede upon him such vengeance:
 Out of his skyn he was beflain
 Al quyk, and in that wise slain,
 So that his skyn was schape al meete, [1182](#)
 2900And nayled on the same seete [1183](#)
 Wher that his Sone scholde sitte.
 Avise him, if he wolde flitte
 The lawe for the coveitise,
 Ther sih he redi his juise.
 Thus in defalte of other jugge
 The king mot otherwhile jugge,

[EXAMPLE OF
CAMBYSES.]

P. iii.
183

Nota quod falsi
 iudices mortis pena
 puniendi sunt.
 Narrat enim
 qualiter Cambises
 Rex Persarum
 quendam iudicem
 corruptum
 excoriari viuum
 fecit, eiusque pelle
 cathedram
 iudicalem operiri
 constituit: ita quod
 filius suus super
 patris pellem
 postea pro tribunali
 cessurus iudicii
 equitatem

To holden up the rihte lawe.
And forto speke of tholde dawe,
To take ensample of that was tho,
2910I finde a tale write also,
Hou that a worthi prince is holde
The lawes of his lond to holde,
Ferst for the hihe goddes sake,
And ek for that him is betake
The poeple forto guide and lede,
Which is the charge of his kinghede.

In a Cronique I rede thus
Of the rihtful Ligurgius,
Which of Athenis Prince was,
2920Hou he the lawe in every cas,
Wherof he scholde his poeple reule,
Hath set upon so good a reule,
In al this world that cite non
Of lawe was so wel begon
Forth with the trouthe of governance.
Ther was among hem no distance,
Bot every man hath his encrese;
Ther was withoute werre pes,
Withoute envie love stod;
Richesse upon the comun good
And noght upon the singuler
Ordeigned was, and the pouer
Of hem that weren in estat
Was sauf: wherof upon debat
Ther stod nothing, so that in reste
Mihte every man his herte reste.

And whan this noble rihtful king
Sih hou it ferde of al this thing,
Wherof the poeple stod in ese,
He, which for evere wolde plese
The hihe god, whos thonk he soghte,
A wonder thing thanne him bethoghte,

euidencius
memoraretur.

[LYCURGUS AND HIS
LAWS.]

Hic ponit
exemplum de
Principibus illis,
qui¹¹⁸⁴ non solum
legem statuentes
illam conseruant,
set vt commune
bonum adaugeant,
propriam
facultatem
diminuunt. Et
narrat quod, cum
Ligurgius
Athenarum
princeps subditos
suos¹¹⁸⁵ in omni
prosperitatis
habundancia
divites et vnanimis
congruis legibus
stare fecisset,
volens ad
vtilitatem rei
publice leges illas
firmius obseruari,
peregre proficisci
se finxit; set prius
iuramentum
solempne a legibus
suis sub hac forma
exegit, quod ipsi
vsque in reditum

And schop if that it myhte be,
Hou that his lawe in the cite
Mihte afterward for evere laste.
And therupon his wit he caste
What thing him were best to feigne,
That he his pourpos myhte atteigne.

A Parlement and thus he sette,

2930 His wisdom wher that he besette

2940 In audience of grete and smale, [1187](#)

2950 And in this wise he tolde his tale:

‘God wot, and so ye witen alle,
Hierafterward hou so it falle,
Yit into now my will hath be
To do justice and equite
In forthringe of comun profit:
Such hath ben evere my delit.
Bot of o thing I am beknowe,

2960 The which mi will is that ye knowe:

The lawe which I tok on honde,
Was altogedre of goddes sonde
And nothing of myn oghne wit;
So mot it nede endure yit,
And schal do lengere, if ye wile.
For I wol telle you the skile;
The god Mercurius and no man [1188](#)
He hath me tawht al that I can
Of suche lawes as I made,

2970 Wherof that ye ben alle glade;

It was the god and nothing I,
Which dede al this, and nou forthi
He hath comanded of his grace
That I schal come into a place
Which is forein out in an yle,
Wher I mot tarie for a while,
With him to speke, as he hath bede. [1189](#)
For as he seith, in thilke stede
He schal me suche thinges telle,

suum leges suas
nullatenus
infringerent:
quibus iuratis
peregrinacionem
suam in exilium
absque reditu pro
perpetuo
delegavit. [1186](#)

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P. iii.
185

2980 That evere, whyl the world schal duelle,
Athenis schal the betre fare.
Bot ferst, er that I thider fare,
For that I wolde that mi lawe
Amonges you ne be withdrawe
Ther whyles that I schal ben oute,
Forthi to setten out of doute
Bothe you and me, this wol I preie,
(3000) That ye me wolde assure and seie
With such an oth as I wol take, [1190](#)

P. iii.
186

2990 That ech of you schal undertake
Mi lawes forto kepe and holde.'
Thei seiden alle that thei wolde,
And therupon thei swore here oth, [1191](#)
That fro the time that he goth,
Til he to hem be come ayein,
Thei scholde hise lawes wel and plein
In every point kepe and fulfille.
Thus hath Ligurgius his wille,
And tok his leve and forth he wente.

3000 Bot lest nou wel to what entente [1192](#)
Of rihtwisnesse he dede so:
For after that he was ago,
He schop him nevere to be founde; [1193](#)
So that Athenis, which was bounde,
Nevere after scholde be relested, [1194](#)
Ne thilke goode lawe cessed,
Which was for comun profit set.
And in this wise he hath it knet;
He, which the comun profit soghte,

3010 The king, his oghne astat ne roghte;
To do profit to the comune,
He tok of exil the fortune,
And lefte of Prince thilke office
Only for love and for justice,
Thurgh which he thoghte, if that he myhte,

P. iii.
187

For evere after his deth to rihte
The cite which was him betake.
Wherof men oghte ensample take
The goode lawes to avance
3020 With hem which under governance¹¹⁹⁵
The lawes have forto kepe;
For who that wolde take kepe
Of hem that ferst the lawes founde,
Als fer as lasteth eny bounde
Of lond, here names yit ben knowe:
And if it like thee to knowe
Some of here names hou thei stonde,
Nou herkne and thou schalt understonde.

Of every bienfet the merite
3030 The god himself it wol aquite;
And ek fulofte it falleth so,
The world it wole aquite also,
Bot that mai noght ben evene liche:
The god he yifh the heveneriche,
The world yifh only bot a name,
Which stant upon the goode fame
Of hem that don the goode dede.
And in this wise double mede
Resceiven thei that don wel hiere;

3040 Wherof if that thee list to hiere¹¹⁹⁶
After the fame as it is blowe,
Ther myht thou wel the sothe knowe,
Hou thilke honeste besinesse
Of hem that ferst for rihtwisnesse
Among the men the lawes made,
Mai nevere upon this erthe fade.
For evere, whil ther is a tunge,
Here name schal be rad and sunge
And holde in the Cronique write;
3050 So that the men it scholden wite,
To speke good, as thei wel oghten,
Of hem that ferst the lawes soghten

[THE FIRST LAW-
GIVERS.]

Hic ad eorum
laudem, qui
iusticie causa leges
primo statuerunt,
aliquorum nomina
specialius
commemorat.

P. iii.
188

In forthringe of the worldes pes.
 Unto thebreus was Moïses
 The ferste, and to thegipcians
 Mercurius, and to Troiens
 Ferst was Neuma Pompilius,
 To Athenes Ligurgius
 Yaf ferst the lawe, and to Gregois
 3060 Foroneüs hath thilke vois, [1197](#)
 And Romulus to the Romeins.
 For suche men that ben vileins
 The lawe in such a wise ordeigneth, [1198](#)
 That what man to the lawe pleigneth,
 Be so the juggle stonde upriht,
 He schal be served of his riht.
 And so ferforth it is befallē
 That lawe is come among ous alle:
 God lieve it mote wel ben holde,
 3070 As every king therto is holde;
 For thing which is of kinges set,
 With kinges oghte it noght be let.
 What king of lawe takth no kepe,
 Be lawe he mai no regne kepe.
 Do lawe away, what is a king?
 Wher is the riht of eny thing,
 If that ther be no lawe in londe?
 This oghte a king wel understonde,
 As he which is to lawe swore,
 3080 That if the lawe be forbore
 Withouten execucioun,
 It makth a lond torne up so down,
 Which is unto the king a sclandre.
 Forthi unto king Alisandre
 The wise Philosophre bad,
 That he himselve ferst be lad [1199](#)
 Of lawe, and forth thanne overal
 (3100*) do justice in general, [1200](#)
 That al the wyde lond aboute

[KINGS MUST KEEP
THE LAWS.]

P. iii.
189

3090 The justice of his lawe doute,
 And thanne schal he stonde in reste.
 For therto lawe is on the beste
 Above alle other erthly thing,
 To make a liege drede his king.
 Bot hou a king schal gete him love
 Toward the hihe god above,
 And ek among the men in erthe,
 This nexte point, which is the ferthe
 Of Aristotles lore, it techeth:

3100 Wherof who that the Scole secheth,
 What Policie that it is
 The bok reherceth after this.

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 190

x. *Nil rationis habens vbi velle tirannica
 regna* [THE FOURTH POINT
 OF POLICY. PITY.]

Stringit, amor populi transiet exul ibi. [1201](#)
Set Pietas, regnum que conseruabit in euum,
Non tantum populo, set placet illa deo.

It nedeth noght that I delate
 The pris which preised is algate,
 And hath ben euer and euer schal,
 Wherof to speke in special,
 It is the vertu of Pite,
 Thurgh which the hihe mageste
 Was stered, whan his Sone alyhte,
 3110 And in pite the world to rihte
 Tok of the Maide fleissh and blod.
 Pite was cause of thilke good,
 Wherof that we ben alle save:
 Wel oghte a man Pite to have
 And the vertu to sette in pris,
 Whan he himself which is al wys
 Hath schewed why it schal be preised.
 Pite may noght be conterpeised
 Of tirannie with no peis;

Hic tractat de
 quarta Principum
 regiminis Policia,
 que Pietas dicta
 est; per quam
 Principes erga
 populum
 misericordes
 effecti
 misericordiam
 altissimi
 graciosius [1202](#)
 consequuntur.

3120For Pite makth a king courteis
Bothe in his word and in his dede.

It sit wel every liege drede
His king and to his heste obeie,
And riht so be the same weie
It sit a king to be pitous
Toward his poeple and gracious
Upon the reule of governance,
So that he worche no vengeance,
Which mai be cleped cruelte.

Nota. [1203](#)

P. iii.
191

3130Justice which doth equite
Is dredfull, for he noman spareth;
Bot in the lond wher Pite fareth
The king mai nevere faile of love,
For Pite thurgh the grace above,
So as the Philosophre affermeth, [1204](#)
His regne in good astat confermeth.*

*Thapostle James in this wise¹²⁰⁵
 3150^SSeith, what man scholde do juise,¹²⁰⁶
 And hath not pite forth with al,
 The doom of him which demeth al
 He may himself fulsore drede,
 That him schal lakke upon the nede
 To fynde pite, whan he wolde:
 For who that pite wol biholde,—
 It is a poynt of Cristes lore.
 And for to loken overmore,
 It is bihovely, as we fynde,
 3160^TTo resoun and to lawe of kynde.
 Cassodre in his apprise telleth,
 ‘The regne is sauf, wher pite duelleth.’
 And Tullius his tale avoweth,¹²⁰⁷
 And seith, ‘What king to pite boweth
 And with pite stant overcome,
 He hath that schield of grace nome,
 Which to the kinges yifth victoire.’
 Of Alisandre in his histoire
 I rede how he a worthi knight
 3170^OOf sodein wraththe and nought of right
 Forjugged hath, and he appeleth.
 And with that word the king quereleth,
 And seith, ‘Non is above me.’
 ‘That wot I wel my lord,’ quoth he;
 ‘Fro thy lordschipe appele I nought,
 But fro thy wraththe in al my thought
 To thy pitee stant myn appeal.
 The king, which understod him wel,
 Of pure pite yaf him grace.
 3180^AAnd eek I rede in other place,
 Thus seide whilom etc. (as 3137 ff.)

Cassodorus. Vbi
 regnat pietas,
 consolidatur
 regnum.

Tullius. Qui pietate
 vincitur scutum
 victorie merito
 gestabit.

P. iii.
192

Valerius narrat
 quod cum rex
 Alexander in ira
 sua quendam
 militem morti
 condemnasset, et
 ille appellauit, dixit
 rex, ‘In terra nullus
 maior me est: ad
 quem ergo
 appellas?’
 Respondit miles,
 ‘Non a maiestate
 tua, set a sententia
 ire tue tantum ad
 pietatem tuam
 appello.’ Et sic rex
 pietate motus
 ipsum in
 misericordiam
 benignissime
 suscepit.

Thus seide whilom Constantin:¹²⁰⁸
 ‘What Emperour that is enclin
 To Pite forto be servant,
 3140 Of al the worldes remenant
 He is worthi to ben a lord.’
 In olde bokes of record
 This finde I write of essamplaire:¹²¹⁰
 Troian the worthi debonaire,
 Be whom that Rome stod governed,
 (3190) Upon a time as he was lerned
 Of that he was to familier,
 He seide unto that conseilless,¹²¹¹
 That forto ben an Emperour
 3150 His will was noght for vein honour,
 Ne yit for reddour of justice;
 Bot if he myhte in his office
 Hise lordes and his poeple plese,
 Him thoghte it were a grettere ese
 With love here hertes to him drawe,
 (3200) Than with the drede of eny lawe.
 For whan a thing is do for doute,
 Fuloft it comth the worse aboute;
 Bot wher a king is Pietous,¹²¹²
 3160 He is the more gracious,
 That mochel thrift him schal betyde,
 Which elles scholde torne aside.*

Constantinus
 Imperator ait:
 ‘Vere se dominum
 esse comprobat,
 qui seruum pietatis
 se facit.’

Troianus ait, quod
 ipse subditos suos
 solite pietatis
 fauore magis quam
 austeritatis rigore
 regere, eorumque
 beneuolenciam
 potius quam
 timorem penes se
 attractare
 proponebat.¹²⁰⁹

P. iii.
 193

*To do pite support and grace,¹²¹³
 The Philosophre upon a place
 In his writinge of daies olde
 3210 A tale of gret essample tolde
 Unto the king of Macedoine:

[TALE OF THE JEW
 AND THE PAGAN.]

Hic in pietatis
 exemplum prout
 Aristotiles Regi
 Alexandro nuper

How betwen Kaire and Babeloine,¹²²¹
 Whan comen is the somer heete,
 It hapneth tuo men forto meete,
 As thei scholde entren in a pas,
 Wher that the wyldernesse was.
 And as they wenten forth spekende
 Under the large wodes ende,
 That o man axeth of that other:
 3220*What man art thou, mi lieve brother?¹²²²
 Which is thi creance and thi feith?'
 'I am paien,' that other seith,
 'And be the lawe which I use
 I schal noght in mi feith refuse
 To loven alle men aliche,
 The povere bothe and ek the riche:
 Whan thei ben glade I schal be glad,
 And sori whan thei ben bestad;
 So schal I live in unite
 With every man in his degre.
 For riht as to miself I wolde,
 Riht so toward alle othre I scholde¹²²³
 Be gracious and debonaire.
 Thus have I told thee softe and faire
 Mi feith, mi lawe, and mi creance;
 And if thee list for aqueintance,
 Now tell what maner man thou art.'
 And he ansuerde upon his part:
 'I am a Jew, and be mi lawe
 I schal to noman be felawe
 To kepe him trowthe in word ne dede,
 Bot if he be withoute drede¹²²⁴
 A verrai Jew riht as am I:
 For elles I mai trewely
 Bereve him bothe lif and good.'
 The paien herde and understod,
 And thoghte it was a wonder lawe.
 And thus upon here sondri sawe

rettulit, declarans
 scribit qualiter
 Iudeus pedestes
 cum quodam
 pagano asinum
 equitante per
 desertum
 itinerando ipsum
 de secta et fide sua
 strictius
 interrogavit. Qui
 respondens ait:
 'Paganus sum et
 fides mea hec est,
 ut omnes vno
 animo diligam et
 penes
 vnumquemque
 tempore
 necessitatis
 pietatem¹²¹⁴ pro
 posse meo
 excerceam.'¹²¹⁵
 Cui Iudeus:
 'Permitte me ergo,
 qui lassatus itinere
 deficio,
 aliquantulum
 equitare, et tu
 respectu pietatis ob
 meam
 recreationem
 pedibus pro
 tempore¹²¹⁶
 incedas.' Et ita
 factum est, unde
 postea paganus
 infra breve lassatus
 asino suo
 restitui¹²¹⁷ a Iudeo
 postulavit. At ille
 ait: 'Nequaquam:
 quia fides mea est,
 ut illi qui sectam
 meam non credit,
 nocumentum¹²¹⁸
 absque pietate
 prouocare debeo.'
 Et hiis dictis

Talkende bothe forth thei wente.
 The dai was hoot, the sonne brente,
 The paien rod upon an asse,
 And of his catell more and lasse
 With him a riche trusse he ladde.
 The Jew, which al untrowthe hadde,
 And wente upon his feet beside,
 Bethoghte him how he mihte ride;¹²²⁵
 And with his wordes slihe and wise
 Unto the paien in this wise
 He seide: 'O, now it schal be seene
 What thing it is thou woldest meene:
 For if thi lawe be certein
 As thou hast told, I dar wel sein,
 Thou wolt beholde mi destresse.
 Which am so full of werinesse,
 That I ne mai unethe go,¹²²⁶
 And let me ride a Myle or tuo,
 So that I mai mi bodi ese.'

3230* The paien wolde him noght desplese
 3240* Of that he spak, bot in pite
 3250* It list him forto knowe and se
 3260* The pleignte which that other made;
 3270* And for he wolde his herte glade,
 He lihte and made him nothing strange.
 Thus was ther made a newe change,
 The paien goth, the Jew alofte
 Was sett upon his asse softe:
 So gon thei forth carpende faste
 Of this and that, til ate laste¹²²⁷
 The paien mihte go nomore,
 3280* And preide unto the Jew therfore
 To suffre him ride a litel while.
 The Jew, which thoghte him to beguile,
 Anon rod forth the grete pas,¹²²⁸
 And to the paien in this cas
 He seide, 'Thou hast do thi riht,

asellum veloci
 passu coegit, et
 paganum a dorso
 illusum reliquit.
 Quod videns
 paganus in terram
 dolens corruit,
 extensisque in
 celum manibus
 summam iusticiam
 inuocabat. Postque
 a terra exurgens,
 cum paulisper
 deambulasset,
 respexit in
 quamdam
 vallem¹²¹⁹ Iudeum
 a leone in mortis
 articulo
 prostratum; et sic
 asinum suum cum
 gaudio resumens,
 pietatem magis
 quam austeritatem
 laudabilem
 decreuit.¹²²⁰

P. iii.
194

P. iii.
195

Of that thou haddest me behiht
To do socour upon mi nede;
And that acordeth to the dede,
As thou art to the lawe holde.
3290* And in such wise as I thee tolde,
I thenke also for mi partie
Upon the lawe of Juerie¹²²⁹
To worche and do mi duete.
Thin asse schal go forth with me
With al thi good, which I have sesed;
And that I wot thou art desesed,
I am riht glad and noght mispaid.’
And whanne he hath these wordes said,
In alle haste he rod aweie.
3300* This paien wot non other weie,
Bot on the ground he kneleth evene,
His handes up unto the hevene,
And seide, ‘O hihe sothfastnesse,
That lovest alle rihtwisnesse,
Unto thi dom, lord, I appele;¹²³⁰
Behold and deme mi querele,
With humble herte I thee beseche;
The mercy bothe and ek the wreche
I sette al in thi juggement.’
3310* And thus upon his marrement
This paien hath made his preiere:¹²³¹
And than he ros with drery chiere,¹²³²
And goth him forth, and in his gate
He caste his yhe aboute algate,
The Jew if that he mihte se.
Bot for a time it mai noght be;
Til ate laste ayein the nyht,
So as god wolde, he wente ariht,
As he which hield the hihe weie,
3320* And thanne he sih in a valleie
Wher that the Jew liggende was,
Al blodi ded upon the gras,

Which strangled was of a leoun.
 And as he lokede up and doun,
 He fond his asse faste by
 Forth with his harneis redely
 Al hol and sound, as he it lefte, [1233](#)
 Whan that the Jew it him berefte:
 Wherof he thonketh god knelende.
 3330* Lo, thus a man mai knowe at ende,
 How the pitous pite deserveth.
 For what man that to pite serveth,
 As Aristotle it berth witesse,
 God schal hise foomen so represse,
 That thei schul ay stonde under foote.
 Pite, men sein, is thilke roote
 Wherof the vertus springen alle:
 What infortune that befall
 In eny lond, lacke of pite [1234](#)
 3340* Its cause of thilke adversite;
 And that aldai mai schewe at yhe,
 Who that the world discretly syhe. [1235](#)
 Good is that every man therfore
 Take hiede of that is seid tofore;
 For of this tale and othre ynowhe
 These noble princes whilom drowhe
 Here evidence and here aprise,
 As men mai finde in many a wise, [1236](#)
 Who that these olde bokes rede:
 3350* And thogh thei ben in erthe dede,
 Here goode name may noght deie
 For Pite, which thei wolde obeie,
 To do the dedes of mercy.
 And who this tale redily
 Remembre, as Aristotle it tolde,
 He mai the will of god beholde
 Upon the point as it was ended,
 Wherof that pite stod commended,
 Which is to charite felawe,

3360*As thei that kepen bothe o lawe.[1237](#)

Of Pite forto speke plein,
Which is with mercy wel besein,
Fulofte he wole himselve peine
To kepe an other fro the peine:
For Charite the moder is
Of Pite, which nothing amis
Can soffre, if he it mai amende.
3170It sit to every man livende
To be Pitous, bot non so wel
(3370*)As to a king, which on the whiel
Fortune hath set aboven alle:
For in a king, if so befall[1239](#)
That his Pite be ferme and stable,
To al the loud it is vailable
Only thurgh grace of his persone;
For the Pite of him al one
Mai al the large realme save.
So sit it wel a king to have
Pite; for this Valeire tolde,
And seide hou that be daies olde
Codrus, which was in his degre
King of Athenis the cite,
A werre he hadde ayein Dorrence:
And forto take his evidence[1240](#)
What schal befall of the bataille,
He thoghte he wolde him ferst consaille
3180With Appollo, in whom he triste;
(3380*)Thurgh whos ansuere this he wiste,
3190Of tuo pointz that he myhte chese,
Or that he wolde his body lese
(3390*)And in bataille himselve deie,
Or elles the seconde weie,

[TALE OF CODRUS.]

P. iii.
198, l.
17

Nota hic de
Principis pietate
erga populum, vbi
narrat quod, cum
Codrus Rex
Athenarum contra
Dorences bellum
gerere deberet,
consulto prius
Appolline
responsum accepit,
quod vnum de
duobus, videlicet
aut seipsum in
prelio interfici et
populum suum
saluari, aut
populum interfici
et se[1238](#) saluum
fieri, eligere
oporteret. Super
quo Rex pietate
motus plebisque
sue magis quam
proprii corporis
salutem affectans,
mortem sibi
preelegit; et sic
bellum aggrediens
pro vita multorum
solus interiit.

P. iii.
199

To sen his poeple desconfit.
 Bot he, which Pite hath parfit
 Upon the point of his believe,
 The poeple thoghte to relieve, [1241](#)
 And ches himselve to be ded.
 3200Wher is nou such an other hed,
 Which wolde for the lemes dye?
 (3400*) And natheles in som partie
 It oghte a kinges herte stere,
 That he hise liege men forbere.
 And ek toward hise enemis
 Fulofte he may deserve pris,
 To take of Pite remembrance,
 Wher that he myhte do vengeance:
 For whanne a king hath the victoire,
 3210And thanne he drawe into memoire
 To do Pite in stede of wreche,
 He mai noght faile of thilke speche
 Wherof arist the worldes fame,
 To yive a Prince a worthi name.

P. iii.
200

I rede hou whilom that Pompeie,
 To whom that Rome moste obeie,
 A werre hadde in jeupartie
 Ayein the king of Ermenie, [1242](#)
 Which of long time him hadde grieved.
 3220Bot ate laste it was achieved
 That he this king desconfit hadde,
 And forth with him to Rome ladde
 As Prisoner, wher many a day
 In sori plit and povere he lay,
 The corone of his heved deposed, [1243](#)
 Withinne walles faste enclosed;
 And with ful gret humilite
 He soffreth his adversite.
 Pompeie sih his pacience
 3230And tok pite with conscience,

[POMPEIUS AND THE
 KING OF ARMENIA.]

Hic ponit
 exemplum de
 victoriosi Principis
 pietate erga
 aduersarios suos.
 Et narrat quod,
 cum Pompeius
 Romanorum
 Imperator Regem
 Armenie
 aduersarium suum
 in bello victum
 cepisset,
 captumque vinculis
 alligatum Rome
 tenuisset, tyrannidis
 iracundie stimulos
 postponens,
 pietatis

So that upon his hihe deis
 Tofore al Rome in his Paleis,
 As he that wolde upon him rewe,
 Let yive him his corone newe
 And his astat al full and plein¹²⁴⁵
 Restoreth of his regne ayein,
 And seide it was more goodly thing
 To make than undon a king,
 To him which pouer hadde of bothe.
 Thus thei, that weren longe wrothe,
 3240 Acorden hem to final pes;
 And yit justice natheles
 Was kept and in nothing offended;
 Wherof Pompeie was comended.¹²⁴⁶
 Ther mai no king himself excuse,
 Bot if justice he kepe and use,
 Which for teschuie crualte
 He mot attempre with Pite.
 Of crualte the felonie
 3250 Engendred is of tirannie,
 Ayein the whos condicion
 (3450) God is himself the champion,
 Whos strengthe mai noman withstonde.
 For evere yit it hath so stonde,
 That god a tirant overladde;
 Bot wher Pite the regne ladde,
 Ther mihte no fortune laste
 Which was grevous, bot ate laste
 The god himself it hath redresced.
 3260 Pite is thilke vertu blessed
 Which nevere let his Maister falle;
 Bot crualte, thogh it so falle
 That it mai regne for a throwe,
 God wole it schal ben overthrowe:
 Wherof ensamples ben ynowhe
 Of hem that thilke merel drowhe.

mansuetudinem
 operatus est. Dixit
 enim quod nobilius
 est Regem facere
 quam deponere:
 super quo dictum
 Regem absque vlla
 redempcione non
 solum a vinculis
 absoluit, set ad sui
 regni culmen
 gratuita voluntate
 coronatum
 restituit.¹²⁴⁴

P. iii.
 201

[CRUELTY.]

Of crualte I rede thus:
 Whan the tirant Leoncius
 Was to thempire of Rome arrived,
 Fro which he hath with strengthe
 3270 prived¹²⁵⁰
 The pietous Justinian,¹²⁵¹
 As he which was a cruel man,
 His nase of and his lippes bothe
 He kutte, for he wolde him lothe
 Unto the poeple and make unable.
 Bot he which is al merciabile,¹²⁵²
 The hihe god, ordeigneth so,
 That he withinne a time also,
 Whan he was strengest in his ire,¹²⁵³
 3280 Was schoven out of his empire.
 Tiberius the pouer hadde,
 And Rome after his will he ladde,
 And for Leonce in such a wise
 Ordeigneth, that he tok juisse
 Of nase and lippes bothe tuo,
 For that he dede an other so,
 Which more worthi was than he.
 Lo, which a fall hath crualte,
 And Pite was set up ayein:
 3290 For after that the bokes sein,
 Therbellis king of Bulgarie
 With helpe of his chivalerie
 Justinian hath unprisoned
 And to thempire ayein coroned.

In a Cronique I finde also
 Of Siculus, which was ek so
 A cruel king lich the tempeste,
 The whom no Pite myhte areste,—¹²⁵⁵
 He was the ferste, as bokes seie,
 3300 Upon the See which fond Galeie
 And let hem make for the werre,—

[CRUELTY OF
LEONTIUS.]

P. iii.
202

Hic loquitur contra
 illos, qui tyrannica
 potestate
 principatum
 obtinentes in¹²⁴⁷
 iniquitatis sue
 malicia gloriantur.
 Et narrat
 exemplum,¹²⁴⁸
 qualiter Leoncius
 tyrannus pium
 Iustinianum non
 solum a solio
 imperatorie
 maiestatis
 fraudulenter
 expulit, set vt ipse
 inhabilis ad
 regnum in¹²⁴⁹
 aspectu plebis
 efficeretur, naso et
 labris abscisis,
 ipsum tyrannice
 mutulauit. Deus
 tamen, qui super
 omnia pius est,
 Tiberio
 superueniente vna
 cum adiutorio
 Terbellis Bulgarie
 Regis, Iustinianum
 interfecto Leoncio
 ad imperium
 restitui
 misericorditer
 procurauit.

[CRUELTY OF
SICULUS.]

P. iii.
203

Hic loquitur
 vlterius de
 crudelitate Siculi
 tyranni,¹²⁵⁴ necnon

(3500) he which al was out of herre
 Fro Pite and misericorde;
 For therto couthe he noght acorde,
 Bot whom he myhte slen, he slouh,
 And therof was he glad ynouh.
 He hadde of conseil manyon,
 Among the whiche ther was on,
 Be name which Berillus hihte;
 3310 And he bethoghte him hou he myhte
 Unto the tirant do likinge,
 And of his oghne ymaginyng
 Let forge and make a Bole of bras,
 And on the side cast ther was
 A Dore, wher a man mai inne,
 Whan he his peine schal beginne
 Thurgh fyr, which that men putten under.
 And al this dede he for a wonder,
 That whanne a man for peine cride,
 3320 The Bole of bras, which gapeth wyde,
 It scholde seme as thogh it were
 A belwinge in a mannes Ere,
 And noght the criinge of a man.
 Bot he which alle sleihtes can,
 The devel, that lith in helle fast,
 Him that this caste hath overcast, [1256](#)
 That for a trespas which he dede
 He was putt in the same stede,
 And was himself the ferste of alle
 3330 Which was into that peine falle [1257](#)
 That he for othre men ordeigneth;
 Ther was noman which him compleigneth. [1258](#)
 Of tirannie and crualte
 Be this ensample a king mai se,
 Himself and ek his conseil bothe,
 Hou thei ben to mankinde lothe
 And to the god abhominable.
 Ensamples that ben concordable [1259](#)

et de Berillo
 eiusdem
 Consiliario, qui ad
 tormentum populi
 quendam taurum
 eneum tyrannica
 coniectura fabricari
 constituit; in quo
 tamen ipse prior,
 proprio crimine
 illud exigente,
 vsque ad sui
 interitus
 expiracionem
 iudicialiter
 torquebatur.

I finde of othre Princes mo,
3340 As thou schalt hiere, of time go. [1260](#)

The grete tirant Dionys,
Which mannes lif sette of no pris, [1261](#)
Unto his hors fulofte he yaf
The men in stede of corn and chaf,
So that the hors of thilke stod
Devoureden the mennes blod;
Til fortune ate laste cam,
That Hercules him overcam,
And he riht in the same wise
3350 Of this tirant tok the juise:
As he til othre men hath do,
(3550*) He same deth he deide also,
That no Pite him hath socoured,
Til he was of hise hors devoured.

Of Lichaon also I finde
Hou he ayein the lawe of kinde
Hise hostes slouh, and into mete
He made her bodies to ben ete
With othre men withinne his hous.
3360 Bot Jupiter the glorious,
Which was commoeved of this thing,
Vengance upon this cruel king
So tok, that he fro mannes forme
Into a wolf him let transforme:
And thus the crualete was kidd,
Which of long time he hadde hidd;
A wolf he was thanne openly,
The whos nature prively
He hadde in his condicion.
3370 And unto this conclusioun,
That tirannie is to despise,
I finde ensample in sondri wise,
And nameliche of hem fulofte,

[DIONYSIUS AND HIS
HORSES.]

Nota hic de
Dionisio tiranno,
qui mire
crudelitatis
seueritate eciam
hospites suos ad
deuorandum equis
suis tribuit: cui
Hercules tandem
superueniens
victum impium in
impietate sua pari
morte conclusit.

[LICHAON.]

P. iii.
205

Nota hic de
consimili
Lichaontis tirannia,
qui carnes
hominum
hominibus in suo
hospicio ad
vescendum dedit;
cuius formam
condicioni similem
Iupiter [1262](#)
coequans ipsum in
lupum
transformauit.

The whom fortune hath set alofte
 Upon the werres forto winne.
 Bot hou so that the wrong beginne
 Of tirannie, it mai noght laste,
 Bot such as thei don ate laste
 To othre men, such on hem falleth;
 3380 For ayein suche Pite calleth
 Vengance to the god above.
 For who that hath no tender love
 In savinge of a mannes lif,
 He schal be founde so gultif,
 That whanne he wolde mercy crave
 In time of nede, he schal non have.
 Of the natures this I finde, [1263](#)
 The fierce Leon in his kinde,
 Which goth rampende after his preie,
 3390 If he a man finde in his weie,
 He wole him slen, if he withstonde.
 Bot if the man coude understonde
 To falle anon before his face
 In signe of mercy and of grace,
 The Leon schal of his nature
 Restreigne his ire in such mesure,
 As thogh it were a beste tamed, [1264](#)
 And torne away halfvinge aschamed,
 That he the man schal nothing grieve.
 3400 Hou scholde than a Prince achieve
 The worldes grace, if that he wolde
 (3600) Destruie a man whanne he is yolde
 And stant upon his mercy al?
 Bot forto speke in special,
 Ther have be suche and yit ther be
 Tirantz, whos hertes no pite
 Mai to no point of mercy plie,
 That thei upon her tirannie
 Ne gladen hem the men to sle;
 3410 And as the rages of the See

[NOBLENESSE OF THE
LION.]

P. iii.
206

Nota qualiter Leo
hominibus stratis
parcit.

Ben unpitous in the tempeste,
Riht so mai no Pite areste¹²⁶⁵
Of crualte the gret oultrage,
Which the tirant in his corage
Engendred hath: wherof I finde
A tale, which comth nou to mynde.

I rede in olde bokes thus:
Ther was a Duk, which Spertachus
Men clepe, and was a werreieur,
3420 A cruel man, a conquerour
With strong pouer the which he ladde.
For this condicion he hadde,
That where him hapneth the victoire,¹²⁶⁸
His lust and al his moste gloire
Was forto sle and noght to save:
Of rancoun wolde he no good have
For savinge of a mannes lif,
Bot al goth to the swerd and knyf,
So lief him was the mannes blod.¹²⁶⁹
3430 And natheles yit thus it stod,
So as fortune aboute wente,
He fell riht heir as be descente¹²⁷⁰
To Perse, and was coroned king.
And whan the worschipe of this thing
Was falle, and he was king of Perse,
If that thei weren ferst diverse,
The tirannies whiche he wroghte,
A thousandfold welmore he soghte
Thanne afterward to do malice.
3440 The god vengeance ayein the vice¹²⁷¹
Hath schape: for upon a tyde,
Whan he was heihest in his Pride,
In his rancour and in his hete
Ayein the queene of Marsagete,
Which Thameris that time hihte,
He made werre al that he myhte:

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[SPERTACHUS AND
THAMARIS.]

Hic loquitur
precipue¹²⁶⁶ contra
tirannos illos qui,
cum in bello
vincere possunt,
humani sanguinis
effusione saturari
nequiunt. Et narrat
in exemplum de
quodam Persarum
Rege, cuius nomen
Spertachus erat,
qui pre ceteris tunc
in Oriente
bellicosus et
victoriosus,
quoscunque gladio
vincere poterat,
absque pietate
interfici constituit.
Set tandem sub
manu Thamaris
Marsegetarum
Regine in bello
captus, quod a diu
quesivit,
seueritatem pro
seueritate finaliter
inuenit. Nam et
ipsa quoddam vas
de sanguine
Persarum plenum
ante se afferri¹²⁶⁷
decreuit, in quo
caput tiranni vsque
ad mortem

And sche, which wolde hir loud defende,
 Hir oghne Sone ayein him sende,¹²⁷²
 Which the defence hath undertake.
 Bot he desconfit was and take;
 And whan this king him hadde in honde,
 He wol no mercy understonde,
 3450 Bot dede him slen in his presence.
 (3650*) The tidinge of this violence¹²⁷³
 Whan it cam to the moder Ere,
 Sche sende anon ay wydewhere
 To suche frendes as sche hadde,
 A gret pouer til that sche ladde.
 In sondri wise and tho sche caste
 3460 Hou sche this king mai overcaste;
 And ate laste acorded was,
 That in the danger of a pass,
 Thurgh which this tirant scholde passe,
 Sche schop his pouer to compasse¹²⁷⁴
 With strengthe of men be such a weie¹²⁷⁵
 That he schal noght eschape aweie.
 And whan sche hadde thus ordeigned,
 Sche hath hir oghne bodi feigned,
 For feere as thogh sche wolde flee
 3470 Out of hir lond: and whan that he
 Hath herd hou that this ladi fledde,
 So faste after the chace he spedde,
 That he was founde out of array.
 For it betidde upon a day,
 Into the pas whanne he was falle,
 Them buisschementz tobrieken alle¹²⁷⁶
 And him beclipte on every side,
 That fle ne myhte he noght aside:
 So that ther weren dede and take
 3480 Tuo hundred thousand for his sake,
 That weren with him of his host.
 And thus was leid the grete bost

mergens dixit: 'O
 tyrannorum
 crudelissime,
 semper esuriens
 sanguinem sitisti:
 ecce iam ad
 saturitatem
 sanguinem bibe.'

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P. iii.
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Of him and of his tirannie:¹²⁷⁷
 It halp no mercy forto crie¹²⁷⁸
 To him which whilom dede non;
 For he unto the queene anon
 Was broght, and whan that sche him sih,
 This word sche spak and seide on hih:
 ‘O man, which out of mannes kinde
 3490 Reson of man hast left behinde
 And lived worse than a beste,
 Whom Pite myhte noght areste,
 The mannes blod to schede and spille
 Thou haddest nevere yit thi fille.
 Bot nou the laste time is come,
 That thi malice is overcome:
 As thou til othre men hast do,
 Nou schal be do to thee riht so.’
 Tho bad this ladi that men scholde
 3500 A vessel bringe, in which sche wolde
 Se the vengance of his juisse,
 (3700) Which sche began anon devise;
 And tok the Princes whiche he ladde,
 Be whom his chief conseil he hadde,
 And whil hem lasteth eny breth,¹²⁷⁹
 Sche made hem blede to the deth
 Into the vessel wher it stod:
 And whan it was fulfild of blod,
 Sche caste this tirant therinne,
 3510 And seide him, ‘Lo, thus myht thou wyne¹²⁸⁰
 The lustes of thin appetit.
 In blod was whilom thi delit,
 Nou schalt thou drinken al thi fille.’
 And thus onliche of goddes wille,
 He which that wolde himselve strange
 To Pite, fond mercy so strange,
 That he withoute grace is lore.
 So may it schewe wel therfore
 That crualte hath no good ende;

3520 Bot Pite, hou so that it wende,
 Makth that the god is merciablen,
 If ther be cause resonable
 Why that a king schal be pitous. [1281](#)
 Bot elles, if he be doubtful
 To slen in cause of rihtwisnesse,
 It mai be said no Pitousnesse,
 Bot it is Pusillamite,
 Which every Prince scholde flee.
 For if Pite mesure excede,
 3530 Kinghode may noght wel procede [1282](#)
 To do justice upon the riht:
 For it belongeth to a knyht
 Als gladly forto fihte as reste,
 To sette his liege poeple in reste,
 Whan that the werre upon hem falleth;
 For thanne he mote, as it befalleth,
 Of his knythhode as a Leon
 Be to the poeple a champioun
 Withouten eny Pite feigned.
 3540 For if manhode be restreigned,
 Or be it pes or be it werre,
 Justice goth al out of herre,
 So that knythhode is set behinde.
 Of Aristotles lore I finde,
 A king schal make good visage,
 That noman knowe of his corage
 Bot al honour and worthinesse:
 For if a king schal upon gesse
 Withoute verrai cause drede,
 3550 He mai be lich to that I rede;
 And thogh that it be lich a fable, [1283](#)
 (3750) Mensample is good and resonable.

[MERCY MUST BE
 WITHOUT
 WEAKNESS.]

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As it be olde daies fell,
 I rede whilom that an hell
 Up in the londes of Archade

[THE MOUNTAIN
 AND THE MOUSE.]

A wonder dredful noise made;^{[1284](#)}
 For so it fell that ilke day,
 This hell on his childinge lay,
 And whan the throwes on him come,
 3560 His noise lich the day of dome
 Was ferfull in a mannes thoght
 Of thing which that thei sihe noght,
 Bot wel thei herden al aboute
 The noise, of which thei were in doute,
 As thei that wenden to be lore
 Of thing which thanne was unbore.
 The nerr this hell was upon chance
 To taken his deliverance,
 The more unbuxomliche he cride;
 3570 And every man was fledd aside,
 For drede and lefte his oghne hous:
 And ate laste it was a Mous,
 The which was bore and to norrice
 Betake; and tho thei hield hem nyce,^{[1285](#)}
 For thei withoute cause dradde.^{[1286](#)}
 Thus if a king his herte ladde
 With every thing that he schal hiere,
 Fulofte he scholde change his chiere
 And upon fantasie drede,
 3580 Whan that ther is no cause of drede.
 Orace to his Prince tolde,
 That him were levere that he wolde
 Upon knihthode Achillem suie
 In time of werre, thanne eschuie,
 So as Tersites dede at Troie.
 Achilles al his hole joie
 Sette upon Armes forto fihte;
 Tersites soghte al that he myhte
 Unarmed forto stonde in reste:^{[1287](#)}
 3590 Bot of the tuo it was the beste
 That Achilles upon the nede

Hic loquitur
 secundum
 Philosophum,
 dicens quod sicut
 non decet Principes
 tirannica
 impetuositate esse
 crudeles, ita nec
 decet timorosa
 pusillanimitate
 esse vecordes.

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212

Nota hic secundum
 Oracium de
 magnanimo Yacide
 et pusillanime
 Thersite.

Hath do, wherof his knyhtlihiende¹²⁸⁸
Is yit comended overal.

King Salomon in special
Seith, as ther is a time of pes,
So is a time natheles
Of werre, in which a Prince algate
Schal for the comun riht debate
And for his oghne worschipe eke.

3600 Bot it behoveth noght to seke
Only the werre for worschipe,
(3800) Bot to the riht of his lordschipe,
Which he is holde to defende,
Mote every worthi Prince entende.

Between the simplesce of Pite
And the folhaste of crualte,
Wher stant the verray hardiesce,¹²⁸⁹
Ther mote a king his herte adresce,
Whanne it is time to forsake,

3610 And whan time is also to take
The dedly werres upon honde,
That he schal for no drede wonde,
If rihtwisnesse be withal.
For god is myhty overal
To forthren every mannes trowthe,¹²⁹⁰
Bot it be thurgh his oghne slowthe;
And namely the kinges nede
It mai noght faile forto spede,
For he stant one for hem alle;

3620 So mote it wel the betre falle
And wel the more god favoureth,
Whan he the comun riht socoureth.
And forto se the sothe in dede,
Behold the bible and thou myht rede
Of grete ensamples manyon,
Wherof that I wol tellen on.

Upon a time as it befell,

Salomon. Tempus
belli, tempus pacis.

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[THERE IS A TIME
FOR WAR.]

Nota qualiter inter
duo extrema
consistit virtus.

Ayein Judee and Irahel¹²⁹¹

Whan sondri kinges come were

In pourpos to destruie there

3630 The poeple which god kepte tho,—

And stod in thilke daies so,

That Gedeon, which scholde lede

The goddes folk, tok him to rede,

And sende in al the lond aboute,

Til he assembled hath a route

With thritti thousand of defence,

To fihte and make resistance

Ayein the whiche hem wolde assaille:¹²⁹²

3640 And natheles that o bataille

Of thre that weren enemys¹²⁹³

Was double mor than was al his;

Wherof that Gedeon him dradde,

That he so litel poeple hadde.

Bot he which alle thing mai helpe,

Wher that ther lacketh mannes helpe,

To Gedeon his Angel sente,

And bad, er that he forther wente,

Al openly that he do crie

3650 That every man in his partie

Which wolde after his oghne wille

(3850*) his delice abide stille¹²⁹⁴

At hom in eny maner wise,

For purchas or for covoitise,

For lust of love or lacke of herte,

He scholde noght aboute sterte,

Bot holde him stille at hom in pes:

Wherof upon the morwe he les

Wel twenty thousand men and mo,

3660 The whiche after the cri ben go.

Thus was with him bot only left

The thridde part, and yit god eft

His Angel sende and seide this

To Gedeon: 'If it so is

[STORY OF
GIDEON.]

P. iii.

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Hic dicit quod
Princeps iusticie
causa bellum nullo
modo timere debet.
Et narrat qualiter
dux Gedeon cum
solis tricentis viris
quinque Reges,
scilicet
Madianitarum,
Amalechitarum,
Amonitarum,
Amoreorum et
Iebuseorum, cum
eorum exercitu,
qui ad lxxxx^{ta}
Milia numeratus
est, gracia
cooperante diuina,
victoriose in fugam
conuertit.

P. iii.

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That I thin help schal undertake,
 Thou schalt yit lasse poeple take,
 Be whom mi will is that thou spede.
 Forthi tomorwe tak good hiede,
 Unto the flod whan ye be come,
 3670 What man that hath the water nome
 Up in his hond and lapeth so,
 To thi part ches out alle tho; [1295](#)
 And him which wery is to swinke,
 Upon his wombe and lith to drinke,
 Forsak and put hem alle aweie.
 For I am myhti alle weie,
 Wher as me list myn help to schewe [1296](#)
 In goode men, thogh thei ben fewe.'
 This Gedeon awaiteth wel,
 3680 Upon the morwe and everydel,
 As god him bad, riht so he dede.
 And thus ther leften in that stede
 With him thre hundred and nomo, [1297](#)
 The remenant was al ago:
 Wherof that Gedeon merveileth,
 And therupon with god conseileth,
 Pleignende as ferforth as he dar.
 And god, which wolde he were war [1298](#)
 That he schal spede upon his riht, [1299](#)
 3690 Hath bede him go the same nyht
 And take a man with him, to hiere
 What schal be spoke in his matere [1300](#)
 Among the hethen enemis;
 So mai he be the more wys,
 What afterward him schal befall.
 This Gedeon amanges alle
 Phara, to whom he triste most,
 Be nyhte tok toward thilke host,
 Which logged was in a valleie,
 3700 To hiere what thei wolden seie;

Upon his fot and as he ferde,¹³⁰¹
 (3900) To Sarazins spekende he herde.
 Quod on, 'Ared mi swevene ariht,
 Which I mette in mi slep to nyht.¹³⁰²
 Me thoghte I sih a barli cake,
 Which fro the Hull his weie hath take,
 And cam rollende doun at ones;
 And as it were for the nones,
 Forth in his cours so as it ran,
 3710 The kinges tente of Madian,
 Of Amalech, of Amoreie,
 Of Amon and of Jebuseie,
 And many an other tente mo
 With gret noise, as me thoghte tho,
 It threw to grounde and overcaste,
 And al this host so sore agaste¹³⁰³
 That I awok for pure drede.'
 'This swevene can I wel arede,'
 Quod thother Sarazin anon:
 3720 'The barli cake is Gedeon,
 Which fro the hell doun sodeinly
 Schal come and sette such ascry
 Upon the kinges and ous bothe,
 That it schal to ous alle lothe:
 For in such drede he schal ous bringe,
 That if we hadden flyht of wynge,
 The weie on fote in desespeir¹³⁰⁴
 We scholden leve and flen in their,¹³⁰⁵
 For ther schal nothing him withstonde.'
 3730 Whan Gedeon hath understonde
 This tale, he thonketh god of al,
 And priveliche ayein he stal,
 So that no lif him hath perceived.
 And thanne he hath fulli conceived
 That he schal spede; and therupon
 The nyht suiende he schop to gon

This multitude to assaile.
 Nou schalt thou hiere a gret mervaile,
 With what voisdie that he wroghte.
 3740 The litel poeple which he broghte,
 Was non of hem that he ne hath
 A pot of erthe, in which he tath
 A lyht brennende in a kressette,
 And ech of hem ek a trompette
 Bar in his other hond beside;
 And thus upon the nyhtes tyde
 Duk Gedeon, whan it was derk,
 Ordeineth him unto his werk, [1306](#)
 And parteth thanne his folk in thre,
 3750 And chargeth hem that thei ne fle,
 And tawhte hem hou they scholde ascrie
 (3950*) ~~All~~ in o vois per compaignie, [1307](#)
 And what word ek thei scholden speke,
 And hou thei scholde here pottes breke
 Echon with other, whan thei herde
 That he himselve ferst so ferde;
 For whan thei come into the stede,
 He bad hem do riht as he dede.
 And thus stalkende forth a pas
 3760 This noble Duk, whan time was,
 His pot tobrak and loude ascride,
 And tho thei breke on every side.
 The trompe was noght forto seke; [1308](#)
 He blew, and so thei blewen eke
 With such a noise among hem alle,
 As thogh the hevene scholde falle.
 The hull unto here vois ansuerde,
 This host in the valleie it herde,
 And sih hou that the hell alyhte;
 3770 So what of hieringe and of sihte,
 Thei cawhten such a sodein feere,
 That non of hem belefte there:
 The tentes hole thei forsoke, [1309](#)

That thei non other good ne toke,
Bot only with here bodi bare
Thei fledde, as doth the wylde Hare.
And evere upon the hull thei blewe,
Til that thei sihe time, and knewe
That thei be fled upon the rage;
3780 And whan thei wiste here advantage,
Thei felle anon unto the chace.

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Thus myht thou sen hou goddes grace
Unto the goode men availeth;
But elles ofte time it faileth
To suche as be noght wel disposed.
This tale nedeth noght be glosed,
For it is openliche schewed
That god to hem that ben wel thewed
Hath yove and granted the victoire:
3790 So that thensample of this histoire
Is good for every king to holde;
Ferst in himself that he beholde
If he be good of his livinge,
And that the folk which he schal bringe
Be good also, for thanne he may
Be glad of many a merie day,
In what as evere he hath to done. [1310](#)
For he which sit above the Mone
And alle thing mai spille and spede,
3800 In every cause, in every nede [1311](#)
His goode king so wel adresceth,
(4000) That alle his fomen he represseth,
So that ther mai noman him dere;
And als so wel he can forbere,
And soffre a wickid king to falle
In hondes of his fomen alle.

Nou forthermore if I schal sein
Of my matiere, and torne ayein
To speke of justice and Pite

[SAUL AND AGAG.]

P. iii.
220

3810After the reule of realte,
This mai a king wel understonde,
Knihthode mot ben take on honde,
Whan that it stant upon the nede:
He schal no rihtful cause drede,
Nomore of werre thanne of pes,
If he wol stonde blameles;
For such a cause a king mai have
That betre him is to sle than save,
Wherof thou myht ensample finde.¹³¹²

3820The hihe makere of mankinde
Be Samuel to Saül bad,
That he schal nothing ben adrad
Ayein king Agag forto fihte;
For this the godhede him behihte,
That Agag schal ben overcome:
And whan it is so ferforth come,
That Saül hath him desconfit,
The god bad make no respit,
That he ne scholde him slen anon.

3830Bot Saül let it overgon
And dede noght the goddes heste:
For Agag made gret behest
Of rancoun which he wolde yive,
King Saül soffreth him to live
And feigneth pite forth withal.
Bot he which seth and knoweth al,
The hihe god, of that he feigneth
To Samuel upon him pleigneth.
And sende him word, for that he left

3840Of Agag that he ne berefte
The lif, he schal noght only dye
Himself, bot fro his regalie
He schal be put for everemo,
Noght he, bot ek his heir also,
That it schal nevere come ayein.

Thus myht thou se the sothe plein,

Hic dicit quod vbi
et quando causa et
tempus requirunt,
princeps illos sub
potestate sua, quos
iusticie aduersarios
agnouerit, occidere
de iure tenetur. Et
narrat in exemplum
qualiter, pro eo
quod Saul Regem
Agag in bello
deuictum iuxta
Samuelis
consilium occidere
noluit, ipse diuino
iudicio non solum
a regno Israel
priuatus, set et
heredes sui pro
perpetuo
exheredati sunt.

P. iii.
221

[DAVID AND JOAB.]

That of tomoche and of tolyte
 Upon the Princes stant the wyte.
 Bot evere it was a kinges riht
 3850 To do the dedes of a knyht;
 For in the handes of a king
 (4050) The deth and lif is al o thing
 After the lawes of justice.
 To slen it is a dedly vice, [1313](#)
 Bot if a man the deth deserve;
 And if a king the lif preserve
 Of him which oghte forto dye,
 He suieth noght thensamplerie
 Which in the bible is evident:
 3860 Hou David in his testament,
 Whan he no lengere myhte live, [1314](#)
 Unto his Sone in charge hath yive
 That he Joab schal slen algate;
 And whan David was gon his gate,
 The yonge wise Salomon
 His fader heste dede anon,
 And slouh Joab in such a wise,
 That thei that herden the juisse
 Evere after dradden him the more,
 3870 And god was ek wel paid therfore,
 That he so wolde his herte plye
 The lawes forto justefie.
 And yit he kepte forth withal
 Pite, so as a Prince schal,
 That he no tirannie wroghte;
 He fond the wisdom which he soghte,
 And was so rihtful natheles,
 That al his lif he stod in pes,
 That he no dedly werres hadde,
 3880 For every man his wisdom dradde.
 And as he was himselve wys,
 Riht so the worthi men of pris
 He hath of his conseil withholde;

Hic narrat vlterius
 super eodem,
 qualiter Daudid in
 extremis iusticie
 causa vt Ioab
 occideretur absque
 vlla remissione
 filio suo Salomoni
 iniunxit.

For that is every Prince holde,
To make of suche his retenue
Whiche wise ben, and to remue
The foles: for ther is nothing
Which mai be betre aboute a king,
Than conseil, which is the substance
3890Of all a kinges governance.

In Salomon a man mai see
What thing of most necessite
Unto a worthi king belongeth.
Whan he his kingdom underfongeth,
God bad him chese what he wolde,
And seide him that he have scholde
What he wolde axe, as of o thing.
And he, which was a newe king,
Forth therupon his bone preide
To god, and in this wise he seide:
'O king, be whom that I schal regne,
Yif me wisdom, that I my regne, [1315](#)
Forth with thi poeple which I have, [1316](#)
To thin honour mai kepe and save.'
Whan Salomon his bone hath taxed,
The god of that which he hath axed
3900Was riht wel paid, and granteth sone
(4100)Nought al only that he his bone
Schal have of that, bot of richesse,
3910Of hele, of pes, of hih noblesse,
Forth with wisdom at his axinges,
Which stant above alle othre thinges.
Bot what king wole his regne save,
Ferst him behoveth forto have
After the god and his believe
Such conseil which is to believe,
Fulfilde of trouthe and rihtwisnesse:
Bot above alle in his noblesse
Betwen the reddour and pite

[SOLOMON'S
WISDOM.]

Hic dicit quod
populum sibi
commissum bene
regere super omnia
Principi laudabilius
est. Et narrat in
exemplum qualiter,
pro eo quod
Salomon, ut
populum bene
regeret, ab
altissimo
sapienciam
specialius
postulavit, omnia
bona pariter cum
illa sibi
habundancius
aduenerunt.

P. iii.
223

Hic dicit secundum
Salomonem, quod
regie maiestatis
imperium ante
omnia sano
consilio
dirigendum est.

3920 A king schal do such equite
And sette the balance in evene,
So that the hihe god in hevene
And al the poeple of his nobleie
Loange unto his name seie.
For most above all erthli good,
Wher that a king himself is good
It helpeth, for in other weie
If so be that a king forsueie,
Fulofte er this it hath be sein,

3930 The comun poeple is overlein
And hath the kinges Senne aboght,
Al thogh the poeple agulte noght.
Of that the king his god misserveth,
The poeple takth that he descerveth
Hier in this world, bot elleswhere
I not hou it schal stonde there.
Forthi good is a king to triste
Ferst to himself, as he ne wiste
Non other help hot god alone;

3940 So schal the reule of his persone
Withinne himself thurgh providence
Ben of the betre conscience.
And forto finde ensample of this,
A tale I rede, and soth it is.

In a Cronique it telleth thus:
The king of Rome Lucius
Withinne his chambre upon a nyht
The Steward of his hous, a knyht,
Forth with his Chamberlein also,
3950 To conseil hadde bothe tuo,
And stoden be the Chiminee
(4150) Of gedre spekende alle thre.
And happeth that the kinges fol
Sat be the fyr upon a stol,
As he that with his babil pleide,

P. iii.
224

Quicquid delirant
reges, plectuntur
Achiui.

[THE COURTIER
AND THE FOOL.]

Hic de Lucio
Imperatore
exemplum ponit,
qualiter Princeps
sui nominis famam
a secretis
consiliariis
sapienter
inuestigare debet;
et si quid in ea
sinistrum inuenerit,

Bot yit he herde al that thei seide,
And therof token thei non hiede.
The king hem axeth what to rede
Of such matiere as cam to mouthe,
3960 And thei him tolden as thei couthe.
Whan al was spoke of that thei mente,
The king with al his hole entente
Thanne ate laste hem axeth this,
What king men tellen that he is:
Among the folk touchende his name,
Or be it pris, or be it blame,
Riht after that thei herden sein,
He bad hem forto telle it plein,
That thei no point of soth forbere,
3970 Be thilke feith that thei him bere.

The Steward ferst upon this thing
Yaf his ansuere unto the king
And thoghte glose in this matiere,
And seide, als fer as he can hiere,
His name is good and honourable:
Thus was the Steward favorable,
That he the trouthe plein ne tolde.
The king thanne axeth, as he scholde,
The Chamberlein of his avis.

3980 And he, that was soubtil and wys,
And somdiel thoghte upon his feith,
Him tolde hou al the poeple seith
That if his conseil were trewe,
Thei wiste thanne wel and knewe¹³¹⁷
That of himself he scholde be
A worthi king in his degre:
And thus the conseil he accuseth
In partie, and the king excuseth.

The fol, which herde of al the cas¹³¹⁸
3990 That time, as goddes wille was,¹³¹⁹
Sih that thei seiden noght ynowh,
And hem to skorne bothe lowh,

prouisa discrecione
ad dexteram
conuertat.

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And to the king he seide tho:
 ‘Sire king, if that it were so,
 Of wisdom in thin oghne mod
 That thou thiselven were good,
 Thi conseil scholde noght be badde.’
 The king therof merveille hadde,
 Whan that a fol so wisly spak,
 4000 And of himself fond out the lack
 Withinne his oghne conscience:
 (4200*) And thus the foles evidence,
 Which was of goddes grace enspired,
 Makth that good conseil was desired. [1320](#)
 He putte away the vicious
 And tok to him the vertuous;
 The wrongful lawes ben amended,
 The londes good is wel despended,
 The poeple was nomore oppressed,
 4010 And thus stod every thing redressed.
 For where a king is propre wys,
 And hath suche as himselven is
 Of his conseil, it mai noght faile
 That every thing ne schal availe:
 The vices thanne gon aweie,
 And every vertu holt his weie;
 Wherof the hihe god is plesed,
 And al the londes folk is esed.
 For if the comun poeple crie,
 4020 And thanne a king list noght to plie [1321](#)
 To hie what the clamour wolde,
 And otherwise thanne he scholde
 Desdeigneth forto don hem grace,
 It hath be sen in many place,
 Ther hath befalle gret contraire;
 And that I finde of ensamplaire.

After the deth of Salomon,
 Whan thilke wise king was gon,

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[FOLLY OF
 REHOBOAM.]

And Roboas in his persone
 4030 Receive scholde the corone,
 The poeple upon a Parlement¹³²²
 Avised were of on assent,
 And alle unto the king thei preiden,
 With comun vois and thus thei seiden:
 'Oure liege lord, we thee beseche
 That thou receive oure humble speche
 And grante ous that which reson wile,¹³²³
 Or of thi grace or of thi skile.
 Thi fader, whil he was alyve
 4040 And myhte bothe grante and pryve,
 Upon the werkes whiche he hadde
 The comun poeple streite ladde:
 Whan he the temple made newe,
 Thing which men nevere afore knewe¹³²⁴
 He broghte up thanne of his taillage,
 And al was under the visage
 Of werkes whiche he made tho.
 Bot nou it is befalle so,
 That al is mad, riht as he seide,
 4050 And he was riche whan he deide;
 So that it is no maner nede,
 (4250*)hou therof wolt taken hiede,
 To pilen of the poeple more,
 Which long time hath be grieved sore.
 And in this wise as we thee seie,
 With tendre herte we thee preie
 That thou relesse thilke dette,
 Which upon ous thi fader sette.
 And if thee like to don so,
 4060 We ben thi men for everemo,
 To gon and comen at thin heste.'
 The king, which herde this requeste,
 Seith that he wole ben avisid,
 And hath therof a time assised;
 And in the while as he him thoghte

Hic dicit quod
 Seniores magis
 experti ad Principis
 consilium
 admittendi potius
 existunt. Et narrat
 qualiter, pro eo
 quod Roboas
 Salomonis filius et
 heres senium
 sermonibus
 renunciatis dicta
 iuuenum preelegit,
 de xii. tribubus
 Israel a dominio
 suo x. penitus
 amisit, et sic cum
 duabus
 tantummodo
 illusus postea
 regnavit.

Upon this thing, conseil he soghte.
And ferst the wise knyhtes olde,
To whom that he his tale tolde,
Conseilen him in this manere;
4070 That he with love and with glad chiere
Foryive and grante al that is axed
Of that his fader hadde taxed;
For so he mai his regne achieve
With thing which schal him litel grieve.

De consilio
Senium.

The king hem herde and overpasseth,
And with these othre his wit compasseth,
That yonge were and nothing wise.
And thei these olde men despise,
And seiden: 'Sire, it schal be schame

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4080 For evere unto thi worthi name,
If thou ne kepe noght the riht,¹³²⁵
Whil thou art in thi yonge myht,
Which that thin olde fader gat.
Bot seie unto the poeple plat,
That whil thou livest in thi lond,
The leste finger of thin hond
It schal be strengere overal
Than was thi fadres bodi al.
And this also schal be thi tale,

De consilio
iuuenum.

4090 If he hem smot with roddes smale,
With Scorpions thou schalt hem smyte;¹³²⁶
And wher thi fader tok a lyte,¹³²⁷
Thou thenkst to take mochel more.¹³²⁸
Thus schalt thou make hem drede sore
The grete herte of thi corage,
So forto holde hem in servage.'

This yonge king him hath conformed
To don as he was last enformed,
Which was to him his undoinge:
4100 For whan it cam to the spekinge,
He hath the yonge conseil holde,
(4300) That he the same wordes tolde

Of al the poeple in audience;
 And whan thei herden the sentence
 Of his malice and the manace,
 Anon tofore his oghne face
 Thei have him oultreli refused
 And with ful gret reproef accused.
 So thei begunne forto rave,
 4110 That he was fain himself to save;
 For as the wilde wode rage
 Of wyndes makth the See salvage,
 And that was calm bringth into wawe,
 So for defalte of grace and lawe
 This poeple is stered al at ones¹³²⁹
 And forth thei gon out of hise wones;
 So that of the lignages twelve
 Tuo tribes only be hemselfe
 With him abiden and nomo:
 4120 So were thei for everemo
 Of no retorn withoute espeir
 Departed fro the rihtfull heir.
 Al Irahel with comun vois¹³³⁰
 A king upon here oghne chois
 Among hemself anon thei make,
 And have here yonge lord forsake;
 A povere knyht Jeroboas
 Thei toke, and lefte Roboas,
 Which rihtfull heir was be descente.
 4130 Lo, thus the yonge cause wente:
 For that the conseil was noght good,
 The regne fro the rihtfull blod
 Evere afterward divided was.
 So mai it proven be this cas
 That yong conseil, which is to warm,
 Er men be war doth ofte harm.
 Old age for the conseil serveth,
 And lusti youthe his thonk deserveth
 Upon the travail which he doth;

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4140 And bothe, forto seie a soth,
Be sondri cause forto have,
If that he wole his regne save,
A king behoveth every day.
That on can and that other mai,
Be so the king hem bothe reule,
For elles al goth out of reule.

And upon this matiere also
A question betwen the tuo
Thus writen in a bok I fond;
4150 Wher it be betre for the lond
A king himselve to be wys,
(4350*) And so to bere his oghne pris,
And that his consail be noght good,
Or other wise if it so stod,
A king if he be vicious
And his conseil be vertuouus.
It is ansuerd in such a wise,
That betre it is that thei be wise
Be whom that the conseil schal gon,
4160 For thei be manye, and he is on;¹³³¹
And rathere schal an one man¹³³²
With fals conseil, for oght he can,
From his wisdom be mad to falle,
Thanne he al one scholde hem alle
Fro vices into vertu change,
For that is wel the more strange.

Forthi the lond mai wel be glad,
Whos king with good conseil is lad,
Which set him unto rihtwisnesse,
4170 So that his hihe worthinesse
Betwen the reddour and Pite
Doth mercy forth with equite.
A king is holden overal
To Pite, bot in special¹³³³
To hem wher he is most beholde;

[WISDOM IN A
KING'S COUNCIL.]

Nota questionem
cuiusdam
Philosophi, vtrum
regno
conueniencius
foret principem
cum malo consilio
optare sapientem,
quam cum sano
consilio ipsum
eligere
insipientem.

[MERCY AND
JUSTICE.]

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Thei scholde his Pite most beholde
 That ben the Lieges of his lond,
 For thei ben evere under his hond
 After the goddes ordinaunce
 4180 To stonde upon his governance.
 Of themperour Anthonius
 I finde hou that he seide thus,
 That levere him were forto save ¹³³⁴
 Oon of his lieges than to have
 Of enemis a thousand dede. ¹³³⁵
 And this he lernede, as I rede, ¹³³⁶
 Of Cipio, which hadde be
 Consul of Rome. And thus to se
 Diverse ensamples hou thei stonde,
 4190 A king which hath the charge on honde
 The comun poeple to governe,
 If that he wole, he mai wel lerne.
 Is non so good to the plesance
 Of god, as is good governance; ¹³³⁷
 And every governance is due
 To Pite: thus I mai argue
 That Pite is the foundement
 Of every kinges regiment,
 If it be medled with justice.
 4200 Thei tuo remuen alle vice,
 And ben of vertu most vailable
 (4400 To) make a kinges regne stable.
 Lo, thus the foure pointz tofore,
 In governance as thei ben bore,
 Of trouthe ferst and of largesse,
 Of Pite forth with rihtwisnesse,
 I have hem told; and over this
 The fifte point, so as it is ¹³³⁸
 Set of the reule of Policie,
 4210 Wherof a king schal modifie
 The fleisschly lustes of nature,

Nota adhuc
 precipue de
 principis erga suos
 subditos debita
 pietate. Legitur
 enim qualiter
 Anthonius a
 Cipione
 exemplificatus
 dixit, quod mallet
 vnum de populo
 sibi commisso
 virum saluare,
 quam centum ex
 hostibus
 alienigenis in bello
 perdere.

Nou thenk I telle of such mesure, [1339](#)
That bothe kinde schal be served
And ek the lawe of god observed.

xi. *Corporis et mentis regem decet omnis
honestas,
Nominis vt famam nulla libido ruat.
Omne quod est hominis effeminat illa voluptas,
Sit nisi magnanimi cordis, vt obstet ei.*

[THE FIFTH POINT
OF POLICY.
CHASTITY.]

The Madle is mad for the femele,
Bot where as on desireth fele,
That nedeth noght be weie of kinde:
For whan a man mai redy finde
His oghne wif, what scholde he seche
4220 In strange places to beseche
To borwe an other mannes plouh,
Whan he hath geere good ynouh [1340](#)
Affaited at his oghne heste,
And is to him wel more honeste
Than other thing which is unknowe?
Forthi scholde every good man knowe
And thenke, hou that in mariage
His trouthe plight lith in morgage,
Which if he breke, it is falshode,
4230 And that descordeth to manhode,
And namely toward the grete,
Wherof the bokes alle trete;
So as the Philosophre techeth
To Alisandre, and him betecheth
The lore hou that he schal mesure
His bodi, so that no mesure
Of fleishshly lust he scholde excede.
And thus forth if I schal procede,
The fifte point, as I seide er, [1341](#)
4240 Is chastete, which sielde wher
Comth nou adaies into place;

Hic tractat
secundum
Aristotelem de
quinta principum
regiminis Policia,
que Castitatem
concernit, cuius
honestas
impudicie motus
obtemperans tam
corporis quam
anime mundiciam
specialius
preservat.

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And natheles, bot it be grace
 Above alle othre in special,
 Is non that chaste mai ben all.
 Bot yit a kinges hihe astat,¹³⁴²
 Which of his ordre as a prelat
 Schal ben enoight and seintefied,
 He mot be more magnified
 For dignete of his corone,
 4250 Than scholde an other low persone,
 Which is noght of so hih emprise.
 (4450) Therefore a Prince him scholde advise,
 Er that he felle in such riote,
 And namely that he nassote
 To change for the wommanhede
 The worthinesse of his manhede.
 Of Aristotle I have wel rad,
 Hou he to Alisandre bad,
 That forto gladen his corage
 4260 He schal beholde the visage
 Of wommen, whan that thei ben faire.
 Bot yit he set an essamplaire,¹³⁴³
 His bodi so to guide and reule,
 That he ne passe noght the reule,
 Wherof that he himself beguile.
 For in the womman is no guile¹³⁴⁴
 Of that a man himself bewhapeth;
 Whan he his oghne wit bejapeth,
 I can the wommen wel excuse:¹³⁴⁵
 4270 Bot what man wole upon hem muse
 After the fool impression
 Of his ymaginacioun,
 Withinne himself the fyr he bloweth,
 Wherof the womman nothing knoweth,
 So mai sche nothing be to wyte.
 For if a man himself excite
 To drenche, and wol it noght forbere,¹³⁴⁶

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Nota de doctrina
 Aristotilis, qualiter
 Princeps, vt animi
 sui iocunditatem
 prouocet, mulieres
 formosas crebro
 aspicere debet.
 Caueat tamen, ne
 mens voluptuosa
 torpescens ex
 carnis fragilitate in
 viciu dilabatur.

The water schal no blame bere.
 What mai the gold, thogh men coveite?
 4280 If that a man wol love streite,
 The womman hath him nothing bounde;
 If he his oghne herte wounde,
 Sche mai noght lette the folie;
 And thogh so felle of compainie
 That he myht eny thing pourchace,
 Yit makth a man the ferste chace,
 The womman fleth and he poursuieth:
 So that be weie of skile it suieth,
 The man is cause, hou so befallle,
 4290 That he fulofte sithe is falle
 Wher that he mai noght wel aryse.
 And natheles ful manye wise
 Befoled have hemself er this,
 As nou adaies yit it is
 Among the men and evere was,
 The stronge is fieblest in this cas.
 It sit a man be weie of kinde
 To love, bot it is noght kinde
 A man for love his wit to lese:
 4300 For if the Monthe of Juil schal frese
 And that Decembre schal ben hot,
 (4500) The yeer mistorneth, wel I wot.
 To sen a man fro his astat
 Thurgh his sotie effeminat,
 And leve that a man schal do,
 It is as Hose above the Scho,
 To man which oghte noght ben used.
 Bot yit the world hath ofte accused
 Ful grete Princes of this dede,
 4310 Hou thei for love hemself mislede,
 Wherof manhode stod behinde,
 Of olde ensamples as I finde. [1347](#)

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These olde gestes tellen thus,

That whilom Sardana Pallus,¹³⁴⁸
 Which hield al hol in his empire
 The grete kingdom of Assire,
 Was thurgh the slouth of his corage
 Falle into thilke fyri rage
 Of love, which the men assoteth,
 4320 Wherof himself he so rioteth,
 And wax so ferforth womannyssh,¹³⁵²
 That ayein kinde, as if a fissh
 Abide wolde upon the lond,
 In wommen such a lust he fond,
 That he duelte evere in chambre stille,
 And only wroghte after the wille
 Of wommen, so as he was bede,
 That selden whanne in other stede
 If that he wolde wenden oute,
 4330 To sen hou that it stod aboute.
 Bot ther he keste and there he pleide,¹³⁵³
 Thei tawhten him a Las to breide,
 And weve a Pours, and to enfile
 A Perle: and fell that ilke while,
 On Barbarus the Prince of Mede
 Sih hou this king in wommanhede¹³⁵⁴
 Was falle fro chivalerie,
 And gat him help and compaignie,
 And wroghte so, that ate laste
 4340 This king out of his regne he caste,
 Which was undon for everemo:
 And yit men speken of him so,
 That it is schame forto hiere.
 Forthi to love is in manere.
 King David hadde many a love,
 Bot natheles alwey above
 Knythode he kepte in such a wise,
 That for no fleisshli covoitise
 Of lust to ligge in ladi armes
 4350 He lefte noght the lust of armes.

[EVIL EXAMPLE OF
SARDANAPALUS.]

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Hic ponit
 exemplum qualiter,
 pro eo quod
 Sardana Pallus¹³⁴⁹
 Assiriorum
 Princeps
 muliebri¹³⁵⁰
 oblectamento
 effeminatus sue
 concupiscencie
 torporem quasi ex
 consuetudine
 adhibebat, a
 Barbaro Rege
 Medorum super
 hoc insidiante in
 sui feruoris maiori
 voluptate¹³⁵¹
 subitis
 mutacionibus
 extinctus est.

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[DAVID.]

Nota qualiter
 Daud amans
 mulieres propter
 hoc probitatem
 Armorum non
 minus excercuit.

For where a Prince hise lustes suieth,
 (4550) That he the werre noght poursuieth,
 Whan it is time to ben armed,
 His contre stant fulofte harmed,
 Whan thenemis ben woxe bolde,
 That thei defence non beholde.
 Ful many a lond hath so be lore, [1355](#)
 As men mai rede of time afore
 Of hem that so here eses soghten,
 4360 Which after thei full diere aboghten.

To mochel ese is nothing worth,
 For that set every vice forth [1356](#)
 And every vertu put abak,
 Wherof priss torneth into lak,
 As in Cronique I mai reherse:
 Which telleth hou the king of Perse,
 That Cirus hihte, a werre hadde
 Ayein a poeple which he dradde,
 Of a contre which Liddos hihte;
 4370 Bot yit for oght that he do mihte
 As in bataille upon the werre,
 He hadde of hem alwey the werre.
 And whan he sih and wiste it wel,
 That he be strengthe wan no del,
 Thanne ate laste he caste a wyle
 This worthi poeple to beguile,
 And tok with hem a feigned pes,
 Which scholde lasten endeles,
 So as he seide in wordes wise,
 Bot he thoghte al in other wise.
 For it betidd upon the cas, [1362](#)
 Whan that this poeple in reste was,
 Thei token eses manyfold;
 And worldes ese, as it is told,
 Be weie of kinde is the norrice
 Of every lust which toucheth vice.

[CYRUS AND THE
LYDIANS.]

Hic loquitur
 qualiter regnum
 lasciue
 voluptatibus
 deditum de facili
 vincitur. [1357](#) Et
 ponit exemplum de
 Ciro Rege
 Persarum, qui cum
 Liddos mire [1358](#)
 probitatis
 strenuissimos
 sibique in bello
 aduersantes nullo
 modo vincere
 potuit, cum ipsis
 tandem pacis
 tractatum
 dissimilans
 concordiam
 finalem
 stabiliri [1359](#) finxit.
 Super quo Liddi
 postea per aliquod
 tempus armis
 insoliti sub pacis
 torpore [1360](#)
 voluptatibus
 intendebant: quod
 Cirus percipiens in
 eos armatus subito
 irruit, ipsosque

Thus whan thei were in lustes falle,
 The werres ben foryeten alle;
 Was non which wolde the worschipe
 4380 Of Armes, hot in idelschipe
 4390 Thei putten besinesse aweie
 And token hem to daunce and pleie;
 Bot most above alle othre thinges
 Thei token hem to the likinges
 Of fleysshly lust, that chastete [1363](#)
 Received was in no degre,
 Bot every man doth what him liste.
 And whan the king of Perse it wiste,
 That thei unto folie entenden,
 4400 With his pouer, whan thei lest wenden,
 Mor sodeinly than doth the thunder
 (4600*) He cam, for evere and put hem under. [1364](#)
 And thus hath lecherie lore
 The lond, which hadde be tofore
 The beste of hem that were tho.
 And in the bible I finde also
 A tale lich unto this thing,
 Hou Amalech the paien king,
 Whan that he myhte be no weie
 4410 Defende his lond and putte aweie
 The worthi poeple of Irael, [1367](#)
 This Sarazin, as it befell,
 Thurgh the conseil of Balaam
 A route of faire wommen nam,
 That lusti were and yonge of Age, [1368](#)
 And bad hem gon to the lignage
 Of these Hebreus: and forth thei wente
 With yhen greye and browes bente
 And wel arraied everych on;
 4420 And whan thei come were anon
 Among thebreus, was non insihte,
 Bot cacche who that cacche myhte,
 And ech of hem hise lustes soghte,

indefencibiles [1361](#)
 vincens sub
 imperio tributarios
 subiugauit.

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[THE COUNSEL OF
 BALAAM.]

Nota hic [1365](#)
 qualiter fata bellica
 luxus infortunat. Et
 narrat quod cum
 Rex Amalech
 Hebreis sibi
 insultantibus
 resistere nequii,
 consilio Balaam
 mulieres regni sui
 pulcherrimas in
 castra Hebreorum
 misit; qui ab ipsis
 contaminati [1366](#)
 gratiam statim
 amiserunt. Et sic
 ab Amalech deuicti
 in magna
 multitudine gladio
 ceciderunt.

Whiche after thei full diere boghte.¹³⁶⁹
 For grace anon began to faile,
 That whan thei comen to bataille
 Thanne afterward, in sori pit
 Thei were take and disconfit,
 So that withinne a litel throwe
 4430 The myht of hem was overthrowe,
 That whilom were wont to stonde.
 Til Phinces the cause on honde
 Hath take, this vengeance laste,
 Bot thanne it cessede ate laste,
 For god was paid of that he dede:¹³⁷⁰
 For wher he fond upon a stede
 A couple which misferde so,
 Thurghout he smot hem bothe tuo,
 And let hem ligge in mennes yhe;
 4440 Wherof alle othere whiche hem sihe
 Ensamplde hem upon the dede,
 And preiden unto the godhiede
 Here olde Sennes to amende:
 And he, which wolde his mercy sende,
 Restorede hem to newe grace.
 Thus mai it schewe in sondri place,
 Of chastete hou the clenness
 Acordeth to the worthinesse
 Of men of Armes overal;
 4450 Bot most of alle in special
 This vertu to a king belongeth,
 (4650) For upon his fortune it hongeth
 Of that his lond schal spede or spille.
 Forthi bot if a king his wille
 Fro lustes of his fleissh restreigne,
 Ayein himself he makth a treigne,
 Into the which if that he slyde,
 Him were betre go besyde.
 For every man mai understonde,
 4460 Hou for a time that it stonde,

It is a sori lust to lyke,
Whos ende makth a man to syke
And torneth joies into sorwe.
The brihte Sonne be the morwe
Beschyneth noght the derke nyht,
The lusti youthe of mannes myht,
In Age bot it stonde wel,
Mistorneth al the laste whiel.

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That every worthi Prince is holde
 4470 Withinne himself himself beholde,
 To se the stat of his persone, [1371](#)
 And thenke hou ther be joies none
 Upon this Erthe mad to laste,
 And hou the fleissh schal ate laste
 The lustes of this lif forsake,
 Him oghte a gret ensample take
 Of Salomon, whos appetit
 Was holy set upon delit,
 To take of wommen the plesance:
 4480 So that upon his ignorance
 The wyde world merveileth yit,
 That he, which alle mennes wit
 In thilke time hath overpassed,
 With fleisshly lustes was so tassed,
 That he which ladde under the lawe
 The poeple of god, himself withdrawe
 He hath fro god in such a wise,
 That he worschipe and sacrificise
 For sondri love in sondri stede
 4490 Unto the false goddes dede.
 This was the wise ecclesiaste,
 The fame of whom schal evere laste, [1372](#)
 That he the myhti god forsok,
 Ayein the lawe whanne he tok
 Hise wyves and hise concubines
 Of hem that weren Sarazines,
 For whiche he dede ydolatrie.
 For this I rede of his sotie:
 Sche of Sidoyne so him ladde,
 4500 That he knelende hise armes spradde
 To Astrathen with gret humblesse,
 (4700) Which of hire lond was the goddesse:
 And sche that was a Moabite
 So ferforth made him to delite

[EVIL EXAMPLE OF
SOLOMON.]

Hic loquitur
 qualiter Principum
 irregulata voluptas
 eos a semita recta
 multociens deuiare
 compellit. Et narrat
 exemplum de
 Salomone, qui ex
 sue carnis
 concupiscencia
 victus mulierum
 blandimentis in sui
 scandalum deos
 alienos eolere
 presumebat.

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De filia Regis
 Cidonie.

De filia Regis
 Moab.

Thurgh lust, which al his wit devoureth,
That he Chamos hire god honoureth.

An other Amonyte also
With love him hath assoted so,
Hire god Moloch that with encense
4510 He sacreth, and doth reverence
In such a wise as sche him bad.
Thus was the wiseste overlad
With blinde lustes whiche he soghte:
Bot he it afterward aboghte.

For Achias Selonites,
Which was prophete, er his decess,
Whil he was in hise lustes alle,
Betokneth what schal after falle.
For on a day, whan that he mette
4520 Jeroboam the knyht, he grette
And bad him that he scholde abyde,
To hie what him schal betyde.
And forth withal Achias caste
His mantell of, and also faste
He kut it into pieces twelve, [1373](#)
Wherof tuo partz toward himselve [1374](#)
He kepte, and al the remenant,
As god hath set his covenant,
He tok unto Jeroboas,

4530 Of Nabal which the Sone was
And of the kinges court a knyht:
And seide him, 'Such is goddes myht,
As thou hast sen departed hie
Mi mantell, riht in such manere
After the deth of Salomon
God hath ordeigned therupon,
This regne thanne he schal divide:
Which time thou schalt ek abide,
And upon that division
4540 The regne as in proporcion
As thou hast of mi mantell take,

De filia Regis
Amon.

[DIVISION OF HIS
KINGDOM.]

Nota hic qualiter
Achias propheta, in
signum quod
regnum post
mortem Salomonis
ob eius peccatum a
suo herede
diminueretur,
pallium suum in
xii. partes scidit,
vnde x. partes
Ieroboe filio
Nabal, qui
regnaturus postea
successit, precepto
dei tribuit.

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Thou schalt receive, I undertake.
And thus the Sone schal abie
The lustes and the lecherie
Of him which nou his fader is.'

So forto taken hiede of this,
It sit a king wel to be chaste,
For elles he mai lihtly waste
Himself and ek his regne bothe,
4550 And that oghte every king to lothe.

O, which a Senne violent,
(4750) Herof so wys a king was schent,
That the vengance in his persone
Was noght ynouh to take al one,
Bot afterward, whan he was passed,
It hath his heritage lassed,
As I more openli tofore¹³⁷⁵

The tale tolde. And thus therfore
The Philosophre upon this thing
4560 Writ and conseileth to a king,
That he the surfet of luxure
Schal tempre and reule of such mesure,
Which be to kinde sufficant
And ek to reson acordant,
So that the lustes ignorance
Be cause of no misgovernance,
Thurgh which that he be overthrowe,
As he that wol no reson knowe.

For bot a mannes wit be swerved,
4570 Whan kinde is dueliche served,
It oghte of reson to suffise;
For if it falle him otherwise,¹³⁷⁷
He mai tho lustes sore drede.¹³⁷⁸

For of Anthonie thus I rede,¹³⁷⁹
Which of Severus was the Sone,
That he his lif of comun wone
Yaf holy unto thilke vice,
And ofte time he was so nyce,

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Aristotiles.¹³⁷⁶ O
Alexander, super
omnia consulo,
conserua tibi
calorem naturalem.

[ANTONIUS.]

De voluptuoso
Antonio.

Wherof nature hire hath compleigned
 4580 Unto the god, which hath desdeigned
 The werkes whiche Antonie wroghte ¹³⁸⁰
 Of lust, whiche he ful sore aboghte:
 For god his forfet hath so wroke
 That in Cronique it is yit spoke.
 Bot forto take remembrance
 Of special misgovernance
 Thurgh covoitise and injustice
 Forth with the remenant of vice,
 And nameliche of lecherie,
 4590 I finde write a gret partie
 Withinne a tale, as thou schalt hiere,
 Which is thensample of this matiere.

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So as these olde gestes sein,
 The proude tirannyssh Romein
 Tarquinius, which was thanne king
 And wroghte many a wrongful thing,
 Of Sones hadde manyon,
 Among the whiche Arrons was on,
 Lich to his fader of maneres;
 4600 So that withinne a fewe yeres
 With tresoun and with tirannie
 (4800) Thei wonne of lond a gret partie,
 And token hiede of no justice,
 Which due was to here office
 Upon the reule of governance;
 Bot al that evere was plesance
 Unto the fleisshes lust thei toke.
 And fell so, that thei undertoke
 A werre, which was noght achieved,
 4610 Bot ofte time it hadde hem grieved, ¹³⁸²
 Ayein a folk which thanne hihte ¹³⁸³
 The Gabiens: and al be nyhte
 This Arrons, whan he was at hom
 In Rome, a prive place he nom

[TARQUIN AND HIS
 SON ARUNS.]

Hic loquitur de
 Tarquino nuper
 Rome ¹³⁸¹
 Imperatore, necnon
 et de eiusdem filio
 nomine Arrons, qui
 omni viciorum
 varietate repleti
 tam in homines
 quam in mulieres
 innumera scelera
 perpetrarunt: set
 specialiter super
 hiis que contra
 Gabinos
 fraudulenter
 operati sunt
 tractare intendit.

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Withinne a chambre, and bet himselfe
 And made him woundes ten or tuelve
 Upon the bak, as it was sene;
 And so forth with hise hurtes grene
 In al the haste that he may
 4620 He rod, and cam that other day
 Unto Gabie the Cite,
 And in he wente: and whan that he
 Was knowe, anon the gates schette,
 The lordes alle upon him sette
 With drawe swerdes upon honde.
 This Arrons wolde hem noght withstonde,
 Bot seide, 'I am hier at your wille,
 Als lief it is that ye me spille,¹³⁸⁴
 As if myn oghne fader dede.'
 4630 And forthwith in the same stede
 He preide hem that thei wolde se,
 And schewede hem in what degre
 His fader and hise brethren bothe,
 Whiche, as he seide, weren wrothe,
 Him hadde beten and reviled,
 For evere and out of Rome exiled.
 And thus he made hem to believe,
 And seide, if that he myhte achieve
 His pourpos, it schal wel be yolde,
 4640 Be so that thei him helpe wolde.
 Whan that the lordes hadde sein¹³⁸⁵
 Hou wofully he was besein,
 Thei token Pite of his grief;
 Bot yit it was hem wonder lief
 That Rome him hadde exiled so.
 These Gabiens be conseil tho¹³⁸⁶
 Upon the goddes made him swere,
 That he to hem schal trouthe bere
 And strengthen hem with al his myht;
 4650 And thei also him have behiht
 To helpen him in his querele.

(4850)Thei schopen thanne for his hele
 That he was bathed and enoignt,
 Til that he was in lusti point;
 And what he wolde thanne he hadde,
 That he al hol the cite ladde
 Riht as he wolde himself devise.
 And thanne he thoghte him in what wise
 He myhte his tirannie schewe;
 4660And to his conseil tok a schrewe,
 Whom to his fader forth he sente
 In his message, and he tho wente, [1387](#)
 And preide his fader forto seie
 Be his avis, and finde a weie,
 Hou they the cite myhten winne,
 Whil that he stod so wel therinne.
 And whan the messenger was come
 To Rome, and hath in conseil nome
 The king, it fell per chance so
 4670That thei were in a gardin tho,
 This messenger forth with the king.
 And whanne he hadde told the thing
 In what manere that it stod,
 And that Tarquinius understod
 Be the message hou that it ferde,
 Anon he tok in honde a yerde,
 And in the gardin as thei gon,
 The lilie croppes on and on,
 Wher that thei weren sprongen oute,
 4680He smot of, as thei stode aboute,
 And seide unto the messenger:
 ‘Lo, this thing, which I do nou hier,
 Schal ben in stede of thin ansuere;
 And in this wise as I me bere,
 Thou schalt unto mi Sone telle.’
 And he no lengere wolde duelle,
 Bot tok his leve and goth withal
 Unto his lord and told him al, [1388](#)

Hou that his fader hadde do.
 4690Whan Arrons herde him telle so,
 Anon he wiste what it mente,
 And therto sette al his entente,
 Til he thurgh fraude and tricherie
 The Princes hefdes of Gabie
 Hath smiten of, and al was wonne:
 His fader cam tofore the Sonne
 Into the toun with the Romeins,
 And tok and slowh the citezeins
 Withoute reson or pite,
 4700That he ne spareth no degre.
 And for the sped of this conqueste
 (4900~~He~~) let do make a riche feste
 With a sollempne Sacrifice
 In Phebus temple; and in this wise
 Whan the Romeins assembled were,
 In presence of hem alle there,
 Upon thalter whan al was diht
 And that the fyres were alyht,
 From under thalter sodeinly
 4710An hidous Serpent openly
 Cam out and hath devoured al
 The Sacrifice, and ek withal
 The fyres queynt, and forth anon,
 So as he cam, so is he gon
 Into the depe ground ayein.
 And every man began to sein,
 ‘Ha lord, what mai this signefie?’
 And therupon thei preie and crie
 To Phebus, that thei mihten knowe
 4720The cause: and he the same throwe
 With gastly vois, that alle it herde,
 The Romeins in this wise ansuerde,
 And seide hou for the wikkidnesse
 Of Pride and of unrihtwisnesse,
 That Tarquin and his Sone hath do,

The Sacrifice is wasted so,
 Which myhte noght ben acceptable
 Upon such Senne abhominable.
 And over that yit he hem wisseth,
 4730 And seith that which of hem ferst kisseth
 His moder, he schal take wrieche
 Upon the wrong: and of that speche
 Thei ben withinne here hertes glade,
 Thogh thei outward no semblant made.
 Ther was a knyht which Brutus hihte,
 And he with al the haste he myhte
 To grounde fell and therthe kiste, [1389](#)
 Bot non of hem the cause wiste,
 Bot wenden that he hadde sporned
 4740 Per chance, and so was overtorned.
 Bot Brutus al an other mente;
 For he knew wel in his entente
 Hou therthe of every mannes kinde
 Is Moder: bot thei weren blinde,
 And sihen noght so fer as he.
 Bot whan thei leften the Cite [1390](#)
 And comen hom to Rome ayein,
 Thanne every man which was Romein
 And moder hath, to hire he bende
 4750 And keste, and ech of hem thus wende
 To be the ferste upon the chance,
 (4950) Tarquin forto do vengeance,
 So as thei herden Phebus sein.

Bot every time hath his certein, [1391](#)
 So moste it nedes thanne abide,
 Til afterward upon a tyde
 Tarquinius made unskilfully
 A werre, which was fasteby
 Ayein a toun with walles stronge
 4760 Which Ardea was cleped longe,
 And caste a Siege therabout,

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[THE RAPE OF
 LUCRECE.]

Hic narrat quod,
 cum Tarquinius in
 obsidione Ciuitatis
 Ardee, vt eam
 destrueret, intentus
 fuit, Arrons filius
 eius Romam

That ther mai noman passen oute.
 So it befell upon a nyht,
 Arrons, which hadde his souper diht,
 A part of the chivalerie
 With him to soupe in compaignie
 Hath bede: and whan thei comen were
 And seten at the souper there,
 Among here othre wordes glade
 Arrons a gret spekinge made,
 Who hadde tho the beste wif
 Of Rome: and ther began a strif, [1392](#)
 For Arrons seith he hath the beste.
 4770 So jangle thei withoute reste,
 Til ate laste on Collatin,
 A worthi knyht, and was cousin
 To Arrons, seide him in this wise:
 'It is,' quod he, 'of non emprise
 To speke a word, bot of the dede,
 4780 Therof it is to taken hiede. [1393](#)
 Anon forthi this same tyde
 Lep on thin hors and let ous ryde:
 So mai we knowe bothe tuo
 Unwarli what oure wyves do,
 And that schal be a trewe assay.'
 This Arrons seith noght ones nay:
 On horse bak anon thei lepte
 In such manere, and nothing slepte,
 Ridende forth til that thei come
 4790 Al prively withinne Rome;
 In strange place and doun thei lihte,
 And take a chambre, and out of sihte
 Thei be disguised for a throwe,
 So that no lif hem scholde knowe.
 And to the paleis ferst thei soghte, [1394](#)
 To se what thing this ladi wroghte [1395](#)
 Of which Arrons made his avant:
 And thei hire sihe of glad semblant,

secreto adiens in
 domo Collatini
 hospitatus est; vbi
 de nocte illam
 castissimam
 dominam
 Lucreciam
 ymaginata fraude
 vi oppressit: vnde
 illa pre dolore
 mortua, ipse cum
 Tarquino patre suo
 tota conclamante
 Roma in
 perpetuum exilium
 delegati sunt.

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Al full of merthes and of bordes;
 4800 Bot among alle hire othre wordes
 Sche spak noght of hire housebonde.
 (5000*) And whan thei hadde al understonde
 Of thilke place what hem liste, [1396](#)
 Thei gon hem forth, that non it wiste,
 Beside thilke gate of bras,
 Collacea which cleped was,
 Wher Collatin hath his duellinge.
 Ther founden thei at hom sittinge
 Lucrece his wif, al environed
 4810 With wommen, whiche are abandoned [1397](#)
 To werche, and sche wroghte ek withal,
 And bad hem haste, and seith, 'It schal [1398](#)
 Be for mi housebondes were,
 Which with his swerd and with his spere [1399](#)
 Lith at the Siege in gret desese.
 And if it scholde him noght displese,
 Nou wolde god I hadde him hiere;
 For certes til that I mai hiere
 Som good tidinge of his astat,
 4820 Min herte is evere upon debat.
 For so as alle men witnesse,
 He is of such an hardiesse,
 That he can noght himselve spare,
 And that is al my moste care,
 Whan thei the walles schulle assaile. [1400](#)
 Bot if mi wisshes myhte availe,
 I wolde it were a groundles pet,
 Be so the Siege were unknet,
 And I myn housebonde sihe.'
 4830 With that the water in hire yhe
 Aros, that sche ne myhte it stoppe,
 And as men sen the dew bedroppe [1401](#)
 The leves and the floures eke,
 Riht so upon hire whyte cheke

The wofull salte teres felle.
 Whan Collatin hath herd hire telle
 The menyng of hire trewe herte,
 Anon with that to hire he sterte,
 And seide, 'Lo, mi goode diere,
 4840 Nou is he come to you hiere,
 That ye most loven, as ye sein.'
 And sche with goodly chiere ayein
 Beclipte him in hire armes smale,
 And the colour, which erst was pale,
 To Beaute thanne was restored,
 So that it myhte noght be mored.
 The kinges Sone, which was nyh,
 And of this lady herde and syh
 The thinges as thei ben befalle,
 4850 The resoun of hise wittes alle
 Hath lost; for love upon his part
 (5050) Cam thanne, and of his fyri dart
 With such a wounde him hath thurghsmite,
 That he mot nedes fiele and wite
 Of thilke blinde maladie,
 To which no cure of Surgerie
 Can helpe. Bot yit natheles
 At thilke time he hield his pes,
 That he no contenance made,
 4860 Bot openly with wordes glade,
 So as he couthe in his manere,
 He spak and made frendly chiere,
 Til it was time forto go.
 And Collatin with him also
 His leve tok, so that be nyhte
 With al the haste that thei myhte
 Thei riden to the Siege ayein.
 Bot Arrons was so wo besein
 With thoghtes whiche upon him runne,
 4870 That he al be the brode Sunne
 To bedde goth, noght forto reste,

Bot forto thenke upon the beste
 And the faireste forth withal,
 That evere he syh or evere schal,
 So as him thoghte in his corage,
 Where he pourtreieth hire ymage:
 Ferst the fetures of hir face,
 In which nature hadde alle grace
 Of wommanly beaute beset,
 4880 So that it myhte noght be bet; ¹⁴⁰²
 And hou hir yelwe her was tresced ¹⁴⁰³
 And hire atir so wel adresced,
 And hou sche spak, and hou sche wroghte,
 And hou sche wepte, al this he thoghte,
 That he foryeten hath no del,
 Bot al it liketh him so wel, ¹⁴⁰⁴
 That in the word nor in the dede ¹⁴⁰⁵
 Hire lacketh noght of wommanhiede.
 And thus this tirannysshe knyht
 4890 Was soupled, bot noght half ariht,
 For he non other hiede tok,
 Bot that he myhte be som krok,
 Although it were ayein hire wille,
 The lustes of his fleissh fulfille;
 Which love was noght resonable,
 For where honour is remuable,
 It oghte wel to ben avised.
 Bot he, which hath his lust assised
 With melled love and tirannie,
 4900 Hath founde upon his tricherie
 A weie which he thenkth to holde,
 (5100*) And seith, 'Fortune unto the bolde
 Is favorable forto helpe.'
 And thus withinne himself to yelpe,
 As he which was a wylde man,
 Upon his treson he began:
 And up he sterte, and forth he wente
 On horsebak, bot his entente

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Audaces fortuna
 iuuat.

Ther knew no wiht, and thus he nam
 4910 The nexte weie, til he cam
 Unto Collacea the gate
 Of Rome, and it was somdiel late,
 Riht evene upon the Sonne set,
 As he which hadde schape his net [1406](#)
 Hire innocence to betrappe.
 And as it scholde tho mishappe,
 Als priveliche as evere he myhte
 He rod, and of his hors alyhte [1407](#)
 Tofore Collatines In,
 4920 And al frendliche he goth him in, [1408](#)
 As he that was cousin of house.
 And sche, which is the goode spouse,
 Lucrece, whan that sche him sih,
 With goodli chiere drowh him nyh,
 As sche which al honour supposeth,
 And him, so as sche dar, opposeth
 Hou it stod of hire housebonde.
 And he tho dede hire understonde
 With tales feigned in his wise, [1409](#)
 4930 Riht as he wolde himself devise,
 Wherof he myhte hire herte glade,
 That sche the betre chiere made,
 Whan sche the glade wordes herde,
 Hou that hire housebonde ferde.
 And thus the trouthe was deceived
 With slih tresoun, which was received
 To hire which mente alle goode;
 For as the festes thanne stode,
 His Souper was ryht wel arraied.
 4940 Bot yit he hath no word assaied [1410](#)
 To speke of love in no degre;
 Bot with covert soubtilite
 His frendly speches he affaiteth,
 And as the Tigre his time awaiteth [1411](#)

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In hope forto cacche his preie.
 Whan that the bordes were aweie
 And thei have souped in the halle,
 He seith that slep is on him falle,
 And preith he moste go to bedde;
 4950 And sche with alle haste spedde,
 So as hire thoghte it was to done,
 (5150) That every thing was redi sone.
 Sche broghte him to his chambre tho
 And tok hire leve, and forth is go
 Into hire oghne chambre by,
 As sche that wende certainly
 Have had a frend, and hadde a fo,
 Wherof fell after mochel wo.
 This tirant, thogh he lyhe softe,
 4960 Out of his bed aros fulofte,
 And goth aboute, and leide his Ere
 To herkne, til that alle were
 To bedde gon and slepten faste.
 And thanne upon himself he caste
 A mantell, and his swerd al naked
 He tok in honde; and sche unwaked
 Abedde lay, but what sche mette,
 God wot; for he the Dore unschette
 So prively that non it herde,
 4970 The softe pas and forth he ferde
 Unto the bed wher that sche slepte, [1412](#)
 Al sodeinliche and in he crepte,
 And hire in bothe his Armes tok.
 With that this worthi wif awok,
 Which thurgh tendresce of wommanhiede
 Hire vois hath lost for pure drede,
 That o word speke sche ne dar:
 And ek he bad hir to be war,
 For if sche made noise or cry,
 4980 He seide, his swerd lay faste by
 To slen hire and hire folk aboute.

And thus he broghte hire herte in doute,
 That lich a Lomb whanne it is sesed
 In wolves mouth, so was desesed
 Lucrece, which he naked fond:
 Wherof sche swounede in his hond,
 And, as who seith, lay ded oppressed.
 And he, which al him hadde adresced
 To lust, tok thanne what him liste,
 4990 And goth his wey, that non it wiste,
 Into his oghne chambre ayein,
 And clepede up his chamberlein,
 And made him redi forto ryde.
 And thus this lecherouse pride
 To horse lepte and forth he rod;
 And sche, which in hire bed abod,
 Whan that sche wiste he was agon,
 Sche clepede after liht anon
 And up aros long er the day,
 5000 And caste away hire freissh aray,
 As sche which hath the world forsake,
 (5200*) And tok upon the clothes blake:
 And evere upon continuinge,
 Riht as men sen a welle springe,
 With yhen fulle of wofull teres,
 Hire her hangende aboute hire Eres,
 Sche wepte, and noman wiste why.
 Bot yit among full pitously
 Sche preide that thei nolden drecche
 5010 Hire housebonde forto fecche
 Forth with hire fader ek also.
 Thus be thei comen bothe tuo,
 And Brutus cam with Collatin,
 Which to Lucrece was cousin,
 And in thei wenten alle thre
 To chambre, wher thei myhten se
 The wofulleste upon this Molde,
 Which wepte as sche to water scholde.

The chambre Dore anon was stoke,
 5020 Er thei have oght unto hire spoke;
 Thei sihe hire clothes al disguised,
 And hou sche hath herself despised,
 Hire her hangende unkemd aboute,
 Bot natheles sche gan to loute
 And knele unto hire housebonde;
 And he, which fain wolde understonde
 The cause why sche ferde so,
 With softe wordes axeth tho,
 ‘What mai you be, mi goode swete?’
 5030 And sche, which thoghte herself unmete
 And the lest worth of wommen alle,
 Hire wofull chiere let down falle
 For schame and couthe unnethes loke.
 And thei therof good hiede toke,
 And preiden hire in alle weie
 That sche ne spare forto seie
 Unto hir frendes what hire eileth,
 Why sche so sore herself beweileth,
 And what the sothe wolde mene.
 5040 And sche, which hath hire sorwes grene,
 Hire wo to telle thanne assaieth,
 Bot tendre schame hire word delaieth,
 That sondri times as sche minte ¹⁴¹³
 To speke, upon the point sche stinte.
 And thei hire bidden evere in on
 To telle forth, and therupon,
 Whan that sche sih sche moste nede,
 Hire tale betwen schame and drede
 Sche tolde, noght withoute peine.
 5050 And he, which wolde hire wo restreigne,
 Hire housebonde, a sory man,
 (5250) Conforteth hire al that he can,
 And swor, and ek hire fader bothe,
 That thei with hire be noght wrothe
 Of that is don ayein hire wille;

And preiden hire to be stille,
For thei to hire have al foryive.
But sche, which thoghte noght to live,
Of hem wol no foryivenesse,
5060 And seide, of thilke wickednesse
Which was unto hire bodi wroght,
Al were it so sche myhte it noght,
Nevere afterward the world ne schal
Reproeven hire; and forth withal,
Er eny man therof be war,
A naked swerd, the which sche bar
Withinne hire Mantel priveli,
Betwen hire hondes sodeinly
Sche tok, and thurgh hire herte it throng,
5070 And fell to grounde, and evere among,
Whan that sche fell, so as sche myhte,
Hire clothes with hire hand sche rihte,
That noman downward fro the kne
Scholde eny thing of hire se:
Thus lay this wif honestly,
Although she deide wofully.
Tho was no sorwe forto seke:
Hire housebonde, hire fader eke
Aswoune upon the bodi felle;
5080 Ther mai no mannes tunge telle
In which anguisshe that thei were.
Bot Brutus, which was with hem there,
Toward himself his herte kepte,
And to Lucrece anon he lepte,
The blodi swerd and pulleth oute,
And swor the goddes al aboute
That he therof schal do vengeance.
And sche tho made a contenance,
Hire dedlich yhe and ate laste
5090 In thonkinge as it were up caste,
And so behield him in the wise,
Whil sche to loke mai suffise.

And Brutus with a manlich herte
Hire housebonde hath mad up sterte
Forth with hire fader ek also
In alle haste, and seide hem tho
That thei anon withoute lette
A Beere for the body fette;
Lucrece and therupon bledende
5100He leide, and so forth out criende
He goth into the Market place¹⁴¹⁴
(5300) Rome: and in a litel space
Thurgh cry the cite was assembled,
And every mannes herte is trembled,¹⁴¹⁵
Whan thei the sothe herde of the cas.
And therupon the conseil was
Take of the grete and of the smale,
And Brutus tolde hem al the tale;
And thus cam into remembrance
5110Of Senne the continuance,
Which Arrons hadde do tofore,
And ek, long time er he was bore,
Of that his fadre hadde do¹⁴¹⁶
The wrong cam into place tho;
So that the comun clamour tolde
The newe schame of Sennes olde.
And al the toun began to crie,
'Awey, away the tirannie
Of lecherie and covoitise!'
5120And ate laste in such a wise
The fader in the same while
Forth with his Sone thei exile,
And taken betre governance.
Bot yit an other remembrance
That rihtwisnesse and lecherie
Acorden noght in compaignie
With him that hath the lawe on honde,
That mai a man wel understonde,
As be a tale thou shalt wite,

5130 Of olde ensample as it is write. [1417](#)

At Rome whan that Apius,
Whos other name is Claudius,
Was governour of the cite,
Ther fell a wonder thing to se
Touchende a gentil Maide, as thus, [1420](#)
Whom Livius Virginius
Begeten hadde upon his wif:
Men seiden that so fair a lif
As sche was noght in al the toun.

5140 This fame, which goth up and doun,
To Claudius cam in his Ere,
Wherof his thoght anon was there,
Which al his herte hath set afyre,
That he began the flour desire
Which longeth unto maydenhede,
And sende, if that he myhte spede
The blinde lustes of his wille.
Bot that thing mai he noght fulfille,
For sche stod upon Mariage;

5150 A worthi kniht of gret lignage,
Ilicius which thanne hihte,

(5350) Accorded in hire fader sihte
Was, that he scholde his douhter wedde.
Bot er the cause fully spedde,
Hire fader, which in Romanie
The ledinge of chivalerie
In governance hath undertake,
Upon a werre which was take
Goth out with al the strengthe he hadde
Of men of Armes whiche he ladde:
So was the mariage left, [1421](#)
And stod upon acord til eft.

The king, which herde telle of this,
Hou that this Maide ordeigned is
To Mariage, thoghte an other.

[TALE OF
VIRGINIA.]

Hic ponit
exemplum super
eodem, [1418](#) qualiter
Luius Virginius
dux exercitus
Romanorum
unicam filiam
pulcherimam
habens cum
quodam nobili viro
nomine Ilicio, vt
ipsam in vxorem
duceret, finaliter
concordauit. Set
interim Apius
Claudius tunc [1419](#)
Imperator virginis
formositatem, vt
eam violaret,
concupiscens,
occusiones quibus
matrimonium
impedire,
ipsamque ad sui
vsum apprehendere
posset, subdola
conspiracione fieri
coniectauit. Et cum
propositum sui
desiderii productis
falsis testibus in
iudicio Imperator
habere debuisset,
pater tunc ibidem
presens extracto
gladio filie sue
pectus mortali
vulnere per
medium transfodit,
dicens: 'Malo
michi de filia mea
virginem habere
mortuam, quam in
sui scandalum
meretricem

And hadde thilke time a brother,
 Which Marchus Claudius was hote,
 5160 And was a man of such riote
 Riht as the king himselve was:
 5170 Thei tuo togedre upon this cas
 In conseil founden out this weie, [1422](#)
 That Marchus Claudius schal seie
 Hou sche be weie of covenant
 To his service appourtenant
 Was hol, and to non other man;
 And therupon he seith he can
 In every point wisesse take,
 So that sche schal it noght forsake.
 Whan that thei hadden schape so,
 5180 After the lawe which was tho,
 Whil that hir fader was absent,
 Sche was somouned and assent [1423](#)
 To come in presence of the king
 And stonde in ansuere of this thing. [1424](#)
 Hire frendes wisten alle wel
 That it was falshed everydel,
 And comen to the king and seiden,
 Upon the comun lawe and preiden,
 So as this noble worthi knyht
 5190 Hir fader for the comun riht
 In thilke time, as was befalle,
 Lai for the profit of hem alle
 Upon the wylde felde armed,
 That he ne scholde noght ben harmed
 Ne schamed, whil that he were oute;
 And thus thei preiden al aboute.
 For al the clamour that he herde,
 The king upon his lust ansuerde,
 And yaf hem only daies tuo
 5200 Of respite; for he wende tho,
 That in so schorte a time appiere [1425](#)
 (5400) Hir fader mihte in no manere.

reseruare
 viuentem.'

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Bot as therof he was deceived;
For Livius hadde al conceived
The pourpos of the king tofore,
So that to Rome ayein therfore¹⁴²⁶
In alle haste he cam ridende,
And lefte upon the field liggende
His host, til that he come ayein.

5210 And thus this worthi capitein
Appiereth redi at his day,
Wher al that evere reson may
Be lawe in audience he doth,
So that his dowhter upon soth
Of that Marchus hire hadde accused
He hath tofore the court excused.

The king, which sih his pourpos faile,
And that no sleihte mihte availe,
Encombred of his lustes blinde

5220 The lawe torneth out of kinde,¹⁴²⁷
And half in wraththe as thogh it were,
In presence of hem alle there
Deceived of concupiscence
Yaf for his brother the sentence,
And bad him that he scholde sese
This Maide and make him wel at ese;
Bot al withinne his oghne entente
He wiste hou that the cause wente,
Of that his brother hath the wyte

5230 He was himselven forto wyte.
Bot thus this maiden hadde wrong,
Which was upon the king along,
Bot ayein him was non Appel,
And that the fader wiste wel:
Wherof upon the tirannie,
That for the lust of Lecherie
His douhter scholde be deceived,
And that Illicius was weyved
Untrewly fro the Mariage,¹⁴²⁸

5240 Riht as a Leon in his rage,
Which of no drede set acompte
And not what pite scholde amounte,
A naked swerd he pulleth oute,
The which amonges al the route
He threste thurgh his dowhter side,
And al alowd this word he cride:
'Lo, take hire ther, thou wrongfull king, [1429](#)
For me is levere upon this thing
To be the fader of a Maide,
5250 Thogh sche be ded, than if men saide
That in hir lif sche were schamed [1430](#)
(5450) And I therof were evele named.'

Tho bad the king men scholde areste
His bodi, bot of thilke heste,
Lich to the chaced wylde bor,
The houndes whan he fieleth sor,
Tothroweth and goth forth his weie,
In such a wise forto seie
This worthi kniht with swerd on honde
5260 His weie made, and thei him wonde,
That non of hem his strokes kepte;
And thus upon his hors he lepte,
And with his swerd droppende of blod, [1431](#)
The which withinne his douhter stod,
He cam ther as the pouer was
Of Rome, and tolde hem al the cas,
And seide hem that thei myhten liere [1432](#)
Upon the wrong of his matiere, [1433](#)
That betre it were to redresce
5270 At hom the grete unrihtwisnesse,
Than forto werre in strange place
And lese at hom here oghne grace.
For thus stant every mannes lif
In jeupartie for his wif
Or for his dowhter, if thei be [1434](#)

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Passende an other of beaute.
 Of this merveile which thei sihe
 So apparant tofore here yhe,
 Of that the king him hath misbore,¹⁴³⁵
 5280 Here othes thei have alle swore
 That thei wol stonde be the riht.
 And thus of on acord upriht
 To Rome at ones hom ayein
 Thei torne, and schortly forto sein,
 This tirannye cam to mouthe,
 And every man seith what he couthe,
 So that the prive tricherie,
 Which set was upon lecherie,
 Cam openly to mannes Ere;
 5290 And that broghte in the comun feere,
 That every man the peril dradde
 Of him that so hem overladde.
 Forthi, er that it worse falle,¹⁴³⁶
 Thurgh comun conseil of hem alle
 Thei have here wrongfull king deposed,
 And hem in whom it was supposed
 The conseil stod of his ledinge¹⁴³⁷
 Be lawe unto the dom thei bringe,
 Wher thei receiven the penance
 5300 That longeth to such governance.
 And thus thunchaste was chastised,
 (5500) Wherof thei myhte ben avised
 That scholden afterward governe,
 And be this evidence lerne,
 Hou it is good a king eschuie
 The lust of vice and vertu suie.

To make an ende in this partie,
 Which toucheth to the Policie
 Of Chastite in special,
 5310 As for conclusion final
 That every lust is to eschue

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[TOBIAS AND
 SARA.]

Hic inter alia
 castitatis regimen
 concernencia
 loquitur quomodo

Be gret ensample I mai argue:
 Hou in Rages a toun of Mede
 Ther was a Mayde, and as I rede,
 Sarra sche hihte, and Raguel
 Hir fader was; and so befell,
 Of bodi bothe and of visage
 Was non so fair of the lignage,
 To seche among hem alle, as sche;
 5320Wherof the riche of the cite,
 Of lusti folk that couden love,
 Assoted were upon hire love,
 And asken hire forto wedde.
 On was which ate laste spedde,
 Bot that was more for likinge,
 To have his lust, than for weddinge,
 As he withinne his herte caste,
 Which him repenteth ate laste.
 For so it fell the ferste nyht,
 5330That whanne he was to bedde dyht,
 As he which nothing god besecheth
 Bot al only hise lustes secheth,
 Abedde er he was fully warm
 And wolde have take hire in his Arm,
 Asmod, which was a fend of helle,
 And serveth, as the bokes telle, [1438](#)
 To tempte a man of such a wise, [1439](#)
 Was redy there, and thilke emprise,
 Which he hath set upon delit,
 5340He vengeth thanne in such a plit,
 That he his necke hath writhe atuo. [1440](#)
 This yonge wif was sory tho,
 Which wiste nothing what it mente;
 And natheles yit thus it wente
 Noght only of this ferste man, [1441](#)
 Bot after, riht as he began,
 Sexte othre of hire housebondes

Matrimonium,
 cuius status
 Sacramentum,
 quasi continenciam
 equiperans, eciam
 honeste
 delectacionis
 regimine moderari
 debet. Et narrat in
 exemplum, qualiter
 pro eo quod illi
 vii.^{tem} viri, qui
 Sarre Raguelis filie
 magis propter
 concupiscenciam
 quam propter
 matrimonium
 voluptuose
 nupserunt, vnus
 post alium omnes
 prima nocte a
 demone Asmodeo
 singillatim iugulati
 interierunt.

Asmod hath take into hise bondes, [1442](#)
 So that thei alle abedde deiden,
 5350 Whan thei her hand toward hir leiden,
 Noght for the lawe of Mariage,
 (5550) Bot for that ilke fyri rage
 In which that thei the lawe excede:
 For who that wolde taken hiede
 What after fell in this matiere,
 Ther mihte he wel the sothe hiere.
 Whan sche was wedded to Thobie,
 And Raphael in compainie
 Hath tawht him hou to ben honeste,
 5360 Asmod wan noght at thilke feste,
 And yit Thobie his wille hadde;
 For he his lust so goodly ladde,
 That bothe lawe and kinde is served,
 Wherof he hath himself preserved,
 That he fell noght in the sentence.
 O which an open evidence [1443](#)
 Of this ensample a man mai se,
 That whan likinge in the degre
 Of Mariage mai forsueie,
 5370 Wel oghte him thanne in other weie
 Of lust to be the betre avised.
 For god the lawes hath assised
 Als wel to reson as to kinde,
 Bot he the bestes wolde binde
 Only to lawes of nature,
 Bot to the mannes creature
 God yaf him reson forth withal,
 Wherof that he nature schal
 Upon the causes modefie, [1444](#)
 5380 That he schal do no lecherie,
 And yit he schal hise lustes have.
 So ben the lawes bothe save
 And every thing put out of sclandre, [1446](#)
 As whilom to king Alisandre

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[CHASTITY.]

Nota. [1445](#)

The wise Philosophre tawhte,
Whan he his ferste lore cawhte,
Noght only upon chastete,
Bot upon alle honestete;¹⁴⁴⁷
Wherof a king himself mai taste,
5390 Hou trewe, hou large, hou joust, hou chaste
Him oghte of reson forto be,
Forth with the vertu of Pite,¹⁴⁴⁸
Thurgh which he mai gret thonk deserve
Toward his godd, that he preserve
Him and his poeple in alle welthe
Of pes, richesse, honour and helthe
Hier in this world and elles eke.

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 Mi Sone, as we tofore spieke
 In schrifte, so as thou me seidest,
5400 And for thin ese, as thou me preidest,
 Thi love throghe forto lisse,
(5600*) That I thee wolde telle and wisse
 The forme of Aristotles lore,
 I have it seid, and somdiel more
 Of othre ensamples, to assaie
 If I thi peines myhte allaie
 Thurgh eny thing that I can seie.¹⁴⁴⁹

Confessor.

 Do wey, mi fader, I you preie:
 Of that ye have unto me told
5410 I thonke you a thousandfold.
 The tales sounen in myn Ere,¹⁴⁵⁰
 Bot yit myn herte is elleswhere,
 I mai miselve noght restreigne,
 That I nam evere in loves peine:
 Such lore couthe I nevere gete,
 Which myhte make me foryete
 O point, bot if so were I slepte,¹⁴⁵¹
 That I my tydes ay ne kepte
 To thenke of love and of his lawe;
5420 That herte can I noght withdrawe.

Amans.

Forthi, my goode fader diere,
Lef al and speke of my matiere¹⁴⁵²
Touchende of love, as we begonne:
If that ther be oght overronne
Or oght foryete or left behinde
Which falleth unto loves kinde,¹⁴⁵³
Wherof it nedeth to be schrive,
Nou axeth, so that whil I live
I myhte amende that is mys.

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5430 Mi goode diere Sone, yis.
Thi schrifte forto make plein,
Ther is yit more forto sein
Of love which is unavised.
Bot for thou schalt be wel avised
Unto thi schrifte as it belongeth,
A point which upon love hongeth
And is the laste of alle tho,
I wol thee telle, and thanne ho.

Confessor.

Explicit Liber Septimus.

FOOTNOTES:

- [927](#) 13 þi time AdBTΔ, K (þe tymes lasse C)
[928](#) 15 drowe AM
[929](#) 25 matier AdBT
[930](#) 28 Declared AdBT
[931](#) 29 thre] þe H₁, AdBT, W
[932](#) 56 And þat AM ... B₂
[933](#) *Latin Verses* ii. 2 capit AdBT, W
[934](#) 87 is thilke] þis ilke H₁ ... B₂
[935](#) 89 *S resumes*
[936](#) 92 thre] þe AMH₁XRLB₂
[937](#) 108 The god] And he B The T He Ad
[938](#) 109 That] And AdBT
[939](#) 119 By chief AM ... C, W þe cheef L
[940](#) 161 experience M ... B₂, Δ
[941](#) 177 *margin* vocat A ... B₂ (*except* E)
[942](#) 190 The F
[943](#) 207 *margin* interim *om.* BΔ
[944](#) 236 ther ne] þerþe (the erthe &c.) ne AMH₁XGEL þerþe (*om.* ne) C erþe ne
R line *om.* W
[945](#) 257 lyfliche AM liueliche W lif iche H₁ fische Δ
[946](#) 262 Noman S, F
[947](#) 269 the *om.* AM
[948](#) 275 And B
[949](#) 298 is vpdrawe (vp drawe) C, AdBT, W
[950](#) 300 vpon alofte AM vp alofte T, Δ
[951](#) 303 befalle H₁EC, SAdB, W
[952](#) 319 *margin* hic *om.* A ... B₂, B, W (*Nota* hic *om.* Δ)
[953](#) 323 fyry drake E, BT
[954](#) 330 exaltaciouns AM
[955](#) 336 falle doun to gr.] doun (downe) to þe gr. (*om.* falle) AM ... B₂ falle doun
to þe grounde J, T, W (thre grounde T)
[956](#) 339 exaltacioun AMH₁
[957](#) 361 Daily H₁ Baaly CL
[958](#) 365 forme AdBT
[959](#) 368 hou it *om.* Ad T it B
[960](#) 374 sond(è) AMXGERCB₂
[961](#) 393 The CL Be AdT
[962](#) 429 fyr] ferst B firþ Ad
[963](#) 438 be hote AJMH₁XL, AdTΔ, K
[964](#) 445 chele] cold(e) AM ... B₂
[965](#) 449 *margin* est *om.* B
[966](#) 451 þe cold AdBT
[966m](#) 451 *margin* domus J, SB, F domus est ACB₂ &c.
[967](#) 456 his AdBT hyȝe X

[968](#) 464 *margin* cordi *om.* AM ... B₂
[969](#) 469 chief *om.* H₁ ... B₂ (is chief *om.* R)
[970](#) 478 increacioun AM ... B₂, W
[971](#) 480 Ordeineþ AH₁ ... B₂ Ordeyne M
[972](#) 483 forto] to AM
[973](#) 492 hath] þat AM ... B₂
[974](#) 508 haþ AMH₁, AdBTΔ, WK
[975](#) 510 fleissh(e) may H₁XRCLB₂ fleissh may him E
[976](#) 521 be told JGC, B betold (bitold) A, S, F
[977](#) 525 priuely AJM plainly B₂
[978](#) 528 bookes B
[979](#) 541 Middelerþe (middelerþe) J, S, F myddel erþe AC, B
[980](#) 546 Cam AJ, F Cham C, SB
[981](#) 552 himselue AJM
[982](#) 575 *margin* Aufrica AJC, F Affrica SB
[983](#) 578 Vnto S ... Δ
[984](#) 584 Which AJC, F Whiche SB
[985](#) 597 haleth] lakkeþ AdBTΔ
[986](#) 620 Which AJ, S, F Whiche B
[987](#) 621 good JC, SB goode A, F
[988](#) 628 Alle opre AJ, S, F Alle (Al) oper EC, B
[989](#) *Latin Verses* iv. 4 quod H₁ ... B₂, B quis T
[990](#) 672 knowechinge F
[991](#) 684 tho] þe JXGL, AdBTΔ, K (þo S)
[992](#) 685 *Paragr. in MSS at* 686
[993](#) 694 Bot þorizonte FWK Be (By) þorizonte SAdBTΔΔ But (Bot) zorizonte
 AMYXGERCB₂ Bot þorughout (þurgh out &c.) JH₁L
[994](#) 717 it tawhte (taughte) A ... B₂
[995](#) 724 schal beknowe SΔ, FK
[996](#) 736 fulwonne FK *rest* ful wonne
[997](#) 769 and *om.* AMH₁XGR
[998](#) 798 wantounesse JC, B, F wantonnesse S wantonesse T
[999](#) 911 that] þe AMH₁G, AdBT, W
[1000](#) 933 vpon] whan AM
[1001](#) 935 f. *margin* De septima—dictus est *om.* B
[1002](#) 936 þe AM ... B₂, AdΔ
[1003](#) 956 bryht (bright) S ... Δ
[1004](#) 962 *margin* assequitur H₁E ... B₂ asseruntur X
[1005](#) 978 as it] and it E, AdBT it XL
[1006](#) 983 *margin* adesse H₁XGECR, SBΔ, W (*Lat. om.* JM, AdT)
[1007](#) 979-982 *Four lines om.* B
[1008](#) 984 þe beste AM ... B₂ his brest W
[1009](#) 1007 out of AdBT and of W
[1010](#) 1017 is *om.* AdBT
[1011](#) 1019 hous of AM
[1012](#) 1027 tuo] moo (mo) AM ... B₂
[1013](#) 1033 of o kynde H₁ERCB₂ of kynde XL
[1014](#) 1044 Hise F
[1015](#) 1058 be bore] bifore (before) AdBT
[1016](#) 1079 Monthe *om.* B

[1017](#) 1095 cold *om.* AdBT
[1018](#) 1100 Augst applied T, F August applied A ... B₂ (*except* E). SAdΔ, WK
 August plyed E, B
[1019](#) 1116 this] þe AMH₁XGRLB₂
[1020](#) 1148 To ... bore AMX ... L To ... lore B₂
[1021](#) 1163 he] it A ... B₂
[1022](#) 1181 f. formes ... enformes AdBT
[1023](#) 1223 unto] and to B
[1024](#) 1229 his signe AdBT
[1025](#) 1260 þe point AM ... B₂
[1026](#) 1261 Constantyn noble þe cite H₁XERCL Constantyne þe noble cite B₂
[1027](#) 1266 Aries haþ H₁ ... B₂
[1028](#) 1280 hihe] sihe (*seye*) BT
[1029](#) 1287 moist AJ, S, F moiste B
[1030](#) 1321 Is hette AM it hatteth Δ monþes BT mannes W
[1031](#) 1346 *margin* Berillis A ... B₂, W
[1032](#) 1361 as þe scole (*om.* seith) AMH₁XRLB₂ after þis scole E (as seiþ þe
 scole JGC)
[1033](#) 1372 *margin* Honochinus *om.* AM
[1034](#) 1383 grene] grete B, W
[1035](#) 1393 ellefþe JC, S, F elleþe A elleueþe B
[1036](#) 1400 him calleþ R, AdBT
[1037](#) 1404 *margin* Topaxion H₁ ... B₂
[1038](#) 1406 Topaxion (topaxione) H₁ ... CB₂ to paxione L
[1039](#) 1412 *margin* Astrologia (astrologia) A ... B₂, BΔ, H₃
[1040](#) 1413 Astrologie (astrologie) MH₁E, BΔ, H₃
[1041](#) 1445 which AJ, S, F whiche B
[1042](#) 1464 palmestrie H₁ ... B₂
[1043](#) 1473 Habraham JX, F *rest* Abraham
[1044](#) 1477 this] his AdBT
[1045](#) 1490 aren] been (*ben*) A ... B₂, W
[1046](#) 1493 such a wise MH₁CL, T, H₃
[1047](#) *Latin Verses* v. 1 sermones H₁ ... B₂, B
[1048](#) 4 pulcra AdBT
[1049](#) 1530 ferste A, S, F first (*first*) JC, B
[1050](#) 1545 in gras H₁CLB₂, W
[1051](#) 1574 and fo A ... B₂, AdT
[1052](#) 1577 þe worldes A ... B₂, BΔ
[1053](#) 1588 þis lore A ... B₂
[1054](#) 1589 his] þe AdBT
[1055](#) 1596 Tak (Taak) AC, SB Take J, F
[1056](#) 1597 and of AMR
[1057](#) 1618 he] men A me M
[1058](#) 1619 iugge AdBT
[1059](#) 1640 trewman AC, S, F trewe man B
[1060](#) *Latin Verses* vi. 4 Hec FKH₃Magd Ex A ... B₂, S ... ΔΔ, W regit BTA gerit
 Ad
[1061](#) 1651 first AJ, S, F firste (*firste*) C, B
[1062](#) 1666 that *om.* AM ... B₂
[1063](#) 1670 Belongeþ to Icon. AM ... B₂

[1064](#) 1671 honeste M ... B₂ (*except* C), SΔ, WH₃
[1065](#) 1681 hih] his B
[1066](#) 1688 of] al AdBT
[1067](#) 1690 eek C, B eke (eeke) A, F
[1068](#) 1695 hou *om.* AM
[1069](#) 1698 þe staat (state) AMB₂, W þe estate R
[1070](#) 1711 behoveth] bilongeþ X, AdBT
[1071](#) 1718 *margin* existat AM ... B₂
[1072](#) 1718 are] been (ben) A ... B₂
[1073](#) 1744 wolde B
[1074](#) 1749 be wel A ... B₂ (*except* H₁ welbe)
[1075](#) 1751 *margin* Nota—designantur *om.* R, B, H₃
[1076](#) 1769 his worldes H₁ ... B₂
[1077](#) 1770 goode *om.* AM
[1078](#) 1789 as] and A ... B₂
[1079](#) 1791 And for he AM ... B₂
[1080](#) 1792 wisemen S, F wise men AJC, B
[1081](#) 1793 on] in AM ... C of L
[1082](#) 1795 *margin* asserit B
[1083](#) 1797 which A, F whiche B
[1084](#) 1800 Arpaphes AMH₁XCLB₂ Araphes R
[1085](#) 1805 he triste] þat trist(e) AM he trusteth Δ
[1086](#) 1815 anssuere F
[1087](#) 1836 of lord] a lord E, AdBT, W
[1088](#) 1842 þe S, FW a AC, B
[1089](#) 1882 I sih AdBT
[1090](#) 1883 And for AM
[1091](#) 1884 of Besaxis H₁XRCB₂ and Besaxis L
[1092](#) 1902 þe womman J, BT
[1093](#) 1932 Of] And M, AdBT
[1094](#) 1942 The A ... B₂
[1095](#) 1978 the *om.* J, AdBT
[1096](#) 1980 therupon] vpon AM
[1097](#) *Latin Verses* viii. 2 Eius FKH₃Magd rest Cuius
[1098](#) 1992 *margin* subditi omni] sub dicionum (*subdicionum*) A ... B₂, B
[1099](#) 2015 bitwene (betwen) more AM ... B₂, Δ, WH₃
[1100](#) 2021 and pile] no pile AM
[1101](#) 2043 *Paragr. here* J, SB, F &c.
[1102](#) 2067 *margin* reuelare AM *om.* C
[1103](#) 2077 do] to H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1104](#) 2078 lawe AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1105](#) 2093 list (luste) to H₁EB₂, AdBT
[1106](#) 2106 vnto H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1107](#) 2122 king *om.* AM
[1108](#) 2128 which] þat AM ... B₂
[1109](#) 2140 Bilongeþ AdBT
[1110](#) 2150 *margin* Nota—Aristotilem *om.* BΔ secundum Aristotilem *om.* S
[1111](#) 2155 *margin* Seneca] Salomon B
[1112](#) 2158 been (ben) A ... B₂
[1113](#) 2198 not A, F noght S nought J, B

- [1114](#) 2199 *margin* Tercio contra populum *om.* B, W
- [1115](#) 2219 ff. *margin* Hic contra—deberes] Hic loquitur super eodem, et narrat quod, cum Diogenes et Arisippus philosophi a scholis Athenarum ad Cartaginem, vnde orti fuerant, reuertissent, Arisippus curie principis sui familiaris adhesit, Diogenes vero in quodam mansiunculo suo studio vacans permansit. Et contigit quod, cum ipse quodam die ad finem orti (ortus S) sui super ripam herbas quas elegerat (eligerat S) ad olera lauasset, superuenit ex casu Arisippus, dixitque ei, ‘O Diogenes, certe si Principi tuo placere scires, tu ad olera tua lauanda non indigeres.’ Cui ille respondit, ‘O Arisippe, certe si tu olera tua lauare scires, te in blandiciis et adulacionibus principis tuo seruire non oporteret.’ SBΔΔ (*Lat. om.* AdT)
- [1116](#) 2243 and takþ B
- [1117](#) 2251 and] and wiþ AM, Δ
- [1118](#) 2262 þastat B
- [1119](#) 2282 satte S, F sate W sat J, AdBT sitte (sit) AMH₁XGC sette (set) ERLB₂, Δ, H₃
- [1120](#) 2294 so] þo GLB₂, AdBT, W
- [1121](#) 2318 sein B sayne W
- [1122](#) 2329 Bot] And AdBTΔ
- [1123](#) 2330 Bot wher] And wher AM ... B₂ Wher now AdBTΔ
- [1124](#) 2329*-2340* *only in* AdBTΔ (*not* SΔ)
- [1125](#) 2332* seid T sayd B
- [1126](#) 2331 euery AdBT
- [1127](#) 2335 him wolde S ... Δ, W
- [1128](#) 2337 as *om.* AM ... B₂ (*except* C)
- [1129](#) 2352 is yit] it is C, AdBT
- [1130](#) 2357 ff. *margin* Hic narrat—aduersabitor] Hic etiam contra vicium adulacionis ponit exemplum: et narrat quod, cum nuper Romanorum imperator contra suos hostes victoriam optinuisset, et cum palma triumphi (triumphe S) in urbem redire debuisset, ne ipsum inanis glorie altitudo superextolleret, licitum fuit pro illo die quod vnusquisque peiora que sue condicionis agnosceret in aures suas apercius exclamaret, vt sic gaudium cum dolore compesceret, et adulantum voces, sique fuerant, pro minimo computaret. SBΔΔ (*Lat. om.* AdT)
- [1131](#) 2363 eny *om.* AM
- [1132](#) 2376 of loond A
- [1133](#) 2377 *margin* fortunata A ... B₂
- [1134](#) 2378 *margin* fuerit] fuit B₂ sint H₁ ... L
- [1135](#) 2379 *margin* forte *om.* AM tokne S ... Δ
- [1136](#) 2384 word(e) AMXLB₂
- [1137](#) 2409 that] his B
- [1138](#) 2412 it *om.* J, AdBT
- [1139](#) 2414 ff. *margin* Hic etiam—reprimeret] Hic ponit exemplum super eodem; et narrat quod eodem die quo imperator intronizatus in palacio suo regio ad conuiuuium in maiori leticia sedisset, ministri sui sculptores coram ipso procederent alta voce dicentes, ‘O imperator, die nobis cuius forme et vbi tumbam sculpture tue faciemus,’ vt sic morte remorsus huius vite blandicias obtemperaret, SBΔΔ *but* procederant SBA (*Lat. om.* AdT)
- [1140](#) 2424 Disour] Gestour AM ... B₂
- [1141](#) 2428 be *om.* AM

[1142](#) 2434 thing] king B₂, AdBT
[1143](#) 2444 Tho took AdB Sto cok T
[1144](#) 2460 be *om.* AM
[1145](#) 2461 as] and A
[1146](#) 2464 do worschipe] worschiped AdBT
[1147](#) 2469 boþe (both) AM ... B₂, AdBΔ, W
[1148](#) 2486 if *om.* AM, Δ
[1149](#) 2530 Irahel (Israel) J, S, FK *rest* Israel
[1150](#) 2536 *margin* adulatis A ... B₂
[1151](#) 2540 Irahel (Israel) AJ, S, FK *rest* Israel
[1152](#) 2546 fro BT
[1153](#) 2560 trew S, F trewe AC, B
[1154](#) 2562 I schal AM
[1155](#) 2594 Ther is on] is þer non B is þer on T
[1156](#) 2598 liked S ... Δ, W
[1157](#) 2609 þer S ... Δ
[1158](#) 2619 him AMX ... B₂, K
[1159](#) 2622 his] þe H₁, S ... Δ
[1160](#) 2633 this] þi S ... Δ
[1161](#) 2637 miht (might) JC, B mihte A, S, F
[1162](#) 2641 *S has lost two leaves* (ll. 2641-3004)
[1163](#) 2657 Irahel (Israel) J, FK *rest* Israel
[1164](#) 2689 flatering AdBT
[1165](#) 2691 euermore JM, B forthermore W
[1166](#) 2698 *margin* regiminis] Regis AM, BT, FW legis H₁ ... B₂ siue regis Δ
(Lat. *om.* J, Ad, K)
[1167](#) 2710 lorde AH₁ lordep M
[1168](#) 2747 do] to AM
[1169](#) 2750 disputacioun AM ... B₂
[1170](#) 2762 menable AXG, FW moeuable (moueable &c.) H₁E, AdBT, K
meuable (?) JMRCLB₂, Δ
[1171](#) 2775 Enclynd (Enclined) H₁ ... B₂, W
[1172](#) 2792 in to his AM ... B₂
[1173](#) 2794 putte AC, B put F
[1174](#) 2806 whiche AJ, B which C, F
[1175](#) 2814 non] anon MCB₂ (*p. m.*) gon E
[1176](#) 2840 good AdBT
[1177](#) 2850 f.

That euery man be wepenles
That come in to &c. H₁ ... B₂

[1178](#) 2857 lest] heer (here) AM ... B₂
[1179](#) 2858 Thus AM
[1180](#) 2863 igerd (I gerde &c.) AM ... B₂
[1181](#) 2887 he *om.* B
[1182](#) (2889-2916 *om.* R)
[1183](#) 2900 vpon H₁ ... B₂
[1184](#) 2920 *margin* qui *om.* BT
[1185](#) 2926 *margin* subditos suos *om.* A ... B₂
[1186](#) 2938 *margin* delegatur BT

[1187](#) 2951 and *om.* A (*p. m.*)
[1188](#) 2967 no man JC, B noman A, F
[1189](#) 2977 as] and AdBT
[1190](#) 2989 3e wol AdBT I wold Δ
[1191](#) 2993 swere H₁ ... B₂, Ad, WK
[1192](#) 3000 lest] heer (here) AM ... B₂
[1193](#) 3003 schop (schoop) AJC, B schope F
[1194](#) 3005 S *resumes*
[1195](#) 3020 which AC, S, F whiche B
[1196](#) 3040 to *om.* A ... CB₂
[1197](#) 3060 hadde AdBT
[1198](#) 3063 such JC, SB suche A, F
[1199](#) 3086 he lad AM, Δ he bad B₂
[1200](#) 3088 To do H₁ ... B₂
[1201](#) *Latin Verses* x. 2 vbi H₁ ... B₂
[1202](#) 3110 *margin* *graciosius* H₁ ... B₂, W
[1203](#) 3122 *margin* *Nota* F *om.* AC, B
[1204](#) 3135 Philosophre] holy book BTA
[1205](#) 3149*-3180* *Only in* BTA (*Ad defective*). *Text follows* B
[1206](#) 3150* scholde] þat scholde T
[1207](#) 3163* þis tale T
[1208](#) 3137-3162 *Placed after* 3360* *in* SΔ
[1209](#) 3142 ff. *margin* Troianus—proponebat *om.* BT
[1210](#) 3143 This A, F Thus B
[1211](#) 3148 conseilleur F
[1212](#) 3159 pitous (petous) JH₁LB₂, Δ, W piteous R piteuous X
[1213](#) 3207*-3360* *Only in* SAdBTΔΔ (*Ad defective to* l. 3269*). *Text follows* S
[1214](#) 3222* *margin* *pietatem* *om.* B
[1215](#) 3223* *marg.* *exerciam* S
[1216](#) 3228* *marg.* *pro tempore* *om.* BT
[1217](#) 3231* *marg.* *asinum sibi restitui* BTA
[1218](#) 3234* *marg.* *nocumentum* S *nocumenta* B
[1219](#) 3244* *marg.* *quadam valle* BT
[1220](#) 3251* *margin after* decreuit B *adds* et cum omni sui cordis intimo deo
 gracias egit
[1221](#) 3212* betwene S
[1222](#) 3220* art] arþ S
[1223](#) 3232* I *om.* BT
[1224](#) 3242* And T
[1225](#) 3256* Bopoghte S
[1226](#) 3265* vnneþes T
[1227](#) 3278* On þis on þat AdBTA
[1228](#) 3283* rod] goþ T
[1229](#) 3292* Iuerie AdT Iewerie B Iurie S
[1230](#) 3305* dom (doom) AdBT dome S
[1231](#) 3311* made SAdBΔΔ mad T
[1232](#) 3312* whan B
[1233](#) 3327* hol BT hole SAd
[1234](#) 3339* lond AdBT londe S
[1235](#) 3342* discretely S

[1236](#) 3348* many wise AdB
[1237](#) After 3360* *ins.* 3137-3162 SΔ *rest proceed with* 3163 ff.
[1238](#) 3176 *margin* se] seipsum BT, H₃ eligere *om.* BT
[1239](#) 3174 if it so AM
[1240](#) 3186 his *om.* AM an W
[1241](#) 3198 thoghte to relieve] of his byleeue AM
[1242](#) 3218 in Ermonie AM
[1243](#) 3225 on his heed B
[1244](#) 3233 *margin* restuit F
[1245](#) 3235 and ful AM ... B₂
[1246](#) 3244 was] is 3it S ... Δ
[1247](#) 3271 *margin* in *om.* H₁ ... B₂, BTΔ
[1248](#) 3274 *margin* in exemplum S ... Δ
[1249](#) 3279 *margin* in *om.* BT
[1250](#) 3270 with] þe XGERL by H₁ no B₂
[1251](#) 3271 pitous (petows) MH₁XLB₂, Δ, WH₃ piteuous AdT
[1252](#) 3276 al is SAdBT is Δ
[1253](#) 3279 of his ire Δ in his A in hie M
[1254](#) 3298 *margin* tiranni *om.* A ... B₂
[1255](#) 3298 To whom AM ... B₂, Ad Inne whom W hom Δ
[1256](#) 3326 this caste] it cast B is cast Ad, H₃ þis made A ... B₂
[1257](#) 3330 vnto AdBT to Δ
[1258](#) 3332 which] þat AM ... B₂
[1259](#) 3338 couenable AM ... R coueable L couable B₂ (C *defect.*)
[1260](#) 3340 ago (a go) H₁E, BΔ, WH₃
[1261](#) 3342 of] at A ... B₂ *om.* W
[1262](#) 3362 *margin* Iupiter *om.* BT
[1263](#) 3387 nature þis AdBT natures þus AM ... B₂
[1264](#) 3397 i tamed AM ... B₂
[1265](#) 3412 areste] haue reste AM
[1266](#) 3420 *margin* precipue *om.* A ... B₂
[1267](#) 3436 *margin* offerre A ... B₂ (offerri G, W)
[1268](#) 3423 hapned XERCB₂ papned L
[1269](#) 3429 to mannes b. AM ... B₂
[1270](#) 3432 as he by sente A as by sente M alle by dissent W
[1271](#) 3440 Til god S ... Δ
[1272](#) 3448 His AM
[1273](#) 3454 dydinge AM
[1274](#) 3464 hir(e) power H₁, BTΔ, W ouerpasse AM
[1275](#) 3465 With] By AM ... B₂
[1276](#) 3476 tobrieken S, F tobreken (to breken) AJC, B
[1277](#) 3483 of *om.* AM
[1278](#) 3484 no] not (noght) AM ... B₂ (*except* E)
[1279](#) 3505 f. him ... him AdBT, W
[1280](#) 3510 him *om.* AM ... B₂, Δ
[1281](#) 3523 Why] Wiþ AdBT
[1282](#) 3530 Knighthode R, B, W
[1283](#) 3551 þogh it be lich to a fable A þoght it be lich a fable M
[1284](#) 3556 And wonder dredful noise it made AdBT
[1285](#) 3574 hield (heeld) A, S, F heelde (helde) C, B helden J

[1286](#) 3575 causa F
[1287](#) 3589 and reste AM ... B₂
[1288](#) 3592 wher of þat his knighthede H₁ ... B₂ wher of his knythede AM, AdΔ,
H₃ (knythlihide F)
[1289](#) 3607 hardinesse R, AdBTΔ, W
[1290](#) 3615 forþere (forþre, forþer) AM ... B₂ (forþe X)
[1291](#) 3628 Irahel (Israel) J, S, F *rest* Israel
[1292](#) 3639 hem L, S ... Δ he A ... CB₂, Λ, FWKMagd
[1293](#) 3641 thre] these W
[1294](#) 3652 delit(e) H₁ ... B₂, W
[1295](#) 3672 out *om.* AdBT
[1296](#) 3677 my lust AM
[1297](#) 3683 nomo JC, S, F no mo(o) A, B
[1298](#) 3688 which] þat AM ... B₂
[1299](#) 3689 scholde AdBT
[1300](#) 3692 his] þis AM ... B₂, AdBTΔ, Magd
[1301](#) 3701 he ferde] aferde AM
[1302](#) 3704 slep] sweuen(e) AM ... L (slep G)
[1303](#) 3716 his host E, B, Magd
[1304](#) 3727 despeir AJMH₁RLB₂, AdBTΔ, W
[1305](#) 3728 schullen B
[1306](#) 3748 his] þis H₁G, BΔ
[1307](#) 3752 per] þe AdBT þair L
[1308](#) 3763 forto] þo to AM B₂ to W
[1309](#) 3773 hole J, S, F holly AC, B
[1310](#) 3797 what þat AM ... B₂
[1311](#) 3800 in] and AM ... RLB₂
[1312](#) 3819 myht (might) AC, B myhte (mihte) J, S, F
[1313](#) 3854 flen (fle) SΔ
[1314](#) 3861 non F
[1315](#) 3902 I my regne] I may regne C, W I regne AdT in my regne H₁E in me
regne XRLB₂
[1316](#) 3903 thi] þe AMC
[1317](#) 3984 wel þanne AMH₁, AdΔ wel than al W
[1318](#) 3989 al of þis BT of al þis Ad al this W
[1319](#) 3990 What tyme B
[1320](#) 4004 that] þe AdBT
[1321](#) 4020 thanne] þat A ... B₂
[1322](#) 4031 þe parlement AM
[1323](#) 4037 which þat H₁ ... B₂, BT, W þat Ad
[1324](#) 4044 to fore (tofore) AM ... B₂, W
[1325](#) 4081 þi (py) right MH₁L, BΔ
[1326](#) 4091 him AM
[1327](#) 4092 a lyte S alyte (alite) AJC, B, F
[1328](#) 4093 þenkest take B
[1329](#) 4115 is *om.* FWK
[1330](#) 4123 Al Irahel (Israel) J, S, FK Al Israhel (Israel &c.) AM ... B₂, W Of
Israel G, AdBT
[1331](#) 4160 is on] but oon (on &c.) AM ... B₂
[1332](#) 4161 oonly (only) AM ... B₂

[1333](#) 4174 bot] and AM ... B₂
[1334](#) 4183 How him were leuere AdBT
[1335](#) 4185 an hondred AM ... B₂
[1336](#) 4186 þus AdBT, W
[1337](#) 4194 good] god F
[1338](#) 4208 ferste (first &c.) AM ... B₂ fist Ad
[1339](#) 4212 þenk C, S, F þenke AJ, B
[1340](#) 4222 good] at home S ... Δ
[1341](#) 4239 firste (ferst &c.) H₁ ... B₂, W fist(e) M, Ad
[1342](#) 4245 hihe (hye) AJC, S, F hih B
[1343](#) 4262 set A, S, F sette C, B
[1344](#) 4266 wommen AM ... B₂, W
[1345](#) 4269 womman J, AdBT, W
[1346](#) 4277 it *om.* AdBTΔ (*ins.* S)
[1347](#) 4312 I] men S ... Δ
[1348](#) 4314 Sardanapallus E, Δ, W
[1349](#) 4316 *marg.* Sardanapallus ER, Δ, W
[1350](#) 4317 *marg.* mulieri A ... B₂ (*except* E)
[1351](#) 4322 *marg.* voluptati H₁ ... B₂
[1352](#) 4321 waxþ (waxeþ, wexep) A ... B₂, Δ, W
[1353](#) 4331 þer as ... þer as AM
[1354](#) 4336 how þat þe king AMLB₂ how þe k. H₁ ... C
[1355](#) 4357 many JC, SB manye A, F
[1356](#) 4362 that] it AM ... B₂
[1357](#) 4365 *margin* viuatur AM vincit W
[1358](#) 4367 *margin* mirum H₁ ... B₂
[1359](#) 4372 *marg.* stabilire A ... B₂
[1360](#) 4375 *marg.* tempore B₂, BT
[1361](#) 4378 *marg.* indefenbiles F
[1362](#) 4381 betidd S, F betidde AC, B be tid J
[1363](#) 4395 fleyssly F
[1364](#) 4402 put AJ, S, F putte C, B
[1365](#) 4408 *margin* hic *om.* BT
[1366](#) 4415 ff. *margin* contaminati—ceciderrunt] contaminati sunt (*om.* *graciam*—
ceciderrunt) BT
[1367](#) 4411 Irael (Irahel) J, S, FK *rest* Israel
[1368](#) 4415 of 3ong age B
[1369](#) 4424 aboughte MH₁GE, AdBΔ
[1370](#) 4435 god *om.* A
[1371](#) 4471 þastat (þe astate) AdBT
[1372](#) 4492 of which B *om.* Ad
[1373](#) 4525 kut (kutt) AJC, S, F cutte B
[1374](#) 4526 toward] vnto AdBT
[1375](#) 4557 f. As more ... is told AdB As more ... tolde T
[1376](#) 4559 *margin* Aristotiles *om.* B
[1377](#) 4572 fille H₁ ... B₂ fulle AM
[1378](#) 4573 tho] þe H₁ ... B₂, AdΔ, W
[1379](#) 4574 Anthonie AJ, F Antonie S antoigne B
[1380](#) 4581 Antonie S Anthonie A Antoine J, B, F
[1381](#) 4595 *margin* nuper Rome] rome nuper BT nuper A *om.* M

[1382](#) 4610 he hadde AM ... B₂
[1383](#) 4611 a] þe LB₂, Δ *om.* AM, T
[1384](#) 4628 ye me] I me AdBT
[1385](#) 4641 Whan þe lordes AM
[1386](#) 4646 The B₂, AdBT
[1387](#) 4662 þo he AdBT
[1388](#) 4688 told C, SB, F tolde A
[1389](#) 4737 ground F therthe] þer he AdBT þere (þer) H₁ YXGERC, Λ
[1390](#) 4746 the] þat S ... Δ
[1391](#) 4754 *Paragraph in MSS. at 4757*
[1392](#) 4772 ther] þus B
[1393](#) 4780 Wher of (Wherof) AdBT, K
[1394](#) 4795 the *om.* A
[1395](#) 4796 þis ladyes B þeis ladis Ad þise lady (*s erased*) T
[1396](#) 4803 him AXGCR
[1397](#) 4810 were X, AdBT
[1398](#) 4812 seide B
[1399](#) 4814 swerd] schield (shelde) H₁, B
[1400](#) 4825 schulde (scholde) M, AdBT
[1401](#) 4832 dewe droppe AM, W
[1402](#) 4880 let GEC, AdBT
[1403](#) 4881 hir *om.* B her(e) H₁ XR
[1404](#) 4886 liked SAdBT
[1405](#) 4887 in the dede] in dede AMXLB₂
[1406](#) 4914 And he AdBT
[1407](#) 4918 he lighte AdBT
[1408](#) 4920 he *om.* AdBT
[1409](#) 4929 þis wise AdBT
[1410](#) 4940 he *om.* AM
[1411](#) 4944 the *om.* AM a H₁
[1412](#) 4971 In to AdBT
[1413](#) 5043 f. minte ... stinte J, SB, F mente ... stente AEC
[1414](#) 5101 vnto X ... B₂
[1415](#) 5104 mannes herte trembled H₁ ... B₂, W manne herte trembled AM
[1416](#) 5113 fadre S, F fader AJC, B
[1417](#) 5130 olde ensample C, F old (oold) ensample AJ, B olde ensamples SΔ
[1418](#) 5133 *margin* super eodem *om.* B
[1419](#) 5140 *margin* tunc *om.* BT
[1420](#) 5135 and þus FWKMagd
[1421](#) 5161 þis Mariage SBTΔ
[1422](#) 5171 þe weie GB₂, S ... Δ
[1423](#) 5182 somouned (*or sommoned*) AJ, F somoned C, SB
[1424](#) 5184 stood (stode) H₁ ... B₂ stante W
[1425](#) 5201 schorte J, S, F schort AC, B
[1426](#) 5206 And þoughte to be þer þerfore H₁ ... B₂
[1427](#) 5220 torned AM ... B₂
[1428](#) 5239 fro] for J, AdBT
[1429](#) 5247 take (taake) AC, S, F tak J, B
[1430](#) 5251 aschamed ALM, Δ
[1431](#) 5263 Al with ... of blood T Al wiþ ... al blod B Wiþ ... al blode Ad

[1432](#) 5267 seide AJ, SB seid F
[1433](#) 5268 þis AMB₂
[1434](#) 5275 And for AdBT Or of W
[1435](#) 5279 haþ him AM, W
[1436](#) 5293 ffor þey B
[1437](#) 5327 withinne] which in AdBT
[1438](#) 5336 serued B
[1439](#) 5337 in such CRB₂
[1440](#) 5341 wriþe AJC, SB wriþ F
[1441](#) 5345 of] for AdBT
[1442](#) 5348 hise bondes J, S, FK his hondes H₁ ... B₂, AdTBΔ, WMagd hondes
(om. his) AM
[1443](#) 5366 Of which AdBT, W O such H₁
[1444](#) 5379 cause AdBT
[1445](#) 5380 *marg.* Nota A, F *om.* C, B
[1446](#) 5383 put AJ, SB pit F
[1447](#) 5388 honeste H₁ ... B₂, Δ, WK
[1448](#) 5392 the *om.* AM
[1449](#) 5407 which I AdBT
[1450](#) 5411 sōūnen F
[1451](#) 5417 *S has lost two leaves* (5417-viii. 336)
[1452](#) 5422 al *om.* H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1453](#) 5426 in to (into) AMB₂

Incipit Liber Octavus.

i. *Que fauet ad viciū vetus hec modo
regula confert,*

[LECHERY.]

P. iii.

275

*Nec nouus econtra qui docet ordo placet.
Cecus amor dudum nondum sua lumina cepit,
Quo Venus impositum deuia fallit iter.*

The myhti god, which unbegunne
Stant of himself and hath begunne
Alle othre thinges at his wille,
The hevene him liste to fulfille
Of alle joie, where as he
Sit inthronized in his See,
And hath hise Angles him to serve,
Suche as him liketh to preserve,
So that thei mowe noght forsueie:
10 Bot Lucifer he putte aweie,
With al the route apostazied
Of hem that ben to him allied,
Whiche out of hevene into the helle¹⁴⁵⁴
From Angles into fendes felle;
Wher that ther is no joie of lyht,
Bot more derk than eny nyht
The peine schal ben endeles;
And yit of fyres natheles
Ther is plente, bot thei ben blake,
Wherof no syhte mai be take.

Thus whan the thinges ben befalle,
That Luciferes court was falle
Wher dedly Pride hem hath conueied,
Anon forthwith it was pourueied
Thurgh him which alle thinges may;

Postquam ad
instanciam
Amantis confessi
Confessor Genius
super hiis que
Aristotiles Regem
Alexandrum
edocuit, vna cum
aliarum
Cronicarum
exemplis seriose
tractauit, iam
vltimo in isto
octauo volumine
ad confessionem in
amoris causa
regrediens tractare
proponit super hoc,
quod nonnulli
primordia nature
ad libitum
voluptuose
consequentes,
nullo humane
rationis arbitrio
seu ecclesie legum
imposicione a suis
excessibus debite
refrenantur. Vnde
quatenus amorem
concernit Amantis
conscienciam pro

finali sue
confessionis
materia Genius
rimari conatur.

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- He made Adam the sexte day
In Paradis, and to his make
Him liketh Eve also to make,
And bad hem cresce and multiplie.
30 For of the mannes Progenie,
Which of the womman schal be bore,
The nombre of Angles which was lore,
Whan thei out fro the blisse felle,
He thoghte to restore, and felle
In hevene thilke holy place
Which stod tho voide upon his grace.
Bot as it is wel wiste and knowe, [1455](#)
Adam and Eve bot a throwe,
So as it scholde of hem betyde,
40 In Paradis at thilke tyde
Ne duelten, and the cause why,
Write in the bok of Genesi,
As who seith, alle men have herd,
Hou Raphael the fyri swerd
In honde tok and drof hem oute,
To gete here lyves fode aboute
Upon this wofull Erthe hiere.
Metodre seith to this matiere, [1456](#)
As he be revelacion
50 It hadde upon avision,
Hou that Adam and Eve also
Virgines comen bothe tuo
Into the world and were aschamed,
Til that nature hem hath reclaimed
To love, and tauht hem thilke lore,
That ferst thei keste, and overmore
Thei don that is to kinde due,
Wherof thei hadden fair issue.
A Sone was the ferste of alle,
60 And Chain be name thei him calle; [1457](#)
Abel was after the secounde,

And in the geste as it is founde,
Nature so the cause ladde,
Tuo douhtres ek Dame Eve hadde,
The ferste cleped Calmana
Was, and that other Delbora.

[LAWS OF
MARRIAGE.]

- Thus was mankinde to beginne;
Forthi that time it was no Sinne
The Soster forto take hire brother,
70 Whan that ther was of chois non other:
To Chain was Calmana betake, [1458](#)
And Delboram hath Abel take, [1459](#)
In whom was gete natheles
Of worldes folk the ferste encres.
Men sein that nede hath no lawe,
And so it was be thilke dawe
And laste into the Secounde Age, [1460](#)
Til that the grete water rage,
Of Noë which was seid the flod, [1461](#)
80 The world, which thanne in Senne stod,
Hath dreint, outake lyves Eyhte.
Tho was mankinde of litel weyhte;
Sem, Cham, Japhet, of these thre,
That ben the Sones of Noë,
The world of mannes nacion
Into multiplicacion
Was tho restored newe ayein
So ferforth, as the bokes sein,
That of hem thre and here issue
90 Ther was so large a retenue,
Of naciouns seventy and tuo;
In sondri place ech on of tho
The wyde world have enhabited.
Bot as nature hem hath excited,
Thei token thanne litel hiede,
The brother of the Sosterhiede
To wedde wyves, til it cam

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Into the time of Habraham.¹⁴⁶²
 Whan the thridde Age was begunne,
 100 The nede tho was overrunne,¹⁴⁶³
 For ther was poeple ynouh in londe:
 Thanne ate ferste it cam to honde,
 That Sosterhode of mariage
 Was torned into cousinage,
 So that after the rihte lyne
 The Cousin weddeth the cousine.
 For Habraham, er that he deide,
 This charge upon his servant leide,
 To him and in this wise spak,
 110 That he his Sone Isaäc
 Do wedde for no worldes good,
 Bot only to his oghne blod:
 Wherof this Servant, as he bad,
 Whan he was ded, his Sone hath lad
 To Bathuel, wher he Rebecke
 Hath wedded with the whyte necke;
 For sche, he wiste wel and syh,
 Was to the child cousine nyh.
 And thus as Habraham hath tawht,
 120 Whan Isaäc was god betawht,
 His Sone Jacob dede also,
 And of Laban the dowhtres tuo,
 Which was his Em, he tok to wyve,
 And gat upon hem in his lyve,
 Of hire ferst which hihte Lie,
 Sex Sones of his Progenie,
 And of Rachel tuo Sones eke:
 The remenant was forto seke,
 That is to sein of foure mo,
 130 Wherof he gat on Bala tuo,
 And of Zelpha he hadde ek tweie.
 And these twelve, as I thee seie,
 Thurgh providence of god himselve
 Ben seid the Patriarkes twelve;

Of whom, as afterward befell,
 The tribes tuelve of Irahel¹⁴⁶⁴
 Engendred were, and ben the same
 That of Hebreus tho hadden name,
 Which of Sibrede in alliance
 140 For evere kepten thilke usance
 Most comunly, til Crist was bore.
 Bot afterward it was forbore
 Amonges ous that ben baptized;
 For of the lawe canonized
 The Pope hath bede to the men,¹⁴⁶⁵
 That non schal wedden of his ken
 Ne the seconde ne the thridde.
 Bot thogh that holy cherche it bidde,¹⁴⁶⁶
 So to restreigne Mariage,
 150 Ther ben yit upon loves Rage
 Full manye of suche nou aday
 That taken wher thei take may.
 For love, which is unbesein
 Of alle reson, as men sein,
 Thurgh sotie and thurgh nycete,
 Of his voluptuosite
 He spareth no condicion
 Of ken ne yit religion,
 Bot as a cock among the Hennes,
 160 Or as a Stalon in the Fennes,
 Which goth amonges al the Stod,
 Riht so can he nomore good,
 Bot takth what thing comth next to honde.
 Mi Sone, thou schalt understonde, Confessor.
 That such delit is forto blame.
 Forthi if thou hast be the same
 To love in eny such manere,
 Tell forth therof and schrif thee hiere.
 Mi fader, nay, god wot the sothe, Amans.
 170 Mi feire is noght of such a bothe,¹⁴⁶⁷
 So wylde a man yit was I nevere,

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That of mi ken or lief or levere
 Me liste love in such a wise:
 And ek I not for what emprise
 I scholde assote upon a Nonne,
 For thogh I hadde hir love wonne,
 It myhte into no pris amonte, [1468](#)
 So therof sette I non acompte.
 Ye mai wel axe of this and that,
 180 Bot sothli forto telle plat,
 In al this world ther is bot on
 The which myn herte hath overgon;
 I am toward alle othre fre.
 Full wel, mi Sone, nou I see
 Thi word stant evere upon o place, [1469](#) Confessor.
 Bot yit therof thou hast a grace,
 That thou thee myht so wel excuse
 Of love such as som men use, [1470](#)
 So as I spak of now tofore.
 190 For al such time of love is lore,
 And lich unto the bitterswete;
 For thogh it thenke a man ferst swete,
 He schal wel fielen ate laste
 That it is sour and may noght laste.
 For as a morsell envenimed,
 So hath such love his lust mistimed,
 And grete ensamples manyon
 A man mai finde therupon.

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At Rome ferst if we beginne,
 200 Ther schal I finde hou of this sinne
 An Emperour was forto blame,
 Gayus Caligula be name,
 Which of his oghne Sostres thre
 Berefte the virginite:
 And whanne he hadde hem so forlein, [1473](#)
 As he the which was al vilein,
 He dede hem out of londe exile.

[EXAMPLES OF
 INCEST. CALIGULA.]

Hic loquitur contra
 illos, quos Venus
 sui desiderii
 feruore
 inflammans ita
 incestuosos efficit,
 vt neque propriis
 Sororibus parcunt.
 Et narrat

Bot afterward withinne a while
 God hath beraft him in his ire
 210 His lif and ek his large empire:
 And thus for likinge of a throwe
 For evere his lust was overthrowe.
 Of this sotie also I finde,
 Amon his Soster ayein kinde,
 Which hihte Thamar, he forlay;
 Bot he that lust an other day
 Aboghte, whan that Absolon
 His oghne brother therupon,
 Of that he hadde his Soster schent,
 Tok of that Senne vengeance
 And slowh him with his oghne hond:
 And thus thunkinde unkinde fond.

And forto se more of this thing,
 The bible makth a knowleching,
 Wherof thou miht take evidence
 Upon the sothe experience.
 Whan Lothes wif was overgon
 And schape into the salte Ston,¹⁴⁷⁴
 As it is spoke into this day,
 220 Be bothe hise dowhtres thanne he lay,
 With childe and made hem bothe
 grete,¹⁴⁷⁵
 Til that nature hem wolde lete,
 And so the cause aboute ladde
 That ech of hem a Sone hadde,
 Moab the ferste, and the seconde
 Amon, of whiche, as it is founde,
 Cam afterward to gret encres¹⁴⁷⁶
 Tuo nacions: and natheles,
 For that the stockes were ungoode,¹⁴⁷⁷
 The branches mihten noght be goode;
 For of the false Moabites
 Forth with the strengthe of Amonites,

exemplum, qualiter
 pro eo quod Gayus
 Caligula tres
 sorores suas
 virgines coitu
 illicito oppressit,
 deus tanti sceleris
 peccatum
 impune¹⁴⁷¹ non
 ferens ipsum non
 solum ab imperio
 set a vita iusticia
 vindice
 priuauit.¹⁴⁷²
 Narrat eciam aliud
 exemplum super
 eodem, qualiter
 Amon filius Dauid
 fatui amoris
 concupiscencia
 preuentus, sororem
 suam Thamar a sue
 virginitatis
 pudicia inuitam
 deflorauit, propter
 quod et ipse a
 fratre suo Absolon
 postea interfectus,
 peccatum sue
 mortis precio
 inuitus redemit.

[AMMON.]

[LOT AND HIS
DAUGHTERS.]

Hic narrat, qualiter
 Loth duas filias
 suas ipsis
 consencientibus
 carnali copula
 cognouit, duosque
 ex eis filios,
 scilicet Moab et
 Amon, progeniuit,
 quorum postea
 generacio praua et
 exasperans contra
 populum dei in
 terra saltim
 promissionis vario

	Of that thei weren ferst misgete,	grauamine quam
	The poeple of god was ofte upsete	sepius insultabat.
230	In Irahel and in Judee, 1478	P. iii.
240	As in the bible a man mai se.	283
	Lo thus, my Sone, as I thee seie,	Confessor.
	Thou miht thiselue be beseie	
	Of that thou hast of othre herd:	
250	For euer yit it hath so ferd,	[INCEST.]
	Of loves lust if so befall	
	That it in other place falle	
	Than it is of the lawe set,	
	He which his love hath so beset	
	Mote afterward repente him sore.	
	And every man is othres lore;	
	Of that befell in time er this 1479	P. iii.
	The present time which now is	284
	May ben enformed hou it stod,	
260	And take that him thenketh good,	
	And leue that which is noght so.	
	Bot forto loke of time go, 1480	
	Hou lust of love exceedeth lawe,	
	It oghte forto be withdrawe;	
	For every man it scholde drede,	
	And nameliche in his Sibrede,	
	Which torneth ofte to vengeance:	
	Wherof a tale in remembrance,	
	Which is a long process to hiere,	
270	I thenke forto tellen hiere.	

ii.	<i>Omnibus est communis amor, set et</i>	[APOLLONIUS OF
	<i>immoderatos</i>	TYRE.]
	<i>Qui facit excessus, non reputatur amans.</i>	
	<i>Sors tamen vnde Venus attractat corda, videre</i>	
	<i>Que rationis erunt, non ratione sinit.</i>	

	Of a Cronique in daies gon,	Hic loquitur adhuc
	The which is cleped Pantheon,	contra incestuosos
		amantum coitus. Et

In loves cause I rede thus,
 Hou that the grete Antiochus,
 Of whom that Antioche tok
 His ferste name, as seith the bok,
 Was coupled to a noble queene,
 And hadde a dowhter hem betwene:
 Bot such fortune cam to honde,
 280 That deth, which no king mai withstonde,
 Bot every lif it mote obeie,
 This worthi queene tok aweie.
 The king, which made mochel mone,
 Tho stod, as who seith, al him one
 Withoute wif, bot natheles
 His doghter, which was piereles
 Of beaute, duelte aboute him stille.
 Bot whanne a man hath welthe at wille,
 The fleissh is frele and falleth ofte,
 And that this maide tendre and softe,
 Which in hire fadres chambres duelte, [1482](#)
 Withinne a time wiste and felte:
 For likinge and concupiscence [1483](#)
 Withoute insihte of conscience
 The fader so with lustes blente,
 That he caste al his hole entente
 His oghne doghter forto spille.
 This king hath leisir at his wille [1484](#)
 With strengthe, and whanne he time sih,
 This yonge maiden he forlih:
 And sche was tendre and full of drede,
 290 Sche couthe noght hir Maidenhede
 300 Defende, and thus sche hath forlore
 The flour which sche hath longe bore.
 It helpeth noght althogh sche wepe,
 For thei that scholde hir bodi kepe
 Of wommen were absent as thanne;
 And thus this maiden goth to manne,
 The wylde fader thus devoureth

narrat mirabile
 exemplum de
 magno Rege
 Antiocho, qui
 vxore mortua
 propriam filiam
 violauit: et quia
 filie Matrimonium
 penes alios
 impedire voluit,
 tale ab eo exiit
 edictum, quod si
 quis eam in
 vxorem peteret,
 nisi ipse prius [1481](#)
 quoddam problema
 questionis, quam
 ipse Rex
 proposuerat,
 veraciter solueret,
 capitali sententia
 puniretur. Super
 quo veniens
 tandem discretus
 iuuenis princeps
 Tyri Appolinus
 questionem soluit;
 nec tamen filiam
 habere potuit, set
 Rex indignatus
 ipsum propter hoc
 in mortis odium
 recollegit. Vnde
 Appolinus a facie
 Regis fugiens,
 quam plura, prout
 inferius
 intitulantur, propter
 amorem pericla
 passus est.

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310 His oghne fleissh, which non socoureth, [1485](#)

And that was cause of mochel care.

Bot after this unkinde fare

Out of the chambre goth the king,

And sche lay stille, and of this thing,

Withinne herself such sorghe made,

Ther was no wiht that mihte hir glade,

For feere of thilke horrible vice.

With that cam inne the Norrice

Which fro childhode hire hadde kept,

320 And axeth if sche hadde slept,

And why hire chiere was unglad.

Bot sche, which hath ben overlad

Of that sche myhte noght be wreke,

For schame couthe unethes speke;

And natheles mercy sche preide

With wepende yhe and thus sche seide:

‘Helas, mi Sister, waileway,

That evere I sih this ilke day!

Thing which mi bodi ferst begat

330 Into this world, onliche that

Mi worldes worschipe hath bereft.’

With that sche swouneth now and eft,

And evere wissheth after deth,

So that welnyh hire lacketh breth.

That other, which hire wordes herde,

In confortinge of hire ansuerde,

To lette hire fadres fol desir [1486](#)

Sche wiste no recoverir:

Whan thing is do, ther is no bote,

340 So suffren thei that suffre mote;

Ther was non other which it wiste.

Thus hath this king al that him liste

Of his likinge and his plesance,

And laste in such continuance,

And such delit he tok therinne,

Him thoghte that it was no Sinne;

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And sche dorste him nothing withseie.
 Bot fame, which goth every weie,
 To sondry regnes al aboute
 350 The grete Beaute telleth oute
 Of such a maide of hih parage:
 So that for love of mariage
 The worthi Princes come and sende,
 As thei the whiche al honour wende, [1487](#)
 And knewe nothing hou it stod. [1488](#)
 The fader, whanne he understod,
 That thei his dowhter thus besoghte,
 With al his wit he caste and thoghte [1489](#)
 Hou that he myhte finde a lette;
 360 And such a Statut thanne he sette,
 And in this wise his lawe he taxeth,
 That what man that his doghter axeth, [1490](#)
 Bot if he couthe his question
 Assoile upon suggestion
 Of certein thinges that befelle,
 The whiche he wolde unto him telle,
 He scholde in certein lese his hed.
 And thus ther weren manye ded,
 Here hevedes stondende on the gate,
 370 Till ate laste longe and late,
 For lacke of ansuere in the wise, [1491](#)
 The remenant that weren wise
 Eschuieden to make assay.
 Til it befell upon a day
 Appolinus the Prince of Tyr,
 Which hath to love a gret desir,
 As he which in his hihe mod
 Was likende of his hote blod,
 A yong, a freissh, a lusti knyht,
 380 As he lai musende on a nyht
 Of the tidinges whiche he herde,
 He thoghte assaie hou that it ferde.

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De aduentu
 Appolini in
 Antiochiam, vbi
 ipse filiam Regis
 Antiochi in vxorem
 postulauit.

He was with worthi compainie
Arraied, and with good navie
To schipe he goth, the wynd him dryveth,
And seileth, til that he arryveth:
Sauf in the port of Antioche
He londeth, and goth to aproche
The kinges Court and his presence.

390 Of every naturel science,
Which eny clerk him couthe teche,
He couthe ynowh, and in his speche
Of wordes he was eloquent;
And whanne he sih the king present,
He preith he moste his dowhter have.
The king ayein began to crave,
And tolde him the condicion,
Hou ferst unto his question
He mote ansuere and faile noght,
400 Or with his heved it schal be boght:
And he him axeth what it was.

The king declareth him the cas
With sturne lok and sturdi chiere, [1492](#)
To him and seide in this manere:
'With felonie I am upbore,
I ete and have it noght forbore
Mi modres fleissh, whos housebonde
Mi fader forto seche I fonde,
Which is the Sone ek of my wif.

410 Hierof I am inquisitif;
And who that can mi tale save,
Al quyt he schal my doghter have;
Of his ansuere and if he faile,
He schal be ded withoute faile.
Forthi my Sone,' quod the king,
'Be wel avised of this thing, [1493](#)
Which hath thi lif in jeupartie.'

Appolinus for his partie,
Whan he this question hath herd, [1494](#)

Questio Regis
Antiochi.

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Scelere vehor,
materna carne
vescor, quero
patrem meum,
matris mee virum,
vxoris mee filium.

Responsio
Appollini.

420 Unto the king he hath ansuerd
And hath rehersed on and on
The pointz, and seide therupon:
'The question which thou hast spoke,
If thou wolt that it be unloke,
It toucheth al the privete
Betwen thin oghne child and thee,
And stant al hol upon you tuo.'

The king was wonder sory tho,
And thoghte, if that he seide it oute,
430 Than were he schamed al aboute.
With slihe wordes and with felle
He seith, 'Mi Sone, I schal thee telle,
Though that thou be of litel wit,
It is no gret merveile as yit,
Thin age mai it noght suffise:
Bot loke wel thou noght despise
Thin oghne lif, for of my grace
Of thretty daies fulle a space
I grante thee, to ben avised.'

440 And thus with leve and time assised
This yonge Prince forth he wente,
And understod wel what it mente,
Withinne his herte as he was lered,¹⁴⁹⁶
That forto maken him afered
The king his time hath so deslaied.
Wherof he dradde and was esmaied,¹⁴⁹⁷
Of treson that he deie scholde,
For he the king his sothe tolde;
And sodeinly the nyhtes tyde,
450 That more wolde he noght abide,
Al prively his barge he hente
And hom ayein to Tyr he wente:
And in his oghne wit he seide
For drede, if he the king bewreide,
He knew so wel the kinges herte,
That deth ne scholde he noght asterte,

Indignacio
Antiochi super
responsione
Appolini.¹⁴⁹⁵

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De recessu
Appollini ab
Antiochia.

The king him wolde so poursuie.
 Bot he, that wolde his deth eschuie,
 And knew al this tofor the hond,
 460 Forsake he thoghte his oghne lond,
 That there wolde he noght abyde;
 For wel he knew that on som syde¹⁴⁹⁸
 This tirant of his felonie
 Be som manere of tricherie
 To grieve his bodi wol noght leve.
 Forthi withoute take leve,
 Als priveliche as evere he myhte,¹⁵⁰⁰
 He goth him to the See be nyhte
 In Schipes that be whete laden.¹⁵⁰¹
 470 Here takel redy tho thei maden
 And hale up Seil and forth thei fare.¹⁵⁰²
 Bot forto tellen of the care
 That thei of Tyr begonne tho,
 Whan that thei wiste he was ago,
 It is a Pite forto hierie.
 They losten lust, they losten chiere,
 Thei toke upon hem such penaunce,
 Ther was no song, ther was no daunce,
 Bot every merthe and melodie
 480 To hem was thanne a maladie;
 For unlust of that aventure
 Ther was noman which tok tonsure,
 In doelful clothes thei hem clothe,¹⁵⁰³
 The bathes and the Stwes bothe
 Thei schetten in be every weie;
 There was no lif which leste pleie
 Ne take of eny joie kepe,
 Bot for here liege lord to wepe;
 And every wyht seide as he couthe,
 490 ‘Helas, the lusti flour of youthe,
 Our Prince, oure heved, our governour,
 Thurgh whom we stoden in honour,¹⁵⁰⁴

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De fuga Appolini
 per mare¹⁴⁹⁹ a
 Regno suo.

Withoute the comun assent
Thus sodeinliche is fro ous went!
Such was the clamour of hem alle.

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Bot se we now what is befalle
Upon the ferste tale plein,
And torne we therto ayein.
Antiochus the grete Sire,
500 Which full of rancour and of ire
His herte berth, so as ye herde,
Of that this Prince of Tyr ansuerde,
He hadde a feloun bacheler,
Which was his prive consailer,
And Taliart be name he hihte: [1506](#)
The king a strong puison him dihte
Withinne a buiste and gold therto, [1507](#)
In alle haste and bad him go
Strawht unto Tyr, and for no cost
510 Ne spare he, til he hadde lost [1508](#)
The Prince which he wolde spille.
And whan the king hath seid his wille,
This Taliart in a Galeie [1509](#)
With alle haste he tok his weie:
The wynd was good, he saileth blyve,
Til he tok lond upon the ryve
Of Tyr, and forth with al anon
Into the Burgh he gan to gon,
And tok his In and bod a throwe.
520 Bot for he wolde noght be knowe,
Desguised thanne he goth him oute;
He sih the wepinge al aboute,
And axeth what the cause was,
And thei him tolden al the cas,
How sodeinli the Prince is go.
And whan he sih that it was so,
And that his labour was in vein,
Anon he torneth hom ayein,
And to the king, whan he cam nyh,

Nota [1505](#) qualiter
Thaliartus Miles,
vt Appolinum
veneno intoxicaret,
ab Antiocho in
Tyrum missus, ipso
ibidem non inuento
Antiochiam rediit.

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530 He tolde of that he herde and syh,
Hou that the Prince of Tyr is fled,
So was he come ayein unsped.
The king was sori for a while,
Bot whan he sih that with no wyle
He myhte achieve his crualte, [1510](#)
He stinte his wraththe and let him be.

Bot over this now forto telle
Of adventures that befelle
Unto this Prince of whom I tolde, [1511](#)
540 He hath his rihte cours forth holde
Be Ston and nedle, til he cam
To Tharse, and there his lond he nam.
A Burgeis riche of gold and fee
Was thilke time in that cite,
Which cleped was Strangulio,
His wif was Dionise also:
This yonge Prince, as seith the bok,
With hem his herbergage tok; [1512](#)
And it befell that Cite so

550 Before time and thanne also,
Thurgh strong famyne which hem ladde
Was non that eny whete hadde.
Appolinus, whan that he herde [1513](#)
The meschief, hou the cite ferde,
Al freliche of his oghne yifte
His whete, among hem forto schifte,
The which be Schipe he hadde broght,
He yaf, and tok of hem riht noght.
Bot sithen ferst this world began,

560 Was nevere yit to such a man
Mor joie mad than thei him made:
For thei were alle of him so glade,
That thei for evere in remembrance
Made a figure in resemblance
Of him, and in the comun place [1514](#)

Qualiter Appolinus
in portu Tharsis
applicuit, vbi in
hospicio cuiusdam
magni viri nomine
Strangulionis
hospitatus est.

Thei sette him up, so that his face¹⁵¹⁵
 Mihte every maner man beholde,
 So as the cite was beholde;¹⁵¹⁶
 It was of latoun overgilt:
 570 Thus hath he noght his yifte spilt.
 Upon a time with his route¹⁵¹⁸
 This lord to pleie goth him oute,
 And in his weie of Tyr he mette
 A man, the which on knees him
 grette,¹⁵¹⁹
 And Hellican be name he hihte,
 Which preide his lord to have insihte
 Upon himself, and seide him thus,
 Hou that the grete Antiochus
 Awaiteth if he mihte him spille.
 580 That other thoghte and hield him stille,
 And thonked him of his warnynge,
 And bad him telle no tidinge,¹⁵²⁰
 Whan he to Tyr cam hom ayein,
 That he in Tharse him hadde sein.
 Fortune hath evere be muable
 And mai no while stonde stable:
 For now it hiheth, now it loweth,
 Now stant upriht, now overthroweth,
 Now full of blisse and now of bale,
 590 As in the tellinge of mi tale¹⁵²¹
 Hierafterward a man mai liere,
 Which is gret routhe forto hiere.
 This lord, which wolde don his beste,
 Withinne himself hath litel reste,
 And thoghte he wolde his place change
 And seche a contre more strange.
 Of Tharsiens his leve anon
 He tok, and is to Schipe gon:¹⁵²²
 His cours he nam with Seil updrawe,
 600 Where as fortune doth the lawe,

Qualiter Hellicanus
 ciuis Tyri Tharsim
 veniens Appolinum
 de insidiis Antiochi
 premuniuit.¹⁵¹⁷

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Qualiter Appolinus
 portum Tharsis
 relinquens, cum
 ipse per mare
 nauigio securiorem
 quesuiet,
 superueniente
 tempestate nauis
 cum omnibus
 preter ipsum solum
 in eadem contentis
 iuxta Pentapolim
 periclitabatur.

And scheweth, as I schal reherse,
 How sche was to this lord diverse,
 The which upon the See sche ferketh.
 The wynd aros, the weder derketh,
 It blew and made such tempeste,
 Non anchor mai the schip areste,
 Which hath tobroken al his gere;
 The Schipmen stode in such a feere,
 Was non that myhte himself bestere,
 610 Bot evere awaite upon the lere,
 Whan that thei scholde drenche at ones.
 Ther was ynowh withinne wones
 Of wepinge and of sorghe tho;
 This yonge king makth mochel wo
 So forto se the Schip travaile:
 Bot al that myhte him noght availe;
 The mast tobrak, the Seil torof,
 The Schip upon the wawes drof,
 Til that thei sihe a londes cooste.
 620 Tho made avou the leste and moste, [1523](#)
 Be so thei myhten come alonde;
 Bot he which hath the See on honde,
 Neptunus, wolde noght acorde,
 Bot altobroke cable and corde, [1524](#)
 Er thei to londe myhte aproche,
 The Schip toclef upon a roche,
 And al goth doun into the depe.
 Bot he that alle thing mai kepe
 Unto this lord was merciablen,
 630 And broghte him sauf upon a table,
 Which to the lond him hath upbore;
 The remenant was al forlore,
 Wherof he made mochel mone. [1525](#)

Thus was this yonge lord him one,
 Al naked in a povere plit: [1526](#)
 His colour, which whilom was whyt, [1527](#)

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 296

Qualiter Appolinus
 nudus super litus
 iactabatur, vbi
 quidam piscator
 ipsum suo collobio

Was thanne of water fade and pale,
 And ek he was so sore acale
 That he wiste of himself no bote,
 640 It halp him nothing forto mote
 To gete ayein that he hath lore.
 Bot sche which hath his deth forbore,
 Fortune, thogh sche wol noght yelpe,
 Al sodeinly hath sent him helpe,
 Whanne him thoghte alle grace aweie;
 Ther cam a Fisshere in the weie,
 And sih a man ther naked stonde,
 And whan that he hath understonde
 The cause, he hath of him gret routhe,
 650 And onliche of his povere trouthe
 Of suche clothes as he hadde
 With gret Pite this lord he cladde.
 And he him thonketh as he scholde,
 And seith him that it schal be yolde,
 If evere he gete his stat ayein,
 And preide that he wolde him sein
 If nyh were eny toun for him.
 He seide, 'Yee, Pentapolim,
 Wher bothe king and queene duellen.'
 660 Whanne he this tale herde tellen,
 He gladeth him and gan beseche
 That he the weie him wolde teche:
 And he him taghte; and forth he wente
 And preide god with good entente
 To sende him joie after his sorwe.

It was noght passed yit Midmorwe,
 Whan thiderward his weie he nam, [1528](#)
 Wher sone upon the Non he cam.
 He eet such as he myhte gete,
 670 And forth anon, whan he hadde ete,
 He goth to se the toun aboute,
 And cam ther as he fond a route
 Of yonge lusti men withalle;

vestiens ad urbem
 Pentapolim direxit.

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 297

Qualiter Appolino
 Pentapolim
 adueniente ludus
 Gignasii per urbem
 publice
 proclamatus est.

And as it scholde tho befall,
That day was set of such assisse,
That thei scholde in the londes guise,
As he herde of the poeple seie, [1529](#)
Here comun game thanne pleie;
And crid was that thei scholden come
680 Unto the gamen alle and some [1530](#)
Of hem that ben delivere and wyhte,
To do such maistrie as thei myhte.
Thei made hem naked as thei scholde,
For so that ilke game wolde,
As it was tho custume and us, [1531](#)
Amonges hem was no refus:
The flour of al the toun was there
And of the court also ther were,
And that was in a large place
690 Riht evene afore the kinges face,
Which Artestrathes thanne hihte.
The pley was pleid riht in his sihte,
And who most worthi was of dede
Receive he scholde a certain mede
And in the cite bere a pris.

Appolinus, which war and wys
Of every game couthe an ende,
He thoghte assaie, hou so it wende,
And fell among hem into game:
700 And there he wan him such a name,
So as the king himself acompteth
That he alle othre men surmonteth,
And bar the pris above hem alle.
The king bad that into his halle
At Souper time he schal be broght; [1533](#)
And he cam thanne and lefte it noght,
Withoute compaignie al one:
Was non so semlich of persone,
Of visage and of limes bothe,
710 If that he hadde what to clothe.

Qualiter Appolinus
ludum gignasii
vincens in
aulam [1532](#) Regis ad
cenam honorifice
receptus est.

At Souper time natheles
 The king amiddes al the pres
 Let clepe him up among hem alle,
 And bad his Mareschall of halle [1534](#)
 To setten him in such degre
 That he upon him myhte se.
 The king was sone set and served,
 And he, which hath his pris deserved [1535](#)
 After the kinges oghne word,
 720 Was mad beginne a Middel bord,
 That bothe king and queene him sihe.
 He sat and caste aboute his yhe
 And sih the lordes in astat,
 And with himself wax in debat
 Thenkende what he hadde lore,
 And such a sorwe he tok therfore,
 That he sat evere stille and thoghte,
 As he which of no mete roghte.
 The king behield his hevynesse,
 730 And of his grete gentillesse
 His doghter, which was fair and good
 And ate bord before him stod,
 As it was thilke time usage,
 He bad to gon on his message
 And fonde forto make him glad.
 And sche dede as hire fader bad,
 And goth to him the softe pas
 And axeth whenne and what he was,
 And preith he scholde his thoghtes leve.
 740 He seith, 'Ma Dame, be your leve
 Mi name is hote Appolinus,
 And of mi richesse it is thus,
 Upon the See I have it lore.
 The contre wher as I was bore,
 Wher that my lond is and mi rente,
 I lefte at Tyr, whan that I wente:
 The worschipe of this worldes aghte, [1537](#)

Qualiter Appolinus
 in cena recumbens
 nichil comedit, set
 doloroso vultu,
 submisso capite,
 ingemiscebat; [1536](#)
 qui tandem a filia
 Regis confortatus
 cytharam plectens
 cunctis audientibus
 citharisando
 vlttramodum
 complacuit.

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300

Unto the god ther I betaghte.'¹⁵³⁸
 And thus togedre as thei tuo speeke,
 750 The teres runne be his cheeke.
 The king, which therof tok good kepe,
 Hath gret Pite to sen him wepe,
 And for his doghter sende ayein,
 And preide hir faire and gan to sein
 That sche no lengere wolde drecche,
 Bot that sche wolde anon forth fecche
 Hire harpe and don al that sche can
 To glade with that sory man.
 760 And sche to don hir fader heste
 Hir harpe fette, and in the feste
 Upon a Chaier which thei fette
 Hirsself next to this man sche sette:
 With harpe bothe and ek with mouthe
 To him sche dede al that sche couthe
 To make him chiere, and evere he siketh,
 And sche him axeth hou him liketh.
 'Ma dame, certes wel,' he seide,
 'Bot if ye the mesure pleide
 Which, if you list, I schal you liere,
 770 It were a glad thing forto hiere.'
 'Ha, lieve sire,' tho quod sche,
 'Now tak the harpe and let me se'¹⁵³⁹
 Of what mesure that ye mene.'
 Tho preith the king, tho preith the queene,
 Forth with the lordes alle arewe,
 That he som merthe wolde schewe;
 He takth the Harpe and in his wise
 He tempreth, and of such assise
 Singende he harpeth forth withal,
 780 That as a vois celestial
 Hem thoghte it souneth in here Ere,
 As thogh that he an Angel were.'¹⁵⁴⁰
 Thei gladen of his melodie,
 Bot most of all the compainie

- The kinges doghter, which it herde,
 And thoghte ek hou that he ansuerde, [1541](#)
 Whan that he was of hire opposed, [1542](#)
 Withinne hir herte hath wel supposed
 That he is of gret gentillesse.
- 790 Hise dedes ben therof witnesse
 Forth with the wisdom of his lore;
 It nedeth noght to seche more,
 He myhte noght have such manere,
 Of gentil blod bot if he were.
 Whanne he hath harped al his fille,
 The kinges heste to fulfille,
 Away goth dissh, away goth cuppe,
 Doun goth the bord, the cloth was uppe,
 Thei risen and gon out of halle.
- 800 The king his chamberlein let calle,
 And bad that he be alle weie
 A chambre for this man pourveie,
 Which nyh his oghne chambre be.
 ‘It schal be do, mi lord,’ quod he.
 Appolinus of whom I mene
 Tho tok his leve of king and queene
 And of the worthi Maide also,
 Which preide unto hir fader tho,
 That sche myhte of that yonge man [1543](#)
- 810 Of tho sciences whiche he can
 His lore have; and in this wise
 The king hir granteth his aprise,
 So that himself therto assente.
 Thus was acorded er thei wente,
 That he with al that evere he may
 This yonge faire freisshe May
 Of that he couthe scholde enforme, [1544](#)
 And full assented in this forme
 Thei token leve as for that nyht.
- 820 And whanne it was amorwe lyht,
 Unto this yonge man of Tyr

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302

Qualiter Appolinus
cum Rege pro filia
sua erudienda
retentus est.

Qualiter filia Regis
Appolinum ornato

Of clothes and of good atir
 With gold and Selver to despende
 This worthi yonge lady sende:
 And thus sche made him wel at ese,
 And he with al that he can plese
 Hire serveth wel and faire ayein. [1545](#)
 He tawhte hir til sche was certein
 Of Harpe, of Citole and of Rote, [1546](#)
 830 With many a tun and many a note [1547](#)
 Upon Musique, upon mesure,
 And of hire Harpe the temprure
 He tawhte hire ek, as he wel couthe.
 Bot as men sein that frele is youthe,
 With leisir and continuance
 This Mayde fell upon a chance,
 That love hath mad him a querele
 Ayein hire youthe freissh and frele,
 That malgre wher sche wole or noght, [1548](#)
 840 Sche mot with al hire hertes thoght
 To love and to his lawe obeie;
 And that sche schal ful sore abeie.
 For sche wot nevere what it is,
 Bot evere among sche fieleth this: [1549](#)
 Thenkende upon this man of Tyr,
 Hire herte is hot as eny fyr,
 And otherwhile it is acale;
 Now is sche red, nou is sche pale
 Riht after the condicion
 850 Of hire ymaginacion;
 Bot evere among hire thoghtes alle,
 Sche thoghte, what so mai befalle, [1550](#)
 Or that sche lawhe, or that sche wepe,
 Sche wolde hire goode name kepe
 For feere of wommanysshe schame.
 Bot what in earnest and in game, [1551](#)
 Sche stant for love in such a plit,

apparatu vestiri
 fecit, et ipse ad
 puelle doctrinam in
 quampluribus
 familiariter
 intendebat: vnde
 placata puella in
 amorem Appolini
 exardescens
 infirmabatur.

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 303

P. iii.
 304

That sche hath lost al appetit
Of mete, of drinke, of nyhtes reste, [1552](#)
860 As sche that not what is the beste; [1553](#)
Bot forto thenken al hir fille
Sche hield hire ofte times stille
Withinne hir chambre, and goth noght oute:
The king was of hire lif in doute,
Which wiste nothing what it mente.

Bot fell a time, as he out wente
To walke, of Princes Sones thre
Ther come and felle to his kne;
And ech of hem in sondri wise
870 Besoghte and profreth his servise,
So that he myhte his doghter have.
The king, which wolde his honour save, [1554](#)
Seith sche is siek, and of that speche
Tho was no time to beseche;
Bot ech of hem do make a bille [1555](#)
He bad, and wryte his oghne wille,
His name, his fader and his good;
And whan sche wiste hou that it stod,
And hadde here billes oversein,

880 Thei scholden have ansuere ayein.
Of this conseil thei weren glad,
And writen as the king hem bad,
And every man his oghne bok
Into the kinges hond betok,
And he it to his dowhter sende,
And preide hir forto make an ende
And wryte ayein hire oghne hond,
Riht as sche in hire herte fond.

The billes weren wel received,
890 Bot sche hath alle here loves weyved,
And thoghte tho was time and space
To put hire in hir fader grace, [1556](#)
And wrot ayein and thus sche saide:

Qualiter tres filii
Principum filiam
Regis singillatim in
vxorem suis
supplicacionibus
postularunt.

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305

Qualiter filia Regis
omnibus aliis
relictis Appolinum
in maritum
preelegit.

'The schame which is in a Maide
 With speche dar noght ben unloke,
 Bot in writinge it mai be spoke;
 So wryte I to you, fader, thus:
 Bot if I have Appolinus,
 Of al this world, what so betyde,
 900 I wol non other man abide.
 And certes if I of him faile,
 I wot riht wel withoute faile
 Ye schull for me be dowhterles.'
 This lettre cam, and ther was press
 Tofore the king, ther as he stod;
 And whan that he it understod,
 He yaf hem ansuer by and by,
 Bot that was do so prively,
 That non of othres conseil wiste.
 910 Thei toke her leve, and wher hem liste
 Thei wente forth upon here weie.
 The king ne wolde noght bewreie
 The conseil for no maner hihe,
 Bot soffreth til he time sihe:
 And whan that he to chambre is come,
 He hath unto his conseil nome
 This man of Tyr, and let him se
 The lettre and al the privete,
 The which his dowhter to him sente:
 920 And he his kne to grounde bente
 And thonketh him and hire also,
 And er thei wenten thanne atuo,
 With good herte and with good corage
 Of full Love and full mariage
 The king and he ben hol acorded.
 And after, whanne it was recorded
 Unto the dowhter hou it stod,
 The yifte of al this worldes good¹⁵⁵⁷
 Ne scholde have mad hir half so blythe:
 930 And forth withal the king als swithe,

Qualiter Rex et
 Regina in
 maritagium filie
 sue cum Appolino
 consencierunt.

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 306

For he wol have hire good assent,
 Hath for the queene hir moder sent.
 The queene is come, and whan sche herde
 Of this matiere hou that it ferde,
 Sche syh debat, sche syh desese,
 Bot if sche wolde hir dowhter plese,
 And is therto assented full.
 Which is a dede wonderfull,
 For noman knew the sothe cas
 940 Bot he himself, what man he was;
 And natheles, so as hem thoghte,
 Hise dedes to the sothe wroghte
 That he was come of gentil blod:
 Him lacketh noght bot worldes good,
 And as therof is no despeir,
 For sche schal ben hire fader heir,[1558](#)
 And he was able to governe.
 Thus wol thei noght the love werne
 Of him and hire in none wise,
 950 Bot ther acorded thei devise[1559](#)
 The day and time of Mariage.
 Wher love is lord of the corage,
 Him thenketh longe er that he spede;
 Bot ate laste unto the dede
 The time is come, and in her wise
 With gret offrende and sacrificise
 Thei wedde and make a riche feste,
 And every thing which was honeste[1560](#)
 Withinnen house and ek withoute
 960 It was so don, that al aboute
 Of gret worschipe, of gret noblesse[1561](#)
 Ther cride many a man largesse[1562](#)
 Unto the lordes hihe and loude;
 The knyhtes that ben yonge and proude,
 Thei jouste ferst and after daunce.
 The day is go, the nyhtes chaunce

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Qualiter Appolinus
 filie Regis nupsit,
 et prima nocte cum
 ea concubiens
 ipsam impregnauit.

Hath derked al the bryhte Sonne;
 This lord, which hath his love wonne,
 Is go to bedde with his wif,
 970 Wher as thei ladde a lusti lif, [1563](#)
 And that was after somdel sene,
 For as thei pleiden hem betwene,
 Thei gete a child between hem tuo,
 To whom fell after mochel wo.

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Now have I told of the spousailes. [1564](#)
 Bot forto speke of the mervailles
 Whiche afterward to hem befelle,
 It is a wonder forto telle.
 It fell adai thei riden oute, [1565](#)

Qualiter
 Ambaciatores a
 Tyro in quadam
 nauí Pentapolim
 venientes mortem
 Regis Antiochi
 Appolino
 nunciarunt.

980 The king and queene and al the route,
 To pleien hem upon the stronde,
 Wher as thei sen toward the londe
 A Schip sailende of gret array.
 To knowe what it mene may,
 Til it be come thei abide;
 Than sen thei stonde on every side,
 Endlong the schipes bord to schewe,
 Of Penonceals a riche rewe.
 Thei axen when the schip is come:

990 Fro Tyr, anon ansuerde some,
 And over this thei seiden more
 The cause why thei comen fore
 Was forto seche and forto finde
 Appolinus, which was of kinde [1566](#)
 Her liege lord: and he appiereth,
 And of the tale which he hiereth
 He was riht glad; for thei him tolde,
 That for vengeance, as god it wolde,
 Antiochus, as men mai wite,

1000 With thondre and lythnyng is forsmite, [1567](#)
 His doghter hath the same chaunce,
 So be thei bothe in o balance.

‘Forthi, oure liege lord, we seie
In name of al the lond, and preie,
That left al other thing to done,
It like you to come sone
And se youre oghne liege men
With othre that ben of youre ken,
That live in longinge and desir¹⁵⁶⁸
1010Til ye be come ayein to Tyr.’
This tale after the king it hadde
Pentapolim al overspradde,
Ther was no joie forto seche;
For every man it hadde in speche
And seiden alle of on acord,
‘A worthi king schal ben oure lord:
That thoghte ous ferst an hevinesse
Is schape ous now to gret gladnesse.’
Thus goth the tidinge overal.

1020 Bot nede he mot, that nede schal:
Appolinus his leve tok,
To god and al the lond betok
With al the poeple long and brod,
That he no lenger there abod.¹⁵⁶⁹
The king and queene sorwe made,
Bot yit somdiel thei weren glade
Of such thing as thei herden tho:
And thus between the wel and wo
To schip he goth, his wif with childe,
1030The which was evere meke and mylde
And wolde noght departe him fro,
Such love was between hem tuo.
Lichorida for hire office
Was take, which was a Norrice,
To wende with this yonge wif,
To whom was schape a woful lif.
Withinne a time, as it betidde,
Whan thei were in the See amidde,
Out of the North they sihe a cloude;

Qualiter Appolino
cum vxore sua
impregnata a
Pentapoli versus
Tyrum
nauigantibus,
contigit vxorem,
mortis articulo
angustiatam, in
nauis filiam, que
postea Thaisis
vocabatur, parere.

1040 The storm aros, the wyndes loude
 Thei blewen many a dredful blast,
 The welkne was al overcast,
 The derke nyht the Sonne hath under,
 Ther was a gret tempeste of thunder:
 The Mone and ek the Sterres bothe
 In blake cloudes thei hem clothe,
 Wherof here brihte lok thei hyde. [1570](#)
 This yonge ladi wepte and cride,
 To whom no confort myhte availe;
 1050 Of childe sche began travaile,
 Wher sche lay in a Caban clos:
 Hire woful lord fro hire aros,
 And that was longe er eny morwe,
 So that in anguisse and in sorwe
 Sche was delivered al be nyhte
 And ded in every mannes syhte; [1571](#)
 Bot natheles for al this wo
 A maide child was bore tho.
 Appolinus whan he this knew,
 1060 For sorwe a swoone he overthrew, [1572](#)
 That noman wiste in him no lif.
 And whanne he wok, he seide, ‘Ha, wif,
 Mi lust, mi joie, my desir, [1573](#)
 Mi welthe and my recoverir,
 Why schal I live, and thou schalt dye?
 Ha, thou fortune, I thee deffie,
 Nou hast thou do to me thi werste.
 Ha, herte, why ne wolt thou berste,
 That forth with hire I myhte passe? [1574](#)
 1070 Mi peines weren wel the lasse.’
 In such wepinge and in such cry
 His dede wif, which lay him by,
 A thousand sithes he hire kiste;
 Was nevere man that sih ne wiste
 A sorwe unto his sorwe lich;

Qualiter Appolinus
 vxoris sue mortem
 planxit.

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For evere among upon the lich¹⁵⁷⁵
 He fell swounende, as he that soghte
 His oghne deth, which he besoghte
 Unto the goddes alle above
 1080 With many a pitous word of love;
 Bot suche wordes as tho were
 Yit herde nevere mannes Ere,
 Bot only thilke whiche he seide.
 The Maister Schipman cam and preide
 With othre suche as be therinne,
 And sein that he mai nothing winne
 Ayein the deth, bot thei him rede,
 He be wel war and tak hiede,
 The See be weie of his nature
 1090 Receive mai no creature
 Withinne himself as forto holde,
 The which is ded: forthi thei wolde,
 As thei conseilen al aboute,
 The dede body casten oute.
 For betre it is, thei seiden alle,
 That it of hire so befallle,
 Than if thei scholden alle spille.
 The king, which understod here wille¹⁵⁷⁶
 And knew here conseil that was trewe,
 1100 Began ayein his sorwe newe
 With pitous herte, and thus to seie:
 'It is al reson that ye preie.
 I am,' quod he, 'bot on al one,
 So wolde I noght for mi persone
 Ther felle such adversite.
 Bot whan it mai no betre be,
 Doth thanne thus upon my word,¹⁵⁷⁹
 Let make a cofre strong of bord,
 That it be ferm with led and pich.'
 1110 Anon was mad a cofre sich,¹⁵⁸⁰
 Al redy broght unto his hond;
 And whanne he sih and redy fond

P. iii.
 312

Qualiter
 suadentibus nautis
 corpus vxoris sue
 mortue in quadam
 Cista plumbo et
 ferro obtusa¹⁵⁷⁷
 que circumligata
 Appolinus cum
 magno thesauro
 vna cum quadam
 littera sub eius
 capite scripta
 recludi et in
 mare¹⁵⁷⁸ proici
 fecit.

This cofre mad and wel enclowed,
 The dede bodi was besowed
 In cloth of gold and leid therinne.
 And for he wolde unto hire winne
 Upon som cooste a Sepulture,
 Under hire heved in aventure
 Of gold he leide Sommes grete
 1120 And of jeueals a strong beyete¹⁵⁸¹
 Forth with a lettre, and seide thus:
 'I, king of Tyr Appollinus,
 Do alle maner men to wite,
 That hiere and se this lettre write,
 That helpeles withoute red
 Hier lith a kinges doghter ded:
 And who that happeth hir to finde,
 For charite tak in his mynde,¹⁵⁸²
 And do so that sche be begrave
 1130 With this tresor, which he schal have.'
 Thus whan the lettre was full spoke,¹⁵⁸³
 Thei haue anon the cofre stoke,
 And bounden it with yren faste,
 That it may with the wawes laste,
 And stoppen it be such a weie,
 That it schal be withinne dreie,
 So that no water myhte it grieve.
 And thus in hope and good believe
 Of that the corps schal wel aryve,
 1140 Thei caste it over bord als blyve.
 The Schip forth on the wawes wente;
 The prince hath changed his entente,¹⁵⁸⁴
 And seith he wol noght come at Tyr
 As thanne, bot al his desir
 Is ferst to seilen unto Tharse.
 The wyndy Storm began to skarse,
 The Sonne arist, the weder cliereth,
 The Schipman which behinde stiereth,
 Whan that he sih the wyndes saghte,

Copia littere
 Appolini capiti
 vxoris sue
 supposite.

P. iii.
313

Qualiter
 Appolinus, vxoris
 sue corpore in
 mare proiecto,
 Tyrum relinquens
 cursum suum
 versus Tharsim
 nauigio dolens
 arripuit.

1150 Towardes Tharse his cours he straghte.

Bot now to mi matiere ayein,
To telle as olde bokes sein,
This dede corps of which ye knowe
With wynd and water was forthrowe
Now hier, now ther, til ate laste
At Ephesim the See upcaste
The cofre and al that was therinne.
Of gret merveile now beginne
Mai hiere who that sitteth stille;
That god wol save mai noght spille.
Riht as the corps was throwe alonde,
Ther cam walkende upon the stronde

Qualiter corpus
predicte defuncte
super litus apud
Ephesim quidam
medicus nomine
Cerymon cum
aliquibus suis
discipulis inuenit;
quod in hospicium
suum¹⁵⁸⁵ portans
et extra cistam
ponens, spiraculo
vite in ea adhuc
inuento, ipsam
plene sanitati
restituit.

1160 A worthi clerc, a Surgien,
And ek a gret Phisicien,
Of al that lond the wisest on,
Which hihte Maister Cerymon;
Ther were of his disciples some.
This Maister to the Cofre is come,¹⁵⁸⁶
He peiseth ther was somewhat in,

P. iii.
314

1170 And bad hem bere it to his In,
And goth himselve forth withal.
Al that schal falle, falle schal;
They comen hom and tarie noght;
This Cofre is into chambre broght,
Which that thei finde faste stoke,
Bot thei with craft it have unloke.
Thei loken in, where as thei founde
A bodi ded, which was bewounde¹⁵⁸⁷
In cloth of gold, as I seide er,

1180 The tresor ek thei founden ther
Forth with the lettre, which thei rede.
And tho thei token betre hiede;
Unsowed was the bodi sone,
And he, which knew what is to done,¹⁵⁸⁸
This noble clerk, with alle haste
Began the veines forto taste,

P. iii.
315

And sih hire Age was of youthe,
 And with the craftes whiche he couthe
 He soghte and fond a signe of lif.
 1190 With that this worthi kinges wif
 Honestely thei token oute,
 And maden fyres al aboute;
 Thei leide hire on a couche softe,
 And with a scheete warmed ofte
 Hire colde brest began to hete,
 Hire herte also to flacke and bete.
 This Maister hath hire every joingt
 With certein oile and balsme enoingt,
 And putte a liquour in hire mouth,
 1200 Which is to fewe clerkes couth,
 So that sche coevereth ate laste:
 And ferst hire yhen up sche caste,
 And whan sche more of strengthe cawhte,
 Hire Armes bothe forth sche strawhte,
 Hield up hire hond and pitously
 Sche spak and seide, 'Ha, wher am I? [1589](#)
 Where is my lord, what world is this?'
 As sche that wot noght hou it is.
 Bot Cerymon the worthi leche
 1210 Ansuerde anon upon hire speche
 And seith, 'Ma dame, yee ben hiere,
 Where yee be sauf, as yee schal hiere
 Hierafterward; forthi as nou
 Mi conseil is, conforteth you:
 For trusteth wel withoute faile,
 Ther is nothing which schal you faile,
 That oghte of reson to be do.'
 Thus passen thei a day or tuo;
 Thei speke of noght as for an ende,
 1220 Til sche began somdiel amende,
 And wiste hireselven what sche mente.
 Tho forto knowe hire hol entente, [1590](#)
 This Maister axeth al the cas,

P. iii.
 316

Qualiter vxor
 Appolini sanata
 domum religionis

Hou sche cam there and what sche was.
'Hou I cam hiere wot I noght,'
Quod sche, 'bot wel I am bethoght
Of othre thinges al aboute':
Fro point to point and tolde him oute
Als ferforthli as sche it wiste.

peciit, vbi
sacro¹⁵⁹¹ velamine
munita castam
omni tempore se
vouit.

1230 And he hire tolde hou in a kiste
The See hire threw upon the lond,
And what tresor with hire he fond,
Which was al redy at hire wille,
As he that schop him to fulfille
With al his myht what thing he scholde.
Sche thonketh him that he so wolde,
And al hire herte sche discloseth,
And seith him wel that sche supposeth
Hire lord be dreint, hir child also;

1240 So sih sche noght bot alle wo.¹⁵⁹²
Wherof as to the world nomore
Ne wol sche torne, and preith therfore
That in som temple of the Cite,
To kepe and holde hir chastete,
Sche mihte among the wommen duelle.
Whan he this tale hir herde telle,
He was riht glad, and made hire knowen
That he a dowhter of his owen
Hath, which he wol unto hir yive

P. iii.
317

1250 To serve, whil thei bothe live,
In stede of that which sche hath lost;
Al only at his oghne cost¹⁵⁹³
Sche schal be rendred forth with hire.¹⁵⁹⁴
She seith, 'Grant mercy, lieve sire,
God quite it you, ther I ne may.'
And thus thei drive forth the day,
Til time com that sche was hol;
And tho thei take her conseil hol,¹⁵⁹⁵
To schape upon good ordinance

1260 And make a worthi pourveance¹⁵⁹⁶
Ayein the day whan thei be veiled.
And thus, whan that thei be conseiled,
In blake clothes thei hem clothe,
This lady and the dowhter bothe,
And yolde hem to religion.
The feste and the profession
After the reule of that degre
Was mad with gret solempnete,
Where as Diane is seintefied;

1270 Thus stant this lady justefied
In ordre wher sche thenkth to duelle.
Bot now ayeinward forto telle
In what plit that hire lord stod inne:
He seileth, til that he may winne¹⁵⁹⁷
The havene of Tharse, as I seide er;
And whanne he was aryved ther,
And it was thurgh the Cite knowe,¹⁵⁹⁸
Men myhte se withinne a throwe,
As who seith, al the toun at ones,
That come ayein him for the nones,

1280 To yiven him the reverence,
So glad thei were of his presence:
And thogh he were in his corage
Desesed, yit with glad visage
He made hem chiere, and to his In,
Wher he whilom sojourned in,
He goth him straght and was resceived.
And whan the presse of poeple is weived,
He takth his hoste unto him tho,

1290 And seith, 'Mi frend Strangulio,
Lo, thus and thus it is befaller,
And thou thiself art on of alle,
Forth with thi wif, whiche I most triste.¹⁵⁹⁹
Forthi, if it you bothe liste,
My doghter Thaise be youre leve
I thenke schal with you beleve

Qualiter Appolinus
Tharsim nauigans,
filiam suam
Thaisim
Strangulioni et
Dionisie vxori sue
educandam
commendauit; et
deinde Tyrum adiit,
vbi cum
inestimabili gaudio
a suis receptus est.

P. iii.
318

As for a time; and thus I preie,
 That sche be kept be alle weie,
 And whan sche hath of age more,
 1300 That sche be set to bokes lore.
 And this avou to god I make,
 That I schal nevere for hir sake
 Mi berd for no likinge schave,
 Til it befalle that I have
 In covenable time of age
 Beset hire unto mariage.'
 Thus thei acorde, and al is wel,
 And forto resten him somdel,
 As for a while he ther sojorneth,
 1310 And thanne he takth his leve and torneth
 To Schipe, and goth him hom to Tyr,
 Wher every man with gret desir
 Awaiteth upon his comynge.
 Bot whan the Schip com in seilinge,
 And thei perceiven it is he, [1600](#)
 Was nevere yit in no cite
 Such joie mad as thei tho made;
 His herte also began to glade
 Of that he sih the poeple glad. [1601](#)
 1320 Lo, thus fortune his hap hath lad;
 In sondri wise he was travailed,
 Bot hou so evere he be assailed,
 His latere ende schal be good.
 And forto speke hou that it stod
 Of Thaise his doghter, wher sche duelleth,
 In Tharse, as the Cronique telleth,
 Sche was wel kept, sche was wel loked,
 Sche was wel tawht, sche was wel boked,
 So wel sche spedde hir in hire youthe
 1330 That sche of every wisdom couthe,
 That forto seche in every lond
 So wys an other noman fond,
 Ne so wel tawht at mannes yhe.

P. iii.
 319

Qualiter Thaysis
 vna cum
 Philotenna
 Strangulionis et
 Dionisie filia
 omnis sciencie et
 honestatis doctrina
 imbuta est: set
 Thaisis
 Philotennam
 precellens in
 odium mortale per
 inuidiam a

Bot wo worthe evere fals envie!¹⁶⁰²
 For it befell that time so,
 A dowhter hath Strangulio,
 The which was cleped Philotenne:
 Bot fame, which wole evere renne,
 Cam al day to hir moder Ere,
 1340 And seith, wher evere hir doghter were
 With Thayse set in eny place,
 The comun vois, the comun grace
 Was al upon that other Maide,
 And of hir doghter noman saide.
 Who wroth but Dionise thanne?
 Hire thoghte a thousand yer til whanne
 Sche myhte ben of Thaise wreke
 Of that sche herde folk so speke.
 And fell that ilke same tyde,
 1350 That ded was trewe Lychoride,
 Which hadde be servant to Thaise,
 So that sche was the worse at aise,
 For sche hath thanne no servise
 Bot only thurgh this Dionise,
 Which was hire dedlich Anemie
 Thurgh pure treson and envie.
 Sche, that of alle sorwe can,
 Tho spak unto hire bondeman,
 Which cleped was Theophilus,
 1360 And made him swere in conseil thus,
 That he such time as sche him sette
 Schal come Thaise forto fette,
 And lede hire oute of alle sihte,
 Wher as noman hire helpe myhte,¹⁶⁰³
 Upon the Stronde nyh the See,
 And there he schal this maiden sle.
 This cherles herte is in a traunce,
 As he which drad him of vengeance
 Whan time comth an other day;
 1370 Bot yit dorste he noght seie nay,

Dionisia recollecta
est.

P. iii.
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P. iii.
321

Bot swor and seide he schal fulfille¹⁶⁰⁴
Hire hestes at hire oghne wille.

The treson and the time is schape,
So fell it that this cherles knape¹⁶⁰⁶
Hath lad this maiden ther he wolde¹⁶⁰⁷
Upon the Stronde, and what sche scholde
Sche was adrad; and he out breide
A rusti swerd and to hir seide,
'Thou schalt be ded.' 'Helas!' quod sche,
1380 'Why schal I so?' 'Lo thus,' quod he,
'Mi ladi Dionise hath bede,
Thou schalt be moerdred in this stede.'
This Maiden tho for feere schryhte,
And for the love of god almyhte
Sche preith that for a litel stounde
Sche myhte knele upon the grounde,
Toward the hevene forto crave,
Hire wofull Soule if sche mai save.¹⁶¹⁰

And with this noise and with this cry,¹⁶¹¹
1390 Out of a barge faste by,
Which hidd was ther on Scomerfare,
Men sterten out and weren ware
Of this feloun, and he to go,
And sche began to crie tho,
'Ha, mercy, help for goddes sake!
Into the barge thei hire take,
As thieves scholde, and forth thei wente.
Upon the See the wynd hem hente,
And malgre wher thei wolde or non,¹⁶¹²

1400 To for the weder forth thei gon,
Ther halp no Seil, ther halp non Ore,
Forstormed and forblowen sore
In gret peril so forth thei dryve,
Til ate laste thei aryve
At Mitelene the Cite.
In havene sauf and whan thei be,

Qualiter Dionisia
Thaysim, vt
occideretur,¹⁶⁰⁵
Theophilo seruo
suo tradidit, qui
cum noctanter
longius ab vrbe
ipsam prope litus
maris interficere
proposuerat, Pirate
ibidem prope¹⁶⁰⁸
latitantes Thaisim
de manu Carnificis
eripuerunt,
ipsamque vsque
Ciuitatem
Mitelenam
ducentes, cuidam
Leonino scortorum
ibidem magistro
vendiderunt.¹⁶⁰⁹

The Maister Schipman made him boun,
 And goth him out into the toun,
 And profreth Thaise forto selle.
 1410 On Leonin it herde telle,
 Which Maister of the bordel was,
 And bad him gon a redy pas
 To fetten hire, and forth he wente, [1613](#)
 And Thaise out of his barge he hente,
 And to this bordeller hir solde. [1614](#)
 And he, that be hire body wolde [1615](#)
 Take advantage, let do crye,
 That what man wolde his lecherie
 Attempte upon hire maidenhede,
 1420 Lei doun the gold and he schal spede.
 And thus whan he hath crid it oute
 In syhte of al the poeple aboute,
 He ladde hire to the bordel tho. [1616](#)
 No wonder is thogh sche be wo: [1617](#)
 Clos in a chambre be hireselve,
 Ech after other ten or tuelle
 Of yonge men to hire in wente;
 Bot such a grace god hire sente,
 That for the sorwe which sche made
 1430 Was non of hem which pouer hade
 To don hire eny vileinie.
 This Leonin let evere asprie,
 And waiteth after gret beyete;
 Bot al for noght, sche was forlete,
 That mo men wolde ther noght come. [1618](#)
 Whan he therof hath hiede nome,
 And knew that sche was yit a maide,
 Unto his oghne man he saide,
 That he with strengthe ayein hire leve
 1440 Tho scholde hir maidenhod bereve.
 This man goth in, bot so it ferde,
 Whan he hire wofull pleintes herde

P. iii.
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Qualiter Leoninus
 Thaisim ad lupanar
 destinavit, vbi dei
 gracia preuenta
 ipsius virginitatem
 nullus violare
 potuit.

And he therof hath take kepe,
 Him liste betre forto wepe
 Than don oght elles to the game.
 And thus sche kepte hirsself fro schame,
 And kneleth doun to therthe and preide¹⁶¹⁹
 Unto this man, and thus sche seide:
 'If so be that thi maister wolde
 1450 That I his gold encresce scholde,¹⁶²⁰
 It mai noght falle be this weie:
 Bot soffre me to go mi weie
 Out of this hous wher I am inne,
 And I schal make him forto winne
 In som place elles of the toun,
 Be so it be religioun,¹⁶²¹
 Wher that honeste wommen duelle.
 And thus thou myht thi maister telle,
 That whanne I have a chambre there,
 1460 Let him do crie ay wyde where,
 What lord that hath his doghter diere,
 And is in will that sche schal liere
 Of such a Scole that is trewe,
 I schal hire teche of thinges newe,
 Which as non other womman can¹⁶²²
 In al this lond.' And tho this man
 Hire tale hath herd, he goth ayein,
 And tolde unto his maister plein
 That sche hath seid; and therupon,
 1470 Whan than he sih beyete non
 At the bordel be cause of hire,
 He bad his man to gon and spire
 A place wher sche myhte abyde,
 That he mai winne upon som side
 Be that sche can: bot ate leste
 Thus was sche sauf fro this tempeste.¹⁶²³
 He hath hire fro the bordel take,
 Bot that was noght for goddes sake,

P. iii.
 324

Qualiter Thais is a
 lupanari virgo
 liberata, inter

Bot for the lucre, as sche him tolde.
 1480 Now comen tho that comen wolde
 Of wommen in her lusty youthe,
 To hie and se what thing sche couthe:
 Sche can the wisdom of a clerk,
 Sche can of every lusti werk [1624](#)
 Which to a gentil womman longeth,
 And some of hem sche underfongeth
 To the Citole and to the Harpe,
 And whom it liketh forto carpe
 Proverbes and demandes slyhe,
 1490 An other such thei nevere syhe,
 Which that science so wel tawhte:
 Wherof sche grete yiftes cawhte,
 That sche to Leonin hath wonne;
 And thus hire name is so begonne
 Of sondri thinges that she techeth,
 That al the lond unto hir secheth
 Of yonge wommen forto liere.
 Nou lete we this maiden hie,
 And speke of Dionise ayein
 1500 And of Theophile the vilein, [1626](#)
 Of whiche I spak of nou tofore.
 Whan Thaise scholde have be forlore,
 This false cherl to his lady
 Whan he cam hom, al prively
 He seith, 'Ma Dame, slain I have [1627](#)
 This maide Thaise, and is begrave
 In prive place, as ye me biede.
 Forthi, ma dame, taketh hiede
 And kep conseil, hou so it stonde.' [1628](#)
 1510 This fend, which this hath understonde,
 Was glad, and weneth it be soth:
 Now herkne, hierafter hou sche doth. [1629](#)
 Sche wepeth, sche sorweth, sche compleigneth, [1630](#)
 And of sieknesse which sche feigneth

sacras mulieres
 hospiciū habens,
 sciencias quibus
 edocta fuit nobiles
 regni puellas
 ibidem edocebat.

P. iii.
 325

Qualiter
 Theophilus ad
 Dionisiam mane
 rediens affirmavit
 se Thaisim
 occidisse; super
 quo Dionisia vna
 cum Strangulione
 marito suo dolorem
 in publico
 confingentes, [1625](#)
 exequias et
 sepulturam
 honorifice
 quantum ad extra
 subdola
 coniectacione fieri
 constituerunt.

P. iii.
 326

Sche seith that Taise sodeinly
 Be nyhte is ded, 'as sche and I
 Togedre lyhen nyh my lord.'
 Sche was a womman of record,
 And al is lieved that sche seith;
 1520 And forto yive a more feith,
 Hire housebonde and ek sche bothe
 In blake clothes thei hem clothe,
 And made a gret enterrement; [1631](#)
 And for the poeple schal be blent,
 Of Thaise as for the remembrance,
 After the real olde usance
 A tumb of latoun noble and riche
 With an ymage unto hir liche
 Liggende above therupon
 1530 Thei made and sette it up anon.
 Hire Epitaffe of good assisse
 Was write aboute, and in this wise
 It spak: 'O yee that this beholde,
 Lo, hier lith sche, the which was holde [1632](#)
 The faireste and the flour of alle,
 Whos name Thaïsis men calle.
 The king of Tyr Appolinus
 Hire fader was: now lith sche thus.
 Fourtiene yer sche was of Age,
 1540 Whan deth hir tok to his viage.'
 Thus was this false treson hidd,
 Which afterward was wyde kidd,
 As be the tale a man schal hiere.
 Bot forto dare mi matiere, [1633](#)
 To Tyr I thenke torne ayein,
 And telle as the Croniqes sein.
 Whan that the king was comen hom,
 And hath left in the salte fom
 His wif, which he mai noght foryete,
 1550 For he som confort wolde gete,
 He let somoun a parlement,

Qualiter Appolinus
 in regno suo apud
 Tyrum existens
 parliamentum fieri
 constituit.

P. iii.
 327

To which the lordes were asent;
And of the time he hath ben oute,
He seth the thinges al aboute,
And told hem ek hou he hath fare, [1634](#)
Whil he was out of londe fare;
And preide hem alle to abyde,
For he wolde at the same tyde
Do schape for his wyves mynde,
1560As he that wol noght ben unkinde.
Solempne was that ilke office,
And riche was the sacrifice,
The feste reali was holde:
And therto was he wel beholde;
For such a wif as he hadde on
In thilke daies was ther non.

Whan this was do, thanne he him
thoghte
Upon his doghter, and besoghte
Suche of his lordes as he wolde,
1570That thei with him to Tharse scholde,
To fette his doghter Taise there:
And thei anon al redy were,
To schip they gon and forth thei wente,
Til thei the havene of Tharse hente.
They londe and faile of that thei seche
Be coverture and sleyhte of speche:
This false man Strangulio,
And Dionise his wif also,
That he the betre trowe myhte,
1580Thei ladden him to have a sihte
Wher that hir tombe was arraied.
The lasse yit he was mispaied,
And natheles, so as he dorste,
He curseth and seith al the worste
Unto fortune, as to the blinde,
Which can no seker weie finde;
For sche him neweth evere among,

Qualiter Appolinus
post parliamentum
Tharsim pro Thaise
filia sua querenda
adiit, qua ibidem
non inventa abinde
navigio recessit.

P. iii.
328

And medleth sorwe with his song.
 Bot sithe it mai no betre be,
 1590 He thonketh god and forth goth he¹⁶³⁶
 Seilende toward Tyr ayein.
 Bot sodeinly the wynd and reyn
 Begonne upon the See debate,
 So that he soffre mot algate
 The lawe which Neptune ordeigneth;
 Wherof fulofte time he pleigneth,
 And hield him wel the more esmaied
 Of that he hath tofore assaied.
 So that for pure sorwe and care,
 1600 Of that he seth his world so fare,
 The reste he lefte of his Caban,
 That for the conseil of noman
 Ayein therinne he nolde come,
 Bot hath benethe his place nome,
 Wher he wepende al one lay,
 Ther as he sih no lyht of day.
 And thus tofor the wynd thei dryve,
 Til longe and late thei aryve
 With gret distresce, as it was sene,
 1610 Upon this toun of Mitelene,
 Which was a noble cite tho.
 And hapneth thilke time so,
 The lordes bothe and the comune
 The hihe festes of Neptune
 Upon the stronde at the rivage,
 As it was custumme and usage,
 Sollempneliche thei besihe.
 Whan thei this strange vessel syhe
 Come in, and hath his Seil aualed,
 1620 The toun therof hath spoke and taled.
 The lord which of the cite was,¹⁶³⁷
 Whos name is Athenagoras,
 Was there, and seide he wolde se
 What Schip it is, and who thei be

Qualiter Nauis
 Appolini ventis
 agitata portum
 vrbis Mitelene in
 die quo festa
 Neptuni
 celebrare¹⁶³⁵
 consueuerunt
 applicuit; set ipse
 pre dolore Thaysis
 filie sue, quam
 mortuam reputabat,
 in fundo nauis
 obscuro iacens
 lumen videre
 noluit.

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Qualiter
 Athenagoras vrbis
 Mitelene Princeps,
 nauim Appollini
 inuestigans, ipsum
 sic contristatum
 nichilque
 respondentem

That ben therinne: and after sone,
 Whan that he sih it was to done,
 His barge was for him arraied,
 And he goth forth and hath assaied.
 He fond the Schip of gret Array,
 1630 Bot what thing it amonte may,
 He seth thei maden hevy chiere,
 Bot wel him thenkth be the manere
 That thei be worthi men of blod, [1638](#)
 And axeth of hem hou it stod;
 And thei him tellen al the cas,
 Hou that here lord fordrive was,
 And what a sorwe that he made, [1639](#)
 Of which ther mai noman him glade.
 He preith that he here lord mai se,
 1640 Bot thei him tolde it mai nocht be,
 For he lith in so derk a place, [1640](#)
 That ther may no wiht sen his face:
 Bot for al that, thogh hem be loth,
 He fond the ladre and doun he goth,
 And to him spak, bot non ansuere
 Ayein of him ne mihte he bere [1641](#)
 For oght that he can don or sein;
 And thus he goth him up ayein.
 Tho was ther spoke in many wise [1642](#)
 1650 Amonges hem that weren wise,
 Now this, now that, bot ate laste
 The wisdom of the toun this caste,
 That yonge Taise were asent.
 For if ther be amendement
 To glade with this woful king,
 Sche can so moche of every thing,
 That sche schal gladen him anon.
 A Messenger for hire is gon,
 And sche cam with hire Harpe on honde,
 1660 And seide hem that sche wolde fonde

consolari
 satagebat.

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Qualiter precepto
 Principis, vt
 Appolinum
 consolaretur,
 Thaisis cum cithara
 sua ad ipsum in
 obscuro nauis, vbi
 jacebat, producta
 est.

Be alle weies that sche can, [1643](#)
 To glade with this sory man.
 Bot what he was sche wiste noght,
 Bot al the Schip hire hath besoght
 That sche hire wit on him despende,
 In aunter if he myhte amende,
 And sein it schal be wel aquit.
 Whan sche hath understonden it,
 Sche goth hir doun, ther as he lay,
 1670Wher that sche harpeth many a lay
 And lich an Angel sang withal;
 Bot he nomore than the wal
 Tok hiede of eny thing he herde.
 And whan sche sih that he so ferde,
 Sche falleth with him into wordes,
 And telleth him of sondri bordes,
 And axeth him demandes strange,
 Wherof sche made his herte change,
 And to hire speche his Ere he leide
 1680And hath merveile of that sche seide.
 For in proverbe and in probleme
 Sche spak, and bad he scholde deme
 In many soubtil question: [1644](#)
 Bot he for no suggestioun
 Which toward him sche couthe stere,
 He wolde noght o word ansuere,
 Bot as a madd man ate laste [1645](#)
 His heved wepende away he caste,
 And half in wraththe he bad hire go.
 1690Bot yit sche wolde noght do so,
 And in the derke forth sche goth,
 Til sche him toucheth, and he wroth,
 And after hire with his hond
 He smot: and thus whan sche him fond
 Desesed, courtaisly sche saide,
 'Avoi, mi lord, I am a Maide;
 And if ye wiste what I am,

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And out of what lignage I cam,
 Ye wolde noght be so salvage.'
 1700 With that he sobreth his corage
 And put away his bevy chiere.
 Bot of hem tuo a man mai liere
 What is to be so sibb of blod:
 Non wiste of other hou it stod,
 And yit the fader ate laste
 His herte upon this maide caste,
 That he hire loveth kindely,
 And yit he wiste nevere why.
 Bot al was knowe er that thei wente;
 1710 For god, which wot here hol entente, [1646](#)
 Here hertes bothe anon descloseth.
 This king unto this maide opposeth,
 And axeth ferst what was hire name, [1647](#)
 And wher sche lerned al this game,
 And of what ken that sche was come. [1648](#)
 And sche, that hath hise wordes nome,
 Ansuerth and seith, 'My name is Thaise,
 That was som time wel at aise:
 In Tharse I was forthdrawe and fed,
 1720 Ther lerned I, til I was sped,
 Of that I can. Mi fader eke
 I not wher that I scholde him seke;
 He was a king, men tolde me:
 Mi Moder dreint was in the See.'
 Fro point to point al sche him tolde,
 That sche hath longe in herte holde,
 And nevere dorste make hir mone
 Bot only to this lord al one,
 To whom hire herte can noght hele,
 1730 Torne it to wo, torne it to wele,
 Torne it to good, torne it to harm.
 And he tho toke hire in his arm, [1649](#)
 Bot such a joie as he tho made
 Was nevere sen; thus be thei glade,

Qualiter, sicut deus
 destinavit, pater
 filiam inuentam
 recognovit.

That sory hadden be toforn.
Fro this day forth fortune hath sworn
To sette him upward on the whiel;
So goth the world, now wo, now wel:
This king hath founde newe grace,
1740 So that out of his derke place
He goth him up into the liht,
And with him cam that swete wiht,
His doghter Thaise, and forth anon
Thei bothe into the Caban gon
Which was ordeigned for the king,
And ther he dede of al his thing,
And was arraied realy.

And out he cam al openly,
Wher Athenagoras he fond,
1750 The which was lord of al the lond:[1650](#)
He preith the king to come and se
His castell bothe and his cite,
And thus thei gon forth alle in fiere,
This king, this lord, this maiden diere.[1651](#)
This lord tho made hem riche feste
With every thing which was honeste,[1652](#)
To plese with this worthi king,
Ther lacketh him no maner thing:
Bot yit for al his noble array

1760 Wifles he was into that day,
As he that yit was of yong Age;[1653](#)
So fell ther into his corage
The lusti wo, the glade peine
Of love, which noman restreigne
Yit nevere myhte as nou tofore.
This lord thenkth al his world forlore,
Bot if the king wol don him grace;
He waiteth time, he waiteth place,
Him thoghte his herte wol tobreke,
1770 Til he mai to this maide speke
And to hir fader ek also

Qualiter
Athenagoras
Appolinum de nauī
in hospiciū
honorifice
recollegit, et
Thaisim, patre
consenciente, in
vxorem duxit.

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For mariage: and it fell so,
That al was do riht as he thoghte,
His pourpos to an ende he broghte,
Sche weddeth him as for hire lord;
Thus be thei alle of on acord.

Whan al was do riht as thei wolde,
The king unto his Sone tolde
Of Tharse thilke traiterie,
1780 And seide hou in his compaignie
His doghter and himselven eke
Schull go vengeance forto seke.
The Schipes were redy sone,
And whan thei sihe it was to done,
Withoute lette of eny wente
With Seil updrawe forth thei wente
Towardes Tharse upon the tyde.
Bot he that wot what schal betide,
The hihe god, which wolde him kepe,
1790 Whan that this king was faste aslepe, [1654](#)
Be nyhtes time he hath him bede
To seile into an other stede: [1655](#)
To Ephesim he bad him drawe,
And as it was that time lawe,
He schal do there his sacrificise;
And ek he bad in alle wise
That in the temple amonges alle
His fortune, as it is befalle,
Touchende his doghter and his wif
1800 He schal beknowe upon his lif.
The king of this Avisioun
Hath gret ymaginacioun,
What thing it signefie may;
And natheles, whan it was day,
He bad caste Anchor and abod;
And whil that he on Anchor rod,
The wynd, which was tofore strange,
Upon the point began to change,

Qualiter Appolinus
vna cum filia et
eius marito nauim
ingredientes a
Mitelena vsque
Tharsim cursum
proposuerunt. Set
Appolinus in
sompnis
ammonitus versus
Ephesim, vt ibidem
in templo Diane
sacrificaret, vela
per mare diuertit.

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And torneth thider as it scholde.
1810 Tho knew he wel that god it wolde,
And bad the Maister make him yare,
Tofor the wynd for he wol fare
To Ephesim, and so he dede.
And whanne he cam unto the stede
Where as he scholde londe, he londeth
With al the haste he may, and fondeth
To schapen him be such a wise,
That he may be the morwe arise
And don after the mandement

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1820 Of him which hath him thider sent.
And in the wise that he thoghte,
Upon the morwe so he wroghte;
His doghter and his Sone he nom,
And forth unto the temple he com
With a gret route in compaignie,
Hise yiftes forto sacrificie.
The citezeins tho herden seie
Of such a king that cam to preie
Unto Diane the godesse,

1830 And left al other besinesse,
Thei comen thider forto se
The king and the solempnete.

With worthi knyhtes environed
The king himself hath abandoned
Into the temple in good entente.
The dore is up, and he in wente, [1656](#)
Wher as with gret devocioun
Of holi contemplacioun
Withinne his herte he made his schrifte;

Qualiter Appolinus
Ephesim in templo
Diane sacrificans,
vxorem suam
ibidem velatam
inuenit; qua secum
assumpta in
Nauim, versus
Tyrum regressus
est.

1840 And after that a riche yifte
He offreth with gret reverence,
And there in open Audience [1657](#)
Of hem that stoden thanne aboute, [1658](#)
He tolde hem and declareth oute
His hap, such as him is befalle,

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Ther was nothing foryete of alle.
 His wif, as it was goddes grace,
 Which was professed in the place,
 As sche that was Abbesse there,
 1850Unto his tale hath leid hire Ere:
 Sche knew the vois and the visage,
 For pure joie as in a rage
 Sche strawhte unto him al at ones,
 And fell aswoune upon the stones, [1659](#)
 Wherof the temple flor was paved.
 Sche was anon with water laved,
 Til sche cam to herself ayein,
 And thanne sche began to sein:
 ‘Ha, blessed be the hihe sonde,
 1860That I mai se myn housebonde,
 That whilom he and I were on!’ [1660](#)
 The king with that knew hire anon,
 And tok hire in his Arm and kiste;
 And al the toun thus sone it wiste.
 Tho was ther joie manyfold,
 For every man this tale hath told
 As for miracle, and were glade,
 Bot nevere man such joie made
 As doth the king, which hath his wif.
 1870And whan men herde hou that hir lif
 Was saved, and be whom it was,
 Thei wondren alle of such a cas:
 Thurgh al the Lond aros the speche
 Of Maister Cerymon the leche
 And of the cure which he dede.
 The king himself tho hath him bede,
 And ek this queene forth with him, [1661](#)
 That he the toun of Ephesim
 Wol leve and go wher as thei be,
 1880For nevere man of his degre
 Hath do to hem so mochel good;
 And he his profit understod,

And granteth with hem forto wende.
And thus thei maden there an ende,
And token leve and gon to Schipe
With al the hole felaschipe.

This king, which nou hath his desir,
Seith he wol holde his cours to Tyr.
Thei hadden wynd at wille tho,

1890 With topseilcole and forth they go, [1662](#)
And striken nevere, til thei come
To Tyr, where as thei havene nome, [1663](#)
And londen hem with mochel blisse.
Tho was ther many a mowth to kisse,
Echon welcometh other hom,
Bot whan the queen to londe com,
And Thaise hir doghter be hir side,
The joie which was thilke tyde
Ther mai no mannes tunge telle:

1900 Thei seiden alle, 'Hier comth the welle
Of alle wommannysshe grace.'
The king hath take his real place,
The queene is into chambre go:
Ther was gret feste arraied tho;
Whan time was, thei gon to mete,
Alle olde sorwes ben foryete,
And gladen hem with joies newe:
The descoloured pale hewe
Is now become a rody cheke,

1910 Ther was no merthe forto seke,
Bot every man hath that he wolde. [1664](#)

The king, as he wel couthe and
scholde,
Makth to his poeple riht good chiere;
And after sone, as thou schalt hiere,
A parlement he hath sommoned,
Wher he his doghter hath coroned
Forth with the lord of Mitelene,
That on is king, that other queene:

Qualiter Appolinus
vna cum vxore et
filia sua Thyrum
applicuit.

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Qualiter Appolinus
Athenagoram cum
Thaise vxore sua
super Tyrum
coronari fecit. [1665](#)

And thus the fadres ordinance
 1920 This lond hath set in governance, [1666](#)
 And seide thanne he wolde wende [1667](#)
 To Tharse, forto make an ende
 Of that his doghter was betraied.
 Therof were alle men wel paied, [1668](#)
 And seide hou it was forto done:
 The Schipes weren redi sone,
 And strong pouer with him he tok; [1669](#)
 Up to the Sky he caste his lok, [1670](#)
 And syh the wynd was covenable.
 1930 Thei hale up Ancher with the cable,
 The Seil on hih, the Stiere in honde, [1671](#)
 And seilen, til thei come alonde
 At Tharse nyh to the cite;
 And whan thei wisten it was he,
 The toun hath don him reverence.
 He telleth hem the violence,
 Which the tretour Strangulio
 And Dionise him hadde do
 Touchende his dowhter, as yee herde; [1672](#)
 1940 And whan thei wiste hou that it ferde, [1673](#)
 As he which pes and love soghte,
 Unto the toun this he besoghte,
 To don him riht in juggement.
 Anon thei were bothe asent
 With strengthe of men, and comen sone,
 And as hem thoghte it was to done,
 Atteint thei were be the lawe
 And diemed forto honge and drawe,
 And brent and with the wynd toblowe,
 1950 That al the world it myhte knowe:
 And upon this condicion
 The dom in execucion
 Was put anon withoute faile.
 And every man hath gret mervaille,

Qualiter Appolinus
 a Tyro per mare
 versus Tharsim iter
 arripiens vindictam
 contra
 Strangulionem et
 Dionisiam vxorem
 suam pro iniuria,
 quam ipsi Thaisi
 filie sue intulerunt,
 iudicialiter
 assecutus est.

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Which herde tellen of this chance,
 And thonketh goddes pourveance,
 Which doth mercy forth with justice.
 Slain is the moerdrer and moerdrice
 Thurgh verray trowthe of rihtwisnesse,
 1960 And thurgh mercy sauf is simplesse
 Of hire whom mercy preserveth;
 Thus hath he wel that wel deserveth.
 Whan al this thing is don and ended,
 This king, which loved was and frended,
 A lettre hath, which cam to him
 Be Schipe fro Pentapolim,
 Be which the lond hath to him write, [1674](#)
 That he wolde understonde and wite
 Hou in good mynde and in good pes
 1970 Ded is the king Artestrates,
 Wherof thei alle of on acord
 Him preiden, as here liege lord,
 That he the lettre wel conceive [1675](#)
 And come his regne to receive,
 Which god hath yove him and fortune;
 And thus besoghte the commune
 Forth with the grete lordes alle.
 This king sih how it was befalle, [1676](#)
 Fro Tharse and in prosperite
 1980 He tok his leve of that Cite
 And goth him into Schipe ayein:
 The wynd was good, the See was plein,
 Hem nedeth noght a Riff to slake,
 Til thei Pentapolim have take.
 The lond, which herde of that tidinge,
 Was wonder glad of his cominge;
 He resteth him a day or tuo
 And tok his conseil to him tho,
 And sette a time of Parlement,
 1990 Wher al the lond of on assent
 Forth with his wif hath him corowned,

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Qualiter Artestrate
 Pentapolim Rege
 mortuo, ipsi de
 regno Epistolas
 super hoc Appolino
 direxerunt: vnde
 Appolinus vna cum
 vxore sua ibidem
 aduenientes ad
 decus imperii cum
 magno gaudio
 coronati sunt.

Wher alle goode him was fuisouned.
Lo, what it is to be wel grounded:[1677](#)
For he hath ferst his love founded
Honesteliche as forto wedde,
Honesteliche his love he spedde
And hadde children with his wif,
And as him liste he ladde his lif;
And in ensample his lif was write,[1678](#)

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2000 That alle lovers myhten wite
How ate laste it schal be sene
Of love what thei wolden mene.
For se now on that other side,
Antiochus with al his Pride,
Which sette his love unkindely,
His ende he hadde al sodeinly,[1679](#)
Set ayein kinde upon vengeance,
And for his lust hath his penance.

Lo thus, mi Sone, myht thou liere
2010 What is to love in good manere,
And what to love in other wise:
The mede arist of the servise;
Fortune, thogh sche be noght stable,
Yit at som time is favorable
To hem that ben of love trewe.
Bot certes it is forto rewe
To se love ayein kinde falle,
For that makth sore a man to falle,
As thou myht of tofore rede.

Confessor ad
Amantem.[1680](#)

2020 Forthi, my Sone, I wolde rede
To lete al other love aweie,
Bot if it be thurgh such a weie
As love and reson wolde acorde.
For elles, if that thou descorde,
And take lust as doth a beste,
Thi love mai noght ben honeste;
For be no skile that I finde
Such lust is noght of loves kinde.

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Mi fader, hou so that it stonde,
 Youre tale is herd and understonde,
 2030 As thing which worthi is to hiere,
 Of gret ensample and gret matiere,
 Wherof, my fader, god you quyte.
 Bot in this point miself aquite
 I mai riht wel, that nevere yit
 I was assoted in my wit,
 Bot only in that worthi place
 Wher alle lust and alle grace
 Is set, if that danger ne were.
 2040 Bot that is al my moste fere:
 I not what ye fortune acompte,
 Bot what thing danger mai amonte
 I wot wel, for I have assaied;
 For whan myn herte is best arraied
 And I have al my wit thurghsoght
 Of love to beseche hire oght,
 For al that evere I skile may, [1681](#)
 I am concluded with a nay:
 That o sillable hath overthrowe
 2050 A thousand wordes on a rowe
 Of suche as I best speke can;
 Thus am I bot a lewed man.
 Bot, fader, for ye ben a clerk
 Of love, and this matiere is derk,
 And I can evere leng the lasse,
 Bot yit I mai noght let it passe, [1682](#)
 Youre hole conseil I beseche,
 That ye me be som weie teche
 What is my beste, as for an ende.
 2060 Mi Sone, unto the trouthe wende
 Now wol I for the love of thee,
 And lete alle othre truffles be. [1683](#)

[THE LOVER
 REQUIRES
 COUNSEL.]

Confessio Amantis,
 vnde pro finali
 conclusione
 consilium
 Confessoris
 impetrat.

The more that the nede is hyh,
 The more it nedeth to be slyh
 To him which hath the nede on honde.
 I have wel herd and understonde,
 Mi Sone, al that thou hast me seid,
 And ek of that thou hast me preid,
 Nou at this time that I schal
 2070As for conclusioun final
 Conseile upon thi nede sette:[1684](#)
 So thenke I finally to knette
 This cause, where it is tobroke,
 And make an ende of that is spoke.[1685](#)
 For I behihte thee that yifte
 Ferst whan thou come under my schrifte,
 That thogh I toward Venus were,
 Yit spak I suche wordes there,
 That for the Presthod which I have,
 2080Min ordre and min astat to save,
 I seide I wolde of myn office
 To vertu more than to vice
 Encline, and teche thee mi lore.
 Forthi to speken overmore
 Of love, which thee mai availe,
 Tak love where it mai noght faile:[1686](#)
 For as of this which thou art inne,
 Be that thou seist it is a Sinne,
 And Sinne mai no pris deserve,
 2090Withoute pris and who schal serve,
 I not what profit myhte availe.
 Thus folweth it, if thou travaile,
 Wher thou no profit hast ne pris,
 Thou art toward thiself unwis:
 And sett thou myhtest lust atteigne,[1687](#)
 Of every lust thende is a peine,
 And every peine is good to fle;
 So it is wonder thing to se,[1688](#)

[THE CONFESSOR
REPLIES.]

Hic super Amoris
 causa finita
 confessione,
 Confessor Genius
 Amanti ea que sibi
 salubrius
 expediunt, sano
 consilio finaliter
 iniungit.

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Why such a thing schal be desired.
 2100 The more that a Stock is fyred,
 The rathere into Aisshe it torneth;
 The fot which in the weie sporneth
 Fulofte his heved hath overthrowe;
 Thus love is blind and can noght knowe [1689](#)
 Wher that he goth, til he be falle:
 Forthi, bot if it so befalle [1690](#)
 With good conseil that he be lad,
 Him oghte forto ben adrad.
 For conseil passeth alle thing
 2110 To him which thenkth to ben a king;
 And every man for his partie
 A kingdom hath to justefie,
 That is to sein his oghne dom.
 If he misreule that kingdom,
 He lest himself, and that is more
 Than if he loste Schip and Ore
 And al the worldes good withal:
 For what man that in special
 Hath noght himself, he hath noght elles,
 2120 Nomor the perles than the schelles;
 Al is to him of o value:
 Thogh he hadde at his retenue
 The wyde world riht as he wolde,
 Whan he his herte hath noght withholde
 Toward himself, al is in vein.
 And thus, my Sone, I wolde sein,
 As I seide er, that thou aryse,
 Er that thou falle in such a wise
 That thou ne myht thiself rekevere:
 2130 For love, which that blind was evere,
 Makth alle his servantz blinde also.
 My Sone, and if thou have be so,
 Yit is it time to withdrawe,
 And set thin herte under that lawe, [1691](#)
 The which of reson is governed

And noght of will. And to be lerned,
Ensamples thou hast many on
Of now and ek of time gon,¹⁶⁹²
That every lust is bot a while;
2140And who that wole himself beguile,
He may the rathere be deceived.
Mi Sone, now thou hast conceived
Somwhat of that I wolde mene;
Hierafterward it schal be sene
If that thou lieve upon mi lore;
For I can do to thee nomore
Bot teche thee the rihte weie:
Now ches if thou wolt live or deie.

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2150Mi fader, so as I have herd
Your tale, bot it were ansuerd,
I were mochel forto blame.
Mi wo to you is bot a game,
That fielen noght of that I fiele;¹⁶⁹³
The fieling of a mannes Hiele
Mai noght be likned to the Herte:
I mai noght, thogh I wolde, asterte,
And ye be fre from al the peine
Of love, wherof I me pleigne.
It is riht esi to comaunde;
2160The hert which fre goth on the launde
Not of an Oxe what him eileth;
It falleth ofte a man merveileth
Of that he seth an other fare,
Bot if he knewe himself the fare,
And felt it as it is in soth,
He scholde don riht as he doth,
Or elles werse in his degre:
For wel I wot, and so do ye,
That love hath evere yit ben used,
2170So mot I nedes ben excused.
Bot, fader, if ye wolde thus

[THE
CONTROVERSY.]

Hic loquitur de
controuersia, que
inter Confessorem
et Amantem in fine
confessionis
versabatur.

Unto Cupide and to Venus
 Be frendlich toward mi querele,
 So that myn herte were in hele
 Of love which is in mi briest,
 I wot wel thanne a betre Prest
 Was nevere mad to my behove.
 Bot al the whiles that I hove¹⁶⁹⁴
 In noncertein betwen the tuo,¹⁶⁹⁵
 2180 And not if I to wel or wo¹⁶⁹⁶
 Schal torne, that is al my drede,
 So that I not what is to rede.
 Bot for final conclusion
 I thenke a Supplicacion
 With pleine wordes and expresse
 Wryte unto Venus the goddesse,
 The which I preie you to bere
 And bringe ayein a good ansuere.
 Tho was betwen mi Prest and me
 2190 Debat and gret perplexete:
 Mi resoun understod him wel,
 And knew it was soth everydel
 That he hath seid, bot noght forthi
 Mi will hath nothing set therby.
 For techinge of so wis a port¹⁶⁹⁷
 Is unto love of no desport;
 Yit myhte nevere man beholde
 Reson, wher love was withholde,
 Thei be noght of o governance.
 2200 And thus we fellen in distance,
 Mi Prest and I, bot I spak faire,
 And thurgh mi wordes debonaire
 Thanne ate laste we acorden,¹⁶⁹⁸
 So that he seith he wol recorden
 To speke and stonde upon mi syde
 To Venus bothe and to Cupide;
 And bad me wryte what I wolde,

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And seith me trewly that he scholde
Mi lettre here unto the queene.
2210 And I sat doun upon the grene
Fulfilt of loves fantasie,
And with the teres of myn ÷e
In stede of enke I gan to wryte
The wordes whiche I wolde endite¹⁶⁹⁹
Unto Cupide and to Venus,
And in mi lettre I seide thus.

[THE
SUPPLICATION.]

The wofull peine of loves maladie,
Ayein the which mai no phisique availe,
Min herte hath so bewhaped with sotie,
2220 That wher so that I reste or I travaile,¹⁷⁰⁰
I finde it evere redy to assaile
Mi resoun, which that can him noght
defende:
Thus seche I help, wherof I mihte
amende.

Hic tractat formam
cuiusdam
Supplicacionis,
quam ex parte
Amantis per manus
Genii Sacerdotis
sui Venus sibi
porrectam
acceptabat.

Ferst to Nature if that I me compleigne,
Ther finde I hou that every creature
Som time ayer hath love in his demeine,
So that the litel wrenne in his mesure
Hath yit of kinde a love under his cure;¹⁷⁰¹
And I bot on desire, of which I misse:
2230 And thus, bot I, hath every kinde his blisse.

The resoun of my wit it overpasseth,
Of that Nature techeth me the weie
To love, and yit no certein sche compasseth
Hou I schal spede, and thus between the tweie
I stonde, and not if I schal live or deie.
For thogh reson ayein my will debate,
I mai noght fle, that I ne love algate.

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Upon miself is thilke tale come,

Hou whilom Pan, which is the god of kinde,
2240 With love wrastlede and was overcome:¹⁷⁰²
For evere I wrastle and evere I am behinde,
That I no strengthe in al min herte finde,
Wherof that I mai stonden eny throwe;
So fer mi wit with love is overthrowe.

Whom nedeth help, he mot his helpe crave,
Or helpeles he schal his nede spille:
Pleinly thurghsoght my wittes alle I have,¹⁷⁰³
Bot non of hem can helpe after mi wille;
And als so wel I mihte sitte stille,
2250 As preie unto mi lady eny helpe:
Thus wot I noght wherof miself to helpe.¹⁷⁰⁴

Unto the grete Jove and if I bidde,
To do me grace of thilke swete tunne,
Which under keie in his celier amidde
Lith couched, that fortune is overrunne,
Bot of the bitter cuppe I have begunne,
I not hou ofte, and thus finde I no game;¹⁷⁰⁵
For evere I axe and evere it is the same.

I se the world stonde evere upon eschange,
2260 Nou wyndes loude, and nou the weder softe;
I mai sen ek the grete mone change,
And thing which nou is lowe is eft alofte;
The dredfull werres into pes fulofte
Thei torne; and evere is Danger in o place,
Which wol noght change his will to do me grace.

Bot upon this the grete clerc Ovide,
Of love whan he makth his remembrance,
He seith ther is the blinde god Cupide,
The which hath love under his governance,
2270 And in his hond with many a fyri lance¹⁷⁰⁶
He woundeth ofte, ther he wol noght hele;

And that somdiel is cause of mi querele. [1707](#)

Ovide ek seith that love to parforne
Stant in the hond of Venus the goddesse,
Bot whan sche takth hir conseil with Satorne,
Ther is no grace, and in that time, I gesse,
Began mi love, of which myn hevynesse
Is now and evere schal, bot if I spede:
So wot I noght miself what is to rede.

2280Forthi to you, Cupide and Venus bothe,
With al myn hertes obeissance I preie,
If ye were ate ferste time wrothe,
Whan I began to love, as I you seie,
Nou stynt, and do thilke infortune aweie, [1708](#)
So that Danger, which stant of retenue
With my ladi, his place mai remue.

O thou Cupide, god of loves lawe,
That with thi Dart brennende hast set afyre
Min herte, do that wounde be withdrawe,
2290Or yif me Salve such as I desire:
For Service in thi Court withouten hyre
To me, which evere yit have kept thin heste,
Mai nevere be to loves lawe honeste.

O thou, gentile Venus, loves queene, [1709](#)
Withoute gult thou dost on me thi wreche;
Thou wost my peine is evere aliche grene
For love, and yit I mai it noght areche:
This wold I for my laste word beseche, [1710](#)
That thou mi love aquite as I deserve,
2300Or elles do me plainly forto sterve.

Whanne I this Supplicacioun
With good deliberacioun,
In such a wise as ye nou wite,

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[VENUS REPLIES TO
THE SUPPLICATION.]

Hic loquitur
qualiter Venus,

Hadde after min entente write
Unto Cupide and to Venus,
This Prest which hihte Genius
It tok on honde to presente,
On my message and forth he wente
To Venus, forto wite hire wille.

accepta Amantis
Supplicacione,
indilate ad singula
respondit.

2310 And I bod in the place stille,
And was there bot a litel while,
Noght full the montance of a Mile,
Whan I behield and sodeinly
I sih wher Venus stod me by.
So as I myhte, under a tre
To grounde I fell upon mi kne,
And preide hire forto do me grace:
Sche caste hire chiere upon mi face,
And as it were halvinge a game^{[1711](#)}

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2320 Sche axeth me what is mi name.^{[1712](#)}
'Ma dame,' I seide, 'John Gower.'
'Now John,' quod sche, 'in my pouer
Thou most as of thi love stonde;
For I thi bille have understonde,
In which to Cupide and to me
Somdiel thou hast compleigned thee,
And somdiel to Nature also.
Bot that schal stonde among you tuo,
For therof have I noght to done;

2330 For Nature is under the Mone
Maistresse of every lives kinde,
Bot if so be that sche mai finde^{[1713](#)}
Som holy man that wol withdrawe
His kindly lust ayein hir lawe;^{[1714](#)}
Bot sielde whanne it falleth so,
For fewe men ther ben of tho,
Bot of these othre ynowe be,
Whiche of here oghne nycete
Ayein Nature and hire office

2340 Deliten hem in sondri vice,

Wherof that sche fulofte hath pleigned,
And ek my Court it hath desdeigned¹⁷¹⁵
And evere schal; for it receiveth
Non such that kinde so deceiveth.
For al onliche of gentil love
Mi court stant alle courtz above
And takth noght into retenue
Bot thing which is to kinde due,
For elles it schal be refused.

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2350Wherof I holde thee excused,
For it is manye daies gon,
That thou amonges hem were on
Which of my court hast ben withholde;
So that the more I am beholde
Of thi desese to commune,
And to remue that fortune,
Which manye daies hath the grieved.
Bot if my conseil mai be lieved,
Thou schalt ben esed er thou go

2360Of thilke unsely jolif wo,
Wherof thou seist thin herte is fyred:
Bot as of that thou hast desired
After the sentence of thi bille,
Thou most therof don at my wille,
And I therof me wole avise.
For be thou hol, it schal suffise:
Mi medicine is noght to sieke¹⁷¹⁶
For thee and for suche olde sieke,¹⁷¹⁷
Noght al per chance as ye it wolden,¹⁷¹⁸

2370Bot so as ye be reson scholden,
Acordant unto loves kinde.¹⁷¹⁹
For in the plit which I thee finde,
So as mi court it hath awarded,
Thou schalt be duely rewarded;
And if thou woldest more crave,
It is no riht that thou it have.'

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iii. *Qui cupit id quod habere nequit, sua tempora perdit,
 Est vbi non posse, velle salute caret.
 Non estatis opus gelidis hirsuta capillis,
 Cum calor abcessit, equiperabit hiems;
 Sicut habet Mayus non dat natura Decembri,
 Nec poterit compar floribus esse lutum;
 Sic neque decrepita senium iuvenile voluptas
 Floret in obsequium, quod Venus ipsa petit.*¹⁷²⁰
Conueniens igitur foret, vt quos cana senectus
 (10) *Attigit, vltius corpora casta colant.*

Venus, which stant withoute lawe
 In noncertein, bot as men drawe
 Of Rageman upon the chance,
 2380 Sche leith no peis in the balance,
 Bot as hir lyketh forto weie;
 The trewe man fulofte aweie
 Sche put, which hath hir grace bede,
 And set an untrew in his stede.
 Lo, thus blindly the world sche diemeth
 In loves cause, as tome siemeth:¹⁷²²
 I not what othre men wol sein,¹⁷²³
 Bot I algate am so besein,
 And stonde as on amonges alle
 2390 Which am out of hir grace falle:
 It nedeth take no witnesse,
 For sche which seid is the goddesse,
 To whether part of love it wende,
 Hath sett me for a final ende
 The point wherto that I schal holde.
 For whan sche hath me wel beholde,
 Halvyng of scorn, sche seide thus:
 ‘Thou wost wel that I am Venus,
 Which al only my lustes seche;
 2400 And wel I wot, thogh thou beseche
 Mi love, lustes ben ther none,
 Whiche I mai take in thi persone;

Hic in exemplum
 contra quoscunque
 viros inveteratos
 amoris
 concupiscenciam
 affectantes loquitur
 Venus, huiusque
 Amantis Confessi
 supplicacionem
 quasi deridens,
 ipsum pro eo quod
 senex et debilis est,
 multis
 exhortacionibus
 insufficientem
 redarguit.¹⁷²¹

For loves lust and lockes hore¹⁷²⁴
 In chambre acorden neveremore,
 And thogh thou feigne a yong corage,
 It scheweth wel be the visage
 That olde grisel is no fole:
 There ben fulmanye yeres stole
 With thee and with suche othre mo,¹⁷²⁵
 2410 That outward feignen youthe so
 And ben withinne of pore assay.
 Min herte wolde and I ne may
 Is noght beloved nou adayes;
 Er thou make eny suche assaies
 To love, and faile upon the fet,
 Betre is to make a beau retret;
 For thogh thou myhtest love atteigne,
 Yit were it bot an ydel peine,
 Whan that thou art noght sufficient
 2420 To holde love his covenant.
 Forthi tak hom thin herte ayein,
 That thou travaile noght in vein,
 Wherof my Court may be deceived.
 I wot and have it wel conceived,
 Hou that thi will is good ynowh;
 Bot mor behoveth to the plowh,
 Wherof the lacketh, as I trowe:
 So sitte it wel that thou beknowe¹⁷²⁶
 Thi fieble astat, er thou beginne
 2430 Thing wher thou miht non ende winne.
 What bargain scholde a man assaie,
 Whan that him lacketh forto paie?
 Mi Sone, if thou be wel bethoght,¹⁷²⁷
 This toucheth thee; foryet it noght:
 The thing is torned into was;
 That which was whilom grene gras,¹⁷²⁸
 Is welked hey at time now.¹⁷²⁹
 Forthi mi conseil is that thou

Remembre wel hou thou art old.'
 2440 Whan Venus hath hir tale told,
 And I bethoght was al aboute,¹⁷³⁰
 Tho wiste I wel withoute doute,¹⁷³¹
 That ther was no recoverir;
 And as a man the blase of fyr
 With water quencheth, so ferd I,¹⁷³²
 A cold me cawhte sodeinly,¹⁷³³
 For sorwe that myn herte made
 Mi dedly face pale and fade
 Becam, and swoune I fell to grounde.
 2450 And as I lay the same stounde,
 Ne fully quik ne fully ded,
 Me thoghte I sih tofor myn hed
 Cupide with his bowe bent,
 And lich unto a Parlement,
 Which were ordeigned for the nones,
 With him cam al the world at ones
 Of gentil folk that whilom were
 Lovers, I sih hem alle there
 Forth with Cupide in sondri routes.
 2460 Min yhe and as I caste aboutes,
 To knowe among hem who was who,
 I sih wher lusty Youthe tho,¹⁷³⁴
 As he which was a Capitein,
 Tofore alle othre upon the plein
 Stod with his route wel begon,
 Here hevedes kempt, and therupon
 Garlandes noght of o colour,
 Some of the lef, some of the flour,
 And some of grete Perles were;
 2470 The newe guise of Beawme there,
 With sondri thinges wel devised,
 I sih, wherof thei ben queintised.
 It was al lust that thei with ferde,
 Ther was no song that I ne herde,

[THE COMPANIES OF
LOVERS.]

Qualiter super
 derisoria Veneris
 exhortacione
 contristatus
 Amans, quasi
 mortuus in terram
 corruit, vbi, vt sibi
 videbatur,
 Cupidinem cum
 innumera
 multitudine nuper
 Amantum variis
 turmis
 assistencium
 conspiciebat.

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Which unto love was touchende;
 Of Pan and al that was likende¹⁷³⁵
 As in Piping of melodie
 Was herd in thilke compaignie
 So lowde, that on every side
 2480 It thoghte as al the hevene cride
 In such acord and such a soun
 Of bombard and of clarion
 With Cornemuse and Schallemele,
 That it was half a mannes hele
 So glad a noise forto hiere.
 And as me thoghte, in this manere
 Al freissh I syh hem springe and dance,
 And do to love her entendance
 After the lust of youthes heste.
 2490 Ther was ynowh of joie and feste,
 For evere among thei laghe and pleie,
 And putten care out of the weie,
 That he with hem ne sat ne stod.
 And overthis I understod,
 So as myn Ere it myhte areche,
 The moste matiere of her speche
 Was al of knyghthod and of Armes,¹⁷³⁶
 And what it is to ligge in armes
 With love, whanne it is achieved.
 2500 Ther was Tristram, which was believed
 With bele Ysolde, and Lancelot
 Stod with Gunnore, and Galahot
 With his ladi, and as me thoghte,
 I syh wher Jason with him broghte
 His love, which that Creusa hihte,
 And Hercules, which mochel myhte,
 Was ther berende his grete Mace,
 And most of alle in thilke place
 He peyneth him to make chiere
 2510 With Eolen, which was him diere.
 Theseüs, thogh he were untrew

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De nominibus
 illorum nuper
 Amantum, qui tunc
 Amanti spasmato,
 aliqui iuvenes,
 aliqui senes,
 apparuerunt. Senes
 autem precipue
 tam erga deum
 quam deam amoris
 pro sanitate
 Amantis
 recuperanda
 multiplicatis
 precibus

misericorditer
instabant.

To love, as alle wommen knewe,
Yit was he there natheles
With Phedra, whom to love he ches:
Of Grece ek ther was Thelamon,
Which fro the king Lamenedon
At Troie his doghter refte aweie,
Eseonen, as for his preie,
Which take was whan Jason cam
2520 Fro Colchos, and the Cite nam
In vengance of the ferste hate;
That made hem after to debate,
Whan Priamus the newe toun
Hath mad. And in avisioun
 Me thoghte that I sih also
Ector forth with his brethren tuo;
Himself stod with Pantaselee,
And next to him I myhte se,
Wher Paris stod with faire Eleine,
2530 Which was his joie sovereigne;
And Troilus stod with Criseide,
Bot evere among, althogh he pleide,
Be semblant he was hevy chiered,
For Diomedes, as him was liered,
Cleymeth to ben his parconner.
And thus full many a bachelor,
A thousand mo than I can sein,
With Yowthe I sih ther wel besein
Forth with here loves glade and blithe.
2540 And some I sih whiche ofte sithe
Compleignen hem in other wise;
Among the whiche I syh Narcise
And Pirus, that sory were.¹⁷³⁷
The worthy Grek also was there,
Achilles, which for love deide:
Agamenon ek, as men seide,
And Menelays the king also
I syh, with many an other mo,

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Which hadden be fortunèd sore
In loves cause.

2550 And overmore
Of wommen in the same cas,
With hem I sih wher Dido was,
Forsake which was with Enee;
And Phillis ek I myhte see,
Whom Demephon deceived hadde;
And Adriagne hir sorwe ladde,
For Theseüs hir Soster tok
And hire unkindely forsok.
I sih ther ek among the press

2560 Compleignende upon Hercules
His ferste love Deyanire,
Which sette him afterward afyre:
Medea was there ek and pleigneth
Upon Jason, for that he feigneth,
Withoute cause and tok a newe;
Sche seide, 'Fy on alle untrewel'
I sih there ek Deydamie,
Which hadde lost the compaignie
Of Achilles, whan Diomede

2570 To Troie him fette upon the nede.
Among these othre upon the grene
I syh also the wofull queene
Cleopatras, which in a Cave¹⁷³⁸
With Serpentz hath herself begrave
Alquik, and so sche was totore,¹⁷³⁹
For sorwe of that sche hadde lore
Antonye, which hir love hath be:
And forth with hire I sih Tisbee,
Which on the scharpe swerdes point

2580 For love deide in sory point;
And as myn Ere it myhte knowe,
She seide, 'Wo worthe alle slowe!'
The pleignte of Progne and Philomene
Ther herde I what it wolde mene,

How Tereüs of his untrouthe
 Undede hem bothe, and that was routhe;
 And next to hem I sih Canace,
 Which for Machaire hir fader grace
 Hath lost, and deide in wofull plit.
 2590 And as I sih in my spirit,
 Me thoghte amonges othre thus
 The doghter of king Priamus,
 Polixena, whom Pirrus slowh,
 Was there and made sorwe ynowh,
 As sche which deide gulteles
 For love, and yit was loveles.
 And forto take the desport,
 I sih there some of other port, [1740](#)
 And that was Circes and Calipse,
 2600 That cowthen do the Mone eclipse,
 Of men and change the liknesses,
 Of Artmagique Sorceresses;
 Thei hielde in honde manyon,
 To love wher thei wolde or non.
 Bot above alle that ther were
 Of wommen I sih foure there,
 Whos name I herde most comended:
 Be hem the Court stod al amended;
 For wher thei comen in presence,
 2610 Men deden hem the reverence,
 As thogh they hadden be goddesses,
 Of al this world or Emperesses.
 And as me thoghte, an Ere I leide,
 And herde hou that these othre seide,
 ‘Lo, these ben the foure wyves,
 Whos feith was proeved in her lyves:
 For in essample of alle goode
 With Mariage so thei stode,
 That fame, which no gret thing hydeth,
 2620 Yit in Cronique of hem abydeth.’
 Penolope that on was hote,

Whom many a knyht hath loved hote,
Whil that hire lord Ulixes lay¹⁷⁴¹
Full many a yer and many a day
Upon the grete Siege of Troie:
Bot sche, which hath no worldes joie
Bot only of hire housebonde,
Whil that hir lord was out of londe,
So wel hath kept hir wommanhiede,
2630 That al the world therof tok hiede,
And nameliche of hem in Grece.

That other womman was Lucrece,
Wif to the Romain Collatin;
And sche constreigned of Tarquin
To thing which was ayein hir wille,
Sche wolde noght hirselves stille,
Bot deide only for drede of schame
In keping of hire goode name,
As sche which was on of the beste.

2640 The thridde wif was hote Alceste,
Which whanne Ametus scholde dye
Upon his grete maladye,
Sche preide unto the goddes so,
That sche receyveth al the wo
And deide himself to yive him lif:
Lo, if this were a noble wif.¹⁷⁴²

The ferthe wif which I ther sih,
I herde of hem that were nyh
Hou sche was cleped Alcione,

2650 Which to Seyix hir lord al one¹⁷⁴³
And to nomo hir body kepte;
And whan sche sih him dreynt, sche lepte
Into the wawes where he swam,¹⁷⁴⁴
And there a Sefoul sche becam,
And with hire wenges him bespradde
For love which to him sche hadde.¹⁷⁴⁵
Lo, these foure were tho

Whiche I sih, as me thoghte tho,
 Among the grete compaignie
 2660 Which Love hadde forto guye:
 Bot Youthe, which in special
 Of Loves Court was Mareschal,
 So besy was upon his lay,
 That he non hiede where I lay [1746](#)
 Hath take. And thanne, as I behield,
 Me thoghte I sih upon the field,
 Where Elde cam a softe pas
 Toward Venus, ther as sche was.
 With him gret compaignie he ladde,
 2670 Bot noght so manye as Youthe hadde: [1747](#)
 The moste part were of gret Age,
 And that was sene in the visage, [1748](#)
 And noght forthi, so as thei myhte,
 Thei made hem yongly to the sihte:
 Bot yit herde I no pipe there [1749](#)
 To make noise in mannes Ere, [1750](#)
 Bot the Musette I myhte knowe,
 For olde men which souneth lowe, [1751](#)
 With Harpe and Lute and with Citole.
 2680 The hovedance and the Carole,
 In such a wise as love hath bede,
 A softe pas thei dance and trede;
 And with the wommen otherwhile
 With sobre chier among thei smyle,
 For laghtre was ther non on hyh.
 And natheles full wel I syh
 That thei the more queinte it made
 For love, in whom thei weren glade.
 And there me thoghte I myhte se
 2690 The king David with Bersabee,
 And Salomon was noght withoute;
 Passende an hundred on a route
 Of wyves and of Concubines,

Juesses bothe and Sarazines,¹⁷⁵²
 To him I sih alle entendant:
 I not if he was sufficient,¹⁷⁵³
 Bot natheles for al his wit
 He was attached with that writ
 Which love with his hond enseleth,
 2700 Fro whom non erthly man appeleth.
 And overthis, as for a wonder,¹⁷⁵⁴
 With his leon which he put under,¹⁷⁵⁵
 With Dalida Sampson I knew,
 Whos love his strengthe al overthrew.
 I syh there Aristotle also,
 Whom that the queene of Grece so¹⁷⁵⁶
 Hath bridled, that in thilke time
 Sche made him such a Silogime,
 That he foryat al his logique;
 2710 Ther was non art of his Practique,
 Thurgh which it mihte ben excluded
 That he ne was fully concluded
 To love, and dede his obeissance.
 And ek Virgile of aqueintance
 I sih, wher he the Maiden preide,
 Which was the doghter, as men seide,
 Of themperour whilom of Rome;
 Sortes and Plato with him come,
 So dede Ovide the Poete.
 2720 I thoghte thanne how love is swete,
 Which hath so wise men reclaimed,
 And was miself the lasse aschamed,
 Or forto lese or forto winne
 In the meschief that I was inne:
 And thus I lay in hope of grace.
 And whan thei comen to the place
 Wher Venus stod and I was falle,
 These olde men, with o vois alle
 To Venus preiden for my sake.

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2730 And sche, that myhte noght forsake
 So gret a clamour as was there,
 Let Pite come into hire Ere;
 And forth withal unto Cupide
 Sche preith that he upon his side
 Me wolde thurgh his grace sende
 Som confort, that I myhte amende,
 Upon the cas which is befalle.
 And thus for me thei preiden alle
 Of hem that weren olde aboute,
 2740 And ek some of the yonge route,
 Of gentillesse and pure trouthe
 I herde hem telle it was gret routhe,
 That I withouten help so ferde.
 And thus me thoghte I lay and herde.

Cupido, which may hurte and hele
 In loves cause, as for myn hele
 Upon the point which him was preid
 Cam with Venus, wher I was leid
 Swounende upon the grene gras.
 2750 And, as me thoghte, anon ther was
 On every side so gret presse,
 That every lif began to presse,
 I wot noght wel hou many score,
 Suche as I spak of now tofore,
 Lovers, that comen to beholde,
 Bot most of hem that weren olde:
 Thei stoden there at thilke tyde,
 To se what ende schal betyde
 Upon the cure of my sotie.
 Tho myhte I hiere gret partie
 Spekende, and ech his oghne avis
 Hath told, on that, an other this:
 Bot among alle this I herde,
 2760 Thei weren wo that I so ferde,
 And seiden that for no riote

[CUPID AND THE
LOVER.]

Hic tractat qualiter
 Cupido Amantis
 senectute confracti
 viscera
 perscrutans, ignita
 sue concupiscencie
 tela ab eo penitus
 extraxit, quem
 Venus postea
 absque calore
 percipiens, vacuum
 reliquit: et sic
 tandem prouisa
 Senectus, rationem
 inuocans, hominem
 interiorem per
 prius amore
 infatuatum mentis
 sanitati plenius
 restaurauit.

P. iii.
 368

An old man scholde noght assote;
 For as thei tolden redely,
 Ther is in him no cause why,
 Bot if he wolde himself benyce;¹⁷⁵⁷
 2770 So were he wel the more nyce.
 And thus desputen some of tho,
 And some seiden nothing so,
 Bot that the wylde loves rage
 In mannes lif forberth non Age;
 Whil ther is oyle forto fyre,
 The lampe is lyhtly set afyre,
 And is fulhard er it be queynt,
 Bot only if it be som seint,
 Which god preserveth of his grace.
 2780 And thus me thoghte, in sondri place
 Of hem that walken up and down
 Ther was diverse opinioun:
 And for a while so it laste,
 Til that Cupide to the laste,
 Forth with his moder full avised,
 Hath determined and devised
 Unto what point he wol descende.
 And al this time I was liggende
 Upon the ground tofore his yhen,
 2790 And thei that my desese syhen
 Supposen noght I scholde live;
 Bot he, which wolde thanne yive
 His grace, so as it mai be,
 This blinde god which mai noght se,
 Hath groped til that he me fond;
 And as he pitte forth his hond¹⁷⁵⁹
 Upon my body, wher I lay,
 Me thoghte a fyri Lancegay,
 Which whilom thurgh myn herte he caste,
 2800 He pulleth oute, and also faste
 As this was do, Cupide nam
 His weie, I not where he becam,

Nota.¹⁷⁵⁸

[THE FIERY DART
WITHDRAWN.]

P. iii.
369

And so dede al the remenant
Which unto him was entendant,
Of hem that in Avision
I hadde a revelacion,
So as I tolde now tofore.

Bot Venus wente noght therfore,
Ne Genius, whiche thilke time¹⁷⁶⁰

[THE HEALING OF
LOVE.]

2810 Abiden bothe faste byme.

And sche which mai the hertes bynde
In loves cause and ek unbinde,
Er I out of mi trance aros,
Venus, which hield a boiste clos,
And wolde noght I scholde deie,
Tok out mor cold than eny keie
An oignement, and in such point
Sche hath my wounded herte enoight,
My temples and my Reins also.¹⁷⁶¹

P. iii.
370

2820 And forth withal sche tok me tho

A wonder Mirour forto holde,
In which sche bad me to beholde
And taken hiede of that I syhe;
Wherinne anon myn hertes yhe
I caste, and sih my colour fade,
Myn yhen dymme and al unglade,
Mi chiekes thinne, and al my face
With Elde I myhte se deface,
So riveled and so wo besein,

2830 That ther was nothing full ne plein,

I syh also myn heres hore.
Mi will was tho to se nomore
Outwith, for ther was no plesance;¹⁷⁶²
And thanne into my remembrance
I drowh myn olde daies passed,
And as reson it hath compassed,
I made a liknesse of miselve
Unto the sondri Monthes twelve,
Wherof the yeer in his astat

Quod status
hominis Mensibus

2840Is mad, and stant upon debat,
That lich til other non acordeth.
For who the times wel recordeth,
And thanne at Marche if he beginne,
Whan that the lusti yeer comth inne,
Til Augst be passed and Septembre,
The myhty youthe he may remembre
In which the yeer hath his deduit
Of gras, of lef, of flour, of fruit,¹⁷⁶⁴
Of corn and of the wyny grape.

anni
equiperatur.¹⁷⁶³

P. iii.
371

2850And afterward the time is schape¹⁷⁶⁵
To frost, to Snow, to Wind, to Rein,
Til eft that Mars be come ayein:
The Wynter wol no Somer knowe,
The grene lef is overthrowe,
The clothed erthe is thanne bare,
Despuiled is the Somerfare,¹⁷⁶⁶
That erst was hete is thanne chele.

And thus thenkende thoghtes fele,
I was out of mi swoune affraied,

2860Wherof I sih my wittes straied,¹⁷⁶⁷
And gan to clepe hem hom ayein.
And whan Resoun it herde sein
That loves rage was aweie,
He cam to me the rihte weie,
And hath remued the sotie
Of thilke unwise fantasie,
Wherof that I was wont to pleigne,
So that of thilke fyri peine
I was mad sobre and hol ynowh.

2870 Venus behield me than and lowh,
And axeth, as it were in game,
What love was. And I for schame
Ne wiste what I scholde ansuere;
And natheles I gan to swere
That be my trouthe I knew him noght;
So ferr it was out of mi thoght,

Riht as it hadde nevere be. 'Mi goode Sone,' tho quod sche, 'Now at this time I lieve it wel, 2880 So goth the fortune of my whiel; Forthi mi conseil is thou leve.' 'Ma dame,' I seide, 'be your leve, Ye witen wel, and so wot I, That I am unbehovely Your Court fro this day forth to serve: 1768 And for I may no thonk deserve, And also for I am refused, I preie you to ben excused. And natheles as for the laste, 1769 2890 Whil that my wittes with me laste, Touchende mi confession I axe an absolucion Of Genius, er that I go.' The Prest anon was redy tho, And seide, 'Sone, as of thi schrifte Thou hast ful pardoun and foryifte; Foryet it thou, and so wol I.' 'Min holi fader, grant mercy,' Quod I to him, and to the queene 1770 2900 I fell on kneis upon the grene, And tok my leve forto wende. Bot sche, that wolde make an ende, As therto which I was most able, A Peire of Bedes blak as Sable Sche tok and heng my necke aboute; Upon the gaudes al withoute Was write of gold, <i>Por reposer.</i> 1771 'Lo,' thus sche seide, 'John Gower, Now thou art ate laste cast, 2910 This have I for thin ese cast, That thou nomore of love sieche. Bot my will is that thou besieche And preie hierafter for the pes,	P. iii. 372 [THE ABSOLUTION.] Amans. [LEAVE-TAKING OF VENUS.] P. iii. 373
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And that thou make a plein reles To love, which takth litel hiede Of olde men upon the nede, Whan that the lustes ben aweie: Forthi to thee nys bot o weie, In which let reson be thi guide;	
2920For he may sone himself misguide, That seth noght the peril tofore. Mi Sone, be wel war therfore, And kep the sentence of my lore And tarie thou mi Court nomore, Bot go ther vertu moral duelleth, 1772 Wher ben thi bokes, as men telleth, 1773 Whiche of long time thou hast write. For this I do thee wel to wite, If thou thin hele wolt pourchace,	
2930Thou miht noght make suite and chace, Wher that the game is nought pernable; 1774 It were a thing unresonable, A man to be so overseie. Forthi tak hiede of that I seie; For in the lawe of my comune We be noght schape to comune, Thiself and I, nevere after this. Now have y seid al that ther is 1775 Of love as for thi final ende:	P. iii. 374
2940*Adieu, for y mot fro the wende.' And with that word al sodeinly, Enclosid in a sterred sky, 1776 Venus, which is the qweene of love, Was take in to hire place above, More wiste y nought wher sche becam. 1777 And thus my leve of hire y nam, 1778 And forth with al the same tide Hire prest, which wolde nought abide, Or be me lief or be me loth,	P. iii. 375 P. iii. 376 P. iii. 377

2950 Out of my sighte forth he goth,
 And y was left with outhen helpe.
 So wiste I nought wher of to yelpe,
 Bot only that y hadde lore
 My time, and was sori ther fore.
 And thus bewhapid in my thought,
 Whan al was turnyd in to nought,
 I stod amasid for a while,
 And in my self y gan to smyle
 Thenkende uppon the bedis blake,
 2960 And how they weren me betake,
 For that y schulde bidde and preie.
 And whanne y sigh non othre weie
 Bot only that y was refusid,
 Unto the lif which y hadde usid
 I thoughte nevere torne ayein:
 And in this wise, soth to seyn,
 Homward a softe pas y wente,
 Wher that with al myn hol entente¹⁷⁷⁹
 Uppon the point that y am schryve
 2970 I thenke bidde whil y live.¹⁷⁸⁰

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 378

iv. *Parce precor, Criste, populus quo
 gaudeat iste;
 Anglia ne triste subeat, rex summe,
 resiste.*

[THE AUTHOR
 PRAYS FOR THE
 STATE OF
 ENGLAND.]

*Corrige quosque status, fragiles absolue reatus;
 Vnde deo gratus vigeat locus iste beatus.*

He which withinne daies sevene¹⁷⁸¹
 This large world forth with the hevene
 Of his eternal providence
 Hath mad, and thilke intelligence
 In mannys soule resonable
 Hath schape to be perdurable,
 Wherof the man of his feture
 Above alle erthli creature

Hic in anno
 quartodecimo
 Regis Ricardi orat
 pro statu regni,
 quod a diu diuisum
 nimia aduersitate
 periclitabatur.¹⁷⁸²

Aftir the soule is immortal,
2980 To thilke lord in special,
As he which is of alle thinges
The creatour, and of the kynges
Hath the fortunes uppon honde,
His grace and mercy forto fonde
Uppon my bare knes y preie,
That he this loud in siker weie
Wol sette uppon good governance. [1783](#)
For if men takyn remembrance
What is to live in unite, [1784](#)

P. iii.
379

2990 Ther ys no staat in his degree
That noughte to desire pes,
With outen which, it is no les,
To seche and loke in to the laste,
Ther may no worldes joye laste. [1785](#)

[EVIL OF DIVISION
IN THE LAND.]

Ferst forto loke the Clergie,
Hem oughte wel to justefie
Thing which belongeth to here cure,
As forto praie and to procure
Oure pes toward the hevene above,
3000 And ek to sette reste and love
Among ous on this erthe hiere.
For if they wroughte in this manere
Aftir the reule of charite,
I hope that men schuldyn se
This loud amende.

And ovyr this, [1786](#)

To seche and loke how that it is [1787](#)
Touchende of the chevalerie,
Which forto loke, in som partie
Is worthi forto be comendid,
3010 And in som part to ben amendid,
That of here large retenue
The lond is ful of maintenue,
Which causith that the comune right [1788](#)

P. iii.
380

In fewe contrees stant upright.
 Extorcioun, kontek, ravine¹⁷⁸⁹
 Withholde ben of that covyne,
 Aldai men hierin gret compleignte
 Of the desease, of the constreignte,
 Wher of the poeple is sore oppressid:
 3020 God graunte it mote be redressid.
 For of knyghthode thordre wolde
 That thei defende and kepe scholde
 The comun right and the fraunchise¹⁷⁹⁰
 Of holy cherche in alle wise,
 So that no wikke man it dere,
 And ther fore servith scheld and spere:¹⁷⁹¹
 Bot for it goth now other weie,
 Oure grace goth the more aweie.
 And forto lokyn ovyrmore,
 3030 Wher of the poeple pleigneth sore,
 Toward the lawis of oure lond,
 Men sein that trouthe hath broke his bond
 And with brocage is goon aweie,
 So that no man can se the weie
 Wher forto fynde rightwisnesse.
 And if men sechin sikernesse
 Uppon the lucre of marchandie,¹⁷⁹²
 Compasement and tricherie
 Of singuler profit to wyne,
 3040 Men seyn, is cause of mochil synne,
 And namely of divisioun,
 Which many a noble worthi toun
 Fro welthe and fro prosperite
 Hath brought to gret adversite.
 So were it good to ben al on,
 For mechil grace ther uppon¹⁷⁹³
 Unto the Citees schulde falle,
 Which myghte availle to ous alle,
 If these astatz amendid were,

3050 So that the vertus stodyn there
And that the vices were aweie:
Me thenkth y dorste thanne seie,
This londis grace schulde arise.

Bot yit to loke in othre wise,¹⁷⁹⁴
Ther is a stat, as ye schul hiere,
Above alle othre on erthe hiere,
Which hath the loud in his balance:
To him belongith the leiance
Of Clerk, of knyght, of man of lawe;

[THE DUTY OF A
KING.]

3060 Undir his hond al is forth drawe¹⁷⁹⁵
The marchant and the laborer;
So stant it al in his power
Or forto spille or forto save.¹⁷⁹⁶
Bot though that he such power have,
And that his myghtes ben so large,
He hath hem nought withouten charge,¹⁷⁹⁷
To which that every kyng ys swore:
So were it good that he ther fore
First un to rightwisnesse entende,

3070 Wherof that he hym self amende
Toward his god and leve vice,
Which is the chief of his office;
And aftir al the remenant
He schal uppon his covenant
Governe and lede in such a wise,
So that ther be no tirandise,
Wherof that he his poeple grieve,
Or ellis may he nought achieve
That longith to his regalie.

P. iii.
382

3080 For if a kyng wol justifie
His lond and hem that beth withynne,¹⁷⁹⁸
First at hym self he mot begynne,
To kepe and reule his owne astat,
That in hym self be no debat
Toward his god: for othre wise¹⁷⁹⁹

Ther may non erthly kyng suffise
 Of his kyngdom the folk to lede,
 Bot he the kyng of hevene drede.
 For what kyng sett hym uppon pride
 3090 And takth his lust on every side
 And wil nought go the righte weie,
 Though god his grace caste aweie
 No wondir is, for ate laste
 He schal wel wite it mai nought laste, [1800](#)
 The pompe which he secheth here.
 Bot what kyng that with humble chere
 Aftir the lawe of god eschuieth
 The vices, and the vertus suieth, [1801](#)
 His grace schal be suffisant
 3100 To governe al the remenant
 Which longith to his duite;
 So that in his prosperite
 The poeple schal nought ben oppressid,
 Wherof his name schal be blessid,
 For evere and be memorial.
 And now to speke as in final,
 Touchende that y undirtok
 In englesch forto make a book
 Which stant betwene ernest and game,
 3110 I have it maad as thilke same
 Which axe forto ben excusid,
 And that my bok be nought refusid
 Of lered men, whan thei it se, [1802](#)
 For lak of curiosite:
 For thilke scole of eloquence
 Belongith nought to my science,
 Uppon the forme of rethorike
 My wordis forto peinte and pike,
 As Tullius som tyme wrot.
 3120 Bot this y knowe and this y wot,
 That y have do my trewe peyne
 With rude wordis and with pleyne,

P. iii.
383

[THE BOOK
 COMPLETED.]

Hic in fine
 recapitulat super
 hoc quod in
 principio libri
 primi promisit se
 in amoris causa
 specialius
 tractaturum.
 Concludit enim
 quod omnis amoris
 delectacio extra
 caritatem nichil
 est. Qui autem
 manet in caritate,
 in deo manet.

In al that evere y couthe and myghte,
This bok to write as y behighte,
So as siknesse it soffre wolde;
And also for my daies olde,
That y am feble and impotent,
I wot nought how the world ys went.
So preye y to my lordis alle

3130 Now in myn age, how so befallle,
That y mot stonden in here grace:[1803](#)
For though me lacke to purchase
Here worthi thonk as by decerte,
Yit the symplesse of my poverté
Desireth forto do plesance
To hem undir whos governance
I hope siker to abide.

P. iii.
384

But now uppon my laste tide
That y this book have maad and write,

[FAREWELL TO
EARTHLY LOVE.]

3140 My muse doth me forto wite,
And seith it schal be for my beste
Fro this day forth to take reste,
That y nomore of love make,
Which many an herte hath overtake,
And ovyrturnd as the blynde
Fro reson in to lawe of kynde;
Wher as the wisdom goth aweie[1804](#)
And can nought se the ryhte weie
How to governe his oghne estat,

3150 Bot everydai stant in debat[1805](#)
Withinne him self, and can nought leve.
And thus forthy my final leve
I take now for evere more,
Withoute makynge any more,
Of love and of his dedly hele,
Which no phisicien can hele.
For his nature is so divers,
That it hath evere som travers
Or of to moche or of to lite,

3160 That plainly mai noman delite, [1806](#)

Bot if him faile or that or this.

P. iii.

Bot thilke love which that is

385

Withinne a mannes herte affermed,

And stant of charite confermed,

Such love is goodly forto have,

[HEAVENLY LOVE.]

Such love mai the bodi save,

Such love mai the soule amende,

The hye god such love ous sende

Forthwith the remenant of grace; [1807](#)

3170 So that above in thilke place

Wher resteth love and alle pes,

Oure joie mai ben endeles.

Explicit iste liber, qui transeat, obsecro liber

Vt sine liuore vigeat lectoris in ore.

Qui sedet in scannis celi det vt ista Iohannis

Perpetuis annis stet pagina grata Britannis.

Derbeie Comiti, recolunt quem laude periti, [1808](#)

Vade liber purus, sub eo requiesce futurus. [1809](#)

*Adieu, for I mot fro the wende.
2941* And gret wel Chaucer whan ye mete, [1810](#)
As mi disciple and mi poete:
For in the floures of his youthe
In sondri wise, as he wel couthe,
Of Ditees and of songes glade,
The whiche he for mi sake made,
The loud fulfild is overal:
Wherof to him in special
Above alle othre I am most holde. [1811](#)
2950For thi now in hise daies olde
Thow schalt him telle this message,
That he upon his latere age,
To sette an ende of alle his werk, [1812](#)
As he which is myn owne clerk,
Do make his testament of love,
As thou hast do thi schrifte above,
So that mi Court it mai recorde.’
‘Madame, I can me wel acorde,’
Quod I, ‘to telle as ye me bidde.’
2960* And with that word it so betidde, [1813](#)
Out of my sihte al sodeynly, [1814](#)
Enclosed in a sterred sky,
Up to the hevene Venus straghte, [1815](#)
And I my rihte weie cawhte, [1816](#)
Hom fro the wode and forth I wente, [1817](#)
Wher as with al myn hole entente, [1818](#)
Thus with mi bedes upon honde, [1819](#)
For hem that trewe love fonde
I thenke bidde whil I lyve
2970* Upon the poynt which I am schryve.

iv.* *Ad laudem Cristi, quem tu, virgo,
peperisti,
Sit laus Ricardi, quem sceptrum colunt
leopardi.
Ad sua precepta compleui carmina cepta,
Que Bruti nata legat Anglia perpetuata.*[1820](#)

[THE AUTHOR
PRAYS FOR THE
KING.]

He which withinne dayes sevene
This large world forth with the hevene
Of his eternal providence
Hath mad, and thilke intelligence[1821](#)
In mannes soule resonable
Enspired to himself semblable,
Wherof the man of his feture
Above alle erthly creature[1822](#)
After the soule is immortal,
2980¶ To thilke lord in special,
As he which is of alle thinges
The creatour, and of the kinges
Hath the fortunes upon honde,[1823](#)
His grace and mercy forto fonde
Upon mi bare knees I preye,
That he my worthi king conveye,
Richard by name the Secounde,[1824](#)
In whom hath evere yit be founde[1825](#)
Justice medled with pite,
2990¶ Largesce forth with charite.
In his persone it mai be schewed
What is a king to be wel thewed,
Touchinge of pite namely:
For he yit nevere unpitously
Ayein the liges of his lond,[1826](#)
For no defaute which he fond,
Thurgh cruelte vengance soghte;
And thogh the worldes chaunce in broghte[1827](#)
Of infortune gret debat,

Hic in fine libri
honorificos que
virtuosos
illustrissimi
Principis domini
sui Regis Anglie
Ricardi secundi
mores, sicut
dignum est, laude
commendabili
describens, pro
eiusdem status
salubri
conseruacione
cunctipotentem
deuocius exorat.

[THE KING
COMMENDED.]

3000¶ It was he not infortunat:
 For he which the fortune ladde,
 The hihe god, him overspradde
 Of his Justice, and kepte him so, [1828](#)
 That his astat stood evere mo
 Sauf, as it oghte wel to be; [1829](#)
 Lich to the Sonne in his degree,
 Which with the clowdes up alofte
 Is derked and bischadewed ofte, [1830](#)
 But hou so that it trowble in their, [1831](#)

3010¶ The Sonne is evere briht and feir,
 Withinne himself and noght empeired: [1832](#)
 Although the weder be despeired,
 The hed planete is not to wite. [1833](#)
 Mi worthi prince, of whom I write,
 Thus slant he with himselve clier, [1834](#)
 And doth what lith in his power [1835](#)
 Not only hier at hom to seke [1836](#)
 Love and acord, but outward eke, [1837](#)
 As he that save his poeple wolde.

3020¶ So ben we alle wel beholde [1838](#)
 To do service and obeyssaunce
 To him, which of his heyh suffraunce [1839](#)
 Hath many a gret debat appesed, [1840](#)
 To make his lige men ben esed; [1841](#)
 Wherfore that his Croniqe schal
 For evere be memorial
 To the loenge of that he doth. [1842](#)
 For this wot every man in soth,
 What king that so desireth pes, [1843](#)

3030¶ He takth the weie which Crist ches:
 And who that Cristes weies sueth,
 It proveth wel that he eschueth
 The vices and is vertuous, [1844](#)
 Wherof he mot be gracious

Toward his god and acceptable.
 And so to make his regne stable, [1845](#)
 With al the wil that I mai yive
 I preie and schal whil that I live,
 As I which in subjeccioun
 3040*Stonde under the proteccioun, [1846](#)
 And mai miselven not bewelde, [1847](#)
 What for seknesse and what for elde, [1848](#)
 Which I receyve of goddes grace.
 But thogh me lacke to purchase
 Mi kinges thonk as by decerte, [1849](#)
 Yit the Simplese of mi poverte
 Unto the love of my ligance
 Desireth forto do plesance:
 And for this cause in myn entente
 3050*This povere bok heer I presente [1850](#)
 Unto his hihe worthinesse,
 Write of my simple besinesse, [1851](#)
 So as seknesse it suffre wolde. [1852](#)
 And in such wise as I ferst tolde,
 Whan I this bok began to make, [1853](#)
 In som partie it mai be take [1854](#)
 As for to lawhe and forto pleye;
 And forto loke in other weye, [1855](#)
 It mai be wisdom to the wise:
 3060*So that somdel for good aprise [1856](#)
 And eek somdel for lust and game [1857](#)
 I have it mad, as thilke same [1858](#)
 Which axe forto ben excused, [1859](#)
 That I no Rethorike have used
 Upon the forme of eloquence,
 For that is not of mi science;
 But I have do my trewe peyne
 With rude wordes and with pleyne
 To speke of thing which I have told. [1860](#)

[THE AUTHOR
 PRESENTS HIS BOOK
 TO THE KING.]

3070* But now that I am feble and old,¹⁸⁶¹
And to the worschipe of mi king
In love above alle other thing¹⁸⁶²
That I this bok have mad and write,¹⁸⁶³
Mi Muse doth me forto wite¹⁸⁶⁴
That it is to me for the beste
Fro this day forth to take reste,¹⁸⁶⁵
That I nomore of love make.¹⁸⁶⁶
But he which hath of love his make¹⁸⁶⁷
It sit him wel to singe and daunce,¹⁸⁶⁸

[FAREWELL TO
EARTHLY LOVE.]

3080* And do to love his entendance
In songes bothe and in seyinges
After the lust of his pleyinges,
For he hath that he wolde have:
But where a man schal love crave¹⁸⁶⁹
And faile, it stant al otherwise.¹⁸⁷⁰
In his proverbe seith the wise,
Whan game is best, is best to leve:¹⁸⁷¹
And thus forthi my fynal leve,
With oute makyng eny more,¹⁸⁷²

3090* take now for evere more
Of love and of his dedly hele,¹⁸⁷³
Which no phisicien can hele.
For his nature is so divers,
That it hath evere som travers
Or of to moche or of to lite,
That fully mai noman delyte,
But if him lacke or that or this.¹⁸⁷⁴
But thilke love which that is
Withinne a mannes herte affermed,

3100* And stant of charite confermed,
That love is of no repentaile;
For it ne berth no contretaile,
Which mai the conscience charge,
But it is rather of descharge,¹⁸⁷⁵

[HEAVENLY LOVE.]

And meedful heer and overal.
 Forthi this love in special^{[1876](#)}
 Is good for every man to holde,^{[1877](#)}
 And who that resoun wol beholde,^{[1878](#)}
 Al other lust is good to daunte:
 3110*Which thing the hihe god us graunte^{[1879](#)}
 Forth with the remenant of grace
 So that of hevene in thilke place
 Wher resteth love and alle pes,^{[1880](#)}
 Oure joye mai ben endeles.^{[1881](#)}

FOOTNOTES:

- [1454](#) 13 the *om.* AM ... B₂, AdBTΔΔ, W
[1455](#) 37 wiste AJ, F wist C, B
[1456](#) 48 his A
[1457](#) 60 Cham AJ Chaym (Caym) H₁ ... B₂, AdBT, W
[1458](#) 71 Cham AJM Chaym (Caym) H₁ ... B₂, AdBT, W
[1459](#) 72 Delbora H₁ ... B₂ (Debora E), Δ, W
[1460](#) 77 into A, FW vnto CLB₂, B
[1461](#) 79 the *om.* A
[1462](#) 98 Habraham J, FK *rest* Abraham
[1463](#) 100 was þo AML
[1464](#) 136 tribus MH₁CB₂, TΔ, W Irahel (Israel) J, FK *rest* Israel
[1465](#) 145 bode H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1466](#) 148 it *om.* GC, BΔ
[1467](#) 170 in such AdBTΔ
[1468](#) 177 I myhte AM
[1469](#) 185 The AM, W
[1470](#) 188 such AJ, B suche F
[1471](#) 210 *margin* impune *om.* BT, W *inpunitum* E
[1472](#) 212 *margin* priuauit] preliauit H₁ ... B₂
[1473](#) 205 so *om.* AdBT
[1474](#) 228 vnto MCL, BT
[1475](#) 231 and made] he made AM ... B₂, AdTB
[1476](#) 237 gret AC, B grete F
[1477](#) 239 not (nought) goode AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1478](#) 245 Irahel *as in* l. 136
[1479](#) 257 And þat AdBT
[1480](#) 262 ago AM ... B₂, AdBTΔ
[1481](#) 280 *margin* ipse prius FK, *om.* A ... B₂, BT (*Lat. om.* AdΔ, W)
[1482](#) 291 chambre (chamber) MH₁XC, AdBTΔ, WK
[1483](#) 293 and] of AM ... B₂, AdBT

[1484](#) 298 The king H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1485](#) 310 which *om.* B
[1486](#) 337 S *resumes*
[1487](#) 354 the *om.* AdBT, W
[1488](#) 355 how þat H₁ ... B₂, AdB
[1489](#) 358 soghte (soughte) A ... CB₂, SAdTB (In al wise he him be þowt Δ)
[1490](#) 362 that *om.* BTΔ, W
[1491](#) 371 þis wise EB₂, BΔ
[1492](#) 403 sturne F sterne A, SB lok] word B
[1493](#) 416 of of F
[1494](#) 419 this] þat AdBT the B₂
[1495](#) 428 *margin* Indignacio—Appolini *om.* SΔ (*as also the marginal notes following down to l. 1020*)
[1496](#) 443 his *om.* B
[1497](#) 446 esmaied JEC, S, FK amaied (amayed) AMH₁XGRLB₂, AdBT
dismaied Δ, W
[1498](#) 462 tyde AMX, W
[1499](#) 467 *margin* mare *om.*
[1500](#) F as evere he] as he H₁ ... B₂, Ad as þey BT
[1501](#) 469 In] Her(e) AdBTΔ be] ben wiþ AdBTΔΔ, W
[1502](#) 471 hale up] haleþ AM ... B₂, AdBTΔ
[1503](#) 483 deelful (deleful) AML, W deedful (dedful) H₁ ... CB₂, AdTA dedly B
[1504](#) 492 stonden B₂, AdBTΔ, WK
[1505](#) 496 *margin* Nota *om.* A ... B₂, BT (*Lat. om.* SAdΔ)
[1506](#) 505 Taliart F Thaliart AJ, SB
[1507](#) 507 box AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1508](#) 510 spare he FK *rest* spare
[1509](#) 513 Taliart J, F Thaliart A, SB
[1510](#) 535 He] His F
[1511](#) 539 which B
[1512](#) 548 him H₁, AdBT
[1513](#) 553 whan (when) AJC, B whanne S, F
[1514](#) 565 the *om.* AMH₁XRL, Ad a B
[1515](#) 566 him FWK it ACLB₂, B
[1516](#) 568 So as] So þat AM ... B₂ (So as G)
[1517](#) 573 *margin* prenuiciauit B preminuit M
[1518](#) 571 a route AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1519](#) 574 the which on knees] which on his knees E, B which on knees
H₁XRLB₂, AdTΔ
[1520](#) 582 no] for no H₁E ... B₂
[1521](#) 590 As in telling(e) AM, AdT ffor as in telling(e) H₁ ... B₂
[1522](#) 598 ygon B
[1523](#) 620 avou (avow) A, B, F a vow (a vou) J, S, K
[1524](#) 624 altobroke A, S, F al tobroke C, B al to broke J
[1525](#) 633 Therof (Ther of) A ... B₂, AdBT Wherefore W
[1526](#) 635 a *om.* AMR
[1527](#) 636 was whilom AM ... B₂, AdBT was som tyme J
[1528](#) 667 Than (Thanne) AM ... B₂, AdBT afterward B
[1529](#) 677 As was herd AdBT
[1530](#) 680 game MH₁, AdBTΔ, W gamis X

[1531](#) 685 As] And AM ... B₂, AdBT tho] þe H₁ ... B₂, AdBT, WK *om.* Δ
[1532](#) 697 *margin* aula A ... B₂, BT
[1533](#) 705 schulde (scholde) AdBT, W
[1534](#) 714 his Mareschal of h. J, S, FK his Marchal of his h. AM ... CB₂, BT his
marschal of the h. Δ, W þe Marchal of his h. Ad (ll. 704-714 *om.* L)
[1535](#) 718 hadde B
[1536](#) 732 *margin* maxime ingemiscebat A ... B₂, BT (*Latin om.* SAdΔ)
[1537](#) 747 of þis worldes aghte J, SΔ, FWK þer of (þerof) which I aughte AM ...
B₂, AdBT
[1538](#) 748 I þer(e) H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1539](#) 772 taakþ (takeþ) AM
[1540](#) 782 he] it AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1541](#) 786 hou that] of þat AH₁ ... B₂, AdBT þat M howe W
[1542](#) 787 he was] it was H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1543](#) 809 that] þe H₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1544](#) 817 he scholde AdB
[1545](#) 827 Hire] He AdBT
[1546](#) 829 of Citole] citole B and citole K
[1547](#) 830 tun] time X, B
[1548](#) 839 wolde AdBT
[1549](#) 845 Touching(e) AM ... B₂, AdBTΔ
[1550](#) 852 may so AMR
[1551](#) 856 and in game] what in game ME, B and what in game CLB₂, AdT
[1552](#) 859 and drinke MCL, BT of drinkyng W
[1553](#) 860 that *om.* AMH₁
[1554](#) 872 hir(e) honour AJH₁ ... L, AdBT
[1555](#) 875 to make AdBT
[1556](#) 892 put AJ, S, F putte C, B
[1557](#) 928 þe worldes A ... B₂, AdT
[1558](#) 946 fadres (faders) AM ... B₂ (*except E*), AdΔ
[1559](#) 950 *Paragraph here* F ther] al (alle) AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1560](#) 958 which was] þat was W was Ad was riht AM ... B₂, BT
[1561](#) 961 and gret AMH₁E ... B₂, BT and of gret X
[1562](#) 962 many man AH₁EC, AdBT many men X
[1563](#) 970 lede B
[1564](#) 975 spousesales FK
[1565](#) 979 adai (aday) J, F a dai (a day) AC, SB
[1566](#) 994 was FWK is A ... B₂, S ... Δ
[1567](#) 1000 forto smyte AM
[1568](#) 1009 liuen in AH₁ ... B₂, AdBTΔ
[1569](#) 1024 lengerr F
[1570](#) 1047 here (her) AC, SB hire J, F
[1571](#) 1056 deide AdBT
[1572](#) 1060 a swoune JC, SB, F aswoune A
[1573](#) 1063 and my desir AdBT, W and desir J
[1574](#) 1069 it myhte FWK
[1575](#) 1076 For evere] Was euer(e) AH₁ ... B₂, AdBT Was neuere M
[1576](#) 1098 *Latin here and at* 1122, 1141, 1151, 1324, 1373, 1424 *om.* SΔ (*up to*
2029 *om.* Δ)
[1577](#) 1102 *margin* obtusa que C, B obtusaque A, F

[1578](#) 1106 *marg.* in mari A ... B₂, BT
[1579](#) 1107 þis AdBT
[1580](#) 1110 sich (siche, swiche) AJMRB₂, BΔ, W such(suche) H₁XECL, SAdT, FK
[1581](#) 1120 of jeueals a] of Ieweles (Iewels) AM ... B₂, AdBT of the Ieweles a W
[1582](#) 1128 tak AJ, S, F take C, B
[1583](#) 1131 whan (when) AJ, SB whanne F
[1584](#) 1142 This prince AJM, SΔ
[1585](#) 1156 *margin* suum *om.* A ... B₂, BT
[1586](#) 1168 the] þis BΔ, W
[1587](#) 1178 was iwounde (I wounde &c.) AM ... L was I bounde B₂ lay ywounde AdBT
[1588](#) 1184 which ... is] þat ... was AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1589](#) 1206 Ha *om.* MXR, AdBT, W
[1590](#) 1222 hol (hool) C, B, F hole AB₂
[1591](#) 1224 *margin* sacro] facto BT
[1592](#) 1240 sih] seiþ AML
[1593](#) 1252 *line om.* B
[1594](#) 1253 schal] haþ AdBT
[1595](#) 1258 took(e) LB₂ AdBT, W
[1596](#) 1260 made AH₁ ... B₂, AdBT
[1597](#) 1274 seiled AdBT
[1598](#) 1277 And FW Tho ACLB₂, B
[1599](#) 1293 whiche A, S, F which JC, B
[1600](#) 1315 And parceiuen þat it B
[1601](#) 1319 þe FW his ACLB₂, B
[1602](#) 1334 worþe J, F worþ AC, SB
[1603](#) 1364 wher þat AM ... B₂, AdBT, W
[1604](#) 1371 swer(e) E ... B₂, K sware X
[1605](#) 1373 *margin* occideret A ... B₂, BT
[1606](#) 1374 cherlissh (cherlische &c.) H₁ ... B₂, AdBT, K
[1607](#) 1375 wher(e) H₁ ... B₂, AdBTΔ, W
[1608](#) 1378 *margin* Pirate ibidem prope] Pirate ibidem A ... B₂ ibidem BT
[1609](#) 1383 *margin* reddiderunt AM
[1610](#) 1388 þat sche AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1611](#) 1389 and þis cry A
[1612](#) 1399 thei] sche B
[1613](#) 1413 fecchen (fechen) AM ... B₂, AdB sechen T
[1614](#) 1415 hir] he AM ... B₂, AdBT1
[1615](#) 1416 And þat he by (be) H₁ ... B₂ And þat by AM
[1616](#) 1423 *Paragraph here in MSS.*
[1617](#) 1424 No wonder þough sche were wo B No wonder þogh sche be wo Ad
[1618](#) 1435 nomen wolde þer noght come K nomen wolden þeer (þer) come AM
no man (noman) wolde þer(e) come H₁ ... B₂, AdBT mo men wolde ther none come W
[1619](#) 1447 kneled BTΔ
[1620](#) 1450 good BT
[1621](#) 1456 be of rel. AM ... B₂, BT
[1622](#) 1465 Which þat AM ... B₂, BT
[1623](#) 1476 fro] of AM ... B₂, BT

[1624](#) 1484 eny AM ... B₂, B
[1625](#) 1503 *margin* configentes F
[1626](#) 1500 Theophile AJC, T, F Theophil B
[1627](#) 1505 ich haue AM
[1628](#) 1509 kepeþ BT
[1629](#) 1512 Now se her after B Now hiere after T
[1630](#) 1513 sorweth] crieþ BT
[1631](#) 1523 make BT *om.* W
[1632](#) 1534 the *om.* AM, Δ, W
[1633](#) 1544 forto clare] to declare AM ... B₂, BT
[1634](#) 1555 told A, B, F tolde C
[1635](#) 1593 *margin* celebrari A ... B₂, BT, W
[1636](#) 1590 *Paragraph here* FWK, at 1595 in most other copies
[1637](#) 1621 þat cite H₁XELB₂, BT
[1638](#) 1633 be] were B
[1639](#) 1637 which a s. AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1640](#) 1641 so] þe AM
[1641](#) 1646 here LB₂, Δ, W
[1642](#) 1649 *Paragraph here* ALB₂, BT at 1652 J, SAd, FW Tho] Thus A ... B₂
[1643](#) 1661 all(e) þe weies AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1644](#) 1683 many F many a ALB₂, B, W
[1645](#) 1687 madd man S madd mad man F
[1646](#) 1710 hol B, F hole AB₂
[1647](#) 1713 was FW is ALB₂, B
[1648](#) 1715 that *om.* AM, W
[1649](#) 1732 toke J, S, F tok (took) AEC, B
[1650](#) 1750 þat lond AJM, SΔ
[1651](#) 1754 maiden] doughter B
[1652](#) 1756 which was þo h. AM
[1653](#) 1761 of yong] zong of E, B
[1654](#) 1790 þe king JC
[1655](#) 1792 vnto H₁ ... B₂, AdB, W
[1656](#) 1836 he in F in he A ... B₂, S ... Δ, WK
[1657](#) 1842 euidence AdBT
[1658](#) 1843 thanne aboute] al (alle) aboute AM ... B₂, AdT þer aboute B
[1659](#) 1854 aswowe AM aswoven B
[1660](#) 1861 That] Which AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1661](#) 1877 þe queene AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1662](#) 1890 topseil(e) cole H₁ ... B₂, AdBTΔ, W
[1663](#) 1892 havene] haue C, AdBT, W þe hauen B₂
[1664](#) 1911 what he w. X ... B₂, AdBT
[1665](#) 1912 ff. *margin* Qualiter—fecit *om.* BΔ
[1666](#) 1920 lord B
[1667](#) 1921 thanne] þat AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1668](#) 1924 Wher of (Wherof) H₁ ... B₂, AdBT, W
[1669](#) 1927 And FW A ACLB₂, B
[1670](#) 1928 Up to] Vpon AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1671](#) 1931 on honde AM ... B₂, AdBT, W
[1672](#) 1939 he herde AM, W
[1673](#) 1940 wiste(n) how it AM ... B₂, AdBT, W

[1674](#) 1967 In which AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1675](#) 1973 wil (wol) conceyue H₁EL, W wol(e) resceyue AdBT
[1676](#) 1978 is befalle AdB, W was falle L
[1677](#) 1992 was him AM, Δ, W
[1678](#) 1999 his lif was write A ... B₂, S ... Δ as it is write FWK
[1679](#) 2006 he hadde al] he hadde J, SΔ (had) hadde (had) AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1680](#) 2009 *margin* Confessor ad Amantem *om.* JEC, AdBT Confessor B₂, Δ, W
[1681](#) 2047 skile] sike AdBT
[1682](#) 2056 let S, F lete AJ, B
[1683](#) 2062 truffles AJC, S, F trifles (triffles) L, B travaux W
[1684](#) 2071 Conseile J, S, F Conseil (Counseil) AC, B
[1685](#) 2073 Thi (py) cause A ... B₂, S ... Δ where] þer B
[1686](#) 2086 noght faile] auaile AM ... B₂, AdBT (*line om.* R)
[1687](#) 2095 sett] siþe (siþ, seþþe &c.) JH₁ERLB₂, AdBT, W sertein if Δ
[1688](#) 2098 it is H₁, FK is it AJMX ... B₂, S ... Δ, W
[1689](#) 2104 This BT Thi Ad And W
[1690](#) 2106 so be befalle F
[1691](#) 2134 set AJ, S, F sette CLB₂, B
[1692](#) 2138 agon (a goon) H₁RCB₂, AdBT, W
[1693](#) 2153 That feelen noght of þat (*om.* I fiele) A That feelen noght. be likned to
 þe herte M
[1694](#) 2178 while AM ... B₂, AdBT, W
[1695](#) 2179 no certein AdBT the] þo AM
[1696](#) 2180 if] wher AM ... B₂, AdBT
[1697](#) 2195 techinge J, SΔ, FWK touchyng (touching) AM ... B₂, AdBTΔ
[1698](#) 2203 þei (þey) acorden AdBT
[1699](#) 2214 wol(e) AdBT
[1700](#) 2220 or I trauaile J, S, F *the rest* or trauaile
[1701](#) 2228 a love] of loue AM ... B₂, BT (Haþ love of kinde 3it Ad)
[1702](#) 2240 was] is AdBT
[1703](#) 2247 þurghout BT
[1704](#) 2251 3elpe AdBTΔ
[1705](#) 2257 I fynde BTΔ
[1706](#) 2270 his *om.* B
[1707](#) 2271 wher AdBT
[1708](#) 2284 þis infortune AdBT þilke fortune B₂, Δ that ilke infortune W
[1709](#) 2294 gentile AJ, S, F gentil C, B
[1710](#) 2298 wold J, S, F wolde AC, B
[1711](#) 2319 agame AJMRL, AdT in game Δ in grame W
[1712](#) 2320 is] was A ... B₂, SBTΔ
[1713](#) 2332 if] it AMXE ... B₂, B
[1714](#) 2334 Hire B
[1715](#) 2342 disteigned AH₁XRLB₂ distreigned M restreigned E
[1716](#) 2367 f. *Two lines om.* S ... Δ (*ins.* Δ)
[1717](#) 2368 The which is holsom to þe seke H₁ ... B₂
[1718](#) 2369 f.

Noght al as þou desire woldest
 Bot so as þou be resoun scholdest

S ... Δ

[1719](#) 2371-2376 *Six lines om.* S ... Δ

[1720](#) *Latin Verses* iii. 8 obsequium] obsessum X ... L obsessum B₂

[1721](#) 2379 ff. *margin* Hic in exemplum—redarguit] Hic narrat qualiter indignata Venus, amantis languidi infirmitatem inspiciens, ne quid amplius in curia sua attemptare presumat, ipsum insufficientem tanquam pro medicina pluribus exemplis exhortabatur S ... ΔΔ

[1722](#) 2386 tome S, F to me AJC, B

[1723](#) 2387 wolde H₁ ... B₂, AdBT

[1724](#) 2403 Mi loues AM, Δ My loue AdBT (*Ad ends with this line*)

[1725](#) 2409 with *om.* AM ... B₂, BT

[1726](#) 2428 sitte AJC, F sit B

[1727](#) 2433 if þat þou wel bepought (be þought) X ... B₂, BTΔ if that thou wel the be thouht H₁

[1728](#) 2436 The which AM ... B₂, BTΔ (þat whilom was þe grene gras Δ)

[1729](#) 2437 as time now AM ... B₂, BTΔ

[1730](#) 2441 Than I AM, BΔ Whan I H₁ ... B₂, T

[1731](#) 2442 And wist(e) wel AM ... B₂, BTΔ

[1732](#) 2445 ferd AJ, S, F ferde C, B

[1733](#) 2446 And cold AM

[1734](#) 2462 *line om.* B

[1735](#) 2476 *margin* Pan id est deus nature A ... B₂

[1736](#) 2497 It was AM ... B₂, BT

[1737](#) 2543 Priamus AM, B, W

[1738](#) 2573 graue BT

[1739](#) 2575 Alquik F Al quik AJ, SB, K

[1740](#) 2598 þere F þer (þer) AJC, B

[1741](#) 2623 Vluxe BT

[1742](#) 2646 Lo, if] See wher AM ... B₂, BT

[1743](#) 2650 Which Ceix (*om.* to) B Which to seke X Which for to se W

[1744](#) 2653 wawe A ... B₂, S ... Δ

[1745](#) 2656 which] þat AM ... B₂, BT

[1746](#) 2664 he lay X, BT (*line om.* Δ *p. m.*)

[1747](#) 2670 manye] fele AM ... B₂, BT

[1748](#) 2672 here visage AM ... B₂, BT

[1749](#) 2675 pipes AM ... B₂, BT piper Δ

[1750](#) 2676 noise] merþe AM ... B₂, BT

[1751](#) 2678 sowned AM ... B₂, BT

[1752](#) 2694 Iuesses eek AM Iues boþe (Iewes both) KW Iewes (Iues &c.) eek H₁ ... B₂, BT

[1753](#) 2696 wher he was AM wher(e) he were X ... B₂, BT if he were H₁, W

[1754](#) 2701 no wonder B

[1755](#) 2702 put AJ, F putte C, B

[1756](#) 2706 so] also E, BT þo Δ

[1757](#) 2769 benyce J, S, FK be nyce (by nice &c.) AM ... B₂, BTΔ, W

[1758](#) 2775 *margin* Nota LB₂, F Nota bene C *om.* A ... R, SBTΔ, WK

[1759](#) 2796 pitte F putte AJC, SB

[1760](#) 2809 whiche S, F which AJC, B

[1761](#) 2819 *margin* Nota contra senes voluptuosos, quorum calor refrigescente natura extinctus est SBTΔ (*om.* Δ)

[1762](#) 2833 Outwiþ SΔ, FWK Out wiþ AJM, TΛ Therwiþ (Ther wiþ) H₁ ... B₂ On
 which B
[1763](#) 2837 *margin* equiperatur A equipatur C, BT, F
[1764](#) 2848 of flour of lef AM ... CB₂ and floure of leef L
[1765](#) 2850 þis time H₁ ... B₂
[1766](#) 2856 Somerfare S, F somer fare AJC, B
[1767](#) 2860 straied] frayed AM ... B₂
[1768](#) 2885 forth] for EC, BTΛ
[1769](#) 2889 for to laste BT
[1770](#) 2899 the *om.* AM
[1771](#) 2907 pur AM ... B₂, B, W pour H₁, T
[1772](#) 2925 moral vertu AM ... B₂, W vertu morar S
[1773](#) 2926 Wher ben þe M, TΛ Ther ben þe B
[1774](#) 2931 pernable J, SΔ, FK parnable W prouable (prouable) AM ... B₂, BTΛ
[1775](#) 2938 *Here begins a new hand in F and ll. 2938-2966 are over an erasure.*
[1776](#) 2942 serred S
[1777](#) 2945 wiste ST wist B, F
[1778](#) 2946 hire (hir) BTΛ, WK here S, F
[1779](#) 2968 hol B, F hole S
[1780](#) 2970 lieue F
[1781](#) 2971 The J, B
[1782](#) 2973 ff. *margin* Hic in anno—periclitabatur SΔ, FK *om.* BTΛ, W
[1783](#) 2987 Wol] Wel S
[1784](#) 2989 liue BTΛ, W lieue S, FK
[1785](#) 2994 wordles F
[1786](#) 3005 f. *Paragraph begins* And ouer þis S To seche FWK *No Paragraph*
 BT
[1787](#) 3006 how þat is B howe it is W
[1788](#) 3013 comune (commune) SBT, F comyn W
[1789](#) 3015 kontek FK context SBT Contek W kontek and Magd contel and Δ
[1790](#) 3023 comun B, F comune ST
[1791](#) 3026 þer fore (þerfore) FK þerof (þer of) SBTΛ, W
[1792](#) 3037 machandie F merchandie S
[1793](#) 3046 mechil F mekull W mochil SBT
[1794](#) 3054 oþre wise S, F oþer w. BTΛ, WK
[1795](#) 3060 is al B
[1796](#) 3063 forto ... forto S for to ... forto F for to ... for to BT
[1797](#) 3066 wiþouten F wiþoute SBT
[1798](#) 3081 beþ F ben (be) SBTΛ, WK
[1799](#) 3085 oþre wise F oþrewise S oþerwise BT othir wyse W
[1800](#) 3094 nouȝt F noght S nought B not T, W
[1801](#) 3098 vertu B
[1802](#) 3113 whanne F
[1803](#) 3131 mot ST, W mote B, F
[1804](#) 3147 *Hand in F changes again*
[1805](#) 3150 euerydai F euery day SBT
[1806](#) 3160 noman F no man SBT
[1807](#) 3169 fforþwiþ F fforþ wiþ SBT
[1808](#) EXPLICIT 5 f. *Last two lines om.* AJCL
[1809](#) 6 sub eo *que* recumbe S

[1810](#) 2941* ff. *This conclusion is in first recension copies only, A ... B₂ &c. But*
 ll. 2941*-2961* *also in Λ. All variations from A are noted.*
[1811](#) 2949* moost A
[1812](#) 2953* eende A al J
[1813](#) 2960* world AMX betidde (bitidde) JH₁ECB₂ by tydde (be tidde) AMRL
[1814](#) 2961* sihte (sighte) JR syht (sight) AMH₁ECLB₂
[1815](#) 2963* f. straghte: cawhte AM strauhte: cauhte J straght(e): caght(e) RL
 straughte: caughte EC
[1816](#) 2964* rihte (rihte) JEC riht (right) AMH₁R
[1817](#) 2965* Hoom AM and om. C
[1818](#) 2966* hole J hoole AM
[1819](#) 2967* f. hoonde: foonde AM
[1820](#) *Latin Verses* iv.* 3 ceptra AM
[1821](#) 2974* mad J maad A
[1822](#) 2978* erply C eerpli AM erpely JH₁ERLB₂
[1823](#) 2983* f. hoonde: foonde AM
[1824](#) 2987* be J
[1825](#) 2988* byfounde A by founde M
[1826](#) 2995* f. loond: foond A
[1827](#) 2998* inbroughte JH₁
[1828](#) 3003* kepte ECB₂ kept AJMH₁RL
[1829](#) 3005* bee A
[1830](#) 3008* bischadewed (byshadewed) AMH₁E by schadewed (by shadowed)
 RCLB₂ beschaded J
[1831](#) 3009* Bot JH₁
[1832](#) 3011* Wipin AM
[1833](#) 3013* hed (hede) JM heed A heued H₁E ... B₂
[1834](#) 3015* f. clier: power J cleer: poweer A
[1835](#) 3016* doop AM
[1836](#) 3017* only hier at hom to seke J oonly heer athoom to seeke A
[1837](#) 3018* acord JER acorde AC eeke AEC
[1838](#) 3020* been AMC by holde AM
[1839](#) 3022* hihe H₁RLB₂ hie J
[1840](#) 3023* a gret (agret) JCL a grete (agrete) AMH₁ &c.
[1841](#) 3024* been A
[1842](#) 3037* f. doop: soop AMR
[1843](#) 3029* f. pees: chees AMR
[1844](#) 3033* f. vertuows: graciows AM
[1845](#) 3036* And for to CB₂ maake A
[1846](#) 3040* Stoonde AM the] his J
[1847](#) 3041* by welde AMH₁
[1848](#) 3042* sekenesse AMH₁R
[1849](#) 3045* be J
[1850](#) 3050* bok J book AC
[1851](#) 3052* besynesse (besynesse) JH₁RL besynesse A busynesse C
[1852](#) 3053* seeknesse (seknesse) JC seeknesse (sekenesse &c.) AMH₁R
[1853](#) 3055* book by gan to maake A
[1854](#) 3056* by taake A
[1855](#) 3058* looke A ooper AM
[1856](#) 3060* f. somdeel A

[1857](#) 3061* of game J
[1858](#) 3062* as AJM for H₁XRCLB₂
[1859](#) 3063* been A
[1860](#) 3069* f. toold: oold A
[1861](#) 3070* Bot J
[1862](#) 3072* ooper A
[1863](#) 3073* book A &c.
[1864](#) 3074* doop AM
[1865](#) 3076* taake A
[1866](#) 3077* nomoore of loue maake A
[1867](#) 3078* Bot J maake A
[1868](#) 3079* sit J sitte AMRCLB₂
[1869](#) 3084* Bot J
[1870](#) 3085* alooperwise A
[1871](#) 3087* Whan game is beste A
[1872](#) 3089* f. moore: moore A
[1873](#) 3091* f. heele: heele AM
[1874](#) 3097* f. Bot J
[1875](#) 3104* Bot J
[1876](#) 3106* love om. AM
[1877](#) 3107* hoolde A
[1878](#) 3108* wol byholde (biholde) ARCL wil biholde B₂ wel be holde J wel
 byholde M
[1879](#) 3110* ous J
[1880](#) 3113* pees AMC
[1881](#) 3114* been endelees AM *At the end* Amen MXERCLB₂

**[1882](#) Epistola super huius opusculi sui complementum
Iohanni Gower a quodam philosopho transmissa.**

Quam cinxere freta, Gower, tua carmina leta
 Per loca discreta canit Anglia laude repleta.
 Carminis Athleta, satirus, tibi, siue Poeta,
 Sit laus completa quo gloria stat sine meta.

**[1883](#) Quia [1884](#) vnusquisque, prout a deo accepit, aliis
 impartiri tenetur, Iohannes Gower super hiis que deus sibi
 sensualiter [1885](#) donauit villicacionis sue rationem, dum
 tempus instat, [1886](#) secundum aliquid alleuiare
 cupiens, [1887](#) inter labores et ocia ad aliorum noticiam tres**

libros doctrine causa forma subsequenti propterea composuit.

Primus liber Gallico sermone editus in decem diuiditur partes, et tractans de viciis et virtutibus,¹⁸⁸⁸ necnon et de variis huius seculi gradibus,¹⁸⁸⁹ viam qua peccator transgressus ad sui creatoris agnitionem redire debet, recto tramite docere conatur. Titulusque¹⁸⁹⁰ libelli istius Speculum Meditantis¹⁸⁹¹ nuncupatus est.

¹⁸⁹²Secundus enim liber sermone latino metrico compositus tractat de variis infortuniis tempore Regis Ricardi Secundi in Anglia contingentibus. Vnde non solum regni proceres et communes tormenta passi sunt, set et ipse crudelissimus rex suis ex demeritis ab alto corruens in foueam quam fecit finaliter proiectus est. Nomenque voluminis huius Vox Clamantis intitulatur.

¹⁸⁹³Tercius iste liber qui ob reuerenciam strenuissimi domini sui domini Henrici de Lancastria, tunc Derby Comitis, Anglico sermone conficitur, secundum Danielis prophetiam super huius mundi regnorum mutacione a tempore regis Nabugodonosor vsque¹⁸⁹⁴ nunc tempora distinguit.¹⁸⁹⁵ Tractat etiam secundum Aristotilem¹⁸⁹⁶ super hiis quibus rex Alexander tam in sui regimen¹⁸⁹⁷ quam aliter¹⁸⁹⁸ eius disciplina edoctus fuit. Principalis tamen huius operis¹⁸⁹⁹ materia¹⁹⁰⁰ super amorem et infatuatas amantium passiones fundamentum habet. Nomenque sibi appropriatum Confessio Amantis specialiter¹⁹⁰¹ sortitus est.

FOOTNOTES:

¹⁸⁸² EPISTOLA huius operis sui AJECL huius operis vel opusculi sui XRB₂ huius opusculi Δ

¹⁸⁸³ QUIA VNUSQUISQUE *ins.* AJXERCLB₂, BTA, F *om.* SΔ, Magd (MH₁G, Ad, WKH₃ *defective at the end*)

¹⁸⁸⁴ 1 Qvuiia F

¹⁸⁸⁵ 2 sensualiter] intellectualiter A ... B₂

¹⁸⁸⁶ 3 dum tempus instat *om.* BTA

[1887](#) 4 ff. inter labores—composuit] tres precipue libros per ipsum dum vixit doctrine causa compositos ad aliorum noticiam in lucem seriose produxit.
BTA

[1888](#) 8 f. necnon—gradibus *om.* BTA

[1889](#) 9 ff. viam—conatur] viam precipue qua peccator in penitendo Cristi misericordiam assequi poterit, tota mentis deuocione finaliter contemplatur
BTA

[1890](#) 11 Titulusque] titulus AX ... B₂

[1891](#) Speculum hominis A ... B₂ Speculum mediantis B

[1892](#) 13 ff. Secundus enim liber, sermone latino versibus exametri et pentametri compositus, tractat super illo mirabili euentu qui in Anglia (anglica J) tempore domini Regis Ricardi secundi anno regni sui quarto contigit, quando seruiles rustici impetuose contra nobiles et ingenuos regni insurrexerunt. Innocenciam tamen dicti domini Regis tunc minoris etatis causa inde excusabilem pronuncians, culpas aliunde, ex quibus et non a fortuna talia inter homines contingunt enormia, euidentius declarat. Titulusque voluminis huius, cuius ordo Septem continet paginas, Vox clamantis nominatur A ... B₂

Secundus liber versibus exametri et pentametri sermone latino componitur, tractat de variis infortuniis tempore regis Ricardi secundi in Anglia multipliciter contingentibus, vbi pro statu regni compositor deuocius exorat. Nomenque voluminis huius, quod in septem diuiditur partes, Vox clamantis intitatur BTA

[1893](#) 20 ff. Tercius iste liber (liber iste J) Anglico sermone in octo partes diuisus, qui ad instanciam serenissimi Principis dicti domini Regis Anglie Ricardi secundi conficitur A ... B₂ Tercius iste liber qui in octo partes diuisus ob reuerenciam stren. dom. sui dom. Henrici de Lanc. &c. BT

[1894](#) 24 vsque in nunc T

[1895](#) 24 distingui B

[1896](#) 25 Nectanabum et Aristotilem A ... B₂

[1897](#) 26 regimine X ... B₂

[1898](#) 26 f. eius disciplina—materia *om.* AX ... B₂ eorum disciplina &c. J

[1899](#) 27 operis] libri J

[1900](#) 28 ff. super amorem et amantum condiciones fundamentum habet: vbi variarum Cronicarum historiarumque sentencie, necnon Poetarum Philosophorumque scripture ad exemplum distinccius inseruntur. Nomenque presentis opusculi Confessio Amantis specialiter intitatur. A ... B₂ (*but all except J have finem for sentencie*).

[1901](#) 30 specialiter *om.* A

TO KING HENRY THE FOURTH¹⁹⁰²

IN PRAISE OF PEACE¹⁹⁰³

¹⁹⁰⁴*Electus Cristi, pie Rex Henrice, fuisti,
Qui bene venisti cum propria regna petisti;
Tu mala vicisti que bonis bona restituisti,
Et populo tristi noua gaudia contribuisti.
Est michi spes lata quod adhuc per te renouata
Succedent fata veteri probitate beata,
Est tibi nam grata gracia sponte data.*

O worthi noble kyng, Henry the ferthe,¹⁹⁰⁵
In whom the glade fortune is befalle
The poeple to governe uppon this erthe,¹⁹⁰⁶
God hath the chose in comfort of ous alle:¹⁹⁰⁷
The worschipe of this lond, which was doun falle,¹⁹⁰⁸
Now stant upriht thurgh grace of thi goodnesse,
Which every man is holde forto blesse.

The highe god of his justice allone
The right which longeth to thi regalie
10 Declared hath to stonde in thi persone,
And more than god may no man justefie.
Thi title is knowe uppon thin ancestrie,
The londes folk hath ek thy riht affermed;
So stant thi regne of god and man confermed.

Ther is no man mai seie in other wise,
That god himself ne hath thi riht declared,¹⁹⁰⁹
Whereof the lond is boun to thi servise,¹⁹¹⁰
Which for defalte of help hath longe cared:
Bot now ther is no mannes herte spared

20 To love and serve and wirche thi plesance,
And al is this thurgh godes pourveiance.[1911](#)

In alle thing which is of god begonne
Ther folwith grace, if it be wel governed:
Thus tellen thei whiche olde bookes conne,
Whereof, my lord, y wot wel thow art lerned.
Axe of thi god, so schalt thou noght be werned
Of no requeste which is resonable;
For god unto the goode is favorable.

Kyng Salomon, which hadde at his axinge
30 Of god what thing him was levest to crave,[1912](#)
He ches wisdom unto the governynge[1913](#)
Of goddis folk, the whiche he wolde save:
And as he ches it fel him forto have;
For thurgh his wit, whil that his regne laste,
He gat him pees and reste unto the laste.[1914](#)

Bot Alisaundre, as telleth his histoire,[1915](#)
Unto the god besoghte in other weie,
Of all the world to winne the victoire,
So that undir his swerd it myht obeie.
40 In werre he hadde al that he wolde preie,
The myghti god behight him that behested,
The world he wan, and had it of conqweste.[1916](#)

Bot thogh it fel at thilke time so,
That Alisandre his axinge hath achieved,
This sinful world was al paiene tho,[1917](#)
Was non which hath the hihe god believed:
No wondir was thogh thilke world was grieved,
Thogh a tiraunt his pourpos myhte winne;
Al was vengeance and infortune of sinne.

50 Bot now the feith of Crist is come a place
Among the princes in this erthe hiere,

It sit hem wel to do pite and grace;
Bot yit it mot be tempred in manere:
For as thei finden cause in the matiere¹⁹¹⁸
Uppon the point, what aftirward betide,
The lawe of riht schal noght be leid aside.

So mai a kyng of werre the viage
Ordeigne and take, as he therto is holde,
To cleime and axe his rightful heritage
60 In alle places wher it is withholde:
Bot other wise if god himsilve wolde
Afferme love and pes between the kynges,
Pes is the beste above alle erthely thinges.¹⁹¹⁹

Good is teshue werre, and natheles
A kyng may make werre uppon his right,
For of bataile the final ende is pees.
Thus stant the lawe, that a worthi knyght
Uppon his trouthe may go to the fight;
Bot if so were that he myghte chese,
70 Betre is the pees, of which may no man lese.

<Sustene> pes oghte every man alyve,¹⁹²⁰
First for to sette his liege lord in reste,
And ek these othre men that thei ne stryve;
For so this world mai stonden ate beste.¹⁹²¹
What kyng that wolde be the worthieste,
The more he myghte oure dedly werre cesse,
The more he schulde his worthinesse encesse.

Pes is the chief of al the worldes welthe,
And to the heven it ledeth ek the weie;
80 Pes is of soule and lif the mannes helthe,
Of pestilence and doth the werre aweie.
Mi liege lord, tak hiede of that y seie,
If werre may be left, tak pes on honde,
Which may noght be withoute goddis sonde.

With pes stant every creature in reste;
Without pes ther may no lif be glad:
Above alle othre good pes is the beste,
Pes hath himself whan werre is al bestad,
The pes is sauf, the werre is evere adrad.[1922](#)

90 Pes is of alle charite the keie,[1923](#)
Which hath the lif and soule forto weie.

My liege lord, if that the list to seche
The sothe essamples that the werre hath wrought,[1924](#)
Thow schalt wiel hiere of wisemennes speche
That dedly werre turneth into noght.
For if these olde bokes be wel soght,[1925](#)
Ther myght thou se what thing the werre hath do,
Bothe of conqueste and conquerour also.

For vein honour or for the worldes good
100 Thei that whilom the stronge werres made,
Wher be thei now? Bethenk wel in thi mod.
The day is goon, the nyght is derk and fade,
Her crualte, which mad hem thanne glade,
Thei sorwen now, and yit have noght the more;
The blod is schad, which no man mai restore.

The werre is modir of the wronges alle;
It sleth the prest in holi chirche at masse,
Forlith the maide and doth hire flour to falle.[1926](#)
The werre makth the grete Citee lasse,
110 And doth the lawe his reules overpasse.
There is no thing wherof meschef mai growe
Which is noght caused of the werre, y trowe.

The werre bringth in poverte at hise hieles,
Wherof the comon poeple is sore grieved;
The werre hath set his cart on thilke whieles
Wher that fortune mai noght be believed.
For whan men wene best to have achieved,

Ful ofte it is al newe to beginne:
The werre hath no thing siker, thogh he winne.

120 Forthi, my worthi prince, in Cristes halve,
As for a part whos feith thou hast to guide, [1927](#)
Ley to this olde sor a newe salve, [1928](#)
And do the werre awei, what so betide:
Purchace pes, and set it be thi side, [1929](#)
And suffre noght thi poeple be devoured,
So schal thi name evere after stonde honoured. [1930](#)

If eny man be now or evere was [1931](#)
Ayein the pes thi preve counseillour,
Let god ben of thi counseil in this cas, [1932](#)
130 And put awei the cruel werreiour. [1933](#)
For god, which is of man the creatour,
He wolde noght men slowe his creature
Withoute cause of dedly forfeiture.

Wher nedeth most, behoveth most to loke.
Mi lord, how so thi werres ben withoute,
Of time passed who that hiede toke,
Good were at hom to se riht wel aboute;
For everemor the werste is forto doute:
Bot if thou myghtest parfit pes atteigne,
140 Ther schulde be no cause forto pleigne.

Aboute a kyng good counseil is to preise
Above alle othre thinges most vailable;
Bot yit a kyng withinne himself schal peise,
And se the thinges that ben resonable,
And ther uppon he schal his wittes stable
Among the men to sette pes in evene,
For love of him which is the kyng of hevene.

Ha, wel is him that schedde nevere blod, [1934](#)
Bot if it were in cause of rihtwisnesse:

150 For if a kyng the peril undirstod,
What is to sle the poeple, thanne y gesse,
The dedly werres and the hevynesse,
Wherof the pes distourbid is ful ofte
Schulde at som time cesse and wexe softe.

O kyng fulfild of grace and of knyghthode,[1935](#)
Remembre uppon this point for Cristes sake,
If pes be profred unto thi manhode,
Thin honour sauf, let it noght be forsake.
Though thou the werres darst wel undirtake,
160 Aftir reson yit tempre thi corage,
For lich to pes ther is non advantage.

My worthi lord, thenk wel, how so befalle,[1936](#)
Of thilke lore, as holi bokes sein,
Crist is the heved and we ben membres alle,
Als wel the subgit as the sovereign:[1937](#)
So sit it wel that charite be plein,
Which unto god himselve most acordeth,
So as the lore of Cristes word recordeth.

In tholde lawe, er Crist himself was bore,
170 Among the ten comandementz y rede
How that manslaghtre schulde be forbore;
Such was the will that time of the godhede:
And aftirward, whanne Crist tok his manhede,[1938](#)
Pes was the ferste thing he let do crie
Ayein the worldes rancour and envie.[1939](#)

And er Crist wente out of this erthe hiere,
And stigh to hevене, he made his testament,[1940](#)
Wher he beqwath to his disciples there
And yaf his pes, which is the foundement
180 Of charite, withouten whos assent
The worldes pes mai nevere wel be tried,[1941](#)
Ne love kept, ne lawe justefied.

The Jewes with the paiens hadden werre,¹⁹⁴²
Bot thei among hemself stode evere in pes:
Whi schulde thanne oure pes stonde out of herre,¹⁹⁴³
Which Crist hath chose unto his oghne encres?
For Crist is more than was Moïses,
And Crist hath set the parfit of the lawe,
The which scholde in no wise be withdrawe.

190 To yive ous pes was cause whi Crist dide;
Withoute pes may no thing stonde availed:
Bot now a man mai sen on everi side
How Cristes feith is every dai assailed,¹⁹⁴⁴
With the Paiens destruid, and so batailed
That for defalte of help and of defence
Unethe hath Crist his dewe reverence.

The righte feith to kepe of holy chirche
The firste point is named of knyghthode,
And everi man is holde forto wirche
200 Uppon the point which stant to his manhode.¹⁹⁴⁵
Bot now, helas, the fame is sprad so broode,
That everi worthi man this thing compleigneth,¹⁹⁴⁶
And yit ther is no man which help ordeigneth.¹⁹⁴⁷

The worldes cause is waited overal,
Ther ben the werres redi to the fulle;
Bot Cristes oghne cause in special,
Ther ben the swerdes and the speres dulle;
And with the sentence of the popes bulle,
As forto do the folk païen obeie,¹⁹⁴⁸
210 The chirche is turned al an other weie.

It is to wondre above a mannys wit¹⁹⁴⁹
Withoute werre how Cristes feith was wonne,
And we that ben uppon this erthe yit
Ne kepe it noght, as it was first begonne.
To every creature undir the sonne

Crist bad himself how that we schulden preche, [1950](#)
And to the folk his evangile teche.

More light it is to kepe than to make;
Bot that we founden mad tofore the hond [1951](#)
220 We kepe noght, bot lete it lightly slake.
The pes of Crist hath altobroke his bond,
We reste ourselve and soeffrin every lond
To slen ech other as thing undefendid:
So stant the werre, and pes is noght amendid.

Bot thogh the heved of holy chirche above
Ne do noght al his hole businesse
Among the men to sette pes and love, [1952](#)
These kynges oughten of here rightwisnesse
Here oghne cause among hemself redresse:
230 Thogh Petres schip as now hath lost his stiere,
It lith in hem that barge forto stiere.

If holy cherche after the duete
Of Cristes word ne be noght al avysed
To make pes, acord and unite
Among the kinges that ben now devised,
Yit natheles the lawe stant assised
Of mannys wit to be so resonable,
Withoute that to stonde hemselfe stable. [1953](#)

Of holy chirche we ben children alle,
240 And every child is holden forto bowe
Unto the modir, how that evere it falle, [1954](#)
Or elles he mot reson desalowe:
And for that cause a knyght schal ferst avowe
The right of holi chirche to defende,
That no man schal the previlege offende.

Thus were it good to setten al in evene
The worldes princes and the prelatz bothe,

For love of him which is the king of hevene:
And if men scholde algate wexe wrothe,
250 The Sarazins, whiche unto Crist be lothe,
Let men ben armed ayein hem to fighte;[1955](#)
So mai the knyht his dede of armes righte.

Upon thre pointz stant Cristes pes oppressed:
Ferst holy cherche is in hirsilf divided,[1956](#)
Which oughte of reson first to be redresced;
Bot yit so highe a cause is noght decided.
And thus, whan humble pacience is prided,
The remenant, which that thei schulden reule,
No wondir is though it stonde out of reule.

260 Of that the heved is siek, the limes aken:
These regnes that to Cristes pes belongen
For worldes good these dedly werres maken,
Whiche helpeles as in balance hongen.[1957](#)
The heved above hem hath noght undirfongen
To sette pes, bot every man sleeth other,
And in this wise hath charite no brother.

The two defaltes bringen in the thridde,
Of mescreantz, that sen how we debate,
Betwen the two thei fallen in amidde,[1958](#)
270 Wher now aldai thei finde an open gate.
Lo, thus the dedly werre stant algate;
Bot evere y hope of King Henries grace
That he it is which schal the pes embrace.

My worthi noble prince and kyng enoight,
Whom god hath of his grace so preserved,
Behold and se the world uppon this point,[1959](#)
As for thi part that Cristes pes be served:
So schal thin highe mede be deserved
To him which al schal qwiten ate laste,
280 For this lif hiere mai no while laste.

See Alisandre, Ector and Julius,
See Machabeu, David and Josue,
See Charlemeine, Godefroi, Arthus, [1960](#)
Fulfilde of werre and of mortalite.
Here fame abyt, bot al is vanite;
For deth, which hath the werres under fote,
Hath made an ende of which ther is no bote.

So may a man the sothe wite and knowe, [1961](#)
That pes is good for every king to have:
290 The fortune of the werre is evere unknowe,
Bot wher pes is, ther ben the marches save. [1962](#)
That now is up, to morwe is under grave;
The mighti god hath alle grace in honde,
With outen him pes may nought longe stonde. [1963](#)

Of the Tenet to winne or lese a chace, [1964](#)
May no lif wite er that the bal be ronne:
Al stant in god, what thing men schal purchace,
Thende is in him er that it be begonne.
Men sein the wolfe, whanne it is wel sponne,
300 Doth that the cloth is strong and profitable,
And elles it may nevere be durable. [1965](#)

The worldes chaunces uppon aventure
Ben evere sett, bot thilke chaunce of pes
Is so behoveli to the creature,
That it above alle othere is pierles: [1966](#)
Bot it may nought be gete natheles [1967](#)
Among the men to lasten eny while,
Bot wher the herte is plein withoute guyle.

The pes is as it were a sacrament
310 Tofore the god, and schal with wordes pleine
Withouten eny double entendement
Be trected, for the trouthe can nought feine:
Bot if the men withinne hemself be veine,

The substance of the pes may noght be trewe,
Bot every dai it chaungeth uppon newe.

Bot who that is of charite parfit,
He voideth alle sleightes ferr aweie,
And sett his word uppon the same plit,
Wher that his herte hath founde a siker weie:
320 And thus whan conscience is trewly weie,
And that the pes be handlid with the wise, [1968](#)
It schal abide and stonde in alle wise.

Thapostle seith, ther mai no lif be good
Which is noght grounded uppon charite,
For charite ne schedde nevere blod,
So hath the werre as ther no properte:
For thilke vertu which is seid pite
With charite so ferforth is aqweinted,
That in hire may no fals semblant be peinted. [1969](#)

330 Cassodre, whos writinge is auctorized,
Seith, wher that pite reigneth, ther is grace, [1970](#)
Thurgh which the pes hath al his welthe assised,
So that of werre he dredeth no manace.
Wher pite dwelleth, in the same place
Ther mai no dedly cruelte sojorne,
Wherof that merci schulde his weie torne. [1971](#)

To se what pite forth with mercy doth,
The cronike is at Rome in thilke empire
Of Constantin, which is a tale soth;
340 Whan him was levere his oghne deth desire
Than do the yonge children to martire,
Of crualte he lafte the querele,
Pite he wroghte and pite was his hele.

For thilke mannes pite which he dede
God was pitous and mad him hol at al; [1972](#)

Silvestre cam, and in the same stede
Yaf him baptisme first in special,
Which dide awai the sinne original,
And al his lepre it hath so purified,
350 That his pite for evere is magnified. [1973](#)

Pite was cause whi this emperour
Was hol in bodi and in soule bothe,
And Rome also was set in thilke honour
Of Cristes feith, so that the lieve of lothe,
Whiche hadden be with Crist tofore wrothe,
Resceived weren unto Cristes lore: [1974](#)
Thus schal pite be preised evermore.

My worthi liege lord, Henri be name,
Which Engelond hast to governe and righte,
360 Men oghten wel thi pite to proclame,
Which openliche in al the worldes sighte
Is schewed with the help of god almightie,
To yive ous pes, which longe hath be debated,
Wherof thi pris shal nevere ben abated.

My lord, in whom hath evere yit be founde [1975](#)
Pite withoute spot of violence,
Kep thilke pes alwei withinne bounde,
Which god hath planted in thi conscience:
So schal the cronique of thi pacience
370 Among the seintz be take into memoire
To the loenge of perdurable gloire. [1976](#)

And to thin erthli pris, so as y can,
Which everi man is holde to commende,
I, Gower, which am al thi liege man,
This lettre unto thin excellence y sende,
As y which evere unto my lives ende
Wol praie for the stat of thi persone
In worschipe of thi sceptre and of thi throne. [1977](#)

Noght only to my king of pes y write,
380 Bot to these othre princes cristene alle,
That ech of hem his oghne herte endite,
And see the werre er more meschief falle:¹⁹⁷⁸
Sette ek the rightful Pope uppon his stalle,
Kep charite and draugh pite to honde,
Maintene lawe, and so the pes schal stonde.

**Explicit carmen de pacis commendacione, quod ad laudem et
memoriam serenissimi principis domini Regis Henrici quarti suus¹⁹⁷⁹
humilis orator Iohannes Gower composuit.¹⁹⁸⁰ Et nunc sequitur
epistola in qua idem Ioannes pro statu et salute dicti domini sui apud
altissimum deuocius exorat.**

¹⁹⁸¹Rex celi deus et dominus, qui tempora solus
Condidit, et solus condita cuncta regit;
Qui rerum causas ex se produxit et vnum
In se principium rebus inesse dedit;
Qui dedit vt stabili motu consisteret orbis
Fixus in eternum mobilitate sua;
Quique potens verbi produxit ad esse creata,
Quique sue mentis lege ligauit ea;
Ipse caput regum, reges quo rectificantur,
10 Te que tuum regnum, rex pie, queso, regat.¹⁹⁸²
Grata superueniens te misit gracia nobis,
Quo sine labe salus nulla perante fuit.
Sic tuus aduentus noua gaudia sponte reduxit,
Quo prius in luctu lacrima maior erat:
Nos tua milicies pauidos releuauit ab ymo,
Quos prius oppressit ponderis omne malum:
Ex probitate tua, quo mors latitabat in vmbra,
Vita resurrexit clara que regna regit:
Sic tua sors sortem mediante deo renouatam
20 Sanat et emendat, que prius egra fuit.
O pie rex, Cristum per te laudamus, et ipsum
Qui tibi nos tribuit terra reuiua colit.

Sancta sit illa dies qua tu tibi regna petisti,
 Sanctus et ille deus qui tibi regna dedit.
 Qui tibi prima tulit, confirmet regna futura,
 Quo poteris magno magnus honore frui.
 Sit tibi progenies ita multiplicata per eum,
 Quod genus inde pium repleat omne solum.
 Quicquid in orbe boni fuerit, tibi summus ab alto
 30 Donet, vt in terris rex in honore regas:
 Omne quod est turpe vacuum discedat, et omne
 Est quod honorificum det deus esse tuum.
 Consilium nullum, pie rex, te tangat iniquum,
 In quibus occultum scit deus esse dolum.
 Absit auaricia, ne tangat regia corda,
 Nec queat in terra proditor esse tua.
 Sic tua processus habeat fortuna perhennes,
 Quo recolant laudes secula cuncta tuas:
 Nuper vt Augusti fuerant preconia Rome, [1983](#)
 40 Concinat in gestis Anglia leta tuis.
 O tibi, rex, euo detur, fortissime, nostro
 Semper honorata scepra tenere manu:
 Stes ita magnanimus quod, vbi tua regna gubernas,
 Terreat has partes hostica nulla manus:
 Augeat imperium tibi Cristus et augeat annos,
 Protegat et nostras aucta corona fores:
 Sit tibi pax finis, domito domineris in orbe,
 Cunctaque sint humeris inferiora tuis. [1984](#)
 Sic honor et virtus, laus, gloria, pax que potestas [1985](#)
 50 Te que tuum regnum magnificare queant. [1986](#)
 Cordis amore boni, pie rex, mea vota parauit;
 Corpore cum nequii, seruiio mente tibi:
 Ergo tue laudi que tuo genuflexus honori [1987](#)
 Verba loco doni pauper habenda tuli.
 Est tamen ista mei, pie rex, sententia verbi,
 Fine tui regni sint tibi regna poli.

FOOTNOTES:

[1902](#) *The text is that of the MS. at Trentham Hall (T). Variations marked Th are those of the copy in Chaucer's Works, ed. 1532, ff. 375 v^o-377.*

[1903](#) *No title in T Iohan Gower vnto the worthy and noble kynge Henry the fourth Th*

[1904](#) *Latin Verses placed at the end of the poem Th*

[1905](#) *1 O Noble worthy kyng Th*

[1906](#) *3 uppon this] here vpon Th*

[1907](#) *4 chosen Th*

[1908](#) *8 highe Th high T*

[1909](#) *16 thi] the Th*

[1910](#) *17 bounde Th*

[1911](#) *21 this is Th goddes purueyaunce Th godespourveiance T*

[1912](#) *30 to om. Th*

[1913](#) *31 the om. Th*

[1914](#) *35 unto the] in to his Th*

[1915](#) *36 his storie Th*

[1916](#) *42 he om. Th*

[1917](#) *45 paynem Th*

[1918](#) *54 as om. Th*

[1919](#) *63 erthly Th*

[1920](#) *71 S.... pes (erasure after S) T To stere peace Th eueriche on lyue Th*

[1921](#) *74 lande may stande Th*

[1922](#) *89 euer TTh*

[1923](#) *90 al TTh*

[1924](#) *93 that] what Th*

[1925](#) *96 ysought Th*

[1926](#) *108 here T her Th*

[1927](#) *121 hast be gyde Th*

[1928](#) *122 Ley Th Leie T*

[1929](#) *124 sette TTh*

[1930](#) *126 euer TTh*

[1931](#) *127 euer TTh*

[1932](#) *129 Lete T Lette Th*

[1933](#) *130 put Th putte T*

[1934](#) *148 neuer TTh*

[1935](#) *155 and knighthode Th*

[1936](#) *162 þenke T thynke Th*

[1937](#) *165 the subgit] be subiecte Th*

[1938](#) *173 But afterwarde Th*

[1939](#) *175 Ayenst Th*

[1940](#) *177 stighed Th*

[1941](#) *181 neuer TTh*

[1942](#) *183 paynys Th*

[1943](#) *185 erre Th*

[1944](#) *194 paynems Th*

[1945](#) *200 which] þat Th*

[1946](#) 202 worthi *om.* Th
[1947](#) 203 is there Th which] that Th
[1948](#) 209 payne Th
[1949](#) 211 a] any Th
[1950](#) 216 how *om.* Th
[1951](#) 219 the *om.* Th
[1952](#) 227 men] people Th
[1953](#) 238 him selfe Th
[1954](#) 241 euer TTh
[1955](#) 251 ayenst Th
[1956](#) 254 is *om.* Th hersilf T her selfe Th
[1957](#) 263 helpples T helplesse Th
[1958](#) 269 Betwene TTh
[1959](#) 276 Beholde TTh
[1960](#) 283 Godfray and Arthus Th
[1961](#) 288 mai] many Th
[1962](#) 291 ben] is Th
[1963](#) 294 pes] men Th
[1964](#) 295 Off (*for* OF) T
[1965](#) 301 neuer TTh
[1966](#) 305 That is aboue al other peerles Th
[1967](#) 306 begete Th
[1968](#) 321 the pes] these Th
[1969](#) 329 here T her Th
[1970](#) 331 ther *om.* Th
[1971](#) 336 wei T way Th
[1972](#) 345 made Th
[1973](#) 350 euer TTh
[1974](#) 356 were TTh
[1975](#) 365 euer TTh
[1976](#) 371 loenge] legende Th
[1977](#) 378 and thy throne Th
[1978](#) 382 mor T
[1979](#) EXPLICIT 3 suis Th
[1980](#) 4 Et nunc—exorat *om.* Th
[1981](#) *Instead of the Latin lines that follow Th has here the lines ‘Electus Cristi—sponte data,’ which in T stand at the beginning, and after these without a break, ‘Henrici quarti—futura deus,’ twelve lines which are written at the end of the Trentham MS.*
[1982](#) 10 Teque T
[1983](#) 39 augusti T
[1984](#) 48 Cuncta que T
[1985](#) 49 paxque T
[1986](#) 50 Teque T
[1987](#) 53 laudique T

NOTES

LIB. V. (*continued*)

1980. F has a stop after 'Avarice,' but see note on l. 3966.

1982 ff. The meaning seems to be that they make no distinction of day or night when there is work of this kind to be done.

2004. *overhippeth*, i. e. leaps over or omits something, so that he has not all that he desires. The word is used in *Piers Plowman*, xv. 379, of omitting passages in the services of the Church.

2015 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 6253 ff.,

'Sicomme le Luce en l'eaue gloute
Du piscon la menuse toute,
Qu'il presde luy verra noer,
Ensi ly riches,' &c.

2031 ff. The tale of Virgil's Mirror is from the French prose *Roman des Sept Sages*, as published by Le Roux de Lincy. It might easily be shown that Gower did not follow either the French metrical version or the Latin *Historia Septem Sapientum*. The English metrical version published by Weber is from a source similar to that of Gower's story, but it differs in some points. Gower seems to be responsible for the introduction of Carthage and Hannibal.

2099. *slepende a nyht*, i. e. while they slept.

2101. Cp. Prol. 182.

2115. *he his oghne body*, i. e. 'he himself.'

2150 f. This point is omitted in the English metrical version.

2157 f. The English metrical version is very similar, 'We schulle the ymage so undersette, That we ne schal hit nothing lette.'

2168. That is, the timber having been set up.

2198 ff. This about Hannibal is introduced here as if taken from a different source, 'For this I finde,' &c.

2238f. Cp. *Mirour*, 10651, 'Plus que gaigners son augst attent.'

2273 ff. The tale of the Two Coffers is essentially the same story as that which we have in Boccaccio *Decam.* x. i, and essentially different from that which is told in *Vit. Barlaam et Josaphat*, cap. vi, as a sequel to the story of the Trump of Death. The story which we have here and in Boccaccio is not at all connected with the idea of choosing by the outward appearance. The coffers are exactly alike, and the very point of the situation lies in the fact that the choice is a purely fortuitous one. The object was to show that they who complained were persons who had fortune against them, and that this was the cause of their having failed of reward, and not any neglect on the part of the king. I cannot say what the source was for Gower; certainly not Boccaccio, whose story is altogether different in its details.

2391 ff. With this story may be compared that in the *Gesta Romanorum*, 109, where by a choice between three pasties, one containing money, a decision is come to as to whether it is God's will that a certain sum shall be restored to its owner, who is a miser.

2476. *tall*, i. e. comely, elegant.

2481. Cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, D 259.

2507. *His thonkes*, 'of his own good will': cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, A 1626, &c.

2543 ff. See *Hist. Alexandri Magni de Preliis*, f 1, ed. Argent. 1489.

2547 ff. *Rom. de Troie*, 23283 ff.

2563. Cp. ii. 2025.

2587. 'If men shall estimate her value.' The reading of the text is also that of S.

2643 ff. This story is to be found in the *Roman des Sept Sages*. Gower follows the same French prose version as before, 2031 ff.

2677. *it stod*. In this kind of expression the verb is usually subjunctive, as Prol. 481, i. 991, iv. 182, &c.

2752. *a weie*. This is also the reading of S.

2815 f. A rather more violent displacement than usual of the conjunction, 'And fled away with all the haste,' &c. Cp. l. 3947.

2835. *hele* seems here to mean 'profit,' in a worldly sense.

2872. According to the *New Engl. Dict.* this is the same as the Dutch 'heepe,' 'heep,' meaning a pruning-hook. 'As there is no cognate word in O. E., its appearance in Gower, and this apparently in a proverbial phrase, is not easy to account for.' In any case the phrase here seems equivalent to 'by hook or by crook.'

2937. F has punctuation after 'dai,' but this is clearly a case of the inverted order of the conjunction: cp. note on Prol. 155, and below on l. 3966.

2961 ff. The story is probably taken from Statius, *Achill.* i. 197 ff., where however it is told at much greater length. For Gower's acquaintance with the *Achilleis*, cp. iv. 1968 ff.

3002 ff. Cp. *Achill.* i. 338 ff.

3004 f. That is, howsoever his behaviour might be watched.

3082. *Protheüs*. According to Statius, *Achill.* i. 494 ff., Protesilaus rebuked Calchas for not having discovered Achilles, upon which Calchas revealed the truth. Perhaps the mention of Protesilaus suggested to Gower the idea of Proteus, of whom he had heard as one who could change his form at will, see l. 6672, and perhaps as having prophesied the birth and greatness of Achilles (Ovid, *Metam.* xi. 221 ff.).

3119. *topseilcole*, see note on viii. 1890.

3138 f. Cp. *Achill.* i. 812 ff.

3247 ff. The first part of the story of Jason and Medea (ll. 3247-3926) is taken from Benoît (*Rom. de Troie*, 703-2062), and not from Guido, as may be easily shown by comparison of the texts. For example, Guido tells all the conditions of the enterprise, about the fire-breathing bulls, the serpent's teeth and so on, at the beginning of the story, whereas Benoît more

dramatically introduces them into the instructions given to Jason by Medea (*Rom. de Troie*, 1337-1374, 1691-1748), and in this he is followed by Gower (3505-3540). Guido says nothing about the sleeplessness of the serpent (*Rom. de Troie*, 1357 f., *Conf. Am.* v. 3514), nor about repeating the charm 'contre orient' (*Rom. de Troie*, 1700), nor does he mention the thanksgiving which Jason is to offer up to the gods after his victory and before he takes the fleece (*Rom. de Troie*, 1735 f., *Conf. Am.* v. 3626 ff.). The sleep of Jason after leaving Medea is omitted by Guido (*Rom. de Troie*, 1755 ff., *Conf. Am.* v. 3665 ff.), and also the bath which he took after his adventure (*Rom. de Troie*, 1999, *Conf. Am.* v. 3801). There is no need to multiply instances, which will be observed by every careful reader. We have seen on other occasions that Gower prefers Benoît to Guido, and not without excellent reasons. Guido indeed makes this story even more prosaic than usual, and combines it with matter-of-fact discussions about the magic powers of Medea and the virtues of the various stones which she used.

Gower, however, does not follow Benoît in a slavish manner. He omits or alters the details of the story very happily at times, and he adds much of his own. Thus he omits all mention of the evil motives of Peleus (or Pelias), and makes the proposal to seek the golden fleece come from Jason; he passes over the story of the dispute with Laomedon, which was necessary to the *Roman de Troie*, but not to the story of Jason taken separately; he adds the discourse of Jason with Oëtes on his arrival; he omits the details about Medea's hair and eyes, her arms and her chin (*Rom. de Troie*, 1254 ff.), and dwells rather upon the feelings which the two lovers had for one another at first sight (3376 ff.). When they are together at night, it is Medea, according to our author, and not Jason, who suggests that it is time to rise and to speak of what has to be done (3547 ff.); and Gower adds the scene of parting (3634-3659), the description of Jason's return over the sea and of Medea's feelings meanwhile upon her tower, and the sending of the maid to inquire how he did. Finally, he much improves the story by making the flight take place at once, instead of prolonging Jason's stay for a month.

Chaucer, who tells the story in a rather perfunctory manner, follows Guido (*Leg. of Good Women*, 1396 ff.).

3291. *And schop anon, &c.* This might be understood of Peleus, who, according to the original story, gave orders for the building of the ship; but

better perhaps of Jason, 'And schop' for 'And he schop,' cp. l. 4590 and vi. 1636.

3376. *herd spoke*: cp. 4485, 'I have herd seid.'

3388. That is, 'they took heed each of other.' For the plural verb cp. 3439.

3416. That is, 'he took St. John as his pledge' of a good issue, 'he committed himself to the care of St. John.' The expression was often used in connexion with setting out on a journey: cp. Chaucer, *Compl. of Mars*, 9.

3422. Cp. iv. 3273, vi. 2104. The expression in vi. 1621 f., 'to ful age, That he can reson and langage,' that is, 'till he is of full age and knows reason,' &c., is much of the same kind.

3488. *dede him helpe*. We must take this second 'helpe' as a substantive, otherwise the rhyme would not be good. The rule is that words identical in form can only be combined in rhyme when they have some difference of meaning.

3509. *to thyle*. The idea was that the golden fleece was guarded in a small island adjacent to the larger 'isle of Colchos.' See *Rom. de Troie*, 1791 ff.,

'Ilec li covient à passer,
Ou voille ou non, un bras de mer;
Mès estreiz est, ne dure mie
Gaires plus de lieue et demie.
De l'autre part est li isliax,
Non mie granz, mès molt est biax.'

3533. *dethes wounde*, 'deadly wound': cp. iii. 2657, 'And smot him with a dethes wounde,' and also the genitives 'lyves' for 'living' and 'worldes' for 'worldly,' i. 1771, iv. 382, &c.

3573. *hold*, i. e. let him hold: cp. viii. 1128, 1420.

3579 ff. According to Benoît Medea gave him first the magic figure, 'une figure Fete par art et par conjure' (cp. 3580), then the ointment and the ring, and after that a writing, the words of which he was to repeat three

times when he came to the place. Gower changes the order of things, and combines the writing with the 'heavenly figure,' describing it as written over with names which he is to repeat in the manner mentioned.

3632. *That thanne he were*, &c., that is, she prayed that he would soon be gone.

3654. 'It shall not be owing to any sloth of mine if I do not,' &c.

3665 ff.

'Dedanz son lit s'est tost cochiez
Endormi sei en eslepas;
Car tot esteit de veiller las:
Et quant il ot dormi grant piece,
Tant qu'il estoit ja halte tierce,
Levez s'est,' &c. *Rom. de Troie*, 1756 ff.

'undren hih' is in the French 'halte tierce.'

3681. *recorde*, 'take note of.'

3688. The reading of X here, 'And forth with all his wey he fongeth,' is also that of GOAd₂.

3707. *scherged*: perhaps the word is suggested by Benoît's expression, 'Les escherdes hérice' (*Rom. de Troie*, 1905).

3711. A literal translation of *Rom. de Troie*, 1906, 'Feu et venin gitot ensemble.' With the lines that follow cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 1911 ff.

3731 ff. The picturesque elements here are perhaps partly suggested by *Rom. de Troie*, 1869 ff.

3747. *That he ne were*, expressing a wish: cp. iv. 3414, 'Helas, that I nere of this lif,' equivalent to 'why ne were I,' l. 5979.

3781 f. 'leyhe' seems to be modified in form for the sake of the rhyme, the usual form in Gower being 'lawhe.'

3786. *naght*, in rhyme for 'noght': cp. 'awht,' 'auht,' i. 2770, v. 6073.

3789. So Ovid, *Metam.* vii. 144 ff.,

‘Tu quoque victorem complecti, barbara, velles,
Obstitit incepto pudor,’ &c.,

but it is also in Benoît, *Rom. de Troie*, 1991 f.

3793 ff. The sending of the maid, with the pretty touch in l. 3800, is an addition by Gower.

3890. Cp. i. 1516.

3904. *this was conseil*, ‘this was a secret’: cp. iii. 778, vi. 2326; so Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, C 819, ‘Shal it be conseil?’ cp. D 966, E 2431.

3927 ff. Benoît tells no more of Jason’s life after his return to Greece, saying that Dares relates no more, and he does not wish to tell stories that may not be true, ‘N’en velt fere acreire mençonge.’ From this point then Gower follows Ovid, *Metam.* vii. 159-293, and it must be understood that the illustrative quotations in the notes are from this passage.

3947. ‘And prayed her that by the magic art which she knew,’ &c. For the order of words cp. 2815 f.

3957 f. Ovid makes it full moon, l. 180, but afterwards, l. 188, says ‘Sidera sola micant.’

3962 ff.

‘Egreditur tectis vestes induta recinctas,
Nuda pedem, nudos humeris infusa capillos,
Fertque vagos mediae per muta silentia noctis
Incomitata gradus.’ *Metam.* vii. 182 ff.

The comparison to the adder in l. 3967 is Gower’s own.

3966. F has a stop after ‘specheles,’ there being a natural tendency even in the best copies to treat ‘and’ or ‘for’ as the beginning of a new clause: so (to take examples from the fifth book only) v. 231, 410, 444, 2318, 2937, 5096, in all which places F has apparently wrong punctuation in connexion with this kind of inverted order.

3971 ff.

‘Ter se convertit, ter sumptis flumine crinem
Irroravit aquis, ternis ululatibus ora
Solvit’: 189 f.

3981. The punctuation is that of F, but perhaps we ought rather to read,

‘Sche preide and ek hield up hir hond,
To Echates and gan to crie.’

3986. *help*. For this use of the imperat. sing, (with ‘helpeth’ just above) see Introduction, p. cxviii.

3994.

‘Sublimis rapitur, subiectaque Thessala Tempe
Despicit, et Creteis regionibus applicat angues:’ 222 f.

Gower very naturally understood this to mean that Medea visited Crete, and hence the confusion of geography. He could not be expected to know that Othrys and Olympus were mountains of Thessaly, and hence that the ‘Creteis’ or ‘cretis’ of his manuscript was probably a corruption.

4000 f.

‘et placitas partim radice revellit,
Partim succidit curvamine falcis ahenae.’ 226 f.

4005. *Eridian*, i. e. Apidanus.

4006.

‘Necnon Peneus, necnon Spercheïdes undae
Contribuere aliquid.’ 230 f.

4011. *the rede See*. Perhaps Gower read 'rubrum mare' for 'refluum mare' in *Metam.* vii. 258.

4031 ff.

'statuitque aras e caespite binas,
Dexteriore Hecates, at laeva parte Iuventae.' 240 f.

4039. 'verbenis, silvaque incinxit agresti,' 242. Gower took 'silva agrestis' as the name of a herb and ingeniously translated it into 'fieldwode.'

4052 f. 'Umbrarumque rogat rapta cum coniuge regem,' 249. Our author is able to supply the names correctly.

4064-4114. This picturesque passage is for the most part original.

4127 ff. 'Nec defuit illic Squamea Cinyphii tenuis membrana chelydri,' 272. Gower understood this to mean 'the scales of Cinyphius (or Cimphius) and *the* skin of Chelidrus.'

4134. 'novem cornicis saecula passae,' 274.

4137. Ovid speaks of the entrails of a werewolf, 'Ambigui prosecta lupi,' &c.

4156. For omission of relative cp. l. 4205 and note on i. 10.

4175 ff. The story here is only summarized by Ovid, *Metam.* vii. 394-401. Gower of course knew it from other sources.

4219. 'intrat Palladias arces,' *Metam.* vii. 398. This means Athens, but it is misunderstood by Gower.

4251. *Philen*, i. e. Nephele. Hyginus tells this story much as it is told here (except that it was the mother of the children who provided the ram), but he gives the name in its Latin form, as 'Nebula.' Note the mistake as to this name in the margin, appearing in all MSS. except SΔΛ.

4299 ff. Note the confused construction of the sentence: cp. note on i. 98.

4391. The metaphor of hunting is still kept up: the gain which they pursue is started like a hare and driven into the net.

4399. *Outward*, that is, when he gives things out, cp. 'withinne' below.

4452. *I were a goddeshalf*. This seems to mean, 'I should be content,' that is, I should be ready to say 'In God's name let it be so.' For the expression cp. l. 5016, 'Thanne a goddes half The thridde time assaie I schal.' In the *New Engl. Dict.* ('half') it is said to be used 'to add emphasis to a petition, command, or expression of consent or resignation': cp. Chaucer, *Book of the Duchess*, 370, 757.

4455. *I biede nevere ... Bot*, 'I demand only.' In this expression 'biede' and 'bidde' have been confused, as often. Thus we have 'I bidde nevere a betre taxe,' i. 1556, 'That I ne bede nevere awake,' iv. 2905, in the latter of which 'bede' may be either pret. subj. of 'bidde,' or pres. ind. equivalent to 'biede,' and vi. 1356, 'He bede nevere fare bet' where 'bede' is apparently pret. subj. of bidde; while in the English *Rom. of the Rose*, 791, we have 'Ne bode I nevere thennes go,' in which 'bode' must be pret. subj. of 'biede.'

4465. *lete*: see note on i. 3365.

4549 ff. Cp. i. 42 ff.

4557 f. 'No law may control him either by severity or by mildness.' For the use of 'compaignie' in the sense of 'friendliness' cp. i. 1478, and below, l. 7759.

4583 ff. Ovid, *Metam.* iii. 362 ff., but the circumstances are somewhat modified to suit Gower's purpose. According to Ovid Echo's fault was that she talked too much and diverted Juno's attention, and her punishment was that her speech was confined to a mere repetition of what she heard. Here the crime is rather that she cunningly concealed in her speech what she ought to have told, and the punishment is that she is obliged to tell everything that comes to her ears.

4590. 'And through such brocage he was untrue,' &c. For the omission of the pronoun see note on i. 1895.

4623. *maken it so queinte*, 'be so cunning': cp. iv. 2314, where however 'queinte' has a different meaning.

4642. *hire mouth ascape*, i. e. escape being repeated by her mouth.

4661. The aspiration of ‘hem,’ so as to prevent elision, is very unusual: cp. Introduction, p. cxxv.

4668 ff. ‘I shall arrange in their due order those branches of Avarice on which no wealth is well bestowed,’ that is, those which make no return for what is bestowed upon them, viz. Usury and Ingratitude.

4708. *of som reprise*, i. e. ‘of some cost,’ cp. i. 3414,

‘Which most is worth, and no reprise
It takth ayein,’

that is, it costs nothing.

4724. *with ydel hand*, ‘with empty hand,’ that is, without a lure. This seems to be the original meaning of the adjective: see *New Eng. Dict.* ‘idle.’

4731. *the gold Octovien*. The treasures of Octovien (or Octavian) were proverbial: cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 1684 f.,

‘Unques Oteviens de Rome
Ne pot conquerre tel avoir,’

and again 28594,

‘Se li tresors Octoviens
Fust lor, si lor donassent il.’

The expression here seems to be in imitation of the French form without preposition, as in the latter of the above quotations.

The French *Roman d’Othevien*, found in the Bodleian MS. Hatton 100, and reproduced in two English versions, has nothing to do with the treasures of Octovien, for which see William of Malmesbury, *Gesta Regum*, ii. § 169 f. The treasures were supposed to be buried at Rome or elsewhere, and several persons, especially the Pope Silvester (Gerbert), were said to

have seen them, but not to have been permitted to carry them away. They appear also in the *Roman des Sept Sages*.

4748. *eschu of*. The adjective is used by Chaucer with 'to' (or 'for to') and infin., *Cant. Tales*, E 1812, I 971. We may note the spelling here with reference to Chaucer's rhyme in the former passage.

4763. 'It may not by any means be avoided that,' &c.

4774. *as to tho pars*, 'as regards those matters': 'pars' is the French plural form, cp. *Mirour*, 7386, where apparently 'pars' means 'duties.'

4787. Cp. l. 7716, where the saying has a different application. The proverb is here used of those who are, as we say, penny wise and pound foolish. In the other passage it is applied to the opposite case of gaining the coat for the hood.

4808 ff. This story is founded on the so-called *Comedia Babionis*, one of those Latin elegiac poems in a quasi-dramatic form which were popular in the fourteenth century. Others of the same class are *Geta* and *Pamphilus*. In the original, Viöla is Babio's step-daughter, with whom he is in love, and who is taken in marriage against his will by Croceus. The serving-man is Fodius, not Spodius, and most of the piece is concerned with an intrigue between him and the wife of Babio. See Wright's *Early Mysteries*, p. 65.

4899. *comth to londe*, 'appears': cp. l. 18.

4921. *who that it kan*, that is, as any one who knows it will witness: cp. l. 4927, 'For, as any one who observes may know, a beast is,' &c.

4937 ff. This story, which is of Eastern origin, is told near the end of the *Speculum Stultorum* (i. e. *Burnellus*), with which Gower was acquainted, as we know from the *Vox Clamantis*. The names there are Bernardus and Dryānus, and the animals are three, a serpent, an ape, and a lion. A similar tale is told by Matthew Paris, under the year 1195, as related by King Richard I in order to recommend liberality in the cause of Christendom. In this the rich man is Vitalis, a Venetian, and the poor man's name is not given. The animals in the pit are a lion and a serpent. Vitalis thanks his deliverer, and appoints a time for him to come to his palace in Venice and receive the promised reward of half his goods; but when he comes, he is refused with contumely. The magic qualities of the gem which the serpent brings are not mentioned in the story of Vitalis.

5010 f. So in the *Speculum Stultorum*, 'Tunc ita Bernardus, Sathanæ phantasmate lusum Se reputans, dixit,' &c.

5022. *blessed*, i. e. crossed himself. This ceremony plays a considerable part in the story of Vitalis, for by it he is preserved from the wild beasts while in the pit.

5025. *Between him and his Ass*, that is, he and his ass together: cp. l. 5381. The expression is imitated from the French, cp. *Roman de Troie*, 5837.

5093. There is a stop after 'Purs,' no doubt rightly, in F. On the other hand the stop after 'wif' in l. 5096 must be wrong.

5123 f. Cp. 4597 ff.

5215. *standt*. For this spelling cp. 'bidt,' iv. 1162.

5231 ff. The outline of this story might have been got from Ovid and from Hyginus, *Fab.* 40-43, but several points of detail suggest a different source. These are, for example, the idea that the son of Minos went to Athens to study philosophy, the statement of the number of persons sent as a tribute to Minos, the incident of the ball of pitch given by Ariadne to Theseus to be used against the Minotaur, and the name of the island where Ariadne was deserted. In the first and third of these Gower agrees with Chaucer, *Legend of Good Women*, 1894 ff., but his story is apparently quite independent, so that in regard to, these matters we must assume a common source: cp. L. Bech in *Anglia*, v. 337 ff.

as telleth the Poete. The authority referred to here must be Ovid (cp. i. 386, ii. 121, v. 6713, 6804, &c.). He slightly mentions the death of Androgeus, *Metam.* vii. 458, and relates the war of Minos against Megara at some length (*Metam.* viii. 1 ff), very briefly summarising the remainder of the story. Chaucer follows Ovid more fully here, telling the story of Nisus, to which Gower does not think it necessary to refer.

5248. *dighte*. This is the form of spelling here in S as well as F: so also in l. 5352.

5264 f. Hyginus says seven persons each year: Chaucer seems to conceive it as one every third year. The usual account is seven youths and seven maidens either every year or once in nine years.

5302. *many on*. Perhaps we should read ‘manye on’ with S and F, as vii. 2191, ‘manye an other.’

5319. This expression occurs also in ll. 5598 and 7553.

5360. *fawht*. Elsewhere this verb has preterite ‘foghte,’ as iii. 2651, iv. 2095, but the strong form ‘faught’ is used by Chaucer, e. g. *Cant. Tales*, B 3519, and this in fact is the originally correct form.

5413. *Chyo*. Ovid says ‘Dia,’ that is Naxos.

5507. *His rihte name*: cp. *Mirour*, 409, ‘par son droit noun Je l’oi nommer Temptacioun,’ 4243, ‘Si ot a noun par droit nommant,’ &c. and other similar expressions.

5510. *as men telleth*: cp. l. 6045, ‘men seith.’

5511. According to the margin Extortion is the *mother* of Ravine.

5550. *femeline*, used repeatedly both as adjective and as substantive in the *Mirour de l’Omme*.

5551 ff. The tale of Tereus is from Ovid, *Metam.* vi. 424-674, in some parts abbreviated and in others expanded, with good judgement usually in both cases, so that this is one of Gower’s best-told tales. He omits the long account given by Ovid of the way in which Pandion was persuaded to allow Philomela to accompany Tereus (*Metam.* vi. 447-510), the incidents of the rescue of Philomela from her imprisonment, which no doubt he felt would be unintelligible to his readers (587-600), and many of the more shocking details connected with the death of Itys and the feast upon his flesh. On the other hand he has added the prayer and reflections of Philomene in her prison (ll. 5734-5768), the prayers of the two sisters (5817-5860), the words of Progne to Tereus (5915-5927), and especially the reflections on the nightingale and the swallow at the end of the story (5943-6029). This latter part is quite characteristic of our author, and as usual it is prettily conceived.

Chaucer, who tells the story in the *Legend of Good Women*, 2228-2393, was weary of it even from the beginning (2257 f.), and omits the conclusion altogether, either as too shocking or as not suiting with his design. So far as he goes, however, he follows Ovid more closely than Gower.

5555. See note on Prol. 460.

5598. So also ll. 5319, 7553.

5623. Ovid's comparison is to fire catching dry straw and leaves, *Metam.* vi. 456 f.

5643 ff. Ovid compares her state after the deed was done to that of a lamb hurt by a wolf and still trembling, or a dove which has escaped wounded from a bird of prey (527-530). Here, on the other hand, the idea is of being held fast, so that she cannot move or escape; while Chaucer, using the same similes as Ovid, applies the comparison less appropriately to her fear of the violence yet to come.

5651. Cp. *Metam.* vi. 531, 'Mox ubi mens rediit.'

5663 ff.

'si copia detur,
In populos veniam; si silvis clausa tenebor,
Implebo silvas, et conscia saxa movebo.' *Metam.* vi. 545
ff.

5670. I suspect the combination 'tale and ende' may have arisen from some such phrase as 'to sette tale on ende' (or 'an ende'), meaning to begin a speech: see *New Engl. Dict.* under 'ende.'

5676. *where is thi fere?* that is, 'where is thy fear of the gods?' We must not take 'fere' in the sense of 'companion' or 'equal,' because in that case it could not properly rhyme with 'Ere.'

5690 f.

'comprensam forcipe linguam
Abstulit ense fero.' *Metam.* vi. 556 f.

Gower must be commended for omitting the tasteless lines which follow in Ovid about the severed tongue, and still more the shocking statement, which even Ovid accompanies with 'vix ausim credere,' of 561 f.

5709. *tyh*, preterite of 'ten,' from OE. 'tēon,' meaning 'draw,' and hence 'come.'

5724. The punctuation follows F, 'To hire' meaning 'in her case,' cp. l. 4182, vii. 4937. It would suit the sense better perhaps to set the comma after 'forsake,' and to take 'To hire' with what follows: cp. note on l. 3966, where it is shown that the punctuation of F is often wrong in such cases as this.

5726. *hir Sostres mynde*, 'her sister's memory.'

5730. *guile under the gore*, that is, deceit concealed, as it were, under a cloak: cp. l. 6680. The expression 'under gore' is common enough, meaning the same as 'under wede,' and this alliterative form looks like a proverbial expression.

5734-5768. All this is original.

5737. *so grete a wo*: cp. l. 6452, and see Introduction, p. cx.

5778. 'nec scit quid tradat in illis,' *Metam.* vi. 580.

5793. 'Non est lacrimis hic, inquit, agendum, Sed ferro,' *Metam.* vi. 611.

5802 ff. According to Ovid this was done under cover of a Bacchic festival (587 ff.).

5816-5860. This is all original.

5840. *to lytel of me let*: see note on l. 1004.

5891 ff. Gower does well in omitting the circumstances of this which Ovid gives (619-646), and in partially covering the horror of it by the excuse of madness, but there is one touch which ought to have been brought in, 'Ah, quam Es similis patri!' (621).

5910 ff. Ovid says that Philomela threw the gory head into the father's face, and that Tereus endeavoured to vomit up that which he had eaten. Our author has shown good taste in not following him.

5915 ff. This speech is not in Ovid.

5943-6029. Nearly all this is Gower's own. Ovid only says, 'Quarum petit altera silvas: Altera tecta subit' (668 f.). We have already observed upon our author's tendency to make additions of this symbolical kind to the stories which he takes from Ovid: see note on i. 2355.

6020. The reading 'here' is given both by S and F, but 'hire' ('hir'), supported by AJMXGCB₂, BT, W, seems to be required by the sense. She informs them of the falseness of her husband, that they also may learn to beware of them, that is of husbands. The combination of 'here' with the singular 'housebonde,' meaning 'their husbands,' would be very harsh.

6041 ff.

'Ille dolore suo, poenaeque cupidine velox,
Vertitur in volucrem, cui stant in vertice cristae,
Prominet immodicum pro longa cuspidē rostrum.
Nomen Epops volucris, facies armata videtur.'

Metam. vi. 671 ff.

The lapwing is identified with the hoopoe because of its crest. In the *Traitié*, xii, where this story is shortly told, Tereus is changed into a 'hupe,'

'Dont dieus lui ad en hupe transformée,
En signe qu'il fuist fals et avoltier,'

while at the same time in the *Mirour*, 8869 ff., the 'hupe' is represented as the bird which tries to deceive those who search for its nest, a description which obviously belongs to the lapwing.

6047. Cp. Chaucer, *Parl. of Foules*, 347, 'The false lapwyng ful of trecherye.'

6053. *goddes forebode*: cp. Chaucer, *Leg. of Good Women*, 10,

'But goddes forbode but men schulde leve,'

where the second form of text has

'But god forbode but men shulde leve.'

We must take 'forebode' as a substantive.

6073. *auht*: modified to suit the rhyme: so ‘awht,’ i. 2770, and ‘naght,’ l. 3786, rhyming with ‘straght.’ The regular forms for Gower are ‘oght,’ ‘noght.’

6145 ff. This is from Ovid, *Metam.* ii. 569-588. Gower has judiciously kept it apart from the story of Coronis and the raven, told by him in the second book, with which it is combined in rather a confusing manner by Ovid. The story is somewhat expanded by Gower.

6150. *wif to Marte*: cp. 1214 f.

6169. *And caste*: cp. l. 4590, and see note on i. 1895.

6197. ‘mota est pro virgine virgo, Auxiliumque tulit,’ *Metam.* ii. 579 f., but Ovid says nothing of any special prayer to Pallas for help, nor does he represent that Cornix was before in attendance upon that goddess.

6207 ff. This is original and characteristic of our author.

6225 ff. This story is from Ovid, *Metam.* ii. 409-507, but Gower evidently knew it from other sources also, for the name Calistona (or Callisto) is not given by Ovid, who calls her ‘virgo Nonacrina’ and ‘Parrhasis.’ Hyginus tells it in various forms, *Fab.* 177 and *Poet. Astr.* ii. 2.

6255. According to Ovid, Diana was quite ignorant of the fact, though the nymphs suspected it.

6258. *in a ragerie*, that is ‘in sport’: cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, E 1847, and the use of the verb ‘rage,’ e. g. i. 1764 and *Cant. Tales*, A 257, 3273, 3958.

6275 ff. ‘I procul hinc, dixit, nec sacros pollue fontes,’ *Metam.* ii. 464.

6281. F has a stop after ‘schame.’

6291 ff. This address is mostly original: cp. *Metam.* ii. 471 ff.

6334 ff.

‘Arcuit omnipotens, pariterque ipsosque nefasque
Sustulit, et celeri raptos per inania vento
Imposuit caelo vicinaque sidera fecit.’

Metam. ii. 505 ff.

Latin Verses, x. The idea expressed is that though examples of virginity can only be produced through marriage, yet virginity is nobler than marriage, as the flower of a rose is nobler than the stock from which it springs. Marriage, in fact, replenishes the earth, but virginity heaven: cp. *Trait.* ii.

6359 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 17119 ff., where the saying is attributed to Jerome, who says in fact that precedence was given in the streets to the Vestal Virgins by the highest magistrates, and even by victors riding in the triumphal car (*adv. Jovin.* ii. 41).

6372 ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 18301 ff. The anecdote is taken from Valerius Maximus, *Mem.* iv. 5, but the name in the original is 'Spurina,' and he does not thrust out his eyes, but merely destroys the beauty of his face. In the *Mirour* it is 'Coupa ses membres.'

6385 ff. 'So may I prove that, if a man will weigh the virtues, he will find that virginity is to be praised above all others.' The sentence is disordered for the sake of the rhymes: cp. ii. 709 ff.

6389. The quotation from the Apocalypse is given in the margin of *SA* and in *Mirour*, 17053 ff. The reference is to Rev. xiv. 4.

6395* ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 17067 and note.

6398 ff. This also appears in *Mirour*, 17089 ff., and *Traitié*, xvi. It may have been taken from the *Epistola Valerii ad Rufinum*.

6402. The margin makes him 'octogenarius,' and so it is also in the *Mirour* and *Traitié*, as well as in the *Epistola Valerii*.

6435 ff. This shows more knowledge than could have been got from the *Roman de Troie*. The story is told by Hyginus, *Fab.* 121, but not exactly as we have it here. This 'Criseide douhter of Crisis' should be distinguished from the Criseide daughter of Calchas (Briseïda in the *Roman de Troie*), who is associated with Troilus, if it is worth while making distinctions where so much confusion prevails.

6442. *dangerous*, that is, 'grudging' or 'reluctant': cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, D 1090, and see note on i. 2443.

6452. *So grete a lust*: cp. l. 5737 and Introduction, p. cx.

6498. *as a Pocok doth*. It is difficult to see the appropriateness of the comparison, for to 'stalke' is to go cautiously or secretly, and that is evidently the meaning here, so that any idea of display is out of the question. The peacock was supposed to be ashamed of its ugly feet, cp. *Mirour*, 23459, and in the *Secretum Secretorum* we actually have the expression 'humilis et obediens ut pavo,' translated by Lydgate (or Burgh) 'Meeke as a pecock.' Albertus Magnus says, 'Cum aspicitur ad solem, decorem ostentat, et alio tempore occultat quantum poterit' (*De Animalibus*, 23). There seems to have been a notion that it was liable to have its pride humbled and to slink away ashamed.

6526. *bile under the winge*, that is, concealed, as a bird's head under its wing: apparently proverbial.

6541. *I mai remene ... mene*. This is apparently the reading of the MSS. The meaning of 'remene' is properly to bring back. It is used earlier, i. 279, with reference to the application of the teaching about vices generally to the case of love, and here it seems to have much the same sense. 'So that I may apply what has been said about this craft directly' ('Withouten help of eny mene') to the case of lovers, they being very evidently offenders in this way.

6581. *hire it is*: but in l. 4470, 'It schal ben hires.'

6608 ff. For the construction see note on i. 718.

6620. *Danger*: see note on i. 2443.

6634. *slyke*: cp. l. 7092*, 'He can so wel hise wordes slyke.' The word means properly to smoothe, hence to flatter: cp. the modern 'sleek.'

6635. *Be him*, &c., i. e. by his own resources or by the help of any other.

6636. *To whom*: see note on i. 771.

6654. *a nyht*, i. e. by night, also written 'anyht,' ii. 2857.

6672. *Protheüs*, that is Proteus: cp. note on l. 3082.

6674. *in what liknesse*, 'into any form whatsoever.'

6680. *under the palle*, 'in secret,' like 'under the gore,' l. 5730.

6713 ff. From Ovid, *Metam.* iv. 192-255, but with several changes. In the original story the Sun-god came to Leucothoe by night and in the form of her mother. Clytie (not Clymene) discovered the fact (without the aid of Venus) and told it to the father; and it was an incense plant which grew from the place where Leucothoe was buried.

6757. For the expression cp. iii. 2555, 'Achastus, which with Venus was Hire priest.'

6779. This change into a flower which follows the sun is suggested by *Metam.* iv. 266 ff., where we are told that Clytie was changed into a heliotrope. Here it is a sun-flower apparently.

6807 ff. From Ovid, *Fasti*, ii. 305-358. The 'mistress' of whom Ovid speaks is Omphale, but Gower supposed it to be Iole. He gets 'Thophis' as the name of the cave from a misunderstanding of l. 317, and apparently he read 'Saba' for 'Lyda' in l. 356, out of which he has got his idea of a goddess Saba with attendant nymphs. This feature, though based on a mistake, is a decided improvement of the story, which is told by Gower in a spirited and humorous manner.

6848 ff. The reading of X in this passage is also that of GOAd₂.

6899. The punctuation is that of F.

6932. *al a route*: so iv. 2145, cp. l. 6257, 'al a compainie.'

7013. Cp. *Mirour*, 7181 ff.

7048. This is a nautical metaphor, 'so near the wind will they steer.' The verb 'love' is the modern 'luff,' meaning to bring a ship's head towards the wind. The substantive 'lof' (genit. 'loves') means in ME. a rudder or some similar contrivance for turning the ship, and 'love' here seems to mean simply to steer. The rhyme with 'glove' makes 'love' from 'lufian' out of the question, even if it gave a satisfactory sense.

7140. *gon offre*. The ceremony of 'offering' after mass was one which involved a good deal of etiquette as regards precedence and so on, cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, A 449 ff., and ladies apparently were led up to the altar on these occasions by their cavaliers.

7179. 'If I might manage in any other way,' like the expression '(I cannot) away with,' &c.

7195 ff. The story comes no doubt from Benoît, *Rom. de Troie*, 2851-4916, where it is told at much greater length. Guido does not differ much as regards the incidents related by Gower, but by comparing the two texts in some particular places we can tell without much difficulty which was Gower's source. For example, in the speech of Hector Benoît has,

‘Veez Europe que il ont,
La tierce partie del mont,
Où sont li meillor chevalier.’ 3791 ff.,

while Guido says, ‘Nostis enim ... totam Affricam et Europam hodie Grecis esse subiectam, quanta Greci multitudine militum sunt suffulti,’ &c. See below, 7340 ff.

The story is told by Gower with good judgement, and he freely omits unnecessary details, as those of the mission of Antenor to Greece. The debate in Priam's parliament is shortened, and the speeches of Hector and Paris much improved.

7197 ff. Cp. 3303 ff.

7202. The sentence is broken off and resumed in a different form: see note on i. 98.

7015* ff. Cp. *Mirour*, 7156 ff.

7033*. *And that*, i. e. ‘And provided that.’

7092*. See note on l. 6634.

7105* ff. The tale is told also in the *Mirour de l'Omme*, 7093-7128. It is to be found in the *Gesta Romanorum* (which however is not Gower's source), and in various other places. Cicero tells what is practically the same story of Dionysius of Syracuse (*De Nat. Deorum*, iii. 34), but the acts of sacrilege were committed by him in various places. The golden mantle was taken from the statue of Zeus at Olympia, and the beard from that of Aesculapius at Epidaurus, the justification in this latter case being that

Apollo, the father of Aesculapius, was always represented without a beard. Those who repeated the anecdote in the Middle Ages naturally missed this point. We may note that Dyonis is the name given in the *Mirour*.

7213 ff. Cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 2779 ff.

7235 ff. *Rom. de Troie*, 3029 ff. Gower has judiciously cut short the architectural details.

7275. *Esionam*: see note on l. 6719.

7307. *in his yhte*, 'in his possession.' For the substance of these lines cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 2915-2950.

7372. *schape ye*, imperative, for *schapeth*; so 'Sey ye' in l. 7435.

7377. *Strong thing*, i. e. a hard thing to bear. This is apparently a translation of the French 'fort,' which was very commonly used in the sense of 'difficult': see the examples in Godefroy's Dictionary, e. g. 'forte chose est de çou croire,' 'fors choses est a toi guerrier ancontre moi.'

7390 ff. 'Ten men have been seen to deal with a hundred and to have had the better.'

7400. *Rom. de Troie*, 3842, 'L'autrier ès kalendes de Mai,' &c. The word 'ender' is an adjective meaning 'former,' originally perhaps an adverb. It is used only in the expressions 'ender day' and 'ender night.' The combination 'enderday' occurs in i. 98.

7420. *Rom. de Troie*, 3889 f.,

'Cascune conseilla à mei
Privéement et en segrei,' &c.

7451 ff. For Cassandra as the Sibyl cp. Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 214 (ed. 1584).

7497 f.

‘Molt est isnele Renommée,
Savoir fist tost par la contrée,’ &c.

Rom. de Troie, 4299 ff.

7555 ff. The further incidents of the embarkation and of the voyage home, *Rom. de Troie*, 4505-4832, are omitted.

7576 f. Cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 4867 ff.

7591 ff. This incident is related in the *Rom. de Troie*, 17457 ff. The occasion was an anniversary celebration at the tomb of Hector, and though the temple of Apollo is not actually named here by Benoît, it has been previously described at large as Hector’s burial place.

7597 ff. The scene in Chaucer’s *Troilus*, i. 155 ff., is well known. He took it from Boccaccio.

7612. In the treatment of Avarice Gower has departed entirely from the plan of fivefold division which he follows in the first three books, as throughout in the *Mirour*. In the sixth book he deliberately declines to deal with more than two of the branches of Gule (vi. 12f.), and the treatment of Lechery is also irregular.

7651. *here tuo debat*, i. e. the strife of those two.

7716. *the Cote for the hod*: that is, he gets a return larger than the amount that he gave; a different form of the expression from that which we have in l. 4787.

7719. *hors*: probably plural in both cases.

7724. ‘If a man will go by the safe way.’

7736 ff. This saying is not really quoted from Seneca, but from Caecilius Balbus, *Nug. Phil.* xi. It must have been in Chaucer’s mind when he wrote ‘Suffice unto thy good, though it be smal,’ that is, ‘Adapt thy life to thy worldly fortune.’

7830 f. I take this to mean, ‘And suddenly to meet his flowers the summer appears and is rich.’ For the meaning of ‘hapneth’ see the examples in the *New English Dictionary*.

7838. *be war*: written as one word in F and afterwards divided by a stroke.

LIB. VI.

Latin Verses. i. 6. *ruit* seems to be transitive, ‘casts down.’

i. 7. Rather involved in order: ‘on the lips which Bacchus intoxicates and which are plunged in sleep.’

4. *mystymed*, ‘unhappily produced.’ In other places, as i. 220, iii. 2458, the word seems to mean to order or arrange wrongly. The OE. ‘mistīman’ means to happen amiss.

7. *dedly*, ‘mortal,’ i. e. subject to death.

34. *wext*, ‘he waxeth’: for the omission of the pronoun see note on i. 1895 and cp. ll. 149, 213, 367, below.

57. For the form of expression cp. i. 380, ii. 2437, and below, l. 106.

59. *sterte* is for ‘stert,’ pres. tense.

70. *in vers*, that is ‘in order.’ The word ‘vers’ is given in Godefroy’s Dictionary with the sense ‘state,’ ‘situation’; e. g. *Rom. de la Rose*, 9523 ff.,

‘Malement est changies li vers,
Or li vient li gieus si divers,
Qu’el ne puet ne n’ose joer.’

71 f. Cp. *Mirour*, 8246 f.

84. *the jolif wo*: cp. i. 88, vii. 1910, and *Balades*, xii. 4, ‘Si porte ades le jolif mal sanz cure.’

105. *of such a thew*, ‘by such a habit’ (i. e. of love), to be taken with ‘dronkelew.’

144. *hovedance*, ‘court dance’: see *New Eng. Dictionary*.

145. *the newefot*: written thus as one word in S and F: it must be regarded as the name of some dance.

160. *it am noght I*: cp. Chaucer, *Leg. of G. Women*, 314, 'sir, hit am I,' *Cant. Tales*, A 1736, &c.

188. *holde forth the lusti route*: perhaps simply, 'continue to be with the merry company.' See 'forth' in the Glossary.

218. *vernage*: the same wine that is called 'gernache' or 'garnache' in the *Mirour de l'Omme*, 'vernaccia' in Italian, but whether a wine of Italy or Greece seems uncertain.

221. *at myn above*: see note on iv. 914.

239. *the blanche fievere*: cp. Chaucer, *Troilus*, i. 916, with Skeat's note.

249. Cp. Chaucer, *Troilus*, i. 420, 'For hete of cold, for cold of hete, I dye.'

253. *of such reles*: this seems to men 'of such strength,' and 'relais' perhaps has a somewhat similar sense in *Mirour*, 3021,

'C'est droit qu'il sente le relais
De la tempeste et de l'orage.'

As in the modern 'relay,' the idea of ceasing or of relaxation may be accompanied by the notion of fresh vigour taking the place of exhaustion, and so the word may stand simply for strength or freshness.

If this explanation is not admissible, we must suppose that 'reles' means here the power of relaxing or dissolving.

285 f. Cp. *Rom. de la Rose*, 4326 f.,

'C'est la soif qui tous jors est ivre,
Yvrece qui de soif s'enyvre.'

290. *liste*: perhaps pret. subjunctive; so l. 606, and 'leste,' 357.

296. *be the bend*, i. e. 'by the band,' at his girdle.

311 f. 'This for the time alleviates the pain for him who has no other joy.' 'As for the time yit' means simply 'for the time,' cp. ll. 738, 893.

321. For 'men' with singular verb cp. ii. 659, v. 5510, 6045, vii. 1352, and Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, A 149, &c.

330 ff. Cp. viii. 2252 ff. and. *Traitié*, xv. 2. The poet referred to in the margin is perhaps Homer, who is quoted in the *Rom. de la Rose* as authority for an arrangement somewhat similar to that described here:

'Jupiter en toute saison
A sor le suel de sa maison,
Ce dit Omers, deus plains tonneaus;
Si n'est viex hons ne garçonneaus,
N'il n'est dame ne damoisele,
Soit vielle ou jone, laide ou bele,
Qui vie en ce monde reçoive,
Qui de ces deus tonneaus ne boive.
C'est une taverne planière,
Dont Fortune la tavernière
Trait aluine et piment en coupes' &c. 6836 ff. (ed. Méon).

Gower has applied the idea especially to the subject of love, and has made Cupid the butler instead of Fortune. The basis in Homer is *Il.* xxiv. 527 ff.,

δοιοὶ γάρ τε πίθοι κατακείαται ἐν Διὸς οὔδῃ, κ.τ.λ.

360. *trouble* is properly an adjective, cp. v. 4160. The corrupt reading 'chere' for 'cler' has hitherto obscured the sense.

399 ff. This story of Bacchus is told by Hyginus, *Poet. Astr.* ii, under the heading 'Aries.'

437. *a riche temple*. This was the temple of Jupiter Ammon.

439. 'To remind thirsty men' of the power of prayer.

485 ff. The story is from Ovid, *Metam.* xii. 210 ff.

502 f. *thilke tonne drouh, wherof, &c.*, 'drew such wine for them that by it,' &c. See note on i. 771 and cp. ll. 618 and 1249 of this book.

537. I do not know what authority is referred to.

598. *unteid*, 'set free,' so 'wandering abroad.'

609. The name of this second branch of Gluttony has not been mentioned before.

632 f. 'so long as he has wealth by which he may be provided with the means.' For the use of 'founde' cp. v. 2690 and Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, C 537, 'How gret labour and cost is thee to fynde!' (addressing the belly).

640. *for the point of his relief*, 'in order to please him,' so below 'he is noght relieved,' l. 678.

656. *toke*, subjunctive, 'how he should take it.'

662. After this line a couplet is inserted by Pauli from the Harleian MS. 7184 (H₃),

To take metes and drinkes newe,
For it shulde alwey eschewe.'

The lines are nonsense and have no metre. They come originally from K, the copyist of which apparently inserted them out of his own head, to fill up a space left by the accidental omission of two lines (645 f.) a little above in the same column. He was making his book correspond column for column with the copy, and therefore discovered his mistake when he reached the bottom, but did not care to draw attention to it by inserting what he had omitted.

663. 'Physique' is apparently meant for the Physics of Aristotle, and something very like this maxim is to be found there, but the quotation, 'Consuetudo est altera natura,' is actually taken from the *Secretum Secretorum* (ed. 1520, f. 21).

664. The transposition after this line of the passage ll. 665-964, which occurs in MSS. of the second recension, is not accidental, as we see by the arrangements made afterwards for fitting in the passage (l. 1146). The

object apparently was to lay down the principle ‘*Delicie corporis militant aduersus animam*,’ illustrated by the parable of Dives and Lazarus, before proceeding to the discussion of ‘*Delicacie*’ in the case of love, and this is perhaps the more logical arrangement; but the alteration, as it is made, involves breaking off the discussion here of the ill effects of change, and resuming it after an interval of nearly two hundred lines.

674. *Awise hem wel*, i. e. ‘let them take good heed.’

683. ‘Without regard to her honour’: cp. *Balades*, xxii. 4, ‘*Salvant toutdis l’estat de vostre honour*.’

709. *abeched*, from the French ‘*abechier*,’ to feed, used properly of feeding young birds. The word ‘*refreched*’ is conformed to it in spelling.

728. The reading of Pauli, ‘I say I am nought gilteles,’ just reverses the sense. Berthelette has the text right here.

738. *for a time yit*: cp. 311, ‘As for the time yit,’ and 893, ‘As for the while yit.’

770. ‘Without wrinkle of any kind,’ cp. *Mirour*, 10164, ‘*Car moult furont de noble grein*’; or perhaps ‘Without the smallest wrinkle,’ ‘*grein*’ being taken to stand for the smallest quantity of a thing: cp. ii. 3310.

778. Cp. Chaucer, *Book of the Duchess*, 939 ff.

785. *schapthe*. For this form, which is given by S and F, cp. the word ‘*sseppe*,’ meaning ‘creature’ or ‘form,’ which occurs repeatedly in the *Ayenbite of Inwyt*.

800. ‘And if it seemed so to all others.’ The person spoken of throughout this passage as ‘he,’ ‘him,’ is the eye of the lover. This seems to itself to have sufficient sustenance by merely gazing on the beloved object, and if it seemed so to all others also, that is, to the other senses, the eye would never cease to feed upon the sight: but they, having other needs, compel it to turn away.

809. *as thogh he faste*: the verb seems to be pret. subjunctive, as ‘*syhe*’ down below.

817. *tireth*. This expresses the action of a falcon pulling at its prey: cp. Chaucer, *Troilus*, i. 787, ‘*Whos stomak foules tiren everemo*.’ The word is

used in the same sense also in the *Mirour*, 7731.

845. *mi ladi goode*, 'my lady's goodness.'

857. Lombard cooks were celebrated, and there was a kind of pastry called 'pain lombard,' *Mirour*, 7809.

879. The romance of Ydoine and Amadas is one of those mentioned at the beginning of the *Cursor Mundi*. It has been published in the 'Collection des poètes français du moyen âge' (ed. Hippeau, 1863). Amadas is the type of the lover who remains faithful through every kind of trial.

891. *a cherie feste*: cp. Prol. 454. It is an expression used for pleasures that last but a short time: cp. Audelay's Poems (Percy Soc. xiv) p. 22,

'Hit fallus and fadys forth so doth a chere fayre'

(speaking of the glory of this world).

893. Cp. 311, 738.

897. *he*, i. e. my ear.

908. *me lacketh*: the singular form is due perhaps to the use of the verb impersonally in many cases.

961. *excede*, subjunctive, 'so as to go beyond reason.'

986 ff. This story furnishes a favourable example of our author's style and versification. It is told simply and clearly, and the verse is not only smooth and easy, but carefully preserved from monotony by the breaking of the couplet very frequently at the pauses: see 986, 998, 1006, 1010, 1016, &c.

995. We have remarked already upon Gower's fatalism, iii. 1348, &c. Here we may refer also to ll. 1026, 1613, 1702, for further indications of the same tendency.

1059. *is overronne*, that is, 'has passed beyond.'

1110. *descryve*, apparently 'understand,' 'discern,' perhaps by that confusion with 'descry' which is noted in the *New Engl. Dictionary*.

1149 f. These two lines are omitted without authority by Pauli.

1176. That is, though they had rendered no services for which they ought to be so distinguished.

1180. *sojourned*: the word is used in French especially of a horse kept in stable at rack and manger and refreshed for work: see *Mirour*, Glossary.

1216. 'So that that pleasure should not escape him.'

1245. *out of feere*, 'without fear.'

1262. *unwar*, here 'unknown': cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, B 427, 'The unwar wo or harm that comth behinde.'

1295. Originally geomancy seems to have been performed, as suggested in this passage, by marks made in sand or earth, then by casual dots on paper: see the quotations under 'geomancy' in the *New Engl. Dictionary*. Gower here mentions the four recognized kinds of divination, by the elements of earth, water, fire, and air.

1306 ff. It is practically certain that Gower was acquainted with the treatise ascribed to Albertus Magnus, called *Speculum Astronomie* or *De libris licitis et illicitis* (*Alberti Magni Opera*, v. 655 ff.), since he seems to follow it to a great extent not only here, but also in his list of early astronomers (vii. 1449 ff.). There are however some things here which he must have had from other sources; for there is no mention in the above-mentioned treatise of 'Spatula,' 'Babilla,' 'Cernes,' 'Honorius.'

1312. *comun rote*, that is, apparently, 'common custom.' The word 'rote' is used also below, l. 1457, where it appears to mean 'condition.' It must be the same as that which appears in the phrase 'by rote,' and it is difficult to believe that it can be the French 'route,' as is usually said. The rhyme here and in l. 1457, as well as those in Chaucer (with 'cote,' 'note'), show that the 'o' had an open sound, and this would be almost impossible from French 'ou.' The expression 'par routine' or 'par rotine' is given by Cotgrave as equivalent to the English 'by rote,' but I am not aware of any use of such an expression in French as early as the fourteenth century. Many of the examples of the phrase 'by rote' seem to have to do with singing or church services (cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, B 1712, *Piers Plowmans Crede*, 379), and Du Cange gives a quotation in which 'rotæ' seems to mean 'chants' or 'hymns' ('rota,' 6). From such a sense as this the

idea of a regular order of service, and thence of ‘custom,’ ‘habit,’ might without much difficulty arise.

1314 ff. The following passage from the *Spec. Astronomiae*, cap. 10, gives most of the names and terms which occur in these lines: ‘Ex libris vero Toz Graeci est liber de stationibus ad cultum Veneris, qui sic incipit: *Commemoratio historiarum* ... Ex libris autem Salomonis est liber de quatuor anulis, quem intitulat nominibus quatuor discipulorum suorum, qui sic incipit: *De arte eutonica et ideica*, &c. Et liber de nouem candariis.... Et alius paruus de sigillis ad dæmoniacos, qui sic incipit: *Caput sigilli gendal et tanchil*.’

1316. *Razel*. ‘Est autem unus liber magnus Razielis, qui dicitur liber institutionum,’ &c. In MS. Ashmole 1730 there is a letter to Dr. Richard Napier from his nephew at Oxford, speaking of a book of Solomon in the University Library called *Cephar Razel*, that is, he explains, ‘Angelus magnus secreti Creatoris,’ of which he proposes to make a copy, having obtained means of entering the library at forbidden hours. Again, in MS. Ashmole 1790 there is a description of this book.

1320. ‘cui adiungitur liber Beleni de horarum opere,’ *Spec. Astron.* p. 661. The seal of Ghenbal is the ‘sigillum gendal,’ mentioned in the former citation.

1321 f. *thymage Of Thebith*. Thebith (or Thebit) stands for Thabet son of Corah, a distinguished Arabian mathematician, to whom were attributed certain works on astrology and magic that were current in Latin. Thus we find *Thebit de imaginibus* very commonly in MSS., and a *Liber Thebit ben Corat de tribus imaginibus magicis* was printed in 1559 at Frankfort. In this latter book the author says, ‘Exercentur quoque hae imagines in amore vel odio, si fuerit actor earum prouidus et sapiens in motibus coeli ad hoc utilibus.’ Thebith is mentioned several times in the *Spec. Astronomiae*, e. g. p. 662, ‘Super istis imaginibus reperitur unus liber Thebith eben Chorath,’ &c. We must take ‘therupon’ in l. 1321 to mean ‘moreover,’ for it is not to be supposed that the image of Thebith was upon the seal of Ghenbal.

1338. The ‘Naturiens’ are those who pursue the methods of astrology, as opposed to those who practise necromancy (‘nigromance’) or black magic.

1356. *He bede nevere*: see note on v. 4455.

1359. *red*, originally written 'rede' in F, but the final letter was afterwards erased. See Introduction, p. cxiv.

1371 f. The rhyme requires that 'become,' 'overcome' shall either be both present or both preterite (subjunctive), and 'wonne' seems to decide the matter for preterite. The only difficulty is 'have I' for 'hadde I' in l. 1370, the latter being required also by the sense (for the reference is to the former time of youth), but not given by the MSS. 'So that I wonne' means 'Provided that I won.'

1391 ff. This story is from the *Roman de Troie*, 28571-28666, 29629-30092. Guido does not differ as to the main points, but there are several details given by Gower from Benoît which are not found in Guido. In particular the ensign carried by Telegonus is mentioned by Guido only in telling of the dream of Ulysses. Some of the passages which tend to show that Benoît was our author's authority are noted below.

1408. *al the strengthe of herbes*: a poem *De Viribus Herbarum* passed in the Middle Ages under the name of Macer.

1422. The mention of 'nedle and ston' in this connexion is a rather daring anachronism, for which of course Gower is responsible.

1424. *Cilly*. Benoît says 'les isles d'Oloi,' and Guido 'in Eolidem insulam,' but Sicily has been mentioned shortly before.

1438 f. Cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 28594 ff. Guido does not mention it.

1441. 'S'el sot des arz, il en sot plus,' *Rom. de Troie*, 28641.

1445 ff. Benoît says nothing of this, but the story of the adventures of Ulysses was to some extent matter of common knowledge in the Middle Ages. Gower may have had it from Ovid, *Metam.* xiv. 277 ff. Guido says in a general way that Circe was in the habit of transforming those who resisted her power into beasts.

1457. *into such a rote*, that is, 'into such a habit' (or 'condition'): see note on l. 1312.

1467. *toswolle bothe sides*, 'with both her sides swollen': cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 28660 f.,

‘Et si li lesse les costez
Toz pleins, ço quit, de vif enfant.’

1474. *understode*: subj., see note on Prol. 460.

1481. *on of al the beste*, see note on iv. 2606.

1513 f. *margin*. This quotation is not from Horace, but from Ovid, *Pont.* iv. 3. 35. Cp. *Mirour*, 10948, where the same quotation occurs and is attributed as here to ‘Orace.’

1524. The form ‘stature’ is required by the metre here, and is given by the best MSS. of the second and third recensions. In Prol. 891, where ‘statue’ occurs, it is reduced to a monosyllable by elision, and so it is in Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, A 975, 1955. The forms ‘statura,’ ‘stature,’ are found with this sense in the Latin and French of the time.

1541 ff.

‘Et si me disoit: Hulixes
Saiches, ceste conjuncions,
Cist vouloir, ceste asembloisons,
Que de moi et de toi desirres,
Ce sunt dolours et mortex ires.’

Rom. de Troie, 29670 ff.

The prediction, however, that one of the two would have his death by reason of their meeting comes later, 29699, whereas Guido combines the materials here much in the same way as Gower.

1552 ff. This idea of a pennon embroidered with a device is Gower’s own conception, constructed from the not very clear or satisfactory account of the matter given by his authority here and later, 29819 ff. The fact is that Benoît did not understand the expression used in the Latin book (the so-called ‘Dictys Cretensis’) which he was here following, the passage being probably corrupt in his copy, and consequently failed to make it intelligible to his readers. The original statement (made with reference to the ensign carried afterwards by Telegonus) is, ‘Ithacam venit gerens manibus

quoddam hastile, cui summitas marinae turturis osse armabatur, scilicet insigne insulae eius in qua genitus erat.’ The meaning apparently is that his spearhead was made of a sea-turtle’s shell. Benoît, in recounting the vision, says that the figure which appeared bore upon the steel head of his lance a crown worked of the bone of a sea-fish,

‘Portoit une coronne ovrée
D’os de poisson de mer salée.’ 29687 f.

Then afterwards, in telling of the departure of Telegonus to seek his father, he says that, to show of what country he was, he bore on the top of his lance the sign of a sea-fish worked like a tower,

‘En semblance de tor ovrée.’ 29822.

Guido apparently was not able to make much of this, and after saying, in the account of the dream, that at the top of the lance there appeared ‘quedam turricula tota ex piscibus artificiose composita’ (Bodl. MS. Laud 645, with variants ‘craticula,’ MS. Add. 365, ‘curricula,’ printed editions), he subsequently omitted mention of the recognisance.

1561 f. *A signe it is ... Of an Empire.* Benoît has,

‘Que c’iert d’ampire conoissance
Et si aperte demostrance
Que por ce seroient devis,’ &c. 29695 ff.,

which may perhaps mean, ‘that it was the cognisance of a kingdom and a sign that they should be divided.’ In Guido, however, it is ‘hoc est signum impie disiunccionis’ (MS. Laud 645 and printed text), or ‘hoc est signum impii et disiunccionis’ (MS. Add. 365).

1567 f. Cp. 2296 ff.

1603 ff. For the order of the clauses here cp. ii. 709, iv. 3520 ff.

1622 ff. *That*, for ‘Til that’; cp. iv. 3273, v. 3422.

1636. 'And he made himself ready forthwith.' For the omission of the pronoun even where the subject is changed cp. v. 3291, 4590.

1637 ff. Cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 29824 ff. Guido says nothing about it.

1643. That is, 'to avoid espial and wrong suspicions.'

1656. *Rom. de Troie*, 29801 f.,

'A Hulyxes, qui fut ses druz,
Mande par lui v. c. saluz.'

Guido says nothing about this.

1660. *Nachaie*, a mistake for 'Acaie,'

'Tant qu'il vint droit en Acaie';

and this again seems to be from 'Ithaca.'

1685. *and welnyh ded*: cp. *Rom. de Troie*, 29906 f. Guido says only 'et ab illis est grauitur vulneratus.'

1689. Gower has judiciously reduced the number from fifteen (*Rom. de Troie*, 29902).

1696. *for wroth*, that is, 'by reason that he was wroth': see note on iv. 1330. We can hardly take 'wroth' as a substantive.

1701. 'Se il ne fust un poi guenchiz,' *Rom. de Troie*, 29939.

1707. *With al the signe*, 'together with the signe,' like the French 'ove tout'; cp. *Mirour* 4 (note).

1745 f. *Rom. de Troie*, 30022 ff. Guido omits this.

1769 ff. For this repetition cp. 2095 ff.

1785. The 'Cronique imperial' is evidently the story itself, and not any particular book in which it is to be found.

1789 ff. The authority which is mainly followed by our author for this story is the Anglo-Norman *Roman de toute Chevalerie*, by Eustace (or

Thomas) of Kent. The beginning of this, including all that we have to do with here, has been printed by M. Paul Meyer in his book on the Alexander romances, 'Bibliothèque française du moyen âge' vol. iv. pp. 195-216. Gower was acquainted, however, also with the Latin *Historia Alexandri de Preliis*, and has made use of this in certain places, as (1) in the account of Philip's vision (2129-2170) where he probably found the French unintelligible, and (2) in the story of the death of Nectanabus (2289 ff.), of which the Latin authority certainly gives the more satisfactory account.

The following are some of the points in which Gower agrees with the *Roman de toute Chevalerie* against the two Latin versions of the story, viz. the *Historia de Preliis* and the *Res Gestae Alexandri* of Valerius: (1) the celebration by Olympias of the festival of her nativity, when she rides out on a white mule and is first seen by Nectanabus, ll. 1823-1880; (2) the omission of the sealing of the queen's womb by Nectanabus, this being introduced only in Philip's vision; (3) the question of the queen as to how she shall procure further interviews with the god, and the answer of Nectanabus, ll. 2109 ff.; (4) the circumstances connected with the egg from which the serpent was hatched, ll. 2219 ff. The English metrical Romance of Alexander, printed by Weber, is also taken from the *Roman de toute Chevalerie*, and consequently the details of it are for the most part the same as those in Gower. It is certain, however, that Gower does not follow this. It would be quite contrary to his practice to follow an English authority, and apart from this there are many small matters here in which he agrees with the French as against the English, e. g. the name Nectanabus, which is Neptanabus in the English (Anectanabus in the *Hist. de Preliis*), the mention of the *nativity* of Olympias as the occasion of her festival, 'Grant feste tint la dame de sa nativité,' the use of the word 'artemage,' l. 1957, the incident of the dragon being changed into an eagle, l. 2200; and such points of correspondence as may seem to suggest a connexion between the two English writers, as in ll. 1844 f., 2231 f., are also to be found in the French. The English alliterative Romance of Alexander follows the *Hist. de Preliis*, and consequently it agrees with Gower in the two passages which have been referred to above.

1798. The sentence is broken off and finished in a different manner. See note on i. 98, and cp. vii. 3632.

1811. *Thre yomen*, &c. This is an addition by Gower. According to the original story Nectanabus was alone, and this would evidently be the better for his purpose.

1828. *list*. This may be present tense, 'it pleases.' Loss of the final *e* in the preterite would hardly occur except before a vowel: see Introduction, p. cxv. The French original lays stress here on the extravagant desire that women have to display themselves.

1831. *At after*, i. e. 'After,' used especially of meals, cp. l. 1181, and Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, B 1445, F 918 'at after diner,' E 1921 'At after mete,' F 302, 1219 'At after soper,' for which references, as for many others elsewhere, I am indebted to Prof. Skeat's very useful Glossary.

1844 f. The French has

'E tymbres e tabours ont e leur corns corné,' 130,

and later

'Plus de mil damoisels ount le jur karolé, 140.

The English version of the second line,

'There was maiden es carolyng,'

comes very near to Gower.

1924. *Bot if I sihe*, 'unless I should see,' pret. subj.

1943 ff. This promise is not in the French.

1959 ff. The astrological terms in these lines are due to Gower. The original says that Nectanabus laid the image in a bed with candles lighted round it, bathed it in the juice of certain herbs, and said his charms over it.

1997. *such thing* ... *Wherof*: cp. ll. 502, 2398.

2005 f.

‘Nectanabus idunc ses karectes fina.’

2062. *putte him*. We should rather read ‘put him’ with S and F: see Introduction, p. cxvi. The French romance here grotesquely represents Nectanabus as making up a disguise for himself with a ram’s head and a dragon’s tail, which he joins together with wax, ‘e puis dedens se mist.’ The Latin *Hist. de Preliis* says simply that he changed himself into a dragon.

2074 ff. The French has,

‘Une pel de moton ouvec les cornes prist,
Une coroune d’or sur les cornes assist.’

The punctuation after ‘tok’ is that of F, but I suspect that ‘in signe of his noblesse’ belongs really in sense to 2076 f., and refers rather to the crown than to the horns, in which case we ought to set a full stop after ‘bar.’

2113. *seth hire grone*, that is, in child-bed.

2128 ff. The French romance, following Valerius in the main, gives a rather confused account of Philip’s dream. Gower has turned from it to the *Historia de Preliis*.

2160. *Amphion*. The name apparently is got from ‘Antifon,’ which occurs below in connexion with the incident of the pheasant’s egg.

2182. *rampende*. The French has ‘mult fierement rampant.’

2199 ff. The transformation into an eagle is found in Valerius and the French romance, and not in the *Hist. de Preliis*. It may be noted, however, that the picturesque description which we have here of the eagle pruning himself and then shaking his feathers, so that the hall was moved as by an earthquake, is Gower’s own.

2219 ff. The Latin accounts say that a bird, according to Valerius a hen, came and laid an egg in Philip’s lap as he sat in his hall. The *Rom. de toute Chevalerie* makes the incident take place out in the fields, and the bird, as here, is a pheasant. The expression used, ‘Un oef laissat chaïr sur les curs

Phelippun,' seems to mean that the egg was laid in Philip's lap. There is nothing about the heat of the sun in the Latin versions.

2250 ff. These lines refer to the precautions taken by Nectanabus to secure that the child shall be born precisely at the right astrological moment: cp. *Rom. de toute Chevalerie*, 401-425. Gower has chosen to omit the details.

2274. *Calistre*, i. e. Callisthenes, who was reputed to be the author of the history of Alexander which Valerius translated.

2299 ff. The question of Alexander and the answer of Nectanabus is given as here in the *Hist. de Preliis*. In Valerius and the French romance Alexander throws Nectanabus down merely in order to surprise him, and the suggestion that Nectanabus knew that he should die by the hands of his son is not made till afterwards.

2368. *Zorastes*. The statement here about the laughter of Zoroaster at his birth is ultimately derived from Pliny, *Hist. Nat.* vii. 15. It is repeated by Augustine, with the addition 'nec ei boni aliquid monstrosus risus ille portendit. Nam magicarum artium fuisse perhibetur inventor; quae quidem illi nec ad praesentis vitae vanam felicitatem contra suos inimicos prodesse potuerunt; a Nino quippe rege Assyriorum, cum esset ipse Bactrianorum, bello superatus est' (*De Civ. Dei*, xxi. 14).

2381. 'Like wool which is ill spun': cp. i. 10.

2387. *Phitonesse*, cp. iv. 1937.

2411. *betawht To Aristotle*, 'delivered over to Aristotle': 'betawht' is the past partic. of 'beteche,' which occurs afterwards, vii. 4234, and in Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, B 2114, 'Now such a rym the devel I beteche.'

2418. *Yit for a time*: to be taken as one phrase; cp. 'for a while yit,' &c., ll. 311, 738, 893.

LIB. VII.

The account given in the earlier part of this book of the parts of Philosophy, that is, of the objects of human knowledge, represents in its

essentials the Aristotelian system. The division into 'Theorique,' 'Rethorique,' and 'Practique' is in effect the same as Aristotle's classification of knowledge as Theoretical, Poetical, and Practical, and the further division of 'Theorique' into Theology, Physics, and Mathematics, and of 'Practique' into Ethics, Economics, and Politics, is that which is made by Aristotle. The statement of Pauli and others that this part of Gower's work is 'very likely borrowed' from the *Secretum Secretorum* is absolutely unfounded. This treatise is not in any sense an exposition of the Aristotelian philosophy, indeed it is largely made up of rules for diet and regimen with medical prescriptions. Gower is indebted to it only in a slight degree, and principally in two places, vii. 2014-2057, the discussion of Liberality in a king, and 3207*-3360*, the tale of the Jew and the Pagan.

The most important authority, however, for the earlier part of the seventh book has hitherto been overlooked. It is the *Trésor* of Brunetto Latini. This book is very largely based upon Aristotle, with whose works Latini was exceptionally well acquainted, and it is from this that Gower takes his classification of the sciences, though in regard to the place of Rhetoric he does not quite agree with Latini, who brings it in under the head of 'Politique,' making Logic the third main branch of philosophy. Gower takes from the *Trésor* also many of his physical and geographical statements and his reference to the debate on the conspiracy of Catiline. On the other hand his astronomy is for the most part independent of the *Trésor*, and so also is his method of dealing with the principles of Government, under the five points of Policy. Brunetto Latini does not treat of politics generally so much as of the practical rules to be observed by the Podestà of an Italian republic. It may be observed that Gower has drawn on the *Trésor* also in the sketch of general history given in the Prologue (ll. 727-820). I refer to pages of the edition of Chabaille, 1863.

26 ff. 'As to which Aristotle ... declares the "intelligences" under three heads especially.' The meaning of 'intelligences' here and in l. 176, and of 'intelligencias' in the margin, l. 149, seems to be nearly the same as 'sciences,' that is to say, divisions or provinces of knowledge.

155. *Algorisme*. This stands properly for the decimal system of numeration, but the use of the word in the plural, l. 158, shows that Gower did not use it in this sense only. The association of the word 'Algorismes' below with the letters *a*, *b*, *c* ('Abece') seems to suggest some kind of

algebraical expression, but this is perhaps due to a misunderstanding by Gower of the word 'abaque' (or 'abake') in the *Trésor*, p. 6: 'Et de ce sont li enseignement de l'abaque et de l'augorisme.'

183 ff. 'Ce est la science par laquele li vii sage s'esforcierent par soutilice de geometrie de trover la grandeur dou ciel et de la terre, et la hautesce entre l'un et l'autre.' *Trésor*, pp. 6, 7.

207 ff. Cp. *Trésor*, p. 15, 'Cele matiere de quoi ces choses furent formées les desvance de naissance, non mie de tens, autressi comme li sons est devant le chant, ... et neporquant andui sont ensemble.' Cp. pp. 104, 105.

216. *Ylem*, this is 'hyle' (Gr. ὕλη), the Aristotelian term for matter. For what follows cp. *Trésor*, p. 105.

245. This comparison of the movement of water within the earth to the circulation of blood in the veins, is taken from the *Trésor*, p. 115: 'autressi comme li sangs de l'ome qui s'espant par ses vaines, si que il encherche tout le cors amont et aval.'

256 ff. Cp. *Trésor*, p. 117.

265 ff. This which follows about the Air seems to be partly independent of the *Trésor*, and the word 'periferie' is not there used. Aristotle divides the atmosphere into two regions only, that of ἀτμός or moist vapour, corresponding to the first and second periferies here, and that of exhalation (ἀναθυμίασις) or fiery vapour, corresponding to the third, *Meteor.* i. 3.

283 f. 'According to the condition under which they take their form.' I suppose the word 'intersticion' to be taken from 'interstitium,' as used with a technical sense in astrology. Albumasar, for example, says, 'Quicquid in hoc mundo nascitur et occidit ex quatuor elementis est compositum, tribus interstitiis educatum, scilicet principio, medio et fine, quae tria in illa quatuor ducta duodecim producant.' This is the cause, he says, why there are twelve signs of the zodiac, 'Praesunt siquidem haec signa quatuor elementis eorumque tribus interstitiis.' He then explains that the first 'interstitium' of each element is that condition of it which is favourable to production, growth and vigour, the second that which is stationary, and the third that which tends to decay and corruption, so that the word is almost equivalent to condition or quality. (Vincent of Beauvais, *Spec. Nat.* xv. 36.)

302. Cp. *Trésor*, p. 119, ‘mais li fors deboutemenz dou vent la destraint et chace si roidement que ele fent et passe les nues et fait toner et espartir.’

307 ff. Cp. *Trésor*, p. 120.

323 ff. *Trésor*, p. 120, ‘dont aucunes gens cuident que ce soit li dragons ou que ce soit une estele qui chiet.’ What follows about ‘exhalations’ is not from the *Trésor*.

334. *Assub*. This word is used in Latin translations of Aristotle as an equivalent of ‘stella cadens.’

339. *exalacion*. This stands for fiery vapour only, originally a translation of Aristotle’s ἀναθυμίασις.

351 ff. The names ‘Eges’ and ‘Daaly’ (l. 361), must be taken originally from Aristotle’s expression δαλοὶ καὶ αἶγες, which he says are names given by some people to various forms of fire in the sky, *Meteor.* i. 4. Our author simply repeated the terms after his authorities and without understanding them. In fact, ‘Eges’ stands for the same as the ‘Capra saliens’ of the preceding lines.

389. The idea of the four complexions of man, corresponding to the four elements, is not due to Aristotle, but we find it in the *Trésor*. The application to matters of love in ll. 393-440 is presumably Gower’s own.

405 f. Aristotle says on the contrary, οἱ μελαγχολικοὶ οἱ πλεῖστοι λάγνοι εἰσίν, *Probl.* 30.

437. *To thenke*. For this use of ‘may’ with the gerund cp. ii. 510, ‘I myhte noght To soffre.’

510. ‘While the flesh has power to act,’ that is during the life of the body.

521 ff. For the geography which follows cp. *Trésor*, pp. 151-153.

534. *the hevene cope*: cp. l. 1579, ‘under the coupe of hevene,’ where the spelling suggests the Latin ‘cupa,’ rather than ‘capa,’ as the origin of the word in this common phrase. The quality of the ‘o’ in Europe is perhaps doubtful.

536. *Begripeth*: used here as plural, cp. l. 1107: ‘calleth’ in l. 561 with ‘men’ (indef.) as the subject is not a case of the same kind.

545. *who that rede*: subj., cp. Prol. 460.

559. That is, presumably, double as much as either of the other two: cp. *Trésor*, p. 152, 'car Asie tient bien l'une moitié de toute la terre.'

566. *Canahim*: a mistake for 'Tanaim' (or 'Tanain'), see *Trésor*, p. 152, where the extent of Asia is said to be from the mouths of the Nile and the 'Tanain' (i. e. the Don) as far as the Ocean and the terrestrial Paradise.

593 ff. Cp. *Trésor*, p. 115.

597. Latini says that this is the explanation given by some people of the tides, but he adds that the astronomers do not agree with them (*Trésor*, p. 172).

611. Aristotle does in fact make of αἰθήρ a fifth element, of which the heaven and the heavenly bodies consist, but Gower takes this account of it and the name Orbis from the *Trésor*, p. 110, where also we find the comparison to the shell of an egg.

652 ff. 'Sapiens dominabitur astris,' an opinion which is developed in the *Vox Clamantis*, ii. 217 ff.

694. *Bot thorizonte*, 'beyond the horizon': so perhaps in the first text of v. 3306, 'But of his lond' stood for 'Out of his lond.' However, this use of 'but' is not clearly established in Southern ME. and perhaps the reading of the second recension, 'Be thorizonte,' may be right. As regards sense, one is much the same as the other: neither is very intelligible, unless 'thorizonte' means the ecliptic.

699. *thei*, that is the planets, not the signs.

725 ff. Cp. *Trésor*, p. 141.

831. *is that on*, i. e. 'is one,' or 'is the first.'

853. The sun's horses are named by Fulgentius, *Mythol.* ii, in the same order as we have here, 'Erythreus, Actæon, Lampos, Philogeus.' They are said there to represent four divisions of the day, Erythreus, for example, having his name from the red light of morning, and Philogeus from the inclination of the sun towards the earth at evening. Ovid gives a different set of names.

944. 'In whatever degree he shall exercise his powers.'

978. *as it appendeth*, ‘as it is fitting,’ lit. ‘as it belongs’: cp. ‘appent,’ *Mir.* 1535.

979. *natheles*. This word is frequently used by Gower with no sense of opposition, meaning ‘moreover’ or something similar: cp. i. 21, vii. 3877, &c.

983. It may be observed that (in spite of this reference and that in l. 1043) our author’s statements about the number and arrangement of stars in the constellations of the zodiac do not at all correspond with those in the *Almagest*.

983 (margin). *produxit ad esse*, ‘brought forth into existence’: the infinitive is often used as a substantive in Gower’s Latin: e. g. *Prol. Lat. Verses*, iv. 4, v. 6.

989. *hot and drye*. According to the astrologers, Aries, Leo, and Sagittarius preside over the element of fire, and are hot and dry by nature; Taurus, Virgo, Capricornus over that of earth, being dry and cold; Gemini, Libra, Aquarius preside over air, and are hot and moist; while Cancer, Scorpio, and Pisces are moist and cold, having dominion over water (Albumasar, cited by Vincent of Beauvais, *Spec. Nat.* xv. 36).

991 f. Aries and Scorpio are the ‘houses’ or ‘mansions’ of Mars, Taurus and Libra of Venus, Gemini and Virgo of Mercury, Cancer of the Moon, Leo of the Sun, Sagittarius and Pisces of Jupiter, Capricornus and Aquarius of Saturn.

1021. *somdiel discordant*: the hot and moist Libra is more in accordance with her nature: see 1111 ff.

1036 f. This statement and the others like it below, 1073, 1089, 1127, 1147, 1198, 1222, may be taken to indicate that the division of the signs was very uncertain in our author’s mind. It may be observed that the usual representation of Taurus in star-maps is with his head, not his tail, towards Gemini.

1085. *the risinge*: that is to say, Virgo is the ‘exaltation’ of Mercury, as well as one of his houses.

1100. For the sense of ‘applied’ cp. v. 913.

1115 f. Libra is the exaltation of Saturn.

1135. That is to say, Scorpio is the ‘fall’ of Venus, being the sign opposite to one of her houses, namely Taurus.

1155 f. Sagittarius is a house of Jupiter, and it is opposite to Gemini, which is one of the houses of Mercury.

1162. *The Plowed Oxe*, i. e. the ox that has ploughed the land.

1166. Then the swine are killed and the larder, or bacon-tub, comes into use.

1175. Capricorn is the ‘fall’ of the Moon, being opposite to her house, Cancer, as the next sign Aquarius is that of the Sun, see l. 1190.

1216. ‘Piscis’ is the reading of the MSS. here in text and margin, but ‘Pisces’ in l. 1253.

1229 ff. That is, Pisces is a house of Jupiter and the exaltation of Venus.

1239 ff. The reference is apparently to the *Introductorium* of Albumasar, but the printed editions of this give an abbreviated text which does not help us here. A fuller translation of the original may be found in manuscript, e. g. MS. Digby 194, where something more or less corresponding to this may be found on f. 55, but the Arabic names of places make it difficult to follow.

1281 ff. This account of the fifteen stars with their herbs and stones is taken by Gower from a treatise called ‘*Liber Hermetis de xv stellis et de xv lapidibus et de xv herbis, xv figuris,*’ &c., which may be found in several manuscripts, e. g. MSS. Ashmole 341 (f. 123) and 1471 (f. 120 v^o): cp. l. 1437, where Hermes is mentioned as the authority. Some information as to the names of the stars here mentioned may be found in Ideler’s *Untersuchungen über den Ursprung und die Bedeutung der Sternnamen*, 1809.

1292 ff. ‘Et scias quod stelle fixe habent fortuna et infortunia quemadmodum et planete’ (*Lib. Herm.*).

1317. ‘anabulla seu titimallum.’

1329. *Algol*, or Caput Algol, the Arabic ‘Ras el-ghûl’ (devil’s head), in Perseus.

1338. *Alhaiot*, probably for ‘Alhaioc,’ that is Capella, from the Arabic ‘El-‘aijûk.’

1343. 'prassium seu marrubium.'

1345. *Canis maior*, 'Alhabor,' i. e. Sirius.

1356. *Canis minor*, 'Algomeiza,' i. e. Procyon.

1362. *Primerole*: in the *Liber Hermetis* we have here 'solsecium, quam elitropiam vocant.'

1364. *Arial*, apparently 'Cor Leonis,' i. e. Regulus.

1367. *Gorgonza*: 'gregonza' in MS. Ash. 341.

1375. 'lappacium maius.'

1378. *gret riote*: 'color huius niger est, faciens hominem iratum, animosum et audacem et mala cogitantem et maledicentem ... et faciens fugere demones et congregare.'

1379 ff. 'Nona stella dicitur Atimet Alaazel, ... et est ex natura Veneris et Mercurii, et dicitur stella pulchritudinis et racionis,' &c. The name 'Atimet Alaazel' is from the Arabic 'El-simâk el-a'zal,' that is the star which we call Spica.

1385. *Salge*, Lat. 'saluia.'

1387. 'Decima vero stella Atimet Alrameth, et dicitur saltator, et est ex natura Martis et Iouis.' This is the Arabic 'El-simâk el-râmih,' which we call Arcturus.

1393. *Venenas*: 'Vndecima stella dicitur Benenais et est postrema de ii stellis que sunt in cauda urse maioris.' In Arabic 'Banat Na'sh.'

1401. *Alpheta*, 'Elfetah,' from the Arabic 'El-fak'ah' (the beggar's dish), meaning the constellation which we call the Northern Crown. Here the name stands for the principal star of that constellation, Gemma.

1419. *Botercadent*. The Latin says 'Vultur cadens,' that is perhaps Vega; but 'Botercadent' would probably be a different star, namely that called in Arabic 'Batn-Kaitos' or Whale's belly.

1426. *Tail of Scorpio*: in the Latin 'Cauda Capricorni.'

1449 ff. These names of the chief authors of the science of astronomy seem to be partly taken from the treatise called *Speculum Astronomiae* or

De libris licitis et illicitis, cap. ii. (*Alberti Magni Opera*, v. 657): cp. note on vi. 1311 ff. The passage is as follows, under the heading ‘*De libris astronomicis antiquorum*’: ‘Ex libris ergo qui post libros geometricos et arithmeticos inueniuntur apud nos scripti super his, primus tempore compositionis est liber quem edidit Nembroth gigas ad Iohathonem discipulum suum, qui sic incipit: *Sphaera caeli* &c., in quo est parum proficui et falsitates nonnullae, sed nihil est ibi contra fidem quod sciam. Sed quod de hac scientia vtilius inuenitur, est liber Ptolemaei Pheludensis, qui dicitur Graece Megasti, Arabice Almagesti, ... quod tamen in eo diligentiae causa dictum est prolixè, commode restringitur ab Azarchele Hispano, qui dictus est Albategni in libro suo.... Voluitque Alpetragius corrigere principia et suppositiones Ptolemaei,’ &c.

It would seem that, either owing to corruption of his text or to misunderstanding, our author separated the name ‘Megasti’ from its connexion with Ptolemy and the Almagest, and made of it a book called ‘Megaster,’ which he attributes to Nembrot.

1461. Alfraganus was author of a book called in Latin *Rudimenta Astronomica*.

1576 f. *out of herre ... entriketh*, that is, ‘involves (this world) in perplexity, so that it is disordered.’

1579. *coupe of hevene*, see note on l. 534.

1595 ff. The discussion in the Roman Senate on the fate of the accomplices of Catiline is here taken as a model of rhetorical treatment. The idea is a happy one, but it is borrowed from the *Trésor*, where Latini, after laying down the rules of rhetoric, illustrates them (pp. 505-517) by a report and analysis of the speeches in this debate, as they are given by Sallust. The ‘Cillenus’ mentioned below is D. Junius Silanus, who as consul-designate gave his opinion first. It is tolerably evident in this passage, as it is obvious in iv. 2647 ff., that Gower did not identify Tullius with Cicero, though Latini actually says, ‘Marcus Tullius Cicero, cils meismes qui enseigne l’art de rectorique, estoit adonques consule de Rome.’

1615 ff. Cp. *Trésor*, p. 509, ‘mais Jules Cesar, qui autre chose pensoit, se torna as couvertures et as moz dorez, porce que sa matiere estoit contraire,’ &c.

1623. *after the lawe*. It may be observed as a matter of fact that the law was on the side of Caesar, and that this was his chief argument against the death penalty.

1706. *Fyf pointz*. The *Secretum Secretorum* recommends to rulers the virtues of Liberality, Wisdom, Chastity, Mercy, Truth, and afterwards of Justice, but there is no very systematic arrangement there, nor in general does the treatment of the subject, except partly as regards Liberality, resemble Gower's. It has been already observed that the treatment of Politics in the *Trésor* is altogether different from that which we have here.

1783 ff. This story comes originally from 3 Esdras, ch. iii, iv. The names, however, of Arpaghes and Manachaz are not found in the text of that book, and the story of Alcestis, which Zorobabel tells, is of course a later addition, made no doubt by our author.

1809. 'Having his mind so disposed.'

1856. *behelde*, an archaic form, used here for the rhyme.

1884 ff. 3 Esdr. iv. 29, 'Videbam tamen Apemen filiam Bezacis, mirifici concubinam regis, sedentem iuxta regem ad dexteram,' &c.

1961 f. 'He that is true shall never rue,' or some such jingle. Cp. Shaksp. *K. John*, v. 7,

'Nought shall make us rue,
If England to herself do rest but true.'

2000. *laste*, pret. 'lasted': cp. Prol. 672, iv. 2315.

2017 ff. This seems to be suggested by a passage in the *Secretum Secretorum*. 'Reges sunt quattuor. Rex largus subditis et largus sibi, Rex auarus subditis et auarus sibi, Rex auarus sibi et largus subditis, Rex largus sibi et auarus subditis.' This last is pronounced to be the worst, as the first is the best.

2031 ff. This refers to a passage in the *Secretum Secretorum* (ed. 1520, f. 8), which runs thus in the printed edition: 'Que fuit causa destructionis regni calculorum: vnde quia superfluitas expensarum superat redditus ciuitatum, et sic deficientibus redditibus et expensis reges extenderunt

manus suas ad res et redditus aliorum. Subditi ergo propter iniuriam clamauerunt ad deum excelsum gloriosum, qui immittens ventum calidum afflixit eos vehementer, et insurrexit populus contra eos et nomina eorum penitus de terra deleuerunt.'

This is obviously corrupt, and it is evident that 'calculorum' stands for a proper name, which Gower read 'Caldeorum,' as it is in MS. Laud 708. Other Bodleian MSS. to which I have referred give 'Saldeorum' (Bodley 181), 'cangulorum' (Add. C. 12), 'singulorum' (Laud 645), 'Anglorum' (Digby 170). 'Nonne' is the reading of the MSS. for 'vnde,' and it seems that 'Que fuit' &c. is also a question.

2039. So in the *Secretum Secretorum* (shortly before the passage quoted above), 'Debes igitur dona dare iuxta posse tuum cum mensura, hominibus indigentibus atque dignis.'

2050. *of ken*, here apparently 'of quality.'

2061 ff. The basis of this story is to be found in Seneca, *De Beneficiis*, v. 24, 'Causam dicebat apud divum Iulium ex veteranis quidam,' &c., but there is no question there of an advocate; the veteran simply gains his case by recalling his personal services. The story appears in a form more like that of Gower in the *Gesta Romanorum*, 87 (ed. Oesterley), but the name Julius is not there mentioned, only 'Quidam imperator.' It may be observed also in general, that though many stories are common to the *Gesta Romanorum* and the *Confessio Amantis*, there is no instance in which Gower can be proved to have used the *Gesta Romanorum* as his authority. Indeed the tales are there so meagrely and badly told for the most part, that there would be little temptation to turn to it if any other book were available.

Such references as 'dicitur in gestis Romanorum' are not to this book but to Roman History.

Hoccleve tells this story much as we have it here, in his *Regement of Princes*, 3270 ff., e. g.

'Han ye forgote how scharp it with yow ferde,
Whan ye were in the werres of Asie?
Maffeith, your lif stood there in jupartie;

And advocat ne sente I non to yow,
But myself put in prees and for yow faght,' &c.

2115 ff. This anecdote is perhaps taken from the *Trésor*, where it occurs more appropriately as an example of hypocritical excuses for not giving, 'Li Maistres dit: Après te garde de malicieus engin de escondire, si comme fist le rois Antigonus, qui dist à un menestrier qui li demandoit un besant, que il demandoit plus que à lui n'aferoit; et quant il li demanda un denier, il dist que rois ne devoit pas si povrement doner. Ci ot malicieus escondit; car il li pooit bien doner un besant, porce que il estoit rois, ou un denier, porce que il estoit menestrel. Mais Alixandres le fist mieulx; car quant il dona une cité à un home, cil li dist que il estoit de trop has afaire à avoir cité; Alixandres li respondit: Je ne pren pas garde quel chose tu dois avoir, mais quel chose je doi doner' (p. 412). This may serve as a rather favourable example of Latini's style.

2132. *is in manere*: cp. l. 4344. It seems to mean that the virtue of giving depends on the measure with which it is done: cp. *Praise of Peace*, 53.

2139. *To helpe with*: cp. i. 452, 2172, ii. 283, &c.

2194. *holden up his oil*: cp. l. 2584, 'To bere up oil.' The only other instance which I can quote of this expression is from Trevisa's translation of the *Polychronicon* (Rolls' Series, vol. iii. p. 447, a reference which I owe to Dr. Murray), 'There Alisaundre gan to boste ... and a greet deel of hem that were at the feste hilde up the kynges oyl.' (In the Latin, *magna convivantium parte assentiente*.) In all these cases it is used of flatterers, and 'oil' seems to stand in this phrase for 'pride' or 'vainglory.' I am disposed to think it is simply the French 'oil,' meaning 'eye,' and getting its present sense from such Biblical expressions as '*oculi sublimium deprimentur*,' '*oculos superbiorum humiliabis*,' '*oculos sublimes, linguam mendacem*'; but I can quote no examples of this meaning in French.

2217 ff. This story is based originally on an anecdote told by Valerius Maximus: 'Idem Syracusis, cum holera ei lavanti Aristippus dixisset, Si Dionysium adulari velles, ista non esses, Immo, inquit, si tu ista esse velles, non adularere Dionysium' (*Mem.* iv. 3). It has been repeated often in a short form.

2268. *the worldes crok*, that is, the crooked way of the world. See the quotations in the *New Engl. Dictionary* under ‘crook,’ 12.

2279. *joutes*: see Godefroy’s Dictionary, where an instance is quoted of the use of this word in a French version of this very story.

2302. F punctuates after ‘pyke,’ and no doubt rightly so. The word ‘trewely’ corresponds to the Latin ‘certe’ in the margin above.

2355 ff. The Roman Triumph as here related was a commonplace of preachers and moralists, cp. Bromyard, *Summa Praedicatorum*, T. v. 36, ‘Triumphus enim secundum Isidorum dicitur a tribus: quia triumphator Romanus cum victoria versus civitatem veniens tres honores habere debuit,’ &c. So l. 2366, ‘Of treble honour he was certein.’ It is also in the *Gesta Romanorum*, 30 (ed. Oesterley), but from neither of these could Gower have got his ‘Notheos’ (for Γνωθι σεαυτόν).

2416 ff. This custom is spoken of in Hoccleve’s *Regement of Princes* with a marginal reference to the *Vita Iohannis Eleemosynarii*, where it is in fact mentioned (Migne, *Patrol.*, vol. 73, p. 354).

2527 ff. From 1 Kings xxii. It will be seen that the story is told rather freely as regards order of events, as if from memory.

2531 (margin). *organizate*, used in a musical sense.

2553. *Godelie*: the person meant is Athaliah.

2584. *bere up oil*: see note on l. 2194.

2660. *astraid*. See *New Engl. Dict.*, under ‘astray,’ verb and adv.

2698 (margin). No manuscript here gives the reading ‘regiminis,’ so far as I know; but it is required by the sense, and the reading ‘regis’ might easily arise from the abbreviation of ‘regiminis,’ as we find it in some MSS. at l. 3106 (margin). Note that S is defective here, and J, Ad, K omit the Latin margin. Δ attempts an emendation.

2726 f. *lete Of wrong to don*, i. e. ‘abstain from doing wrong.’

2765 ff. From Godfrey of Viterbo (in *Monum. Germ. Hist.* xxii. p. 169), ‘Quando voluit rectores dare provinciis ... nomina eorum examinabat in populo, dicens: Si quis habet crimen contra eos, dicat et probet,’ &c. This passage is not contained in the earlier redactions of the *Pantheon*, and

consequently we may conclude that Gower's copy was one which contained the later additions: cp. notes on 4181 ff. and viii. 271 ff.

2771. *his name*, that is, his reputation: cp. 2774.

2780. *stod ... upon*, 'rested upon,' 'was guided by.'

2783 ff. The saying by which this story is characterized, 'malle locupletibus imperare quam ipsum fieri locupletem,' is more properly attributed to M'. Curius Dentatus (Valerius Maximus, *Mem.* iv. 3. 5): but Fabricius also rejected gifts sent him by the Samnites.

2810. *bothe*: apparently both the men and their possessions.

2833 ff. This is probably Conrad II, of whom Godfrey of Viterbo says 'nulli violatori pacis parcebat.'

2845 ff. Originally taken from Valerius Maximus, who tells it, however, with reference to Charondas, the supposed legislator of Thurii (*Mem.* vi. 5).

2864. *sete*: apparently a strong past participle formed from 'sette' by confusion with 'sitte': cp. 'upsete' rhyming with 'misgete,' viii. 244.

2883. *of dawe*: equivalent to 'of this lif,' iv. 3414.

2889 ff. This is a story which we find very often repeated (originally from Herodotus), e. g. Valerius Maximus, *Mem.* vi. 3, *Gesta Romanorum*, 29 (without mention of Cambyses by name), Hoccleve's *Regement of Princes*, &c. In Δ we find added to the marginal Latin,

'vnde versus,
Sede sedens ista iudex inflexibilis sta,
Sit tibi lucerna lux, lex, pellisque paterna,
Qua resides natus pro patre sponte datus.
A manibus reuoces munus, ab aure preces.'

It would seem that the last line should stand as the second.

2902. *Avise him*, 'Let him consider.'

flitte, 'turn aside,' cp. iv. 214; but also intransitive, v. 7076.

2917 ff. Another often repeated story. The *Gesta Romanorum* has it (169) with a reference to Trogus Pompeius (that is Justin, *Epit.* iii. 3). Gower makes the city Athens instead of Sparta (cp. 3089), and the god Mercury instead of Apollo.

3054 ff. This list of legislators is from the *Trésor*, p. 24, but the text which our author used seems to have been corrupt. The passage runs thus in the printed edition: 'Moyses fu li premiers qui bailla la loi as Hebreus; et li rois Foroneus fu li premiers qui la bailla as Grezois; Mercurus as Egypciens, et Solon à cels de Athenes; Ligurgus as Troyens; Numa Pompilius, qui regna après Romulus en Rome, et puis ses filz, bailla et fist lois as Romains premierement,' &c. If we suppose 'Solon' to have been omitted in the MS., the passage might read (with changes of punctuation) nearly as we have it in Gower.

3092. *on the beste Above alle other*: cp. iv. 2606, &c.

3137 ff. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 13921, and see also ii. 3204 ff. (margin).

3144. *Troian*: so given in all MSS. for 'Traian.' So also in the *Mirour*, 22168, and in Godfrey of Viterbo, *Spec. Reg.* ii. 14 (*Mon. Germ. Hist.* xxii. p. 74).

3181 ff. Valerius Maximus, *Mem.* v. 6: but he does not mention the Dorians as the enemy against whom Codrus fought. However, the story was a common one: cp. *Gesta Romanorum*, 41.

3201. *lemes*: cp. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, A 3886.

3149* f. The reference is to the Epistle of St. James ii. 13, 'Iudicium enim sine misericordia illi qui non fecit misericordiam.'

3157*. That is, 'Blessed are the merciful, for they shall obtain mercy.'

3161* f. Cp. *Mirour de l'Omme*, 13918 ff., where the same is quoted.

3163* ff. Quoted also in the *Mirour*, 13925 ff., and there also attributed to Tullius, but I cannot give the reference.

3210. *drawe*: the change to subjunctive marks this sentence as really conditional.

3215 ff. Valerius Maximus, *Mem.* v. 1. 9.

3217. *in jeupartie*, i. e. equally balanced, the result uncertain.

3267 ff. Justinian II is described by Gibbon as a cruel tyrant, whose deposition by Leontius was fully deserved, and who, when restored by the help of Terbelis, took a ferocious vengeance on his opponents: ‘during the six years of his new reign, he considered the axe, the cord, and the rack as the only instruments of royalty.’ Nothing apparently could be less appropriate than the epithet ‘pious,’ which Gower bestows upon him.

3295 ff. This again was a very common story: cp. *Gesta Romanorum*, 48 (ed. Oesterley). Hoccleve tells it with a reference to Orosius, *Regement of Princes*, 3004 ff. Gower probably had it from Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, p. 181 (ed. 1584), where Berillus is given for Perillus, as in our text. He takes ‘Phalaris Siculus’ as the tyrant’s name, and shortens it to Siculus.

3302. I take the preceding three lines as a parenthesis, and this as following l. 3298.

3341. ‘Dionys’ is a mistake for Diomedes, or rather Diomedes is confused with the tyrant Dionysius.

3355 ff. Cp. Ovid, *Metam.* i. 221 ff.

3359. *With othre men*, i. e. ‘by other men’: cp. viii. 2553.

3387 ff. This characteristic of the lion is mentioned by Brunetto Latini, *Trésor*, p. 224.

3417 ff. This story is told much as it appears in Justin, *Epit.* i. 8, and Orosius, *Hist.* ii. 7, but the name Spertachus (Spartachus) is apparently from Peter Comestor (Migne, *Patrol.* vol. 198, p. 1471), who gives this as the name of Cyrus in his boyhood. The same authority may have supplied the name ‘Marsagete,’ for the histories named above call Thamyras only ‘queen of the Scythians’; but Comestor omits the details of the story.

3207* ff. The tale of the Jew and the Pagan is from the *Secretum Secretorum*, where it is told as a warning against trusting those who are not of our faith. The differences are mainly as follows. No names of places are mentioned in the original; the ‘pagan’ is called ‘magus orientalis,’ and he rides a mule: the Jew is without provisions, and the Magian feeds him as well as allowing him to ride: the Jew is found not dead but thrown from the mule, with a broken leg and other injuries—there is no mention of a lion except in the entreaties of the Magian, ‘noli me derelinquere in deserto, ne forte interficiar a leonibus.’ The Magian is about to leave him to die, but the Jew pleads that he has acted only in accordance with his own law, and again appeals to the Magian to show him the mercy which his religion enjoins. Finally the Magian carries him away and delivers him safely to his own people. Probably our author thought that this form of the story unduly sacrificed justice to mercy, and therefore he killed his Jew outright.

3342* ff. Note the subjunctive after ‘who (that)’ here and in ll. 3349, 3355: see note on Prol. 460.

3418. The name ‘Spertachus’ is given in full by F in the Latin summary, l. 3426 (margin). In the English text the first syllable is abbreviated in most copies, but A has ‘Spartachus’ and H₃ ‘Spertachus.’

3539. *Pite feigned*: cp. l. 3835.

3581. The reference should be to Juvenal, *Sat.* viii. 269 ff.,

‘Malo pater tibi sit Thersites, dummodo tu sis
Aeacidae similis, Vulcaniaque arma capessas,
Quam te Thersitae similem genuisset Achilles.’

Gower has here taken the point out of the quotation to a great extent, but it occurs in the *Mirour*, 23371 ff., in its proper form, though with the same false reference.

3627 ff. From the Book of Judges, ch. vii.

3632. For the anacoluthon cp. iv. 3201, vi. 1798, and note on i. 98.

3639. The reading of the second recension, ‘hem,’ seems clearly to be right here: ‘against those who would assail them.’

3640 ff. The meaning apparently is that each single division of the three which the enemy had was twice as large as Gideon’s whole army. The original text says nothing of the kind.

3752. *per compaignie*, ‘together.’

3820 ff. 1 Samuel xv.

3860 ff. 1 Kings ii.

3877. *natheles*, ‘moreover’: cp. 4242 and note on Prol. 39.

3884. *that*, for ‘to that’: cp. Prol. 122.

3891 ff. 1 Kings iii.

4011. *propre*, i. e. ‘in himself.’

4027 ff. 1 Kings xii.

4144. *can ... mai*, used in their original senses, the one implying knowledge and the other active power.

4181 ff. The person meant is Antoninus Pius, of whom his biographer Capitolinus says that he loved peace ‘*eousque ut Scipionis sententiam frequentarit, qua ille dicebat, malle se unum civem servare quam mille hostes occidere*’ (*Hist. August.* ed. 1620, p. 20). Godfrey of Viterbo, in the text given by Waitz (*Mon. Germ. Hist.* xxii. pp. 75, 163), regularly calls him Antonius, and probably Gower had the saying from this source. It is one of the later additions to the *Pantheon*: cp. note on 2765 ff.

4195. *is due To Pite*. This seems to mean ‘is bound by duty’ to show mercy.

4228. *His trouthe plight*, ‘the engagement of his faith.’ Here we have the word ‘plight’ from OE. ‘*pliht*,’ to be distinguished from ‘*plit*.’

4242. *natheles*: cp. l. 3877.

4245. *hihe*: note the definite form after the possessive genitive, as after a possessive pronoun.

4284. 'And even if it should chance that he obtained any friendliness from her.' For the use of 'compainie' cp. v. 4558.

4335. *Barbarus*: more properly Arbaces, but 'Barbatus' in the *Pantheon* (p. 165, ed. 1584).

4361 ff. Cp. Justin, *Epit.* i. 7, where however the expedient is said to have been used (as related by Herodotus) after Cyrus had put down a revolt.

4406 ff. Numbers xxv.

4408. *Amalech*: Balak is meant.

4464 ff. This means apparently that the later time of life will be as a dark night which is not illuminated by any sunshine of dawn; but it is not very clearly expressed.

4469 ff. 1 Kings xi.

4515. That is, 'Ahijah the Shilonite,' called 'Ahias Silonites' in the Latin version.

4559 ff. (margin). The quotation is from the *Secretum Secretorum*: 'O summe rex, studeas modis omnibus custodire et retinere calorem naturalem' (ed. 1520, f. 25 v^o).

4574 f. Caracalla, son of Severus, is here meant. His name was Aurelius Antoninus, and he is called Aurelius Antonius in the *Pantheon* (*Mon. Germ. Hist.* xxii. p. 166). Caracalla is called by Orosius 'omnibus hominibus libidine intemperantior, qui etiam novercam suam Iuliam uxorem duxerit' (*Hist.* vii. 18), and this character of him is repeated in the *Pantheon*.

4593 ff. This story is from Ovid, *Fasti*, ii. 687-720. Gower's rendering of it is remarkable for ease and simplicity of style: see especially ll. 4667-4685, 4701-4717.

4598. Neither Aruns nor Sextus is mentioned by name in Ovid, who speaks only of 'Tarquinius iuvenis.' Gower gives to Aruns the place of Sextus throughout this and the following story.

4623. *schette*, intransitive, equivalent to 'were shut': cp. iii. 1453.

4701 ff. The sacrifice at which this portent occurred is here brought into connexion with the capture of Gabii, a construction which is not unnaturally suggested by Ovid's abrupt transition, l. 711.

4718 ff.

‘Consulitur Phoebus. Sors est ita reddita: Matri
Qui dederit princeps oscula, victor erit.’ *Fasti*, ii. 713 f.

Ovid means that a message was sent to Delphi; but our author understands it differently.

4739 f. ‘Creditus offenso procubuisse pede’ (720).

4754 ff. This again is from Ovid, where it occurs as a continuation of the last story, *Fasti*, 721-852. Chaucer, who tells this story in the *Legend of G. Women*, 1680 ff., also follows Ovid, and more closely than Gower, e. g. 1761 ff., 1805 ff., 1830f.

4757. *unskilfully*, that is, ‘unjustly,’ without due ‘skile’ or reason.

4778 ff. ‘Non opus est verbis, credite rebus, ait’ (734).

4805 f. This is derived from a misunderstanding of *Fasti*, ii. 785,

‘Accipit aerata iuvenem Collatia porta.’

Cp. l. 4911 below. Both Chaucer and Gower make the tragedy occur at Rome, though Chaucer professes to have Livy before him.

4902. ‘audentes forsve deusve iuvat.’

4937. *To hire*: cp. v. 5724. It means here much the same as ‘by her.’

5062. *sche myhte it noght*, ‘sche could not help it.’

5088 ff.

‘Illa iacens ad verba oculos sine lumine mouit,
Visaque concussa dicta probare coma.’ *Fasti*, ii. 845 f.

5093 ff. This latter part is added from other sources, perhaps from Livy.

5131 ff. Chaucer tells the story of Virginia as the Tale of the Doctor of Physic, professing to follow Livy, but actually taking his materials chiefly from the *Roman de la Rose*, 5613 ff., from which he transcribes also the

reference to 'Titus Livius.' His story differs from that of Livy in many respects, and the changes are not at all for the better. For example, Chaucer does not mention the absence of Virginius in the camp, and he makes him kill his daughter at home and carry her head to Appius. Gower follows Livy, or some account drawn from Livy, without material alteration. It may be observed that Chaucer (following the *Rom. de la Rose*) uses the name 'Apius' alone for the judge, and 'Claudius' for the dependent, while Gower names them more correctly 'Apius Claudius' and 'Marchus Claudius.' On the subject generally reference may be made to Rumbaur's dissertation, *Geschichte von Appius und Virginia in der engl. Litteratur*, Breslau, 1890.

5136. *Livius Virginius*, a mistake for 'Lucius Virginius.'

5151. *Ilcius*, that is, *Icilius*.

5209. *til that he come*, 'till he should come,' the verb being pret. subjunctive.

5254 ff. The sentence is irregular in construction, but intelligible and vigorous: 'but as to that command, like the hunted wild boar, who when he feels the hounds hard upon him, throws them off on both sides and goes his way, so (we may say) this knight,' &c. The simile is due to Gower.

5261. *kepte*, 'waited for.'

5307 ff. From the Book of Tobit, ch. vi-viii. The moral of the story is given by vi. 17, where Raphael says to Tobias, 'Hi namque qui coniugium ita suscipiunt, ut Deum a se et a sua mente excludant, et suae libidini ita vacent sicut equus et mulus, quibus non est intellectus, habet potestatem daemonium super eos.' This, however, is absent from the English version (which follows the LXX), as are also the precepts which follow, about nights to be spent in prayer by the newly married couple. The same is the case with the five precepts given to Sara by her parents, which are mentioned in the *Mirour*, 17701 ff.

5390. This line, written in F as follows,

'Hov trewe · hou large · hou ioust · hov chaste,'

is enough to show that *v* and *u* are used indifferently in this kind of position: cp. *movþe: coupe*, 5285 f.

5408. *Do wey*, 'Have done': see *New English Dictionary*, 'do,' 52.

LIB. VIII.

We may suppose that our author had some embarrassment as regards the subject of his eighth book. It should properly have dealt with the seventh Deadly Sin and its various branches, that is, as the *Mirour de l'Omme* gives them, 'Fornicioun,' 'Stupre,' 'Avolterie,' 'Incest,' 'Foldelit.' Nearly all of these subjects, however, have already been treated of more or less fully, either in the fifth book, where branches of Avarice are spoken of with reference to the case of love, or in the seventh, under the head of Chastity as a point of Policy. Even the author's commendation of Virginity, which might well have been reserved for this place, and which would have been rather less incongruous at the end than in the middle of the shrift, has already been set forth in the fifth book. There remained only Incest, and of this unpromising subject he has made the best he could, first tracing out the gradual development of the moral (or rather the ecclesiastical) law with regard to it, and then making it an excuse for the Tale of Apollonius (or Appolinus) of Tyre, which extends over the larger half of the book. The last thousand lines or so are occupied with the conclusion of the whole poem.

36. *upon his grace*, that is, free for him to bestow on whom he would.

44. Raphael is not named in Genesis.

48. *Metodre*, that is, Methodius, in whose *Revelationes* it is written, 'Sciendum namque est, exeuntes Adam et Evam de Paradiso virgines fuisse,' so that 'Into the world' in l. 53 must mean from Paradise into the outer world.

62 ff. This is not found in Genesis, only 'genuitque filios et filias,' but Methodius says that the sisters of Cain and Abel were Calmana and Debora.

110. For the hiatus cp. *Mirour*, 12241,

‘De Isaäk auci je lis.’

158. *ne yit religion*. The seduction of one who was a professed member of a religious order was usually accounted to be incest: cp. *Mirour*, 9085 ff. and l. 175 below.

170. ‘I keep no such booth (or stall) at the fair,’ that is, ‘I do no such trade.’

244. *upsete*: see Introduction, p. cxix, and cp. vii. 2864.

271 ff. Gower tells us here that he finds the story in the *Pantheon*. That is true, no doubt: it is told there in the peculiar kind of verse with which Godfrey of Viterbo diversified his chronicle, and a most useful text of this particular story, showing the differences of three redactions, is given by S. Singer in his *Apollonius von Tyrus*, Halle, 1895, pp. 153-177. There is ample evidence that Gower was acquainted with the *Pantheon*, but it is not the case that he followed it in this story, as has been too readily assumed. Godfrey tells the tale in a much abbreviated form, and Gower unquestionably followed mainly the Latin prose narrative which was commonly current, though he thought the *Pantheon*, as a grave historical authority, more fit to be cited. The very first sentence, with its reference, ‘as seith the bok,’ is enough to indicate this, but a few more points may be mentioned here in which the story of the *Pantheon* differs from Gower and from the prose *Historia Apollonii Tyrii*. (1) Godfrey of Viterbo does not say what was the problem proposed by Antiochus, nor does he mention the period of thirty days. (2) He gives no details of the flight of Apollonius or of the mourning of his people, and he does not mention the incident of Taliart (or Thaliarchus). (3) The name Pentapolim is not introduced. (4) There is no mention in the *Pantheon* of the wooing of the daughter of Archistrates by three princes (or nobles) or of the bills which they wrote. (5) There is no mention of the nurse Lichorida being taken with Apollonius and his wife on shipboard, of the master of the ship insisting that the corpse should be thrown into the sea, or of the name of the physician, Cerimon. (6) The *Pantheon* says nothing of the vow of Apollonius in ll. 1301-1306. (7) The name Theophilus is not given. (8) There is no mention of the tomb of Thaise (or Tharsia) being shown to Apollonius. (9) In the *Pantheon* the punishment of Strangulio and Dionysia precedes the visit to Ephesus, and

there is no mention of the dream which caused Apollonius to sail to Ephesus.

There are indeed some points in which Gower agrees with the *Pantheon* against the *Historia*, for example in making the princess ask for Apollonius as her teacher on the very night of the banquet instead of the next morning, and in representing that Apollonius went to his kingdom after leaving his daughter at Tharsis (cp. E. Klebs, *Die Erzählung von Apollonius aus Tyrus*, Berlin, 1899). Perhaps however the most marked correspondence is where Gower makes the wife of Apollonius ‘Abbesse’ of Diana’s temple (l. 1849), which is evidently from Godfrey’s line, ‘Sic apud Ephesios velut abbatissa moratur’: cp. also l. 1194 ‘warmed ofte.’ These are both among the later additions to the *Pantheon*, and apparently were overlooked by Singer and Klebs when they pronounced that Gower probably knew only the earlier redaction: cp. notes on vii. 2765, 4181.

The Latin prose narrative has been printed in *Welseri Opera*, ed. 1682, pp. 681-704, and also in the Teubner series (ed. Riese, 1871, 1893). It is a translation from a Greek original, as is sufficiently indicated by the Greek words that occur in it, and by the Greek customs which it refers to or presupposes. Gower agrees with it pretty closely, but the story is not improved in his hands. It loses, of course, the Greek characteristics of which we have spoken, and several of the incidents are related by Gower in a less effective manner than in the original. For example, in the scene near the beginning between Antiochus and Apollonius, the king asks, ‘Nosti nuptiarum conditionem?’ and the young man replies, ‘Novi et ad portam vidi,’ to which there is nothing corresponding in Gower. Again, at a later stage of the story, when the three young nobles send in their proposals to the daughter of Archistrates, the original story makes her reply in a note which declares that she will marry only ‘the ship-wrecked man.’ The king innocently inquires of the three young men which of them has suffered shipwreck, and finally hands the note to Apollonius to see if he can make anything of it. This is much better managed than by Gower. On the other hand our author has done well in dispensing with the rudeness and boastfulness of Apollonius on the occasion when the king’s daughter plays the harp at the feast, and also in modifying the scenes at the brothel and excluding Athenagoras from taking part in them. The quotations given in the following notes are made from the Bodleian MS. Laud 247, a good copy

of the twelfth century, which has a form of text more nearly corresponding to that which Gower used than that of any of the printed editions, and by means of which we can account for the names Thaise and Philotenne.

It can hardly be necessary to observe that the play of *Pericles, Prince of Tyre*, had another source besides Gower, and especially as regards its fourth and fifth acts. Marina is waylaid while going to visit the tomb of her old nurse, as in the original story, the scene of the pirates agrees more nearly with the original than with Gower, Lysimachus plays a part very like that which Gower took away from Athenagoras, and the scene between Cleon and Dionyza (iv. 4) seems to be suggested by the original. The story was current in English prose, as is well known.

386. *And seileth*: cp. v. 3291 and note.

395. *he moste*, 'that he might,' 'ut sibi liceret,' a common use of the word in older English (see examples in Bosworth and Toller's Dictionary).

405 ff. (margin). The riddle as given in the Laud MS. is, 'Scelere uehor. Materna carne uescor. Quero patrem meum matris mee uirum uxoris mee filiam, nec inuenio.' Most copies have 'fratrem meum' for 'patrem meum,' but Gower agrees with the Laud MS. I do not attempt a solution of it beyond that of Apollonius, which is, 'Quod dixisti scelere uehor, non es mentitus, ad te ipsum respice. Et quod dixisti materna carne uescor, filiam tuam intueri.'

484. *the Stwes*. For the spelling cp. 'Jwes,' v. 1713, 1808.

536. This is by no means in accordance with the original. Antiochus exclaims on hearing of the flight of Apollonius, 'Fugere modo quidem potest, effugere autem quandoque me minime poterit,' and at once issues an edict, 'Quicumque mihi Apollonium contemptorem regni mei uiuum adduxerit, quinquaginta talenta auri a me dabuntur ei: qui uero caput eius mihi optulerit, talentorum c. receptor erit' (f. 205 v^o), and he causes search to be made after him both by land and sea. The change made by Gower is not a happy one, for it takes away the motive for the flight from Tarsus, where Apollonius heard of this proscription.

542 ff. In the original Apollonius meets 'Hellanicus' at once on landing, and is informed by him of the proscription. He makes an offer to Strangulio to sell his wheat at cost price to the citizens, if they will conceal his

presence among them. The money which he receives as the price of the wheat is expended by him in public benefits to the state, and the citizens set up a statue of him standing in a two-horse chariot (biga), his right hand holding forth corn and his left foot resting upon a bushel measure.

603. *ferketh*, 'conveys,' from OE. 'fercian': cp. Anglo-Saxon Chron. 1009, *Hī fercodon ða scipo eft to Lundenne* (quoted in Bosworth and Toller's Dictionary).

624. 'But with cable and cord broken asunder ... the ship' &c., past participle absolute, as ii. 791, viii. 1830.

640. *forto mote To gete ayein*. Apparently this means 'to wish to get again,' a meaning derived from the phrase 'so mot I,' &c., expressing a wish. The infinitive is very unusual. For the gerund with 'to' which follows it cp. ii. 510, vii. 437, where we have this construction with 'mai,' 'mihte.'

679. The account in the original story is here considerably different. Gower did not understand the Greek customs. 'Et dum cogitaret unde uite peteret auxilium, uidit puerum nudum per plateam currentem, oleo unctum, precinctum sabana, ferentem ludos iuueniles ad gymnasium pertinentes, maxima uoce dicentem: Audite ciues, audite peregrini, liberi et ingenui, gymnasium patet. Apollonius hoc audito exuens se tribunario ingreditur lauacrum, utitur liquore palladio; et dum exercentes singulos intueretur, parem sibi querit et non inuenit. Subito Arcestrates rex totius illius regionis cum turba famulorum ingressus est: dumque cum suis ad pile lusum exercebatur, uolente deo miscuit se Apollonius regi, et dum currenti sustulit pilam, subtili ueiocitate percussam ludenti regi remisit' &c. (f. 207 v^o).

The story proceeds to say that the king, pleased with the skill of Apollonius in the game of ball, accepted his services at the bath, and was rubbed down by him in a very pleasing manner. The result was an invitation to supper.

Gower agrees here with the *Pantheon* in making the king a spectator only.

691. *Artestrathes*. The name is Arcestrates in the Laud MS.

706. *lefte it noght*, 'did not neglect it.'

720 f. 'Ingressus Apollonius in triclinium, contra regem adsignato loco discubuit.' Gower apparently sets him at the head of the second table. For 'beginne' cp. *Cant. Tales*, Prol. 52, with Skeat's note.

767 ff. In the original all applaud the performance of the king's daughter except Apollonius, who being asked by the king why he alone kept silence, replied, 'Bone rex, si permittis, dicam quod sentio: filia enim tua in artem musicam incidit, nam non didicit. Denique iube mihi tradi liram, et scies quod nescit' (f. 208 v^o). Gower has toned this down to courtesy.

782. 'ita stetit ut omnes discumbentes una cum rege non Apollonium sed Apollinem estimarent.'

866 ff. In the original this incident takes place when the king is in company with Apollonius. The king replies that his daughter has fallen ill from too much study, but he bids them each write his name and the sum of money which he is prepared to offer as dowry, and he sends the bills at once to the princess by the hand of Apollonius. She reads them, and then asks whether he is not sorry that she is going to be married. He says, 'Immo gratulor,' and she replies, 'Si amares, doleres.' Then she writes a note, saying that she wishes to have 'the shipwrecked man' as her husband, adding 'Si miraris, pater, quod pudica uirgo tam imprudenter scripserim, scitote quia quod pudore indicare non potui, per ceram mandavi, que ruborem non habet.' The king having read the note asks the young men which of them has been shipwrecked. One claims the distinction, but is promptly exposed by his companions, and the king hands the note to Apollonius, saying that he can make nothing of it. Apollonius reads and blushes, and the king asks, 'Inuenisti naufragum?' To which he replies discreetly, 'Bone rex, si permittis, inueni.' The king at last understood, and dismissed the three young men, promising to send for them when they were wanted.

901 ff. 'cui si me non tradideris, amittis filiam tuam,' but this is afterwards, in a personal interview.

930 ff. There is no mention of the queen in the original. The king calls his friends together and announces the marriage. The description of the wedding, &c., ll. 952-974, is due to Gower.

1003 ff. In the original story it is here announced to Apollonius that he has been elected king in succession to Antiochus; but this was regarded by our author as an unnecessary complication.

1037 ff. The details of the description are due to our author.

1054 ff. So far as the original can be understood, it seems to say that the birth of the child was brought about by the storm and that the appearance of death in the mother took place afterwards, owing to a coagulation of the blood caused by the return of fair weather.

1059-1083. This is all Gower, except 1076 f.

1089 ff. Apparently the meaning is that the sea will necessarily cast a dead body up on the shore, and therefore they must throw it out of the ship, otherwise the ship itself will be cast ashore with it. The Latin says only, 'nauis mortuum non suffert: iube ergo corpus in pelago mitti' (f. 211 v^o).

1101. The punctuation is that of F.

1128. *tak in his mynde*, 'let him take thought': cp. v. 3573, and l. 1420 below.

1165. *the wisest*: cp. Introduction, p. cxi.

1184 ff. In the original it is not Cerimon himself, but a young disciple of his, who discovers the signs of life and takes measures for restoring her. She has already been laid upon the pyre, and he by carefully lighting the four corners of it (cp. l. 1192) succeeds in liquefying the coagulated blood. Then he takes her in and warms her with wool steeped in hot oil.

1195. 'began' is singular, and the verbs 'hete,' 'flacke,' 'bete' are used intransitively: 'to flacke' means to flutter.

1219. 'In short, they speak of nothing': 'as for an ende' seems to mean the same as 'for end' or 'for an end' in later English: cp. *New English Dictionary*, 'end.'

1248. This daughter is apparently an invention of Gower's, who perhaps misread the original, 'adhibitis amicis filiam sibi adoptauit,' that is, he adopted her as his daughter.

1285. *his In*, 'his lodging,' in this case the house of Strangulio. Note the distinction made here by the capital letter between the substantive and the

adverb: see Introduction, p. clix.

1293. *whiche*: note the plural, referring to Strangulio and his wife.

1295. The name here in the original is 'Tharsia,' given to her by her father's suggestion from the name of the city, Tharsus, where she was left; but the Laud MS. afterwards regularly calls her Thasia.

1311 ff. This is not in accordance with the Latin prose story. He is there represented as telling Strangulio that he does not care, now that he has lost his wife, either to accept the offered kingdom or to return to his father-in-law, but intends to lead the life of a merchant. Here the expression is 'ignotas et longinquas petens Egypti regiones.' On the other hand the *Pantheon* makes him proceed to his kingdom, apparently Antioch.

1337. *Philotenne*: the name in the Laud MS. is 'Philothemia,' but it is not distinguishable in writing from Philothenna. There is much variation as to this name in other copies.

1349 ff. Much is made in the original story of the death of this nurse and of the revelation which she made to Tharsia of her real parentage. Up to this time she had supposed herself to be the daughter of Strangulio. The nurse suspected some evil, and advised Tharsia, if her supposed parents dealt ill with her, to go and take hold of the statue of her father in the market-place and appeal to the citizens for help. After her death Tharsia visited her tomb by the sea-shore every day, 'et ibi manes parentum suorum inuocabat.' Here Theophilus lay in wait for her by order of Dionysiades.

1374. *cherles*. This is the reading of the best copies of each recension: cp. 'lyves' for 'livish' i. e. living, 'worldes' for 'worldly,' 'dethes' for 'dedly,' iii. 2657, iv. 382, &c.

1376. *what sche scholde*, that is, what should become of her.

1391. *Scomerfare*. The first part of this word must be the French 'escumerie,' meaning piracy: see Du Cange under 'escumator,' e. g. 'des compaignons du pays de Bretagne, qui étaient venuz d'Escumerie.'

1393. *and he to go*, that is, 'and he proceeded to go,' a kind of historic infinitive: cp. Chaucer, *Troilus*, ii. 1108, 'And she to laughe,' *Leg. of Good Women*, 653 'And al his folk to go.' (In *Piers Plowman*, A. Prol. 33, 'And somme murthes to make,' quoted by Mätzner, it is more probable that 'to

make' is dependent on 'chosen.')

In addition to these instances we have the repeated use of 'to ga' in Barbour's *Bruce*, e. g. viii. 251, ix. 263, which is much more probably to be explained in this way than as a compound verb. Cp. Skeat's *Chaucer*, vol. vi. p. 403, with C. Stoffel's note on *Troilus*, ii. 1108, which is there quoted.

1410. The Laud MS. has 'leno leoninus nomine,' but many copies give no name.

1420. *Lei doun*, 'let him lay down': cp. l. 1128.

1423. There is an interesting touch in the original here which would not be intelligible to Gower. When Tharsia is led into the house, the character of which she does not know, she is bidden to do reverence to a statue of Priapus which stands in the entrance hall. She asks her master whether he is a native of Lampsacus, and he explains to her that his interest in this matter is not local but professional.

1424 ff. There is much in the original about the visit of Athenagoras and of other persons, who are successively so far overcome by the tears and entreaties of Tarsia, as not only to spare her but to give her large sums of money, while at the same time they make a jest both of themselves and of one another for doing so.

1451 f. The rhyme is saved from being an identical one by the adverbial use of 'weie' in the second line, 'mi weie' being equivalent to 'aweie.'

1513. In the original she is reproached by her husband for the deed, and this is the case in the play of *Pericles* also.

1518. *of record*, 'of good repute.'

1534 f. Cp. *Pericles*, iv. 4, 'The fairest, sweetest, best lies here,' but the rest of the epitaph compares unfavourably with Gower's.

1567 ff. Here we have a curious lapse on the part of our author. He represents that the king had no sooner held his parliament and celebrated the sacrifice in memory of his wife, than he began to prepare for his voyage to Tharsis. The story requires however that at least fourteen years should elapse, and this, according to the original narrative, has been spent by Apollonius in travelling about as a merchant, a matter of which Gower says

nothing. Probably the *Pantheon*, which is not very clear on the matter, is responsible for the oversight.

1587. 'For she is continually changing with regard to him.'

1617. *besihe*, 'attended to.' The use of this verb was not very common in Gower's time except in the participle 'beseie,' 'besein.' The verb means (1) look, see, (2) look to, attend to, (3) provide, arrange: hence the participle is quite naturally used in the sense of 'furnished,' 'provided,' and we have 'unbesein of,' l. 153, for 'unprovided with.' It is usually explained by reference to its first sense, as having regard necessarily to appearance. 'Appearing in respect of dress, &c.,' 'Appearing as to accomplishments, furnished' (so *New English Dictionary*), but it is more natural to take these meanings of the participle as from senses (2) (3) of the verb. It is doubtful whether even the phrase 'well besein' used of personal appearance means anything but 'well furnished.'

1636. *fordrive*, 'driven about' by storms, actually and metaphorically.

1670 ff. Her song is given in the original; it is rather pretty, but very much corrupted in the manuscripts. It begins thus,

'Per sordes gradior, sed sordis conscia non sum,
Ut rosa in spinis nescit mucrone perire,' &c.

1681 ff. Several of her riddles are given in the original story and he succeeds in answering them all at once. One is this,

'Longa feror uelox formose filia silue,
Innumeris pariter comitum stipata cateruis:
Curro uias multas, uestigia nulla relinquens.'

The answer is 'Nauis.'

She finally falls on his neck and embraces him, upon which he kicks her severely. She begins to lament, and incidentally lets him know her story. The suggestion contained in ll. 1702 ff., of the mysterious influence of kinship, is Gower's own, and we find the same idea in the tale of Constance, ii. 1381 f.,

‘This child he loveth kindly,
And yit he wot no cause why.’

1830. ‘And all other business having been left’: cp. ii. 791.

1890. *With topseilcole*: cp. v. 3119,

‘Bot evene topseilcole it blew.’

The word ‘topseilcole’ (written as one word in the best copies of each recension) does not seem to occur except in these two passages. It is evidently a technical term of the sea, and in both these passages it is used in connexion with a favourable wind. Morley quotes from Godefroy a use of the word ‘cole’ in French in a nautical sense, ‘Se mistrent en barges et alerent aux salandres, et en prisrent les xvii, et l’une eschapa, qui estoit a la cole.’ Unfortunately, however, it is uncertain what this means. The vessels in question were in port when they were attacked, and therefore ‘a la cole’ might reasonably mean with sails (or topsails) set, and so ready to start. A topsail breeze would be one which was fairly strong, but not too strong to allow of sailing under topsails, and this is rather the idea suggested by the two passages in Gower.

It should be noted that in F and in some other MSS. there is a stop after the word ‘topseilcole.’

1948. *forto honge and drawe*: the verbs are transitive, ‘that men should hang and draw them’ (i. e. pluck out their bowels).

1983. This must mean apparently ‘They had no need to take in a reef.’ The use of ‘slake’ with this meaning does not seem quite appropriate, but a sail or part of a sail is slackened in a certain sense when it is taken in, seeing that it is no longer subject to the pressure of the wind.

2055. *leng the lasse*: cp. iii. 71, ‘the leng the ferre.’ This form of the comparative is usual in such phrases, as Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, A 3872, ‘That ilke fruit is ever leng the wers,’ and perhaps also E 687, F 404, *Compl. unto Pite*, 95, where the MSS. gives ‘lenger.’ The form ‘leng’ is the original comparative adverb of ‘long.’

2077. *toward Venus*: cp. v. 6757. Here it means ‘on the side of Venus.’

2095. *sett*, imperative, like ‘set case,’ i. e. ‘suppose that.’ The reading ‘sith’ is certainly wrong.

2113. *his oghne dom*. The word ‘dom’ is used here in special reference to ‘kingdom’ in the line above. ‘Every man has a royal rule to exercise, that is the rule over himself.’

2124 f. ‘When he has not kept possession for himself of his own heart.’

2165. *And felt it*: we have here the elision-apocope in the case of a preterite subjunctive.

2194. *hath nothing set therby*, ‘accounted it as nothing.’

2198. *withholde*, ‘kept’ (in service).

2212 f. Cp. iii. 298, *Vox Clam.* ii. 1.

2217 ff. This ‘Supplication’ is a finished and successful composition in its way, and it may make us desire that our author had written more of the same kind. The poem *In Praise of Peace*, which is written in the same metre and stanza, is too much on a political subject to give scope for poetical fancy. The nearest parallel in style is to be found in some of the author’s French Balades.

2245. *Whom nedeth help*, ‘He to whom help is needful’: cp. Prol. 800, i. 2446.

2253 ff. Cp. vi. 330 ff.

2259 ff. Cp. *Balades*, xx.

2265. *Danger*: see note on i. 2443.

2288. Cp. i. 143 ff.

2312. *a Mile*: cp. iv. 689. It means apparently the time that it takes to go a mile: cp. Chaucer, *Astrol.* i. 16, ‘five of these degres maken a milewey and thre mileweie maken an houre.’

2319. *a game*, for ‘agame’: cp. Chaucer, *Troilus*, iii. 636, 648. More usually ‘in game,’ as l. 2871.

2341. *fulofte hath pleigned*: as for example in the *Planctus Naturae* of Alanus de Insulis.

2365. 'And I will consider the matter': practically equivalent to a refusal of the petition, as in the form 'Le Roy s'avisera.'

2367. *is noght to sieke*, 'is not wanting': cp. i. 924, ii. 44, &c.

2378. 'In no security, but as men draw the chances of Ragman.' To understand this it is necessary to refer to compositions such as we find in the Bodleian MSS., Fairfax 16, and Bodley 638, under the name of 'Ragman (or Ragmans) Rolle.' The particular specimen contained in these MSS. begins thus:

'My ladyes and my maistresses echone,
Lyke hit unto your humble wommanhede,
Resave in gre of my sympill persone
This rolle, which withouten any drede
Kynge Ragman me bad [me] sowe in brede,
And cristyned yt the merour of your chaunce.
Drawith a stryng and that shal streight yow lede
Unto the verry path of your governaunce.'

After two more stanzas about the uncertainty of Fortune and the chances of drawing well or ill, there follows a disconnected series of twenty-two more, each giving a description of the personal appearance and character of a woman, in some cases complimentary and in others very much the reverse, usually in the form of an address to the lady herself, e. g.

'A smal conceyt may ryght enogh suffyse
Of your beaute discripcion for to make;
For at on word ther kan no wyght devyse
Oon that therof hath lasse, I undertake,' &c.

Apparently these stanzas are to be drawn for and then read out in order as they come, for the game ends with the last,

‘And sythen ye be so jocunde and so good,
And in the rolle last as in wrytynge,
I rede that this game ende in your hood.’

Evidently the same kind of game might be played by men with a view to their mistresses. It is much the same thing as the ‘Chaunces of the Dyse,’ where each stanza is connected with a certain throw made with three dice: cp. note on iv. 2792. The name ‘Ragman Rolle’ seems to be due to the disconnected character of the composition.

2407. *olde grisel*: cp. Chaucer, *To Scogan*, 35: ‘grisel’ means grey horse.

2415. *upon the fet*, that is, when the time comes for action. The rhyme with ‘retret’ shows that this is not the plural of ‘fot’: moreover, that is elsewhere regularly spelt ‘feet’ by Gower.

2428. *sitte* for ‘sit’: cp. Introduction, p. cxiv.

2435. *torned into was*: the verb used as a substantive, cp. vi. 923.

2450 ff. The situation here has some resemblance to that in the Prologue of the *Legend of Good Women*, where the author has a vision of the god of Love coming to him in a meadow, as he lies worshipping the daisy, accompanied by queen Alcestis, and followed first by the nineteen ladies of the Legend, and then by a vast multitude of other women who had been true in love. The differences, however, are considerable. Here we have Venus and Cupid, the latter armed with a bow and blind (whereas Chaucer gives him two fiery darts and his eyesight), with two companies of lovers, both men and women, marshalled by Youth and Eld as leaders; and the colloquy with the poet has for its result to dismiss him with wounds healed from Love’s service, as one who has earned his discharge, while in the case of Chaucer it is a question of imposing penance for transgressions in the past and of enlisting him for the future as the servant of Love. The conception of the god of Love appearing with a company of true lovers in attendance may be regarded as the common property of the poets of the time, and so also was the controversy between the flower and the leaf (l. 2468), which Chaucer introduces as a thing familiar already to his readers. If our author

had any particular model before him, it may quite as well have been the description in Froissart's *Paradys d'Amours* (ed. Scheler, i. 29 f.):

'Lors regardai en une lande,
Si vi une compagne grande
De dames et de damoiselles
Friches et jolies et belles,
Et grant foison de damoiseaus
Jolis et amoureux et beaus.

"Dame," di je, "puis je sçavoir
Qui sont ceuls que puis là veoir?"
"Oil," dit ma dame de pris;
"Troïllus y est et Paris,
Qui furent fil au roi Priant,
Et cesti que tu vois riant,
C'est Laiscelos tout pour certain," &c.

and she proceeds to enumerate the rest, including Tristram and Yseult, Percival, Galehaus, Meliador and Gawain, Helen, Hero, Polyxena, and Medea with Jason.

I do not doubt that Gower may have seen the *Legend of Good Women*, but it was not much his practice to borrow from contemporary poets of his own country, however free he might make with the literature of former times or of foreign lands.

2461. *who was who*: cp. vii. 2001.

2468. Cp. Chaucer, *Leg. of G. Women*, 72, 188, &c.

2470. *the newe guise of Beawme*, that is, the new fashions of dress, &c., introduced from Bohemia by the marriage of Richard II in 1382.

2500 f. *which was believed With bele Ysolde*, 'who was accepted as a lover by Belle Isolde.' Apparently 'believed' is here used in the primary sense of the verb, from which we have 'lief.' For the use of 'with' cp. l.

2553. We may note here that the spelling 'believe' is regular in Gower, 'ie' representing 'ē.'

2502. *Galahot*, i. e. Galahalt, called by Mallory 'the haut prince.'

2504 ff. It may be noted that several of the lovers in the company of Youth are impenitent in their former faithlessness, as Jason, Hercules and Theseus, while Medea, Deianira and Ariadne are left to complain by themselves. Troilus has recovered Cressida, if only for a time. It is hard to say why Pyramus failed of Thisbe's company, unless indeed she were unable to pardon his lateness (cp. 2582).

2515 ff. Cp. v. 7213 ff.

2553. *with Enee*: cp. vii. 3359 and l. 2501.

2573 ff. It is likely enough that this idea of Cleopatra's death may have been a reminiscence of the *Legend of Good Women*, 696 ff. Chaucer apparently got it from some such account as that quoted by Vincent of Beauvais from Hugh of Fleury, 'in mausoleum odoribus refertum iuxta suum se collocavit Antonium. Deinde admotis sibi serpentibus morte sopita est.' From this to the idea of a grave full of serpents would not be a difficult step.

2582. *Wo worthe*: cp. l. 1334.

2663. I take 'lay' to mean 'law,' i. e. the arrangement of his company.

2687. Cp. iv. 2314.

2705 ff. An allusion to some such story as we have in the 'Lay d'Aristote' (Méon et Barbazan, iii. p. 96).

2713. The punctuation follows F.

2714 ff. This refers to the well-known story of Virgil and the daughter of the Emperor, who left him suspended in a box from her window.

2718. *Sortes*. It is impossible that this can be for 'Socrates,' with whose name Gower was quite well acquainted. Perhaps it stands for the well-known 'Sortes Sanctorum' (Virgilianae, &c.), personified here as a magician, and even figuring, in company with Virgil and the rest, as an elderly lover.

2799. Cp. i. 143 ff.

2823. *syhe*, subj., 'should see.'

2828. *deface*: apparently intransitive, 'suffer defacement': cp. iv. 2844.

2833. *Outwith*, 'outwardly': so 'inwith' often for 'within,' 'inwardly.' Dr. Murray refers me to *Orm.* i. 165, 'utenn wiþþ,' and Hampole, *Prick of Conscience*, 6669, 'outwith.' The best MSS. have a stop after 'Outwith.'

2904. *A Peire of Bedes*: the usual expression for a rosary: cp. *Cant. Tales*, Prol. 158 f.,

'Of smal coral aboute hire arm she bar
A peire of bedes gauded al with grene.'

2926 f. That is the *Speculum Hominis* and the *Vox Clamantis*.

2931. *pernable*. The best MSS. have this, and it is obviously suitable to the sense: 'Do not pursue when the game cannot be caught.' From 'prendre' Gower uses 'pernonis,' 'pernetz,' &c., in the *Mirour*.

2938. At this point begins a new hand in F, and for the rest of this leaf (f. 184) the text is written over an erasure (ll. 2938-2966). A note is written opposite l. 2938 for the guidance of the scribe, 'now haue &c.' It may be noted that l. 2940 has a coloured initial A as for the beginning of a paragraph, and this apparently belongs to the original writing, whereas in the first recension MSS. the paragraph begins at l. 2941. The next leaf (f. 185) is a substituted one, and the text is written still in the same hand.

The orthography of the new hand, in which ll. 2938-3146 are written, differs in some respects from the standard spelling which we have in the rest of the manuscript. The chief points of difference are as follows:

(1) *-id* (*-yd*) termination almost always in the past participle, as *enclosid*, *turnyd*, *bewhapid*, *blessid* (but *sterred*), *iþ* frequently in the 3rd pers. sing. of verbs, *belongiþ*, *seruiþ*, *causiþ* (but *secheþ*, *suieþ*), and *-in* (*-yn*) in 3rd pers. pl., as *takyn*, *sechin*, *hierin*, *schuldyn* (also *to lokyn*). (2) *-is* (*-ys*) in the genit. sing, and in the plural of substantives, as *londis*, *mannys*, *bedis*, *lawis*, *wordis* (but *þinges*, *myghtes*). (3) *-ir* (*-yr*) termination, as *aftir*, *ouyr*, *wondir* (but *siker*). (4) *y* for *i* (*I*) in many cases, especially as the

pronoun of the first person (once *I*), also *ys* (sometimes), *hym*, *wipynne*. (5) *gh* for *h* in such words as *sigh*, *sighte*, *myghte*, *knyghthode*. (6) *ou* for *o* in *nought*, *brought*, *þoughte*, &c. (7) consonants doubled in *vppon* and vowels in *maad* (also *mad*), *book*, *goon*. (8) separation of words, as *in to*, *un to*, *hym self*, *þer fore*, *þer vpon*, *wher of*, *wip ouden*.

It may be observed that something of the same tendency is observable at this point in the Stafford MS., but the differences appear in a much less marked manner, and chiefly in the terminations *-id*, *-ip*, *-is*, *-ir*. *S* does not give *y* for *I*, *ys* for *is*, nor *myghte*, *sigh*, *nought*, *oughte*, *vppon*, *þer fore*, &c.

2974 (margin). *orat pro statu regni*. This marks exactly the stage reached in the second of the three versions which we have of Gower's account of his own works (p. 480,) 'vbi pro statu regni compositor deuocius exorat.' The first completely excuses and the third utterly condemns the king, but the second makes no mention of him either for praise or blame, and that is the line taken in this form of the epilogue.

3012. *maintenue*, that is, 'maintenance' of quarrels by the lords on behalf of their followers: cp. *Mirour*, 23732 ff., where the same subject is dealt with.

3081. *beth*: see *Intro.* p. cxiv: but it is the reading of *F* only.

3114. *curiosite*, 'artful workmanship': cp. Chaucer, *Compleinte of Venus*, 81.

3147. Here, at the beginning of f. 186, the hand in *F* changes again and the rest of the manuscript, including the *Traitié*, the Latin poems and the author's account of his books, is written in the hand which we have in the first leaf of the Prologue.

2955*. *his testament of love*. There is no reason to suppose that this is a reference to any particular work which Gower may have known that Chaucer had in hand. It may be a general suggestion that Chaucer should before his death compose some further work on love, which should serve as his last testimony (or last will and testament) on the subject, as the shrift of the present poem was our author's leave-taking. To assume that the poem

referred to must be the *Legend of Good Women*, and to argue from this that the *Confessio Amantis* was written before the *Legend* was given to the public, would be very rash. It is not likely that Usk's *Testament of Love* was known to Gower when he wrote this.

2991*. This quality of mercy, for which Richard is especially praised, seems to have been precisely the point in which he was afterwards most found wanting by our author, so that he finally earns the title of 'crudelissimus rex.' Matters had not gone so far as this when the second form of epilogue was substituted, in which these praises were simply omitted. Gower was then (in the fourteenth year of the reign) in a state of suspended judgement, expressed by the 'orat pro statu regni' of 2974 (margin). The subsequent events, and especially the treatment of the duke of Gloucester and his friends, finally decided his opinions and his allegiance, as we may see in the *Cronica Tripertita*.

3054* ff. See Prol. 83* ff.

3102*. *no contretaille*, 'no retribution' afterwards: cp. *Traitié*, vii. 3, 'De son mesfait porta le contretaille.'

3104*. That is, it tends rather to set us free from evil consequences than to bring them upon us.

EXPLICIT, 5 f. The following copies of the first recension contain these last two lines, XERB₂Cath. Of the rest MH₁YGODAr.Ash. are imperfect at the end, N₂ omits the Explicit altogether, and I have no note as regards this point about Ad₂P₁Q. Of the seven which I note as having the 'Explicit' in four lines only, three are of the revised and four of the unrevised group. All copies of the second and third recensions have the last two lines, except of course those that are imperfect here.

QUAM CINXERE FRETA, &c. The 'philosopher' who was the author of this epistle is no doubt responsible also for the lines 'Eneidos, Bucolis,' &c. (printed in the Roxb. ed. of the *Vox Clamantis*, p. 427), in which our author is compared to Virgil, the chief difference being that whereas Virgil had achieved fame in one language only, Gower had distinguished himself in

three. The writer in that case also is 'quidam philosophus' (not 'quidam Philippus,' as he is called in the printed copy), and I suspect that he was the 'philosophical Strode' who is coupled with Gower in the dedication of *Troilus*.

3. 'tibi' belongs to the next line, 'siue satirus Poeta' being taken together.

QUIA VNUSQUISQUE, &c. The form here given is found in no manuscript of the *Confessio Amantis* except F and H₂ (copied from F), though some other third recension copies, as W and K, may probably have contained it. We have it, however, also in two manuscripts of the *Vox Clamantis*, the All Souls copy and that in the Hunterian Library at Glasgow.

It should be noted that whereas the first recension manuscripts regularly contain the Latin account of the author's three books in immediate connexion with the *Confessio Amantis*, in the second recension it is made to follow the *Traitié*, and SΔ, which do not contain the *Traitié*, omit this also, while in F it comes later still, following the Latin *Carmen de multiplici viciorum pestilencia*. Thus the form which we have in F must be regarded as later than the accompanying text of the *Confessio Amantis*, from which it is separated in the MS. both by position and handwriting, and the words 'ab alto corruens in foueam quam fecit finaliter proiectus est' seem to indicate that it was written after the deposition of Richard II.

11 f. 'Speculum hominis' in all copies of the first recension. 'Speculum meditantis' over an erasure in the Glasgow MS. of the *Vox Clamantis*.

25 ff. Note the omission here (of nine words which are necessary to the sense) in every first recension copy except J. Similarly below all except J have 'finem' for 'sentencie,' obviously from a mistaken reading of a contraction ('fiē'). These must be original errors, only removed by later revision, the first no doubt due to dropping a line.

IN PRAISE OF PEACE.

The text of this poem is taken from the manuscript at Trentham Hall belonging to the Duke of Sutherland, which contains also the *Cinkante*

Balades. Of this book a full description has been given in the Introduction to Gower's French Works, pp. lxxix ff. The present poem is the first piece in the book (ff. 5-10 v^o), and is written in the same hand as the *Balades* and *Traitié*, a hand which resembles that which appears in ff. 184, 185 of the Fairfax MS., though I should hesitate to say positively that it is the same. Evidently, however, the manuscript is contemporary with the author, and it gives us an excellent text of the poem. The date of its composition is doubtless the first year of king Henry IV, for the manuscript which contains it ends with some Latin lines (added in a different hand), in which the author speaks of himself as having become blind in the first year of king Henry IV and having entirely ceased to write in consequence of this.

As a composition it is not without some merit. The style is dignified, and the author handles his verse in a craftsmanlike manner, combining a straightforward simplicity of language with a smooth flow of metre and a well-balanced stanza, the verse being preserved from monotony by variety of pause and caesura. Some stanzas are really impressive, as those which begin with ll. 99, 127, 148. The divisions of the poem, indicated in the MS. by larger coloured initials, have hitherto escaped the notice of editors.

The poem was printed first in the collected edition of *Chaucer's Works*, 1532, commonly called Thynne's edition (ff. 375 v^o-378), and reprinted from this in the succeeding folio editions of Chaucer (e. g. 1561, f. 330 v^o, 1598, f. 330 v^o, 1602, f. 314). There was no attempt made in any of these to ascribe its authorship to Chaucer, Gower's name being always given as the author. It has been published also by J. Wright in his *Political Poems and Songs* (Rolls' Series), the text being taken from the Trentham MS., and it has been included by Prof. Skeat in his interesting collection of poems which have been printed with Chaucer's works (*Chaucerian and other Pieces*, pp. 205-216).

Thynne followed a manuscript which gave a fair text, but one much inferior to that of the Trentham copy, both in material correctness and in spelling, e. g.

‘Kyng Salomon whiche had at his askyng
Of god | what thyng him was leuest craue
He chase wysedom vnto gouernyng

Of goddes folke | the whiche he wolde saue
And as he chase it fyl him for to haue
For through his wytte while y^t his reigne last
He gate him peace and rest in to his last'

All the material variations of Thynne are given in the critical notes, but not his differences of spelling. Wright's text is not to be trusted as a reproduction of the Trentham MS. He made several serious mistakes in copying from or collating it, and he has a good many trifling inaccuracies of spelling. The following are his worst errors:

l. 3 *om.* this 16 the *for* thi 71 To stere peace (*following Thynne*) 108 *om.* doth tofalle *for* to falle 136 than *for* that 173 But aftirwards 202 *om.* worthi 211 any *for* a 246 [good] *seeming to imply that it is not in the MS.* 263 Which heliples 278 reserved *for* deserved 289 man *for* king 292 [up] 306 begete *for* be gete 356 Resteined *for* Resceived 363 deleated *for* debated 382 sese *for* see. In addition to these rather gross blunders, he has about a hundred smaller deviations from the manuscript which he professes to follow, as, for example, 7 for to *for* forto (*and so afterwards*) 16 him self *for* himself (*and so afterwards*) 19 But 27 request *for* requeste 39 might *for* myht 56 shal *for* schal 83 lefte *for* left 84 not *for* noght 90 charitie *for* charite 98 Both *for* Bothe 102 gone *for* goon nygth *for* nyght 110 dothe 112 I 120 Crists 155 fulfilled 172 wille 194 destrued 219 made 254 Ffirst chirche her silf 260 sick 280 life 287 made an end 319 found 355 Which 382 meschiefe and a good many more. He also omits in a very misleading manner the last lines of the rubric which follows the poem, 'Et nunc sequitur epistola' &c., as well as the 'epistle' itself, 'Rex celi deus'; and he makes it appear that the lines 'Henrici quarti' &c. follow at once, whereas they are at the end of the MS. and in a different hand.

I think it worth while to specify these instances because Wright's edition has been accepted by Prof. Skeat as an accurate reproduction of a manuscript which is not generally accessible, and if no notice were taken here of the readings given by Wright, it would still remain in doubt whether he or I represented the text more correctly. Especially in the cases where Wright has bracketed a word as not occurring in the manuscript, it might be supposed that his positive testimony was to be preferred.

Prof. Skeat has based his text on Thynne, making such alterations of spelling as seemed to him suitable, and giving the variants of Wright's edition as those of the Trentham MS. Misled by Wright, he has accepted in his text the readings 'reserved' in l. 278, and 'cese' in l. 382.

The text given by the Trentham MS. is apparently quite free from material error, except as regards the word erased in l. 71, and the points of spelling which require correction are very few in number. The orthography is not quite in accordance with the standard spelling of the Fairfax and Stafford MSS., and in some respects resembles that of the third hand of F, on which we have commented in the note on *Confessio Amantis*, viii. 2938. Here however there is only a slight tendency to use *i* for *e* in weak terminations. We have *distourbid* 153, *vndefendid: amendid* 223 f., *handlid* 321, *soeffrin* 222, *folwip* 23, *goddis* 32, 84, *mannys* 237, but elsewhere almost always the usual forms, as *affirmed*, *cared*, *gouerned*, *aken*, *ledep*, *londes*, *mannes*. On the other hand the *-ir* termination is used almost regularly, as *vndir*, *wondir*, *aftir*, *modir* (but *vnder* 286), and there is a tendency also to substitute *i* for *e* in other places also, as *first*, *chirche* (also *ferst*, *cherche*), *wirche*, *dide* (348), *proprite*, but *here* for *hire* 108, 329, cp. 254. For *I* (pers. pronoun) we have regularly *y*; *gh* usually for *h* in such words as *right*, *myghti*, *knyght*, *light*, *highe*, *stigh*, but also *riht*, *rihtwisnesse*, *knyht*; *vppon* for *vpon*, *schulde* but also *scholde*. In addition to these points we may note the dropping of *-e* several times in *euer*, *neuer*, which hardly ever occurs in the Fairfax MS., and also in *heuen* 79, but we have also *euere*, *neuere*, *heuene*. The *-e* of the weak preterite form is dropped before a vowel in *myht* 39, *behight* 41, *had* 42, *mad* 103, 345: *-e* is inserted in some imperatives, as *Leie* 122, *sette* 124, *Lete* 129, *putte* 130, *penke* 162, *Beholde* 276 (but *let* 158, *Kep* 367, 384, *draugh* 384). As regards the use of *þ* and *ȝ* the Trentham MS. agrees with F.

There is no title in the manuscript, and Prof. Skeat calls the poem 'The Praise of Peace,' a title suggested by Mr. E. W. B. Nicholson. I have adopted a modification of this, 'To King Henry the Fourth in Praise of Peace,' expressing also the substance of that given by Thynne.

8 ff. The threefold claim of Henry IV is given in this stanza, as in Chaucer's well-known Envoy, but the 'conquest' is here represented as a divine sanction.

50. *a place*, 'into place': cp. *Conf. Amantis*, v. 735, 'Hou suche goddes come aplace.'

53. *in manere*, 'in due measure': cp. *Conf. Amantis*, vii. 2132, 4344.

55. *what aftirward betide*, 'whatever may happen afterwards.'

71. The first word of the line is erased in the manuscript, only the initial S being left, with a space for five or six letters after it. The word which is suggested in the text is perhaps as likely as any other: for the form of it cp. 'Maintene,' l. 385. Thynne's reading, 'To stere peace,' looks like a lame attempt on the part of a copyist to fill the gap.

78 ff. *Conf. Amantis*, iii. 2265 ff.

89. I write regularly 'evere' 'nevere' in accordance with Gower's practice: so 126, 127, 148, 241, 301, 350, 365.

90. *alle charite*. The MS. has 'al charite,' but the metre and the grammatical usage both require 'alle,' as in l. 293 and elsewhere.

94. *wisemennes*: cp. 'wisemen,' *Conf. Amantis*, vii. 1792.

106 ff. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, iii. 2273 ff.

113. *Conf. Amantis*, iii. 2294 f.

115. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, Prol. 444.

121. 'Whose faith thou hast partly to guide.'

122. I correct the imperative form 'Leie,' and also 'sette' 124, 'Lete' 129, 'putte' 130, 'thenke' 162, 'Beholde' 276, as contrary to Gower's practice and in several cases disturbing the metre.

150. Strictly speaking, we ought to have the subjunctive, 'undirstode,' but the rhyme will not allow.

155. So Prol. 88 f.,

'The hyhe god him hath proclamed
Ful of knythode and alle grace.'

157 f. 'Peace with honour' was a favourite thought of Gower's, 'pax et honor' in the *Vox Clamantis*, vii. 1415.

174. 'on earth peace, goodwill towards men.'

177 ff. 'Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you.'

204. *waited*, 'attended to.'

235. *devised*, 'divided': cp. *Conf. Amantis*, ii. 3264.

236 ff. 'nevertheless the law stands so reasonably established by man's wit, that they can stand firm without that' (i. e. without the help of the Church).

266. Cp. Prol. 795, 'The comun ryht hath no felawe,' that is, none to take its part.

278 f. *deserved To him*. The reading is right. It means 'earned by service rendered to him': cp. *Conf. Amantis*, iv. 3577, 'Thogh I no deth to the deserve.'

281 ff. For the nine worthies see Caxton's Preface to Mallory's *Morte d'Arthur*.

295 f. The question of winning a 'chase' at tennis is not one which is decided at once by the stroke that is made, but depends on later developments.

330 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, vii. 3161*.

337 ff. *Conf. Amantis*, ii. 3187 ff.

345. *at al*, 'altogether.'

354. *the lieve of lothe*, 'they who were now loved but had before been hated' (by God).

356. I read 'weren' for the metre. However the case may be with Chaucer, there is no instance elsewhere in Gower of elision prevented by caesura. The cases that have been quoted are all founded on misreadings.

365 f. Cp. *Conf. Amantis*, viii. 2988*.

379. *of pes*, 'with regard to peace.'

382. *see the werre*, that is, ‘look to the war’: cp. ll. 137, 144, 281 ff. The reading ‘sese’ was invented by Wright.

REX CELI DEUS, &c. This piece is to a great extent an adaptation of the original version of *Vox Clamantis*, vi. cap. 18, as it stands in the Digby MS. The first eight lines are identically the same. Then follows in the *Vox Clamantis*,

‘Ipse meum iuuenem conseruet supplico Regem,’ &c.

Of the remainder, as we have it here, ll. 25 f., 31-33, 36-39, 41 f., 45-48 correspond with slight variations to lines in the *Vox Clamantis* version, but the arrangement of them is different.

10. *Te que tuum regnum*, ‘Thee and thy kingdom,’ a quite common position of ‘que’ in Gower’s Latin. So below, ll. 49, 50, 53, and often elsewhere.

35. So also *Conf. Amantis*, vii, *after* l. 1984.

GLOSSARY AND INDEX OF PROPER NAMES

The general resemblance between Gower and Chaucer in the matter of language makes a comparison of their English vocabularies almost a matter of course. Chaucer's word-list is naturally much more extensive than Gower's, not only on account of the superior genius of the writer, but also because of the greater extent and variety of his work, Gower's English work being less than half of Chaucer's in amount, and consisting of verse only, while nearly a fourth part of Chaucer's is prose. We find, however, that Gower has more than six hundred words which are not used by Chaucer. Most of these are comparatively new formations from French or Latin, but there is also among them a fair sprinkling of old-established English words, some of which no doubt were falling into disuse. Such words are, for example: adryh, aghte, anele, arecche, areche, arere v., bezete, bysne, eldemoder, enderday, ferke, for3ifte, forlie, forworpe, frede, 3eme, gladschipe, goodschipe, grede (gradde), grip, heveneriche, kingesriche, lere (= loss), lich (= corpse), metrede, miele, mone (3), mull, orf, orped, rowe v. (= dawn), sawht, skiere, spire v., spousebreche, þarmes, tome s., tote, tyh (*pret.*), tyt *adv.*, wow, yhte.

Of the rest the following (among others) are words for which no authority earlier than Gower is cited in the *New English Dictionary* (A-I): those for which Gower is the sole authority are printed in italics.

abeche, *ablaste*, aboard, abroche *adv.*, accidence, *agrope*, altemetrie, *apostazied*, apparantie, approbacion, artificier, aspirement, assignement, *assobre*, assote v., astraied, attempte v., *attitled*, avant *adv.*, *avantance*, babe, baldemoine, balke v., baske, bass *adj.* ('base'), bedawe, bederke, befole ('befool'), belwinge, *bethrowe*, *bewympled*, bienvenue, bombard, brothell, *brygantaille*, calculacion, *caliphe*, carte (= writing), chacable, chace (at tennis), chance v., chevance, circumference, client, *coise*, cokard, cokerie ('cooking'), compense, conclave, concordable, congelacion, congruite,

contempt, contourbe, courbe s. and *adj.*, decas, deificacion, delaiement, delate (= dilate), depos s., *desclos adj.*, desclose v., desobeie, desobeissance, dispers, distillacion, *doubtif*, drunkschipe, *duistre*, effeminat *adj.*, eloquent, enbrouderie ('embroidery'), enclin, encluyed, encourtined, enfile, enheritance, *ensamplerie*, entendable, entendance, entendant, epitaphe, esmaie, espeir, espleit ('exploit'), exalacion, excessif, excitacioun, *excusement*, expectant, faie *adj.*, fieverous, fixacioun, flacke, folhaste, folhastif, forcacche, forge s., *forstormed*, forsueie, forthrere (= furtherer), froise, gaignage, gamme, genitals, godward, gule, hepe (= hook), heraldie, hovedance, injustice, interruption, intersticion, inthronize.

Of these nearly half are used in the English of the present day.

For the remainder of the alphabet I content myself with calling attention to the following, without venturing on any statement about their earlier use:

justificacion, liberal, liberalite, lien (= bond), lugge, mathematique, matrone, mecanique, mecherie, menable, mineral, moevement, multitude, oblivion, obstinacie, occupacion, original, passible, perjurie, philliberd (= filbert), piereles, pilage, pleintif *adj.*, pointure, porte (= porthole), preparacion, presage, preserve, proclame, prophetesse, providence, purefie, raile s., recepcion, recreacion, relacion, renounce, reptil, resemblance, restauratif, revelen, riff (= reef of a sail), sale, salvage, scharnebud, scisme, sculpture, seintefic, solucion, specifie, sprantlen, spume, stacion, studious, substitucion, supplante, supporte, temprure, tenetz (= tennis), terremote, tonsure, transpose, trompette.

In matters of vocabulary my obligations are first and principally to the *New English Dictionary*, then to Prof. Skeat's *Chaucer Glossary*, to Stratmann's *Middle Engl. Dictionary* (ed. Bradley), and to Halliwell's *Dictionary of Archaisms*. With reference especially to Gower I may mention the dissertation by G. Tietze (Breslau, 1889).

The following Glossary is meant to include all the words used in Gower's *English Works*, with their various forms of spelling and (where necessary) of inflexion, accompanied with such references as are required for verification of the forms given and for illustration of the different uses and meanings of the words. As a rule, when a word occurs more than once, at least two references are given, but this statement does not apply to inflexional forms. If a word presents any difficulty or is used in a variety of

meanings, the number of references is proportionally increased. A complete set of references is given for proper names.

The *Confessio Amantis* is referred to by P., i, ii, iii, &c., P. standing for the Prologue, and the Roman numerals for the successive books. PP. stands for the poem *In Praise of Peace*. Word-forms which are not found in the Fairfax MS., or only in the latter part of it, which is written by a different hand, are sometimes enclosed in parentheses. These are also used occasionally to indicate variation of spelling: thus **dissencioun (-on)** means that the word is spelt either with ‘-oun’ or ‘-on’ termination, **wher(e)** indicates that ‘wher’ and ‘where’ are alternative forms. In all cases where ‘y’ is used to represent ‘3,’ that fact is indicated by ‘(3)’ placed after the word when it occurs in its place, as **beyete(3)**

The grammatical abbreviations are, s. substantive, a. adjective, v. verb, v.a. verb active, v.n. verb neuter, v.a.n. verb active and neuter, 3 s.pres. 3rd person singular present tense, pret. past tense, pp. past participle, def. definite form of adjective, &c.

In many cases an explanation is given of the meaning of words for the convenience of readers, but no discussion as to their meaning or origin is admitted in the Glossary.

A.

a, *interj.* iv. 3622, see **ha**.

a, **an**, *indef. art.* P. 18, 350, (= one) ii. 1169, 1261.

a, (= Fr. à), *in a dieu*, a fin, see **adieu**, **afyn**.

a, *in a day*, a doun, a ferr, a game, a goddeshalf, a morwe, a nyht, a place, a swoune, see **dai**, **doun**, **ferr**, &c.

Aaron, P. 437, ii. 3047.

abaissht, **abayssht**, *pp.* iv. 1330, vi. 2329.

abak, *adv.* iii. 481, vii. 4363, back.

abandone, **abandoune**, v.a. P. 766, ii. 1596, 2772, v. 5378, viii. 1834, let go, give up, devote.

abate, v.a. ii. 3171, vi. 2354, vii. 1639;

v.n. **tabate**, ii. 809.
Abbategnyh, vii. 1458.
abbesse, s. viii. 1849.
abbot, s. ii. 3056.
abece, vii. 158, a, b, c.
abeche, v.a. vi. 709, feed.
abedde, *adv.* P. 602, i. 1781, 2599.
abegge, v.a. iii. 1828, v. 7522, pay for:
 cp. **abye**.
abeie, *see* **abye**.
Abel, viii. 61, 72.
abesse, v.a. i. 2063, abase.
abhominable, a. ii. 3107, vii. 3337.
abide, **abyde(n)**, v.n. i. 859, 1535, 1599, 2909, 3201, ii. 1501, PP. 285,
 wait, remain;
 v.a. ii. 2594, 2626, iii. 1616, viii. 900, wait for, endure:
 3 s.*pres.* **abit**, **abitt**, iii. 201, 1658,
 pret. **abod**, i. 151,
 imperat. **abyd**, iv. 1777,
 pp. **abide**, vii. 2860.
abie, *see* **abye**.
ablaste, v.a.*pret.* v. 3712, blew upon.
able, a. ii. 98, 3258, iv. 267, 2561.
Abner, ii. 3087.
abord, *adv.* ii. 1138, alongside (of a ship).
aboute, *adv.* P. 367, i. 403, ii. 1227,
 abouten, i. 2529,
 aboutes, vii. 2280, viii. 2460, round, round about;
 come aboute, **bringe a.**, i. 2629, ii. 1531, 2282, iv. 61, 259:

prep. iv. 1356.

above, *adv.* P. 891, i. 467, 1610, 1860, 2491, iv. 1595, aloft, at advantage,
before this;

hier above, i. 1377;

from above, i. 3278:

prep. i. 810,

aboven, P. 971, i. 2833:

as subst. iv. 914, v. 2542, 7293, vi. 221, advantage.

abregge, *v.a.* vii. 1990, cut short.

abreid, *s.* iv. 588, start.

abreide, *v.a.* vii. 2882, upbraid.

abreide, *v.n.pret.* i. 155, 2851, ii. 3241, started.

abroche, *adv.* v. 1677, abroach.

abrod, *adv.* iv. 3102, v. 6891, abroad.

absence, *s.* ii. 1321, 1647.

absent, *a.* iv. 1797, vii. 5181.

Absolon, ii. 3093, viii. 217.

absolucioun (-on), *s.* ii. 1317, iii. 596, viii. 2892.

abstinence, *s.* P. 327, vi. 634.

abydinge, *s.* vii. 502.

abye, **abie**, *v.a.* ii. 3022, iii. 221, v. 5541,

abeie, iii. 306,

3 s.pres. **abyth**, v. 5516,

abeith, vi. 1378,

pret. **aboghte**, ii. 2153, viii. 217,

pp. **aboght**, i. 381, 2614, pay for:

cp. **abegge**.

acale, *adv.* viii. 638, 847, acold.

accept, *a.* v. 6394, acceptable.

acceptable, *a.* vii. 4727, viii. 3035*.

accidence, s. ii. 3210, v. 763, *see notes*.

accidie, s. iv. 539, sloth.

accioun, s. ii. 388.

acompte, **accord**, *see* **acompte**, **acord**.

accuse, v.a. P. 487, iii. 2377.

accusement, s. ii. 1703.

Achab, vii. 2529 ff.,
genit. **Achabbes**, vii. 2552.

Achaie, v. 1907.

Achastus, iii. 2555.

achates, vii. 1362, agate.

Achelons, iv. 2068.

Acheron, v. 1110.

Achias, vii. 4515 ff.

achieve, v.a. P. 92, i. 103, 700, 1257, ii. 1311, v. 1276, finish, attain to;
to ben achieved (= to succeed), ii. 2360,
cp. ii. 3091:
v.n. ii. 372, v. 2043, succeed.

Achilles, ii. 2454, iii. 2642 ff., iv. 1694, 1800, 1970 ff., 2161, v. 2963 ff.,
7591, viii. 2545, 2569,
acc. **Achillem**, vii. 3583.

Achilo, iii. 2566.

Achitofell, ii. 3090.

Acis, ii. 131 ff.

acold, *adv.* iv. 247, vi. 1007.

acompte, s. ii. 1715, iv. 292, 1653,
accompte, iv. 1062, 2243.

acompte, v.a. iii. 1104, 2281, v. 2014;

v.n. vii. 2226,
tacompte, i. 650.

acord, *s.* P. 1034, i. 849, 1789,
accord, P. 85, iv. 2069;
in acord, i. 1115;
of thin acord, &c., i. 849, ii. 2536;
in on acord, i. 2250.

acordable, *a.* v. 2930, in accord.

acordant, *a.* i. 455, 2436, iv. 1244:
adv. iv. 498, v. 142, viii. 2371.

acorde, *v.n.* P. 358, 878, i. 388, ii. 105;
thei ben acored, ii. 630,
thus acored (*pp.absol.*), i. 826;
refl. i. 3386, vii. 3241:
2 s.pret. **acordest**, iii. 2058,
pres. part. **acordende**, ii. 1612, iii. 603: agree.

acordement, *s.* vii. 168.

acquite, *see* **aquite**.

acroche, *v.a.* iii. 1047, v. 5624, take hold of, gain.

acte, *s.* P. 405.

Acteon, i. 336 ff.

Acteos, vii. 855.

adaies, *adv.* iii. 828, at this time;
now adaies, **nou adayes**, &c., P. 171, iv. 1228,
cp. 'on daies nou,' iv. 1731:
see also **aday**.

Adam, i. 3304, iv. 2224, v. 1707 ff., 6964, vi. 5, viii. 26 ff.

adamant, *s.* vii. 833, 1397.

aday, *adv.* v. 2463,
now (nou) aday, i. 655, iv. 2616, viii. 151,
cp. **a day**, vii. 438,

now a day, ii. 444:
cp. **adaies**.

addre, *see* **eddre**.

adieu, viii. 2940,
a dieu, ii. 2739, v. 3662.

adoted, *pp.* vi. 79, infatuated.

adoun, *adv.* i. 3280,
a doun, iv. 2710, v. 385.

adrad, *a.* i. 157, 2748, ii. 479, 3489.

adresce, *v.a.* i. 1722, 2725, v. 1480,
(*refl.*) v. 5021,
adresse, iii. 2336, arrange, prepare.

Adriagne, **Adriane**, v. 5332 ff., viii. 2556.

Adrian (1), P. 745.

Adrian (2), v. 4938 ff.,
genit. **Adrianes**, v. 5155.

adryh, *adv.* iv. 1330, aside.

adverse, *a.* iv. 3403.

adverse, *v.a.* ii. 1792, oppose.

adversite, *s.v.* 2232, vii. 3340*.

advocat, *s.* vii. 2067.

aeremance, *s.* vi. 1301, divination by air.

afaite, *see* **affaite**.

afer, *adv.* v. 318,
see **ferr**.

afered, *a.* i. 2124, iv. 600,
a feerd, v. 7150*.

affaite, *v.a.* ii. 464, 2851, iv. 3337,
afaite, iv. 1157, v. 6852,

pp. **affaited**, i. 1259, 1671,
afaited, v. 2000: prepare, train.

affeccioun (-on), s. i. 2858, vi. 1350,
thaffeccioun, P. 366, inclination.

afferme, *v.a.* P. 189, ii. 2928, iv. 3421, v. 783, confirm, establish;
v.n. v. 857, 2596, declare, affirm.

affiche, *v.a.* v. 2520.

affile, *v.a.* i. 678, iii. 516, iv. 3332, sharpen, prepare.

afflyhte, **afflihte**, **aflihthe**, *v.n.pret.* i. 2185, ii. 766, iv. 1438, 1556, was
disturbed (with grief, joy or fear), was afflicted;
v.a. iii. 1422,
pp. **affliht**,
aflyht, ii. 1518, v. 5438.

affraie, *v.a.*, *pp.* **affraied**, iii. 57, iv. 3400, viii. 2859, startle, frighten.

affray, s. iv. 3068, fright.

afire, *adv.* *see* **afyre**.

afore, *prep.* iii. 2547, v. 822;
adv. i. 973,
afor, vi. 927.

afote, *adv.* iv. 2095.

after, *prep.* P. 11, 54, 637, i. 809, iv. 1327, v. 1605,
(**aftir**, viii. 2979 ff.), after, according to:
at after mete, &c., vi. 1181, 1831:
after that, **after**, (= according as) P. 544, 708, ii. 1586, iii. 1074:
adv. P. 634, i. 999,
(**aftir**, viii. 3073),
ther after, v. 7030.

aftercast, s. iv. 904, late throw (of the dice).

afterward, *adv.* P. 74, i. 757, iv. 865,
(**aftirward**, PP. 55).

afyn, *adv.* v. 2349,

a fin, iv. 60, finally.
afyre, ii. 149, 2292, v. 1485,
afire, i. 1662.
Agag, vii. 3823 ff.
Agamenon, ii. 2452, iii. 1892 ff., 2186, v. 3101, 6435 ff., viii. 2546.
agaste, *v.a.pret.* vii. 3716,
pp. agast, iii. 420, iv. 2760, terrified.
agayn, again, *adv.* v. 3790, 4413, back:
cp. ayein.
age, s. i. 488, 779, 2229, iii. 1237, iv. 604, v. 901,
of age, iii. 1943, v. 1259.
aghte, s. viii. 747, possession.
ago, *adv.* iv. 943,
cp. agon, ago, pp.
agon, *pp.* P. 875, ii. 1218, 2696,
ago, P. 31, iv. 2918, 2960, gone, past.
agregge, *v.n.* v. 7624, grow heavy.
agrise, *v.a.* iii. 2160,
pp. agrise, P. 598, v. 5908, terrify.
agrope, *v.a.* and *n.* ii. 1356, 2814, v. 2858, examine, discover.
agulte, *v.n.* vii. 3932, do wrong.
ai, *see ay.*
air, *see eir* (1).
aise, *see ese.*
aisshe, s. viii. 2101, ashes.
ake, *v.n.* PP. 260, ache.
akiele, *v.n.* iv. 2671, grow cool.
al, all, alle, a., sing. al the, al this, al his, &c., P. 95, 104, 135, &c.,

all his, i. 2291,
all the, viii. 784,
the Cite all, ii. 3473;
alle grace, alle thing, alle untrowthe, alle haste, alle wise, &c., P. 89,
 433, i. 301, 747, 925 f., ii. 624, 1259,
but al honour, i. 879,
al untrowthe, ii. 1684,
al Erthe, i. 2825,
al Envie, ii. 168;
pl. all my, al the, all these, &c., iii. 123, iv. 2377, 3165, v. 2685, &c.,
alle, P. 146, i. 992, 1481, 1930, 2877,
alle othre, P. 734, i. 666,
al othre, iv. 1532:
as subst. al, i. 2247, ii. 704, 1027,
pl. alle, P. 826, i. 1443,
upon alle, P. 125, ii. 117, on all occasions,
for al that, iv. 1348, 2278,
cp. vii. 2677,
at al, PP. 345, altogether.
adv. al, P. 13, i. 640, 856, 1068, 1145, ii. 966, &c.,
all, ii. 608, v. 1935,
with a. al lene, iv. 1344,
al one, i. 351, 666, 1526, ii. 2410, &c.,
(cp. alone),
al him one, i. 3144,
al only, ii. 133, iv. 2083,
all thogh, iv. 269,
al be it so, iv. 2393, 2920,
al were there, iii. 2557,
al nere it, v. 997.

Ala Corvi, vii. 1371.

Alaezel, vii. 1380.

alarge, *adv.* iii. 2139.

Albe, ii. 1855.

Albert, P. 780.

Albinus, i. 2460.

Albumazar, vii. 1239.

Alceone, **Alceoun**, iv. 2929 ff., 3121 ff.,
Alcione, viii. 2649.

Alceste, vii. 1920 ff., viii. 2640.

alconomie, s. iv. 2459, 2578, alchemy.

aldai, **alday**, *adv.* P. 15, 310, i. 2753, iii. 1178,
al dai, ii. 1899.

Aldeboran, vii. 1310.

ale, s. iii. 433, 1626.

allegge, *see* **allegge**.

Alemaine, s. P. 804,
Alemaigne, vii. 751.

Alemans, *pl.* P. 810,
thalemans, P. 821.

Alexandrine, *a.* vii. 563, of Alexandria.

Alfraganus, vii. 1461.

alfulli, *adv.* ii. 501.

algate, *adv.* P. 646, 894, i. 1296, ii. 2637,
algates, i. 300, iii. 690, in any case, assuredly.

Algol, vii. 1329.

algorisme, s. vii. 155, 158.

Alhaiot, vii. 1338.

alheil, *interj.* iii. 1261.

aliche, **alyche**, *adv.* P. 932, i. 1298, ii. 3253, iii. 68, iv. 2392, 3330,
alich, iv. 2253,
alike, vi. 383.

alihte, *v.n.*, *see* **alyhte**.

Alisandre, Alisaundre, P. 693, ii. 1841, 2415, iii. 1227, 2366, 2440, v. 1454, 1571, 2545, 5535, vi. 2273 ff., vii. 5, 22, &c., 3168*, 4234 ff., 5384, PP. 36, 44, 281.

Alisandre, vii. 1255, Alexandria.

alite, alitel, *see* **lite, litel**.

allaie, v.a. vi. 310, vii. 5406, alleviate.

allas, *interj.* v. 3910:

cp. **helas**.

Allee, ii. 722, 1228 ff.

allegge, alege, v.a. v. 7326,

pret. **alleide**, i. 1453, iii. 2155, iv. 1920, vii. 2073;

v.n. v. 6980: *allege*.

allewey, *adv.*, *see* **alway**.

alliance, s. ii. 1184, vii. 2549, viii. 139.

allied, a. viii. 12.

allowe, alowe, v.a. P. 154, i. 1283, 1590, ii. 539, iii. 1552, iv. 2282, v. 564, *approve, accept*.

allyhte, v.a. v. 4520, *lighten*.

Almageste, vii. 739, 983, 1460.

Almareth, vii. 1387.

Almeene, ii. 2466.

almesse, s. P. 226, 742, i. 2935, ii. 1471, iii. 2233, *alms, good deed*.

Almeüs, iii. 2564.

almost, *adv.* vi. 414.

almyhte, almihte, a. ii. 906, viii. 1384, (**almighte**, PP. 362).

almyhti, almyhty, a. P. 585, v. 1737, 5741.

alofte, *adv.* P. 921, i. 885, 2563, iii. 152, vii. 169, *on high, aloud*.

alonde, *adv.* ii. 2212, v. 3747.

alone, *a. or adv.* i. 839, 1523, (**allone**, PP. 8);
al one, *see al.*

along, *adv.* iv. 2817,
along on me, on miself along, on mi will along, &c., iv. 624, 952,
2818, v. 2327, 5881 f.,
long on, v. 2329.

alonge, *v.n.* v. 3282,
pp. **alonged**, vi. 1840, desire.

alowd, aloud, *adv.* ii. 843, 1512, v. 3848.

Alpetragus, vii. 1463.

Alpheta, vii. 1401.

Alphonse, i. 3393.

alquik, *a.* viii. 2575, alive.

als, *adv.* P. 565, 1064,
als faste (at once), i. 414, ii. 1267,
als so faste, &c., i. 1041, ii. 132, v. 2288:
cp. **also, as.**

also, *adv.* P. 4, &c.,
ek also, i. 3305, &c.,
also wel, i. 1316:
cp. **als.**

altemetrie, *s.* vii. 1468.

alter, *s.* v. 4034,
aulter, v. 4079, (**thalter**, vii. 4707).

alther best, altherbest, *adv.* i. 1921, iv. 571,
alther werst, i. 326.

althermest, *adv.* i. 3102, v. 2897.

althertrewest, *a.* ii. 499.

altherworst, *adv.* vi. 238.

althogh, *conj.* P. 157, &c.,

all thogh, iv. 269.

alto, *adv.* i. 2415.

altobreke, *v.a.*, *pp.* **altobroke**, viii. 624, PP. 221, break asunder.

altogedre, *adv.* vii. 2962,
cp. **togedre**.

alway, **alwey**, **alwei**, *adv.* P. 832, i. 1840, iii. 1459,
allewey, iv. 2587.

alyhte (1), **alihte**, *v.n.inf.* ii. 423, iii. 182, iv. 3002,
pret. i. 2227, iii. 2659,
pp. **alyht**, v. 1782, come down, alight.

alyhte (2), *v.a.*, *pret.* **alyhte**, v. 1670,
pp. **alyht**, vii. 4708, light, give light to;
v.n. vii. 3769, be lighted up.

alyve, *a. or adv.* i. 2164, ii. 645, iv. 2169.

am, **art**, &c., *see* **be**.

Amadas, vi. 879.

Amadriades, *pl.* v. 6236.

amaied, *pp.* i. 2030, a-maying.

Amalech, (1) vii. 3711.

Amalech, (2) vii. 4408, (*for* Balach).

amased, *pp.* iv. 579, 697, v. 5296, (**amasid**, viii. 2957).

Amazoine, iv. 2166.

amblaunt, (*pres.p.*) *a.* ii. 1506,
amblende, iv. 1309, ambling.

amende, *s.* v. 7287,
pl. **amendes**, v. 688, vii. 1585.

amende, *v.a.* P. 183, 254,
imperat. **amende thee**, i. 2934,
god thamende, i. 568,

pp. **amended**, i. 1003, viii. 2608, (**amendid**, viii. 3010);
v.n. i. 2431, 3350, viii. 1666.

amendement, s. P. 83, iii. 2514, iv. 1768.

Ametus, vii. 1917, viii. 2641.

amiddes, *prep. or adv.*,
 the wode amiddes, &c., i. 112, 2819,
 amiddes in, iii. 2074, iv. 1349,
 amiddes of, iv. 2871,
 amidde, iv. 1673, 3498, viii. 1038,
 amidd, *prep.* i. 361.

amirall, s. ii. 1090.

amis, **amys**, *adv.* P. 48, i. 1970, iii. 17, vii. 2473.

amoeved, *pp.* iii. 497, iv. 861, moved.

Amon (son of Lot), viii. 236.

Amon (king), iv. 1509.

Amon (nation), vii. 3712.

Amon (son of David), viii. 214.

among, *prep.* P. 5, i. 669,
 amonges, P. 40, i. 1372, among, during:
 among, *adv.* iv. 1209, v. 5984,
 evere among, i. 2333, ii. 1079, &c.,
 alwei among, iii. 1459, meanwhile, at times.

Amonites, *see* **Amonyte**.

amonte, **amounte**, *v.n.* i. 3111, iv. 291, 1654, v. 1917, 2581, avail, mean.

Amonyte, vii. 4507,
 pl. **Amonites**, viii. 242.

Amoreie, vii. 3711.

amorous, **amerous**, *a.* i. 1414, iii. 745, iv. 921, v. 58,
 amourous, v. 1409, vii. 791.

amorwe, *adv.* ii. 2657, iv. 3194,

amorwe day, v. 2116,
 cp. viii. 820,
a morwe, ii. 781, 890.

Amos, vi. 1922 ff., (Jupiter) Ammon.

Amphion, vi. 2160.

Amphioras, iii. 2563.

Amphitrion, ii. 2459 ff.

Amphrisos, v. 4005.

amyraude, s. vii. 1383, emerald.

an, *see* **a**.

an, *for* 'on,' v. 496.

anabulla, vii. 1317, (a herb).

ancestre, s. v. 1823, vii. 2884.

ancestrie, s. PP. 12.

ancher, **anker**, ii. 1136, viii. 606, 1805 f., anchor.

Anchises, iv. 79, v. 1400.

and, P. 2, 12, 155, &c.

Andragene, v. 1398.

Andrew, v. 1907.

Androchee, v. 5233.

anele, v.a. vii. 337, melt.

anemie, *see* **enemie**.

angel, s. P. 950, ii. 298, vi. 1530,
 pl. **anglis**, iii. 2256,
 angles, viii. 7 ff.

anger, s. iii. 77 ff.,
 angre, iii. 379,
 pl. **angres**, iii. 380.

angreliche, *adv.* iii. 380.

angri, *a.* iii. 30, 378.

angringe, *s.* vii. 2665.

anguisshe, **anguisse**, *s.* vii. 5081, viii. 1054.

animalis, *Lat. a.* iv. 2542.

anker, *see* **ancher**.

annuied, *pp.* iv. 1346.

anon, *adv.* P. 160, 626, i. 1130,

anon ryht, P. 1022,

anon forth, i. 3353,

anon as, i. 471, 1262, iv. 2758.

another, P. 968:

see **other**.

ansuere, **answere**, *v.n.* i. 290, 1461, 1658,

3 s.pres. **answerth**, i. 1951,

pp.pl. **ansuerde**, i. 3246.

ansuere, **answere**, *s.* i. 1510, 1823, iii. 2407,

ansuer, viii. 907.

Anthenor, i. 1095, 1124, v. 1835 ff., 7274 ff., vii. 1562.

Anthonie, **Antonie**, vii. 4574 ff., (Caracalla).

Anthonius, vii. 4181, Antoninus.

Anticrist, v. 1807.

Antigonus, vii. 2121.

Antioche, vii. 1247, viii. 275, 387.

Antiochus, v. 7012, viii. 274 ff., 2004.

Antonye, viii. 2577, Marcus Antonius.

Anubus, i. 836 ff.

any, *see* **eny**.

anyht, *adv.* ii. 2857,
cp. **a nyht**.

apart, *adv.* vi. 2311.

ape, v. 4995 ff., vi. 1450.

Apemen, vii. 1884.

aperceive, v.*a.* i. 960, ii. 983, 2138, perceive.

apert, *a.* iv. 3205, open:
in apert, ii. 686, openly.

Apis, v. 1560 ff.

Apius, vii. 5131.

aplace, *adv.* i. 1888, v. 735, a place,
i. 2377, iv. 2481, into place.

apointe, **appointe**, v.*a.* ii. 791, iv. 273, 1692, v. 708, 4115, vi. 1973,
refl. ii. 3204,
to ben apointed, i. 2160, fix, resolve, appoint.

Apollo, &c., *see* **Appollo**.

aportenant, *see* **appourtenant**.

apostazied, *a.* viii. 11, rebellious.

apostles, s.*pl.* iii. 2499, v. 1797,
sing. **thapostel**, P. 434, 881.

appaie, **apaie**, v.*a.* i. 3429, ii. 594, 1433, v. 146,
pp. **appaied**, ii. 1433, please, satisfy.

appalle, v.*n.* iv. 3160, grow faint.

apparant, *a.* ii. 1320, 1552, vii. 5278.

apparant, *a.* ii. 1711, heir apparent.

apparantie, s. i. 636, appearance.

apparence, *see* **thapparence**.

appartiene, v.*n.* vii. 1063.

appel, s. (1) v. 7414, vi. 5, apple.

appel, s. (2), *see* **appell**.

appele, v.n. vii. 3171*, 3305*, viii. 2700, appeal.

appeled, pp. iii. 1601, accused.

appell, **appel**, s. ii. 3418, vii. 5233,
apeel, vii. 3177*, appeal.

appende, v.n. vii. 978, belong.

appese(n), v.a. P. 191, i. 1351, iii. 133, vii. 2006.

appetit, s. iv. 3013, 3544, v. 257.

appiere, v.n. i. 838, 1198, ii. 3337.

applied, pp. i. 577, iv. 2607, v. 913, assigned.

appointe, *see* **apointe**.

Appolinus, viii. 375 ff.

Appollo, v. 918, 1072, 5845, 7594, vii. 3189,
Apollo, v. 7111* ff.,
Apollinis (*genit.*), v. 7109*.

appourtenant, a. ii. 2508, iv. 64, 3131, v. 1496,
appourtienant, vii. 1019,
aportenant, v. 4318.

apprise, **aprise**, s. i. 81, 293, iii. 2764, iv. 2332, viii. 812, teaching.

approbacion, s. iv. 2519.

appropre, v.a. vii. 430,
pp. **appropried**, iv. 3223, vii. 499.

aproche, v.n. ii. 40, v. 5623;
v.a. iii. 96, viii. 388,
naproche, iv. 1135.

apropriacioun, s. ii. 2396.

Aquarius, vii. 1187 ff., 1253.

aqueint, *pp.* vi. 265, quenched.

aqueintance, *s.* i. 2400, ii. 1178, iv. 85.

aqueinte, *v.refl. and n.* ii. 3506, iv. 2313,
pp. **aqueinted**, iv. 2137,
(**aqweinted**, PP. 328).

aquite, **aquyte**, **acquite**, *v.a.* i. 1594, 2772, iii. 2578, iv. 967, v. 2385, set
free, acquit;
i. 1054, remit;
iv. 195, satisfy;
iii. 2671, vii. 3030, requite;
pp. **aquit**, iii. 2460, iv. 967,
acquited, i. 1054.

ar, *adv.* ii. 2141, iv. 1422;
cp. **er**.

Arabe, *s.* iv. 2627, Arabic (language).

Arachel, vii. 1457.

arai, **araied**, *see* **arraai**, **arraied**.

arawhte, *pret.* of *arecche* (OE. *areccan*), v. 1826, explain.

Araxarathen, iv. 3675.

Arcenne, **Arcennus**, ii. 1332 ff., 1534.

arcennicum, *s.* iv. 2483.

Archade, iii. 2317, v. 1007, vii. 3555.

Archas, v. 6283.

Ardea, vii. 4760 ff.

areche, (OE. *aræcan*), *v.a.* i. 3207, ii. 666, v. 387,
pret. **arauhte**, vi. 457, attain, reach to:
v.n. i. 3024, iii. 2247, reach up, extend.

arede, *v.a.n.* P. 601, v. 928, vii. 3703,
pret. **aradde**, P. 626, i. 2854: explain, give explanation.

arere, *adv.* iii. 1082, behind.

arere, *v.a.* iv. 1938, vi. 437, 1107, raise up.

areste, *v.a.* i. 1644, ii. 162, 2745, iii. 609, delay, keep in check, arrest.

arewe, *see* **arowe**.

argue, *v.n.* vii. 1847, 4196.

argument, *s.* iv. 1798, v. 7028,
pl. **argumentz**, vii. 1823.

argumenten, *v.n.* P. 370.

Arial, vii. 1364.

Aries, vii. 980 ff., 1266.

ariht, *adv.* i. 2847, ii. 724, iv. 2993.

Arion, P. 1054.

arise, **aryse**, *v.n.* P. 1041, i. 1909, iii. 2503,
3 *s.pres.* **arist**, P. 504, 545, ii. 474,
pret. **aros**, i. 2957,
pp. **arist**, ii. 228,
arise, v. 5907;
v.a. (?) v. 1745.

Arisippus, **Arisippe**, **Arisippes**, vii. 2231 ff.

Aristarchus, iv. 2640.

ariste, *s.* iii. 1224, iv. 1285, rising.

aristologie, *s.* vii. 1413, birthwort.

Aristotle, **Aristote**, **Aristotiles**, vi. 99, 2274, 2412, vii. 4 ff., 50 ff.,
3333* ff., 3544, 4257, 5403, viii. 2705.

arivaile, **arryvaile**, *s.* ii. 1032, iv. 94, 1927.

arive, *see* **aryve**.

arm, *s.* ii. 2486, iv. 1141,
pl. **armes**, P. 607, i. 912, ii. 2481.

arme, *v.a.* v. 3181,
pp. **armed**, i. 1171, 1998, iv. 1701, v. 3686.

Armene, v. 1397.

Armenye, **Armenie**, iv. 1245, vii. 1251,
Ermenie, vii. 3218.

armes, *s.pl.* P. 213, i. 1413, 2528, v. 3627 (feat of arms),
men of armes, ii. 2998, iv. 1625.

(sal) armoniak, iv. 2480.

armonie, s. vii. 165.

arowe, **arewe**, *adv.* i. 255, ii. 2038, v. 6955.

Arpaghes, vii. 1800 ff.

arraï, **array**, **arai**, **aray**, s. i. 901, 2512, 2705, iv. 1393, v. 1312, 7488.

arraie, **araie**, *v.a.* i. 1748, 2029, ii. 1836, vi. 641, array, prepare;
arraied of (provided with), ii. 2556.

arrive, **arryve**, *see* **aryve**.

Arrons, vii. 4598 ff.

arryvaile, *see* **arivaile**.

arsmetique, s. vii. 149, arithmetic.

art, s. iv. 933, 2607.

artemage, s. vi. 1957, magic art.

Artestrathes, **Artestrates**, viii. 691, 1970.

Arthus, PP. 283.

artificier, s. vii. 1691.

artmagique, s. viii. 2602.

arwe, s. ii. 2236, v. 1266, arrow.

aryse, *see* **arise**.

aryve, **arive**, **arryve**, **arrive**, *v.a.* ii. 717, 1905, bring to land;
v.n. iii. 1043, iv. 81, 1917, vii. 3269, come to land, come.

as, P. 50, 60, 233, i. 847, ii. 2205,
(= as if) i. 666, 1358, ii. 1047,

as it were, i. 1800,
as who seith, P. 43, i. 1381 &c.,
as he which &c., P. 186, 1020, i. 369,
as him which, iii. 1276,
as of (as regards), P. 492, i. 557, 1969, iii. 1479,
as to, P. 199, i. 300, iii. 2283,
as forto, P. 31, i. 107, 2379,
as tho, ii. 213, iv. 375,
as in (= in), i. 1707, 1940,
as be (= be), i. 1334,
as me thenketh (= me thenketh), iv. 1649,
als ... as, P. 1064: *cp.* **als**.

ascape, *v.a.* i. 1552, 2882 (**aschape**, v. 7033*), **eschape**, vi. 1017;
v.n. i. 517, ii. 1982, iv. 2107, **eschape**, vii. 3466.

ascendent, *s.* vi. 1963.

aschamed, *a.* i. 979, iv. 1885.

ascrie, *v.n.* vi. 1690, vii. 3751, raise a cry.

ascry, *s.* v. 7546, vii. 3722.

asende, *v.a.*, *pret.* **asente**, i. 2138,
pp. **asent**, i. 1493, 1743,
assent, i. 3222, sent for.

aside, *adv.* P. 879, i. 1536, 2534, ii. 1426, iv. 2512,
asyde, v. 4512,
gon aside, vii. 2388 (go wrong).

Asie, vii. 533, 554 ff.

aske, **askinge**, *see* **axe**, **axinge**.

aslepe, *adv.* i. 1180, ii. 825,
rocke aslepe, ii. 1081,
broght aslepe, iv. 3347.

Asmod, vii. 5335 ff.

aspect, *s.* i. 3009, vii. 904.

aspidis, s. i. 463.

aspie, s. i. 1172, ii. 1830, iii. 2087, v. 1997,
upon aspie, iv. 1473: spy, watch.

aspie, v.a. i. 312, ii. 305,
pp. **aspyd**, iv. 1858;
v.n. ii. 100, 515, v. 675,
pret. **aspide**, ii. 135.

aspirement, s. vii. 256, breathing.

assaie, v.a. i. 1080, 1758, 3028, iii. 647, 1066;
v.n. i. 3430, v. 2680: try, attempt, experience.

assaile, **assaille**, v.a. i. 1999, iii. 154, 1904,
the feld a., ii. 1838, 2620;
v.n. P. 727, v. 5526, vi. 1308: attack, attempt.

assay, **assai**, s. i. 690, 791, ii. 3261, iii. 717, v. 273, 4156, trial, proof;
at alle assaies, P. 172, ii. 2447, v. 4883, in every way.

asse, s. i. 2248, iv. 2009, vii. 3251*.

assemble, v.n. ii. 2621, iv. 1953, engage in battle, iii. 189, associate
(together);
v.a. ii. 1765, iii. 368, v. 686, 1772, gather together, join.

assent, s. i. 1125, 3380,
thassent, ii. 1479,
of on assent, i. 1494,
of his a., i. 1744,
to hire a., i. 2623.

assente, v.n. ii. 2816, iii. 1976, iv. 3488,
thei ben assented, ii. 2539, *cp.* viii. 818.

asseure, *see assure*.

assigne, v.a. i. 234, ii. 1337, iv. 271.

assignement, s. v. 7154, vi. 401.

Assire, v. 1541, vii. 4316.

assise, assisse, *v.a.* P. 66, i. 1468, 3050, ii. 636, iii. 1866, iv. 280, place, appoint, arrange.

assisse, assise, *s.* v. 788, 1986, 2878, viii. 778,
thassise, P. 148, order, condition, manner.

assobre, *v.n.* vi. 291, grow sober;
v.a. vi. 460, sober.

assoile, *v.a.* iii. 2570, viii. 364;
v.n. pret. **assoilede**, iii. 2556: absolve, solve (a question).

assote, *v.n.* i. 508, 781, 2596, ii. 2269, behave foolishly, dote;
v.a. iv. 697, v. 6841, vii. 4319, make foolish, besot.

assuage, *v.n.* i. 1438, iii. 1614;
v.a. ii. 3208, vi. 587.

Assub, vii. 334.

assure, asseure, *v.a.* ii. 902, 2013, 2467, iii. 1773, 2202, iv. 3526, assure, satisfy, betroth, pledge.

astat, estat, *s.* P. 105, i. 599, 2764, iv. 229, viii. 3149,
thastat, i. 2100,
thestat, P. 202,
estatz (*pl.*), v. 1849.

astellabre, *s.* vi. 1890, astrolabe.

asterter, *v.a.* i. 658, 722, 1934, 3381, iii. 163, 240, 566, escape from, elude;
v.n. iv. 724, 1304, v. 808, 5821, escape, be avoided, v. 707, come to pass.

astone, *v.n.* vi. 1584, be at a loss.

astoned, *a.* P. 277.

astraid, *pp.* v. 145, vii. 2660, astray.

Astrathen, vii. 4501.

astray, *adv.* vii. 2679.

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astrologie, s. vii. 680.

astronomie, s. iv. 3246, vi. 1347.

astronomien, s. v. 3083, vii. 348.

aswoune, *adv.* ii. 1347, 3237, iv. 3632,
a swoune, viii. 1060.

asyde, *see aside*.

at, *prep.* P. 34,
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ate laste, P. 369, 702,
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Athenagoras, viii. 1622, 1749.

Athene, **Athenes**, **Athenys**, **Athenis**, iii. 1984, 2131, v. 5235, 5250 ff.,
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Athlans, i. 424, Atlas.

atir, *see atyr*.

Atropos, iv. 2756.

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atteigne(n), *v.a.* i. 754, 1621, ii. 184, 2553,
pret. **atteinte**, v. 3698;
v.n. i. 2690, iv. 949,
pp. **atteight**, v. 2224.

atteint, *pp.* iii. 2213, v. 7102*, viii. 1947, convicted.

attempre(n), *v.a.* i. 1354, iii. 236, 1857, iv. 2554.

attempte, *v.a.* viii. 1419, try.

attitled, *pp.* v. 882, 1312, 1331, vii. 1004.

atwinne, *adv.* iii. 2750, v. 5942.

atwo, **atuo**, *adv.* iv. 431, v. 73.

atyr, **atir**, *s.* i. 1753, 1758, v. 4118, preparation, attire.

auctor, *see* **auctour**.

auctorite, *s.* i. 800, iv. 2628,

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auctorize, *v.a.* vii. 2415, vouch for;

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auctour, **auctor**, *s.* iv. 2412, v. 947, vi. 1314, vii. 1456.

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Aufrique, v. 1195, vii. 533, 578, 2088.

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in aunter if, P. 480, i. 189, ii. 480,

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 (**avayle**, P. 77*, **availle**, viii. 3048);
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 v.a. iii. 505, viii. 1619, lower.

avance, *v.a.* i. 2652, ii. 16, 2589, iv. 2116, v. 3006,
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avant, *adv.* iii. 1082, in front.

avant, *s.* i. 2427, ii. 2952, boast.

avantage, *s.* i. 1575, 2711, ii. 3158, iv. 2358,
 thavantages, v. 1978.

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avaunte, **avante**, *v.refl.* i. 2389, 2567, 2655, 2961, boast (oneself).

avenant, *a.* vii. 834, comely.

aventure, *s.* P. 212, 619, i. 1416, ii. 260, 3297, iii. 2016, peril, chance,
 case;
 put (sette) in aventure, i. 3212, iv. 322,
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aventurous, *a.* i. 1523.

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averous, *a.* v. 61, 4676,
 thaverous, v. 57, avaricious.

Avicen, iv. 2610.

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avys, i. 1471, opinion, advice.

avise, v.a. i. 1736;
v.n. iii. 1067, observe;
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vow.

Avynoun, **Avinoun**, P. 331, ii. 3001.

await, s. iii. 955, 1016, v. 666, watch, ambush:
cp. **wait**.

awaite, **awayte**, v.a. i. 1260, 1672, ii. 463, iii. 1368, iv. 263, 808, v. 3004,
watch for, attend to;
v.n. i. 907, ii. 2332, 2869, iv. 2119, v. 207, watch, wait.

awake, v.a. i. 887, 1782, 2087, iv. 3228, v. 424, wake, keep awake;
v.n. ii. 2896, iv. 2905,
pret. **awok**, i. 121, ii. 843, v. 5435, vii. 3717.

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aweye, i. 53,
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schal nevere aweie, iv. 2394,
myhte noght aweie, could not avail, i. 1110,
cp. iii. 349, v. 7179.

aweiward, *adv.* i. 141.

awher, *adv.* ii. 393, v. 6585.

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awroke, *pp.* v. 7268, avenged.

awry, *adv.* ii. 442.

axe, aske, *v.a.* P. 268, 960, i. 170, 694, 1461, 2149, v. 5472,
imperat. **axe**, i. 3344;
v.n. i. 160, 881, 1875, ii. 1232, iii. 2747: ask, ask for, demand.

axeltre, *s.* iii. 1209.

axinge, *s.* i. 1480, ii. 339, iv. 2128,
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ayeins, v. 6413, against, contrary to, opposite, to meet;
ayein the day, i. 930, toward morning,
cp. v. 4954,
ayein the dai, i. 2511, with a view to the day.

ayein, ayeyn (3), *adv.* P. 185, i. 861, 1057, 2090, iii. 1243, iv. 1137,
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babe, s. ii. 3238, iii. 320.

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bacbite, v.a. ii. 411.

bacbitinge, **bakbitinge**, s. ii. 451, 558, 1605, 1609.

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barli, *as a.* vii. 3705 ff., of barley.

barm, s. iii. 302, vi. 227, bosom.

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beaute, *s.* i. 771, 1837, ii. 123.

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beblede, *v.a.pp.* **bebled**, ii. 700, iii. 1406, stain with blood.

beclippe, *v.a.* i. 1790, ii. 2550, iv. 2783, v. 2003,
pp. **beclipt**, i. 912, embrace, contain.

become, *v.n.* P. 303,
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3 *pl.* **become**, P. 738.

bedawe, *v.n.* v. 1982, dawn.

bedd, **bed**, *s.* i. 876, ii. 828, 856,
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beddefiere, vi. 1916, bedfellow.

beddeshed, *s.* iii. 445.

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(**bedis**, viii. 2959),
peire of bedes, viii. 2904: prayer, command, bead.

bederke, *v.a.* i. 1169.

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beerdles, *a.* v. 7202*.

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beyat (3), v. 1396,
pp. **begete(n)**, iv. 3249, v. 3194, 7313, vii. 5137.

begge, *v.a.* v. 1785*, buy:
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beggere, **begger**, *s.* i. 2249, iv. 2249, v. 2414,
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pp. with adv. iii. 1157, vi. 1553,
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wo bego(n), iv. 3394, v. 4348.

begrave, *v.a.* i. 2348,
pp. **begrave**, ii. 887, 2649, iv. 2171, bury;
pp. **begrave**, i. 2541, engraved.

begripe, *v.a.* vii. 536, encompass.

begrowe, *pp.* v. 6831, grown over.

beguile, *v.a.* i. 677, 705, ii. 651, iii. 2180, deceive, betray.

behelde, *see* **beholde**.

beheste, *s.* P. 81*, i. 1100, 1270, PP. 41, promise, assurance.

behete, **behiete**, **behihte**, *see* **behote**.

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behelde, vii. 1856,
3 s.pres. **beholt**, i. 2700, ii. 2434,
3 s.pret. **behiel**, i. 414, v. 5441,
beheld, ii. 1833,
pl. **behielde**, iv. 3090,
pret. subj. **behelde**, iv. 574,
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beholde, *pp.* v. 94, vii. 4175, bound.

behonge, *v.a.* v. 7489, vi. 1839.

behote, *v.a.n. inf.* iv. 1824,
1 s.pres. **behote**, i. 1233, 2678,

behete, behiete, iv. 638, 3144, 3470, v. 6701,
3 s. **behet**, i. 1954,
3 pl. **behote**, ii. 1664,
pret. **behihte**, i. 1565, iii. 1014, iv. 1555, v. 1476, 4979,
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(**behighte, behight**, viii. 3124, PP. 41),
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dedicate.

behove, s. P. 358, ii. 1674, vii. 1332, advantage.

behove, v.n. iii. 640, 1114, vii. 1711, 2025, viii. 2426,
behoveth nede, vii. 1353: be needful, help, ought.

behovely (-li), a. i. 2393, iii. 1330, v. 1757, PP. 304,
(**bihovely**, vii. 3159*),
behovelych(e), v. 4012, vii. 1975; profitable, helpful.

beie,
v.a. ii. 3061, iii. 639,
3 s.*pres.* **beith**, v. 4396,
pret. **boghte**, ii. 2397, 2736, iii. 380,
pp. **boght**, iii. 894, 2066, buy, pay for, avenge;
cp. **begge**.

beinge, s. vii. 90 ff.

bejape, v.a. i. 2363, ii. 2489, iv. 900, v. 3207, 6216, deceive, mock.

beknowe(n), v.a.n. i. 593, 1376, ii. 275, vi. 1390,
pp. **beknowe(n)**, P. 1039, i. 550, v. 6466,
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I am beknowe ... this, ii. 236,
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Bel, v. 1556 f.

Bele Ysolde, vi. 472, viii. 2501.

beleve, v.n. P. 10, i. 1516, ii. 2524, iv. 2816,
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is beleft, was beleft, ii. 2569, 3458,

is belaft, vi. 2346.

(belie), *v.a.*,
3 pl. pret. beleie, v. 7581,
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believe, *v.a.n.* P. 284, i. 580, 1215, 2012, ii. 629, 2136, iii. 2222, viii. 2500,
beleve, v. 6124; believe, believe in, trust.

believe, bilieve, s. P. 91, i. 699, 894, 1216, ii. 3396, iii. 967,
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belle, s. i. 1949, 2391, ii. 1728, iv. 346.

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belonge, *v.n.* P. 67, 259, i. 691, 2345, 2904, iv. 2293, 3307, (3 *s.pres.*
belongith, viii. 2997 ff.), belong, be fitting.

beloved, *a.* P. 38, i. 1920, v. 4365.

Belus, v. 1546, 1556.

belwe, *v.n.* iv. 2113, bellow.

belwinge, s. vii. 3322, bellowing.

Belzebub, v. 1557.

bemene, *v.a.* i. 1540, iii. 1983.

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bende, *v.a.n.*,
pret. bende, ii. 2235, vii. 4749,
pp. bent, iii. 449, viii. 2453.

bene, s. v. 4408, bean.

Benedab, vii. 2539 ff.

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bente, *a.pl.* vii. 4418, arched.
benyce, *v.refl.* viii. 2769, befool (oneself).
benyme, *v.a.*,
2, 3 *s.pres.* **benymst**, **benymth**, iii. 1309, v. 7002,
pp. **benome**, vi. 36, take away.
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bere, s. ii. 160, vi. 1450, bear.
bere, *v.a.* P. 294, 492, i. 850,
3 *s.pres.* **berth**, i. 467, iii. 1784,
pret.s. **bar**, P. 908, i. 434,
pl. **bere**, **beere**, i. 2795, iv. 1323, 1376, vii. 1796,
pret. subj. **beere**, iv. 2749,
pp. **bore**, i. 773, 2788, ii. 933, 2635,
boren, ii. 976,
ybore, ii. 499;
bar (berth) on hond, iii. 664, iv. 32, v. 546,
berth an hond, v. 496.
bereined, *pp.* i. 2915, vii. 1234.
Berenger, P. 780.
bereve, *v.a.* P. 411, vii. 3245*,
pret. **berefte**, P. 744, vii. 3840,
beraft, v. 5647,
pp. **beraft**, viii. 209.
beried, *pp.* iii. 293.
berille, vii. 1349.

Berillus, vii. 3309.

berke, v.n. ii. 1796,
3 s.pret. **bark**, ii. 1861.

berne, s. ii. 86, v. 4907, barn.

Bersabee, vi. 97, viii. 2690.

berste, v.n. viii. 1068.

berthe, s. iv. 2231, v. 827.

besant, s. v. 1930.

Besazis, vii. 1884.

beschade, v.a. iv. 3207, vii. 743, 809;
cp. **bischadewe**.

beschrewe, v.a. i. 1036, iii. 810, curse.

beschrewed, a. i. 640, iii. 480, evil-disposed.

beschyne, v.a. vii. 4465, shine upon.

(**be-se**), v.a.,
pret. pl. **besihe**, viii. 1617, look after, prepare:
pp. **besein**, **beseie**, P. 559, i. 358, 2360, iv. 1384,
wo **besein**, ii. 262,
besein of, iii. 1844,
besein to, iv. 180, provided, equipped, prepared.

beseche, v.a.n. i. 589, 1339, 1985, 2174, 2259 &c.,
besieche, viii. 2912,
beseke, ii. 960, v. 916, 1355;
pret. **besoghte(n)**, i. 1808, 2640, ii. 108, 1212, 1483, v. 1459,
besoughte, v. 3440,
besoughten (pl.), P. 198,
pp. **besoght**, v. 6230,
imperat. **besech**, i. 2937.

beseke, see **beseche**.

beseme, v.a. i. 2013, ii. 2935, iv. 745.

besette, *v.a.* i. 3237, iv. 1482,

pp. **beset**, i. 2538, 2736, ii. 3252, iv. 1567, v. 555,

besett, iv. 496, set, employ, bestow.

besi, **besy**, *a.* ii. 1764, iv. 235, 509, 953.

beside, **besyde**, *prep.* i. 2305, iii. 294, 530, vii. 2242,

besiden, v. 7311, beside, contrary to:

adv. P. 446, 801, ii. 60, 1993, by the side, aside, as well:

faile and go beside, iv. 2862,

cp. v. 2428, vi. 1248, vii. 4458.

besien, *v.refl.* iv. 1183, 1230.

besiliche, *adv.* i. 373, iv. 57, 1235,

besily, iv. 2185.

besinesse, *s.* i. 1130, ii. 460, 1074, iv. 513, viii. 3052*,

besynesse, P. 49*,

businessse, P. 63,

(**businessse**, PP. 226).

besischipe, *s.* iv. 1119.

besnewed, *pp.* i. 2044, vi. 1498.

besowed, *pp.* viii. 1114, sewn up.

besprede, *v.a.* vii. 1150,

pret. **bespradde**, viii. 2655,

pp. **bespred**, v. 6917.

best, *a.* i. 1525,

the beste, i. 768,

pl. iii. 500;

as subst. **for the beste, to the beste**, i. 997, 1748, 2488,

thi beste, i. 1603:

adv. **best**, P. 337, ii. 2676.

bestad, *pp.* i. 1049, 2584, ii. 69, 922, 1149, iii. 77, vii. 3228*, situated,
engaged, troubled.

bestaile, *s.* v. 331, 1022, cattle.

beste, s. P. 909, i. 976, 2828, beast.

bestere, v.refl. ii. 3196, viii. 609.

bestial, a. i. 2913.

bestly, a. i. 3025.

bestowe, v.a. iv. 2472.

beswike, v.a. i. 498, 760, deceive.

beswinke, v.a. v. 6085,
pp. **beswunke**, i. 2646, labour for.

besyde, *see* **beside**.

bet, a. v. 4715:
adv. i. 1976, 2514, iii. 349, 2239;
for bet for wers, iv. 673:
cp. **betre**.

betake, v.a. iv. 1431,
3 s.pres. **betakth**, iii. 1978,
pret. **betok**, iv. 3327,
imperat. **betaketh**, ii. 1036,
pp. **betake(n)**, P. 309, i. 80, vii. 1335, viii. 2960; give, deliver,
commend:
betaken (*pp.*), v. 743, taken.

bete, v.a.n. P. 428, i. 1155, ii. 2356,
pret. **bet**, iii. 997, vii. 4615,
pp. **bete(n)**, iii. 974, v. 1960, vii. 4635, beat.

beteche, v.a. vii. 4234,
pret. **betawhte**, **betauhte**, **betaghte**, iii. 1940, v. 3575, viii. 748,
pp. **betawht**, vi. 2411, viii. 120, deliver.

bethenke, v.a.n. PP. 101,
pret. **bethoghte**, vi. 1165,
pp. **bethoght**, iv. 142, think of, remember;
refl. **he him bethoghte**, i. 798,
cp. i. 2116,
bethoughte hire, v. 3423;

I am bethoght, i. 1267,
this I am bethoght, iii. 1250,
bethoght, ii. 2906.

Bethincia, v. 1141.

bethrowe, *pp.* vi. 114.

betide, **betyde**, *v.n.* i. 149, 2265, iv. 1024, 1779,
3 *s.pres.* **betitt**, ii. 1997,
pret. **betidde**, **betydde**, ii. 2463, vi. 1607,
betidd, vii. 4381,
pp. **betid**, P. 182, v. 2101,
betidd, iii. 473, v. 6254, happen, come to pass.

betokne, *v.a.* P. 594, 628, i. 2888, ii. 731, vii. 1757 ff.;
v.n. ii. 1804, vii. 4518.

betraie, *v.a.* i. 1079, ii. 1181, viii. 1923.

betrappe, *v.a.* iii. 1358, vii. 4915.

betre, **bettre**, *a.* P. 352, i. 1556, 2424, iv. 37;
subst. **the betre**, v. 7393:
adv. P. 543, i. 720,
the betre, i. 1543:
cp. **bet**.

betwen, **betuen**, *prep.* P. 18, i. 2164, ii. 411, 653, v. 5025, 5718,
hem betwene (betuene), P. 790, 1000, v. 3062:
adv. **betwene**, ii. 942.

betyde, *see* **betide**.

bewake, *v.a.* v. 3498, 6611, watch, watch through.

bewar, *v.imperat.* (= be war), ii. 571, iii. 1496, 1738, v. 6048.

beware, *v.a.* P. 394, ii. 3066, 3359, iii. 2219, vii. 2518, spend, employ.

beweile, *v.refl.* i. 972, iv. 2958.

bewelde, *v.refl.* iii. 990, vii. 510, viii. 3041*, have power over (oneself).

bewepe, *v.a.* iv. 1565, vii. 2888.

bewhape, v.a. vi. 80, vii. 4267, viii. 2219,
(pp. **bewhapid**, viii. 2955), bewilder, amaze.

bewounde, v.a.pp. v. 5008, viii. 1178.

bewreie, v.a. ii. 1530, v. 701, 2940, viii. 454,
pp. **bewreid**, v. 6785, reveal, expose.

bewympled, pp. v. 6913.

beyelpe (3), v.refl. vii. 2096, boast (oneself).

beyende (3), prep. i. 424.

beyete (3), s. P. 304, 784, i. 1194, 2684, ii. 2355, iv. 1709, gain, property,
possession.

bible, s. P. 354, i. 2788, iv. 1960, 2655, v. 7025, vii. 2527, 3624, viii. 224.

bidde, v.a.n. P. 458, i. 884, 934, 1556,
bidde his bede, v. 6985,
3 s.pres. **bit**, i. 1310, iv. 1161,
bidt, iv. 1162, 2802,
pret. **bad**, P. 45*, i. 157, 1535, 2902, ii. 1140,
badd, vi. 1735,
pl. **bede**, i. 2048, iii. 750,
biede, viii. 1507,
pret. subj. **bede**, iv. 2905, vi. 1356,
imperat. **bidd**, iv. 1434, v. 7588,
pp. **bede**, i. 813, 841, iii. 1557,
beden, i. 2520; bid, command, invite, ask for, pray:
cp. **biede**, with which **bidde** has been confused.

biddinge, s. i. 2552.

bide, v.n.,
pret. **bod**, viii. 519, 2310, stay.

biede, v.a. v. 4455,
pp. **bode**, P. 244, i. 2865, command, demand:
cp. **bidde**.

bienfait, s. iii. 758,
bienfet, vii. 3029.

bienvenue, s. ii. 1503.

bile, s. iv. 2710, 3108, v. 6526.

bilieve, *see* **believe**, s.

bille, s. viii. 875, 889, 2324, writing.

bime, *see* **byme**.

binde, **bynde**, *v.a.n.* i. 1623, v. 3606, viii. 2811,

3 s.p. **bint**, vi. 72,

pret.s. **bond**, v. 853, 5056,

pl. **bounden**, v. 151,

pp. **bounde(n)**, i. 2538, ii. 540, iii. 2095.

bischadewe, *v.a.* viii. 3008*.

bisnesse, *see* **besnesse**.

bisschop, **bisshop**, ii. 904, 936.

bisschopriches, *s.pl.* P. 208.

bisse, s. vi. 990, fine linen.

bite, *v.n.* iii. 119,

pret. **bot**, vi. 5.

Biten, v. 1402.

biter, *a.* vi. 250,

def. **biter**, vi. 371,

bitter, viii. 2256;

the bitre (*as subst.*), i. 1708.

biternesse, s. vi. 344.

bitterswete, s. viii. 191:

cp. vi. 250.

blad, **bladd**, s. iii. 252, iv. 927.

blak, *a.* iv. 1343, v. 4045,

blake, *def.* i. 1167,

voc. iv. 2842,

pl. iv. 2494.

blame, s. i. 630, 1017, 2074, 3056;
as a. i. 2405.

blame(n), v.a. P. 60*, i. 3053,
to blame(n), P. 538, i. 3054, v. 5210.

blameles, *a*. vii. 3816.

blaminge, s. v. 1455.

blanche, *a*. (*fem.*) vi. 239.

blase, v.n. ii. 2949.

blase, s. v. 3510, 4089, viii. 2444.

blast, s. i. 1069, 2411, iii. 419.

bleche, *a*. v. 2477, wan.

blede, v.n. ii. 840, vi. 1746.

blenchinge, s. vi. 205, 1867.

blende, v.a.,
3 s.pres. **blent**, v. 2492,
pret. **blente**, v. 3467,
pp. **blent**, i. 1126, v. 2165, blind, conceal.

blesse, v.a. i. 3418, v. 1238,
(pp. **blessid**, viii. 3104);
v.n. i. 620, v. 5022, cross oneself.

blessed, *a*. vii. 3260.

blessinge, s. ii. 3317, v. 1281.

blew, *a. as subst.* iv. 1317, vii. 2188, blue.

blind, **blynd**, *a*. i. 47, ii. 355, 759, v. 980,
blinde, P. 139,
def. i. 621, 2490, ii. 1822,
pl. i. 228, 927, iii. 1465, v. 2959;
the blinde (blynde), *as subst.* P. 536, i. 2952, v. 536,
cp. vii. 2470: blind, deceitful.

blindly, *adv.* viii. 2385.

blisse, *s.* i. 1771, v. 544, viii. 33.

blithe, **blythe**, *a.* ii. 18, 657, v. 6140, viii. 929.

blockes, *s.pl.* iii. 1033.

blod, *s.* i. 2235, 3170, vi. 840, vii. 4132,
blood, vii. 423.

blodi, *a.* P. 757, iii. 1400,
bloody, ii. 861.

blowe, *v.a.n.* P. 923, i. 1065, 2133, 2411, ii. 1122, 2134, v. 1818,
pret. **blew**, **bleu**, i. 2143, iii. 1025, v. 5409,
blewh, ii. 2892,
pl. **blewe**, vi. 2263,
pp. **blowe**, i. 2298, iv. 735, vii. 3041.

blowinge, *s.* iv. 2484.

blythe, *see* **blithe**.

blyve, **blive**, *adv.* iii. 1044, viii. 515, quickly;
als (as) blyve, iv. 1854, v. 3318,
cp. vi. 1430: forthwith.

boc, *see* **bok**.

bode, *v.a.* i. 3282, proclaim.

bodi, **body**, *s.* P. 474, 995, ii. 977,
pl. **bodies**, iv. 1320, 2463.

bodili, **bodily**, **bodely**, *a.* ii. 3256, v. 193, 1775,
bodiliche, ii. 3344, vi. 397:
adv. **bodily**, ii. 2969 (= in person), iii. 767,
bodely, iv. 975.

boiste, *see* **buiste**.

bok, *s.* P. 18, ii. 868
(**book**, viii. 3108),
boc, vii. 480,
in boke, iv. 978,
pl. **bokes**, P. 2, i. 2458.

boke, v. P. 51*, iv. 2664, viii. 1328, record, write books, teach with books.

bold, *a.* ii. 1690, iii. 1846, iv. 2192,
pl. **bolde**, vii. 4355.

bole, *s.* iv. 2112, vii. 1017, 3313, bull.

bombard, *s.* viii. 2482, (a musical instrument).

bon, *s.* i. 1531, ii. 2291, iii. 463,
pl. bones, ii. 2302, vi. 2309.

bond, *s.* ii. 2112, iv. 894,
pl. **bondes**, P. 502, ii. 3027, iv. 2105.

bonde, *a.* vi. 74, bond (slave).

bondeman, *s.* viii. 1358.

bone, *s.* ii. 768, 1430, vii. 3899, petition, boon.

Boneface, **Bonefas**, ii. 2940, 2950 ff.

bor, *s.* vii. 5255, boar.

bord, *s.* i. 2111, ii. 689, iv. 400, viii. 720,
pl. **bordes**, i. 2529, ii. 1426, iv. 3018, board, table;
iv. 1741, side (of a ship),
schipes bord, v. 3922, viii. 987,
over bord, viii. 1140.

borde, *s.* iii. 741,
pl. **bordes**, vii. 4799, viii. 1676, jest.

bordel, *s.* v. 1054, viii. 1411 ff., brothel.

bordeller, *s.* viii. 1415.

borwe, *v.a. n.* iv. 10, v. 6640, 7665.

borwe, *s.*, **to borwe**, iv. 774, 960, v. 3416.

bost, *s.* iii. 2083, v. 2142, vii. 3482, boast.

bot, *s.* P. 44*, i. 1960, ii. 1108,
be bote, P. 40*,

to bote, v. 3731; boat.

bot, *prep.* vii. 694, beyond: *conj.* P. 12, 56, 73 &c.,

but, P. 63* f., 168,

bot (= only), P. 454, i. 675, (= unless) P. 144, i. 1543, ii. 374, v. 473,

ne ... bot, i. 264,

noght ... bot, ii. 1587,

bot if, P. 345, i. 441, 1546,

bote (except), ii. 2392, (but) v. 2015.

bote, s. i. 28, 2232, ii. 2051, iv. 133,

do bote, ii. 2274, iii. 2272: remedy, help.

boteler, s. i. 2593, vi. 295 ff.

Botercadent, vii. 1419.

bothe, s. viii. 170, booth.

bothe, *a.pl.* P. 159, i. 317,

bothe tuo, P. 1068, i. 851,

bothen, i. 1829, vii. 2469,

oure herte bothe, iii. 1473,

bothe also, iii. 1471;

as adv. i. 1106, iv. 1874.

botme, s. i. 1961, bottom.

bouele, s. v. 4137.

boun, *a.* viii. 1407, PP. 17, ready.

bounde, s. iv. 2506, vi. 634.

bounde, *v.a.* ii. 1754, vii. 560.

bounte, s. v. 2595, goodness.

bowe, s. i. 1967, ii. 151, 2234, 2956, iv. 2983, bow.

bowe, *v.n.* P. 153, i. 718, 1238, 1248, 1284, ii. 3225, iv. 1130, bow, bend,
turn aside, submit.

bowh, s. iv. 856, 1331,

pl. **bowes**, i. 2824, 2902, bough.

Bragmans, *pl.* v. 1453.

braie, *v.n.* i. 3027.

brain, *s.* i. 2568, *iv.* 107,
brayn, *v.* 1463.

branche, *s.* P. 346, *iv.* 3688, *v.* 1965,
braunche, *i.* 2311.

Branchus, *i.* 1428, 1456.

Brangwein, *vi.* 473.

bras, *s.* P. 610, *i.* 1087, *iv.* 236, 2472.

breche, *s.* v. 332.

bred, *s.* *ii.* 1856, *iii.* 446.

brede, *s.* *iii.* 1963, *v.* 5661, breadth.

brede, *v.a.* *i.* 542, *iii.* 1322, *v.* 7700.

breide, *v.a.* *vii.* 4332, braid.

breide, *v.a.*, *pret.* *iii.* 1429, *viii.* 1377, drew.

bregge, *s.* v. 2205, *vii.* 2242, bridge.

breke, *v.a.* P. 148, *i.* 1303, 1334, 1512;
v.n. *i.* 1248, 1700, *ii.* 3008:
pret. **brak**, *ii.* 3008, *iv.* 847, *v.* 1710,
pp. **broke**, P. 653, *ii.* 3394.

brenne, *v.a. n.* P. 329, *i.* 323, *ii.* 5, 23, *iv.* 820,
3 *s.* *pret.* **brende**, *ii.* 2302, *v.* 1100,
brente, *v.* 1667,
3 *pl.* **brenden**, *i.* 1184,
pp. **brent**, *i.* 2006,
def. **brente**, *v.* 7210, burn.

brennynge, *s.* *vi.* 2232.

brere, *s.* P. 409, 413, briar.

breſt, *s.* P. 607, *i.* 662, 1327, *iii.* 2011, *v.* 1384,

briest, viii. 2175, breast, heart.

Bretaigne, vii. 752.

breth, s. i. 119, 2127, ii. 530, iii. 289, iv. 2758.

brewe, v.a. ii. 246, iii. 1626.

Brexeïda, ii. 2455.

brid, s. i. 101, 2703,
bridd, i. 2088,
pl. **briddes**, i. 111, 1728.

bridel, s. i. 1697, ii. 3009, iii. 1629, iv. 1203,
brydel, iv. 1434.

bridlen, v.a. i. 2037, viii. 2707.

briht, **bryht**, **bright**, a. v. 3110, vii. 734,
def. **bryhte**, v. 3169,
brighte, v. 2783,
pl. **brihte**, iv. 988,
bryghte, iii. 1039.

brihte, **bryhte**, *adv.* v. 36, 3732,
bryht, vii. 1857,
compar. **bryhtere**, **brihtere**, iv. 1322*, vi. 1525.

brimme, s. v. 4968.

bringe, v.a. P. 348, i. 1318, 1447,
3 s. *pres.* **bringth**, P. 1082,
pret. **broghte**, P. 760, ii. 1246, iv. 2951, **broughte**, v. 3934,
pp. **broght**, P. 623, i. 788, **brought**, iii. 604,
imperat. **bring**, vi. 1728;
bringen forth, iv. 3119, **forth broghte**, ii. 1246, **broght aboute**, iv. 2352.

bringere, s. v. 345.

brinke, s. i. 2310, 2980, iii. 1408.

brocage, s. v. 341, 4426, 4590, viii. 3033.

broche, s. v. 6173, brooch.

brocour, s. v. 4387 ff., 4573.

brod, brood, s. ii. 383, v. 4375, brood.

brod, a. iv. 3164, v. 6792,
pl. brode, i. 1729, 1749, v. 1266, broad:
adv. v. 1086, (**broode**, PP. 201).

brond, s. v. 1485, 4089.

brothell, s. vii. 2595, worthless fellow.

brother, s. P. 1050, i. 2071, PP. 266,
genit. i. 2139, ii. 1197, iv. 2944,
pl. brethren, v. 799, vi. 1077.

browe, s. i. 1589, 1678, vii. 4418.

brustle, *v.n.* iv. 2732.

Brut, P. 38*.

brutel, s. P. 877, brittle.

Brutus, vii. 4735 ff.

bryd, s. i. 1788, bride.

brygantaille, s. P. 213, irregular troops.

bryht, *see briht*.

buck, s. iv. 1300, 1978.

buille, buile, *v.n.* iii. 431, v. 1487, 4121,
pres.p. buillende, v. 2221.

buissh, s. i. 359, 2984, ii. 2356,
bussh, i. 2044.

buisshelles, *s.pl.* v. 2204.

buisshement, s. iii. 2089.

buiste, boiste, s. v. 3594, viii. 507, 2814, box.

Bulgarie, vii. 3291.

bulle, s. ii. 2825, 2978, PP. 208, (pope's) bull.

burel, *a.* P. 52, simple.

burgeis, *s.* v. 7255, viii. 543, citizen.

burgh, *s.* P. 794, v. 3125, vii. 1690.

Burgoigne, vii. 770.

burned, *a.* i. 2540, v. 3110, 4339, polished.

buxom, *a.* P. 153, v. 2807, obedient.

buxomly, *adv.* iii. 546, v. 3030.

buxomnesse, *s.* i. 1355.

by, *adv.* i. 1802, iv. 1172, v. 4517, vii. 4955,

bi, iv. 397,

by and by (in order), iii. 557, v. 5503, 7280,

faste by, v. 298:

cp. **be**, *prep.*

byme, **bime** (= by me), ii. 2016, iii. 892 (against me), 2702 (for me), iv. 1182, 1423 (to me), 3369, v. 4484.

bysne, *a.* ii. 771, blind.

C

ça, vi. 60.

caban, *s.* viii. 1051, 1601.

cable, *s.* i. 1068, v. 443, viii. 624.

cacche, *v.a.* iv. 3283,

pret. **cawhte**, ii. 1349, 1441, iii. 1461,

cauhte, v. 3924,

pp. **cawht**, i. 1654, 2277,

caght, ii. 1746;

v.n. ii. 3192.

cadence, *s.* iv. 2414.

Cadme, **Cadmus**, i. 339, iv. 2401, v. 4273.

cage, *s.* iv. 1191.

caitif, s. i. 161, v. 2801.
cake, s. vii. 3705 ff.
Calcas, i. 1085.
calcedoine, s. vii. 1431.
calcinacion, s. iv. 2518.
calculacion (-oun), s. v. 3085, 6459, 7163*.
Caldee (country), P. 666, 717, v. 750, 781, 1592,
 Chaldee, vii. 2031;
 Caldee (language), iv. 2627.
Caldeus, *pl.* v. 787.
caldron, **caldroun**, s. v. 4117, 4141.
Caleph, v. 1687.
Calidoyne, iv. 2047.
Caligula, viii. 202.
caliphe, s. (1), ii. 2549, caliph.
caliphe, s. (2), v. 3915, (a kind of vessel).
Calipsa, **Calipse**, vi. 1427, viii. 2599.
Calistona, v. 6228 ff.
Calistre, vi. 2274, vii. 20.
calle, *v.a.n.* P. 126, i. 2459, 3146, ii. 937, iii. 1436.
calm, *a.* vii. 4113.
Calmana, viii. 65, 71.
Calvus, P. 775.
Cam, *see* **Cham**.
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2 *s.* **couthest**, **couthist**, vii. 2298, 2301;
cowthe him thonk, ii. 1007; know:
1, 3 *s.pres.* **can**, P. 60, i. 28,
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cunnen, vii. 2172,
pret. **cowthe**, **couth**, P. 1073, i. 30, 536,
cowde, **coude**, iv. 1255, 1540, know how to, be able to.

connynge, *s.* vii. 671.

conoiscance, *s.* vi. 1638.

conquere, *v.n.* iii. 1649.

conquerour, *s.* iii. 1286, vii. 893.

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(**conqweste**, PP. 42).

Conrade, vii. 2833.

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consailer, *see* **conseilour**.

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792, v. 1847, feeling, conscience, sense of guilt.

conseil, consail, P. 146, 156, i. 609, 888, 1018, 1097, 1395, ii. 687, 1891, 3415, v. 3904 (secret), vii. 2076 (advocate);
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refl. iii. 2727, vii. 3188.

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conserve, s. vi. 636, vii. 54, conserve, preserver.

consideracion, s. vii. 2749.

consistoire, s. ii. 2908.

conspire, *v.n.* i. 1206, ii. 2170, 2834, ii. 2945;
v.a. i. 1173, 1504, ii. 2329: conspire; agree upon, contrive.

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Constantine, ii. 706.

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Constantin (1), Constantinus, P. 743, ii. 3188, 3339, 3449, vii. 3137, PP. 339, Constantine the Great.

Constantin (2), ii. 590, Tiberius Constantinus.

Constantin (3), P. 740, Constantine V.

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(**contekt**, viii. 3015).

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continue, *v.n.* iv. 508.

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controvinge, *s.* vi. 2372.

conveie, *v.a.* ii. 1125, iv. 203, viii. 2986*.

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converten, *v.a.* ii. 601, 639, iv. 1676,
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coupe, vii. 1579, cloak, covering, vault.

coper, *s.* iv. 2473.

coppe, *see* **cuppe**.

Cor Scorpionis, vii. 1410.

corage, *s.* P. 111, 448, i. 780, 833, ii. 1338, iv. 391, heart, spirit,
disposition.

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corrant, *a.* vii. 352, running.

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costeiant, *a.* ii. 2551, bordering.

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cote, *s.* i. 2999, ii. 2270, iv. 1355, v. 7716, coat.

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couard, *a.* iv. 611;

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couardie, *s.* iv. 1934, vii. 1860.

couche, *s.* iv. 3015, v. 160, viii. 1193.

couche, *v.n.* i. 1261;

v.a. iv. 2710,

pp. couched, viii. 2255.

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couple, s. vii. 4437.

coupled, *v.a.pp.* v. 657, viii. 277.

courbe, s. v. 956, hump.

courbe, *a.* i. 1687, bent.

cours, s. i. 509, 2637, iii. 1031, iv. 1270.

courser, s. vi. 1188,

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courtaisly, **cortaisly**, *adv.* i. 2108, viii. 1695.

courteis, **curteis**, *a.* iv. 2300, v. 155, vi. 1992.

courteour, s. i. 1410, v. 7125*.

courtesie, **curtesie**, s. ii. 1214, v. 169, 5397.

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coveite, *v.a.n.* ii. 238, v. 262, 6379.

coveitise, s. P. 263, iii. 2308, v. 223,

covoitise, v. 1976 ff., vii. 2013, covetousness.

coveitous, *a.* ii. 317,

def. **covoitouse**, vii. 2168,

pl. **coveitouse**, v. 4800,

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covenable, *a.* v. 2675, 6112, suitable.

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(**covyne**, vii. 2335*, viii. 3016), company, agreement, device,
conspiracy.

covined, pp. i. 1102, agreed.

covoitise, **covoitous**, see **coveitise**, &c.

cow, s. iv. 3323 ff.

cowde, see **conne**.

cowth, **couth**, a. ii. 432, iii. 2109, iv. 2543; v. 389,
pl. **cowthe**, i. 2862, known.

cowthe, v. see **conne**.

crabbe, s. vii. 1053.

craft, s. i. 1136, 1749, ii. 1849, iv. 925,
craftes, iv. 1048, 2667.

crafteliche, adv. i. 1755.

crafti, a. i. 1091, skilful.

crake, v.n. vii. 305, burst.

Crassus, v. 2069.

crave, v.a. i. 1362, 3343, ii. 329, iii. 1306, iv. 3290, v. 189;
v.n. iv. 54, vii. 2427: ask for, ask.

creacion, s. v. 933, vii. 203.

creance, s. ii. 754, iii. 2505, v. 783.

creatour, s. ii. 3436, v. 778.

creature, s. P. 911, i. 1529, v. 779.

crede, s. iii. 478, v. 2912, 7119.

credence, s. i. 533, 707, ii. 867, iv. 2921, v. 743, belief, faith.

credible, *a.* P. 574, vii. 128, 2528.

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pret. **crepte**, i. 908,

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creste, s. v. 6044.

Cresus, iv. 1325 (*genit.*), v. 4730.

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cri, cry, s. i. 375, 2188, iii. 545, 1055, iv. 3600.

crie(n), *v.a.n.* i. 955, 1369, iii. 222, iv. 3066, vii. 3649,

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3 s. *pres.* **crith**, i. 2338, iv. 3619,

pret. **cride**, i. 2326, 3167,

pp. **cryd**, iv. 1857,

crid, viii. 679, cry, lament, pray for, proclaim.

criinge, s. vii. 3323.

Crise, i. 1085,

Crisis, v. 6444.

Criseide (1), v. 7597, viii. 2531,

Criseïda, ii. 2456.

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Crist, *genit.* **Cristes**, P. 165, 237 ff., 749 ff., 1032, i. 664, ii. 587 ff., 1597, 2503, 3354, 3466, iii. 1121, 2288, 2494 ff., 2547, iv. 1662 ff., v. 747, 1752 ff., 6390, 7001, 7106*, vi. 975 ff., vii. 3157*, viii. 141, 3030* f., PP. 50, 120, 156 ff.

cristall, s. iv. 1322*, v. 5066, vii. 1325.

cristendom, s. ii. 746, 3454, Christianity.

cristene, *s.pl.* P. 898, Christians:

a. PP. 380;

superl. **the cristeneste**, ii. 1598.

cristne, *v.a.* ii. 908, 3474.

Croceus, v. 4835, 4860.

crois, s. ii. 770, 3392, v. 1722.

crok, s. v. 2872, vii. 2268, 4892, crook, crookedness, device.

croke, *v.a.* v. 522, bend.

croked, *a.* iii. 440.

croket, s. v. 7065, curl.

cronique, **cronique**, P. 101, i. 759, 1994, 3059,
pl. **croniques**, iv. 2395.

crop, s. P. 118,

pl. **croppes**, vii. 4678, top.

Cropheon, iii. 2022.

crossen, *v.a.* i. 1165, set (sails).

crouche, s. ii. 390, cross.

crowe, *v.a.* iv. 3003, announce by crowing.

crowe, s. iv. 3001, v. 6206.

crualte, s. P. 49, iii. 235, 2149,
(**cruelte**, viii. 2997*).

cruel, *a.* iii. 15, 2000, iv. 1509.

crumme, s. vi. 1003.

cry, *see cri*.

cunne, *see conne*.

cunnyng, *a.* vi. 2437, skilled.

Cupide, i. 124, ii. 39, iii. 169, 1351, 1463, 1695, iv. 488, 496, 1242, 1265, 1275, 1471, 1684, 1692, 3558, v. 1405, 1419, 1485, 4802, 4827, 5819, 5843, vi. 345, viii. 2172 ff., 2453 ff.,

Cupido, ii. 2470, iii. 907, iv. 1733, viii. 2745.

cuppe, **coppe**, s. P. 343, i. 2474, ii. 699, iv. 399, v. 285.

cure, s. P. 211, i. 132, 1507, 3211, ii. 1083, 3054, iv. 1744, v. 1492, 1915, 2655, charge (of parish, &c.), care, help, remedy.

cured, *a.* P. 211, with spiritual charge.

curiosite, s. viii. 3114, artful skill.

curious, *a.* i. 1524, iv. 922, v. 6816, vii. 760, careful, inquisitive.

curse, *v.n.* i. 1369, iv. 2834;

v.a. v. 557,

corse, v. 7354.

cursednesse, s. v. 6989, curse.

cursinge, s. P. 274, ii. 2979.

curteis, *see courteis*.

curtesie, *see courtesie*.

cuss, s. v. 6558, kiss.

custummance, s. v. 1117.

custumme, **custume**, s. vi. 532, viii. 685, 1616.

custummer, s. ii. 1928.

Cusy, ii. 3092.

cutte, *see kutte*.

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Daaly, vii. 361.

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dai, day, s. P. 59, 163, i. 812, 1991,
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 fro dai to dai, v. 1586,
 be daie, iii. 148, v. 1265,
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Daires, *genit.* v. 1063.

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dame, s. i. 2551, ii. 749,
 ma dame, i. 168, iv. 1374.

damoiselle, s. v. 1352.

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dampne, *v.a.* i. 1032, ii. 880, v. 4922, condemn.

dance, *see* daunce.

danger, *see* daunger.

dangerous, *a.* v. 6442, reluctant.

Daniel, P. 590 ff., 1039, i. 2859 ff., vi. 1405.

dansinge, s. iv. 1530.

Dante, vii. 2329*.

dante, *see* **daunte**.

Danubie, ii. 1819.

danz, s. i. 3395, vii. 50, 1459, (used as a title).

Daphne, iii. 1686 ff.

dar, *v.n.* 1 *s.pres.* i. 1222, 2765,
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3 *pl.* **dar**, iv. 345, 350,
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2 *s.* **durstest**, iv. 40: dare.

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daunger, **danger**, s. i. 2443, ii. 1110, iii. 1537 ff., iv. 1149, 1641, 2813,
2903, 3589, v. 1389, 6620 ff., viii. 2264:
see note on i. 2443.

daunsinge, s. v. 3143.

daunte, *v.a.* i. 469, 2390, 2962, iii. 177, iv. 2072,
dante, v. 7220, tame, conquer.

David, ii. 3088, vi. 95, vii. 3860 ff., 4345, viii. 2690, PP. 282.

dawe, s. i. 2125,
of dawe, vii. 2883 (dead),
pl. **dawes**, i. 2794, iv. 3318:
cp. **dai**.

de (Langharet), ii. 2995.

debat, s. P. 106, 567, i. 2920, ii. 1907, strife, dispute.

debate, v.n. P. 928, i. 2453, iii. 2731;

v.a. P. 998, vii. 1640, 1744: contend; contend for, contend against.

debonaire, a. P. 553, i. 231, iii. 601, v. 176, vi. 863.

decas, s. P. 837, destruction.

deceipte, s. P. 541, i. 676, 753, iii. 184,

deceite, P. 114.

deceivable, a. ii. 1698, deceived;

ii. 2202, 3018, deceitful.

deceivant, a. i. 1214, iv. 2076;

as subst. ii. 1875.

deceive, v.a. i. 417, 751, viii. 2344:

v.n. i. 1207.

Decembre, vii. 1181, 4301.

decerte, s. i. 614, 1354, 3277, iii. 2293, iv. 1605,

pl. **decertes**, vii. 2049, service, merit.

decerve, see **deserve**.

decess, s. v. 3253, vii. 4516.

decide, v.a. P. 334, vii. 52, PP. 256.

declaracion, s. iv. 2228.

declare, v.n. i. 3436, iv. 312, v. 1380;

v.a. i. 73, v. 7399.

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def. **dede**, ii. 840, 2647, iv. 2890,

the dede, (as subst.), i. 1445,

pl. **dede**, P. 9, i. 1037, iv. 1959, dead, killed.

Dedalion, iv. 2933.

Dedalus, iv. 1039, v. 5286.

dede, s. P. 228, i. 634, 1851,

in dede, i. 2933, iii. 329.

dedly, dedli, *a.* P. 904, i. 577, ii. 2571, iii. 274, iv. 2163, vi. 7,
dedlich (*def.*), vii. 5089, viii. 1355;
adv. iii. 1579, v. 6759.

deduit, *s.* viii. 2847, delight.

dee, *s.* v. 2437,
pl. **dees**, i. 54, iv. 1095, 1778, 2792, die,
pl. dice.

def, *a.* iv. 585.

deface, *see* **desface**.

defalte, *s.* P. 502, i. 1510, ii. 1856, iv. 1253,
in mi defalte, in thi d., iv. 3482, 3588,
defaulte, v. 537, vi. 271,
defaute, vii. 260, failure, want, fault.

defame, *s.* v. 5925, vii. 2055.

defence, defense, *s.* P. 218, 388, ii. 1806, iv. 1026, v. 1710, 5638,
prohibition, protection.

defende, *v.a.* P. 421, i. 567, ii. 3411, iii. 2263, 2769, iv. 1672, 2338,
protect, forbid.

defie (1), **defye**, *v.a.n.* i. 1043, iii. 503, vi. 723, 1203 ff., dissolve, digest.

defie (2), **deffie**, *v.a.* iv. 2848, vii. 2246, viii. 1066, defy.

defloure, *v.a.* v. 5812.

defoule, *v.a.* i. 977, 2835, iii. 2534, v. 2197, vi. 574;
v.n. iii. 586, pollute, destroy, outrage.

degre, degree, *s.* P. 50, 798, 930, i. 751, 1256, 2234, ii. 1224, v. 1688,
condition, state, manner;
be degrees (degres), i. 258, iv. 2490, in gradation.

Deianire, Deianyre, ii. 2154 ff., iv. 2048 ff.,
Deyanire, viii. 2561.

Deïdamie, v. 3046 ff., **Deÿdamie**, viii. 2567.

deie, *see* **dye**.

deificacion, *s.* v. 934, 1173.

deifie, *v.a.* v. 776, 1148, 1494.

deigne, *v.n.* vi. 293, 1002;
impers. i. 2099, iv. 3564.

deinte, *see* **deynte**.

deintefull, *a.* vi. 813.

del, *see* **diel**.

delaie, **deslaie**, *v.a.* 1434, iv. 1755, 3399, vii. 5042, viii. 445;
v.n. ii. 1020.

delaient, *s.* iv. 226, v. 5088.

delate, *v.a.* vii. 3103, set forth.

delay, *s.* ii. 824, 3418.

Delbora (1), iv. 2437.

Delbora (2), viii. 66,
acc. **Delboram**, viii. 72.

dele, *v.n.* i. 1225, 2762, ii. 3202, iii. 69, iv. 333, have to do, deal, consult.

deliberacioun, *s.* viii. 2302.

delicacie, *s.* P. 325, iv. 2434, vi. 608 ff.

delicat, *a.* vi. 666 ff., vii. 909.

delice, *s.* vi. 795,
pl. **delices**, i. 2673, iv. 1671, v. 876, delight.

delicious, *a.* vi. 671, 957, delightful, delicate.

delit, *s.* i. 442, iv. 384, 3014, v. 187 ff., pleasure, charm.

delitable, *a.* v. 2676.

delite, *v.n. and refl.* i. 2688, iv. 3357, vi. 510,
(**delyte**, viii. 3096*).

deliverance, *s.* i. 1584, v. 1657.

delivere, *a.* vii. 1855, viii. 681, active;
adv. vii. 458, readily.

delivere, *v.a.* v. 3549,
pp. delivered (of childbirth), ii. 935, iii. 202, iv. 459.

Delos, v. 1256.

Delphos, v. 1071.

delve, *v.a.n.* P. 352, i. 3256, v. 2159, dig, dig for.

demande, *s.* i. 3071, ii. 2973, iv. 2793, viii. 1489.

deme, **dieme**, *v.a.* P. 537, i. 1892, 2014, iii. 2101, iv. 1770;
v.n. iii. 340, 750, 1216, v. 5152,
deeme, vii. 2311: judge of, think good, condemn; decide, be judge.

demeine, *s.* viii. 2226,
pl. **demeynes**, v. 1332, possession.

demene, *v.a.* ii. 1101, deal with.

Demephon, iii. 1764, 1807, iv. 731 ff 2555.

Demetrius, ii. 1619 ff.

demeynes, *seedemeine*.

demonstracioun (-on), *s.* v. 7164*, vi. 1346.

dendides, vii. 842, (name of a stone).

dep, *a.* v. 4947,
depe, (*def.*) iv. 1715,
(*pl.*) i. 3069:
subst. **the depe**, ii. 1035.

departe(n), *v.a.* P. 468, 643, i. 2935, iv. 1317, v. 602, 1689, divide,
distribute;
v.n. P. 169, ii. 2645, iii. 2750, iv. 2833, be separated, depart.

departinge, *s.* ii. 320.

depe, *adv.* i. 1679;
comp. **deppere**, ii. 2070.

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ferforth, *adv.* P. 29*, i. 2690, ii. 1596, iv. 2139.
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ferful (1), **feerful**, a. iv. 360, v. 1860, vii. 306, 3561.
ferke, v.a. viii. 603, convey.
ferme, ferm, a. vii. 3175, viii. 1109.

ferr, fer, feer, a. P. 261, i. 2378, iii. 68, v. 1507, vii. 311,
def. ferre, iii. 1901, far, distant:
adv. P. 565, i. 1042, 1313, iii. 878, iv. 831, 931,
feer, i. 570;
compar. ferre, iii. 71:
a ferr, i. 2335, iii. 1039,
afer, v. 318.

ferst, a.,
def. ferste, i. 580, ii. 1307, 1676,
(**firste**, v. 7017*, PP. 198),
ferst, iii. 27,
ate ferste, P. 522, iv. 895:
adv. P. 198, i. 998,
ferste, iv. 2601, vii. 1530,
(**first**, viii. 3082).

ferthe, a.,
def. ii. 1875, iv. 2482, PP. 1, fourth.

ferthest, adv. iv. 13.

fest, s. ii. 468, fist.

feste, s. i. 2499, iv. 1483, v. 1018.

fet, s. viii. 2415, deed, feat.

fethere, s. iv. 107,
pl. fetheres, fethers, iv. 1049, v. 6204, 6209.

fethrebed, s. iv. 3020.

fette(n), v.a. i. 2548, iv. 646, viii. 1413,
pret. fette, v. 2779,
pp. fet, fett, i. 2549, ii. 2686, iv. 1851, fetch, get.

feture, s. iv. 380, v. 2598, viii. 2977,
pl. fetures, vii. 4877, feature, make.

fewe, a.pl. P. 22, i. 1424,
as subst. iv. 2614;
a fewe, ii. 1507, iv. 1286.

fioble, *a.* P. 887, iii. 269, iv. 1392,
(**feble**, viii. 3127),
sup. **fioblest**, vii. 4296;
as subst. P. 615.

fioble, *v.a.* vi. 373.

fioblesce, *s.* ii. 2272.

fiede, *see fede.*

fiedinge, *s.* vi. 746, 941.

field, *see feld.*

fieldwode, *s.* v. 4039, *see note.*

fiel, *v.a.n.* ii. 3015, iii. 2730, v. 1043,
pret. **felte**, i. 2497,
felt, viii. 2165,
pp. **felt**, i. 210, feel, think.

fieling, *s.* P. 951, vi. 344.

fierce, *see fiers.*

fiere, ii. 349, companion;
in fiere, **in fere**, i. 993, ii. 710, viii. 1753, together.

fiers, *a.* vii. 899,
pl. **fierce**, v. 3517.

fievere, *s.* v. 464 ff., 5995.

fieverous, *a.* v. 589.

fifte, *a.def.* ii. 2320, vii. 611.

fiftene, *num.* vii. 1304.

fight, *s.* PP. 68.

figure, *s.* P. 620, i. 1530, iv. 2563,
pl. **figures**, P. 918.

figure, *v.a.* vii. 1016, 1032, shape, figure.

fihte, **fyhte**, *see feihte.*

fille, felle, s. iii. 2609, v. 255, 1680, fill.

fille, felle, v.a. ii. 3448, v. 2205, vi. 590, viii. 34, fill.

fin, a. P. 606, vi. 1891,

pl. **fine**, v. 1548,

fyne, iv. 2554.

a fin, iv. 60, at last:

cp. **afyn**.

final, a. P. 982, i. 1647, iii. 1816,

(**fynal**, viii. 3088*),

in final, viii. 3106.

finali, finaly, adv. i. 1956, ii. 1050, iii. 75, v. 595.

finde, fynde, v.a. P. 94, 572, iii. 2056,

3 s.pres. **fint, fynt**, ii. 394, 2129, iv. 3403,

pret. **fond**, i. 113, 2337, v. 2690, vii. 3300,

pl. **founde(n)**, P. 812, i. 1109,

pp. **founde(n)**, i. 2299, v. 6814, vi. 633; find, invent, provide.

finger, s. iv. 653, v. 7118*,

finger ende, vi. 1064,

pl. **fingres**, iv. 1177.

fire, v. *see fyre*.

firmament, s. P. 959, iv. 1032.

firy, *see fyri*.

fissh, fissch, s. vi. 1264,

pl. **fissches**, i. 491, ii. 3456, iii. 957.

fisshere, s. iii. 956, viii. 646.

five, *see fyve*.

fixacion (-oun), s. iv. 2520, 2574.

flacke, v.n. viii. 1196, flutter.

flamme, s. P. 345, v. 3508.

flaterende, pres.p. as a. vii. 2652.

flaterie, s. vii. 2168 ff., 2515 ff.

flatour, s. vii. 2179 ff., 2330*.

fle, flen (1), *v.a.n.* P. 203, i. 1223, 1701, iii. 600, iv. 1990,

flee, ii. 3161, vii. 3528,

pret. **fledde**, i. 2636, ii. 152,

pp. **fledd**, vii. 3570; escape, flee, avoid.

fle (2), *v.n.* iv. 1050, vi. 2225,

3 *s.pres.* **fleth**, i. 1727, ii. 151, iii. 2430,

fleith, i. 2673,

pret. **flyh, flih**, iii. 2108, v. 6206,

subj. **flyhe**, vii. 358,

pp. **flowe(n)**, v. 3750, 6129; fly.

fle (3), *v.a.* v. 4692, flay.

flees, s. v. 46, 3272.

Flegeton, v. 1109.

fleisschly, fleisshly (-li), fleysshly, *a.* vii. 4211, 4237, 4348, 4395,

flesschly, v. 6402*.

fleissh, s. i. 2235, v. 1940,

fleisch, i. 1531,

flessch, v. 6395* ff.

flete, s. ii. 1134, iii. 1036, fleet.

flete, *v.n.* iii. 1628, vi. 335,

flietende, iv. 3083, float.

fleume, s. vii. 414, 451.

flihte, *see flyhte*.

flint, s. v. 4692.

flitte, *v.a.n.* v. 7076, vii. 2902,

flitt, iv. 214, move, turn aside.

flock, s. P. 391, 421.

flod, s. i. 364, ii. 719, v. 1605, viii. 79,

pl. flodes, P. 1013.
flor, s. iv. 2785, v. 4148, viii. 1855, floor, ground.
Florent, i. 1411 ff.
florin, s. v. 335, 2410, vii. 2095.
flour, s. i. 3261, v. 278,
pl. floures, P. 937, viii. 2943*.
floure, *v.n.* v. 4144, 7626.
flowe, *v.n.* P. 39*, 933, ii. 1881.
flyh, *see fle* (2).
flyhte, **flihte**, s. iv. 1055, 2342,
flyht, iv. 1058, v. 5975.
fo, s. ii. 3354, iii. 284, iv. 3408;
as a. v. 7252.
fode, s. i. 2975, ii. 87, v. 325,
foode, vi. 846.
fol, *a.* i. 442, 2269,
fool, vi. 569, vii. 4271, foolish.
fol, s. i. 2214, ii. 3248, iv. 3347, vii. 3953 ff.,
foll, i. 1967,
fool, vi. 19,
pl. foles, iv. 625, v. 322,
fooles, vi. 535; fool.
folde, s. P. 390, 439, ii. 3055, fold: v. 2784, embrace.
fole, s. viii. 2407, foal.
folhaste, s. iii. 1430 ff., 2735,
folhast, iii. 1096.
folhastif, *a.* iii. 1635, 1795, vii. 899.
folhastifnesse, s. vii. 435.
folie, s. i. 520, 2357, iii. 141.

folk, s. P. 467, i. 2033, ii. 1770, iii. 185.

folwe, v.a.n. P. 443, i. 261,
3 s.pres. **folweth**, ii. 3503,
folwith, iv. 671, PP. 23.

fom, s. iv. 1666, v. 4008, vi. 1469.

foman, s. v. 6418*,
pl. **fomen**, i. 2877, iv. 1523,
foomen, vii. 3334*.

fonde, v.a.n. P. 62, 80*, i. 3198, ii. 929, iv. 3109, v. 1421, attempt, try.

fonge, v.a. ii. 2558, iii. 1111, iv. 2294, take.

for, prep. P. 16, i. 844, 1683, ii. 1856, iv. 1090 f.,
for al that &c., i. 192, 1055, iii. 334, vii. 2677:
cp. **fore**.

for, conj. P. 12, 40, i. 598, 1012, 1466,
for that, P. 22, i. 1784, since, because, in order that.

forbere, v.a. i. 244, 1602, 3119, 3163, ii. 538, 1768, iii. 138, 411, 754,
2321, iv. 1496, 2344, v. 6309;
v.n. i. 1279, iii. 754, v. 563: leave out, spare, prevent, forbear, avoid.

forbiede, v.a.n. v. 394,
god forbiede &c., ii. 3064, iii. 1121,
god forbede, iii. 477,
pret. **forbad**, v. 1636,
pp. **forbede**, i. 3408, iii. 2253.

forblowe(n), pp. ii. 25, viii. 1402, blown about.

forbought, pp. ii. 1573, bought off.

forcacche, v.a. P. 409, drive out.

forcast, pp. v. 1193, cast away.

forde, s. ii. 2166, vii. 1236, ford.

fordo, v.a. P. 326, i. 2415, ii. 3172,
pp. **fordo**, v. 7576, destroy.

fordrive, *v.a.pp.* viii. 1636, driven about.

fore, *adv.*, **come fore**, **travaile fore**, &c., iv. 1723, v. 3345, viii. 992.

forebode, *s.* v. 6053, prohibition.

forein, *a.* iii. 5, v. 973, vii. 2975, far removed.

forest, *s.* i. 351, 1528, 2292, iii. 324.

forestempne, *s.* iii. 994, man at the prow (?).

foretokne, *s.* i. 2812.

foreward, *s.* iii. 507, v. 7004, engagement.

forfare, *pp.* i. 109, worn out (with travel).

forfet, *s.* iii. 1798, vii. 2721, 4583, transgression, forfeit.

forfete, *v.a.* v. 5477.

forfetur, **forsfature**, iii. 1500, v. 780, 1764, 4214, offence, punishment.

forge, *s.* i. 1088, v. 963, workmanship, forge.

forge, *v.a.* i. 1087, iv. 237, vi. 1958.

forgnawe, *pp.* iii. 1406, gnawed to pieces.

forgon, *v.a.* v. 7284, go without.

forjuge, *v.a.* vii. 3171*, condemn.

forlete, *v.a.pp.* vii. 584, viii. 1434, abandoned, left alone.

forlie, *v.a.*,
 3 *s.pres.* **forlith**, PP. 108,
 pret. **forlai**, **forlay**, iii. 2031, v. 802, viii. 215,
 forlih, viii. 300,
 pp. **forlein**, **forlain**, iii. 198, 2276, v. 3189; lie with, violate.

forlore, *v.a.pp.* i. 2947, ii. 1242, v. 2825,
 forlorn, v. 1882, lost.

forme, *s.* P. 53*, 871, i. 576, 1339, 2670, ii. 2473, iv. 2211, v. 1872,
 pl. **formes**, iv. 2501.

forme, *v.a.* ii. 1012, 3245.

formel, *a.* vii. 157.

Foroneüs, vii. 3060.

fors, *s.*,

no fors, *v.* 7720, no matter.

forsake, *v.a.* P. 166, i. 1012, iii. 680, iv. 1592,

3 s.pres. **forsakth**, ii. 2450,

forsok, iii. 2031,

pl. **forsoke(n)**, P. 809, i. 611,

imperat. **forsak**, vii. 3675,

pp. **forsake**, i. 210, 3128, ii. 157; deny, give up, avoid, desert.

forschape, *v.a.* iv. 2108,

pret. **forschop**, i. 370, 1846,

pl. **forschope**, vi. 1446,

pp. **forschape**, i. 416, iii. 377, transform.

forsfaiture, *see* **forfeture**.

forsfet, *pp.* ii. 1039.

forslowthen, *v.a.* iv. 2319, v. 1887, neglect by sloth.

forsmite, *pp.* viii. 1000, smitten (to death).

forstormed, *pp.* ii. 25, viii. 1402, driven by storms.

forsueie, *v.n.* i. 1028, vii. 3928, 5369, go wrong.

forswere, *v.a.* v. 2870,

pp. **forswore**, ii. 875, v. 3229.

forth, *adv.* (of place) i. 826, iv. 799, vii. 4362, (of time) P. 818, i. 949, v. 1724,

forth therupon, i. 2503,

forth after, iii. 2103,

forth over, i. 3431,

forth riht, ii. 1270;

forth (= continually), P. 931,

axeth forth (go on asking) i. 2668,

dryve forth, P. 374, spend (time):

as prep. **forth with**, P. 680, i. 680, 2936, ii. 927, 1479, iii. 310,

forthwith, ii. 699, 1034, together with, with;
forth withal, ii. 791.

forth, s. i. 3314, course.

forthbringe, v.a. vii. 2213,
pp. **forthbrought**, v. 1257.

forthdrawe, v.a. v. 330,
pp. **forthdrawe**, ii. 1395, 2697, iv. 471, 1569, 1616,
(**forth drawe**, viii. 3060), draw out, bring forth, bring up, breed.

forthdrawere, s. iv. 3381, breeder.

forthdrawinge, s. v. 1021, breeding.

forthenke, v.a. iii. 2614;
impers. iii. 139, 630,
pret. **forthoghte**, ii. 796, 2398: repent; it repents (me), it is displeasing.

forther(e), *adv.* *see* **further(e)**.

forthermor(e), *see* **furthermor(e)**.

forthest, a. i. 1199, ii. 3150:
cp. **further(e)**.

forthferde, v.n.*pret.* i. 98, went forth.

forthgon, v.n. iv. 1850.

forthi, *adv.* P. 5, i. 1638,
(**forthy**, viii. 3152,
for thi, viii. 2950*), therefore:
noght forthi, i. 1901, ii. 398, nevertheless.

forthren, v.a. ii. 2045, vi. 353.

forthrere, s. vii. 804.

forthriht, *adv.* v. 7118*, straight.

forthringe, s. ii. 661, 2048, vii. 2957, furtherance.

forthrowe, *pp.* viii. 1154, thrown about.

forthwith, *adv.* ii. 359, 1204, v. 643, at once, moreover:

prep. see **forth**.

forto, P. 31, 208, i. 804, &c.,
for to, P. 209, 339.

fortrede, *v.a.*,
pp. **fortrode**, v. 6054, tread to death.

fortunat, *a.* vii. 917.

fortune, *s.* P. 70, i. 1670, 2625, ii. 1477.

fortune, *v.a.* P. 584, i. 1859, iii. 2365, iv. 188, viii. 2549, bring about,
deal with, regulate, make fortunate.

forwacched, *pp.* v. 5421, wearied with want of sleep.

forwakid, *pp.* iv. 404, wearied with want of sleep.

forwept, *pp.* iv. 404, worn out with weeping.

forwhy and, *conj.* ii. 2025, v. 2563, provided that.

forworthe, *v.n.* vi. 280, perish.

foryete (3), *v.a.* i. 224, iv. 576,
3 *s.pres.* **foryet**, iv. 544,
pret. **foryat**, iv. 654,
imperat. **foryet**, viii. 2434,
pp. **foryete(n)**, P. 311, i. 2015, v. 5239;
v.n. i. 3426.

foryetel (3), *a.* vii. 415, forgetful.

foryetelnesse (3), *s.* iv. 541, 629.

foryifte (3), *s.* viii. 2896, forgiveness.

foryive (3), *v.a.n.* i. 2384, iii. 898, iv. 3427, vii. 4071,
pp. **foryive**, i. 2253, 3334,
foryove, i. 2136, forgive, give.

foryivenesse (3), *s.* iv. 3491, vi. 2213.

fostre, *v.a.* P. 326, ii. 437.

fostringe, *s.* vii. 2174.

fot, s. P. 357, i. 2053, 2539,
 under fote, P. 117, iii. 1167,
 under foote, vii. 3335*,
 on fote, v. 1664,
 at his fot, iii. 233,
 pl. feet, P. 612, i. 2300;
 fot hot, iv. 3350.

foul, **foughl**, s. *see* **fowhl**.

foul, *a.* i. 1532,
 def. foule, i. 1734, iii. 2252,
 pl. iii. 431, vi. 573;
 compar. foulere, i. 1759;
 sup. the fouleste, i. 1718.

foule, *adv.* v. 5708.

founde, *v.a.* P. 289, 824, ii. 3476, viii. 1994,
 3 pl.pret. foundeden, v. 904.

fundement, s. vii. 703, 4197.

foundour, s. v. 1002.

foure, *num.* ii. 1037, iv. 2464, vii. 2371,
 fowre, iv. 2477.

fourtenyht, s. iv. 1418.

fourtiene, *num.* i. 3134, viii. 1539.

fourty, *num.* iv. 1563.

fowhl, **foughl**, **foul**, s. iii. 2605, v. 7072, vii. 140,
 pl. fowhles, foules, iii. 2601, iv. 1298, v. 1025.

fox, s. ii. 3033,
 pl. foxes, iv. 1836.

France, P. 747, ii. 2966, 3011 ff., vii. 770.

franchise, s. P. 761, ii. 3483, iii. 2699,
 (**fraunchise**, viii. 3023), freedom, privilege, liberality.

franchised, *pp.* ii. 3263, privileged.

fraternite, s. v. 1775.

fraude, s. ii. 2151, 3046, iii. 1068.

fre, a. i. 752, 1930, ii. 2112, iii. 2236, v. 4728 (liberal):
adv. ii. 3253.

frede, v.a. iv. 3511,
pret. **fredde**, v. 7167, feel.

Frederik, v. 2392.

freissh, **freyssh**, a. i. 779, iv. 1362,
def. **freisshe**, **fresshe**, i. 3353, iii. 1390, v. 6736,
freissh, vii. 5000,
pl. **freisshe**, **freysshe**, i. 353, 2355;
comp. **freisshere**, vi. 768.

freissh, *adv.* viii. 2487.

frele, a. i. 773, viii. 289, 834, frail.

frely, *adv.* v. 2847,
freliche, v. 4769.

friend, s. iii. 274, vii. 1574 f.,
pl. **friendes**, i. 992, 2147.

friended, *pp.* viii. 1964.

friendliche, *adv.* vii. 4920.

friendlihede (-hiede), s. iii. 946, v. 4755.

friendly, **friendlich**, a. i. 2423, v. 4833, viii. 2173.

friendschipe, s. ii. 2179, 2461,
frenschipe, iii. 1060.

frenesie, s. iii. 210, v. 848.

Frensche, a.*def.* P. 770;
subst. pl. **Frensche**, ii. 2993.

frere, s. vi. 138, friar.

frese, v.n. iv. 613, 1092, vi. 249.

fressh, *see* **freissh**, *a*.

frete, *v.a.*, 3 *s. pres.* **fret**, vii. 412, consume.

frette, *s.* v. 3015, ornament.

freyne, *v.a.* v. 7471, question.

friday, *s.* v. 81.

Frigelond, **Frige**, v. 147, 272.

Frigidilles, iv. 2408.

Frixus, v. 4254 ff.

fro, *prep.* P. 169, i. 395, 2895,

mi ladi fro, iv. 558,

cp. v. 3639,

from, v. 6250:

adv. P. 569, i. 457, 1791, iv. 2877.

froise, *s.* iv. 2732, pancake.

fronce, *see* **frounce**.

front, **frount**, *s.* i. 1685, iv. 1349, v. 6305, forehead.

frosen, (*pp.*) *a.* vi. 245.

frost, *s.* vii. 282, viii. 2851.

frosti, *a.* vii. 1205.

frounce, **fronce**, *s.* ii. 392, vi. 770, vii. 1594, wrinkle, obstruction.

frounce (up), *v.a.* i. 1589, wrinkle.

froward, *prep.* P. 863, away from.

fruit, *s.* i. 2822, v. 278,

fruyt, v. 374.

fuisoune, *v.a.* viii. 1992, supply in abundance.

fulfille, *v.a.* i. 856, 1290, v. 256,

pret. **fulfelde**, v. 1246,

pp. **fulfild**, i. 895, ii. 909,

fulfilt, viii. 2211;
v.n. vii. 1584: fill, perform; suffice.

fulgrowe, a. i. 2818.

fulhard, a. viii. 2777.

full, a. P. 399, 558,
ful, P. 89, ii. 598,
def. **fulle**, iv. 3705,
full, i. 1629,
pl. **fulle**, v. 822, 2204.

full, **ful**, *adv.* P. 451, 787, i. 1171, 1178, ii. 607.

fulle, s. ii. 2826, iv. 948, 2896.

fully, **fulli**, *adv.* i. 1292, 2047, 2769,
fulliche, i. 1757, ii. 1326,
fullich, iii. 2661.

fulmanye, a. viii. 2408, very many.

fulofte, *adv.* P. 507, &c.,
fullofte, i. 662,
fulofte tyme, i. 1382,
cp. iii. 41,
ful ofte, P. 463,
full ofte, ii. 2330.

fulsore, *adv.* vii. 3153*.

fulwoful, a. i. 3000.

fulwonne, v.a.pp. vii. 736, fully won.

funke, s. vi. 512, spark.

furgh, s. iv. 1846, v. 3527, furrow, (furlong).

furlong, s. v. 1991.

furred, a. i. 627.

further(e), *adv.* i. 105, 2447, ii. 78, iii. 81,
forther(e), ii. 1191, iii. 2747, vii. 3648.

furthermor(e), forthermor, *adv.* ii. 626, 1164, iii. 942, iv. 2858,
forthere mor, iii. 885.

fy, *interj.* i. 616, iv. 610.

fyf, *see fyve*.

fyhte, *see feihte*.

fynde, *see finde*.

fyne, *v.a.* iv. 2456, *refine*.

fyne, *a. see fin*.

fyr, *s.* P. 344, ii. 164,
on fyre, iii. 16,
be the fyr, iv. 2724,
fer, iii. 694,
pl. fyres, iii. 1039.

fyrdrake, *s.* vii. 323, *fiery dragon*.

fyre, *s.* ii. 150, *bolt (of a crossbow)*.

fyre, fire, *v.a.* P. 222, i. 1174, ii. 2946, iv. 2088, viii. 2775, *set on fire*.

fyri, firy, *a.* i. 144, 2002, iv. 1020, 1274.

fyve, five, *num.* i. 296, 545, 2163,
fyf, vii. 1706.

G

gabbe, *v.n.* ii. 1937, *lie*.

Gabie, vii. 4621 ff.

Gabiens, *pl.* vii. 4612 ff.

gadre, *v.a.* v. 1287, 3999;
pres. part. gaderende,
v.n. iii. 858.

gaignage, *s.* iii. 2347, *harvest*.

Galahot, viii. 2502.

Galathe(e), ii. 108 ff.

Galba, vi. 538, 563.

galeie, s. ii. 2543, v. 3915, vii. 3300, viii. 513.

galle, s. iii. 703, v. 1481, vi. 341, vii. 461 ff.

galled, *pp.* iv. 1344.

game, s. P. 462, i. 1542, ii. 269, iii. 44, viii. 678, 2931, 3087*,

gamen, i. 347, v. 6314, viii. 680,

diverse game, vi. 1849,

in game, ii. 528, iii. 549,

on pure g., iii. 733,

a game, viii. 2319.

gamme, s. vii. 172, scale (of music).

gan, *see ginne*.

gape, *v.n.* vii. 3320.

gardin, s. i. 3144, vii. 2279.

garlandes, *s.pl.* viii. 2467.

garnement, s. i. 2510, v. 7189*.

gaspe, *v.n.* v. 3975, 4064.

gastly (-li), *a.* v. 2745, 5062, vii. 4721, fearful.

gate, s. P. 439, i. 299, 2134, iv. 1001, v. 3329 f., vii. 3313*,

gate tre, iv. 3593; gate, way.

gaudes, *s.pl.* viii. 2906.

gay, *a.* i. 2704, v. 3106.

Gayus Caligula, viii. 202.

Gayus Fabricius, vii. 2784.

geant, s. ii. 155, 2167, iv. 2075,

pl. **geantz**, v. 1091.

Geber, iv. 2608.

Gebuz, vii. 1463.

Gedeon, vii. 3633 ff.

Gelboë, iv. 1952.

Gemini, vii. 1031 ff., 1267.

generacion, s. iv. 2227.

general, *a.* P. 384, ii. 2804, 3084, v. 1700,
in general, P. 431, i. 1502.

Genesi, v. 1602, viii. 42.

genitals, *s.pl.* v. 855.

Genius, i. 196, iv. 2771, vii. 1, viii. 2306, 2809, 2893.

gentil, *a.* P. 61*, i. 2665, ii. 1180, iv. 206, 2223,
gentile, v. 2713, viii. 2294:
s. the gentils, iv. 2199, v. 1271.

gentillesse, **-esce**, s. i. 1436, 1721, iii. 2699, iv. 2202,
gentillesse, viii. 730.

geomance, vi. 1295, divination by earth.

geometrie, s. vii. 151.

Geptes, *pl.* i. 2466.

gerarchie, s. vii. 1773, rule.

gerdil, s. v. 6866.

gere, s. i. 1996, v. 2984, 3663.

gert, *pp.* v. 3965.

gesse, s. i. 1889, vii. 3548,
al to gesses, v. 840,
withoute gesses, v. 1136.

gesse, *v.a.n.* P. 64, i. 896, iv. 282, 881, vi. 1592.

gest, *s.*,
pl. gestes, v. 493, guest.

geste, s. v. 5275,
pl. gestes, v. 6359, vii. 4313, story.

Geta, Gete, ii. 2477 ff.

gete(n), v.a. (n.) P. 312, i. 628, 793, iv. 2124,
get, (*inf.*) ii. 60,
3 s.pres. get, v. 6086,
pret. gat, i. 3420, iv. 136,
pp. gete, ii. 977, 1813, *get*, *beget*.

getinge, s. vii. 2309.

Ghenbal, vi. 1320.

gibet, s. iii. 2104.

Gibiere, vi. 1323.

gilt, *see gult*.

ginne, v.n.,
3 s.pres. ginth, v. 6010,
pret. gan, i. 110, 114, 199, &c.,
pl. gonnen, v. 3764.

gknawe, *see gnawe*.

glad, a. P. 55*, i. 158,
gladd, v. 495,
pl. glade, P. 299, i. 1114;
compar. gladdere, iv. 1543,
gladder, v. 5373;
sup. gladdest, vii. 2422.

glade(n), v.a. i. 2767, iv. 3199;
v.n. i. 2738, ii. 2737, vi. 1211;
refl. i. 2532, vii. 2605: *gladden*; *rejoice*.

gladly, *adv.* ii. 284, 2032.

gladnesse, s. i. 90, ii. 223, iv. 2784.

gladschipe, s. i. 3128, ii. 229,
gladschip, iii. 72.

glas, s. ii. 1921, v. 2154, mirror.
glede, s. iii. 39, hot coal.
glistre, v.n. i. 1137, v. 3734, vii. 815.
Glodeside, i. 2575 ff.
gloire, s. P. 262, i. 2677, 2720.
glorious, s. v. 6815, vii. 890.
glose, s. i. 271, vii. 2171, comment, flattery.
glose, v.a. i. 1254, vii. 3786, explain, conceal;
 v.n. v. 6537, vii. 2172, 2531, 3973, flatter, cajole.
glotonie, s. vi. 543, 1161.
glotoun, s. v. 1058, 1469.
glove, s. P. 357, iii. 2154, v. 7047.
glu, s. v. 3603.
glyde, v.n. v. 5062, vii. 326,
 pret. **glod**, v. 3967.
gnawe, **gknawe**, v.a.n. ii. 520, vi. 372,
 pp. **gnawe**, iii. 2014.
go, **gon**, v.n. P. 17, 697, i. 1444, 1514, iv. 1583, &c.,
 refl. i. 1619, 2177;
 3 s.pres. **goth**, P. 269, i. 933, 1619,
 geth, ii. 1804, 2616, iii. 2300,
 imperat. **go**, i. 1261,
 go we, i. 1769,
 goth, v. 2343,
 pp. **go**, **gon**, P. 132, i. 87,
 (**goon**, viii. 3033, PP. 102),
 time **go**, iv. 297,
 go, **gon**, (= ago), i. 64, ii. 2096.
god, s. P. 27, 72, i. 836,
 godd, i. 921, 1903,
 genit. **goddes**, i. 855,

godes, i. 2718,
(**goddis**, PP. 32),
pl. **goddes**, ii. 190.

goddesse, s. i. 125, iii. 753, v. 839, 1151,
godesse, i. 235, 369, 805.

a goddeshalf, v. 4452 (*see note*),
cp. v. 5016.

Godefroi, PP. 283.

Godelie, vii. 2553.

godespourveiance, s. PP. 21 (MS.).

godhede, **godhiede**, s. P. 192, 498, iii. 2523, v. 1102.

godward, i. 869.

gold, s. P. 205, i. 1101, 2537, iii. 1701.

golde, *a.* P. 631, v. 6780.

goldhord, s. v. 2118, hoard of gold.

goldring, s. ii. 2607, v. 2202.

gone, *v.n.* v. 4064, gape.

good, *a.* P. 4, 88*, 146, &c.,
def. **goode**, P. 459, i. 1257,
good, i. 2764,
voc. **goode**, i. 3147,
pl. **goode**, P. 42, i. 2976;
as subst. v. 3831.

good, s. P. 249, i. 1183, v. 4926,
pl. **goodes**, i. 628, v. 4984, wealth, kindness.

goode, s. P. 237, i. 1150, 2773, iv. 2369, goodness, advantage.

goodlihiede, s. iv. 608.

goodly, **goodli**, *a.* i. 152, 2422, 3137, ii. 19,
goodlych, ii. 2026:
adv. **goodliche**, ii. 787,

goodli, goodly, iv. 152, vii. 5362.

goodnesse, s. P. 485.

goodschipe, s. iv. 2173, vi. 1474.

gore, s. v. 5730, cloak, cover.

Gorgones, i. 402.

gorgonza, vii. 1367 (name of a stone).

goshauk, s. iv. 2935, v. 5644.

gospell, gospel, s. P. 967, iii. 2492, v. 1794.

gost, s. iv. 574.

gostly, gostli, a. P. 420, ii. 2818, v. 1948,
gostliche, v. 1855:
adv. gostli, v. 1874.

got, s. vii. 345, 1171, goat.

governance, s. P. 108, i. 3391, v. 971,
governaunce, P. 187.

governe, *v.a.n.* P. 721, i. 43, 2009, viii. 947,
refl. i. 2621.

governour, s. iii. 2729, v. 1016.

governynge, s. PP. 31.

Gower, viii. 2321, 2908, PP. 374.

grace, s. P. 89, i. 732, 859, 1684, 2158, ii. 2630,
pl. graces, i. 51, grace, favour, pardon.

gracious, a. i. 137, ii. 562, 3080, v. 409, favourable, kind, favoured.

gradde, *v.n.pret.* iii. 1692, v. 5004;
v.a. vi. 445: cried out, cried out for.

gramaire, s. vii. 1528 ff.

grame, s. iii. 48, 734, trouble.

grant, graunt, s. i. 793, 1449, ii. 1505, v. 969, permission, gift.

grantdame, s. i. 1445.

grante(n), v.a.n. P. 92, i. 1828, 2597,
graunte, ii. 1463, viii. 3110*.

grant merci (-y), i. 1832, 1902, ii. 2313, 3366, thanks.

grape, s. v. 1230, viii. 2849.

gras, s. i. 352, 2844, vii. 1306,
grass, vii. 289,
pl. grasses, i. 2976, grass, herb.

grase, v.n. i. 2974.

grave, s. i. 1838, ii. 1525.

grave(n), v.a.pp. i. 555, iii. 2078, iv. 3672, engraved, buried.

gravel, s. v. 311.

Grece, P. 717, i. 1108, ii. 1644, iii. 1828, 2310, 2547, iv. 1872, v. 817,
1337, 1560, 1592, 3247, 3359, 3685, 3902, 3927, 4022, 4249, 7199
ff., vii. 887, viii. 2515, 2631, 2706.

Grecs, *see Grek*.

grede, *see gradde*.

gredi, a. v. 2006.

gredily, *adv.* v. 2240,
griedili, v. 2017.

(**greede**, v.n. v. 394*, desire.)

Gregeis, a. v. 3311:
cp. Gregois.

Gregoire, P. 284, 945, v. 1746 ff., 1901, 6396*.

Gregois, s. iv. 2401, Greek (language),
pl. Gregois, Gregeis, i. 1117, 1162, iii. 970 ff., 1759, iv. 1819, 2147, v.
3074, 3753, 3778, 7580, vii. 3059, Greeks:
cp. Grek.

greie, greye, a.pl. v. 2473, 6305, vii. 4418.

grein, s. P. 320, ii. 3310, v. 1885, vi. 770, grain, condition.

greine, v.n. v. 823, 7626, bear corn, ripen.

Grek, s. iv. 2627, Greek (language), vi. 1314, viii. 2544;

pl. **Greks**, **Grecs**, P. 696, i. 1080, ii. 1807, iii. 1889 ff., 2677, iv. 1699,
v. 1056 ff., 1304 ff., 3148, 7356,

Grekes, v. 1365, 1455, 3355.

grene, a. P. 935, i. 113, 778, ii. 496, vii. 4618, 5040,

greene, iv. 1491, 2309, green, fresh.

grene, s. i. 682, 2348,

griene, iv. 3325, green field;

greene, vii. 1168, greenness.

gret, a. P. 226, iv. 1837,

grete, iv. 453, v. 5737,

def. **grete**, P. 748, ii. 588,

pl. P. 78, i. 2683;

as subst. i. 3365;

compar. **grettere**, iv. 1459,

gretere, vi. 2219;

sup. **greteste**, ii. 599.

grete, v., *see* **griete**.

gretli, **gretly**, *adv.* P. 164, ii. 2834, iii. 1321.

grevable, a. iv. 309, grievous.

grevance, s. i. 1308, 1500, ii. 1657, iii. 296,

grievance, vi. 969, harm, grief.

greve, s. v. 4015, v. 5965, grove.

greven, v., *see* **grieve**.

grevous, a. v. 469, vii. 3258.

griedili, *see* **gredily**.

grief, s. ii. 210, iii. 2724.

griete, v.a. v. 5583,

3 s.pres. **gret**, vi. 1742,

pret. **grette**, vii. 4520,
imperat. **griet**, i. 2433,
gret, viii. 2941*, greet.

grietinge, s. i. 2425.

grievance, *see* **grevance**.

grieve, **greve(n)**, *v.a.n.* P. 283, i. 326, ii. 119, iii. 10, vi. 367;
impers. P. 1086, i. 2011, ii. 54: hurt, vex, do injury, be vexed.

grinde, *v.a.*,
3 *pl. pret.* **grounde**, iii. 3.

gripe, s.,
genit. **gripes**, i. 2545, griffin.

grisel, s. viii. 2407.

grith, iii. 1847, protection.

grom, s. ii. 3408, servant.

grone, *v.n.* iv. 3170, v. 539, vi. 2113.

grope, v. ii. 3015, v. 103, viii. 2795.

Grossteste, iv. 234.

groucche, *see* **grucche**.

ground, s. P. 1062, i. 473, ii. 3432,
to **grounde**, i. 119, 2051,
upon **grounde**, i. 2300,
upon the **ground**, i. 2830,
fro the **grounde**, v. 160,
fro the **ground**, v. 5702,
unto the **grounde**, v. 5007.

grounded, *pp.* ii. 1753, iv. 1966, vii. 1433, viii. 1993, based, composed,
disposed.

groundles, *a.* vii. 4827, bottomless.

growe, *v.n.* P. 163, 511, ii. 46, iv. 3006,
pret.pl. **grewe**, i. 2084,

pp. **growen**, i. 553, iii. 152.
growinge, s. P. 952.
grucche, *v.n.* i. 1264, 1349, v. 545, 4852,
groucche, vii. 2193, complain.
grucchinge, s. ii. 2222.
guide, s. P. 145, 391, ii. 1328.
guide, **guyde**, *v.a.* P. 128, ii. 1884, 7702, direct, carry on.
guie, **guye**, *v.a.* vii. 1673, 1774, viii. 2660.
guile, s. i. 890, ii. 479,
 (**guyle**, PP. 308).
guile, *v.a.n.* ii. 1915, v. 3204.
Guilliam de Langharet, ii. 2995.
guilour, s. vi. 1381, 2015.
guise, s. i. 2696, 2706, viii. 676, fashion.
gule, s. vi. 10, 629, gluttony.
gulion, s. v. 6861, tunic, garment.
gult, **gilt**, i. 1880, 3334, ii. 1935, iv. 886, 1223, guilt.
gulte, *v.n.* ii. 3294, be guilty.
gulteles, *a.* ii. 1702, 2153, iii. 870,
gylteles, vi. 728.
gultif, **gultyf**, *a.* i. 558, 2448, ii. 873, guilty.
Gunnore, viii. 2502, Guinevere.
Gurmond, i. 2466,
genit. **Gurmondes**, **Gurmoundes**, i. 2474 ff.
guye, *see* **guie**.
gylteles, *see* **gulteles**.

H

ha, *interj.* i. 1659, iii. 462,

ha lord, i. 2207,

Ha mercy, iii. 225,

A godd, iv. 3622.

habit, *s.* iv. 2575.

habitable, *a.* vii. 586.

Habraham,

genit. **Habrahammes**, v. 1628, 1650, vi. 1023 ff., vii. 1473, viii. 98 ff.

haft, *s.* iv. 926.

hail, *s.* vii. 296.

hale, *v.a.n.* ii. 2354, v. 5023, 5431, vii. 273.

half, **halve**, *s.* P. 133, 395, i. 1062, ii. 2787, iii. 1071, iv. 241, side, half;

a goddes half, v. 5016, in God's name,

cp. v. 4452,

in Cristes halve, PP. 120, for Christ's sake:

adv. **half**, ii. 1955, iv. 1857.

halfdede, *a.pl.* vi. 594.

halfdrunke, *a.* vi. 58.

halfwode, *a.* vi. 513, half mad.

haliday, *s.* v. 7058.

halle, *s.* i. 2113, 2201, iv. 1325.

hals, *s.* v. 2914, neck.

halsen, *v.a.* iv. 3074, explain (as an omen).

halten, *v.n.* iii. 917, v. 1348,

pret. **haltede**, iv. 1345, go lame.

haltres, *s.pl.* iv. 1357 ff.

halve, *see* **half**.

halvendel, *s.* v. 2109, 4985, half.

halvinge, **halvyng**, *adv.* iv. 1885, viii. 2319, 2397,

halfvinge, vii. 3398.

halwe, v.a. v. 7051,
pp. halwed, v. 7028*.

hand, *see* **hond**.

handle, v.a. P. 65*, iii. 1956,
(pp. **handlid**, PP. 321).

hange, **honge**, v.n. i. 1479, 1682, 2181, iii. 1555, 2105, iv. 303,
pret. pl. **hyngen**, iv. 1358;
v.a. v. 6560,
pret. **hyng**, iii. 2181, iv. 860,
heng, ii. 3094, viii. 2905,
pl. **hinge**, v. 1722,
pp. **honged**, v. 2811, vi. 1514.

hansell, s. v. 7160.

Hanybal, v. 2054, 2198.

hapne, v.*impers.* ii. 2234, iii. 2652, iv. 734;
pers. v. 7831: happen, appear.

happ, i. 1717, iii. 70,
hap, i. 67,
pl. **happes**, ii. 2547, v. 2249, fortune, chance.

happe, v.n. v. 2336, viii. 1127;
impers. ii. 718, iii. 1357:
cp. **hapne**.

happi, a. iv. 367.

hard, a. P. 640, i. 2330, iv. 3583, v. 452,
def. **harde**, i. 2985,
pl. **harde**, ii. 3027, iv. 2105;
superl. **hardest**, P. 733.

harde, *adv.* i. 1050, ii. 1821.

hardi, **hardy**, a. ii. 2621, iii. 539, 2404, iv. 161.

hardiesce(-esse), s. iv. 2015, 2088, vii. 1861.

hardinesse, s. iv. 1966.

hardnesse, s. iv. 2495, 2557.

hare, s. P. 1061, iv. 2720, vii. 3776.

harm, s. P. 344, ii. 370, iii. 757, v. 716,
pl. harmes, iv. 881, v. 3360.

harme, v.a. vii. 1135, 4354.

harneis, s. v. 3109, vi. 1652, vii. 3326*, suit of armour, trappings.

harpe, s. P. 1055, iv. 2418, viii. 758.

harpe, v. P. 1073, v. 922, viii. 1670.

haste, s. P. 650, i. 2201, ii. 1542.

haste(n), v.n. ii. 1541, iii. 1652, iv. 290;
refl. i. 2302, ii. 1831;
v.a. iii. 1656, 1723, v. 3342.

hastely, *adv.* v. 4044.

hastifesse, s. v. 1482.

hastihiede, s. v. 3532.

hastyf, **hastif**, a. iv. 1629, v. 6286.

hat, s. ii. 1872.

hate, s. P. 128, i. 1844, iii. 285.

hate(n), v.a. P. 927, 997, i. 2454, iii. 935.

hatte, v. *see hote*.

hauberk, s. v. 3170.

hawk, s. i. 2672, v. 4725, 6129.

haunte, v.a. i. 2656, ii. 482, v. 1956, practise.

have, v. P. 61, i. 3344, v. 2839,
2 s.pres. **hast**, i. 176,
3 s. **hath**, P. 88, 130,
3 pl. **have**, i. 1361, &c.,

han, i. 1021,
pret. hadde(n), P. 227, &c.,
hade, iv. 650, viii. 1430,
had, v. 5865,
pp. had, P. 62,
hadd, i. 129, v. 113.

haveles, *a.* v. 2506, 6968, destitute.

havene, *s.* iii. 1038, v. 7557, viii. 1275.

havinge, *s.* vii. 2274, possession.

he, *pron.* P. 69,
him, P. 15, 88,
hem (*pl. obl.*) P. 1, 155, 415,
him (= himself), P. 676, i. 26,
(**hym**, viii. 3089),
hem (= themselves), i. 625.

hebenus, *s.* iv. 3017.

Hebreu, *s.* iv. 2398, 2653, Hebrew (language);
Hebreus, vii. 4417, viii. 138,
thebreus, vii. 3054.

Hector, iv. 2141, v. 2550, 7332,
Ector, viii. 2526, PP. 281.

Hecuba, v. 7308.

hed, *s.* (1) P. 605, i. 2535, iii. 1212 (of a cask), iv. 236,
heved, P. 152, i. 1536,
hefd, i. 199,
on hede, vii. 846,
on hevede, vii. 1108,
of hed, iv. 3439 (*see note*),
pl. hefdes, vii. 4694,
hevedes, viii. 369; head:
as a. vii. 811, viii. 3013*, chief.

hed, *s.* (2) ii. 2066, condition (?).

heiere, *see* **hih**.

heihte, **heyhte**, s. i. 2820, vii. 180,
 on (upon) heihte, P. 1019, i. 467, 2673,
 upon heighte, iv. 2124, vii. 1121.

heil, *a.* i. 703, 2122, healthy, wholesome.

heir, s. i. 1429, ii. 1320,
 eir, iii. 2708,
 hair, ii. 2578, iv. 1252.

helas, *interj.* i. 974, 3183, iii. 1472:
 cp. **allas**.

hele, s. P. 278, 397, i. 1821, 2761, v. 2835,
 soule hele, P. 749, ii. 1313; health, salvation, profit.

hele, *v.a.* (1) P. 398,
 heelee, vii. 1568, heal.

hele, *v.a.* (2), ii. 1955, iii. 779, 2756, v. 4033;
 v.n. ii. 2056: conceal, cover.

Heleine (1), **Heleyne**, v. 3073, 7472 ff.,
 Eleine, viii. 2529, Helen (of Troy).

Heleine (2), ii. 3471, (mother of Constantine).

Heleine (3), ii. 1200, 1437.

Helenus, v. 7461, 7569.

hell, **hel**, s. i. 424, ii. 163, iv. 1980, 2991, vii. 3721,
 hull, P. 618, v. 1573, vii. 3706,
 pl. **helles**, iii. 1035,
 hulles, v. 3996, hill.

helle, s. P. 456, i. 3410, ii. 3135, v. 29,
 helle king, iv. 2851.

Hellen, v. 4257.

Hellican, viii. 575.

Helmege, i. 2592 ff.

helpe, help, s. P. 801, i. 2639, ii. 1329, 1516, iv. 986.

helpe(n), *v.a.n.* i. 25, 820, iv. 2291,
pret. halp, i. 421, 1947,
imperat. help, v. 4970.

helpeles, *a.* ii. 1394, viii. 1125, PP. 263.

helpinge, s. v. 4695.

helplich, *a.* iii. 503, vi. 1324.

helthe, s. P. 96, 1052, i. 2496, health, salvation.

hemself, *pl.* P. 302, 682, i. 1016,
hemselve(n), P. 351, ii. 98, vii. 2436.

hen, s. v. 4101,
pl. hennes, viii. 159.

hende, *a. as subst.* iv. 644, graceful creature.

Henri, P. 87, PP. 358,
Henry, PP. 1,
genit. Henries, PP. 272.

hente, *v.a.* iv. 2798, 2890,
pret. hente, i. 144, ii. 1274,
pp. hent, i. 3379, take, seize.

hep, s. iv. 3008, great quantity.

hepe, s. v. 2872, hook.

hepehalt, *a.* v. 957, lame.

her, s. i. 2181, v. 3964,
pl. heres, i. 2999, hair.

her, *pron. see here.*

herald, s. i. 2403,
pl. heraldz, i. 2526, iv. 1632.

heraldie, s. ii. 399, *see note.*

herbage, *see therbage.*

herbe, s. v. 3802, vi. 1408, vii. 1317 ff.

herber, s. iv. 833.

herbergage, s. ii. 1337, iv. 82, vii. 1069, lodging.

herbergour, s. ii. 1329.

Hercules, ii. 2154 ff., iv. 2057 ff., v. 1083, 1474, 3294, 3470, 3668, 3878, 6808 ff., 7198, 7217, vii. 3348, viii. 2506, 2560.

here, v. *see* **hiere**.

here, **her**, *pron. poss.* P. 51, 154, &c., their:
here tuo, v. 7651, of them two.

Heredot, iv. 2413.

heresie, s. P. 350.

heringe, **hieringe**, s. i. 449, vi. 909, vii. 3770.

heritage, s. i. 2619, ii. 1025,
pl. **heritages**, vii. 2008.

herke, v.*imperat.* ii. 1226,
herk, v. 5878, listen.

herkne, v.*a.n.* i. 96, 329, 1596, 2780, ii. 1999, 2037, listen to, listen.

Hermes, iv. 2606, vii. 1437, 1476.

Hermyngheld, **Hermyngheld**, ii. 749 ff.

herre, s.,
out of h., P. 962, ii. 2964, iii. 72, PP. 185, off the hinges, out of order.

hert, i. 371, 2299, iv. 1300, hart.

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kepe, *s.* P. 179, i. 1179,
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kepe(n), *v.a.n.* P. 150, 475, i. 746, ii. 803,
3 s.pres. **kepeth**, P. 321,
kepeth, v. 4691,
pret. **kepte**, P. 596, i. 2052, v. 5754, vii. 5261,
kept, ii. 181,
imperat. **kep**, i. 1227, iii. 1498, PP. 367,
pp. **kept**, P. 147: keep, hold, take care of, regard, wait for; take care,
expect.

kepere, *s.* v. 4675, vii. 2659,
pl. **kepers**, ii. 941.

keping(e), i. 2131, v. 1467, viii. 2638.

kerf, s. v. 757, carving.

kerse, s. iii. 588, 1652, cress.

kertell, s. v. 6915,
pl. kertles, iv. 1315.

kerve, v.a. vi. 66, cut.

kesse, *see kisse*.

keye, *see keie*.

kid, kidd, *pp.* iii. 206, v. 2957, 5124, known.

kiele, v.n. v. 6908, grow cool;
v.a. vi. 736, 1065, cool, allay.

kin, *see ken*.

kinde, kynde, s. P. 535, 733, i. 11, 31, 917, 1624,
kende, v. 4637;
lawe of kynde, i. 2231,
kinde of man, v. 2: nature, manner, race.

kinde, a. iii. 2597, 2706, iv. 502, vii. 4298, kind, natural.

kindely, *adv.* ii. 1381, naturally.

kindeschipe, s. ii. 325, v. 4910.

kindly, a. ii. 2740, vii. 1094, natural.

king, kyng, s. P. 25, 186, 256, i. 1094, 2062, 2141.

kingdom, s. i. 2968, vii. 4316, viii. 2112,
kyngdom, viii. 3087.

kingeshalve, s. ii. 1042, king's behalf.

kingesriche, s. v. 4202, kingdom.

kinghede (-hode), s. vii. 1714, 1765, 3530.

kinled, *pp.* vii. 340, kindled.

kisse, kesse, v.a. iii. 169, iv. 2824,

pret. **keste**, P. 109, i. 2053, ii. 1522,
kiste, i. 912, ii. 1441,
kist, v. 3777,
kest, vi. 1746,
pp. **kest**, iv. 500.

kiste, s. v. 83, 2306, viii. 1230, chest.

kiththe, s. v. 4180, vi. 123, 2087, kith, knowledge.

knape, s. viii. 1374, knave.

Knaresburgh, ii. 943 ff., 1264 ff.

knave, s. iii. 1782, v. 114, 201, vii. 1836, servant;
knave child, iv. 432, v. 4255, boy.

kne, s. P. 609, ii. 772, v. 6566,
pl. **knes**, knees, i. 213, 3145, iii. 223.

knele, v.n. i. 935, 3027, iv. 1172.

knette, v.a. i. 1420, vii. 1592,
pret. **knette**, iv. 858,
knet, v. 6866,
pp. **knet**, v. 4966, fasten together, bind, combine.

knif, **knyf**, s. ii. 830, iii. 1108, v. 4001.

kniht, **knyhthode**, &c., *see* **knyht**, &c.

knowe(n), v.a.n. P. 72, 140, i. 1579,
pret. **knew**, i. 1009, 2341,
kneu, v. 2665, 5410,
kniew, iv. 1838,
knewh, ii. 2891,
2 s. **knewe**, vi. 2313,
pl. **knewe(n)**, P. 106, ii. 3210,
pret. subj. **knewe**, i. 1312,
imperat. **know**, vii. 2389,
pp. **knowe**, i. 1191, 2134;
knowende of, iii. 864, vi. 1398,
knowe of, v. 5356, acquainted (with).

knowleching(e), s. P. 860, i. 1483, ii. 1282, v. 2992,
knouleching(e), iv. 3202, vi. 982,
pl. **knowlechinges**, vii. 137.

konne, *see* **conne**.

knyf, *see* **knif**.

knyht, **kniht**, s. P. 707, i. 316, ii. 587,
(**knight**, **knyght**, vii. 3169*, viii. 3059, PP. 243).

knyhthode, **knihtthode**, s. P. 89, ii. 1640, 2513,
knyhthod, **knihtthod**, i. 1436, v. 2057,
(**knyghthode**, viii. 3021, PP. 155), knighthood, valour.

knyhtlihiede, s. vii. 3592.

knyhtly (-li), **knihtly (-li)**, *a.* ii. 727, 2625, v. 661, vi. 95.

krepel, s. vii. 1854, cripple.

kressette, s. vii. 3743, cup (for a light).

kutte, **cutte**, *v.a.pret.* ii. 831, iii. 823,
kut, vii. 4525,
pp. **cut**, v. 6520.

kynde, *see* **kinde**.

kyng, **kyngdom**, *see* **king**, **kingdom**.

L

Laar, iii. 819.

Laban, viii. 122.

laborious, *a.* iv. 2636.

labour, s. i. 3252, iii. 665, iv. 2396.

laboure, *v.n.* iv. 242, 1691;
v.a. iv. 970.

labourer, s. iv. 2440, vi. 136,
laborer, viii. 3061.

lacche, *v.a.* P. 410, ii. 109, seize.

lachesce, **lachesse**, *s.* iv. 4, 281.

Lachesis, iv. 2761.

lacke, **lack**, *s.* P. 393, i. 1988, iv. 335, 1070, v. 6077, want, fault:
cp. **lak**.

lacke, *v.n.* P. 428, i. 1366, 2396, 3023,
lakke, ii. 2392,
impers. **lacketh**, viii. 2427 ff.,
cp. vi. 908, be wanting:
v.a. ii. 530, iii. 2630, iv. 343, want.

laden, *pp.* viii. 469.

ladi, **lady**, *s.* i. 162, 317,
genit. **ladi**, **lady**, i. 924, 1263, ii. 40, iv. 1437,
pl. **ladis**, **ladys**, iv. 1307, v. 3139.

ladischipe, *s.* i. 2577, iv. 1120, 1730, vi. 271, 1946, ladyship, honour.

ladiward, ii. 255, iii. 508.

Ladon, v. 1015.

ladre, *s.* viii. 1644, ladder.

laghtre, *s.* viii. 2685, laughter.

lak, *s.* i. 1691, ii. 394, iii. 561, iv. 128, v. 6290, fault.

lame, *a.* v. 2709.

Lamedon, v. 3303, 7197 ff.,
Lamenedon, viii. 2516.

lampe, *s.* iv. 258, viii. 2776.

Lampes, vii. 856.

Lancastre, P. 87.

lance, *s.* viii. 2270.

lancegay, *s.* viii. 2798.

Lancelot, iv. 2035, viii. 2501.

langage, s. P. 1023, iv. 315.

Langharet, ii. 2995.

lanterne, s. iv. 817.

Laodomie, iv. 1905.

lapacia, vii. 1375.

lape, *v.n.* vii. 3671, lap.

lapis, iv. 2535 ff.

lappe, s. iv. 303.

lappe, *v.a.* v. 4207, 5774, wrap.

lappewincke, s. v. 6041.

larder, s. v. 5513, vii. 1166.

large, *a.* P. 239, i. 876, 2821, wide, liberal;

at large, P. 46*, ii. 994, iii. 174, iv. 829.

largely, *adv.* ii. 953,

largeliche, vii. 2052.

largesse, **largesce**, s. P. 225, v. 409, 1958, 7633 ff., vii. 1989 ff.,
liberality, gift.

las, s. vii. 4332, lace.

lasse, *a.comp.* P. 20, 57*, 947, i. 476, ii. 2260,

lesse, v. 2529;

as subst. iii. 93, iv. 2240:

adv. **lasse**, P. 629, i. 263, 1927,

lesse, i. 1925, v. 4739: less.

lasse, *v.a.* P. 56, i. 1836, 2401;

v.n. iv. 782: make less; grow less.

last, *a.* P. 642, vii. 1215,

def. **laste**, P. 826:

as subst. **my laste**, iii. 304,

ate l., P. 369, i. 1820,
to the l., P. 250, i. 983, viii. 2784,
as for the l., viii. 2889.

laste, *adv.* iv. 3383,
last, vii. 4098.

laste(n), *v.n.* P. 249, 662, iii. 289, v. 279,
pret. **laste**, P. 672, iv. 2315, last, endure.

late, *a.* ii. 345, iv. 878,
thoghte al to late til, ii. 1538;
comp. **latere**, viii. 1323.

late, *adv.* i. 1645, iv. 1421, late; i. 1843, iii. 219, lately.

Latewar, iv. 252;
cp. iv. 1421.

laththe, s. iii. 84.

Latin, s. ii. 3187, iv. 2638, 2656, Latin (language):
the Latins, iv. 2634:
a. latin, vi. 981.

Latona, v. 1249 ff.

latoun, s. ii. 1850, viii. 569, bronze.

laude, s. vii. 1384, praise.

launde, s. iv. 1290, viii. 2160.

lave, *v.a.* viii. 1856.

laverock, s. v. 4100.

Lavine, iv. 2187.

lawe, s. P. 102, i. 809, 2793,
(*pl.* **lawis**, viii. 3031):
cp. lay.

laweles, *a.* ii. 2962, vi. 1256.

lawhe, *v.n.* ii. 245, iv. 641,
lawghe, v. 479,

laghe, viii. 2491,
leyhe, v. 3781,
3 s.pret. **lowh**, **louh**, i. 1766, ii. 3320, vi. 2034,
low, P. 1071,
3 pl.pret. **lowhen (to scorne)**, v. 696, 6931; laugh.

lay, s. (1), iv. 109, v. 1191, lake.

lay, s. (2), vii. 1046, viii. 1670, song.

lay, s. (3), ii. 3354, viii. 2663, law.

Lazar, vi. 1037 ff.

lazre, s. vi. 996, leper.

leche, s. ii. 3220, 3296, vi. 866, viii. 1209, physician, remedy.

lecherie, s. v. 1046, 1493, vii. 799.

lecherous, *a.* v. 1410,
def. **lecherouse**, vii. 4994.

lechour, s. v. 872.

lecoun, s. iii. 1377, iv. 562.

led, s. iii. 1705, iv. 2471, viii. 1109.

lede(n), *v.a.* P. 793, i. 784, 2090, iii. 179, 341, iv. 987,
pret. **ladde**, P. 712, 771, i. 763, iii. 332, v. 1247,
ledde, iii. 2178, v. 677,
pp. **lad**, i. 1050, ii. 759,
ledd, vi. 870; lead, guide, manage, take.

ledere, s. v. 2055,
pl. **leders**, v. 7616, leader.

leding, s. vii. 5156, 5297.

leese, s. P. 408, meadow.

lef, s. i. 2884, iv. 586,
pl. **leves**, P. 935, i. 354, leaf.

left, s. iii. 301, left hand.

legges, *s.pl.* P. 611.

leiance, *s.* viii. 3058, allegiance.

leie, **lein**, *v.a.* i. 500, iv. 1747, v. 2889,

3 *s.pres.* **leith**, P. 382, i. 472,

leyth, P. 276,

3 *pl.* **leyn**, P. 476,

pret. **leide**, **leyde**, i. 1017, 2312, iv. 240,

pp. **leid**, **leyd**, P. 48*, i. 892, v. 7596,

laid, v. 4512,

imperat. **ley**, **lei**, i. 3434, ii. 1926, viii. 1420; lay, set, apply.

leisir, **leiser**, *s.* iii. 1907, iv. 2799, v. 158, 3435, 7035, time, convenience, opportunity.

lemes, *see* **lime**, *s.*

lemman, *s.* vii. 1899.

lene, *a.* iv. 1344, lean.

lene, *v.a.*,

pret. **lente**, i. 423,

pp. **lent**, v. 4128, lend.

leng, *adv. comp.* iii. 71, viii. 2055.

lengere, *adv. comp.* i. 1516, ii. 1434, 2602,

lenger, i. 147.

lengthe, *s.* iii. 1963, iv. 3255.

Leo (emperor), P. 739.

Leo (sign of the zodiac), vii. 1067 ff., 1249.

Leoncius, **Leonce**, vii. 3268 ff.

leonesse, *s.* iv. 1976.

Leonin, viii. 1410 ff.

leoun, **leon**, *s.* P. 1059, i. 2248, ii. 3035,

lyon, v. 5684.

lepard, *s.* iv. 1977.

lepe, *v.n.* iii. 916, vi. 187,
pret. lepte, i. 2051, ii. 2301,
imperat. lep, vii. 4782.

lepre, *s.* ii. 3192 ff., PP. 349, leprosy.

lere, **liere**, *v.* P. 868, i. 454, 2123, v. 2029, learn, teach.

lere, *s.* i. 1509, viii. 610, loss.

lered, *a.* viii. 3113, learned.

lerne, *v.a.n.* i. 44, 2010, ii. 1851, iii. 601, v. 3852, 6836, vii. 3146: teach,
inform, learn.

lerved, *a.* vii. 635, PP. 25.

les, *s.* v. 782, vii. 2684, falsehood.

Lesbon, *v.* 6436.

lese, *v.a.n.* P. 415, i. 1332, 1809, ii. 32,
3 s.pres. lest, ii. 256, iv. 1494,
pret. les, vi. 1772, vii. 3658; lose.

lesinge, **lesynge**, *s.* i. 679, 2268, ii. 409,
pl. lesinges, v. 946, lying.

lesse, *see lasse*.

lest, *v.imperat.* i. 827, 1876, listen.

lest, *v. see list*.

lest, *a.* i. 3249,
def. leste, vii. 1459;
ate leste, i. 277, 3259; least.

lest, *adv.* i. 1070, 2362,
leste, i. 3296.

let, *s. see lette*.

lete, *v.a.n.* i. 6, 3366, ii. 2253, iii. 2664, iv. 643,
3 s.pres. let, P. 509, ii. 1906,
leteth, vii. 390,
3 s.pret. let, P. 1020, i. 1011, ii. 2480, v. 5840,

imperat. **let**, **lett**, i. 220, 1618, 2834,
lete, vi. 450,
pp. **lete**, P. 440, ii. 3228 (shed), iv. 454;
let make, **let do**, &c., P. 1020, i. 1011, iv. 490,
lete by, v. 1004 (valued),
cp. v. 5840: leave, release, omit, let, cause.

Lethes, **Lethen**, iv. 3011, v. 1109.

lette, *v.a.n.* i. 38, 780, ii. 94, iii. 1873, 2213, iv. 795, 1481,
pret. **lette**, ii. 2240,
pp. **let**, P. 308, ii. 128, iii. 2044; hinder, delay, put off.

lette, s. ii. 93, 2129, iii. 2298, iv. 2000,
let, v. 3900, vii. 2779, hindrance.

lettre, s. P. 209, i. 2423, ii. 3038, iv. 2401, letter, writing.

lettyng, s. vii. 236, hindrance.

Leuchotoe, v. 6726.

leve, s. i. 857, 1162, 1469, 1807, ii. 113, iv. 1160,
token leve, i. 1162,
cp. ii. 2780, iv. 1381: leave.

leve(n), *v.a.n.* P. 404, i. 1311, 1558, 1808, 2693, 2940, iii. 1179, iv. 1159,
viii. 2881,
leeveth, iv. 3428,
pret. **lefte**, P. 743, i. 1673, v. 2389,
lafte, PP. 342,
pp. **laft**, v. 4056,
left, v. 4222,
imperat. **lef**, ii. 571, v. 5223; leave, leave off, omit.

leve, *v.n.* P. 412, iv. 1382,
pret. **lefte(n)**, P. 695, vii. 3682, remain.

leveful, *see* **lieffull**.

levein, s. iii. 446, leaven.

levene, s. vi. 2267, flash (of lightning).

levere, *a.comp.* P. 37, ii. 6,
 hath (hadde) l., i. 1511, ii. 1582, iii. 479,
 were l., ii. 530, iii. 762, iv. 1657:
 as subst. ii. 2449, v. 546:
 adv. iv. 1337: dearer, rather:
 cp. **lief**, **lievest**.

levest, *see* **lievest**.

lewed, *a.* i. 274, ii. 3423, iii. 479, unlearned, ignorant.

leyhe, *see* **lawhe**.

leyt, **leyte**, *s.* vii. 303, 308, flame.

leyte, *v.n.* vii. 307, blaze.

liberal, *a.* vii. 876.

liberalite, *s.* v. 7646.

liberte, *s.* vii. 2815.

Libra, vii. 1102 ff., 1258.

libraire, *s.* P. 321.

lich, *s.* viii. 1076, corpse.

lich, **liche**, *a.* P. 113, 634, ii. 3245, iv. 3649, v. 1550,
 lych, v. 29;
 lik, i. 488, ii. 1794, v. 615:
 adv. **lich**, P. 951, i. 2672, ii. 3033, 3456,
 lik, i. 1950.

Lichaon, **Lichao**, v. 6225, 6298, vii. 3355.

liche, *s.* i. 2277, 2791, iii. 2588, v. 7318,
 like, **lyke**, i. 2315, 2995, 3139, ii. 3037; likeness, match.

Lichomede, v. 2976 ff.

Lichorida, **Lychoride**, viii. 1033, 1350.

licke, *v.a.* vi. 928, 1015.

licuchis, vii. 824 (name of a stone).

Liddos, vii. 4369.

lie, s. *see* **lye**.

lie, lye, v.n. P. 124, i. 725, 1512, 2437, ii. 1603, iii. 1252, speak falsely.

Lie, viii. 125, Leah.

lie, v.n.,

3 s.pres. **lith, lyth**, P. 336, i. 161, 2429,

3 s.pret. **lay, lai**, P. 602, i. 1788, 2728,

3 pl. **lihe, lyhen**, ii. 1456, vii. 1797,

leie(n), iv. 479, v. 974,

2 s.pret. subj. **leye**, iv. 2849,

imperat. **ly**, vi. 2311,

pp. **leie**, iv. 2914, lein, vii. 2597; lie, be situated:

cp. **ligge**.

lief, a. ii. 209, vii. 4628,

lief ... loth, i. 1627, ii. 999, iv. 669,

lieve ... lothe, ii. 3229, iv. 778,

def. as subst. **lieve**, iii. 1901,

pl. ii. 3395,

voc. **lieve**, iv. 1702, dear, pleasant:

cp. **levere, lievest**.

lief, s. i. 1203, ii. 2449, 2486, loved one.

lieffull, a. iii. 2208,

leveful, v. 7053, lawful.

liegance, ligeance, ligance, s. P. 25*, iii. 1822, v. 2673, vii. 2698,
allegiance, rule.

liege, a. P. 27*, i. 2075, ii. 2762, iv. 201,

(**lige**, viii. 3024),

pl. **here oghne liege**, iii. 1760.

liege, s. iii. 1767, iv. 1904, vii. 3094, 4177,

(**lige**, viii. 2995*), subject.

lien, s. iii. 242, bond.

lieutenant, s. i. 947, ii. 1319.

lieve, *v.a.n.* i. 44, 727, 1063, ii. 471, iii. 1315, believe, trust:
god lieve, vii. 3069, God grant.

lievest, *a.superl.* ii. 329, iv. 1501, v. 186,
levest, PP. 30:
adv. i. 1608:
cp. **lief**.

lif, *s.* P. 96, i. 36, 1477, ii. 1225, v. 2297,
genit. **lyves**, **lives**, i. 1821, 2685,
pl. **lyves**, iv. 2353, viii. 81;
to lyve, ii. 1525,
on lyve, v. 7102,
al my lyve, iii. 886,
a lyves creature, iv. 382: life, person.

lifissh, *a.* v. 4920, vii. 257, living.

liflode, *s.* v. 4961, vi. 798, livelihood.

lifte, *s.* ii. 3488, sky.

ligance, *see* **liegance**.

Ligdus, iv. 451.

lige, *see* **liege**.

ligge, *v.n.* ii. 1138, iv. 2132,
pres. part. **liggende**, i. 885, ii. 839,
ligende, i. 2346.

lignage, *s.* i. 3335, ii. 2849,
pl. **lignages**, v. 1600, vii. 4117, descent, tribe.

Ligurgius, iv. 738, vii. 2918 ff., 3058.

liht, *s.* *see* **lyht**.

liht, *a.* (1) *see* **lyht**.

liht, **lyht**, *a.* (2), i. 3078, iii. 518,
(**light**, PP. 218),
pl. **lyhte**, v. 831;
comp. **lihtere**, v. 4692: light, easy.

lihte, *v.a.* iv. 258, kindle.

lihte, *v.n.* v. 7072,
3 *s.pres.* **liht**, v. 1580,
pret. **lihte**, i. 2310, vii. 3273*, alight.

lihtly (-li), **lyhtly**, *adv.* i. 1063, ii. 2085, iv. 538, viii. 2776,
(**lightly**, PP. 220),
lihtliche, i. 2650, easily.

lik, *see lich.*

like, **lyke**, *s. see liche.*

like, **lyke**, *v.n.impers.*, i. 70, 652, 756, 950, iii. 634, iv. 1182, 2150,
lyketh, v. 7079, vii. 522;
pers. ii. 1377, viii. 378,
lyke, P. 21, vii. 2298;
likende, viii. 2476,
is to like, iv. 2419: please, be pleased, like.

liking(e), **likynge**, *s.* i. 496, 1709, iv. 1868, v. 649, 7737,
pl. **likinges**, vi. 1214, pleasure.

likinge, *a.* iii. 186, v. 3840, pleasant.

liklihiede, *s.* v. 596, comparison.

likned, *pp.* ii. 2118, viii. 2155, compared.

liknesse, *s.* P. 908, i. 370, iv. 2109, viii. 2601.

lilie, *s. as a.* vii. 4678, of lilies.

lime, *v.a.* ii. 574, besmear (with birdlime).

lime, *s.* iv. 275,
pl. **limes**, **lemes**, v. 1476, vii. 3201, limb.

linde, *s.* i. 2304, iv. 1341.

line, **lyne**, *s.* iv. 2623, v. 1082, 4054, viii. 105.

lippe, *s.* i. 1683, iii. 119, iv. 386.

liquour, *s.* viii. 1199.

lisse, *v.a.* iii. 1361, vi. 2419, vii. 5401, relieve;
v.n. vi. 311, give relief.

list, *v.impers.* i. 1403, 1822, iii. 1110, iv. 907,
lest, i. 37, 1922,
lusteth, *v.* 2577,
pres. subj. **liste**, *v.* 505,
pret. (ind. or subj.) **liste**, i. 932, 1984,
leste, i. 720, vi. 357,
list, iii. 2446, please:
pers. i. 2741, iii. 1
(**if thou lest**), 111, iv. 3147, viii. 486,
(**lust**, P. 85*), like, desire.

lite, *see lyte*.

litel, *a.* P. 957, i. 357, ii. 1151:
adv. i. 615, iv. 2617,
alitel, iv. 1339.

lith, *s.* i. 1691, limb.

live(n), *v.n.* P. 171, i. 127, 189, 1710, ii. 1723,
lyve, iv. 1930.

livere, *s.* vii. 457 ff., liver.

livinge, **lyvyng**, *s.* v. 1615, vii. 1657, 1934.

Livius (Virginus), vii. 5136, 5204.

lo, *interj.* P. 234, 918.

lock, *s.* iv. 2879, v. 6621,
lokes (*pl.*), v. 6632, lock (of a door).

lockes, *s.pl.* i. 1685, viii. 2403, locks (of hair).

lode, *s.* v. 4962, load.

lodesman, *s.* iii. 996, helmsman.

loenge, **loange**, *s.* iv. 1548, vii. 3924, viii. 3027*, PP. 371, praise.

lofte, *s.* vii. 300, height.

logged, loged, *pp.* v. 2114, 6659, lodged.

logginge, *s.* vi. 1817.

logique (-qe), *s.* vii. 1528 ff., viii. 2709.

lok, *s.* i. 122, 2313, ii. 1350, look, gaze.

loke(n), *v.n.* P. 328, 449, i. 1686, 2811, 2992, ii. 3075, v. 624,
(**lokyn**, viii. 3029),

imperat. **lok**, i. 1225,

loke, i. 1703, v. 1220, look, take care, keep watch;

v.a. P. 52*, ii. 733, vi. 1959 ff., examine, watch.

loke(n), *v.a.pp.* ii. 358, 1868, 1996, v. 33, shut up.

lokes, *see lock.*

lokinge, lokynge, *s.* i. 680, 1785, iii. 763, looking, sight.

lollardie, *s.* P. 349, v. 1807, 1819.

lomb, *s.* i. 604, vii. 4983.

Lombard, Lumbard, P. 207, 778, vi. 857,

pl. **Lombardz, Lombars, Lombardes**, P. 772 ff., i. 2459, ii. 2101 ff.

Lombardie, P. 755, i. 2461, vii. 800.

lond, *s.* P. 123, 959

(*gen.* **londis**, viii. 3053),

pl. **londes**, P. 501;

to londe, i. 1170, ii. 1828, v. 18, 4899,

into londe, i. 3288,

of londe, i. 2240,

in londe, iii. 1818,

be londe, iv. 1627,

out of londe, iii. 878,

over londe, v. 923,

fro the londe, ii. 179.

londe, *v.n.* ii. 2545, iv. 736, 1927.

londflodes, *s.pl.* vii. 1235.

lone, *s.* v. 4697, loan.

long, *a.* P. 55, i. 2870,
def. longe, i. 171, ii. 817.

longe, *adv.* P. 62, i. 1645, iii. 1888, iv. 943, 1490, 1782,
long, v. 1086, vii. 4999;
comp. (no) longer, ii. 1038:
long on, *see along*.

longe, *v.n.* (1), ii. 1424, v. 7030, desire:
impers. iii. 2760, v. 2526, 3688.

longe, *v.n.* (2), P. 80, i. 254, 1480, v. 972, vii. 1064,
(3 *s.pres. longith*, viii. 3079), belong.

lope, *s.* iii. 916, leap.

lord, *s.* P. 86, i. 816,
ha lord, v. 2397,
pl. lordes, i. 2032, v. 7332,
(**lordis**, viii. 3129).

lorde, *v.n.* ii. 3267, be lord.

lordschipe, *s.* i. 2959, ii. 1484.

lore, *s.* P. 19, 323, i. 1338, 2665,
pl. lores, i. 2768, vii. 23, teaching, learning.

lore, *pp.* i. 974, 2008, iii. 188, lost:
cp. lose.

lorer, *s.* iii. 1716, laurel.

loresman, *s.* v. 1005, teacher.

los, *s.* iii. 2144, v. 996, 5334, fame.

los, *a.*,
def. lose, i. 2660, loose.

lose, *v.a.* v. 697, vii. 1592, set free:
pret. loste, P. 686, i. 3304,
lost, ii. 2290, v. 3465,
pp. lost, P. 44, i. 1742, lose:
cp. lese.

lost, s. P. 762, i. 3106, ii. 2348, iv. 1485, loss.

lot, s. v. 5309, vii. 1337.

Loth, viii. 227.

loth, a. i. 2876, ii. 962, iv. 1186,

pl. **lothe**, i. 2282, v. 4277,

lief ... loth, i. 1203, ii. 999, 2227,

lieve ... lothe, ii. 3229, iv. 778, v. 770,

hem thoghte lothe, iv. 1041: unwilling, unpleasing, hateful.

lothe, v.a. v. 4650, vii. 3274, hate, make hateful;

v.n. v. 5767, vii. 3724, be hateful.

lothly, a. i. 1530, v. 647, vi. 2199;

sup. **the lothlieste**, i. 1676.

loude, *see* **lowde**.

lourde, a. v. 657, clumsy.

loure, v.n. i. 172, ii. 245, iii. 30, v. 479, frown.

loute, v.n. i. 720, 2333, iii. 127, iv. 1169, bow, yield (to):

cp. **lute**.

love, s. P. 75, i. 811, 1863,

genit. **loves**, i. 689, ii. 188, iii. 131,

love drinke, vi. 333; love, loved one.

love(n) (1), v.a.n. P. 389, 1050, i. 752, 1936, ii. 502.

love (2), v.n. v. 7048, (luff), steer.

loveday, s. P. 1047.

lovedrunke, s. vi. 111, 307, love drunkenness.

loveles, a. ii. 2961, v. 2505.

lovere, s. iv. 554,

pl. **lovers**, i. 673, ii. 237.

low, lou, a. i. 2256, iv. 3521,

lowe, iii. 606, vii. 740,

pl. **lowe**, P. 924;

superl. **the lowest**, vii. 224.

low, lowh, v.,
see lawhe.

lowde, loude, *a.pl.* i. 2808, ii. 309, iv. 3064:
adv. iii. 452, v. 5673.

lowe, *adv.* i. 718, 1066, iv. 1004;
sup. **lowest**, i. 704.

lowe, *v.a.n.* iv. 1273, viii. 587, lower, go lower.

Lowis (emperor), P. 777.

Lowyz (king of France), ii. 2966.

Lubie, vi. 410, 1922,
Lubye, vi. 2069.

luce, s. v. 2015, pike.

Lucie, ii. 905, Lucius.

Lucifer, i. 3299, v. 1701, viii. 10,
genit. **Luciferes**, viii. 22.

Lucius (1), v. 7124* ff.

Lucius (2), vii. 3946.

lucre, s. i. 1706, iii. 2360, iv. 2590.

Lucrece, vii. 4809, 4985 ff., viii. 2632.

lugge, *v.a.* vii. 1893.

Lumbard, *see Lombard.*

lunge, s. vii. 452, 465.

lure, s. iv. 285.

lurke, *v.n.* v. 6746.

lust, s. P. 19, 230, i. 443, 754, ii. 1109,
pl. **lustes**, i. 778, 1241, 2517, iv. 1318; pleasure, desire, charm.

lust, v. *see list.*

lusti, lusty, *a.* P. 937, i. 317, 1581, 2167, 2306, pleasant.

lustles, *a.* ii. 2024, iv. 3262, 3455.

lute, *s.* viii. 2679.

lute, *v.n.* i. 1933, lurk:

cp. **loute**.

luxure, *s.* vii. 4561, lust.

lye, *v.* *see* **lie**.

lye, lie, *s.* P. 504, iii. 895, dregs.

lyht, liht, *s.* i. 633, 1168, ii. 836, iii. 920,

be lyhte, *v.* 6517,

pl. **lyhtes**, iv. 3221, light.

lyht, liht, *a.* (1) P. 941, i. 2176, vi. 1982, vii. 956,

pl. **lihte**, iii. 783, bright.

lyht, *a.* (2), *see* **liht**.

lyhte, *adv.* *v.* 4076, brightly.

lyhthnynge, *s.* viii. 1000, lightning.

lyke, *see* **liche**.

lym, *s.* *v.* 7233, vi. 1594, lime, (mortar).

lyn, *s.* iv. 2437, *v.* 1203, flax.

lyne, *see* **line**.

lyon, *see* **leoun**.

lyte, *a.* ii. 429, *v.* 6627,

as subst. **a lyte, a lite**, i. 264, 2687, ii. 2045,

(often in MSS. **alite, alyte**, *as* i. 2687, ii. 2045, vii. 4092);

to lite, iii. 581, *see* **tolite**.

lyvynges, *see* **livinges**.

M

ma dame, i. 168, iv. 1374.

macched, *pp.* v. 5422.

mace, *s.* v. 6865, viii. 2507.

Macedoyne, Macedoine, ii. 1616, iii. 2451, vi. 1809, vii. 3211*;
as a. ii. 1840.

Macer, vi. 1408.

Machabeu, PP. 282.

Machaire, iii. 146 ff., viii. 2588.

macon, *s.* vii. 2427, mason.

madd, mad, *a.* i. 130, v. 496, 5891.

Madian, vii. 3710.

madle, *a. as subst.* iv. 1301, vii. 4215, male.

mageste, *see majeste.*

magicien, *s.* v. 3084, vi. 1337.

magique, *s.* iv. 2077, vi. 1402;
a. v. 3947, vi. 1434.

magnefie, magnifie, *v.a.* P. 44, 886, i. 2998, ii. 2827, iv. 2608.

mai, *v. see mowe.*

maide(n), mayde(n), i. 2481, 2573 ff. 3327, v. 3476,
a maide child, viii. 1058,
pl. maidenes, iv. 255, maidens, iv. 1464, 1575:
cp. may.

maidehiede, *s.* v. 6384.

maidenhod(e), maidenhiede (-hede), maydenhiede (-hede), *s.* iv. 1566,
1585, v. 3068, 6181, 6219, vii. 5145,
maidenhed, v. 6769.

Maii, i. 100, 2026, vii. 1045,
May, vii. 2276,
genit. Maies, i. 2089, May.

maile, *s.* v. 3111.

main, s. vi. 90, strength.

maintenue, s. viii. 3012, maintenance.

maintiene, v.a. i. 3285,

meintiene, iv. 3433,

maintene, PP. 385.

maister, s. i. 35, 1260, ii. 1134, v. 56,

pl. **maistres**, v. 434.

maistred, v.a.pp. iv. 3518.

maistrefull, a. iii. 212.

maistresse, s. i. 1825, iii. 170, viii. 2331.

maistrie, s. iii. 1566, 2768, vi. 2341, vii. 1398,

pl. **maistries**, v. 2061, mastery, great deed.

majeste, **mageste**, s. ii. 1058, v. 1510, 1737.

majorane, s. vii. 1433.

make, s. (1), i. 101, 2088, iii. 2612, v. 4275, mate, match.

make, s. (2), v. 2296, fashion.

make(n), v.a. P. 23, 155, viii. 3143,

2, 3, s.pres. **makst**, **makth**, i. 774, iv. 2844,

pret. **made**, P. 207, 816, ii. 858, 1265,

mad, ii. 310, v. 3822,

pp. **mad**, P. 347, i. 2427,

(**maad**, viii. 3110),

made (*pl.*), P. 300,

maked, v. 680.

makere, s. ii. 916, vii. 1508.

makeinge, **makyng(e)**, s. v. 1022, 1203, viii. 3089*, 3154, making,
composing (poetry).

maladie, **maladye**, s. i. 128, ii. 9, 3221, viii. 2642.

male, s. iv. 546, wallet.

Malebouche, ii. 389.

malencolie, s. P. 1069, iii. 27 ff., vii. 402.

malencolien, *a.* iii. 33, 241.

malencolious, *a.* iii. 87.

malengin, s. v. 344, evil device.

malgracious, *a.* v. 647.

malgre, s. v. 6481, 6946, ill-will:
adv. i. 789, 1329, in spite of the will;
malgre myn, iv. 59,
m. hem, iv. 1233, *cp.* vi. 524.

malice, s. P. 62*, i. 605, vii. 939.

malicious, *a.* iii. 1634, vii. 2852.

man, s. P. 21, iii. 1249 ff.,
genit. **mannes**, P. 14, i. 2412,
(**mannys**, viii. 2975),
to manne, iii. 1967, viii. 308,
pl. **men**, P. 12, 167, i. 768,
genit. **mennes**, i. 1995; man, servant.

manace, s. i. 1598, iii. 1832.

manace, *v.a.n.* iii. 1525, 1533, vi. 1680.

Manachaz, **Manachas**, vii. 1801 ff.

mandement, s. viii. 1819, command.

Mane, v. 7023.

manere, s. P. 362, i. 793, iv. 1281,
such a maner wise, &c., P. 83*, i. 1086, 1360, iii. 1072,
cp. i. 1977,
in manere, vii. 2132, 4344, PP. 53.

Manes, *pl.* v. 1363.

manfull, *a.* vii. 2881.

manhod(e), s. P. 260, ii. 1639, 2514, iii. 1964,

manhiede, manhed(e), i. 1212, 3044, iv. 325, 2033; man's nature, manliness, race of men.

mankinde, s. ii. 3108, iv. 2443.

manlich, *a.* vii. 5093.

manna, s. v. 1673.

manneskinde, s. v. 4110.

mannyssh, *a.* vi. 1528.

manslawhte, s. iii. 2544,
(**manslaghtre**, PP. 171).

mantel, mantell, s. v. 3557, 4201, 6890, vii. 4524, 5067.

many, mani, *a.sing.* P. 857, ii. 89, 447, iv. 1619,
many a, P. 75, i. 1958,
many an, vii. 2191, **many (manye) on**, v. 5302,
pl. **manye, manie**, P. 299, 672, i. 2530, iv. 1629,
many, v. 2904, 4015, 5147;
as subst. **manye**, i. 3238, v. 4001.

manyfold, *adv.* iii. 1702, 1952, iv. 125,
be manyfold, v. 1778.

manyon, *pron.* i. 416, 655, 2441,
pl. **manion**, ii. 1272:
cp. **many**.

mappemounde, s. vii. 530.

marbre, s. iv. 3666 ff., v. 2035.

Marc, vi. 474.

March, v. 5968, vii. 1008,
Marche, viii. 2843,
Mars, viii. 2852, March.

marchandie, s. ii. 600, vii. 917.

marchant, s. v. 952, 2689, vii. 1687.

marche, s. P. 720, i. 1417, ii. 2521 ff., vii. 555, PP. 291, border, territory.

Marche, *see* **March**.

marche, *v.n.* iv. 2987, border.

Marchus Claudius, vii. 5167 ff.

mareschall, **mareschal**, *s.* viii. 714, 2662.

mariage, *s.* i. 1763, ii. 625, v. 1260.

Marie, i. 3278, v. 1782*.

maried, *pp.* v. 509.

marked, *pp.* vii. 1144.

market (place), *s.* v. 1535, vii. 5101.

marrement, *s.* vii. 3310*, trouble.

marrubium, vii. 1343, (name of a herb).

Mars (1), **Mart**, **Marte**, v. 651 ff., 883 ff., 1215, 1477, 3506, 6150;
(the planet) iv. 2470, vii. 889 ff., 992, 1136, 1314, 1323, 1360, 1374,
1389, 1411.

Mars (2), *see* **March**.

Marsagete, vii. 3444.

martire, *s.* PP. 341.

mased, *a.* vi. 132.

Masphat, iv. 1533.

masse, *see* **messe**.

mast, *s.* i. 1068, viii. 617.

mat, *a.* iii. 114, vi. 34, 730, weak, dejected.

mathematique, vii. 72, 145 ff., 623.

matiere, *s.* P. 6, 984, iv. 565, v. 572, matter, cause.

matins, *s.* v. 7111.

matrimoine, *s.* i. 1777.

matrone, *s.* i. 1657.

may, v. *see mowe*.

may, s. iv. 30, v. 3438:
cp. maide.

mayde, *see maide*.

Maximin, vii. 2766.

me, *pron.* P. 30*, i. 117, 567, me, myself.

mea culpa, i. 661.

mechanique, s. vii. 1693.

mecherie, *see micherie*.

mechil, *see mochel*.

mede, s. i. 795, 1554, ii. 2727, v. 4720,
meede, v. 7133*, vii. 129.

Mede, vii. 4335, 5313.

Medee, **Medea**, iii. 2559, v. 2539, 3241, 3368 ff., 4361, viii. 2563.

medicine, s. i. 30, 167, ii. 3203, medicine, healing.

meditacioun, s. ii. 2876.

medle, *v.a.* i. 1709, 3014,
pp. **medled**, P. 858,
medlid, iv. 1475;
v.n. vii. 1586: mingle.

Meduse, **Medusa**, i. 401 ff., 551.

medwe, s. v. 4151, 5964.

meedful, *a.* viii. 3105*.

meel, s. vi. 720, meal.

meene, *see mene*.

meete, *see mete*.

Megaster, vii. 1455.

meind, *see meynd*.

meintiene, *see* **maintiene**.

meke, **mieke**, *a.* v. 2472, 5396, vii. 916.

meke, *v.refl.* i. 866, v. 7386, submit.

meknesse, *s.* i. 126, ii. 1486.

melk, *s.* v. 4048.

melle, *v.n.* v. 2833,
cp. **medle**.

melled, *a.* vii. 4899, mingled.

melodie, *s.* i. 494, v. 1030.

melte, *v.n.* iv. 1057,
pret. **malt**, iv. 1065.

membre, *s.* P. 153, v. 1457, PP. 164.

memoire, *s.* P. 1002, i. 1775, ii. 1421.

memorial, *s.* iv. 532, 563, 2042, memory.

memorial, *a.* viii. 3026*, 3105, remembered.

men, *indef. pron. sing.* ii. 659, v. 5510, viii. 2926, people.

menable, *a.* i. 1067, ii. 1123, iii. 390, vii. 2762:
see note on i. 1067.

menage, *s.* v. 4809.

Menander (1), iv. 109.

Menander (2), iv. 2409.

mencioun, *s.* ii. 428, iii. 739.

mende, *see* **mynde**.

mene, **meene**, *v.a.n.* i. 15, 280, 926, 1210, ii. 2465, iii. 2761, iv. 1859,
pret.

mente, P. 667, 1024,

mint, vii. 5043; mean, intend, speak.

mene, **meene**, *a.* v. 3895, 5330.

mene, s. v. 6542.

Menelay, iii. 2136, v. 3072, viii. 2547.

Menesteüs, iii. 2145.

meninge, s. ii. 1599,
 menynge, vii. 4837.

menstral, s. vii. 2423.

menstre, s. v. 7059, minster.

mercerie, s. ii. 3059.

merci, **mercy**, s. i. 1832, 1902, 1936, iii. 222, thanks, mercy.

merciabie, *a.* iii. 1514, iv. 3426, vii. 3276, merciful.

Mercurial, *a.* vii. 1357.

Mercurie, **Mercurius**, i. 422 ff., iv. 2053, 3332 ff., v. 938, 1399, 1465,
 7411, vii. 2967, 3056;
 (the planet) iv. 2474, vii. 757 ff., 1087, 1156, 1382, 1421, 1427.

merel, s. P. 430, vii. 3266, lot.

merie, **merye**, *a.* i. 2081, 2734, iv. 504, v. 6128:
 adv. v. 3779.

merite, s. P. 301, v. 4893,
 merit, v. 1725.

meritoire, *a.* P. 465.

merthe, s. i. 2531, iv. 3149,
 pl. **merthes**, i. 102, vii. 4799.

merveile, **merveille**, *v.n.* ii. 774, 1347, iv. 1266, vi. 171,
 mervaille, i. 2226;
 impers. v. 4481, vi. 385.

merveile, **merveille**, s. i. 3234, iii. 1422, vii. 3998,
 merveilles (*pl.*), v. 309, iv. 2059,
 mervaille, **mervaille**, iv. 1480, vii. 2456.

merveiled, *a.* v. 2060, filled with wonder.

merveilous, *a.* iv. 2990, v. 5292.

meschief, *s.* P. 150, ii. 1029, iii. 2387,
(**meschef**, PP. 111),
mischief, iii. 137.

meschieved, *pp.* iv. 15.

mescreance, *s.* v. 1444, vi. 2366.

mescreantz, *s.pl.* PP. 268.

Mese, iii. 2645, iv. 3516.

message, *s.* i. 834, ii. 816, iii. 255, message, embassy.

messenger, *s.* ii. 943, v. 1185, vii. 4681,
messagier, i. 2505;
fem. **messagere**, iv. 2972.

messe, **masse**, *s.* i. 660, iv. 1133, v. 7037, 7111.

mestier, *s.* vii. 1692, occupation.

measure, *s.* P. 1056, 1080, i. 2402, iv. 3305, viii. 768.

measure, *v.a.* iv. 3306, v. 7638.

metall, **metal**, *s.* P. 735, iv. 2449 ff.

Metamor, **Methamor**, i. 389, v. 6711.

mete, *s.* P. 475, i. 812, 2843, ii. 1363, iii. 183, meat.

mete, **meete**, **miete**, *v.a.n.* (1), i. 2599, ii. 457, iii. 52, iv. 2902, v. 5584,
pret. **mette**, P. 42*, i. 85,
pp. **met**, iv. 2094, meet.

mete, **meete**, *v.a.n.* (2), iii. 51, iv. 2901,
pret. **mette**, iv. 2910, 3065, vi. 1980, dream.

mete, **meete**, *a. and adv.* ii. 458, vii. 2899, fit, fitly.

Methamor, *see* **Metamor**.

Metodre, viii. 48.

metre, *s.* iv. 2414.

metrede, s. vi. 2003, dream.

meynd, meind, *a.* P. 615, v. 2311, 4049, mingled.

mi, min, *see my*.

Micene, Micenes, iii. 2039, 2081.

Micheas, vii. 2595 ff.,

Michee, vii. 2667.

micherie, mecherie, s. v. 6296, 6495, 6754, 6944, thievishness.

michinge, s. v. 6525, thieving.

midday, s. iv. 3273.

middel, *a.* P. 17, v. 7691, viii. 720.

middel, s. iv. 1356, vi. 786, vii. 1058, waist, middle.

middelertthe, middilertthe, s. i. 3305, vii. 287.

Mide, Myde, v. 153 ff., 412.

midmorwe, s. viii. 666.

midnyht, s. ii. 2891.

mieke, *a. see meke*.

miele, s. vi. 590, bowl.

miete, *see mete*.

miht, mihte, v. *see mowe*.

miht, s. *see myht*.

milde, mylde, *a.* P. 1058, i. 915, ii. 1056, vi. 1918, viii. 1030.

mile, myle, s. ii. 1474, a ten mile, iv. 1707,

thritty mile, v. 2036, (of time) iv. 689, viii. 2312.

milion, s. v. 2613.

minde, *see mynde*.

mine, s. *see myn*.

mineral, s. iv. 2559.

minerall, *a.* iv. 2552.

Minerve, *s.* i. 1120, 1147, *v.* 1189, 1460, 1831, 7413, *vii.* 1922, 1933.

ministre, *v.n.* i. 808;
v.a. *vii.* 1030.

ministres, *s.pl.* i. 583.

Minotaurus, **Minotaure**, *iv.* 1043, *v.* 5277, 5291 ff.

minte, *see mene.*

minut, **mynut**, *s.* *iv.* 241, 642, *vi.* 2257.

mir, *see myr.*

miracle, *s.* *iv.* 522, 3661, *vii.* 662.

mirour, *s.* *P.* 496, *iii.* 1076, *v.* 2033, *viii.* 2821.

mirre, *s.* i. 1705.

mis, **mys**, *s.* i. 3311, *vi.* 2359, wrong.

mis, **mys**, *adv.* i. 2403, *ii.* 559, *vii.* 5429, amiss.

misbegat, *v.a.pret.* *vi.* 2357.

misbelieve, *s.* *ii.* 1569, *v.* 833, 1593.

misbelieved, (*pp.*) *a.* *v.* 739.

misbere, *v.refl.* *vii.* 5279, misbehave (oneself).

misbore, *pp.* *ii.* 971.

miscaste, *v.a.* *iii.* 110.

mischief, *see meschief.*

misconte, *v.n.* i. 3112.

misdede, *s.* *iii.* 1931, 2614.

misdespended, *v.a.pp.* i. 298.

misdo, *v.a.n.* i. 3443,
pret. **misdede**, *iii.* 227,
pp. **misdo**, i. 2385, *ii.* 3513.

miselve(n), miself, *pron.* i. 62, 192, 556,
myselfe, *iv.* 853,
(**my self**, *viii.* 2958).

misericorde, *s.* *iii.* 2628, 2712, *vii.* 3303.

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mone, s. (2), P. 142, 484, i. 1168, v. 1447, vii. 721 ff., moon.

mone, s. (3), i. 1634, companion.

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miht, iii. 1356,
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mowe, *v.a.* ii. 2375, reap.

mowth, **mouth**, *s.* i. 1275, ii. 431,
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mue, *s.* iii. 1412, cage.

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mull, *s.* v. 2310, rubbish.

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Muse, *s.* viii. 3074*, 3140.

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myne, s. *see myn*.

Mynitor, v. 897.

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mysdrawe, *pp.* P. 430, wrongly drawn.

myst, *see* **mist**.

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newe, *v.a.* P. 92*, i. 2700, vi. 1497, renew, produce;
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newefongel, *a.* v. 4367.

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next, *adv.* i. 256, 1230, 1964,
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neysshe, **neisshe**, *a.* iv. 3681, v. 4693, soft.

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nombre, v.a. ii. 1769, vii. 1122.

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nomo, s.pl. i. 1898, ii. 133,
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nomore, **nomor**, a. ii. 1526, iv. 603:
subst. i. 270, 1605, 3439;
cp. **nomo**:
adv. P. 1086, i. 1226, 2101.

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Nonarcigne, v. 1009.

noncertein, s. viii. 2179, 2378, uncertainty.

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notefie, *v.a.* ii. 2825.

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nother, *see nouth*.

nothing, s. i. 909, ii. 1166 &c.,
no thing, iii. 1834:
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nouche, s. i. 2420, v. 7066, vi. 1134, brooch.

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nowher, *adv.* ii. 31,
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nawher(e), iv. 1044, v. 3269:
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nowhider, *adv.* v. 520.

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nycete, *s.* v. 462, vi. 176, folly.
nygard, *s.* v. 4850.
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nyh, *a.* P. 261;
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prep. i. 2322, ii. 1115:
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nyht, **niht**, *s.* P. 939, i. 1167, ii. 2656,
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nyhtingale, *s.* i. 355, iv. 2872, v. 5944.
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is obeied (to), ii. 1529: obey, submit, do obeisance.

obeissance, s. P. 107, i. 2606, viii. 2713,
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obeissant, *a.* i. 2502, 2795, iv. 425, v. 1351, obedient.

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obstinacie, s. iv. 3434.

obstinat, *a.* iv. 3442, v. 1704.

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occident, s. iv. 3235, vii. 582,
thoccident, P. 720, the West.

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Octobre, vii. 1139.

Octovien, v. 4731.

odde, *a.* vii. 1580.

Oënes, iv. 2045.

Oëtes, v. 3321.

of, *prep.* P. 1, 3, 235, i. 825, 1212, 2237, 2737, ii. 2285, iv. 3414, v. 1998,
of, from, by reason of, as regards, by:

of that (= since), P. 333, i. 417, 1128, 2566;

of tolde, speke of, &c., i. 2866, iv. 2466:

adv. i. 1745, 2471, off.

offence, s. i. 2072, iii. 104, 614, iv. 505.

offende, v.n. P. 422;
v.a. vii. 3243, PP. 245.

office, s. P. 80, i. 2410, iii. 2004, 2218,
thoffice, i. 242.

officer, officier, s. i. 647, 2506.

offre, v.a. i. 1122, 1159;
v.n. iii. 1990.

offrende, s. i. 936, v. 1638, viii. 956,
offringe, iii. 1995, v. 830.

ofherkne, v.n. ii. 2007.

ofte, *adv.* P. 14, i. 620,
often, P. 502,
ofte sithes (time), i. 118, ii. 2015,
often times, v. 4777.

oftetime, *adv.* vi. 1248.

oghne, a. P. 86, i. 951 &c.,
oughne, i. 1948, v. 588,
owen, viii. 1248,
owne, viii. 2954*.

oght, s. P. 846, iv. 673, 1765, 3487,
ought, i. 1287, ii. 1930, iv. 1745,
auht, v. 6073:
adv. i. 549, ii. 274,
awht, i. 2770.

oghth, v. 3 s.*pres.* iii. 2474,
pret. **oghte**, i. 462, 2238, v. 4984,
oughte, v. 2607,
owhte, ii. 549,
thou oghtest, iv. 1794;
impers. ii. 2142, iii. 704, 1666: ought, owe, own.

oignement, s. v. 3596, viii. 2817.

oil, s. vii. 2194, 2584 (*see note*).

oile, s. *see* **oyle**.

old, *a.* P. 1003, i. 1072,
 def. olde, i. 2693, 2696,
 pl. olde, P. 7, i. 3390,
 (*as subst.*), v. 3930;
 of (be) olde ensample, iii. 782, 1683,
 be olde tyde, v. 139:
 cp. eldeste.

Olimpe, v. 3997.

Olimpias, vi. 1824, 1965.

olyve, s. v. 4142.

Omelie, v. 1901, Homilies.

on, *prep.* P. 28, 789, i. 350, 697, 1677, iv. 624, 1632;
 adv. i. 1273: **on**, **in**.

on, *num.* P. 125, i. 194, 1274, 1793, **one**;
 in on, P. 159, **united**;
 in on, evere in on, P. 523, i. 1795, iii. 526, v. 375, **in the same way**,
 without ceasing;
 on and on, i. 194, vi. 1315, **one by one**:
 pron. on, i. 2483, ii. 1217, 1247, iv. 605, 2050,
 oon, ii. 1092, iv. 555, v. 519,
 on ... other, P. 649, 968, i. 1496,
 that on ... that other, i. 397, v. 2298,
 on the ferste, &c., iv. 2606, vi. 1481, vii. 3092:
 cp. one.

onde, s. i. 979, v. 3975, **emotion**, **breath**.

one, *a.* i. 2179, vii. 3619, 4161,
 al one, P. 72, i. 351,
 al myn one, &c., i. 115, iv. 833,
 him one, viii. 634, **single**, **alone**.

ones, *adv.* i. 962, ii. 1490,

at ones, i. 2202, ii. 2301, iv. 2102.
only, onli, *adv.* P. 265, 719, i. 622, iv. 3202,
onlyche, onlich(e), i. 740, 1948, iii. 42.
onwrong (?), *adv.* P. 65*.
oon, *see on*, *pron.*
open, *a.* P. 34, 865, ii. 431, 776,
in open, i. 616,
leie open, v. 974.
openly, *adv.* P. 330, i. 2187,
openliche, i. 1035, ii. 918.
operacioun (-on), s. vii. 998, 1282.
opinioun (-on), s. i. 1990, ii. 3214, iii. 2114,
oppinion, P. 531, v. 1174.
opne, *v.a.* v. 3594, 5785.
oppose, *v.a.* i. 225, 880, 1276, 1601;
v.n. iii. 436, viii. 1712; question; ask questions.
opposit, s. iv. 3243.
oppresse, *v.a.* iii. 49, 2335, v. 889, 1806, vi. 568,
(*pp.* **oppressid**, viii. 3019).
or, *conj.* P. 215,
or ... or, P. 211, i. 740, either ... or,
or (that) ... or, iii. 1192, iv. 1093, whether ... or.
or, *prep.* *see er*.
Orace, vii. 3581,
cp. vi. 1513 *marg.*
Orayn, v. 806.
Orbis, vii. 613, 618, 687.
Orchamus, v. 6727.

ordeine, ordeigne, *v.a.* P. 379, i. 828, 1754, 2126, 2504, 3319, iv. 3624,
appoint, arrange.

ordinal, *s.* vii. 969, arrangement.

ordinance, *s.* ii. 677, 1643, iii. 1787,
ordinaunce, iv. 3559, management, order.

ordre, *s.* i. 243, 1026, v. 890,
order, v. 6954,
pl. **ordres**, i. 608.

ore, *s.* ii. 1904, v. 3688, viii. 1401, oar.

Oreades, v. 1330.

orf, *s.* P. 410, cattle.

orient, *s.* i. 2789, iv. 3236, vii. 555,
thorient, P. 719.

original, *a.* v. 1767, vi. 1.

orped, *a.* i. 2590, iii. 2415, valiant.

Ortolan, iv. 2609.

Orus, v. 798.

oth, *s.* i. 985, 1487, iii. 55, 220, oath.

other, *a.* P. 264,
other wise, P. 463, i. 1048, 1615,
in othre wise, viii. 3054,
cp. **otherwise, an other**, i. 178,
another, P. 968,
an othre, i. 481,
non othre, viii. 2962,
that other, P. 373, i. 1783, ii. 1832 (the next),
thother, ii. 1740,
that othre, v. 3172,
pl. **othre**, P. 255, i. 1728, iv. 1184,
other, i. 116, iv. 1183,
thother, vii. 371:

as subst. P. 1024,
an other, i. 1500, iii. 179, vii. 4741, 5165,
an othre, i. 1496, ii. 511,
ech ... other, iv. 500,
eche (echon) ... othre, i. 2061, 2082,
pl. othre, P. 427, i. 810, 2074:
adv. i. 1760, otherwise.

othergate, *adv.* P. 440, iv. 2790.

otherwhile, *adv.* i. 2335 f., 2515, ii. 456, 1080, sometimes, any time.

otherwise, *adv.* P. 240, i. 1938,
of otherwise, ii. 2421:
cp. other.

Othes, P. 818.

Othrin, v. 3997.

oughne, *see* **oghne**.

ought, *see* **oght**.

oughte, *see* **oghth**.

oule, s. i. 1727, iii. 585, vi. 1450.

oultrage, s. P. 1080, ii. 2967, iii. 1775, vii. 1190.

oultreli, *adv.* vii. 4107, utterly.

oure, *poss. pron.* P. 5, i. 2062, iii. 1473,
our, v. 1860.

ourselfe, *pron.* PP. 222,
cp. **ousselve**.

ous, *pers. pron.* P. 1, 5 &c.,
refl. P. 543,
(**us**, viii. 3110*), *us*.

ousselve, *pron.* P. 525,
ousself, iii. 2302, ourselves:
cp. **ourselfe**.

out, *see* **oute**.

outake(n), **outtake**, *pp.* P. 136, vii. 264;
as prep. i. 3077, iv. 3459, v. 215: excepted, except.

outbreide, *v.a.pret.* iii. 800,
out breide, viii. 1377, drew out.

outdrowh, **outdrouh**, *v.a.pret.* iii. 1661, v. 3719, drew out.

oute, **out**, *adv.* P. 689, i. 1418, ii. 1887, 3240, iv. 2351, viii. 1377,
(*as exclamation*) v. 3910,
out of, P. 131, i. 933, &c.

outher, *conj.* *see* **owther**.

outher, *indef.pron.* v. 2836.

outtake, *see* **outake**.

outward, *adv.* P. 447, ii. 2201, v. 1996, 4399; outwardly, out.

outwith, *a.* viii. 2833, outwardly.

over, *prep.* P. 755,
over this, P. 328,
(**ovyr this**, viii. 3005),
over that, P. 1017, besides,
cp. **overthis**, **overthat**;
over al, iii. 1945, throughout.

overal, *adv.* P. 119, i. 1713,
overall, iv. 2882, everywhere, throughout.

overblowe, *v.n.* v. 7828.

overcaste, *v.a.* P. 657, i. 1070, iii. 1010, 1136, 1354, v. 4603, viii. 1042,
overthrow, upset, cover (with clouds).

overcome, *v.a.*,
3 *s.pres.* **overcomth**, iii. 619,
pret. **overcom**, P. 757,
overcam, v. 1093,
pp. **overcome**, P. 704, i. 970, v. 3745.

overforth, *adv.* P. 635.

overgilt, *pp.* viii. 569, gilded over.

overglad, i. 2713, iv. 678.

overgladed, *pp.* iii. 106.

overgo, *v.n.*,

3 *s.pres.* **overgoth**, iii. 102,

overgeth, iii. 1962,

pp. **overgo(n)**, i. 3325, iv. 664, pass away:

v.a. iii. 576, 1488, viii. 182, 227, overcome.

overhaste, *v.a.* iii. 1675.

overhippe, *v.a.* v. 2004, leap over.

overladde, *v.a.pret.* iii. 2364,

pp. **overlad**, iv. 582, v. 2749, overcame, overcome.

overlein, *pp.* vii. 3930, oppressed.

overlippe, *s.* v. 376, upper lip.

overmo, **overmor(e)**, *adv.* i. 2386, 3361, ii. 378, iii. 918,

(**ovyrmore**, viii. 3029), moreover.

overpasse, *v.a.* i. 517, 2402, ii. 2401, vii. 1839, 4075, pass over, pass by,
avoid, surpass;

v.n. P. 630, i. 6, 2922, iii. 94, iv. 1134, pass away.

overrede, *v.a.*,

pret. **overradde**, ii. 956,

pp. **overrad**, iv. 207, read over.

overrenne, *v.a.*,

pret. **overran**, iii. 2445,

pp. **overronne**, i. 2478, iv. 2188, v. 6974, vi. 1059, vii. 862,

overrunne, viii. 100, overrun, conquer, pass, omit, transgress.

overscape, *v.a.* i. 2242, iii. 518, escape from.

overseie, *pp.* **oversein**,

v.a. ii. 1011, viii. 879, looked over.

oversein, **overseie**, *a.* v. 3190, viii. 2933, careless, imprudent.

overset, *v.a.pp.* i. 1953, v. 2707.

oversit, *v.a.* 3 *s.pres.* iii. 618,
pret. **oversat**, iv. 806, outstay.

overspradde, *v.a.pret.* v. 1653, 7114*, viii. 1012, 3002*.

overtake, *v.a.* v. 700,
pret. **overtok**, ii. 303,
pp. **overtake**, P. 135, ii. 2586, iii. 2098, iv. 3415, overtake, convict,
ruin.

overthat, *adv.* P. 839, iii. 277, moreover;
cp. **over**.

overthis, *adv.* i. 448, 573, iv. 3698, moreover;
cp. **over**.

overthrowe, *v.a.* P. 139,
pret. **overthrew**, **overthreu**, vi. 1590, viii. 2704,
pl. **overthrewe**, vi. 2264, turn over, overthrow;
v.n. P. 969, i. 1886, 1962, ii. 252,
pret.subj. **overthrewe**, iii. 1630, be overthrown.

overtorne, *v.a.* iv. 1280, vi. 129, 1956,
(*pp.* **ovyrtornyd**, viii. 3145), turn over, overturn;
v.n. P. 958.

overtrowe, *v.n.* i. 2369.

overwende, v. iii. 1131, v. 1668, overturn, come over.

overwroth, *a.* iii. 579.

Ovide, i. 333, 386, 2274, ii. 106, 2297, iii. 361, 381, 736, iv. 1211, 2669
ff., 3317, v. 140, 635, 878, 4229, 5570, 6146, 6710, viii. 2266 ff.,
2719.

owen, *see* **oghne**.

owther, **outh**, *conj.* i. 2309, iii. 847, iv. 938, either.

oxe, *s.* i. 2843, ii. 86, v. 10,
pl. **oxen**, v. 1023,
oxes, iv. 1835.

oyle, oile, s. iv. 257, viii. 1198, 2775, oil.

P

Paceole, v. 299.

pacience, s. ii. 2819, iii. 12, 1098.

pacient, *a.* iii. 706.

packe, s. v. 5516, 6094.

Pafagoine, iv. 2148 ff.

page, s. iv. 1192, foot-boy.

paie, *v.a.n.* iv. 1848, 3269, v. 2679,
3 *s.p.* **paith**, v. 4522,
paieth, v. 5513,
pret. **payde**, v. 1755,
pp. **paid**, **payd**, i. 2449, 3324, ii. 2217, iii. 934,
paied, i. 2984, please, pay, satisfy.

paiement, s. v. 5087, 5520.

paien, s. vii. 3246* ff.,
pl. **paiens**, vi. 1313, PP. 183, pagan.

paiene, **payene**, *a.* v. 1137, 1943,
paien, vii. 3222*, 4408, pagan.

paindemeine, s. vi. 620.

Palamades, iii. 1007, iv. 1817.

pale, *a.* i. 701, 982, ii. 1346.

paleis, s. P. 838, i. 2964, ii. 3231.

Palene, v. 1199.

Palladion, v. 1833 ff.

Pallant, v. 1209.

Pallas, i. 420 ff., v. 1207 ff., 4219, 6149 ff.

palle, *v.a.n.* v. 5486, vi. 342, weaken, grow weak.

palle, s. v. 6680, covering.
Pan, v. 1007, viii. 2239, 2476.
panche, s. vi. 1000, belly.
Pandas, iv. 2410.
Pandion, v. 5556.
Pandulf, iv. 2408.
panne, s. i. 2472, iv. 2733.
Pantasilee, iv. 2139 ff., v. 2547,
 Pantaselee, viii. 2527.
Panthasas, iv. 3049.
Pantheon, viii. 272.
papacie, s. P. 364, ii. 2895.
papal, *a.* ii. 2925.
papat, s. ii. 2833, papacy.
paper, s. iv. 198.
Paphos, iv. 435.
Paphus, iv. 434.
pappes, *s.pl.* iii. 2010, 2073.
par, *prep.* *see per.*
paradis, s. P. 1005, i. 3303, iv. 682, v. 1707, vi. 207,
 paradys, i. 502.
parage, s. i. 3336, viii. 351, equal rank, rank.
parail, s. vii. 1038.
paramour, s. iv. 1269, 1470.
Parasie, v. 1011.
parconner, s. viii. 2535, partner.
pardoun, s. i. 2174, viii. 2896.

parfit, *a.* iii. 2496, v. 2032,

def. **parfit**, iv. 2522,

parfite, iv. 2624;

as subst. **the parfit**, iv. 2363, v. 1723:

adv. v. 1714.

parfitly, **parfitli**, *adv.* ii. 755, iv. 2497, v. 2136,

parfihtliche, v. 1732.

parforne, *v.a.* vii. 1373, viii. 2273, perform.

Paris, v. 7374 ff., viii. 2529.

park, *s.* i. 1566, iv. 1288.

parlement, *s.* ii. 1549, 2653, iii. 2130, v. 484.

part, *s.* P. 64, i. 321, 1376, ii. 174, 1447,

pl. **pars**, v. 4774,

partz, v. 7704.

parte, *v.a.* P. 170, 467, v. 73, divide, distribute:

v.n. ii. 1578, v. 131, 3639, 6175, 7582, part (from, with), depart, share.

parti, *a.* iii. 983, variegated.

parti, *s.* ii. 1740, v. 7341, part, party.

partie, *s.* P. 43, 792, 956, ii. 230, part, party:

stant partie, iii. 1160.

partinge, *s.* vii. 2008, division.

pas, **pass**, *s.* i. 1421, ii. 2205, v. 6090, pass, passage;

i. 2183, vi. 1197, pace, foot's pace,

the grete pas, ii. 988, v. 3178, vii. 3283*,

(the) softe pas, ii. 1509, vii. 4970.

Pasiphe, v. 5279.

passage, *s.* ii. 1885, 2194, 2209, 3036, iv. 1902, passage, passing away.

passe(n), *v.a.* i. 332, 651, 1849, 2175, iv. 1666, viii. 2692, pass, pass

through, pass over, surpass;

v.n. P. 689, i. 142, 499, 1534, 2247, ii. 944, 2810, iv. 2239, v. 5954, vii.

4762, pass, happen, pass away.

passible, *a.* v. 771, liable to suffer.

passioun (-on), *s.* P. 915, iii. 2721, vi. 169.

past, *s.* iii. 447, vi. 620, paste, pastry.

paste, *s.* v. 2407, pasty.

pasture, *v.n.* i. 2915.

paternoster, *s.* v. 7119.

path, *s.* v. 1990.

patriarch, *s.* v. 1635, vi. 1040,
pl. **patriarkes**, viii. 134.

patrimoine, *s.* P. 741.

Paul (Emilius), Paulus, ii. 1776 ff.

Pauline, i. 765 ff.

paved, *pp.* viii. 1855.

pay, *s.* vi. 1208, satisfaction.

payene, *see* **paiene**.

peine, *s.* P. 509, i. 1209, 1367, ii. 2586,
(**peyne**, viii. 3121),
pl. **peines**, i. 2900, punishment, pain:
do mi peine, &c., ii. 507, v. 658, endeavour.

peine, peyne, *v.refl.* iv. 414, viii. 2509, suffer, take pains;
peined, *pp.* i. 2916, ii. 26, troubled.

peinte, *v.a.* i. 284, 1346, 2729, ii. 2854, iv. 2138, PP. 329, paint,
embellish.

peinture, *s.* vi. 1894.

peire, *s.* v. 5691,
p. of bedes, viii. 2904.

peis, *s.* vii. 3119, viii. 2380, weight.

peise, *v.a.* P. 540, i. 3377, iii. 2403;

v.n. v. 232, viii. 1169: weigh, feel by weight.

Pelage, ii. 1316.

Peleüs (1), iii. 2550.

Peleus (2), v. 3249 ff., 4187, Pelias.

pelote, s. v. 5349, ball.

pelrinage, s. i. 803, ii. 1315, iv. 1199.

penance, **penaunce**, s. P. 471, i. 1669, ii. 2316, viii. 477.

Peneie, v. 4006.

penne, s. iii. 271.

Penolope, iv. 152 ff., 1822, vi. 1471, viii. 2621.

penon, s. vi. 1650.

penonceal, s. viii. 988.

pensel, s. vi. 1553, 1733, pennon.

Pentapolim, viii. 658, 1966 ff.

peny, s. vii. 2125.

per, **par**, *prep.* P. 42*, i. 1521, 2049, 2225, ii. 1644, iii. 2604, iv. 39, 964, 1101, 1239, v. 3351.

peraunter, *adv.* ii. 563, perchance.

perce, v.a. iii. 451, iv. 2881, 3030, v. 1678, pierce.

Perce, *see* **Perse**.

perceive, v.a. i. 471, 899;
v.n. v. 2086.

perdurable, a. vii. 520, viii. 2976, eternal.

perfeccioun, s. P. 436.

periferie, s. vii. 265 ff.

peril, s. P. 381, i. 1076, iii. 185.

perjurie, s. v. 3225, perjure, v. 7617.

perle, s. iv. 1313, v. 3015, vii. 4334.

perled, *a.* i. 2510.

pernable, *a.* viii. 2931.

Peronelle, i. 3396.

perpetuel, *a.* vii. 98.

perplexete, s. viii. 2190.

perrie, s. i. 2997, v. 7117*, vi. 1135, vii. 1397, precious stones, stone.

Perse (1), **Perce**, P. 678 ff., ii. 2548, 2629 ff., iii. 2312, vii. 1784, 3433 ff., 4366 ff., Persia.

Perse (2), *see* **Perseüs** (2).

Perse (3), ii. 1784 ff., (name of a dog).

Perseüs (1), i. 419.

Perseüs (2), **Perse**, ii. 1620, 1647 ff., (king of Macedon).

Persiens, *pl.* P. 697.

persone, s. P. 71, i. 840, ii. 1098, iv. 160.

pes, s. P. 109, i. 1103, iv. 2046, PP. 62,
pees, P. 1061, PP. 35, peace, protection.

pese, s. v. 4409, pea.

pestilence, s. P. 279, ii. 1648, v. 1070.

pet, s. i. 2981, v. 4945 ff.,
pitt, i. 1908,
pl. **pettes**, v. 1114, 4047,
puttes, v. 4043, pit.

Peter, i. 656, ii. 3335, 3478, v. 1871, 1904,
genit. **Petres**, P. 234, PP. 230.

Petornius, v. 1520.

Petro, i. 3395.

Phara, vii. 3697.

Pharao, v. 1654.

Phares, v. 7023.

Pharisee, P. 305.

Phebe, iv. 3254.

Phebus, iii. 783 ff., 1688 ff., iv. 979 ff., 3197, 3243 ff., v. 6447 ff., 6740 ff., vii. 4704 ff.,

Phebum (*acc.*), v. 6719.

Phedra, *see* **Fedra**.

phesant, s. vi. 2223.

Pheton, iv. 983 ff.

Philemenis, iv. 2151.

Philemon, iv. 2405.

Philen, v. 4251.

Philerem, v. 1163.

Philippe (1), **Philipp**, vi. 2112, 2221.

Philippe (2), ii. 1616.

philliberd, s. iv. 869, filbert.

Phillis, iv. 743, 866 ff., viii. 2554.

Philogeüs, vii. 857.

Philomene, v. 5561 ff., viii. 2583.

philosophie, s. iii. 1219, iv. 2399, vi. 1404.

philosophre, s. ii. 2674, iii. 1201, iv. 2453,
philisophre, v. 2080.

Philotenne, viii. 1337.

Phinees, vii. 4432.

phisicien, s. viii. 1164, 3156.

phisique, s. ii. 3163, iv. 2420, 3304, vi. 663, 1409, vii. 71, 135;
medicine, treatment, physical science.

phisonomie, s. vi. 109.

phitonesse, s. iv. 1937, vi. 2387.

Phocus, iii. 2551.

Phoieus, s. iii. 2023 ff.

Phorceüs, i. 390.

Phyryns, v. 6372.

pich, s. v. 2176, 5349, viii. 1109, pitch.

Pictagoras, vi. 1410.

pie, s. iv. 3001, v. 1998, magpie.

piece, s. v. 1338,
al to pieces, iii. 465, 1048.

pier, s. i. 3337, iii. 1344, vii. 2461;
as a. i. 3365: peer, equal.

piereles, *a*. viii. 286, PP. 305.

pietous, *a*. vii. 3159, 3271, merciful.

pigne, s. v. 1010, pine.

pike, **pyke**, *v.a.n.* i. 698, 2568, iii. 500, iv. 2650, v. 6633, 6681, vii. 1590,
2282, pick, choose, assume.

pilage, s. v. 2071, 6172, vii. 2035, plunder, plundering.

pile(n), *v.a.n.* P. 401, iii. 2359, vii. 4053, plunder.

pilegrin, s. i. 2041, pilgrim.

Pileon, iv. 1980.

piler, s. iv. 2054, v. 1670, pillar.

pilour, s. iii. 2372, robber.

pilwe, s. i. 2986, iv. 3021, v. 540, pillow.

piment, *see* **pyment**.

pinacle, s. iv. 3662.

pipe, **pype**, s. iv. 3334, 3342, v. 1032, viii. 2675.

pipe, *v.n.* iv. 3343, v. 95, 1032.

pipinge, s. iv. 3345, viii. 2477.

Piramus, iii. 1376 ff., 1660, viii. 2543.

pire, *v.n.* vi. 818, peer.

piromance, s. vi. 1298, divination by fire.

Pirotouïs, vi. 489.

Pirrus, iv. 2161, v. 3195, viii. 2593.

Piscis, vii. 1216,

Pisces, vii. 1253.

pitance, s. vi. 877, portion (of food).

pite, s. P. 320, i. 2203, ii. 3174, vii. 3107 ff.,

pitee, vii. 3177*, mercy, pity.

pitous, *a.* i. 122, 680, 979, vii. 3125.

pitously, *adv.* iii. 1663, iv. 3621,

pitousliche, iv. 2810.

pitousnesse, s. vii. 3526.

pitt, *see* **pet**.

place, s. i. 136, 1314, 1513,

a place, i. 2377, iv. 2451,

cp. **aplace**.

planetrie, s. vii. 1469.

planete, s. iii. 1216, iv. 2467, v. 753, vii. 637 ff.

planisperie, s. vii. 1464.

plante, *v.a.* PP. 368.

planteine, s. vii. 1391.

plat, *adv.* i. 472, 1495, ii. 2047, vii. 4084, flatly, plainly.

plate, *s.* v. 3111, 7113*.

Plato, *vi.* 1404, viii. 2718.

plaunte, *s.* ii. 2370.

plede, *v.n.* vii. 2069.

pledour, *s.* ii. 3416.

ple, **plee**, *s.* ii. 3416, vii. 2068, plea.

pleie, *v.n.* i. 54, 348, 1764, 1854, 2031, v. 6786, vii. 2423,

pleye, *P.* 85*, viii. 3057*;

refl. i. 364, iii. 151;

v.a. iv. 904.

pleiefieres, *s.* pl. iv. 482.

pleigne, *v.n.* *P.* 183, 747, i. 999, ii. 446, 1650,

pleine, *iv.* 3180, complain.

pleignte, **pleinte**, *s.* i. 3026, ii. 293, iii.

1983, *iv.* 117, complaint.

plein, *a.* (1), *iv.* 1539, vii. 931,

def. **pleine**, *i.* 864, full.

plein, *a.* (2), *P.* 184, 408, *i.* 282, 736, vii. 2350, viii. 1982,

def. **pleine**, *v.* 5251,

pl. **pleyne**, viii. 3122, level, simple, plain, smooth.

plein, *adv.* i. 1490, 1656, ii. 1452, *iv.* 39, vii. 1594, fully, plainly.

pleine, **plein**, *s.* i. 113, 357, ii. 1498, *v.* 1287.

pleinly, **pleinli**, *adv.* *P.* 473, *i.* 127, ii. 1238, 2789,

pleinliche, *i.* 211, fully, plainly.

pleinte, *see* **pleignte**.

pleintif, *a.* *iv.* 154.

plenerliche, *adv.* *P.* 527, *i.* 1278,

plenerly, vii. 525, fully.

plente, s. P. 97, v. 2218.

plentivous, plentevous, *a.* v. 2147, vii. 931, abundant.

plesance, s. i. 882, 1499, 2617, ii. 1177.

plesant, *a.* i. 1503, v. 1295.

plese(n), *v.a.* P. 192, i. 1698, 3051, ii. 1450, v. 4761.

plesir, s. v. 501.

pley, s. P. 85*, vi. 1852, viii. 692.

pleye, *see pleie*.

pleyinge, s. viii. 3082*.

Pliades, vii. 1320.

plie, *v.a.* i. 578, 1249, ii. 3419,

plye, vii. 3871, bend;

v.n. i. 1779, iii. 871, iv. 3564, bend, submit;

 ii. 3146, strive.

plight, s. vii. 4228, engagement.

plihte, plyhte (1), *v.a.* iii. 1508,

pret. **plihte, plyhte**, i. 822, ii. 1205,

pp. **plihht**, iv. 757, engage.

plihte (2), *v.a.pret.*,

to plihte, v. 850, tore in pieces.

plit, s. P. 57, 296, i. 989, 1663, 2579, ii. 692, v. 2031,

plyt, ii. 2980, condition, state of things, manner.

plover, s. vi. 943.

plowh, plouh, s. i. 1566, 3257, iii. 514, v. 3720,

plogh, iv. 2383, plough, ploughed land.

plowed, *a.* vii. 1162, of the plough.

plowman, s. ii. 3422.

Pluto, iv. 2851, v. 1104, 1146, 1290, 4052.

plye, *see* **plie**.

plyhte, *see* **plihthe**.

pocock, s. v. 6498.

poepple, s. P. 107, i. 1193.

poesie, s. iv. 1038, 2668, v. 6806.

poete, s. i. 386, ii. 121, viii. 2719.

point, i. 73, 1229, iii. 308, viii. 2579 f.,

(**poynt**, vii. 3157*),

pl. **pointz**, i. 288, vii. 1706;

in the point as (as soon as), P. 268,

in p. to, ii. 1016,

in good p., ii. 2792,

cp. vii. 4654,

out of p., i. 1304: point, condition, manner.

pointure, s. vii. 1048, prick.

pliced, *pp.* i. 2543, polished.

policie, s. iii. 459, vii. 1683, 1986, &c.

Poliphemus, **Polipheme**, ii. 107 ff.

Polixenen, iv. 1696,

Polixena, v. 7593, viii. 2593.

pomel, iii. 307, 1443.

pompe, s. P. 304, i. 2685, ii. 1773.

Pompeie, v. 5533, vii. 3215 ff.

Pompilius, *see* **Neuma**.

Pontsorge, ii. 3003.

pope, s. P. 371, 745, ii. 635, 2809 ff., PP. 383.

popi, s. iv. 3007, poppy.

por reposer, viii. 2907.

porchace, *see* **purchase**.

pore, *see* **povere**.

porpartie, *see* **pourpartie**.

porpos, *see* **pourpos**.

porsuite, *see* **poursuite**.

port, s. (1), i. 674, 3429, iv. 1187, v. 1426, viii. 2195, bearing, behaviour, kind.

port, s. (2), viii. 387, harbour.

porte, s. ii. 1114 ff., porthole.

porveaunce, *see* **pourveance**.

positif, *a.* P. 247, iii. 172.

possessioun (-on), s. P. 684, ii. 3480, v. 64, v. 1685.

pot, s. iii. 656, vii. 3742,
pl. **pottes**, P. 614, vi. 914.

potestat, s. iv. 3522.

poudre, *see* **pouldre**.

pouer, P. 144, i. 2892, ii. 928, iii. 1779,
(**power**, viii. 3062 ff.).

Poul, ii. 3335, 3478, v. 1910.

pouldre, **poudre**, s. P. 623, i. 2003, vii. 354, powder.

Poulins, iv. 2420.

pound, s. iv. 2591, v. 2719.

purchase, **purchase**, *v.a.* i. 816, iii. 1484, iv. 1996,
purchase, P. 129, viii. 3132,
porchace, v. 4684, procure, seek after;
v.n. i. 2157, ii. 3504, v. 2001, vi. 1944, endeavour, make gain, succeed.

pourchas, s. v. 6089, gain.

poure, *v.a.* iii. 679, v. 2222, pour.

pourpartie, s. i. 406, v. 7000,
porpartie, v. 1691, share.

pourpos, s. i. 642, 1178,
porpos, v. 3363.

pourpose, *v.a.n.* ii. 2528,
purpose, P. 53;
refl. v. 1988.

pourpre, s. vi. 990, purple.

pours, **purs**, s. ii. 2683 ff., v. 5093 ff., purse.

poursuiant, s. ii. 2552,
pl. **poursuiantz**, ii. 239, suitor.

poursuie, *v.a.* i. 946, iv. 2685,
poursewe, iv. 3453, pursue, attain to;
v.n. ii. 255, 2630, iii. 1673, vi. 2406, make pursuit, continue.

poursuite, **porsuite**, s. iv. 28, v. 4423.

pourtreie, *v.a.* vii. 4876.

pourtreture, s. iv. 2421, v. 757.

pourveance, s. P. 585, i. 1916, 2028, v. 926, 5539,
porveaunce, **porveance**, P. 188, v. 2674, providence, foresight,
provision.

pourveie, *v.a.* i. 843, iv. 204,
pp. **pourveid**, v. 4021,
pourveied, vii. 1681;
v.n. ii. 1327;
impers. viii. 24: provide, ordain.

pourveour, s. v. 1997, procurer.

povere, *a.* P. 227, i. 2098, 3010,
pore, viii. 2411;
as subst. P. 317, vi. 1004;
superl. **the povereste**, iv. 2238.

poverte, s. P. 303, i. 1353, iv. 2219.

power, *see* **pouer**.

practique, s. iv. 2612, vii. 41, 1648 ff., method, moral science.

prance, *v.n.* vi. 1191.

preche(n), *v.a.* ii. 3433, iii. 2500, v. 3361 (admonish);
v.n. P. 231, i. 1277.

prechinge, s. v. 1906.

prechour, s. ii. 3356.

precious, *a.* v. 1549,
pl. **precieuse**, iv. 1354.

preferre, *v.a.* ii. 3073, 3254, iv. 1806, vii. 2824.

preie, s. iii. 1393, 2605, prey.

preie, *v.a.n.* P. 231, i. 804, 3195, iv. 369,
praie, ii. 1933, viii. 2998,
(**preye**, P. 31*, 66*),
prai (1 *s.pres.*) i. 220,
3 *s.pres.* **preith**, P. 748,
pret. **preide**, P. 600, i. 1549, ii. 1120, iv. 398, 1368,
preyde, iv. 192,
pp. **preid**, v. 4241,
imperat. **prei**, i. 2937, vi. 451; pray to, pray for, pray.

preiere, s. i. 794, iii. 135, iv. 172, 3231, prayer.

preise, *v.a.n.* P. 539, i. 2120, ii. 394, v. 231.

preisinge, s. ii. 407.

preiyng, s. vi. 426.

prelacie, s. P. 287, v. 1902.

prelat, s. P. 294, vii. 4246,
pl. **prelatz**, v. 1850, PP. 247.

prenostik, s. ii. 1793, presage.

preparacion, s. vii. 1429.

pres, press, presse, s. iv. 148, 2162, v. 4, 2440, 7253, viii. 904, 2751,
crowd, eagerness:

in presse, iv. 2849, down below (*cp.* Chaucer, *Troilus*, i. 559).

presage, s. ii. 1790.

presence, s. i. 1635, 2071, ii. 757, v. 1069.

present, s. v. 4204,
in present, v. 3595,
pl. **presens**, vi. 1497, gift.

present, *a.* P. 587, ii. 1368.

presente, *v.a.* v. 1911, viii. 2307;
refl. v. 2093.

preserve, *v.a.* vii. 3856, viii. 1961.

press, presse, s. *see* **pres**.

presse, *v.a.* ii. 462, 1733;
v.n. viii. 2752.

prest, priest, s. i. 193 ff., iii. 2275, 2556,
pl. **prestes**, i. 810.

presthod(e), s. P. 259, viii. 2079.

presumpcioun, s. i. 1989.

pretoire, s. vii. 2847.

Priamus, iii. 975, 1890, v. 7226 ff., viii. 2523, 2592.

pricke, s. P. 396, i. 3311, iii. 116.

pride, s. P. 224, i. 581 &c.

pride, pryde, *v.refl.* i. 2372, ii. 1811;
pp. **prided**, PP. 257.

prie, *v.n.* iv. 1176, v. 7078,
pryhe, v. 470.

priente, s. i. 555, vi. 2149, print.

prieve, *see* **prove, proeve**.

prike, *v.a.n.* i. 2036, iv. 997, vi. 1191, spur, ride.

prime, *s.* v. 3880.

primerole, *s.* vii. 1214, 1362, primrose.

prince, *s.* P. 45, ii. 633, iii. 1005.

prinche, *v.n.* v. 4854.

principal, *a.* i. 307, 581, iv. 2489, v. 1115;

as subst. iii. 1282, v. 1995, 6446,

in principal, vii. 29.

prioress, *s.* v. 891.

pris, *s.* P. 42, i. 848, 1900, 2525, 2755, 3304, 3329, vii. 3966,

priss, vii. 4364, value, prize, fame, praise:

sette pris of, i. 3068, iii. 1454, iv. 908, value,

stonde in p., iv. 2632, v. 1708,

cp. ii. 278, be valued, be praised.

prisoner, *s.* iii. 2375, v. 7212, vii. 2374.

prisoun (-on), *s.* ii. 1854, iv. 1042 ff., v. 5734;

prisone, vii. 2630.

prive, **pryve**, *v.a.* vii. 3270, 4040, deprive.

prive, *a.* i. 815, 1738, ii. 2858, vii. 121,

privi, v. 7621,

(**preve**, PP. 128),

in prive, ii. 686; secret.

prively (-li), *adv.* i. 898, 2069, v. 2143,

privelich(e), ii. 1695, v. 1247.

privete, **privite**, *s.* i. 1660, ii. 1416, 1651,

pl. **privetes**, i. 2806.

privilege, **privilege**, P. 103, v. 7173, vii. 1989,

(**previlege**, PP. 245).

probleme, *s.* i. 3071, viii. 1681.

procede, *v.n.* P. 405, 1025, iv. 1.

process, s. viii. 269.

processioun, s. i. 1140, v. 7560.

proclame, v.a. P. 88, ii. 3039, iv. 2478.

procurour, s. v. 2862.

prodegalite, s. v. 7645, vii. 2026.

proeve(n), prove(n), v.a.n. P. 556, 926, 948, i. 61, 758, 1851, iii. 2311,
prieve, vii. 126, try, prove, appear.

professed, pp. v. 890, 1805, viii. 1848, bound by vow.

professioun (-on), s. ii. 2383, viii. 1266.

profit, s. P. 295, ii. 348., iii. 2468, v. 188.

profitable, a. ii. 2201, PP. 300.

profite, v.n. iv. 2298, 2572.

profre, v.a.n. and refl. iii. 1988, iv. 1130,
 3 s.pres. **proferth**, i. 1693,
profreth, i. 1772, v. 5322, 6923, offer.

profre, s. iii. 1989, v. 4745, offer.

progenie, s. ii. 592, iv. 2701.

Progne, v. 5559 ff., viii. 2583.

prolacioun (-on), s. ii. 2875, vii. 173, utterance.

prolificacion, iv. 3248, fruitfulness.

prologe, s. P. 66.

promission, s. v. 1686, promise.

Promotheüs, iv. 2422, v. 1523.

pronounce, v.a. ii. 391, v. 7321.

prophecie, s. P. 588, ii. 1857, iii. 764.

prophecie, v.a. v. 1167.

prophete, s. v. 1693, vi. 1093, vii. 2560.

prophetesse, s. ii. 1802.

proporcion, s. v. 2531, 7245.

propre, *a.* P. 258, 535, i. 3393, ii. 2365, iii. 2361, iv. 2543, proper, own, appropriate;
adv. vii. 4011, for (his) own part.

proprely (-li), *adv.* i. 299, ii. 289, v. 1328, vii. 1268,
properly, P. 947,
propreliche, iv. 5.

proprete, s. P. 929, ii. 2377, iii. 2326, v. 1336,
(**proprite**, PP. 326),
pl. **propretes**, i. 257, iii. 1225,
propretees, vii. 63.

Proserpine, Proserpina, iv. 2850, v. 1277, 4053.

prosperite, s. i. 2802, iv. 1213.

proteccioun, s. v. 2573, viii. 3040*.

Protheselai, iv. 1901.

Protheüs, v. 3082, 6672.

proud, *a.* P. 347, 712, v. 198,
def. **proude**, P. 222, i. 1980;
sup. **proudest**, i. 1996.

proudly, *adv.* i. 1912.

prouesse (-esce), P. 98, i. 1083, ii. 2589, iv. 2302.

prove, v. *see* **proeve**.

prove, s. ii. 1673,
prieve, ii. 2022, vi. 1924, trial.

Provence, ii. 3004.

provende, s. P. 210, prebend.

proverbe, s. P. 786, v. 6631, vi. 448, vii. 1961.

providence, s. ii. 1322, iv. 863, vii. 3941.

province, s. vii. 2770.

provisour, s. v. 2905.

prudence, s. iv. 2652, v. 2289.

prune, *v.refl.* vi. 2203, trim (oneself).

Prus, iv. 1630.

pryhe, *see* **prie**.

pryve, *see* **prive**, v.

Pseudo, v. 1879.

Puile, v. 2064 ff., 2646.

puison, **puyson**, s. i. 2645, ii. 565, iii. 2457, vi. 2246, poison.

pulle, *v.a.* P. 400, ii. 1788,
imperat. **pull**, iv. 723.

purchase, *see* **purchase**.

pure, *a.* P. 742, i. 1721, 1987, iii. 2214;
sup. **the purest**, P. 921; pure, mere, absolute.

pure, *v.a.* iv. 2555.

purefie, **purifie**, *v.a.* i. 1044, ii. 3460.

purgatoire, s. i. 1776, 2682.

purge, *v.a.* i. 1039.

purifie, *see* **purefie**.

purpose, *see* **pourpose**.

purs, *see* **pours**.

pusillamite, s. iv. 314, 707, vii. 3527.

put, s. *see* **pet**.

pute(n), *v.a.inf.* i. 462, ii. 1551, iii. 547, 2648, iv. 1641,
putte, iv. 2288,
put, i. 1578, 3213, ii. 93,
1 s.pres. **put**, i. 732, v. 2951,

3 s. **put**, i. 690, ii. 2493,
3 pl. *pres. (subj.) putte*, v. 608,
pret. putte, P. 1069, i. 2797,
pitte, viii. 2796,
put, P. 683, 693, 718, i. 1013, 1807,
putt (*pl.*), v. 7417,
imperat. sing. put, ii. 3154,
pl. putteth, ii. 1033.

pyke, *see pike*.

pyl, s. ii. 390, pile (*as in the phrase 'cross or pile'*).

Pymaleon, iv. 372.

pyment, **piment**, s. vi. 218, 337.

pyne, s. v. 4020, pain.

Q

quake, *v.n.*,
pret. quok, qwok, iii. 258, vi. 2206.

qualite, s. P. 954.

quant, *see tant*.

quarel, s. v. 7239, bolt.

queene, **queen**, **quen**, *see qwene*.

queint, **queynte**, *see quenche*.

queinte, **qweinte**, *a.* i. 283, 2730, ii. 2853, iv. 2314, v. 4623, viii. 2687,
cunning, curious, gentle.

queintise, s. i. 906, ii. 2403, cunning.

queintise, *v.a.* viii. 2472, adorn.

quelle, *v.a.* v. 5357, kill.

queme, *see qweme*.

quenche, *v.a.* ii. 1627, vi. 452,
pret. queynte, v. 3697,

pp. **queint**, **queynt**, ii. 1556, 1748, v. 2223.

querele, *s.* P. 277, i. 134, 1822, ii. 16, v. 2066,
querelle, ii. 2703, 2967, cause, quarrel, enterprise.

querele, *v.n.* vii. 3172*.

queste, *s.* v. 2878.

questioun (-on), *s.* i. 1013, 1460, 3098, iii. 2245, question, torture.

quik, **quyk**, **qwik**, *a.* v. 6774, vii. 2898, viii. 2451,
def. **qwike**, ii. 2779,
pl.s. **qwike**, ii. 3405, alive, living.

quikselver, *s.* iv. 2475.

quit, **qwyt**, *a.* i. 1664, ii. 691, iii. 1588, iv. 661,
pl. **quyte**, iii. 2577, free, unpunished.

quite, **quyte**, *v.a.* i. 3347, iii. 1608, v. 7184*, viii. 1255,
(qwhiten, PP. 279),
pp. **quit**, iii. 2194, v. 7729; pay for, requite, acquit.

quod, *v.pret.* i. 183, 1273, 1557, 3183, said.

qwed, **qued**, *s.* iii. 1534, v. 3568, bad thing, villain.

qweinte, *see* **queinte**.

qweme, **queme**, *v.a.n.* ii. 197, iii. 902, v. 4366,
queeme, vii. 2312;
impers. iv. 746, 966: please, be pleasing.

qwene, **qweene**, *s.* i. 139, 1914, 2601,
queene, i. 132, queen, viii. 1896,
qwen, **quen**, v. 2543 ff.

qwik, *see* **quik**.

qwok, *see* **quake**.

qwyt, *see* **quit**.

R

racches, *s.pl.* v. 4388, hounds (hunting by scent).

Rachel, viii. 127.

rage, s. P. 1079, i. 2620, 2945, ii. 910, 1275,
pl. rages, vii. 3410.

rage, v.n. i. 1764, sport.

Rageman, s. viii. 2379, *see note*.

ragerie, s. v. 6258, sport.

Rages, vii. 5313.

ragged, a. v. 1509.

ragges, s.pl. i. 1723.

Raguel, vii. 5315.

raile, s. vi. 2201.

ramage, a. iii. 2430, wild.

Ramoth Galaath, vii. 2541.

rampe, v.n. vi. 2182, 2230, vii. 2573.

rancoun, s. v. 1755, vii. 3426.

rancour, iii. 2730, vii. 3443.

ransake, v.a. v. 6094.

rape, s. iii. 517, 1625, haste.

rape, v.n. iii. 1678, hasten.

Raphael, vii. 5358, viii. 44.

rase, v.n. v. 4090, run swiftly.

raised, pp. iv. 580, erased.

rasour, as a. ii. 830.

rathere, adv. comp. i. 2748, ii. 503, iv. 2195, 2756,

rather, P. 88*, iv. 1619, sooner, rather;

superl. rathest, i. 27, iii. 2121.

rave, v.n. iii. 91, vii. 4109, be mad, rage.

raven, s. iii. 812, 2077.

Ravenne, i. 2638.

ravine, s. iii. 2433, v. 5507 ff., rapine, robbery by violence.

raviner, s. v. 5530, 5627.

ravisht, *a.* iv. 683.

Razel, vi. 1316.

Rea, v. 849.

real, *a.* i. 2924, v. 5551, vii. 2449, viii. 1526, royal.

reali (-y), *adv.* viii. 1563, 1747, royally.

realme, s. vii. 49, 646.

realte, s. i. 2063, vii. 3810, royalty.

Rebecke, viii. 115.

rebell, ii. 1718, rebellious.

rebelle, *v.n.* v. 2065.

rebuke, *v.a.* v. 689, vii. 2668.

recche, *v.n.* ii. 2344, v. 4402,

pret. **rowhte**, iv. 3547,

roghte, v. 6383, have care;

v.a., *pret.* **roghte**, vii. 3010, care for;

impers. ii. 252, v. 4702,

pret. **roghte**, ii. 2403, iii. 664, v. 938, be a care (to).

receite, **receipte**, s. vi. 290, vii. 991, receiving, receptacle.

receive, **receyve**, *v.a.* P. 178, i. 872, 1208, viii. 1974,

resceive, vii. 1819, viii. 1287.

recepcion, s. vi. 1962.

reclame, *v.a.* v. 4724, vii. 1843, viii. 54, 2721, call back (as a hawk),
summon.

reclus, *a.* ii. 2817.

recomande, *v.a.* P. 29*, vi. 949.

reconcile, *v.a.* P. 185, v. 1743*,
reconsile, v. 1783, vii. 1578.

record, *s.* P. 122, i. 850, ii. 939, 1696, v. 3082, viii. 1518,
be (stonde) of r., i. 1116, 1632, 3363, iii. 2060.

recorde(n), *v.a.n.* P. 964, i. 481, ii. 106, 629, 892, iii. 1377, iv. 562, 1639,
v. 3681, viii. 2204, remember, take note of, relate, repeat.

recovere, *v.a.* iii. 578, 1998, iv. 1485, v. 303, 6579;
v.n. v. 2429, 4420: get back, make good, help; prosper.

recoverir, *s.* ii. 3159, v. 228, 6195, remedy, expedient.

recreacioun (-on), *s.* vi. 638, vii. 477.

red, *a.* iv. 386,
def. rede, v. 1661, 4011,
pl. rede, ii. 402;
as subst. the rede, iv. 2571: red.

red, *s.* i. 108, 1563, 2146, ii. 116, 2065,
to rede, iii. 1771, vii. 3634; advice, counsel.

reddour, *s.* iii. 348, v. 4558, vii. 3151, harshness, strictness.

rede, *v.a.n.* P. 15, i. 2271, ii. 104,
pret. radde, v. 3693,
pp. rad, ii. 1045, iv. 571,
imperat. red, vii. 1596, read: P. 16, i. 914, 1294,
1 s.pres. rede, i. 78, 1396, **red**, vi. 1359,
pret. radde, iv. 1842, advise, decide.

rede, *v.n.* iv. 185, v. 5988, grow red.

redely (-li), **redily**, **redyly**, *adv.* P. 948, i. 1533, ii. 1221, v. 297, 366,
1601, 2239, 6462, 7836, easily, quickly, eagerly.

redi, **redy**, *a.* P. 424, i. 856, 2093, ii. 3444, iii. 83, v. 1036:
adv. iii. 449.

redinesse, *s.* iv. 2356.

redinge, *s.* vi. 878.

redresce, *v.a.* P. 486, i. 3417, ii. 2427,
redresse, ii. 1801, (*pp.* **redressid**, viii. 3020); set right, reform.

redy, *see* **redi**.

reforme, *v.a.* i. 3035, ii. 3404, iv. 2945, vii. 1538, restore.

refreche, *v.a.* vi. 710.

refte, *v.a.pret.* v. 5697, viii. 2517.

refus, *s.* viii. 686, refused.

refuse, *v.a.n.* P. 74*, i. 1015, iii. 76, 1195, iv. 1238, 1750,
(*pp.* **refusid**, viii. 2963), deny, refuse.

regalie, *s.* P. 103, i. 2959, ii. 1022, vii. 1684, royal estate, royalty.

regiment, *s.* ii. 1751, vii. 915, 1245, 1702, rule, government.

regioun, **region**, *s.* iv. 2939, v. 2599, 6032.

registre, *s.* vii. 19.

registred, *v.a.pp.* ii. 3031.

regne, *s.* P. 127, 579, ii. 2651.

regne(n), *v.n.* P. 32*, i. 2890, 3036, v. 3253,
(*reigne*, PP. 331), reign.

reguard, *s.* iv. 3520.

reguerdoned, *v.a.pp.* iii. 2716.

reguerdoun, *s.* v. 2368.

reherce, **reherse**, *v.a.* i. 584, 1637, ii. 1682, iv. 3029, declare, repeat.

rein, **reyn**, *s.* iii. 692, vii. 286, viii. 1592,
pl. **reines**, i. 2987, rain.

reinbowe, *s.* v. 1185.

reine, **reyne**, *v.n.* i. 2925, iii. 689;
v.a. v. 1672: rain.

reins, *s.pl.* viii. 2819, reins (of the body).

reisshe, **reysshe**, *s.* ii. 42, v. 4694,

risshe, iv. 2853, rush.
rejoie, v.*refl.* vi. 208.
rekeninge, s. iii. 2283.
rekevere, v.*refl.* viii. 2129, recover:
cp. recovere.
rekne(n), v.*n.* iii. 64, vii. 1101.
relacion, s. vi. 2254, report.
reles, s. i. 1188, iii. 848, vi. 253, deliverance, release, power (?).
relesse, v.*a.* ii. 2904, 3322, iv. 1572, vii. 3005.
relief, s. vi. 640, satisfaction.
relieve, v.*a.* ii. 104, ii. 172, iii. 1316, 2636, v. 2135, 2628, vi. 678, raise
up, assist, relieve, satisfy.
religioun (-on), s. i. 623, viii. 158, 1265, 1456.
remembrance, s. P. 69, i. 1060, 3392, ii. 1519, iii. 2558,
remembraunce, iv. 449, memory, mention.
remembre, v. i. 2682, vii. 1118, have memory, remember.
remenant, s. P. 963, i. 1184, 3016, 3294.
remene, v.*a.* i. 279, v. 6541, (bring back), apply.
remission, s. v. 4445.
remuable, *a.* vii. 4896, unstable.
remue, v.*a.* i. 1327; iii. 1165;
v.*n.* iii. 1411, v. 5646; move, remove.
Remus, v. 900.
rende, v.*a.*,
pret. rente, iii. 2072.
rendre, v.*a.* viii. 1253, deliver.
renegat, s. ii. 1093.
renes, s.*pl.* iv. 998, reins (for driving).

renne, *v.n.* P. 505, ii. 24, 401, 1972,
 pret. ran, ii. 2296,
 pl. ronne, i. 373,
 runne, vii. 4869, viii. 750,
 pp. runne, v. 6127.

renomed, *a.* i. 2653.

renomée, *s.* iv. 1250.

renoun, *s.* iii. 1886, iv. 2154.

renounce, *v.a.* ii. 2931.

rente, *s.* i. 1566, 3356, v. 1053.

repast, *s.* vi. 698, 926.

repeire, *v.n.* vii. 1136.

repentaile, *s.* v. 6783, viii. 3101*.

repentance, *s.* i. 2446, iii. 803, v. 296.

repente, *v.a.n.* i. 757, iii. 2184, v. 2837;
 refl. iii. 1814, viii. 255;
 impers. vii. 5328.

replie, *v.n.* v. 4644.

repos, *s.* v. 508.

reposer, viii. 2907.

represse, *v.a.* vii. 2410, 3334*.

reprise, *s.* i. 3308, 3414, v. 4708, retribution, cost.

reproef, *s.* P. 490, vii. 4108.

reproeve(n), *v.a.* iii. 498, 1274, iv. 862,
 reprove, v. 4619.

reptil, *s.* vii. 1011.

requeste, *s.* ii. 1491,
 reqweste, PP. 27.

reresouper, s. vi. 911, late supper.
rerewarde, s. ii. 1827, rear-guard.
res, s. iii. 1152, 1671, vi. 58, haste.
resceive, *see* **receive**.
rescoue, v.a. i. 667, vi. 96,
 rescowe, v. 2019, save, deliver.
rescousse, ii. 1700, iii. 2085, v. 2551,
 rescouss, iv. 2146, rescue.
resemblable, a. P. 950.
resemblance, s. ii. 1376, iv. 2424.
resemblant, a. iv. 2492.
resembled, v.a.pp. ii. 2839, v. 251, compared.
resigne, v.a. P. 776, ii. 2931.
resistence, s. P. 387, i. 2154.
resonable, a. P. 359, i. 1030, ii. 276, iii. 389.
resoun, **reson**, P. 151, 488, i. 775, 2675, ii. 2495, iii. 245, iv. 652.
respit, s. iv. 1563, vii. 3828, 5200.
respite, v.a. i. 1053, 1593, iii. 2672, save, i. 2213, vii. 1617, delay;
 v.n. i. 1456, delay.
restauracioun, s. vi. 637.
restauratif, a. vi. 859.
reste, s. P. 110, i. 998, 1604, ii. 2509.
reste(n), v.n. ii. 1135, 1476, iv. 736, 1670;
 v.a. vii. 2936;
 refl. viii. 1308.
resting place, s. vii. 1865.
restore, v.a. P. 761, iii. 1827, 2480, vii. 4445.
restreigne, v.a. P. 510, i. 2660, ii. 889, 1168, restrain, keep back.

retenance, retienance, s. ii. 1576, v. 7467, vii. 1054, retinue.

retenue, s. i. 1328, ii. 3409, iii. 1166, 2421, service, retinue.

rethorien, s. vi. 1399.

rethorike, rethorique (-qe), s. iv. 2649, vi. 1401, vii. 36, 1523 ff., 1631.

retorn, s. vii. 4121.

retorne, v.n. vii. 1428.

retret, s. viii. 2416.

reule, s. P. 108, 803, i. 883,

rewle, iii. 1169,

rule, vi. 9.

reule(n), v.a.n. P. 252, 497, i. 17, 808, ii. 1322,

rewle, iii. 2250.

revel, s. v. 3143.

revelacion, s. viii. 49, 2806.

revelen, v.n. iv. 2719, revel.

reverence, s. P. 298, i. 218, 3291, ii. 1358, 2843, v. 322.

revers, a. ii. 222, 2105, v. 7658, vi. 1418;

subst. iii. 2289: opposite, contrary.

reversed, pp. P. 30.

revile, v.a. v. 2806, vii. 4635, debase, abuse.

revolucion, s. iv. 1783.

reward, s. iii. 345, iv. 2024, v. 4978, regard, reward.

rewarde, v.a. v. 171, 4471, viii. 2374.

rewardinge, s. iii. 1596, v. 5195.

rewe, v.a.n. P. 164, 1004, iii. 1610, 1625, v. 5760, vii. 3233, repent, be
 sorry, have pity.

rewe, s. *see* **rowe**.

reyn, *see* **rein**.

reyne, *see* **reine**.

reyni, **reyny**, *a.* i. 692, iii. 988, iv. 2979, rainy.

ribald, *s.* vii. 2383 ff.

Richard, *P.* 25, viii. 2987*,
genit. **Richardes**, *P.* 24*.

riche, *a.* *P.* 633, i. 814, 2537;
as subst. vi. 1072;
sup. **richest**, **the richeste**, i. 1098, v. 2612.

riche, *s.* i. 2278, domain.

riche, *v.a.* iv. 2265, v. 2398, 7744, enrich.

richeliche, *adv.* iv. 1371.

richesse, *s.* *P.* 97, ii. 737, iv. 514, 2208,
pl. **richesses**, vi. 633.

ride, **ryde(n)**, *v.a.n.* i. 350, 2035, ii. 945, 3194, iv. 1106, v. 7404, vi.
1188,
pret.sing. **rod**, i. 348, ii. 1136,
pl. **riden**, ii. 1272, v. 1293,
imperat. **ryd**, i. 1562,
pp. **ride**, vii. 2859;
cam ride, &c., i. 350, iv. 1307: ride, make expedition, lie at anchor.

riedes, *s.pl.* v. 1031, reeds.

rif, *a.* ii. 1618, rife, current.

riff, *s.* viii. 1983, reef (of a sail).

rifle, *v.a.* iii. 2384, v. 6521.

rigole, *v.a.* v. 1436, delight (wantonly).

riht, *a.*, **rihte**, vii. 1312,
def. **rihte**, **ryhte**, *P.* 232, i. 33, 1052, ii. 947,
(**righte**, viii. 3091),
riht, iii. 300:
adv. **riht**, **ryht**, *P.* 682, 829, i. 639, 1862, 3362, ii. 1789, right, *P.* 50,
rihte, v. 5351, vii. 545.

riht, ryht, s. P. 271, 795,
right, P. 251, viii. 3023,
ryhte, v. 898,
be rihte, vii. 2137,
at alle rihtes, v. 3530.

rihte, ryhte, v.a. ii. 589, iv. 821, v. 3058, vii. 2728,
(**righte**, PP. 252),
pret. **rihte**, vii. 5072, direct, arrange;
v.n. ii. 3071, go right.

rihtful, rihtfull, a. vii. 2833, 2918, 3814, 4122,
(**rightful**, PP. 59, 383), just, true.

rihtwisnesse, ryhtwisnesse, s. P. 109, i. 2936, v. 1645,
(**rightwisnesse**, viii. 3035), righteousness.

rime, s. iv. 2414, rhyme.

rime, v.a. v. 1370, put in rhyme.

rinde, rynde, s. i. 3261, v. 324, 4123, bark.

ring, s. i. 2420, ii. 2614,
ryng, v. 7119*.

ringe, v.a.,
pp. **runge**, ii. 1728, iii. 452.

riote, s. v. 1217, 5240, 5278, vii. 1378,
riot, v. 7131*, riot, disorder.

riote, v.refl. vii. 4320.

ripe, a. i. 2822, ii. 2579.

rise, ryse, v.n. P. 544, v. 7135*,
pret. **ros**, iv. 436,
pp. **rise**, ii. 1427.

risinge, s. vii. 1085.

risshe, *see* **reisshe**.

rivage, s. vi. 1435, viii. 1615, landing place.

rivele, *v.n.* i. 1681, be wrinkled;
pp. **riveled**, viii. 2829.

rivere, *s.* i. 1043, ii. 2161, v. 1014.

ro, *s.* iv. 2786, roe.

robbe, *v.a.n.* v. 207, 993, 6107.

robberie, *s.* iii. 2212, v. 6083 ff., 6142.

Roboas, vii. 4029, 4128.

roche, *s.* i. 2305, iii. 1048, v. 6814,
pl. **rockes**, iii. 1034, 1054, rock.

rocke, *v.a.* ii. 1081.

rockes, *s.pl.* *see* **roche**.

rodd, *s.* i. 2898, iv. 1276.

rode, *s.* (1), i. 1730, iv. 1629, journey, raid.

rode, *s.* (2), vi. 773, ruddy colour.

rode, *s.* (3), ii. 1161, rood.

Rodes, iv. 1630.

rodi, **rody**, *a.* iv. 385, v. 2471, viii. 1909, ruddy.

Rodopeie, iv. 734.

rof, *s.* ii. 2947, roof.

rolle, *v.n.* iii. 313, vii. 3707.

romance, *s.* vi. 878.

Romanie, ii. 2638, vii. 5155.

rome, *a.n.* v. 6502.

Rome, P. 715 ff., 845, i. 763 ff., ii. 588 ff., 1195 ff., 1315 ff., 1448 ff.,
1638 ff., 2502 ff., 2803, 3039, 3189, 3476 ff., iii. 100, iv. 2647, v.
904, 1067, 1435, 2031 ff., 2196, 2393, 4939, 5020, 5125, 6359 ff.,
6811, 7104* ff., vii. 1598, 2061, 2347, 2361 ff., 2448, 2767, 2785,

2882 ff., 3145, 3216 ff., 3269 ff., 3946, 4188, 4636 ff., 5131 ff., viii.
199, 2717, PP. 353;

Rome lond, P. 715,

Rome gate, ii. 1537.

Romein, *a.* ii. 1406, 1829, 2565, iv. 2639;

subst. P. 768, i. 764, ii. 2554 ff., vii. 2846, 4594,

Romain, viii. 2633,

pl. **Romeins**, P. 737, 841, ii. 679, 1774 ff., 2777, v. 1068 ff., 1307,
2199 ff., vii. 2336, 3061, 4697 ff.

Romelond, ii. 2544.

Romeward, ii. 1173, v. 2190.

Romulus, v. 900, vii. 3061.

rondeal, *s.* i. 2709, 2727.

ronne, *see* **renne**.

rooted, *a.* i. 1319.

rore, *v.n.* ii. 160, roar.

rore, *s.* vi. 2183.

rose, *s.* i. 603, ii. 402.

Rosemounde, i. 2481.

rosine, *s.* v. 2176, rosin.

Rosiphelee, iv. 1249.

rosmarine, *s.* vii. 1407.

rote, *s.* (1), P. 118, i. 145, 2838, iv. 134,

roote, vii. 3336*, root.

rote, *s.* (2), vi. 1312, 1457, custom, condition.

rote, *s.* (3), viii. 829, (a musical instrument).

rother, *s.* ii. 2494, rudder.

round, *a.* iv. 1147, vi. 777,

pl. **rounde**, vi. 1327:

adv. i. 358, 2829, iv. 3005.

roune, *v.n.* ii. 45, 1944, iv. 407, v. 478;
v.a. v. 2460: whisper.

rounge, *v.n.* ii. 520, nibble.

route, *s.* P. 793, i. 2734, ii. 2997, iii. 2389, v. 1910, 5054, company,
quantity:
al a route, iv. 2145, v. 6932.

route, *v.n.* iv. 2731, 3272, v. 6895, snore.

routhe, *see rowthe*.

rovere, *s.* iii. 2369.

rowe, *s.* ii. 1960, iv. 26, 2238,
rewe, viii. 998, row, company;
be rowe, vi. 1315, in order:
cp. **arowe**, **arewe**.

rowe, *v.n.* (1), P. 40*, i. 1961, iv. 1781;
v.a. ii. 1905: row.

rowe, *v.n.* (2), iii. 1057, dawn.

rowthe, **routhe**, *s.* i. 182, 1200, iii. 1597, v. 5394, pity.

rueke, *v.n.* iv. 1669, crouch.

ruide, **rude**, ii. 173, iv. 946, v. 2571, viii. 3122.

ruine, *s.* P. 837, v. 1706.

rule, *see reule*.

runge, *see ringe*.

rust, *s.* iv. 2494, 2557.

rusti, *a.* viii. 1378.

ryde, *see ride*.

ryht, **ryhtwisnesse**, *see riht*, &c.

ryve, *s.* vi. 1429, viii. 516, shore.

S

Saba, v. 6833, 6932.

sable, s. viii. 2904.

sacre, v.a. vii. 4510, worship.

sacrement, s. PP. 309.

sacrifice, **sacrifise**, s. i. 1120, 1141, iii. 1995, iv. 2966.

sacrifie, v.a.n. i. 1128, iv. 1519, viii. 1826, sacrifice, offer.

sacrilege, s. v. 6979 ff.,
 sacrilege, v. 7016*, 7090.

sadd, a. vii. 226, firm.

sadel, s. iv. 1202,
 pl. **saddles**, iv. 1312.

sage, a. v. 7455.

saghte, *see* **sawht**.

Sagittarius, **Sagittaire**, vii. 1143, 1150, 1258.

sai, **sain**, **saide**, &c., *see* **seie**.

sail, *see* **seil**.

saintuaire, s. P. 322.

sake, s. P. 24, i. 209, 2474, ii. 585.

sal armoniak, s. iv. 2480.

Salamyne, iv. 3652.

sale, s. v. 5084.

salfly, *see* **saufly**.

salge, s. vii. 1385.

saliens, *see* **Capra**.

Salomon, iv. 2340, vi. 93, 1317, 1407, vii. 3594, 3865, 3891 ff., 4027,
 4477 ff., viii. 2691, PP. 29.

salt, s. iv. 1837.

salte, a. iv. 1666, 3092, v. 1342,
pl. v. 1347.

salue, v.a. ii. 1504, greet.

Salustes, **Saluste**, ii. 1199, 1220.

salvacion, s. ii. 3361, v. 1795.

salvage, a. iv. 2262, vii. 4112, wild.

salve, s. P. 134, 396, ii. 2788, viii. 2290, cure.

salvely, *see* **saufly**.

Samarie, iv. 1938, vi. 2387, vii. 2554.

same, a. i. 1585;
as subst. P. 461, i. 629, 3032.

same, *adv.* v. 3375, together.

Samele, v. 1044.

Sampnites, *pl.* vii. 2787.

Sampson, vi. 94, viii. 2703.

Samuel, iv. 1936 ff., vii. 3821 ff.

sanguin, a. vii. 455.

sanz, *prep.* iii. 1550, v. 508.

saphir, s. vii. 1342.

sapience, s. v. 1205.

Sarazin, s. iii. 2489, iv. 1679, vii. 3702 ff., 4412, PP. 250;
fem. **Sarazine**, ii. 705, vii. 4496, viii. 2694.

Sardana Pallus, vii. 4314, Sardanapalus.

sardis, vii. 1416, sard.

Sarra, vii. 5315.

Satiri, *pl.* v. 1327.

satureie, s. vii. 1423, savory.

Saturnus, Saturne, Satorne, iv. 2445, v. 845 ff., 1133 ff., 1221, 1388, vi. 1293;

(the planet) iv. 2471, 3223, vii. 937, 1115, 1174, 1188, 1330, 1340, 1374, 1427, viii. 2275.

sauf, *a.* P. 104, ii. 181, iv. 917,

sauf conduit, v. 994,

saulf, P. 1016,

pl. **save**, ii. 1157, iv. 1453, 2172, safe:

adv. ii. 935, 2188, safely:

as prep. i. 432,

save, i. 1271,

salve, v. 1359, save, except;

save ... that, iv. 3497.

saufly, saufli, *adv.* i. 1469, 3152, ii. 3309, v. 2159,

saufliche, v. 3617,

salvely, v. 2932,

salfly, v. 2965, safely.

Saül, iv. 1935 ff., vi. 2384, vii. 3821 ff.

saundres, *s.pl.* ii. 1961.

save, *v.a.* P. 470, i. 941, 1300, iii. 927.

save, *prep.*, *see* **sauf**.

saveine, s. vii. 1353.

savinge, s. v. 2794, vii. 3383.

savour, s. iv. 2495, v. 587.

sawe, s. ii. 588, 1396, iii. 431, iv. 2684, saying, speech.

sawht, *pp.a.* iii. 2742, reconciled,

saghte (*pl.*), viii. 1149, at peace.

Saxon, ii. 723,

Saxoun (language), ii. 1405.

say, s. ii. 2090, trial.

scales, *see* **skales**.

scars, *see* **skars**.

scarsly, *see* **skarsly**.

scarsnesse, *see* **skarsnesse**.

sceptre, *s.* ii. 589, PP. 378.

schake, *v.a.*, *pp.* v. 570,
pret. **schok**, vi. 2205.

schal, *v.* 1, 3 *s.pres.* P. 15, 93, i. 1711, iv. 377, 2823,
2 *s.* **schalt**, P. 589,
pl. **schulle(n)**, i. 2251, 2558,
schul(l), i. 3197, 3246, v. 1914,
schule, v. 3529,
schol, P. 1034,
pret. **scholde(n)**, P. 43, 153, 275, 362, 421, &c.,
schold, ii. 578,
schulde(n), P. 317, v. 5357, viii. 2961,
(**schuldyn**, viii. 3004): shall, must, may.

schale, *s.* iv. 566, (nut) shell.

schallemele, *s.* viii. 2483, shawm.

schame, *s.* i. 274, 1668, ii. 3062, 3355, iv. 871.

schame, *v.a.* iii. 2200, v. 723.

schameles, *a.* vii. 1964, free from shame.

schanckes, *s.pl.* iv. 2725, legs.

schape(n), *v.a.n. and refl.* P. 387, i. 297, 820, 1514, 1551, 3342,
pret. **schop**, P. 706, ii. 2855, iii. 1206,
schope, v. 4278,
pl. **schope(n)**, i. 1105, 2627,
pp. **schape(n)**, i. 1195, 1509, 1544; shape, appoint, contrive, prepare,
bring about.

schaply, *a.* ii. 3112.

schappe, *s.* i. 1736, shape.

schapthe, s. vi. 785, shape.

scharnebud, s. ii. 413, dung-beetle.

scharpe, *a.* P. 396, iii. 252, iv. 2417, vii. 170.

scharpnesse, s. P. 1084.

schave, *v.a.* viii. 1303.

schawe, s. iv. 1293, v. 6133, wood.

sche, *pron.* P. 853, i. 148, &c.,
scheo, i. 160.

schede(n), *v.a.* iii. 2243, vii. 3493,
pret. **schedde**, PP. 148,
pp. **schad**, iv. 1661, PP. 105.

schedinge, s. iii. 1105, 2534.

scheete, s. viii. 1194.

scheld, *see* **schield**.

schelle, s. vi. 2228, vii. 615, viii. 2120.

schenche, *v.a.* ii. 3098, pour out.

schent, *v.a.pp.* i. 1292, iii. 450, iv. 554, v. 728, harmed, ruined.

schep, **schiep**, s. P. 399, v. 3271,
pl. P. 414, iv. 2894.

scheperdesse, s. v. 6115.

schepherde, s. P. 394, 1064, iii. 2257.

scherded, (*pp.*) *a.* v. 3707.

scherdes, *s.pl.* vi. 1985, scales.

schere, *v.a.* v. 4001,
pp. **schore**, i. 1751, cut, crop.

scheres, *s.pl.* v. 5691.

scherte, s. i. 2171, ii. 2243,
schortes (*pl.*), i. 2179.

schete, *v.n.*,

3 *s.pres.* **schet**, ii. 2957,

pret. **schotte**, v. 4862, shoot.

schette, *v.a.* ii. 2130,

pret. **schette**, vi. 1587,

pp. **schet**, ii. 2807, iii. 2043;

v.n. iii. 1453, vii. 4623: shut.

schewe(n), *v.a.* P. 112, i. 84, 1035, ii. 603,

imperat. **schew**, **scheu**, i. 185, v. 6190, show;

v.n. P. 46, 834, i. 626, ii. 1921, iii. 809, 857, appear, be evident.

schield, **scheld**, *s.* i. 421, 1998, 2470, ii. 2594.

schiep, *see* **schep**.

schifte, *v.a.* iii. 1310, v. 3166, 4668, vii. 1518, viii. 556, arrange, dispose of, turn.

schilde, **schylde**, *v.a.* P. 67*, ii. 714, iv. 2753, v. 6334, vi. 1244;

v.n. 266: protect, defend.

schip, *s.* i. 1065, ii. 24,

be schipe, P. 1016, iv. 731,

to (into) schipe, i. 1164, ii. 1108,

to schip, viii. 1573.

schipman, *s.* i. 500, iii. 991, viii. 1084.

schode, *v.a.* i. 1750, vii. 1534, divide.

schof, *see* **schowve**.

scholde, *see* **schal**.

schoo, **scho**, *s.* P. 356, vii. 4306, shoe.

schort, *a.* i. 1687, iv. 1709,

schorte, vii. 5201,

pl. **schorte**, ii. 903, iii. 874.

schortly, **schortli**, *adv.* i. 1690, v. 2603.

schote, *s.* ii. 2238, shot.

schour, s. vii. 290,
pl. schoures, v. 4173, 7829,
shoures, P. 938.

schovele, s. v. 16, shovel.

schowve, v.a. ii. 2340,
pret. schof, ii. 174, iv. 108,
pp. schoven, vii. 3280, push, thrust.

schreden, v.a. i. 2837, tear.

schrewe, s. iii. 798, 2220, v. 959, vii. 44, rascal, scoundrel.

schrewed, a. vi. 2098, villainous.

schrifte, s. i. 197, 818, v. 1385.

schrive(n), **schryve**, v.a.n. and refl. i. 208, 219, 546, iii. 1127, v. 7101,
pret. schrof, iv. 519,
imperat. scrif (thee), i. 587, 2718,
pp. schrive(n), i. 190, 2383, iv. 1772,
schryve, viii. 2969, confess, hear in confession, absolve.

schrunk, *pp.* i. 1683.

schryhte, v.n.pret. viii. 1383, shrieked.

schuldre, s. P. 607, i. 1687, ii. 2220, shoulder.

schydes, s.pl. iii. 1033, split pieces (of wood).

schylde, see **schilde**.

schyne, v.n. iii. 1308, iv. 980,
pret. schon, iv. 3551.

science, s. iv. 974, 2413,
pl. sciences, iv. 2666, vii. 27.

scisme, s. P. 348, schism.

sclaundre, **sclandre**, **sklaundre**, s. ii. 881, v. 712, 5536, 7570, vii. 3083.

sclaundre, v.a. ii. 864, slander.

scole, s. P. 199, i. 2665, ii. 436, iv. 3373, school.

scomerfare, s. viii 1391, piracy.

score, s. ii. 500, iv. 1356, 2891.

scorn, s. viii. 2397,

to scorne, to skorne, v. 696, 6931, vii. 3992.

scorne, v.a. v. 6217.

Scorpio, vii. 1123 ff., 1259, 1403,

tail of Scorpio, vii. 1426.

scorpioun (-on), s. vii. 1124, 4091.

Scottes, pl. ii. 929.

scribe, s. P. 305.

scripture, P. 872, iv. 2626, writing.

scrivein, s. iii. 1070, writer.

sculpture, s. iv. 2422, vi. 1343.

se, sen, v.a.n. P. 28, 134, 610, i. 1132,

 (see, PP. 281 ff., 382),

 2 s.*pres.* **sest**, ii. 1059,

 3 s. **seth**, i. 2804, ii. 224,

pret. **sih, syh**, P. 603, 617, i. 795, &c.,

sawh, i. 138, iii. 1604,

sihe, v. 5810,

 (**sigh**, viii. 2962),

 2 s. **sihe**, ii. 234, iii. 2629,

 pl. **syhe(n), sihen**, iii. 970, vii. 1798, 4745,

pret. subj. **syhe, sihe**, i. 664, 904,

imperat. **seth**, ii. 861,

pres. part. **seēnde**, ii. 1808,

 pp. **sen**, P. 342,

sene, P. 789, 936,

seene, iv. 1492,

seie, ii. 967, v. 2374,

sein, seyn, i. 2883, ii. 170, iii. 757.

seal, s. i. 1474, 1487, ii. 3217.

seche, *v.a.n.* P. 173, 899, i. 570, 1285, 2278, ii. 3219, iv. 3463,
(3 *pl.pres.* **sechin**, viii. 3036),
sieche, viii. 2911,
seke, **sieke**, i. 1024, 3072, ii. 928, 1455, iv. 1604,
pret. **soghte(n)**, i. 425, 1144, ii. 2474, iv. 2163,
soughte, P. 197, v. 3933,
sowhte, iv. 3548,
pp. **soght**, ii. 3128,
sought, v. 4003,
imperat. **sech**, v. 7605;
al to seche, **noght to s.**, &c., i. 924, ii. 44, 2276, iv. 2963.

secounde, *a.* i. 2601, ii. 1, iv. 2479, v. 2127,
seconde, i. 1233, v. 2129, following, second.

secre, *a.* ii. 2132,
in secre, i. 617.

secret, *s.* vi. 1573.

secretaire, *s.* iv. 888, private counsellor.

secte, *s.* P. 349, v. 1643, vii. 1572, religion, kind.

seculers, *s.pl.* i. 648.

sed, *s.* iv. 3007, v. 4014, seed.

Sedechie, vii. 2566 ff.

see, **se**, *s.* (1) P. 306, v. 1944, vi. 1037, seat.

see, **se**, *s.* (2) P. 933, i. 486, ii. 145, 2531, iii. 86, sea:
see foul, vi. 2129,
cp. **sefoul**.

seewolf, *s.* v. 4138, shark.

sefne, *see* **sevene**.

sefnthe, *a.* vii. 1363.

sefoul, *s.* viii. 2654.

Segne, v. 1113.

seie (1), **sein**, **sain**, *v.a.n.inf.* P. 431, i. 281, 2760, (**seye**, **seyn**, P. 86*, viii. 2966), **say**, **sai**, i. 2750, v. 5198,
2 *s.pres.* **seist**, **saist**, i. 176, ii. 555,
3 *s.* **seith**, P. 43, &c.,
3 *pl.* **sein**, **sain**, P. 12, 56, **seie**, P. 442,
pret. **seide**, **saide**, i. 153, 768, 2740, 3218, **sayde**, v. 1756, **seid**, i. 3188, v. 4309,
imperat. **sey**, **sei**, **say**, **sai**, i. 184, 1822, 2418, ii. 1871, iii. 932, **seie**, vii. 4084,
pp. **seid**, **said**, P. 335, i. 585, 1229, 3323, iii. 931, vii. 150;
as who seith, P. 43, i. 2794: say, name.

seie (2), *see se.*

seil, *s.* i. 704, 1165, ii. 2152, iii. 1555,
sail, v. 3313, 3923, sail.

seile(n), **saile**, *v.n.* i. 511, iv. 1741, v. 991,
pres.part. **sailende**, **seilende**, ii. 1210, iv. 733, v. 5407,
seilinge, i. 524.

sein, *pp.* *see se.*

seint, *a.* ii. 3335,
fem. **seinte**, iv. 964.

seint, *s.* viii. 2778,
pl. **seintz**, v. 1813.

seintefie, *v.a.* vii. 4247, viii. 1269.

seisine, *see sesine.*

sek, **siek**, *a.* i. 703, 1703, ii. 15, v. 586, viii. 873,
sik, v. 616,
def. **sike**, vi. 1012,
pl. **seke**, P. 914;
as subst. **the sike**, ii. 1202,
pl. **seke**, ii. 3163,
sieke, viii. 2368: sick, sick man.

seke, *see seche.*

seker, *see siker*.

sekerliche, *see sikerliche*.

sekernesse, *see sikernesse*.

seknesse, s. P. 61, i. 2571, v. 410,
sieknesse, i. 185, 713,
siknesse, ii. 3249, iii. 280, sickness.

selde(n), *adv.* P. 787, iii. 1636, iv. 61,
sielde(n), iv. 1472, 2282, v. 4420;
sielde whanne, iv. 2734,
sielde wher, vii. 4240,
selde if, v. 6595,
selden whanne ... if, vii. 4328: seldom.

seli, *a.* iii. 658, simple.

selk, *s.* iv. 857, v. 5770, silk.

selle, *v.a.* ii. 3061, v. 243,
pret. **solde**, iii. 2546,
pp. **sold**, ii. 1662.

Selonites, vii. 4515.

selve, *a.* i. 200, ii. 51, 2064;
as subst. **that selve**, i. 1247.

selver, *s.* P. 608, iv. 2460, viii. 823.

Sem, vii. 546, 557, viii. 83.

semblable, *a.* i. 646, iii. 2595, v. 1545.

semblance, **semblaunce**, *s.* ii. 3273, iv. 379, v. 1534, 6674.

semblant, *s.* P. 114, i. 1213, ii. 1912, vi. 707, appearance;
feigne semblant, ii. 187, 2015, 2196, make pretence.

seme(n), *v.n. and impers.* P. 559, i. 614, 903,
sieme, i. 1891, viii. 2386,
me (him, you) semeth, iii. 2344, iv. 965, 1774.

Semiramis, iii. 1332, v. 1432.

semly, semlich, *a.* i. 1899, viii. 708.

sempiterne, *a.* vii. 104.

senatour, *s.* ii. 1195, 1330.

sende, *v.a.n.* P. 86, 161,
pret. sende, P. 1013, i. 851, 992,
sente, i. 3095, ii. 613, v. 1072,
pp. sent, P. 588,
send, v. 5236.

Senec, ii. 3095, v. 7735.

senne, sinne, *s.* P. 457, 920, 1017, i. 2929, ii. 3063, iii. 2033, 2546, v.
1739 ff.,
(*synne*, viii. 3040), *sin*.

sensible, *a.* vii. 127.

sentence, *s.* i. 2153, ii. 2978, 3417, vii. 1620.

Septembre, vii. 1117, viii. 2845.

Septemtrion, vii. 1264.

sepulture, *s.* i. 2349, iii. 2015.

Serapis, v. 1564 ff.

serpent, *s.* i. 396,
pl. serpentz, viii. 2574.

servage, *s.* ii. 2981, vii. 4096, servitude.

servant, *s.* i. 251, ii. 3300,
pl. servantz, iii. 18,
servantes, vii. 2333*.

serve(n), *v.a.* P. 707, i. 737, 860, 2521, ii. 35, 1297, iii. 502, iv. 531;
v.n. i. 169, 1245, 2131, iii. 1291, iv. 1407,
(3 *s.pres. servith*, viii. 3026).

servicable, *a.* v. 762.

service, servise, *s.* P. 78*, i. 176, ii. 2971, iv. 1036.

servitude, *s.* v. 1655.

sese, *v.a.* i. 1697, 2479, 3357, ii. 3009, iii. 2646, seize, take possession of, deliver as a possession.

sesine, **seisine**, *s.* v. 5527, vii. 564, possession.

sesoun (-on), *s.* iii. 693, vii. 1014, season.

set, *s.* vii. 4913, setting (of the sun).

sete, **seete**, *s.* v. 846, vi. 1041, vii. 2900, seat.

sette(n), *v.a.n.* P. 357, i. 2,
3 *s.pres.* **set**, i. 637, 1724,
sett, viii. 3089,
pret. **sette**, P. 41*, i. 201, ii. 2226, vii. 4624,
set, ii. 2220, v. 3691,
imperat. **sett**, viii. 2095,
pp. **set**, **sett**, P. 116, 245, i. 1486, iii. 647,
sette, vi. 10,
sete, vii. 2864;
sette ... of, v. 2498,
set ... therby, viii. 2194;
set, appoint, suppose, account, plant, make attack.

sevene, *num.* P. 804, i. 577, ii. 3207,
sefne, i. 2916, vii. 692.

seventy, *num.* viii. 91.

Severus, vii. 4575.

sewe, *s.* v. 5900, seasoned dish.

sex, **sexe**, *num.* v. 7246, vii. 5347, viii. 126.

sexte, *a.* vii. 908, 1082.

sextenthe, *a.* P. 25.

sextiene, *num.* vii. 1055.

seyinge, *s.* viii. 3081*.

Seyix, *see Ceix*.

shoures, *see schoures*.

sibb, *a.* viii. 1703, related.

Sibeles, **Sibele**, *v.* 1135 ff.

Sibille, *v.* 7454.

sibrede, *s.* viii. 139, 266, kindred.

sich, *see such*.

Siculus, *vii.* 3296.

side, **syde**, *s.* P. 28, 146, 392, 1085, *i.* 2381, 3424, *iii.* 1503, *iv.* 1308, 3227,

(ride) on side, *iv.* 1311.

Sidoynes, *vii.* 4499.

sieche, *see seche*.

siege, *s.* *i.* 1082, *iii.* 1759.

sieged, *v.a.pp.* *iii.* 2046, besieged.

siek, **sieknesse**, *see sek*, **seknesse**.

sieke, *v.* *see seche*.

sielde(n), *see selde(n)*.

sighe, **syghen**, *v.n.* *iv.* 3170, *v.* 3670, 5729, sigh.

sighte, *see sihte*.

signal, *s.* *vi.* 1668, sign.

signe, *s.* *i.* 2544, *iii.* 2227;
(of the zodiac) *iv.* 3222, *v.* 752, *vii.* 695, 968 ff.

signet, *s.* *v.* 5775.

signifie, **signefie**, *v.a.* P. 885, *iii.* 814, *v.* 914, *vii.* 4717.

sihte, **syhte**, *s.* *i.* 427, 437, 665, 1728, 2221, *ii.* 3072,
sighte, *vii.* 1228, *viii.* 2950, sight.

sik, *see sek*.

sike, syke, *v.n.* i. 697, 1726, 2996, 3140, ii. 1350, iv. 1150, sigh.

siker, seker, *a.* P. 568, ii. 2422, 3153, iv. 1003, v. 664, 2427;

superl. **sikerest**, ii. 2469,

the sekereste, vi. 1599;

adv. i. 3048, 3339, iv. 911: sure, secure; surely.

sikerliche, sekerliche, *adv.* i. 1564, 2145,

sikerly, iii. 1427,

sikirly, iv. 2498, surely, assuredly.

sikernesse, sekernesse, *s.* i. 1890, iv. 937, v. 205, vi. 232, security.

siknesse, *see* **seknesse**.

silence, *s.* i. 1302,

cilence, iv. 3206, vi. 1872.

sillable, *s.* viii 2049.

silogime, *s.* viii. 2708.

Silvestre, P. 742, ii. 3351 ff., PP. 346.

Simon (Magus), P. 204, 241, 439 ff., ii. 3055.

simple, *a.* iv. 1187, v. 2589, viii. 3052*.

simplesce (-esse), *s.* P. 217, i. 832, 2099,

(**symplesce**, P. 76*, **symplesse**, viii. 3134), simplicity, humility.

sinful(l), *a.* iii. 2569, PP. 45;

as subst. iv. 3490.

singe, *v.n.* i. 111, ii. 3012, iii. 330,

pret. **song**, P. 1057, ii. 1080,

sang, i. 2732,

pl. **songe**, i. 2034,

sunge, v. 1468,

pp. **sunge**, ii. 1300.

singulier, singuler, *a.* vii. 1996, 2931, private.

sinke, *v.n.* i. 1309, v. 2938,

sincke, iii. 1628,

pret. **sank**, ii. 2070,

pp. sunke, vi. 115.

sinne, *see senne*.

sire, s. P. 722, i. 2878, ii. 54, 2710, lord, sir.

Sirenes, *pl.* i. 484.

sithe, **sythe**, s. v. 3590,

ofte sithe (sithes), **fulofte sythe**, &c. i. 118, 318, 1400, ii. 658, iii. 458,
time, times.

siththe(n), *adv.* P. 832, i. 1842, vi. 2351;

conj. **siththe**, **sith**, **sithe(n)**, P. 973, i. 13, iii. 66, vi. 1073,

sithen that, i. 2244: since.

sitte, *v.n.* P. 337, i. 2397,

2 s.pres. **sist**, v. 5742,

sittest, vii. 2462,

3 s. **sit**, **sitt**, i. 1317, v. 6121,

sitteth, iv. 2724, vii. 2286,

pret. **sat**, i. 1675, iv. 653,

satte, vii. 2282,

pl. **seten**, i. 2524, ii. 2913, iii. 2163,

siete(n), iii. 1809, v. 3339,

seete, vi. 1174, sit, be seated:

impers. (it) **sit**, i. 273, 745, 1211, iii. 1674,

sitte, viii. 2428, suits, is fitting.

sive, s. iii. 433, sieve.

skales, **scales**, *s.pl.* ii. 3456, v. 4128.

skar, s. P. 507, crack.

skarcete, s. v. 4857, stinginess.

skars, **scars**, *a.* v. 4712, 4728, sparing.

skarse, *v.n.* viii. 1146, diminish.

skarsly, **scarsly**, *adv.* iv. 552, v. 4412.

skarsnesse, **scarsnesse**, s. v. 394, 4674 ff., 4740, stinginess.

skiere, v. (*refl.*) i. 478, ii. 472, v. 1424, defend.

skile, s. P. 380, 402, i. 36, 1866, iii. 2165,
skyle, iii. 2360,
pl. **skiles**, ii. 2770, reason, reasoning:
as a. iii. 397, reasonable.

skile, v.n. viii. 2047, reason.

skin, **skyn**, s. i. 1681, v. 2469, 6862.

skippe, v.n. iv. 2784, vii. 345,
pret. **skipte**, iv. 2110, v. 4997.

sklaundre, *see* **sclaundre**.

skorne, *see* **scorne**.

skulke, v.a. iv. 2720.

skulle, s. i. 2544 ff.

sky, s. i. 2001, iii. 984, iv. 825, 1436, viii. 2942,
pl. **skyes**, v. 3993, cloud, sky.

skyn, *see* **skin**.

slades, s.*pl.* iv. 2727.

slake, v.a. iv. 2812, viii. 1983, slacken, appease;
v.n. PP. 220.

slawhte, s. iii. 2058, 2483, slaying.

sle(e), **slen**, v.a.n. i. 1439, 2590, iii. 261,
3 s.*pres.* **sleth**, ii. 2623, iii. 957,
(**sleeth**, PP. 265),
pret. **slowh**, **slouh**, **slow**, **slou**, i. 434, v. 3727, 4045, 5897,
pl. **slowhe**, i. 377, v. 1722,
slowen, i. 1181,
subj. **slowe**, PP. 132,
pp. **slain**, **slayn**, P. 685, i. 527, 1427,
slawe, i. 514, ii. 770.

sleihte, **sleyhte**, s. i. 468, 688, 797, 1085, 1111,
sleighte, iv. 2082, 2123, v. 2111,
pl. **sleyhtes**, ii. 1873, skill, device, trickery.

slep, s. i. 155, 1782,

a slepe, v. 2177,

to slepe, ii. 3333,

to slep, iv. 2819,

Slep, Slepes hous, god of Slep, iv. 2973 ff.

slepe(n), v.n. P. 310, 476, i. 884,

pret. **slepte**, P. 595,

slep, v. 2762,

pp. **slepe**, iv. 2914, v. 158.

slepi, a. iv. 2731, 2848, vi. 1405.

slider, a. vi. 378, slippery.

slieve, s. v. 2575, 7669.

slih, *see* **slyh**.

slipte, v.n.pret. iv. 2109.

slitte, s. P. 338, cleft, separation.

slombre, v.n. iv. 3032.

slow, slou, slowh, slouh, a. iv. 54, 245, 1281, v. 1949, vii. 415, 761,

voc. **slowe**, iv. 843,

pl. (as subst.) **slowe**, iv. 137, 356, 1082;

superl. **the sloweste**, iv. 1082.

slowh, s. i. 2981, marsh.

slowthe, slouthe, s. P. 321, 342, iii. 2758, iv. 3 &c., sloth.

slowthe, v.a. iv. 19, lose by sloth;

v.n. iv. 1796, 3420, be slothful.

sluggardie, s. iv. 2714, 3177,

slugardie, iv. 2752.

slyde(n), v.n. iv. 41, v. 4158, vi. 1792, vii. 4457.

slyh, slih, a. P. 262, v. 2303, vii. 4936,

def. **slyhe**, ii. 2374,

slyh, ii. 2341,

pl. **slyhe, slihe**, ii. 2199, v. 3213, vii. 3257*;

superl. def. **slyheste, slyeste**, i. 1442, ii. 2102: cunning.

slyhli (-ly), *adv.* i. 2629, v. 677, 7145*.

slyke, *v.a.* v. 7092*, smoothe;
v.n. v. 6634, flatter.

slym, *s.* vii. 338.

slype, *v.refl.* v. 6530, sneak along.

smal, *a.* iv. 463, 1147,
def. **smale**, v. 1990,
pl. **smale**, P. 81, i. 1679;
as subst.pl. P. 426: slender, small.

smale, *adv.* v. 4535.

smaragdine, *s.* vii. 840, emerald.

smarte, *adv.* vii. 848, quickly.

smeile, *v.n.* iv. 2546;
v.a. vii. 2794.

smite, *see* **smyte**.

smith, *s.* v. 644, 962.

smok, *s.* i. 2171.

smoke, *s.* ii. 1556.

smyle, *v.n.* ii. 1404, iv. 388, v. 3012.

smyte, *v.a.n.* P. 424, iii. 910,
3 s.pres. **smit**, P. 1085,
pret. sing. **smot**, i. 2003, 2342, ii. 874, iv. 3349,
smette, ii. 2239,
pp. **smite(n)**, iii. 911, v. 334, vii. 4695.

snake, *s.* vii. 1010.

snoute, *s.* iii. 128, 1400, iv. 2749.

snow, *s.* vii. 293, viii. 2851,
snow whyt, iii. 807.

so, *adv.* P. 8, 29, i. 1695, ii. 139;

who so, P. 1002,

how so, i. 1455,

be so, so be, i. 187, 1652,

up so doun, ii. 1744, iii. 80, iv. 561.

sobbe(n), *v.n.* iii. 303, v. 5729.

sobbinge, *s.* i. 2182.

sobre, *a.* P. 239, iii. 140, viii. 2684, 2869.

sobre, *v.a.* viii. 1700.

socour, *s.* iii. 2670, v. 4953.

socoure, *v.a.* i. 653, ii. 2882, iii. 328.

Socrates, iii. 640, 701.

sode, *pp.* v. 4281, boiled.

sodein, *a.* P. 619, i. 1069, ii. 688, iii. 335,

soudein, *v.* 4942, sudden:

adv. iii. 862.

sodeinliche, soudeinliche, *adv.* P. 503, i. 2963, v. 7830, vi. 211,

sodeinly (-li), P. 1038, i. 911, iv. 573,

soudeinly, vi. 1423,

(**sodeynly**, viii. 2961*).

soffrance, suffrance, *s.* P. 773, iii. 1639, 1672, v. 4267,

(**suffraunce**, viii. 3022*).

soffre, suffre, *v.a.n.* P. 698, 788, i. 1371, 2380, 2570, 2941, ii. 206, 3023,
v. 7378,

3 *s.pres.* **soffreth, soeffreth, suffreth**, iii. 2431, iv. 1428, v. 574,

(1 *pl.* **soeffrin**, PP. 222); suffer, allow, leave, permit.

softe, *a.* i. 619, 1220, 2564, **soft**, iii. 2734,

pl. **softe**, i. 915, ii. 309;

the soft pas, iii. 1386; gentle, quiet:

adv. P. 476, i. 1725.

softly, *adv.* iv. 2885.

sojorne, sojourne, *v.n.* iv. 740, 3224, v. 1078, vii. 1173, viii. 1286, dwell, remain:

pp. **sojorned**, vi. 1180, vii. 294, kept.

solas, *s.* vii. 1900, pleasure.

soldan, *see* **souldan**.

solein, soulein, *a.* iii. 1220, iv. 448, vi. 135,
fem. **soleine**, v. 1971, alone, lonely, strange.

solempne, sollempne, *a.* v. 1317, vii. 4703, viii. 1561.

solempnite, sollempnite, *s.* i. 1157, iv. 3651,
solempnete, sollempnete, iii. 2169, vi. 1825, vii. 2405, celebration, ceremony.

sollempneliche, *adv.* viii. 1617.

solucion, *s.* iv. 2515.

Solyns, Solins, iii. 2600, iv. 2410, Solinus.

som, *a.* P. 6, i. 1499, v. 2469 ff.,
som while, som time, iii. 2624, iv. 649, viii. 3119,
som man, vii. 643 f.;
pl. **some**, i. 1265,
somme, P. 355,
alle and some, v. 7320,
som men, P. 529, iii. 2113:
as subst. **som**, vi. 384,
pl. **some, somme**, P. 432, i. 2034 ff., ii. 1362, 2510, iii. 2112.

somdiel, somdel, *a.* P. 613, iii. 697, iv. 800;
adv. P. 286, 612, i. 1003: some, somewhat.

somer, *s.* iv. 1091, viii. 2853,
somer dai, ii. 732,
somer floures, P. 937; summer.

somerfare, *s.* viii. 2856, condition of summer.

somertide, *s.* v. 6009,
somer tyde, v. 6819.

somme, s. iii. 2568, vii. 161, viii. 1119, sum.

somoune, **sommone**, v.a. vii. 5182, viii. 1551, 1915, summon.

sompnolence, s. iv. 2703, 2770 ff.

somtime, *adv.* iv. 810 f., 1131, 2799,

somtyme, iv. 3304,

som time, **som tyme**, iv. 649, viii. 3119.

somwhat, *pron.* i. 1297, iii. 2332, iv. 2829;

adv. P. 19.

somwho, *pron.* P. 345, some one.

sond, s. v. 4009, vi. 1294, sand.

sonde, s. ii. 324, 1567, iii. 247, iv. 799, viii. 1859, sending, message, decree.

sondre, v.n.,

to sondre, iii. 986, part asunder.

sondri, **sondry**, P. 29, 501, i. 2530, ii. 1476, iii. 2210, v. 1458,

sundri, v. 7437, separate, several, various.

sondrily, *adv.* vii. 1305.

sone, s. P. 740, i. 206 &c.,

to sone, v. 806; son.

sone, *adv.* i. 996, 1633, 2091, ii. 357,

also sone, i. 3079; soon.

soned, *see* **soune**.

song, s. ii. 3012, iv. 3346,

songe, i. 2745,

pl. **songes**, i. 2739.

sonne, s. P. 919, iii. 1307, iv. 979,

sonne lyht, v. 2790,

sonnes l., vi. 559,

sunne, ii. 3452, sun.

sopp, s. v. 3807.

sor, s. P. 134, ii. 22, 2789,
sore, v. 2858, hurt, sore.

sorceresse, s. vi. 1434, viii. 2602.

sorcerie, s. iv. 2077, v. 940, vi. 1289, 1768 ff.

sore, *adv.* P. 598, i. 475, 2245,
sor, vii. 5256.

sore, *v.n.* i. 2672, vii. 1842, soar.

sore, s., *see sor*.

sorgful(l), *a.* ii. 1303, iii. 1481, sorrowful.

sorgfully, **sorwfulli**, *adv.* i. 3173, ii. 69.

sorghe, *see sorwe*.

sori, **sory**, *a.* i. 989, 2182, ii. 2307, iii. 2203, iv. 1347, wretched,
unhappy.

sort, s. i. 673, iv. 450, 3099, kind, lot.

Sortes, viii. 2718.

sorwe, s. i. 971, 1665, ii. 48, iv. 1212,
sorghe, ii. 165, v. 513, sorrow.

sorwe, *v.n.* i. 1814, 3182, ii. 745;
v.a. PP. 104.

soster, s. i. 399, 3155, iii. 165, iv. 1383,
suster, iv. 1369,
genit. sostres, v. 5726.

sosterhode, s. v. 4205, 5398, viii. 103,
sosterhiede, viii. 96.

soth, *a.* P. 12, 534, i. 1955,
def. sothe, iii. 1270,
pl. sothe, PP. 93,
in soth, iii. 1078.

soth, s. ii. 58,
the sothe, P. 834, 850, i. 981,

pl. **sothes**, vii. 2351, truth.

sothfastnesse, s. i. 2268, vii. 3303*.

sothly, **sothli**, *adv.* ii. 522, iv. 3496, v. 244,
sothliche, ii. 2021, truly.

sothsawe, s. v. 2935, truth.

sothseiere, s. iii. 761, vii. 2348.

sotie, s. i. 539, 2320, iv. 1887,
sotye, vi. 223, folly.

soubgit, *a.* P. 675, iv. 3523, v. 1726,
sougit, vi. 1507;
subst. **soubgit**, iii. 1277, v. 55,
subgit, PP. 165: subject.

soubtil, **soutil**, *a.* ii. 2125, iv. 2076, vi. 1443,
soubtiel, v. 1026.

soubtilite, s. ii. 2378, 3046,
soutilete, v. 2138.

souche, *v.n.* i. 314, ii. 1969, suspect.

soudein, *see* **sodein**.

soudeinliche, *see* **sodeinliche**.

sougit, *see* **soubgit**.

souke, *v.n.* ii. 3227, suck.

souldan, **soldan**, s. ii. 613 ff., 2548 ff., vii. 1784.

souldeour, s. iii. 2356, soldier.

soule, s. P. 453,
genit. P. 749, ii. 1313.

soulein, *see* **solein**.

soulphre, *see* **sulphre**.

soun, s. i. 2217, iii. 453, iv. 346, sound.

sound, *a.* ii. 2223, v. 5371, vi. 1488,
pl. sounde, v. 4164.

soune, *v.n.* i. 2807, ii. 2875, iii. 60;
v.a. v. 5699,
soned, (*pp.*), iv. 2644: sound.

soupe, *v.n.* i. 2114, v. 6872, vii. 4766, have supper.

souper, *s.* i. 2112, v. 3835, 6871,
souper time, viii. 705.

soupertime, *s.* viii. 711.

souple, *v.a.* vii. 4890, (bend), influence.

sour, *a.* vi. 1127, viii. 194,
the soure, vi. 336;
adv. soure, ii. 246.

source, *s.* i. 148, iii. 611.

soure, *v.a.* iii. 447, make sour;
v.n. i. 1190, turn sour.

south, *s.* vi. 862.

southward, *adv.* vii. 1255.

soutilete, *see soubtilite.*

soverein, **sovereign**, *a.* P. 186, i. 1609, iv. 1518, vii. 1776,
fem. sovereigne, ii. 3507, vii. 1392, viii. 2530:
subst. i. 862, v. 1133,
soverain, v. 1464.

sovereinete, *s.* i. 1847.

sowe, *v.a.n.* P. 320, v. 819,
pret. siew, sieu, sew, iv. 1837, v. 1883, 3722,
pp. sowe, ii. 2376.

sowinge, *s.* v. 1228.

sowke, *s.* ii. 1079, suck.

space, *s.* iv. 615, 679, v. 3439, 3843.

spade, s. v. 16.

Spaine, Spaigne, i. 3390, ii. 1088, vi. 539, 569.

spanne, s. i. 1112, span.

spare, v.a. ii. 693, 3360, iii. 2220, PP. 19;
v.n. iii. 2217, iv. 439,
to spare, v. 7826.

sparinge, s. v. 4785.

sparke, s. ii. 2946, iv. 2995.

spatula, s. vi. 1311.

specefie, *see* **specifie**.

speche, s. P. 174, i. 923, 1278, iv. 875,
spieche, iv. 144.

specheles, a. i. 1293, v. 3966.

special, a., **in special**, P. 120, i. 1501.

specifie, **specefie**, v.a.n. P. 33, 866, i. 572, ii. 1407, iv. 2534.

sped, s. i. 107, 1379, ii. 115, iv. 3450,
spied, i. 1956, iv. 301, success, advantage.

spede, **spiede**, v.n. i. 687, 796, 2654, iv. 2280,
pret. **spedde**, iv. 2178, succeed, be advanced;
v.a. and refl. ii. 103, 2232, iii. 2198,
pret. **spedde**, ii. 624, v. 3866,
pp. **sped**, i. 1557, vi. 2095,
spedd, v. 1720, advance, help, hasten.

speke(n), v.n. P. 31, i. 10, 204, 1520,
3 s.pres. **spekth**, i. 656,
pret. **spak**, i. 294, 818,
pl. **spieke(n)**, ii. 959, 1456, 2264, v. 622, vii. 1611,
speeke, viii. 749,
imperat. **spek**, iii. 850,
pp. **spoke**, i. 537, 1178,
speke, v. 5035.

spekere, s. v. 945, 1466.

spekinge, s. v. 7129*,
pl. spekynges, i. 239.

spelle, v.a. iv. 570.

spellinge, s. v. 4067.

spende, v.a. iv. 2591,
pret. spente, v. 7787.

Spercheïdos, v. 4006.

spere, s. i. 1998, ii. 3195.

Spertachus, vii. 3418.

spiece, s. vii. 888,
pl. spieces, spices, i. 2977, 3446, iii. 466, v. 5898, vi. 856, kind, spice.

spille, v.a. i. 1192, 2850, vii. 3493,
pret. spilde, ii. 948,
spilte, iii. 1446,
pp. spilt, ii. 3285, viii. 570, destroy, spill, waste;
v.n. iii. 264, iv. 2586, perish, fail.

spinne, v.a.n. v. 1283,
pp. sponne, vi. 2381, PP. 299.

spire, v.n. ii. 1146, 1999;
v.a. viii. 1472: inquire, inquire for.

spirit, s. ii. 3137, iv. 2364, viii. 2590,
pl. spiritz, iv. 2464.

spirital, spiritiel, a. ii. 2987, v. 1915;
as subst. P. 855, ii. 3492.

splen, s. vii. 449 ff.

Spodius, v. 4817.

spoke, s. vii. 815.

spore, s. P. 1084, i. 2301, iii. 1235, spur.

sporne, *v.a.* iv. 2115, vi. 429, kick against;
v.n. iv. 1279, vi. 464, vii. 4739, stumble.

spot, *s.* iv. 609, PP. 366.

spousaile, *s.* ii. 642,
pl. **spousailes**, viii. 975.

spouse, *s.* iii. 658, v. 6017.

spouse, *v.a.* vi. 497.

spousebreche, *s.* iii. 2158, v. 6014, adultery.

spoute, *s.* vii. 1193.

sprantlende, *v.n. pres.part.* iv. 111.

spriede, **sprede**, **spreede**, *v.a.n.* i. 2824, ii. 504, vi. 895,
3 *s.pres.* **sprat**, ii 417,
sprede, v. 7679,
pret. **spradde**, ii. 684, iv. 1526, v. 1458,
sprede, v. 6891,
pp. **sprad**, iv. 3082,
sprede, v. 2316; spread.

spring, *s.* v. 6239,
daies spring, iv. 2852.

springe(n), *v.n.* P. 347, i. 353, iii. 428,
pret. **sprong**, i. 2306, iii. 1921,
pl. **spronge**, i. 2085,
sprungen, v. 1595,
pp. **sprongen**, vii. 4679.

spume, *s.* v. 4122.

square, *a.* vi. 1327.

squier, *s.* ii. 254,
pl. **squiers**, v. 2275.

stable (dore), *s.* iv. 903.

stable, *a.* iv. 268, 444, vii. 4202;
adv. iv. 3671.

stable, *v.a.* PP. 145, set firmly.

stacion, *s.* vii. 204, place.

staf, *s.* P. 420, v. 536, 4991.

stage, *s.* P. 603, iv. 2977, vii. 741.

stake, *s.* ii. 3094, iv. 2431, vi. 191.

stalke, *v.n.* i. 910, ii. 828, v. 3861, 6498, go stealthily.

stalle, *s.* PP. 383, place.

stalle, *v.a.* vii. 1162.

stalon, *s.* viii. 160, stallion.

stanche, **staunche**, *v.a.* P. 345, i. 2312, 2838, 3308, vi. 303, 422, quench,
satisfy, heal.

stare, *v.n.* iv. 1832, vi. 178.

stark, *adv.* iv. 3082.

stat, *s.* ii. 2992, iii. 1998,
(**staat**, viii. 2990):
cp. **astat**.

statue, *s.* P. 891.

stature, *s.* i. 2166, 3135, iv. 744, vii. 981, stature, form; vi. 1524, statue.

statut, *s.* ii. 1741, v. 4551, viii. 360.

stede, *s.* (1) P. 274, 1074, i. 842, iii. 923, iv. 3483,
pl. **stedes**, iv. 718, v. 2087, place;
in stede of, P. 128, 396, i. 1669,
in the stede, ii. 2684,
in hire stede, i. 2602, iii. 1558.

stede (2), *see* **stiede**.

stedefast, *a.* vii. 906.

stel, *see* **stiel**.

stele, *v.a.n.* iv. 3333, v. 207, 3873,

pret. stal, stall, iv. 3351, v. 3900, 6750,
pp. stole(n), iv. 902, v. 6558, steal.

Stellibon, i. 398.

stelthe, s. i. 644, v. 6296, 6495 ff.

stepmoder, s. i. 1844.

stere, *v.a.* ii. 447, iii. 137, iv. 337, 2085, 3124, v. 1854;
v.n. v. 3064: stir, move.

steringe, s. ii. 3141, motive.

sterne, *a.* i. 2127, iii. 2444, iv. 2065,
sturne, viii. 403.

sterre, s. iv. 1348, v. 879, 912, vii. 1303 ff.

sterred, *a.* vii. 1060, viii. 2942.

sterreles, *a.* vii. 1024, 1126.

sterreliht, s. v. 3958, 6508,
sterre lyht, i. 1168.

sterthe, *v.n.* iv. 336, vi. 59, vii. 3656,
pret. sterthe, ii. 850, iv. 2102,
pp. stert, i. 372, start, rush, move.

sterve(n), *v.n.* i. 3263, ii. 36, iv. 797,
pret. sing, starf, ii. 885,
pp. storve(n), iii. 1509, v. 1999; die.

stevene, s. i. 493, 3025, iv. 847, voice, promise.

steward, *see stieward*.

steyne, v. ii. 1963, stain.

sticke, s. v. 4959, 5054, 5972.

stiede, stede, s. i. 2508, iv. 901, vi. 1280, steed.

stiel, s. P. 611, vi. 1814,
stel, iv. 2425, steel.

stiere, s. i. 560, 2943, ii. 709, helm, guidance.

stiere, *v.a.* P. 234, 1088, i. 506, 1064, 2394;
v.n. iii. 993.

stiereles, *a.* ii. 1393, without rudder.

stieresman, *s.* v. 3122.

steward, **steward**, ii. 1091, 2760, v. 2669 ff, vii. 3948.

Stige, v. 1113, Styx.

stigh, *see* **styh**.

stike, *v.n.* iii. 1631, iv. 2723, stick.

stile, *s.* i. 8.

stille, *a.* i. 1289, iii. 932, 2738, iv. 3009, silent, quiet:
adv. P. 478, i. 886, 952, 1794, 2617, iii. 1719, quietly, in silence,
always.

stille, *v.a.* P. 61*, vii. 1583, viii. 2636, keep still, silence, satisfy.

Stinfalides, v. 1019.

stinge, *v.a.* vii. 1048.

stink, *s.* iv. 2557.

stinte(n), *v.n.* iii. 1612, iv. 3453,
pret. **stinte**, ii. 1132,
imperat. **stynt**, viii. 2284, cease;
v.a. iv. 132, vi. 2005, make to cease.

stock, *s.* iii. 585, v. 1513, viii. 239,
stok, iv. 2868.

stod, *s.* vii. 3345, viii. 161, stud.

stoke(n), *v.a.pp.* i. 538, iv. 584, vii. 5019, shut.

stol, *s.* vii. 3954,
pl. **stoles**, P. 336, iv. 626, stool.

stomak, **stomac**, **stomach**, *s.* v. 1487, vi. 162, vii. 479.

stomble, *v.n.* iv. 621.

ston, s. P. 618, i. 1794, iv. 2523 ff.,
pl. **stones**, P. 953, i. 2537.

stonde, v.n. P. 84, i. 428, 1313, 3233,
3 s.pres. **stant**, P. 30, 118, 170, &c.,
standt, v. 5215,
pres. subj. **stonde**, P. 481, i. 1458,
stond, i. 3416,
pret. **stod**, P. 95, 214, ii. 2513,
(**stood**, viii. 3004*),
pl. **stode(n)**, P. 50, 233, 798,
3 s.pret. subj. **stode**, P. 41, iii. 1580,
(3 *pl.* **stodyn**, viii. 3050),
imperat. **stond**, iv. 3244,
pp. **stonde(n)**, i. 2930, vii. 2629; stand, remain, depend.

stoppe(n), v.a. i. 475, 522, v. 3516.

stor, s. ii. 2363, store.

storie, s. v. 6002.

stormes, s.*pl.* i. 2987, v. 3298.

stormy, a. P. 938, iii. 686.

storge, see **sterve**.

stounde, s. i. 1425, ii. 2, 877, iv. 3632, time, period.

stoute, a. (*pl.*), v. 3507, 7282.

straght, *adv.* P. 1044, ii. 1482,
strawht, **strauht**, v. 3327, 3665.

straied, *pp.* viii. 2860.

strange, a. P. 604, i. 1416, 3029, ii. 2060.

strange, v.a. iv. 1489, v. 1890, 6040;
v.n. v. 4103: estrange, change; grow strange.

strangle, v.a. v. 6531, vii. 3323*.

Strangulio, viii. 545, 1290 ff.

strauht, *a.* vi. 772, straight.

strauht, **strawht**, *adv.* *see* **straght**.

straw, *see* **stree**.

strecche, *v.a. and refl.* i. 1, 622,

pret. **strawhte**, **strauhte**, ii. 1056, iii. 1407, v. 5029,

straghte, i. 2820, viii. 1150, stretch, direct;

v.n.pret. **strawhte**, **strauhte**, **straghte**, i. 2820, iii. 1939, v. 3338, 3923,
reach, go.

stree, **stre**, *s.* iii. 85, 667, iv. 1716,

straw, v. 2310,

pl. **stres**, i. 2993, straw.

streit, *a.* v. 7655, close.

streite, **streyte**, *adv.* ii. 237, 1638, v. 261, vi. 1374, near, closely, strictly.

streite, *v.a.* v. 6380, diminish.

strem, *s.* P. 509, ii. 195, iv. 2730, stream.

strengere, **strengest**, *see* **strong**.

strengthe, *s.* P. 704, i. 787, ii. 2413, vi. 1595, strength, force, stronghold.

strengthe(n), *v.a.* ii. 1077, 3157, vi. 1598, vii. 2546, strengthen.

strete, *s.* i. 938, iii. 1338, street.

streyte, *see* **streite**.

strif, *s.* P. 248, 993, iii. 650.

strike, *v.a.* v. 3318;

v.n. viii. 1891.

strok, *s.* P. 426, iv. 2099, v. 2565.

stronde, *s.* i. 1169, ii. 758, iv. 741, shore.

strong, *a.* P. 716, ii. 1740, v. 7377,

def. **stronge**, P. 314, v. 2050,

pl. i. 1155, ii. 48, iii. 1112, iv. 2103;

comp. **strengere**, vii. 4087;

superl. **strengest**, vi. 1593:
as subst. **the stronge**, P. 615, vii. 4296.

strowed, *v.a.pp.* iv. 3022, strewn.

stryve, *v.n.* iii. 26, 1651, PP. 73.

studie, *v.n.* P. 323, i. 3091, vii. 2245.

studie, *s.* iv. 2662, v. 3090.

studious, *a.* vii. 759.

sturdi, *a.* viii. 403, harsh.

sturne, *see* **sterne**.

stwes, *s.pl.* viii. 484, stews.

styh, *v.n.* 3 *s.pret.* ii. 3401, v. 3991,
(**stigh**, PP. 177), ascended.

subfumigacioun, *s.* vi. 1310.

subgit, *see* **soubgit**.

subjeccioun (-on), *s.* P. 683, i. 2857, ii. 3272, v. 6409.

sublimacion, *s.* iv. 2517.

substance (-aunce), *s.* P. 199, iv. 2465, 2563, PP. 314.

substancial, *a.* vii. 226.

substitucion, *s.* vii. 2769.

such, *pron.a.* P. 8, i. 175, 1624, ii. 2241, iii. 2421,

swich, v. 377,

swiche, iv. 1429,

sich, viii. 1110,

pl. **suche**, i. 853,

swiche, ii. 504:

as subst. **swich**, ii. 566,

pl. **suche**, **swiche**, P. 233, 299, iv. 1236:

as adv. **such**, P. 735.

sucre, *s.* i. 1705, v. 2833, sugar.

suete, *see swete*.

sufficance, *s.* i. 4, 1915, v. 4819, ability, sufficiency.

sufficant, *a.* i. 1183, ii. 2700, iii. 1779, viii. 2696,
(**suffisant**, viii. 3099), sufficient.

suffise, **suffice**, *v.n.* P. 324, i. 1399, iii. 321, iv. 790, 1129, v. 320, vii.
5092, suffice, be able, endure.

suffrance, **suffre**, *see soffrance*, &c.

suggestioun (-on), *s.* i. 1014, viii. 364, 1684.

suie, *v.a.* i. 2256, ii. 256,
(**sue**, viii. 3031*);
v.n.pres.p. **suiende**, ii. 1591, 3526, iv. 2482,
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time, *v.a.* ii. 2238, aim.

tirannie, tirannye, s. P. 49, ii. 1721, v. 5921,
tyrannyes, (*pl.*) v. 988,
tirandie, tiraundie, P. 756, iii. 1117,
(**tirandise**, viii. 3076).

tirannyssh, a. vii. 4594,
tirannysshe, vii. 4889.

tirant, a. v. 5627, vii. 1889,
(*subst.* **tiraunt**, PP. 48).

tire, *v.n.* vi. 817, pull.

Tiresias, iii. 363, 749.

Tisbee, iii. 1374 ff., 1663, viii. 2578.

title, s. PP. 12.

titled, *v.a.pp.* iv. 2468, assigned.

to, *prep.* P. 10, 67, i. 1554, ii. 158, v. 5724;
with gerund, P. 33, 133, ii. 511, iv. 2373, viii. 1393, *cp.* **forto**:
adv. (1) **to ... fro**, P. 569, i. 1571, 2067; (2) P. 81, i. 1063, too;
cp. **tomoche**, **tolite**.

to, *prefix*, *see to plihite*.

tobete, *v.a.pp.* iii. 122, beaten to pieces.

tobloue, *v.a.pp.* viii. 1949, blown about.

tobreide, *v.a.pret.* iv. 1535, rent.

tobreke, *v.a.* i. 1068, 1420, 2650,
pret. **tobrak**, ii. 1825,
pp. **tobroke**, P. 390, i. 1154, break in pieces;
v.n. iv. 359,
3 s.pres. **tobrekth**, P. 505,
pret. **tobrak**, vi. 2226,
pl. **tobrieken**, vii. 3476, break (in pieces), break forth.

toclef, *v.n.pret.* viii. 626, parted asunder.

todrawe, *v.a.*,
3 pl. pret. **todrowhe**, i. 378,
pp. **todrawe**, i. 513, iii. 1405, tear asunder.

tofore, *prep.* P. 1, i. 2134, iii. 2052, &c.,
tofor, i. 518, iii. 2053, 2375, before, in presence of:
adv. P. 822, i. 2948,
ther tofore, i. 1153,
hier t., i. 2787,
now t., i. 1867,
tofor, ii. 2128, before, formerly.

togedre, *adv.* P. 648, i. 1102, ii. 137,
al togedre, P. 984.

tohewe, *v.a.* iv. 1547,
 toheewe, (*pp.*) v. 5899, hew in pieces.

tokne, *s.* P. 638, i. 873, 1174, 2211, iii. 804,
 that in tokne, P. 907.

tokne, *v.a.* P. 601, betoken.

tokninge, *s.* v. 5765.

tolyte, **tolite**, *s.* i. 19, iv. 2621, vii. 3847,
 to lite, iii. 581, too little.

tombe, *see* **tumbe**.

tome, *s.* ii. 2680, (leisure), opportunity.

tome (= to me), i. 294, ii. 3160, viii. 2386.

tomoche, *s.* i. 19, iv. 2621, v. 7689,
 to moche, iii. 591, too much.

tomorwe, *adv.* iii. 2399, iv. 9, vii. 3668.

tonge, *see* **tunge**.

tonne, *s.* P. 504, iii. 1210, v. 1677, vi. 333,
 tunne, viii. 2253.

tonsure, *s.* viii. 482.

too, *s.* v. 472,
 pl. **ton**, P. 876, toe.

toose, *v.a.* P. 400, shear.

Topazion, vii. 1406.

to plihite, *v.a.pret.* v. 850, pulled in pieces.

topseilcole, *s.* v. 3119, viii. 1890.

topulled, *v.a.pp.* i. 565, pulled asunder.

torche, *s.* iv. 3651, v. 3846.

tormente, *v.a.* i. 2989, iv. 412.

torne, *v.a.* P. 273, i. 1537, 2267, 2408,

(*pp.* **turnyd**, viii. 2956);
refl. i. 1792, iv. 2112;
v.n. P. 463, 591, i. 3265, v. 312,
(**turne**, PP. 95): turn, return.

torneie, **tourneie**, *v.n.* i. 2515, vi. 1850, tourney.

tornement, *s.* i. 2509.

torninge, **tornyng**, *s.* P. 138, iii. 85.

torof, *v.n.pret.* viii. 617, was torn to pieces.

to sondre, *see* **sondre**.

tosprad, *pp.* v. 3964.

toswal, *v.n.pret.* v. 6252,
pp. **toswolle**, vi. 1467.

tote, *v.n.* v. 470, vi. 819, spy, gaze.

toth, *s.* P. 325,
pl. **teeth**, **teth**, ii. 411, v. 3523, tooth.

tothe (= to the), iv. 1875.

tothrowe, *v.a.* vii. 5257, throw aside.

totore, *pp.* P. 414, i. 1723, iv. 1355, torn in pieces.

touche, **touch**, *s.* v. 269, 315, 6278, 7147.

touche, *v.a.* P. 58, i. 313, ii. 2057, iv. 667, v. 275, touch, concern;
touchende, i. 742, 3441, concerning;
v.n. i. 241, ii. 527, iv. 3016, have concern, treat;
touchende of, P. 481, i. 1232,
(**as**) **touchinge of**, i. 2721, viii. 2993*,
touchende to, i. 1338, 1971, concerning.

touchinge, *s.* iii. 84.

toun, *s.* P. 839, i. 802, iii. 454, 1380,
to toune, ii. 1354,
in toune, ii. 2103.

tour, *s.* P. 1019, ii. 3027, iv. 818, tower.

tourneie, *see* **torneie**.

tow, *s.* v. 5623.

toward, *prep.* i. 456, 638, 1136, 2103, 2284, 3032, ii. 1384, viii. 2077,
towardes, P. 78, i. 747, iii. 1090, to, towards, with regard to, near:
toward Troie, iii. 2643, on the way to T.

towh, *a.* vi. 722, tough.

Trace, v. 1198, 5569, 5832, Thrace.

trace, *v.a.* vi. 1328.

traiteresse, *s.* v. 4620.

traiterie, *s.* iii. 2211, viii. 1779, treason.

trance, **traunce**, *s.* i. 1800, iii. 1457, viii. 1367, 2813.

trance, *v.* iv. 2115, trample (?).

transforme, *v.a.* i. 2971, ii. 194, iv. 501.

translate, *v.a.* ii. 3044,

3 pl. pret. translateden, iv. 2660, change, translate.

transpose, *v.a.* iv. 2656, translate.

trapped, *v.a.pp.* i. 1133, v. 2708, furnished with trap-doors, entrapped.

traunce, *see* **trance**.

travail(l), *s.* ii. 1009, iv. 1105, 1604 ff.,

travaile, iv. 2663, labour.

travaile, *v.n.* P. 78*, i. 2658, ii. 266, 641, 2533, viii. 1050, labour, travail;
refl. iii. 584, v. 110; labour, strive:
v.a. ii. 3314, iv. 428, 1893, trouble, cause to labour, iii. 1205, travel
about.

travers, *s.* viii. 3158, obstacle.

tre, **tree**, *s.* i. 1319, 2818, iv. 3593,
pl. tres, **trees**, P. 935, ii. 2298.

treble, *a.* vii. 1755, 2366.

trede, v. viii. 2682.

tregetour, s. ii. 1873, juggler.

treigne, s. vii. 4456, snare.

treine, s. iv. 621, train (of a robe).

treis, s. i. 2963, three, (*or* one, two, three).

tremble, v.n. ii. 2622, iii. 190;
v.a. vii. 5104.

tresced, a. vii. 4881.

tresces, **tresses**, s.pl. v. 5464, 5686.

treson, **tresoun**, s. i. 1659, ii. 1185, 2945, vii. 1563.

tresor, s. P. 316, i. 2633, v. 69,
tresour, ii. 3305, treasure.

tresorer, s. ii. 3304.

tresorie, s. v. 134, 1922.

trespas, s. vii. 3327.

tresses, *see* **tresces**.

trete(n), v.n. P. 77, i. 7, 1099, ii. 3201, iii. 1831;
v.a. ii. 1686: treat, deal, deal with.

tretee, s.v. 5258, treaty.

treteur, s. iii. 2096, viii. 1937, traitor.

trewe, **trew**, a. P. 184, i. 702, 1198, iii. 2228, 2346, v. 2877, 7391, true;
superl. **the treweste**, ii. 1282.

trewes, s.pl. iv. 2708, truce.

trewly, **trewli**, **treuly**, i. 1650, iii. 66, iv. 921, v. 2536, 3454,
trewely, ii. 2018, iv. 1649,
trewliche, i. 1336, truly.

trewman, s. vii. 1640.

tribe, s. vii. 4118, viii. 136.

tribut, s. i. 2795, iv. 2159, v. 5365.

tricherie, s. i. 828, ii. 812, iv. 2078.

tricherous, *a.* ii. 3019.

Tricolonius, v. 1239.

trie, **trye**, *v.a.* ii. 3420, iv. 2456, v. 2895, vi. 1204, vii. 42, separate,
purify, test.

trinite, s. i. 3276, vii. 77.

triste, *v.a.n.* i. 1947, ii. 492, 1160,

truste, v. 2898,

pret. **triste**, i. 1983, 2573, 2874,

troste, i. 1739,

truste, v. 3894; trust.

tristesce, s. iv. 3396, 3432.

Tristram, vi. 471, viii. 2500.

Triton, v. 1192.

Trocinie, iv. 2928.

Troian, vii. 3144, Trajan.

Troie, i. 1078 ff., ii. 2452, iii. 974 ff., 1757, 1885 ff., 2643, iv. 81, 147 ff.,
772 ff., 1696, 1820 ff., 1903 ff., 2143, 2152, v. 1003, 1833, 2551,
3071, 3303, 5281, 6455, 7197 ff., vi. 1391, 1416, vii. 3585, viii.
2517, 2570, 2625;

newe Troye, P. 37*,

tale of (bok of) T., i. 483, iii. 971, v. 3245, vii. 1559.

Troiens, *pl.* v. 1839, 7211, vii. 3056.

Troieward, iv. 732, v. 6450.

Troilus, ii. 2457, iv. 2795, v. 7597, viii. 2531.

trompe, s. i. 2128, ii. 2866, vii. 3763.

trompen, *v.n.* i. 2139, sound a trumpet.

trompette, s. vii. 3744, trumpet.

trosse, *see trusse*.

trouble, *a.* v. 4160;
as subst. vi. 360: turbid.

trouble, *v.a.* vi. 362;
v.n. **trouble**, viii. 3009*.

trowe, *v.a.* P. 512, v. 580, 1925, believe;
v.n. i. 1925, 2691, iii. 531, believe, think.

trowthe, **trouthe**, *s.* P. 154, 488, i. 746, 1559, 1588, iv. 2747, v. 4363, vi.
2285, vii. 1724 ff.,
trouthe plight, vii. 4228,
pl. **trowthes**, i. 822: truth, assurance, loyalty.

truage, *s.* iv. 2175, v. 1553, 1726, tribute, subjection.

truandise, *s.* iv. 2767, laziness.

truantz, *s.pl.* iv. 342, idlers.

truffle, *s.* viii. 2062, trifle.

trusse, *v.a.* i. 2634, iv. 1398, pack.

trusse, **trosse**, *s.* v. 4966, v. 5056, vii. 3253*, bundle.

trust, *s.* P. 91, i. 3154, ii. 769, iii. 281,
trist, iii. 2754, v. 2133.

truste, *see triste*.

Tubal, iv. 2425.

tuelfthe, *see twelfthe*.

tuelve, *see twelve*.

Tullius, iv. 2648, vi. 1401, vii. 1589, 3163*, viii. 3119.

tumbe, **tombe**, *s.* iv. 3665, viii. 1527, 1581, tomb.

tun, *s.* viii. 830, tune.

tunder, *s.* ii. 1274, tinder.

tunderstonde (= to understonde), ii. 815.

tunge, *s.* P. 61*, i. 678, ii. 1602, iv. 2639,
tonge, iii. 1799, tongue, language.

(false) tungen, *a.* ii. 1751.

tunne, *see* **tonne**.

tuo, **two**, *num.* P. 336, i. 810, 2041, v. 188,
bothe tuo, P. 1068, i. 851.

turne, *see* **torne**.

Turne, iv. 2186.

turves, *s.pl.* v. 4031.

tweie, *num.* P. 18, i. 1344, v. 3610,
tweine, **tueine**, ii. 3472, v. 4040, two.

twelfthe, **tuelfthe**, *a.* vii. 1215, 1402.

twelve, **tuelve**, *num.* P. 158, 526, i. 1134, ii. 97.

twenty, *num.* iv. 1356, vii. 1227.

twinklunge, **twinclunge**, *s.* i. 3033, v. 5935.

twinne, *v.a.* iii. 423;
v.n. ii. 2293: separate, be separated.

twinnes, *s.pl.* vii. 1033, twins.

two, *see* **tuo**.

twyes, *adv.* v. 4094, twice.

tyde, *s.* *see* **tide**.

tyde, *v.n.* v. 3755, happen.

tyding(e), *see* **tidinge**.

tye, *s.* v. 3559, case.

tyh, *v.n.pret.* v. 5709, came.

tymber (1), *see* **timber**.

tymber (2), vi. 1844, timbrel.

tyme, *see time*.

tymliche, *adv.* iv. 3163.

Tymolus, v. 6831.

Typhon, v. 798 ff.

Tyr, viii. 375 ff.

tyrannye, *see tirannie*.

tyt, *adv.* v. 5769, vi. 1751, quickly.

U

Uluxes, Ulixes, Ulixé, i. 516 ff., iv. 147, 1818 ff., v. 3099 ff., 3201, vi. 1392 ff., viii. 2623.

umbreide, *v.a.* v. 5034, reproach.

unable, *a.* vii. 585, 3275, useless, incapable.

unaffiled, *a.* i. 2287, untrained.

unansuerd, *a.* ii. 2706.

unaperceived, *a.* v. 6271,
unaparceived, v. 7147*.

unaquit, *a.* ii. 3332, unrewarded.

unarme, *v.a.* v. 3803.

unarmed, *a.* vii. 3589.

unarraied, *a.* vii. 2659, in disorder.

unavanced, *a.* v. 2328.

unavised, *a. or adv.* i. 2701, iii. 1097, iv. 1241, unwise, unwisely.

unbegunne, *a.* viii. 1, without beginning.

unbehovely, *a.* vii. 1134, viii. 2884, unprofitable, unfit.

unbende, *v.a.pret.* i. 1967, unbent.

unbesein, *a.* viii. 153, devoid.

unbinde, *v.a.* viii. 2812,
pp. **unbounde**, *v.* 159.

unbore, **unborn**, *a.* i. 3164, iv. 3221, *v.* 1748.

unbounde, *a.* *v.* 7734.

unbuxom, *a.* i. 1255, 1272, disobedient.

unbuxomly, **unbuxomliche**, *adv.* i. 1368, vii. 3569, rebelliously.

unbuxomnesse, *s.* i. 1394, disobedience.

unchaste, *see* **thunchaste**.

unclene, *a.* ii. 575, unclean.

unclennesse, *s.* vii. 474.

unclose, *v.a.* *v.* 2376, open.

unclothe, *v.refl.* *v.* 3494.

uncoupled, *v.a.pp.* i. 2298.

uncouth, *a.* *v.* 5694.

undefendid, *a.* PP. 223, not forbidden.

under, *prep.* P. 108, i. 27, 1104, **undur**,
v. 1573, (**undir**, viii. 3060, PP. 39):
adv. P. 76, i. 2237, ii. 418.

underfonge, *v.a.* P. 68, iv. 206, viii. 1486,
pret. **underfing**, *v.* 7182*, *pp.*
underfonge, i. 63, ii. 1751, iv. 418,
(**undirfongen**, PP. 264), receive, accept.

undergete, *v.pp.* ii. 1133, come under.

underling, *s.* vi. 2350, vii. 1294.

undernethe, *prep.* ii. 2933;
adv. *v.* 3130.

undersette, *v.a.* *v.* 2157, support.

understonde, *v.a.n.* P. 206, 481, i. 46,

pret. **understod**, i. 1798,
(**undirstod**, PP. 150),
pret. subj. **understode**, P. 460, i. 2774,
imperat. **understond**, i. 1882, ii. 3132,
pp. **understonde**, P. 34*.

understondinge, s. iii. 1950, vi. 972, understanding, significance.

undertake, *v.a.n.* i. 2020, 3232, iv. 1967, v. 2340,
(**undirtake**, PP. 159),
pret. **undertok**, v. 2130,
(**undirtok**, viii. 3107),
pl. **undertoke**, v. 2077,
pp. **undertake**, P. 241, i. 1108, undertake, take in hand, declare.

undeserved, *a.* i. 51, vi. 358.

undo(n), *v.a.n.* i. 2855, iii. 690,
pret. **undede**, v. 2380,
imperat. **undo**, ii. 2483,
pp. **undo**, ii. 1016, v. 7450.

undoinge, s. vii. 4099.

undren, s. v. 3669.

unenvied, *a.* P. 115.

unethes, *adv.* P. 846, i. 1221,
unethe, iii. 2536,
noght (ne) ... unethes, iv. 570, 3478,
unnethes, vii. 5033, hardly.

unevene, *a.* P. 803, v. 4547:
adv. P. 170, iii. 14.

unfolde, *v.a.* iv. 686.

ungentilesce, s. iv. 845.

unglad, *a.* ii. 234, 3117,
pl. **unglade**, ii. 3287.

unglade, *v.a.* v. 5680.

ungoode, *a.pl.* P. 489, viii. 239.

ungoodly, *a.* v. 6136,
ungoodlich, v. 6293;
superl. def. **ungoodlieste**, iii. 422.

unhapp, *s.* ii. 3085, iii. 1466,
pl. **unhappes**, iv. 1024.

unhappely, *adv.* i. 376.

unhappi, *a.* ii. 2280, iii. 1390, v. 5685, unfortunate, ill-omened.

unholpe, *a.* v. 1862, unhelped.

unholy, *a.* v. 7021*.

unhorsed, *v.a.pp.* iii. 2658.

unite, *s.* P. 987, vii. 78, unity.

universiel, **universal**, *a.* vi. 2261, vii. 215.

unjoynted, *v.a.pp.* iv. 274.

unkemd, vii. 5023, uncombed.

unkendeli, *a.* ii. 3124, unnatural:
cp. **unkindeliche**.

unkest, *a.* ii. 467,
unkist, iv. 2712, unkissed.

unkinde, **unkynde**, *a.* i. 2565, iii. 374, 2055, iv. 849,
thunkinde, viii. 222, unnatural, ungrateful.

unkinde, *s.* viii. 222.

unkindeliche, *adv.* iii. 375, 2066,
unkindely, iii. 2065, viii. 2005, 2558, unnaturally, unkindly.

unkindenesse, *s.* v. 5141.

unkindeschipe, *s.* ii. 3103, v. 4699, 4887 ff.

unkist, *see* **unkest**.

unknet, *v.a.pp.* ii. 2372, v. 556, vii. 4828.

unknowe(n), *a.* P. 319, ii. 467, v. 1251, unknown; ii. 1105, v. 3148, not knowing.

unliche, unlich, unlike, *a.* v. 4415, vi. 1862, vii. 133, unequal, unlike, superior.

unliered, unlered, *a.* P. 233, iv. 611, untaught.

unloke, *v.a.pp.* P. 654, iii. 425, viii. 424, unlocked.

unlust, *s.* viii. 481, sorrow.

unlusti, *a.* ii. 1308, unhappy.

unmerciable, *a.* iii. 216, unmerciful.

unmete, unmeete, *a.* ii. 122, iii. 1100, iv. 3573, vii. 5030, unequalled, unworthy, far apart:
adv. v. 2140, beyond comparison.

unmyhti, *a.* v. 1502, unable.

unmylde, *a.* i. 1242.

unpeysed, *a.* P. 64*, unweighed.

unpike, *v.a.* v. 6509, unfasten.

unpinned, *pp.* iii. 424, unconfined.

unpitous, *a.* vii. 3411.

unpitously, *adv.* viii. 2994*.

unplein, *a.* i. 1058, dishonest.

unpreised, *a.* ii. 2078.

unprisone, *v.a.* vii. 3293, free from prison.

unprofitable, *a.* ii. 3108.

unpurse, *v.a.* v. 558, take from the purse.

unresonable, *a.* v. 761, viii. 2932.

unriht, *a.* ii. 2773, iii. 1247, wrong.

unrihte, *v.a.* ii. 506, v. 6744, set wrong, undo.

unrihtwisnesse, *s.* vii. 4724, 5270.
unsauhte, *a.(pl.)*, vii. 2034, out of accord.
unschette, *v.n.* iv. 2997, vii. 4968, open.
unsein, *a.* v. 3572, unseen.
unsely, *a.* i. 88, v. 459, viii. 2360, unhappy.
unsemlieste, *see thunsemlieste*.
unserved, *a.* iii. 2277.
unsittende, *a.* vii. 1736, unfitting.
unskilfully, *adv.* vii. 4757, unjustly.
unsofte, *a.* iii. 123.
unsowed, *v.a.pp.* viii. 1183.
unsped, *a.* viii. 532, without success.
unstable, *a.* P. 863, ii. 1226.
unstoken, *pp.* v. 34, opened.
untame, *a.* iii. 245, wild.
unteid, *a.* iii. 830, iv. 3462, vi. 598, unrestrained, wandering.
unthewed, *a.* i. 3040, wrongly disposed.
unthryve, *v.n.* v. 2508, be unprosperous.
until, *prep.* i. 2061, iv. 3058, unto.
unto, *prep.* P. 80, 152, i. 2162, iv. 684, &c.,
 un to, P. 339, viii. 3069.
untome (= unto me), iii. 99.
untoward, *prep.* iv. 559, v. 2622, towards.
untreuly, **untrewly**, *adv.* v. 5814, vii. 5239,
 untrewely, v. 6976.
untrewe, *a.* P. 536, i. 1201.
untrist, **untrust**, *s.* v. 585, 717, mistrust.

untrowthe, untrouthe, s. i. 926, ii. 852, 2750, v. 5683.

untrusse, v.a. v. 4988, unload.

unwaked, a. vii. 4966, asleep.

unwar, a. ii. 1041, iv. 15, vi. 1262,
pl. unaware, P. 393, ignorant, careless, unknown.

unwarli, adv. vii. 4784.

unwedded, a. ii. 785, v. 6436*.

unwelde, a. iii. 989, vii. 1855, unmanageable, helpless.

unwerred, a. iii. 2317, free from war.

unwis, *see unwys*.

unworschipe, s. vii. 2130, dishonour.

unworthely, adv. vii. 2479.

unwys, a. ii. 208, iv. 3529, **unwis**, viii. 2094, *def. unwise*, iii. 1799,
pl. unwise, v. 742.

up, *prep.* ii. 3469, iv. 1002, 1342, v. 160, upon:
adv. P. 570, i. 339, 1184, v. 3530;
cp. uppe:
up so doun, ii. 1744, iii. 80, iv. 561.

upbere, v.a., *pp.* **upbore**, v. 1814, viii. 405, 631.

upcaste, v.a.*pret.* iv. 3032, vii. 1156, *pp.*
upcast, i. 697.

updrawe, v.a.*pp.* ii. 794, v. 3313, viii. 599, brought up, drawn up.

upheld, v.a.*pret.* i. 985.

uplefte, v.a.*pret.* i. 1674, vii. 2264,
uplifte, i. 198, lifted up;
v.n. *uplefte*, P. 696, was raised.

upon, *prep.* P. 27, 61, 781, i. 968, 1000, 1197, 1599, 2673, ii. 2899, iii.
2425, iv. 236, 2080, 3101, (**uppon**, viii. 2959);
adv. v. 3556,

hier upon, v. 7206*: on, upon, into, with regard to, by reason of.
uppe, *adv.* P. 344, i. 2570, iv. 1831: *cp.* up.
upriht, upryht, *a. and adv.* P. 147, 656, 1028, i. 746, ii. 253, vii. 5282.
uprihtes, upryhtes, *adv.* P. 940, i. 2918, iii. 2634.
upriste, s. i. 2198, rising.
upset, *v.a.pp.* v. 2316, set up,
 upsete, viii. 244, overthrown.
upward, *adv.* i. 663, v. 3978.
us, s. P. 359, i. 2695, v. 137, use, usage.
usage, s. v. 7542, vi. 664.
usance, s. i. 2027, vi. 569, custom.
use(n), *v.a.* P. 397, i. 342, 1373, 2101, v. 6578,
 (*pp.* **usid**, viii. 2964), use, practise;
 v.n. ii. 400, v. 38, be wont.
usure, s. v. 4384 ff.

V

vailable, *a.* vii. 1526, 3176, PP. 142, serviceable.
vailant, *a.* iv. 1633, valiant.
vaile, *v.n.* vii. 144, profit.
Valentinian, v. 6398.
Valerie, Valeire, v. 6360, vii. 3181.
valleie, s. v. 1013, vii. 3320*, valley.
value, s. ii. 3410, iii. 2765.
vanite, s. i. 451, 2784, v. 215, vii. 2410.
vanyssht, *v.n.pp.* v. 3959.
variance, s. P. 542, vii. 1758.

vasselage, s. v. 902, 6435*, prowess.

veck, s. i. 1675, hag.

Vegecius, v. 885.

vegetabilis, iv. 2535.

veile, v.a. viii. 1261.

vein, a. ii. 1713,
 def. **vein**, P. 221, i. 599,
 fem. **veine**, P. 262, i. 2677,
 pl. **veine**, i. 2689;
 in vein, i. 1946, 2736, ii. 2253.

veines, **veynes**, s. *pl.* ii. 3123, iv. 3463, v. 4164, viii. 1186, veins.

veneison, s. iv. 1996, game (in hunting).

Venenas, vii. 1393.

venerie, s. v. 1262, hunting.

venerien, a. vii. 795, 1347.

vengable, a. iv. 3510, apt to take vengeance.

vengance, s. i. 378, 1433,
 (**vengaunce**, viii. 2997*).

venge(n), v.a. *and refl.* i. 991, 2578, ii. 1285, iii. 1013, vii. 2891, avenge.

vengement, s. i. 1457, viii. 220, vengeance.

Venus, i. 124, 235 ff., 2491, iii. 1462, 2555, iv. 419, 824, 1262, 1467,
 1787, 3558, 3658, v. 650, 859, 917, 1388 ff., 1493, 4827, 4861,
 5819, 5843, 6715, 6753, 7413, 7479 ff., vi. 506, 614, 639, 2425, vii.
 20, viii. 2172 ff.;
 (the planet) iv. 2473, 3245, vii. 773, 797, 1020, 1113, 1135, 1231,
 1315, 1382, 1395, 1421.

venym, s. P. 858, ii. 2294, 3490.

Ver, vii. 1014.

Verconius, iv. 2433.

vernage, s. vi. 218, (a kind of wine).

verrai, verray, *a.* P. 978, i. 1450, 2451, ii. 3397, iv. 2275,
veray, verai, iv. 2519, v. 1774, true.

verrailliche, verraily, *adv.* i. 904, vi. 116, 866.

vers, s. vi. 70, order.

vertu, s. P. 79, 360, iv. 2327, vii. 1545, virtue, power.

vertue, *v.refl.* iii. 2766, endeavour.

vertules, *a.* vii. 1319, without virtue.

vertuous, *a.* P. 39, ii. 7, iv. 2635, vii. 1327, 1548, virtuous, powerful.

verveyne, s. v. 4039.

Vesper, iv. 3209.

vessel(l), s. ii. 1133, 3445, vii. 3500.

Veste, v. 892.

vestment, s. v. 7135.

viage, s. ii. 2528, iv. 218, 1948, viii. 1540, journey.

vicair, s. ii. 2804.

vice, s. P. 79, i. 577, 647.

vicious, *a.* vii. 792.

victoire, s. P. 1001, i. 2476, iii. 2681.

vigile, s. iv. 3252.

vil, *a.* P. 887, i. 2098.

vilein, *a.* iii. 1182, v. 7203,
pl. **vileins**, P. 738, worthless, cowardly:
subst. iii. 1244, iv. 2300, vii. 3062, boor, commoner.

vilenie, vileinie, s. i. 2408, v. 170, viii. 1431, worthlessness, unworthy deed.

vines, *s.pl.* iv. 2441, v. 1229.

vinour, s. vii. 1875, vine-grower.

Viola, v. 4811, 4849.

violence, s. ii. 2977, iii. 24, iv. 607.

violent, *a.* vii. 946, 4551.

virelai, s. i. 2709, 2727.

Virgile, v. 2032, vi. 98, viii. 2714.

virgine, s. v. 1773 ff., 6363 ff., viii. 52.

virginite, s. v. 6243, 6340 ff., viii. 204.

Virginus, vii. 5136.

Virgo, vii. 1081 ff., 1249.

visage, s. P. 112, i. 1684, ii. 1789, iii. 1784, vii. 4046, face, appearance, pretext.

viser, s. i. 637, ii. 2081, mask.

visioun, s. v. 7410.

visite, *v.a.* ii. 917.

vitaile, *v.a.* ii. 711, 1031, victual.

Vitellus, **Vitelle**, vi. 538, 563.

voide, *a.* iv. 2098, v. 1914, viii. 36, empty, clear.

voide, **voyde**, *v.a.* i. 1890, ii. 2125, iv. 2084, PP. 317, empty, drive away.

vois, s. i. 495, 1828, v. 995, 1721, voice, rumour, vote.

voisdie, s. vii. 3739, cunning.

voluptuosite, s. viii. 156.

vou, s. v. 5816.

vouche, *v.a.* iii. 486, iv. 668, affirm.

vowe, *v.a.* i. 3021.

Vulcanus, v. 642 ff., 956.

W

wacche, *v.n.* ii. 110, watch.

wacche, **wachche**, *s.* iv. 2808, v. 2241, watch.

wade, *v.n.* ii. 2221, iii. 228.

waile, **weile**, *v.n.* i. 3025, v. 7443.

waileway, *interj.* viii. 327.

waisshe(n), *v.a.n. and refl.* v. 301, 1471,
pret.s. **wissh**, v. 306,
wysssh, v. 3806, vii. 2283,
pl. **wisshen**, v. 3836,
pp. **waisschen**, i. 2846; wash.

waite, **wayten**, *v.n.* ii. 110, 117, iii. 915, 2090, iv. 802, wait, keep watch;
v.a. v. 7112, PP. 204, watch for, attend to.

wake(n), *v.n.* iii. 51, iv. 2709, 2837, 3314,
pret. **wok**, i. 914, ii. 1349, wake, stay awake.

wakere, *s.* iv. 3162.

wakinge, *s.* iv. 3142.

wal, *see* **wall**.

Wales, ii. 904.

walke, *v.n.* i. 99, ii. 758, 2094, iii. 364.

wall, **wal**, *s.* P. 836, ii. 1089, 2893,
pl. **walles**, i. 1155.

walle, *v.a.* v. 7230.

wane, *s.* v. 5369, vii. 591.

wanhope, *s.* iii. 281, iv. 3397, despair.

wantounesse, *s.* iv. 1277, v. 6116, vii. 798.

wantounly, *adv.* iv. 1017.

war, *a.* P. 508, i. 330, 1075, ii. 557,

pl. **ware**, viii. 1392,
be war, ii. 1606, v. 7838, aware, careful.

war, *v.n. and refl. imperat.* **war thee wel**, iii. 968, v. 7606,
war hem wel, iii. 1113,
war, vii. 1137.

warant, s. i. 1695, ii. 1237, v. 1924, security, warrant.

warde, s. i. 332, iii. 1953, v. 5298, guard;
pl. **wardes**, v. 1868, wards (of a key).

warde, *v.a.n.* i. 331, 536, iii. 1954, v. 5297, guard.

wardein, s. v. 6614, 7152*.

warie, *v.a.* v. 510, 3913, curse.

warisoun (-on), s. i. 671, 3349, property.

warm, *a.* iii. 314, iv. 422, vii. 4135,
al warm, ii. 2485, v. 679.

warme, *v.a.* viii. 1194.

warne, *v.a.* i. 2506, ii. 1436, 2092, iv. 1432, warn, command, inform.

warnynge, s. viii. 581.

was, were, &c., see be.

was, *as subst.* viii. 2435.

wast, *a.* P. 839, v. 7816, desolate, wasted.

wast, s. (1), i. 1192, v. 356, 4656, waste.

wast, s. (2), v. 7143, waist.

waste, *v.a.* P. 649, i. 2836, 3310.

wastour, s. v. 1053.

water, s. i. 2194, ii. 2189, 3170, iv. 3009, vii. 238,
water stronde, i. 1169,
water Nimphes, v. 1182,
water spoute, vii. 1193.

watergates, *s.pl.* iii. 689, 987.

waterpot, *s.* iii. 673.

wawe, *s.* i. 2945, ii. 24, 728, iv. 3083.

waxe, **wexe**, *v.n.* P. 629, ii. 2260, iii. 56, iv. 345,
3 *s.pres.* **wext**, vi. 34,
waxeth, P. 1078,
3 *s.pret.* **wax**, P. 914, ii. 1713,
3 *pl.* **woxen**, P. 914, vii. 1995,
pp. **woxe**, v. 9, 6008.

way, *see* **weie**.

wayt, *s.* ii. 2447, 2999.

wayten, *see* **waite**.

we, *pron.* P. 2, i. 842, &c.,
cp. **ous**.

wedd, *s.* i. 1558, pledge;
to **wedde**, i. 1588, ii. 2662, iv. 2876, as a pledge.

wedde(n), *v.a.n.* i. 1587, 1741, 2486, ii. 623, 664, 1305, v. 486,
pp. **weddid**, iv. 650, **wedded**, i. 1761.

wedded, *a.* v. 4655, 5631.

weddinge, *s.* vii. 5326.

wede, *s.* ii. 1847, v. 6209, dress, cover.

weder, *s.* i. 2925, ii. 1888, iii. 1029, v. 7048, weather, wind.

weene, *s.* iv. 2595, expectation.

weene, *v.* *see* **wene**.

weer, *see* **wer**.

weie, *s.* P. 17, 232, i. 89, 818, 1002, 1712, 3440,
(**weye**, viii. 3058*),
wey, i. 1562,
way, v. 6596;
do wey, vii. 5408;

mi weie, his weie (= away), viii. 1452, PP. 336: way, road, means.

weie, *v.a.n.* v. 4412, vii. 1105, PP. 91,
pp. **weie**, PP. 320, weigh.

weile, *see waile*.

weke, s. i. 3110, vii. 957, week.

wel, *adv.* P. 92, 522, 616, &c.,
wiel, P. 648, vii. 816,
wel is, i. 1605,
wel you be, ii. 1513,
cp. iii. 840,
wel the more, &c., P. 55*, ii. 3512, 3523,
wel a fourtenyht, iv. 1418,
als (also) wel ... as, i. 1316, 2248 f., ii. 3408.

wel, wele, s. P. 547, i. 149, 2371, iii. 283, 780, iv. 1070, prosperity,
happiness.

welcome, *a.* v. 3788.

welcome, *v.a.* v. 3373, viii. 1895.

welcominge, welcomyng, s. ii. 671, v. 3813, vi. 1504.

welde(n), *v.a.* ii. 2411, iv. 1828, v. 77, 1631, vii. 657, manage, rule.

welfare, s. ii. 225, iv. 3412.

welke, *v.n.* P. 934, wither;
pp. **welked**, viii. 2437.

welkne, s. P. 928, iii. 985, viii. 1042.

welle, s. i. 148, 2306, 2343, iii. 1408, well, spring;
welle stremes, vii. 251.

wellwillende, *a.* iv. 507, well disposed.

welmore, *adv.* i. 973, iii. 455, 797, much more.

welnyh, *adv.* P. 30, i. 983, vi. 1685.

welthe, P. 95, 787, i. 2495, ii. 1207, prosperity, wealth.

welwillinge, s. iii. 599, 2258, goodwill.

wenche, s. ii. 3097.

wende(n), v.a. v. 522,
pret. **wente**, ii. 2248,
pp. **went**, P. 246, iii. 878, v. 4450, vii. 442, turn;
v.n. and refl. P. 591, i. 2090,
3 s.pres. **went**, i. 50,
pret. **wente**, i. 143, 826, 1163, v. 3314,
went, v. 7533, turn, go.

wene, **weene**, v.n. P. 337, 656, i. 681, 1603, 1897, ii. 2479, iv. 911, 2596,
pret. **wende**, i. 2005, ii. 2289, think, expect, trust;
v.a. i. 925, 1194, ii. 2018,
pret. **wende**, i. 1187, expect, believe.

wenge, *see* **wynge**.

wente, s. iv. 168, v. 2726, vi. 1029, vii. 2250, turn, way, device.

wenyng, **wenyng**, i. 1946, 1958, 2267, expectation, thought.

wepe, v.n. i. 115, 955, 965, 2325,
3 s.pres. **wepth**, i. 2338,
pret. **weppte**, i. 2180, 2325, weep.

wepinge, s. i. 2188, 3171, viii. 522.

wepne, s. ii. 1767, v. 338, weapon.

wepneles, a. vii. 2850, without arms.

wer, **weer**, s. P. 143, i. 1924, iii. 1148, doubt, difficulty.

werche, *see* **worche(n)**.

were (1), v.a. P. 356, iv. 1429,
pp. **wered (oute)**, P. 870, wear;
v.n. **were (oute)**, P. 368.

were (2), v.a. v. 3615, defend.

were, s. vii. 4813, wearing.

werinesse, s. vii. 3264*.

werk, s. P. 51, i. 1090, 2542,
pl. werkes, P. 491, iii. 1274.

werke, *see worche(n)*.

werkman, s. i. 1091.

werkmanschipe, s. i. 2541.

werne, *v.a.* i. 1931, ii. 85, iv. 2066, viii. 948;
v.n. i. 2622, prevent, refuse.

werre, s. P. 129, i. 2463, 3288, war.

werre, *v.a.* iii. 2489, 2537, fight against,
pp. werred, iv. 1805, be engaged in war;
v.n. iii. 2584, v. 6420*, make war.

werre, *see werse*.

werreiour, s. ii. 2516, iii. 2348, PP. 130.

werse, *a.comp.* P. 638, iii. 1563,
worse, P. 57, iii. 2598;
as subst. the werse, iii. 587,
the worse, v. 7353,
the werre, P. 176, iii. 1646,
for bet, for wers, iv. 673:
adv. wurse, v. 6994,
worse, vii. 5293.

werste, *a.sup.* i. 3057,
worste, iii. 2102;
as subst. the werste, P. 641, ii. 1675, v. 7363,
cp. viii. 1067,
the worste, ii. 443, v. 3278:
adv. werst, worst, i. 326, iv. 420,
worste, i. 2360.

wery, *a.* iii. 1153, vii. 415, weary.

west, s. vii. 565.

westward, *adv.* vii. 576.

wet, *a.* i. 1680,
 pl. **wete**, v. 4087;
 as subst. **the wete**, vi. 1271.

wete, *v.a.* vi. 1042,
 pret. **wette**, v. 3973, wet.

wether, *s.* v. 4045, vi. 429, ram.

wetinge, *s.* iv. 1109, wetting.

weve, *v.a.n.* v. 1283, vii. 4333,
 pret. **waf**, v. 5770, weave.

wevinge, *s.* iv. 1175.

wex, *s.* iv. 1055, vi. 1958, wax.

wexe, *see* **waxe**.

wey, *see* **weie**.

weyhte, *s.* ii. 341, 1926, iii. 1572, weight, balance.

weyve, *v.a.* i. 479, 2894, ii. 610, 2930, iii. 1061, iv. 3692, vi. 1456, 2058,
 weive, iii. 1854, viii. 1288, put aside, refuse, leave, vacate;
 v.n. ii. 3469, iii. 1768, 2509, turn aside, refuse, leave off.

whan, **whanne**, *conj.* P. 9, 343, i. 112,
 whan that, P. 37, 337,
 when, i. 1757, 2402.

what, *pron. and a.* P. 26, i. 881, (= whatever) P. 69*, i. 281, iii. 325,
 what man, iii. 2508,
 what womman, i. 1610,
 what ... that, P. 68, 399, 997,
 what as (evere), P. 487, i. 1830, v. 351,
 what ... what, iv. 701, v. 527, 7583,
 what ... and, viii. 856,
 what time, iv. 1983.

what, *s.* i. 1676, iii. 1217, v. 4429, thing.

whel, *see* **whiel**.

whelp, *s.* i. 1259.

when, *see whan, whenne*.

whenne, when, *interr. adv.* iv. 578, viii. 738, 989,
 fro whenne, ii. 3135, v. 614,
 fro whenne that, ii. 1147,
 fro when, iv. 1336;
 conj. **whenne as evere**, i. 3375,
 whenne that, ii. 1583: whence.

wher (1), **where**, *interr. adv.* P. 381, i. 126, 932;
 conj. P. 288, i. 35,
 wher that, P. 666,
 wher(e) as (evere), P. 893, i. 37, iii. 2339, iv. 2877;
 wher on, iv. 3001,
 elles where, ii. 1979, iii. 2079: where.

wher (2), *interr. adv.*,
 wher ... or, i. 57, 1811;
 conj., **wher ... or**, i. 789, iii. 1000, iv. 1516,
 wher so ... or, iv. 641, v. 466, 3569, viii. 2220: whether.

wherby, *rel. adv.* v. 4991.

wherinne, *rel. adv.* iv. 1835.

wherof, *rel. adv.* P. 47, i. 454, 829, 1203, iv. 1790, vii. 741,
 (**whereof**, PP. 17 ff., **wher of**, viii. 2952 ff.),
 wherof that, i. 541, 1266; of which, whence.

wherto, *rel. adv.* iii. 254.

wherupon, *rel. adv.* i. 12, v. 268,
 (**wher upon**, vi. 1762).

wherwith, *rel. adv.* v. 2618.

whete, s. iv. 1710, viii. 469.

whether, *a.* ii. 1725, iii. 1733, iv. 1741, which (of the two), which ever.

whether, *conj.*,
 whether that ... or, i. 1332, iv. 1092;
 cp. **wher** (2).

whi, why, interr. adv. P. 32, 849, i. 2149, iv. 2023,

why that, P. 557,

whi ne were it (a wish), iv. 2855;

for why, v. 4717.

which, rel. pron. and a. P. 52, 75, i. 193, 766, 2411, iii. 343 (that which),
2527,

the which, P. 71,

pl. **whiche**, P. 707, i. 404, ii. 604,

which, P. 1016,

which that, i. 94,

which(e) as, i. 1653, ii. 2082:

interr. i. 827;

in exclamation, iv. 1212, v. 388, 1186.

whider, interr. adv. iv. 578, 3446, whither.

whiderward, interr. adv. vii. 777.

whiel, whel, P. 138, 444, 561, i. 2490, ii. 241, 1822, iv. 1196, wheel.

whil, whyl, while, conj. P. 252, i. 762, ii. 1010, iii. 1577, iv. 1495,

whil that, whyl that, i. 963, 3384.

while, whyle, s. P. 558, i. 706, 756, 1094, 1264, 1577, 2628, ii. 1846,
2324, 2862, v. 6752;

al the while (*as conj.*), iii. 2530,

the whyle, iv. 1565, (meanwhile): short time, time, leisure.

whiles, whyles, see therwhile.

whilom, P. 54, 886, i. 975, **whylom**, iv. 2347, formerly.

whippe, s. iii. 120.

who, pron. indef., who that, P. 13, 550, i. 481,

who so, P. 1002,

who so that, v. 50,

who as evere, iv. 1096, 1685,

as who seith, P. 43, i. 1381, 2794:

interr. P. 176,

who was who, vii. 2001, viii. 2461:

relat. **whom**, P. 85,

the whom, ii. 162,
whos, P. 444,
the whos, iv. 3039, v. 1798:
cp. **which**.

why, *see whi*.

whyt, whit, *a.* ii. 1506, iii. 797, iv. 1348,
def. **whyte**, iv. 859,
pl. **whyte**, i. 2045, iv. 1310:
as subst. **whyt**, iv. 1317,
the whyt, v. 3016,
the whyte, iv. 2571.

wicchecraft, *s.* vi. 1288.

wicke, *a.* ii. 571, iii. 115, 462, 1651, v. 7353,
wikke, viii. 3025, *bad*:
as subst. v. 5915.

wicke, *s.* i. 3312, ii. 495, *evil*.

wicked, *a.* ii. 496, iii. 1626,
wickid, iii. 649, vii. 3805,
wikkid, P. 459.

wickedly, *adv.* i. 959.

wickednesse, wikkidnesse, *s.* vii. 4723, 5060.

wide, *see wyde*.

wiel, *see wel*.

wierde, *s.* iii. 1819,
weerdes, (*pl.*) iv. 2765, *destiny*.

wif, *s.* i. 677, 765, 1573,
genit. **wyves**, i. 2500,
dat. **to wyve**, v. 2686,
pl. **wyves**, ii. 1283, v. 6019, *woman, wife*.

wifhode, *s.* i. 974, v. 456, vi. 1475.

wifles, *a.* i. 1411, viii. 1760, *without wife*.

wihssinge, s. iii. 1174, wishing.

wiht, **wyht**, s. i. 28, 315, 745, 1548,
wight, i. 3011, person, creature.

wikkid, **wikkidnesse**, *see wicked*, &c.

wilde, **wylde**, *a.* P. 68*, 1057, i. 1241, ii. 161, 2295, iii. 325, 1638,
a wylde fyr, v. 2178.

wildernesse, s. iv. 1975, v. 1263,
wyldernesse, vii. 3216*.

wile, *see wyle*.

wilful, *a.* iii. 2449.

wille, **will**, s. P. 477, i. 190, 928, 1953, iii. 1161 ff., iv. 1828,
(**wil**, P. 72*, viii. 3037*), will, pleasure, wilfulness.

willinge, s. v. 5744.

wind, *see wynd*.

winde, *v.a., pret.* **wond**, v. 6889.

winge, *see wyng*.

winke, **wynke**, *v.n.* i. 384, v. 1842, close the eye.

winne, *see wynne*.

winnyng, s. iii. 2284.

wirche, *see worche(n)*.

wis, *see wys*.

wisdom, s. P. 13, i. 2267, viii. 1483.

wise, s. P. 463, i. 478, 747, 2018, 3027,
wyse, P. 8, manner.

wisemen, *see wysman*.

wisly, *see wysly*.

wiss, *adv.*, **als so wiss**, v. 3487,
als so wiss ... as, v. 4444, surely.

wisse(n), *v.a.* P. 232, iii. 1640, v. 1669, inform, guide.

wisshe, *v.n.* i. 115, 3164, iii. 1575, iv. 11,
pret. **wisshide**, i. 120.

wisshes, *s.pl.* iii. 1507, iv. 1107, vii. 4826.

wist, *see wite*.

wit, **witt**, *s.* P. 14, i. 1309, 1907, iii. 609, 1163 ff.,
pl. **wittes**, P. 81, i. 296, mind, reason, wits, senses.

wite(n), *v.a.n.* P. 286, i. 2742,
2 *s.pres.* **wost**, ii. 3528,
3 *s.* **wot**, P. 27, ii. 226,
woot, i. 1640,
3 *pl.* **witen**, i. 608,
pret. **wiste**, P. 1024, i. 911, 931, ii. 36,
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